German, Step by Step, Root by Root

An etymology-driven curriculum, built one word at a time

Adhithya Rajasekaran

This edition compiled incrementally — new chapters added as they are written.

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Preface

This book teaches German one word at a time, and it teaches each word by taking it apart. It is written for someone starting from zero, whose only shared language is English. The method is the same as its companion volumes — one word per lesson, gone deep — but the etymology flows through a different channel. Spanish and French are Latin's children; *German is English's sibling.* Both are Germanic languages, so German words are most often *direct cousins* of English words, with no Latin middleman: *gut* is English *good*, *Tag* is *day*, *Nacht* is *night*. The gaps between them are not random — they follow the **High German Consonant Shift** (*d*→*t*, *t*→*s*, *k*→*ch*), a single sound-law you can learn once and then use to guess the English cousin on sight (the Romance languages have their own such laws — Latin *-ct-* became Spanish *-ch-*).

Where it lights something up, the book sets German beside its cousins — English always, and Spanish and French as Latin's side of the family, each form supplied in full so no prior knowledge of them is needed. The richest moment is *Nacht*, where German *Nacht*, English *night*, Spanish *noche*, and French *nuit* turn out to be the same Indo-European word, split four ways.

How to use this book

Every numbered section is one word, or one small phrase, and takes a few minutes — the length of a queue, an errand, or the walk to the bus. Read them in order the first time through: each section stands on the ones before it, and nothing is used before it has been taught. After that the book becomes reference, and you can open it anywhere.

Say the German out loud wherever you can. The prompts under *Your turn* are written to be spoken, and saying a word is most of what makes it stay. The questions under *Before you move on* carry their own answers in brackets: cover them, answer from memory, then look.

Nothing here is gated behind pronunciation. Each lesson names the one

or two sounds its own word needs, exactly where they are needed. The whole system is gathered in a reference at the back of the book — somewhere to look things up when you are curious, never a chapter to sit through first.

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244.3 ablehnen 1679
244.4 abschließen 1680
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245 To pay attention, To spend, To pronounce, To answer, To end 1683
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245.3 aussprechen 1685
245.4 beantworten 1686
245.5 beenden 1686

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248 To furnish, To end, To discover, To excuse, To find out 1701
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249 To complete, To get done, To appear, To produce, To demand 1707
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Chapter 1

Greetings

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (12) ✓ **pen** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 16 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can greet someone in German, recognize the reply, and choose an appropriate response.
>
> *The German greetings, built from their pieces — a word for "good," the day-parts, and the three-gender article system. Because German and English are siblings, most words here are direct cousins, reshaped by the High German Consonant Shift; where it helps, Spanish and French stand alongside for contrast. Writing begins with the same familiar cousin: follow one visible Hallo, then copy it once while the model stays in sight — no hidden spelling and no second word are due. GE-C01-practice closes the chapter by running the whole arc, casual to bedtime.*

1.1 hallo — "hello," and this time it *is* a cousin

Your first German word — and a reassuring one, because German and English are close cousins: *both are Germanic languages.* That kinship will help you all through this book, and *hallo* is the first proof.

Sounds you'll need

- German **h** is pronounced (not silent like Spanish/French): *HA-lo.*
- German **a** is a clean, open *ah.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hallo — informal "hello / hi." Unlike Spanish *hola* (which only *looks* like "hello" by coincidence — a false friend), German **hallo** and English **hello** are the real thing: both grew from the same old Germanic hailing call (*hala*, a shout to get attention or hail a ferryman), the same family as English *holla*, *hollo*, and *hail*. Nineteenth-century English "hello" was even shaped partly by German *hallo*.

> The pattern to carry through this whole book: because English is a Germanic language, German words are often **direct cousins** of English words — same family, no Latin middleman. (The Romance languages like Spanish and French reach English mostly *through* Latin; German reaches it directly.)

Why it's said this way

hallo is informal-to-neutral — fine among friends, and increasingly common generally. Polite or first meetings often use a daytime greeting instead. You will build that greeting one familiar piece at a time over the next few lessons.

Writing — follow one word you can see

Keep **Hallo** visible. Trace directly over it, then copy it once in large, slow letters. Say *HA-lo* while your hand moves. Stop there.

This is not spelling from memory and not free writing. Your eye and hand are only following a word whose meaning and sound are already on the page.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "hallo" — *HA-lo*, with a real *h*
- "hallo" then English "hail", "holler" — the true hailing family

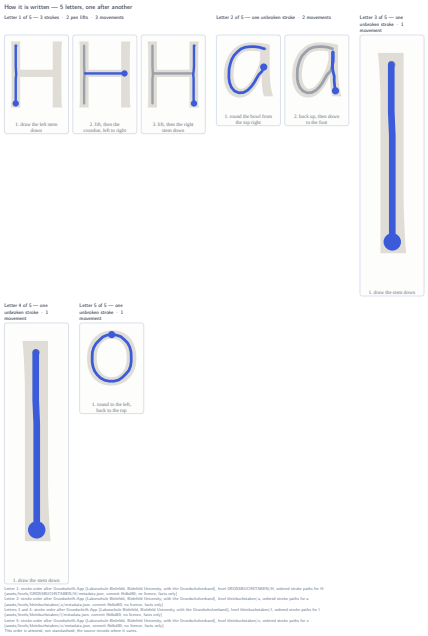
Before you move on

Is German *hallo* a real cousin of English *hello*, or a coincidence like Spanish *hola*? (A real cousin — same Germanic hailing root.)

1.2 Hallo — copy one greeting with help

Point to **Hallo** and say it once: *HA-lo*. The model stays on the page.

Writing — one guided copy



How Hallo is written, letter by letter, stroke by stroke

Copy **Hallo** once on the line below it. Begin with the tall capital **H**, then follow with **allo**. Look back at the model whenever you want.

Say the word as you finish. Then draw one small line under the **H** that German and English inherited in the same old hailing family.

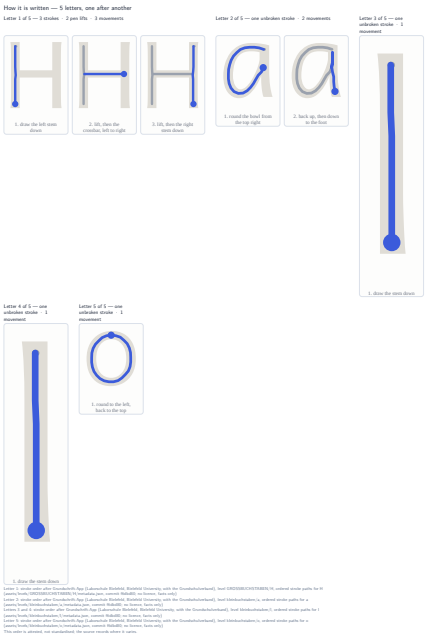
Before you move on

Compare your copy with the model. If one letter differs, repair only that letter. No hiding, no spelling test, and no second word today.

1.3 Hallo — write it with the model covered

Look at **Hallo** once and say it: *HA-lo*. Then cover it.

Writing — delayed copy



How Hallo is written, letter by letter, stroke by stroke

With the model covered, wait ten seconds, then write **Hallo** once from memory.

Ten seconds is long enough that your hand cannot be copying a shape it can still see, and short enough that a word you met a minute ago is still there.

Only after the word is finished, uncover the model. Compare, and repair **one** letter — the first that differs and no others.

Before you move on

Check the **H** before anything else. Hearing *HA-lo* tells you nothing about whether the first letter is tall, and an English-trained hand writes *hallo* without noticing.
Both spellings exist in German, which is exactly why the capital is worth checking rather than assuming: the double **l** is the part the sound guarantees, and the capital is the part it does not.

1.4 Hallo — write it from the sound

Cover every **Hallo** on the page. Nothing to copy and nothing to uncover.

Writing — dictation

Say *HA-lo* aloud, or play it, and write what you hear. Once.

A delayed copy asks your hand to remember a shape. Dictation asks it to turn a **sound** into a shape, which is the thing writing is actually for, and the two do not always arrive together.

Before you move on

Uncover the model and compare. You heard **one** *l* and the page wants **two**.
That doubled letter is not decoration and it is not about the *l* at all — it is German telling you about the vowel in front of it. A doubled consonant means the vowel before it is **short**, so *Hallo* has the clipped *a* of *HA-lo* rather than a long one. German writes the length of its vowels by what comes after them, and this greeting is the first place you meet the rule.

1.5 gut — "good," and the sound-law that reshapes German

This word starts most German greetings. It's a direct twin of English "good" — and the *tiny* difference between them (*good* vs *gut*) opens the single most useful decoding rule in the language.

Sounds you'll need

- German **u** = *oo* as in *food* or English *boot*: *goot*. The final **t** stays crisp — never softened. → reference

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gut — "good." Root: Proto-Germanic ***gōdaz** — and English **good** comes from the *exact same* word. No Latin in sight; German and English just inherited it from their shared Germanic parent.
So why *gut* and not *good*? One sound-law:
The High German Consonant Shift. Long ago, German (but not English) pushed a whole set of consonants forward. One of its rules: **d** → **t**. So every English *d* tends to show up as *t* in German:

English	German
goo**d**	gu**t**
day	**T**ag
be**d**	Be**tt**
do	**t**un

It's a single regular sound-law — the same kind of trick that reshaped the Romance languages (Latin *-ct-* became Spanish *-ch-*, *noche*). Learn the shift once, and you can guess the English cousin behind a German word (and vice-versa) on sight. More rules of the shift as we go.

Grammar Lens: German merges "good" and "well"

English splits *good* (adjective) from *well* (adverb); Spanish splits *bueno* from *bien*; French splits *bon* from *bien*. **German does not** — *gut* is *both*. "A good day" is *ein guter Tag* — and the very same *gut* is how you say you are doing well, which is what the wellbeing exchange is built on. One word covers the whole job, so the Romance *bien/bueno* pair collapses back into a single German word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "gut" — *goot*
- "gut" then "good" — the d→t shift

- "Tag" then "day"; "gut" then "good" — same shift, twice

Before you move on

English *d* becomes which letter in German? (*t* — *good*→*gut*, *day*→*Tag*.) Does German split "good" and "well" like English? (No — *gut* is both.)

1.6 der, die, das — "the," and the gender English *and* the Romance languages lost

Before your first noun: German's words for "the." Many European languages tag every noun with a grammatical *gender* — Spanish and French each run two — and German has it too, but with a twist neither of them kept.

Sounds you'll need

- **der** = *dair*, **die** = *dee*, **das** = *dahss*. The **r** of *der* is barely a vowel-like murmur at the back of the mouth, not an English *r*; *die* rhymes with English *see*; the final **s** of *das* is a sharp *ss*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

der — "the" (masculine). **die** — "the" (feminine). **das** — "the" (neuter). Roots: the old Germanic demonstratives ***sa / *sō / *þat** ("that one") — the *same* family as English **the** and **that**:

- **das** ↔ English **that** (the High German shift again: English *t* → German *s*, so *that* → *das*).
- **die** ↔ the *-y* of English **the**/**they**.

Unlike Spanish *el/la* and French *le/la* (both from Latin *ille/illa*), German's articles are cousins of English's own "the" — Germanic all the way.

Grammar Lens: German kept THREE genders

Here's the twist. Latin had three genders (masculine, feminine, neuter); Spanish and French **collapsed to two**, folding neuter into

masculine. German **kept all three**: *der* (masc.), *die* (fem.), *das* (neut.). So a German noun is one of *three* classes, not two — and, as everywhere, the gender is unpredictable and must be learned *with* the noun and its article. English, meanwhile, threw gender out entirely and kept a single "the" — the opposite extreme. Your next nouns will let you practise that pairing.
One more thing coming later: German articles also change by **case** (their job in the sentence), so *der* has other forms (*den, dem, des*). Ignore that for now; learn *der / die / das* as the three "the"s and leave it there.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der", "die", "das"
- "das" then English "that" — the t→s shift
- "der" for masculine, "die" for feminine, "das" for neuter

Before you move on

How many genders does German keep, vs Spanish/French? (Three vs two — German kept the neuter, *das*.) What English word is *das* a cousin of? (*That*.)

1.7 Tag — "day," a straight cousin of English *day*

Your first German noun. In Spanish "day" was *día* (via Latin); in French, *jour* (via a longer Latin detour). In German it's *Tag* — and it's English "day" with one consonant shifted, and nothing else.

What to know first

- der / die / das — gender; *Tag* is masculine, *der Tag*.

Sounds you'll need

- **Tag** = *tahk* — a long open *a*, the vowel of English *father*; Germans harden a final *-g* to a *k* (**final devoicing**), so *Tag* rhymes with English *tock*, not with English *tag*. German nouns are always **Capitalized** (every noun, not only names).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

der Tag — "the day" (masculine). Root: Proto-Germanic ***dagaz** — and English **day** is the same word. The only difference is the High German Consonant Shift from the *gut* lesson (**d** → **t**): *dagaz* → English *day*, German *Tag*.
So the three Romance-and-Germanic "day" words line up by ancestry:

- Spanish *día*, French *jour* ← Latin *dies* / *diurnum*
- German **Tag** ↔ English **day** ← Germanic **dagaz*

Two entirely different roots for "day" (Latin *dies* vs Germanic *dagaz*) — which is why *día* and *Tag* look nothing alike, even though both languages are cousins far enough back.

Grammar Lens

Tag is **masculine** (*der Tag*) — learn it with its article, as always. Also note the capital *T*: German writes **every** noun with a capital letter, a spelling rule no other language here shares.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Tag" — *dair tahk*
- "Tag" then "day" — hear the d→t shift

Before you move on

Tag and English *day* share a Germanic root; the shift is which consonant change? (*d→t.*) What's odd about how German writes *Tag*? (Capitalized — all German nouns are.)

1.8 Guten Tag — assembled, and a first taste of German endings

Snap *gut* and *Tag* together for the standard polite greeting. But notice — *gut* shows up as *gut**en***, and that extra *-en* is your first glimpse of how German adjectives work.

What to know first

- gut · Tag

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Guten Tag = **gut** ("good") + **Tag** ("day") = "good day," the neutral polite "hello" for daytime. Said *GOO-ten tahk*. Both words are inherited: *gut* ← Old High German *guot*, and *Tag* ← Proto-Germanic **dagaz*, the same word as English *day* (EtymDB 2.1).

Grammar Lens: why *guten*, not *gut*?

Like every Germanic and Romance adjective, German *gut* **agrees** with its noun — but German adjectives agree in *more* dimensions than Spanish or French: not only gender and number, but **case** (the noun's job in the sentence). *Guten Tag* is a frozen piece of a longer wish — "I wish you a good day" — and in that fuller thought, "a good day" is the *object* of the wishing (the accusative case). For a masculine noun in that role, *gut* takes the ending **-en**: *guten*. The rest of the wish fell away and left the ending behind.
Don't try to master German's ending system now — it's a later chapter. Just bank two things: (1) German adjectives take endings that shift with gender, number, *and* case; (2) the greeting is really "(I wish you a) good day," which is why it's *guten*. A later bedtime greeting will give you a gentle contrast with a feminine noun and a different ending.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Guten Tag" — *GOO-ten tahk*
- "Hallo" (casual) then "Guten Tag" (polite) — the register gap

Before you move on

Guten Tag literally shortens from what fuller phrase? ("[I wish you a] good day.") Why the *-en* on *gut*? (Adjective agreement — masculine, accusative.)

1.9 Morgen — "morning," hiding in your English *tomorrow*

The morning word — and a straight English cousin again, once you spot it.

What to know first

- Tag — same build ahead: *guten* + this noun.

Sounds you'll need

- **Morgen** = *MOR-gun* — stress the first syllable; the *g* is a hard *g*; the German *r* is soft and guttural; the unstressed *-en* sinks to a soft *-un*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

der Morgen — "the morning" (masculine). Root: Proto-Germanic ***murganaz** — the same root as English **morning**, **morn**, and the *-morrow* in **tomorrow** ("to-morrow" = "at [the] morning [to come]"). No Latin detour; German *Morgen* and English *morning* are the same Germanic word, barely changed.

A small false-friend warning for later: German *Morgen* can also mean **"tomorrow."** A later farewell will reuse it with that meaning. Context tells the two senses apart; English keeps them in separate words (*morning* vs *tomorrow*), while German lets *Morgen* do both jobs.

Grammar Lens

Morgen is **masculine** (*der Morgen*) — so, like *Tag*, it will take *guten* in the greeting.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Morgen" — *dair MOR-gen*
- "Morgen" then English "morning", "tomorrow" — the same root

Before you move on

What English words share *Morgen*'s root? (*morning*, *morn*, *to-morrow*.) *Morgen* is masculine — so "good morning" will use *gut* with which ending? (*guten* — like *guten Tag*.)

1.10 Guten Morgen — good morning

Same assembly as *Guten Tag*, one noun swapped. Nearly free.

What to know first

- Guten Tag · Morgen

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Guten Morgen = **gut** ("good") + **Morgen** ("morning") = "good morning." *Morgen* is masculine, exactly like *Tag*, so *gut* takes the same **-en**: *guten* — no new agreement to learn. Said *GOO-ten MOR-gen*.
Morgen ← Old High German *morgan* (EtymDB 2.1), kin to English *morn*.
Used in the morning (roughly until midday); after that, German switches to *Guten Tag*. You will build the evening greeting next, from the same familiar pattern.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Guten Morgen" — *GOO-ten MOR-gen*
- "Guten Morgen" then "Guten Tag" — morning, then midday

Before you move on

Why is it *guten* Morgen (same ending as *Guten Tag*)? (*Morgen* is masculine too.)

1.11 Abend — "evening," cousin of English *eve*

The evening word — a quieter English cousin than the others, but a real one.

What to know first

- Tag — the same *guten* + noun build.

Sounds you'll need

- **Abend** = *AH-bent* — stress the first syllable; a long open *a*; the final *d* hardens to a *t* sound (German de-voices final consonants, exactly as it did to the *-g* of *Tag*).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

der Abend — "the evening" (masculine). Root: Proto-Germanic ***ābanþs** — the same root as English **eve** and **even(ing)** (as in *Christmas Eve*, "the eve of…"). English wore it down to *eve*; German kept more of it as *Abend*. Same Germanic word for "the close of the day."

> Contrast worth banking across all four languages: "evening" has a *different* root in each branch — Germanic *ābanþs* (German *Abend*, English *eve*), vs Latin *sērus* "late" (French *soir*) and Latin *tardus* "late" (Spanish *tarde*). The Romance pair named it after *lateness*; the Germanic pair named it after the *evening-down* of the day.

Grammar Lens

Abend is **masculine** (*der Abend*) — so, again, *guten* in the greeting. Three masculine day-parts in a row (*Tag*, *Morgen*, *Abend*) all take *guten*. The next day-part is feminine, so it will gently show you a different ending without adding a new rule to memorize now.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Abend" — *dair AH-bent*
- "Abend" then English "eve", "evening"

Before you move on

Abend is a cousin of which English words? (*eve*, *evening.*) Is it masculine or feminine? (Masculine — *der Abend*, takes *guten.*)

1.12 Guten Abend — good evening

The evening member of the set. Same *guten*, one more masculine noun.

What to know first

- Guten Tag · Abend

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Guten Abend = **gut** + **Abend** (masculine) = "good evening," *GOO-ten AH-bent*. *guten* again — the third masculine day-part in a row.
You now have the daytime arc: **Guten Morgen** (morning) → **Guten Tag** (midday/afternoon) → **Guten Abend** (evening). All *guten*, all masculine. Only bedtime is left — and it breaks the pattern. *Abend* ← Old High German *āband* (EtymDB 2.1), kin to the *even* of English *evening.*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Guten Abend" — *GOO-ten AH-bent*
- the arc — "Guten Morgen, Guten Tag, Guten Abend"

Before you move on

All three day-greetings use *guten* — because their nouns are all which gender? (Masculine.)

1.13 Nacht — "night," where all four of your languages meet

This is the best cross-language word in the whole chapter. German *Nacht*, English *night*, Spanish *noche*, French *nuit* — **all four are the same word**, traced back far enough. Here's the family reunion.

What to know first

- der / die / das — *Nacht* is feminine, *die Nacht*.

Sounds you'll need

- **Nacht** = *nahkht* — the **ch** is the guttural *loch* sound: a scrape at the back of the mouth, after the open *a*, and **not** an English *ch*. It is the same throat-scrape as Spanish *j* (*jamón*) and Arabic *kh*. → reference

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

die Nacht — "the night" (feminine). Root: it goes all the way back to **Proto-Indo-European *nók^{w}ts** ("night") — the deep ancestor of *every* one of your night-words:

Branch	Word
German (Germanic)	**Nacht**
English (Germanic)	**night**
Spanish (Latin)	**noche**
French (Latin)	**nuit**
(the Latin itself)	*noctem*

They split apart by each branch's own sound-laws — Germanic turned the *kt* into *ht* (**Nacht**, **night**; that's Grimm's Law), while Latin kept *ct* (*noctem*), which Spanish then softened to *-ch-* (**noche**) and French to *-it-* (**nuit**). Four languages, four rules, one PIE word. When you say

Nacht, you're saying the same ancient syllable as *noche* and *nuit*.

Grammar Lens

Nacht is **feminine** — *die Nacht* — inherited from its Germanic gender (and it matches feminine *noche/nuit/noctem*, all feminine too). Its gender matters immediately: it's why "good night" is *gut**e** Nacht*, not *guten*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "die Nacht" — *dee nahkht*, guttural *ch*
- the family — "Nacht, night, noche, nuit"

Before you move on

Nacht, night, noche, nuit all descend from one PIE word — roughly what? (**nók^{w}ts*, "night.") Is *Nacht* masculine or feminine? (Feminine — *die Nacht*.)

1.14 Gute Nacht — good night, and the ending that finally changes

The greeting that breaks the *guten* streak — and shows you exactly what German's endings are tracking.

What to know first

- gut · Nacht

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gute Nacht = **gut** ("good") + **Nacht** ("night") = "good night," *GOO-te nahkht*. *Nacht* ← Proto-Germanic **nahts*, the same word as English *night* (EtymDB 2.1).

Grammar Lens: *gute*, not *guten*

Three greetings in a row were *gut**en*** (Tag, Morgen, Abend — all masculine). This one is *gut**e***. The reason is the one you set up: *Nacht* is **feminine**, and a feminine noun in the "(I wish you a) good _____" accusative takes the ending **-e**, not **-en**. So the endings line up:

- *gut**en** Tag / Morgen / Abend* — masculine → **-en**
- *gut**e** Nacht* — feminine → **-e**

That single vowel is German's adjective quietly reporting the noun's gender — exactly the job *bueno/buena* and *bon/bonne* did in Spanish and French, just with German's own endings.

Why it's said this way

Like Spanish *buenas noches* and French *bonne nuit*, *Gute Nacht* is the **bedtime** farewell — "sleep well," said on parting for the night, not an evening hello (that's *Guten Abend*). Same split French makes; German keeps the greeting (*Abend*) and the send-off (*Nacht*) apart.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Gute Nacht" — *GOO-te nahkht*
- "Guten Tag" then "Gute Nacht" — hear *-en* vs *-e*, and say why

Before you move on

Why *gute* Nacht but *guten* Tag? (*Nacht* is feminine, *Tag* masculine — the ending agrees.) Is *Gute Nacht* a greeting or a bedtime farewell? (Bedtime farewell.)

1.15 die — one article for every plural

You have learned three words for "the," one per gender. Here is the relief: in the plural there is only ever **one**.

You'll want to know: *die* for every plural

Singular: **der** Tag · **der** Morgen · **der** Abend · **die** Nacht
Plural: **die** Tage · **die** Morgen · **die** Abende · **die** Nächte

Whatever the noun's gender, the plural article is **die**. *der* → *die*, *das* → *die*, *die* → *die*. Three genders in the singular collapse to one form in the plural — German, like French with *les*, spends a single article on every plural noun there is.

Sounds you'll need

Many German plurals bend the vowel as well as adding an ending. *Nacht* → *Nächte*: the open *a* of *nahkht* is fronted to **ä**, the vowel of English *bed*, so *Nächte* is *NEKH-tuh*. That two-dot mark is called an **umlaut**, and the vowel change it writes down is one of German's regular plural signals.

Grammar Lens: the four day-parts in the plural

singular	plural	what changed
der Tag	**die Tage**	article, plus *-e*
der Morgen	**die Morgen**	article only — the noun is unchanged
der Abend	**die Abende**	article, plus *-e*
die Nacht	**die Nächte**	article, plus *-e*, plus the umlaut *a* → *ä*

German plurals are not built from one rule the way English adds *-s*. Each noun carries its own plural, which is why a German noun is worth learning as a set of three: *der Tag, die Tage*. The one thing that never varies is the article.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

die goes back to Old High German *dio*, *diu*, plural forms of the pointing word "that" — inherited, from the same Proto-Germanic stem as English *the* and *that*. EtymDB 2.1 has no row for German *die*; it traces English *that* to Proto-Germanic **þat*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Tag, die Tage" — singular, then plural
- "der Abend, die Abende"
- "die Nacht, die Nächte" — hear the *a* bend to *ä*
- "der Morgen, die Morgen" — only the article moved

Before you move on

Which article do German plurals take? (**die** — always, whatever the gender.) Which of the four day-parts looks the same in the plural? (*Morgen* — *der Morgen, die Morgen.*) What changed in *Nächte* besides the ending? (The vowel — *a* took an umlaut and became *ä*.)

1.16 Practice — the German greetings

No new words — only the day's arc, until the endings are automatic.

What you've built

- **hallo** — casual "hi" (a *real* cousin of English "hello").
- **gut** — "good" *and* "well" (← Germanic **gōdaz* = English *good*; the d→t shift).
- **der / die / das** — "the," and German's *three* genders (kept the neuter).
- **Guten Morgen → Guten Tag → Guten Abend** — the daytime arc, all *guten* (masculine nouns).
- **Gute Nacht** — bedtime farewell, *gute* because *Nacht* is feminine.

Two threads: **register** (*hallo* vs *Guten Tag*) and **agreement** (*guten* for masculine day-parts, *gute* for feminine *Nacht*). And one big idea: German words are **direct Germanic cousins of English**, reshaped by the High German Consonant Shift (*good*→*gut*, *day*→*Tag*, *that*→*das*).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- greet a friend casually, then politely — *hallo* / *Guten Tag*
- the right greeting for right now — morning/day/evening
- "Guten Tag" then "Gute Nacht" — and say why the ending changes
- three shift-cousins — gut/good, Tag/day, das/that

Twice through: Run Guten Morgen → Guten Tag → Guten Abend → Gute Nacht without hesitating on *guten*/*gute*.

Before you move on

Which German greeting uses *gute*, not *guten*, and why? (*Gute Nacht* — *Nacht* is feminine.) Which English words are cousins of *Abend* and *Nacht*? (*Eve* and *evening*; *night* — whose older root also gave Spanish *noche* and French *nuit*.) Next chapter, you will learn to introduce yourself and then build the friendly and respectful ways to address someone.

Chapter 2

Introducing Yourself

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (10) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 10 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can introduce myself in German, give my name, and understand the other person's name.
>
> *Now a first real exchange — giving your name, asking for someone else's, and saying you are glad to meet them: Ich heiße Mira. — Wie heißen Sie? — Ich heiße Arun. — Freut mich. It is built the way the greetings were: each piece taken apart first, then assembled — and, because German is English's sibling, most of those pieces are direct English cousins. GE-C02-practice puts the four lines back together at the end.*

2.1 ich — "I," the same ancient word as Latin *ego*

To introduce yourself, first "I." German's is a three-letter word hiding a very deep root.

Sounds you'll need

- **ich** = *ikh* — the *ch* here is **soft**: a light hiss at the front of the mouth (the "ich-sound"), *not* the throat-scrape of *Nacht*. German has both; after *i* and *e* it's the soft one.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ich — "I." Root: Proto-Germanic ***ik**, from Proto-Indo-European ***eǵ** — the *same* deep root that became:

- Latin **ego** (and English **ego**), Greek *egō*,
- and, worn down hardest of all, English **I**.

So German *ich*, Latin *ego*, and English *I* are three survivals of **one** ancient word for "I" — English filed it down to a single letter, German kept a bit more.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich" (*ikh*, soft *ch*)
- the three cousins — *ich* / *ego* / *I*

Before you move on

What PIE root gave **ich**, and what Latin and English words are its cousins? (**eǵ* — Latin *ego*, English *I*.) Which *ch* sound does *ich* use — soft or the *Nacht* scrape? (The soft "ich-sound.")

2.2 du / Sie — "you," familiar and formal

To ask someone's name you need "you" — and German's formal one is the strangest of all the languages here.

Sounds you'll need

- **du** = *doo* (long *u*, as in *boot*). **Sie** = *zee* (the *s* is a *z*-sound at the start).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

du (familiar "you") ← Proto-Germanic ***þū**, from PIE ***tū** — the *same* root as:

- English archaic **thou**, Latin **tū**, French **tu**.

English kept *thou* only in old prayers and some dialects; German uses *du* every day.

Grammar Lens: two "you"s — and German's is the odd one out

- **du** — friends, family, children, peers. Intimate, equal.
- **Sie** — the respectful "you," for strangers and elders.

Here's the twist: **Sie** is really the word for **"they"** (*sie*), promoted to a polite "you" and always **Capitalized** (*Sie*) to tell it apart from *sie* = "they/she." So German is polite by addressing you in the **third person plural** — as if saying "might *they*…" about you to your face. Three languages, three escapes from the blunt "you":

- Spanish coined **usted** ("your grace"),
- French uses the **2nd-person plural** *vous* ("you all"),
- German borrows the **3rd-person plural** *Sie* ("they").

When unsure, use **Sie**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "du" (*doo*), "Sie" (*zee*)
- who gets *du* (friends), who gets *Sie* (strangers, elders)
- what *Sie* literally is (capitalized "they," used as polite "you")

Before you move on

What is the formal **Sie** literally, and why capitalized? (It's "they," *sie*, promoted to polite "you"; capitalized to distinguish it.) What old English word was the lost *du*? (*thou*.)

2.3 heißen — "to be called," the verb English almost lost

German gives its name with one plain verb — *heißen*, "to be called." No "myself" needed, unlike the Romance languages.

Sounds you'll need

- **heißen** = *HY-ssen*. The **ß** (*Eszett*) is a sharp "ss." **ei** is the vowel of English *eye*. So **heiße** = *HY-ssuh*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

heißen — "to be called / to be named." Root: Proto-Germanic ***haitaną**. English *had* this verb:

- **hight**, "named" — now archaic ("a knight *hight* Gawain"), and
- **behest**, "a command" — literally something *called for*.

So German kept as an everyday word a verb English let fade to poetry. And where Spanish and French say "I call *myself*" (a reflexive), German uses *heißen* as a plain verb of **being** called — no "myself" at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "heißen" (*HY-ssen*)
- the English fossil — *hight* ("named"), *behest*

Before you move on

What does **heißen** mean, and what archaic English word is its cousin? ("To be called"; *hight*.) How is German's way of giving a name different from Spanish/French? (A plain verb "to be called," no reflexive "myself.")

2.4 heißen with a person on the front — one verb, three endings

You have the verb and you have the people. *heißen* is the form a dictionary prints; it is not the form you say. Put a person in front of it and the tail of the word moves.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

heißen ← Old High German *heizzan*, "to call, to command" ← Proto-Germanic **haitanǫ* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The old English word *hight*, "called", comes from the same verb.

Grammar Lens: one verb, changing its ending

heißen is the dictionary (infinitive) form. German swaps the ending for each person:

- **ich heiße** — I am called
- **du heißt** — you (familiar) are called
- **Sie heißen** — you (formal) are called

That ending-swap is the same machine on every German verb. You'll use *ich heiße* and *Sie heißen* in the next lessons.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three forms — ich heiße / du heißt / Sie heißen
- the infinitive, then the *ich* form — heißen, ich heiße
- the tails alone — *-e*, *-t*, *-en*

Before you move on

Which ending goes with *ich*? (*-e* — *ich heiße*.) With formal *Sie*? (*-en* — *Sie heißen*, the same as the dictionary form.) Is this ending machine special to *heißen*? (No — every German verb runs it.)

2.5 ich heiße... — "my name is...," literally "I am called"

Assemble the two pieces — *ich* and *heißen* — into the sentence you need for meeting anyone.

You'll want to know: ich heiße...

- **ich** (I) + **heiße** (am called).

  ich heiße... = word for word "I am called…" = **"my name is..."**

Ich heiße Arun. → "My name is Arun." *Ich heiße Mira.* → "My name is Mira."

Why it's said this way

German also has the literal "my name is":

- **mein Name ist...** — where **Name** ← Proto-Germanic ***namô**, the *same* root as English **name** and Latin **nōmen** (→ English **noun**, **nom**inate). It's correct and common.

But **ich heiße** is warmer and more idiomatic — German prefers the **verb** ("I am called") over the **noun** phrase ("my name is"). (Note **Name** is Capitalized: German capitalizes *every* noun — you'll see it on every naming word.)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich heiße…" then your own name
- what it literally says ("I am called")
- the literal alternative — "mein Name ist…"

Before you move on

What does **ich heiße** literally mean? ("I am called.") What's the more literal "my name is," and what English words is *Name* cousin to? (*mein Name ist*; *name*, *noun*.)

2.6 wie — "how," cousin of English *how*

German asks "what's your name?" as "**how** are you called?" — so first, "how."

Sounds you'll need

- **wie** = *vee*. Two traps: German **w** is an English *v*, and **ie** is a long *ee*. So *wie* sounds like English "vee," never "wy."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wie — "how." Root: Proto-Germanic ***hwī**, from the PIE interrogative root ***k^{w}o-** — the very root behind the English **wh-** words:

- **how**, **what**, **who**, **why** — and, through Latin, the **qu-** of *question*, *quantity*, and the *quo modo* that became French *comment*.

German *wie* and English *how* are the same question-word, lightly reshaped.

Grammar Lens: German counts names as a matter of "how"

Like French, German asks a name with "**how**," not "what": *wie heißen Sie?* is literally "*how* are you called?" — about the *manner* of your being called. Don't translate word for word; learn the logic: the name-question runs on **wie**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "wie" (*vee* — *w* is *v*, *ie* is *ee*)
- the English *wh-* cousins — how, what, who, why
- "how are you called?" is the German for "what's your name?"

Before you move on

How is **wie** pronounced, and what English question-words share its root? (*vee*; how / what / who / why.) English asks "what is your name?" — what does German literally ask? ("*How* are you called?")

2.7 wie heißen Sie? — "what's your name?"

Assemble it: "how" + "are you called" = the polite question that opens the introduction.

You'll want to know: wie heißen Sie?

- **wie** (how) + **heißen Sie** ("are you [formal] called").

  wie heißen Sie? = literally "**how are you called?**" = the polite **"what's your name?"**

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wie heißen Sie is built from *wie*, "how", *heißen*, "to be called", and *Sie*. *heißen* ← Old High German *heizzan* ← Proto-Germanic **haitanǫ*, "to call, to command" (EtymDB 2.1). The polite *Sie* is the word for "they", capitalised.

Grammar Lens: verb in second place

German likes the verb in the **second** slot of a sentence:

Wie (1) *heißen* (2) *Sie*?

The **informal** version swaps in *du* and its ending:

Wie ***heißt du****?*

So the one verb *heißen* runs the whole exchange: *ich heiße…* to give your name, *wie heißen Sie?* to ask for someone else's. (Reply to *wie heißen Sie?* with *Ich heiße….*)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "wie heißen Sie?" (formal)
- the informal — "wie heißt du?"
- the pair — ask, then answer: "wie heißen Sie?" / "ich heiße…"

Before you move on

What does **wie heißen Sie?** literally say? ("How are you called?") What's the informal version, and where does German put the verb? (*Wie heißt du?*; the verb goes second.)

2.8 mich — "me," the same word as *ich*, doing a different job

English does not say "gladdens I." It says "gladdens **me**." German makes the same move, and the next phrase you learn needs it.

You'll want to know: mich

mich — "me," the object form of *ich*.

Said *mikh*: the final **ch** is the soft ich-sound you already met in *ich*, not the throat-scrape of *Nacht*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mich ("me," the object form) ← Proto-Germanic ***mek**, from PIE ***me-** — the *same* first-person root as English **me**, **my**, **mine** (and the French *me* in *je m'appelle*). So German *mich*, English *me*, and French *me* are three cousins of one ancient word for "me." And just as English shifts **I** (subject) → **me** (object), German shifts **ich** → **mich**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich" then "mich" — subject, then object
- the three cousins — *mich* / *me* / *me*
- "mich" (*mikh*, soft *ch* — not the *Nacht* scrape)

Before you move on

What is *mich*, and what is its subject form? ("Me"; *ich*.) Which English pair does *ich* → *mich* match? (*I* → *me*.) Which *ch* does *mich* use? (The soft ich-sound.)

2.9 freut mich — "pleased to meet you," i.e. "it gladdens me"

The warm close to an introduction — and it literally says the meeting makes you glad.

Sounds you'll need

- **freut mich** = *froyt mikh*. **eu** is the vowel of English *boy*; the final **ch** is the soft ich-sound again (from *ich*).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

freut mich is short for **es freut mich (Sie kennenzulernen)** — "it **gladdens** me (to get to know you)." The verb **freuen** ("to gladden") sits on **froh** ("glad, joyful"):

- the same **froh** in **Frohe Weihnachten** ("Merry Christmas"), and a cousin of English **frolic** (via Dutch *vrolijk*, "merry").

So *freut mich* says, warmly, "this makes me glad."

Grammar Lens: "it gladdens *me*"

German literally says "[it] gladdens **me**" — the *meeting* is what does the gladdening, and you (**mich**) are on the receiving end. A common variant is the plain **angenehm** ("pleasant / agreeable"), also usable as "pleased to meet you."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "freut mich" (*froyt mikh*)

- the root — *froh* (“glad”), as in *Frohe Weihnachten*
- the variant — “angenehm”

Before you move on

What does **freut mich** literally mean, and on what word is *freuen* built? (“It gladdens me”; *froh*, “glad.”) What does *mich* mean in it? (“Me” — the meeting gladdens *me*.)

2.10 Chapter 2 — the introduction, whole

Every piece is built. Here’s the exchange it was all for.

The exchange

German	English
Ich heiße Mira.	My name is Mira.
Wie heißen Sie?	What’s your name?
Ich heiße Arun.	My name is Arun.
Freut mich.	Pleased to meet you.

Every piece a Germanic cousin of English:

- **ich** ← **ik* (English *I*, Latin *ego*)
- **mich** ← **mek* (English *me*, *my*, *mine*)
- **heißen** ← **haitanǫ* (English *hight*, *behest*)
- **wie** ← **hwī* (English *how*, *what*, *who*)
- **freuen** ← *froh* (glad; English *frolic*)

And two habits of German to keep: it names with a **plain verb of being called** (“I am called,” no “myself”), and it is polite by the **third person** (*Sie* = “they”).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the whole exchange, both voices
- your own introduction — "ich heiße …, freut mich"
- ask it back — "wie heißen Sie?"

Before you move on

Give your name in German, ask someone else's, and say you're pleased to meet them. (*Ich heiße… / Wie heißen Sie? / Freut mich.*) What two German habits does this show? (Naming with a plain "to be called" verb; politeness by the third person, *Sie.*) Next chapter: *Wie geht's?* ("how's it going?") and answering with *gut* again — the responding cycle.

Chapter 3

How Are You?

Modes: **voice** (17) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 5 of 18 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask how someone is in German, answer naturally, and return the question.
>
> *German asks after someone with a verb of motion — Wie geht es dir?, "how goes it to you?" — so this chapter builds that question one word at a time and then answers it across a full ladder, from Sehr gut! down through Es geht and So lala to Nicht so gut. Around it sit the two courtesies that hold every German conversation together, danke and bitte, each an English word in disguise. GE-C03-formal-practice runs the finished exchange in the formal register, where only the listener word changes.*

3.1 danke — "thank you," which is really "I think of you"

You can introduce yourself in German. Next comes *how are you?* — and every answer to it leans on one word. It hides a secret that English shares and hides too: **to thank is to think.**

You'll want to know: danke

danke — "thank you."

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-a-german` — *DAHN-kuh*: a pure open *ah*, the vowel of English *father*, and a final *-e* that sinks to a soft *uh* rather than disappearing. Stress the front: *DAHN-kuh*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

danke comes from **denken**, "to think." The old idea: to thank someone is to **keep them in mind** — "I think of you," "you are in my thoughts." German *Dank* ("thanks") and *Gedanke* ("a thought") are the same root wearing two coats.

And here is the payoff for an English speaker: **English "thank" and "think" are the same word too.** Old English *þancian* ("thank") and *þencan* ("think") split from one root — to thank was to *hold in thought*. So *danke* is not foreign at all; it is English **thank** with the **think** still visible inside it.

Three different pictures of gratitude, worth holding side by side:

Language	**"Thanks"**	**Literal idea**
German	*danke*	"I **think** of you"
French	*merci*	a **reward**, a **mercy**
Spanish	*gracias*	**grace**, **favour**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "danke" — *DAHN-kuh*, stress the front
- "danke" — thanks, with the thinking inside it
- English "thank" then "think" — one root, two coats

Before you move on

What everyday idea is *danke* built from? (Thinking — "to think.")
What two English words share that same split? (*Thank* and *think*.)
Where does the stress fall? (On the front: *DAHN-kuh*.)

3.2 schön — "beautiful," and your first umlaut with rounded lips

Danke on its own is complete and polite. But German has a one-word upgrade, and the upgrading word is worth having on its own — it is one of the commonest adjectives in the language.

You'll want to know: schön

schön — "beautiful, lovely, nice."

Sounds you'll need

- `umlaut-oe` — **ö** is made by saying **ay** and then *rounding your lips* as if to whistle, without moving your tongue. English has no such vowel, so build it from two things you can already do: hold the *e* of *bed*, then push your lips forward into an *o* shape. That is **ö**.
- `sch-sh` — **sch** is simply English **sh**. So *schön* is *shurn* — with no *r* actually sounded, the way a Southern English speaker says *fern*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schön is English **sheen**. Both come from a Germanic root meaning *bright, shining* — so the oldest sense of *schön* is not "pretty" but "gleaming," and English kept the shine while German took the beauty. Now snap it onto the word you already have:

> **danke schön** — "thank you nicely" → "thank you very much."

Literally you are thanking someone *beautifully*. English has no equivalent move; the nearest is the tone of voice in "thanks *so* much."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ay" then round your lips — "ö"
- "schön" (*shurn*)
- "danke schön" — thank you very much

Before you move on

What does *schön* mean, and which English word is it? ("Beautiful"; *sheen.*) How do you make **ö**? (Say *ay*, then round the lips.) Upgrade a thank-you. (*Danke schön.*)

3.3 vielen Dank — "many thanks," with the noun stepping forward

Danke is a verb form — "I thank." But English also has a *noun*, **thanks**, and so does German. Meet it, and a second upgrade opens up.

You'll want to know: der Dank

der Dank — "the thanks, the gratitude" (masculine).

Capital **D**, because every German noun is capitalised — the rule from *Tag*. Said *dahnk*, with the final **k** crisp.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

viel means "much," inherited from Old High German *filu*, "many" (EtymDB 2.1). English *full* is not the same word; *viel*'s English match, Old English *fela*, died out. Put it in front of *Dank* and you get the phrase Germans reach for when *danke* alone feels too thin:

vielen Dank — "many thanks."

The **-en** on *vielen* is the same kind of adjective ending you met on *guten Tag*: German adjectives dress to match their noun. You do not have to build it yet — learn *vielen Dank* whole, the way you learned *guten Tag* whole.
So the family now reads: *danke* (I thank) · *der Dank* (the thanks) · *Gedanke* (a thought) — all from *denken*, "to think."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Dank" — the noun, capital D

- "vielen Dank" — many thanks
- the family — "danke", "Dank" — thanks as a thought

Before you move on

What is the noun behind *danke*? (*Der Dank.*) What does *viel* mean, and where does it come from? (*Much* — Old High German *filu.*) Say "many thanks." (*Vielen Dank.*)

3.4 bitte — the Swiss-army word: "please" *and* "you're welcome"

Every *danke* wants an answer. German's answer is a word that also means "please" — and three other things besides, all from one idea.

You'll want to know: bitte

bitte — "please," and "you're welcome."

Sounds you'll need

- `i-short` — *BIT-tuh*: a short crisp *i* as in English *bit*, a clearly doubled *t*, and the soft *-uh* ending you already met on *danke*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bitte is the asking-form of **bitten**, "to ask, to request, to pray." When you say *bitte* you are, at root, **making a request** — "I ask this of you."
That verb, inherited from Proto-Germanic **bidjanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1), is a cousin of two English words:

- **bid** — as in "I *bid* you welcome," "do as you are *bidden*": to ask or command.
- **bead** — astonishingly, yes. A *bead* was originally a **prayer**. People counted their prayers (Old English *gebed*) on a string, and the name of the prayer slid onto the little ball it was counted on. A rosary **bead** is a frozen request — exactly what *bitte* still is.

That single idea, *I ask*, lets one word cover so much ground:

You say *bitte* when...	**It means**	**Why it is all "I ask"**
making a request	**please**	"I ask you…"
answering *danke*	**you're welcome**	"I ask nothing back"
handing something over	**here you go**	"I offer, at your request"
you did not hear	**pardon?**	"I ask you to repeat"

Tone does the sorting. The word never changes.

Why it's said this way

The courtesy loop closes every small favour in German: **Danke.** — **Bitte.** It is the twin of Spanish *de nada* and French *de rien*, and leaving off the *bitte* sounds curt in a way English "no problem" does not.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "bitte" — *BIT-tuh*, doubled *t*
- the loop — "danke" … "bitte"
- "bitte" as *please*, then as *you're welcome* — same word, new tone

Before you move on

What verb is *bitte* from? (*Bitten*, "to ask, to pray.") What two English words are its cousins? (*Bid*, and *bead* — a bead was a prayer.) Name two jobs *bitte* does. (Please; you're welcome; here you go; pardon?) What answers *danke*? (*Bitte.*)

3.5 gehen — "to go," and it is just English *go*

German asks "how are you?" with a verb of **motion**. You already own that verb without having studied it, because it *is* English *go*.

You'll want to know: gehen

gehen — "to go." The form you will need most is **geht**, "goes."

That **-t** is the ending you already met on *heißt*: third person, one person, one *t*.

Sounds you'll need

- `h-silent-lengthening` — in *gehen* the **h** is **not** breathed. It is a silent letter whose whole job is to **stretch the vowel before it**: *GAY-en*, not *ge-HEN*. So **geht** is simply *gayt*.

This is worth banking now, because German uses the trick everywhere — several words in the next few lessons hide a lengthening *h*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gehen and English **go** descend from the *same* Germanic verb — no Latin detour, no false friend, a straight cognate. When you say *geht*, you are saying *goes*.
And that is the whole idea behind German's "how are you?": wellbeing is not something you *are*, it is something that **goes**.

Language	The verb it asks with	The picture
German	*gehen*, "to go"	how does it **go**?
French	*aller*, "to go"	how does it **go**?
Spanish	*estar*, "to stand"	how are you **standing**?

Two of the three put wellbeing in motion; Spanish puts it on its feet.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "gehen" (*GAY-en*) — the *h* only stretches
- "geht" (*gayt*) — "goes"
- German *gehen* and English *go* — the same word

Before you move on

What English word is *gehen*? (*Go* — a straight cognate.) What does the *h* do in *gehen*? (Nothing but lengthen the vowel.) Which two of the three languages ask "how are you?" with "to go"? (German and French; Spanish uses "to stand.")

3.6 es — "it," the small word German leans on

You have the verb: *geht*, "goes." But goes *what*? German needs a subject, and for a state — the weather, your day — it reaches for one tiny word.

You'll want to know: es

es — "it."

Said *ess*: a short clean *e*, the vowel of English *bet*, and a crisp *s*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

es is English **it**. The two look unalike only because of the same swap you already met in *das* / *that*: where English keeps a **t**, German often shows an **s**. Line them up and the pattern is one column wide:

English	German
tha**t**	da**s**
i**t**	e**s**
wha**t**	wa**s**

Same word, one consonant apart — and *das*, the neuter "the," is *es*'s close relative, which is why both point at things rather than people.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "es" (*ess*) — "it"
- "it" then "es"; "that" then "das" — the same t/s swap, twice
- "es" — "it," for a thing or a state

Before you move on

What is *es*? ("It.") Which English consonant turns up as *s* in German? (*T* — *it/es*, *that/das*, *what/was*.)

3.7 mir — "to me," the third coat that *ich* wears

You have *ich* ("I," the doer) and *mich* ("me," the done-to). German keeps a **third** form for a different job — and English keeps the same job without a special word for it.

You'll want to know: mir

mir — "to me, for me."

Said *meer*: a long *ee*, and a soft German **r** at the end that is barely more than a vowel — closer to *mee-uh* than to an English *meer*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

German marks *the person something happens* ***to*** with a form of its own. It is called the **dative** — the "to-whom" form.

Job	German	English
the doer	*ich*	I
the done-to	*mich*	me
the to-whom	*mir*	to me

English merged the last two into one word, *me*, and now signals the difference by **word order** instead: "she gave **me** the book" — *me* is the to-whom there, even though it looks identical to the done-to *me* in "she saw me." German never merged them, so it can put the to-whom anywhere and still be clear. *Mir* is inherited: EtymDB 2.1 traces Old High German *mir* and English *me* to the same Proto-Germanic **miz*. That is why wellbeing works the way it does: something *goes*, and it goes **to a person**. The person is in the dative.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three coats — "ich", "mich", "mir"

- "mir" (*meer*) — "to me"
- "to me" then "mir" — the to-whom form

Before you move on

What does *mir* mean? ("To me, for me.") Which of *ich* / *mich* / *mir* is the to-whom form? (*Mir.*) How does English show that job instead? (By word order — "gave *me* the book.")

3.8 dir — "to you," and English used to have it too

Mir is "to me." To ask how someone else is doing, you need the same form pointed the other way.

You'll want to know: dir

dir — "to you," the to-whom form of *du*.

Said *deer*, with the same soft trailing **r** as *mir*. The two rhyme, which is the easiest way to remember they are a pair.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dir is English **thee** — the old to-you form, from the same Germanic root, with the *th* hardened to *d* exactly as *das* answers *that*.
English has not lost it entirely. It is fossilised in old phrases: "I give **thee** thanks," "woe is **thee**." Those are datives — *thee* was never the doer, always the to-whom, which is precisely *dir*'s job.
So the pattern completes itself:

doer	**to-whom**
ich	*mir*
du	*dir*

Remember: *dir* belongs to *du*, so it is for friends and family. A stranger gets a different word, and that is the next lesson.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "mir" then "dir" — they rhyme
- "du" then "dir" — doer, then to-whom
- "dir" and English "thee" — the same word

Before you move on

What does *dir* mean? ("To you.") Which English word is it? (*Thee.*) Whom do you say *dir* to? (Someone you call *du* — a friend or family.)

3.9 Wie geht es dir? — "how are you?"

Nothing new is coming. You have all four words — *wie*, *geht*, *es*, *dir*. This lesson only puts them in order.

You'll want to know: Wie geht es dir?

Wie geht es dir? — "How are you?"

Word for word: "How goes it to you?"

German	English
wie	how
geht	goes
es	it
dir	to you

Said *vee gayt es deer* — remember German **w** says *v*, and *ie* is a long *ee*.

Every piece has been earned: *wie* from asking someone's name, *geht* from *gehen*, *es* and *dir* from the last two lessons. This is what the book has been building toward — a real question assembled from parts, not memorised whole.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

geht is a form of *gehen* ← Old High German *gān* ← Proto-Germanic **gānǫ*, "to go" — the same verb as English *go*. (EtymDB 2.1)

You'll want to know: Wie geht's?

In speech, *geht es* crushes together into **geht's**:

> **Wie geht's?** — the form you will actually hear.

It drops the *dir* entirely, which makes it neutral: no need to decide between friend and stranger. When in doubt, this is the safe one.

And you can already answer it:

> **Wie geht's? — Danke, gut!**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Wie geht es dir?" — *vee gayt es deer*
- the four pieces — "wie", "geht", "es", "dir"
- the short form — "Wie geht's?"
- the whole exchange — "Wie geht's?" … "Danke, gut!"

Before you move on

What does *Wie geht es dir?* say word for word? ("How goes it to you?") What contracts into *geht's*? (*Geht es.*) Why is *Wie geht's?* the safe form? (It drops *dir*, so it needs no friend-or-stranger choice.)

3.10 Ihnen — "to you," said at a respectful distance

> *Dir* is for a friend. But you already know German splits its "you" in two, and the polite half needs its own to-whom form.

You'll want to know: Ihnen

> **Ihnen** — "to you," formal.

Said *EE-nen*: the **h** is silent and merely stretches the *i* into a long *ee*, the same trick as in *gehen*. Stress the front.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ihnen is, underneath, "to **them**." German's polite "you" is the third-person plural borrowed wholesale: rather than address you directly, the language speaks of you as though you were a group — distance as respect. *Sie* is "they" used as "you"; *Ihnen* is "to them" used as "to you."
The capital letter is doing real work. Written small, *ihnen* means "to them" about actual other people. Written **Ihnen**, it is aimed at the person you are speaking to. Same sound, and only the page can tell them apart.

to whom	informal	formal
you	*dir*	*Ihnen*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Ihnen" (*EE-nen*) — long *ee*, silent *h*
- "dir" then "Ihnen" — friend, then stranger
- "Sie" and "Ihnen" — the polite pair

Before you move on

What does *Ihnen* mean? ("To you," formally.) What does it literally say? ("To them.") What does the capital **I** tell you? (It is aimed at the listener, not at other people.)

3.11 Wie geht es Ihnen? — the same question, at a distance

You have the question for a friend, and you have the formal to-whom word. Putting them together needs no new grammar at all — just a swap.

You'll want to know: Wie geht es Ihnen?

> **Wie geht es Ihnen?** — "How are you?", to a stranger or an elder.

Listener	Question
friend, family	*Wie geht es dir?*
stranger, elder	*Wie geht es Ihnen?*

Three of the four words never move. Only the last one changes.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ihnen is the "to them" form of *sie*, "they": German's polite "you" is the inherited word for "they", capitalised.

Grammar Lens: politeness lives in the pronoun

This is a rule worth generalising: **German carries politeness in the pronoun, not in the sentence.** English reaches for extra words to be polite — "I was wondering whether you might…" — and stacks them in front. German usually leaves the sentence exactly as it is and changes *who you are calling the person*.
You saw the same move with *du* and *Sie*. Here it reaches the dative: *dir* becomes *Ihnen*, and the politeness is done.
And when you would rather not choose at all, the contraction sidesteps it: **Wie geht's?** names no listener, so it commits to nothing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to a friend — "Wie geht es dir?"
- to a stranger — "Wie geht es Ihnen?"
- the pair back to back, hearing only the last word change
- the neutral escape — "Wie geht's?"

Before you move on

What is the formal "how are you?" (*Wie geht es Ihnen?*) How many words change from the informal? (One — *dir* to *Ihnen*.) Where does German keep its politeness? (In the pronoun, not in extra words.)

3.12 sehr — "very," and it used to mean "sorely"

Gut answers "how are you?" perfectly well. One small word in front of it turns a polite answer into a warm one.

You'll want to know: sehr

sehr — "very."

Said *zair*: German **s** before a vowel buzzes like English **z**, the **h** is silent and stretches the vowel, and the **r** softens almost to *ah*.

Sehr gut! — "Very well!"

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sehr is English **sore**. In Middle High German it meant *painfully, grievously* — and intensifiers very often start life as words for pain, then fade into pure degree. English did exactly the same thing and then half forgot: "**sorely** missed," "**sore** afraid" both mean *very*, not *painful*.
So *sehr gut* is, at the root, "sorely good" — and English *very* went the same road from a different start, having once meant *truly* (French *vrai*).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "sehr" (*zair*) — buzzing *z*, silent *h*
- "sehr gut" — very well
- "danke sehr" — thanks very much

Before you move on

What does *sehr* mean? ("Very.") Which English word is it? (*Sore* — as in "sorely missed.") Answer warmly. (*Sehr gut!*)

3.13 nicht — "not," the same word as English *naught*

Not every day is a good one. To say so, you need the one word that turns any German sentence around.

You'll want to know: nicht

nicht — "not."

Said *nikht*: the **ch** is the soft ich-sound from *ich* and *mich*, not the throat-scrape of *Nacht*. The vowel before it is short.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nicht and English **not** are one word. Both come from a Germanic phrase meaning *no thing at all* — literally "not a whit." English shows the longer form still: **naught** (and **nought**, the zero) is the undressed version, and *not* is what happens when centuries of fast speech wear it down.
So the pair lines up with the *ch* rule you already have:

English	German
na**ugh**t	ni**ch**t
ni**gh**t	Na**ch**t

That English *gh* is a fossil: it once *was* the German *ch* sound, and English stopped pronouncing it while keeping the letters.
Now the answer ladder reaches downward:

Nicht so gut. — "Not so good."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "nicht" (*nikht*) — soft *ch*

- “naught” then “nicht”; “night” then “Nacht”
- “nicht so gut” — not so good

Before you move on

What does *nicht* mean? (“Not.”) Which English word is it, undressed? (*Naught*.) What does English *gh* used to be? (The German *ch* sound.)

3.14 so lala — “so-so,” and the tune carries it

You can now say *gut* and *nicht so gut*. Between them sits the honest middle, and German fills it with a word that means nothing whatsoever.

You’ll want to know: so lala

so lala — “so-so, middling, could be worse.”

Said *zo LAH-lah*, with the voice rising and falling across the *lala* — a shrug set to music. Say it flat and it lands wrong; the tune is most of the meaning.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

There is nothing to take apart, and that is the point. **so** is English **so**. **lala** is not a word at all — it is the same *lalala* you hum when you do not know the lyrics, pressed into service as a meaning.
This is not a German quirk. Reach for “so-so” in almost any language and you find a small repeated noise doing the work, because a shrug is easier to sing than to say.

Why it’s said this way

The shrug collection, four deep across the books in this series:

Language	The shrug	Literally
German	*so lala*	"so la-la"
French	*comme ci, comme ça*	"like this, like that"
Spanish	*más o menos*	"more or less"
Italian	*così così*	"so so"

Three of the four work by **repetition** — say a small thing twice and it comes out meaning *neither one nor the other*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "so lala" with the tune — up, then down
- the ladder — "sehr gut", "gut", "so lala", "nicht so gut"
- the four shrugs — *so lala*, *comme ci comme ça*, *más o menos*, *così così*

Before you move on

What does *so lala* mean? ("So-so.") What does *lala* mean on its own? (Nothing — it is pure sing-song.) What do three of the four shrugs have in common? (They repeat a small word.)

3.15 es geht — the German shrug: "it goes"

Someone asks *Wie geht's?* You are neither great nor terrible. German has an answer for exactly that, and it is made of two words you already own.

You'll want to know: es geht

es geht — "it goes." → "So-so. I'm getting by."

Nothing has been added. That is the whole trick.

Es geht mir gut says it goes **well**. Take the *gut* away and German does not become vague — it becomes *pointed*. The listener was waiting for a *gut* or a *schlecht*, and you gave neither. The **absence** is the meaning.

English does this too, with tone rather than deletion: "It's… going."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

geht ← Old High German *gān* ← Proto-Germanic **gāną*, "to go", the same verb as English *go*; **es** ← Old High German *iz*, "it", English *it*'s twin. (EtymDB 2.1)

Grammar Lens: the answer ladder

You now hold the whole range, top to bottom, with no word left unexplained:

Answer	Sense
Sehr gut!	very well
Gut, danke.	well, thanks
Es geht.	so-so, getting by
So lala.	so-so, sung with a shrug
Nicht so gut.	not so well

Es geht and *so lala* sit on the same rung and differ only in mood: *es geht* is dry and a little stoic, *so lala* is light and musical. Choose by the face you want to make.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "es geht" — flat, unhurried
- "es geht mir gut", then just "es geht" — hear the *gut* go missing
- the ladder top to bottom — "Sehr gut", "Gut danke", "Es geht", "So lala", "Nicht so gut"

Before you move on

What does *es geht* mean literally, and in use? ("It goes"; "so-so.") What makes it mean so-so? (The missing *gut* — the absence is the message.) Which answer sits at the top of the ladder? (*Sehr gut.*) At the bottom? (*Nicht so gut.*)

3.16 und — "and," and how to hand the question back

Someone asks how you are; you answer. A conversation only starts when you ask back — and German returns the question in two words.

You'll want to know: und

und — "and."

It is English **and** with the vowel darkened, and it has barely changed in a thousand years — one of the oldest words either language still uses daily.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

und ← Old High German *unti* ← Proto-Germanic **andi* — inherited, the same word as English *and*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `d-t-final` — say *oont*, not *oond*. German hardens a **d** at the end of a word into a **t**. It is the same rule that makes *Tag* come out as *tock* rather than *tahg*: whatever the spelling, a final consonant goes voiceless. So *und* rhymes with English *hunt*, not with *shunned*.

Grammar Lens: returning the question

Hand the question back by naming the other person — in the **to-whom** form, because it is short for "and how goes it *to you*?"

To a friend	To a stranger
und dir?	*und Ihnen?*

Not *und du* — the dative is doing real work here, and using the doer-form is the giveaway of a beginner. The same shape appears across the series: Spanish *¿y tú?*, French *et toi?*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "und" (*oont*, hard *t*)

- "und dir?" — and you, to a friend
- "und Ihnen?" — and you, to a stranger

Before you move on

How is *und* pronounced, and why? (*Oont* — a final *d* hardens to *t*.) Return the question to a friend. (*Und dir?*) To a stranger? (*Und Ihnen?*) Why not *und du*? (It is short for "how goes it *to you*" — the to-whom form.)

3.17 Practice — *Wie geht's?*, casually

No new words. Everything below has had its own lesson; this is the first time they run together at speed.

The exchange

German	English
Hallo! Wie geht's?	Hi! How are you?
Gut, danke, und dir?	Well, thanks — and you?
Es geht.	So-so.
Danke! — Bitte.	Thanks! — You're welcome.

Four moves: greet, ask, answer-and-return, close the courtesy loop.

Grammar Lens: why dir, and not du

Und dir? keeps the dative because it is short for the full question — "and how goes it **to you**?" Saying *und du* would be the one wrong note in the whole exchange, and it is the commonest beginner slip there is.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the whole exchange, both voices
- "Wie geht's? — Gut, danke."
- "Und dir? — Es geht."

Twice through: "Wie geht's? — Gut, danke, und dir?"

Before you move on

Run the casual exchange without looking. Which answer is the so-so one? (*Es geht.*) Which word answers *danke*? (*Bitte.*) Why *dir* and not *du*? (The question means "how goes it *to you*" — the to-whom form.)
Which English word is hiding in *sehr*? (***Sore*** — as in *sorely missed.*) And *bitte* is the asking-form of which word, cousin of English *bid*? (***Bitten***, to ask.)

3.18 Formal practice — *Wie geht es Ihnen?*

Same exchange, same order, same verb. One word changes throughout — and that is the chapter's whole argument about German politeness.

The exchange

German	English
Guten Tag. Wie geht es Ihnen?	Good day. How are you?
Danke, gut. Und Ihnen?	Well, thanks. And you?
Es geht.	So-so.
Danke! — Bitte.	Thanks! — You're welcome.

Set it beside the casual version and the difference is two words, both of them the listener:

	Casual	Formal
the question	*Wie geht's?*	*Wie geht es Ihnen?*
the return	*und dir?*	*und Ihnen?*

Danke, *gut*, *es geht* and *bitte* do not shift at all. German courtesy words are register-neutral; the politeness is carried entirely by the pronoun.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the formal exchange, both voices
- "Wie geht es Ihnen? — Danke, gut."

- "Und Ihnen? — Es geht."

Twice through: "Wie geht es Ihnen? — Danke, gut. Und Ihnen?"

Before you move on

Which greeting opens the formal exchange? (*Guten Tag.*) Which dative pronoun appears twice? (*Ihnen.*) What changes from the casual version? (*Dir* becomes *Ihnen* — nothing else.) Where does German keep its politeness? (In the pronoun.)
Taken literally, who is *Ihnen* aimed at? (**Them** — *to them*: the polite *you* speaks of you as though you were a group.)

Chapter 4

Farewells

Modes: **voice** (12) **eyes** (1) **pen** (3) **Hands-free start:** the first 7 of 16 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can end a German conversation politely, choose a farewell that fits the situation, and write German's three distinctive marks — the eszett, the umlaut, and a capital on every noun.
>
> *German parts formally with a promise to see each other again, casually with a word that travelled from French through Walloon and Low German before it got here, and softly with bis — "until" — plus a word for time. This chapter takes auf Wiedersehen apart into the three words it is made of, then teaches bis as a recipe and fills its slot three times: bald, später, morgen. GE-C04-practice closes the arc with the first conversation that runs from hello to goodbye.*

4.1 sehen — "to see," and it is English *see*

> The German goodbye is a promise to *see* each other again. Before you can say it, you need the verb — and you have met its spelling trick already.

You'll want to know: sehen

> **sehen** — "to see."

The **-en** on the end is the infinitive ending you know from *gehen* and *heißen*: the dictionary form of every German verb wears it.

Sounds you'll need

- `h-silent-lengthening` — the same silent *h* as in *gehen*: it is not breathed, it only stretches the vowel. *ZAY-en.*
- `s-voiced` — a German **s** before a vowel buzzes like English **z**. So *sehen* opens with a *z*, not an *s*.

Put together: *ZAY-en.* Compare *gehen*, *GAY-en* — the two verbs rhyme, and they will keep rhyming through every form.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sehen and English **see** are the same word, both from Germanic ***sehwan**. There is no Latin in this line at all — unlike Spanish *ver* and French *voir*, which both come from Latin *vidēre* (the *vid-* you can still see in English **video** and **evident**).
So the two families split the sense of sight between them:

Family	"To see"	Still visible in English
Germanic	German *sehen*, English *see*	*see*, *sight*
Latin	Spanish *ver*, French *voir*	*video*, *vision*, *evident*

English, as usual, ended up owning both halves.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "sehen" (*ZAY-en*) — buzzing *z*, silent *h*
- "gehen" then "sehen" — they rhyme
- "sehen" and English "see" — the same word

Before you move on

What does *sehen* mean, and which English word is it? ("To see"; *see*.) What does the *h* do? (Only lengthens the vowel.) Where does Spanish *ver* come from instead? (Latin *vidēre* — English *video*,

evident.)

4.2 wieder — "again," and the *with* that means *back*

You have *sehen*, "to see." The goodbye promises to see each other **again** — so the next piece is that "again."

You'll want to know: wieder

wieder — "again."

Said *VEE-der*: the **w** says *v* and **ie** is a long *ee*, both rules you already met in *wie*. The final **-er** softens almost to *-uh*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The obvious guess is that *wieder* is English **wither**. It is not.
Its real cousin is the **with-** of **withdraw**, **withstand** and **withhold** — and that *with-* is not the ordinary English *with* meaning "alongside." It is an older word meaning **back** or **against**:

- to with**draw** is to draw **back**
- to with**stand** is to stand **against**
- to with**hold** is to hold **back**

That older sense is exactly what *wieder* still carries: **back, again**. So when a German says *wieder*, they are saying the *with-* of *withdraw*. It comes from Old High German *widar*, "against" (EtymDB 2.1).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "wieder" (*VEE-der*) — *v*, then a long *ee*
- "withdraw", "withstand" — the *with-* that means *back*
- "wieder sehen" — to see again

Before you move on

What does *wieder* mean? ("Again.") Which English word is it hiding in? (The *with-* of *withdraw*.) What does that *with-* mean there? ("Back" or "against" — not "alongside.")

4.3 auf — "on, upon," and it is English *up*

Two pieces down, one to go. The formal goodbye opens with a three-letter word that turns out to be one you say constantly in English.

You'll want to know: auf

auf — "on, upon."

Sounds you'll need

- `au-diphthong` — German **au** is the *ow* of English *house*, never the *aw* of *caught*. So *auf* rhymes with English **owf**, not with *oaf*.
- `f-final` — the **f** is crisp and unvoiced at the end.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

auf is English **up**. The vowel drifted — German widened it to *au*, English kept it short — but it is one word, and the meanings still overlap almost exactly:

German	English
auf	up, upon, on
aufstehen	to stand **up**
aufmachen	to make **up**, to open

English **upon** is literally *up* + *on*, which is the same doubling German gets from *auf* alone. That is why *auf* translates sometimes as "up" and sometimes as "on": English split the job into two words and German never did.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "auf" (*owf*) — the *ow* of *house*
- "auf" and English "up" — the same word
- "auf wieder sehen" — on the seeing-again

Before you move on

What does *auf* mean? ("On, upon.") Which English word is it? (*Up.*) How is **au** pronounced? (Like the *ow* in *house.*)

4.4 auf Wiedersehen — "goodbye," i.e. "till we see again"

Three lessons, three words. Now snap them together — nothing here is new.

You'll want to know: auf Wiedersehen

auf Wiedersehen — "goodbye," to a stranger, an elder, or on the telephone.

Said *owf VEE-der-zay-en.* Piece by piece:

German	English
auf	on, upon
wieder	again
sehen	to see

So it reads **"on the seeing-again"** → "until we see each other again." Note the capital **W**: welded together the three words became a *noun*, and German capitalises every noun. *Ein Wiedersehen* on its own is "a reunion."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

auf Wiedersehen is built from *auf*, *wieder* and *sehen. auf* ← Old High German *ūf*, the same word as English *up*; *sehen* ← Old High German *sehan* ← Proto-Germanic **sehwanǫ*, the same verb as English *see.* (EtymDB 2.1)

Why it's said this way

Set the three goodbyes side by side and each language shows what it thinks parting is:

Language	Goodbye	The metaphor
German	*auf Wiedersehen*	"till we **see** again"
French	*au revoir*	"till the **re-seeing**"
Spanish	*adiós*	"to **God**"

German and French shake hands on a re-seeing; Spanish commends you to God. The German and the French are not merely similar — they are the same sentence built from each language's own parts.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "auf Wiedersehen" — *owf VEE-der-zay-en*
- pull it apart — "auf", "wieder", "sehen"
- "auf Wiedersehen" then "au revoir" — the same sentence, twice

Before you move on

What does *auf Wiedersehen* literally say? ("On the seeing-again.") What are its three pieces? (*Auf*, *wieder*, *sehen*.) Why the capital **W**? (The welded word is a noun, and German capitalises nouns.) And which English *with-* is *wieder*'s real cousin? (The *with-* of ***withdraw*** — back, again — not *wither*.)

4.5 tschüss — the casual "bye" that used to say "to God"

Between friends, Germans almost never say the full *auf Wiedersehen*. They say one clipped syllable — which hides the best secret in this chapter.

You'll want to know: tschüss

tschüss — "bye."

Sounds you'll need

- `tsch-ch` — **tsch** is the *ch* of English **ch**urch. So the word starts *chü-*, not *tsh-oo*.
- `umlaut-ue` — **ü** is made the way you made **ö**, but starting from *ee* instead of *ay*: say **ee**, then round your lips without moving your tongue.

Together: *chüss*, short and clipped, rhyming roughly with a rounded *chuess*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tschüss looks purely German. Trace it back and it leaves the country entirely:

Step	Form	Language
1	*adieu* — "to God"	French
2	*adjûs*	Walloon (southern Belgium)
3	*atschüs*	Low German
4	*tschüss*	modern German

And since French *adieu* is *à Dieu*, "to God," the breeziest German goodbye is a far-travelled cousin of French **adieu** and Spanish **adiós** — all three the same small blessing, just worn down further at each step. The friendliest, most throwaway German goodbye is secretly the most solemn one.

Grammar Lens: which goodbye, to whom

This is **register** — the same split you have drilled since *du* and *Sie*. Pick the parting to match the relationship:

Say	To
tschüss	friends, family, peers, casual shops
auf Wiedersehen	strangers, elders, officials, the telephone

If you would say *Sie* to them, say *auf Wiedersehen*.

Why it's said this way

You will also hear **tschau**. That one is Italian *ciao*, borrowed straight and respelt to German spelling rules — so German ended up with two casual goodbyes imported from two different Romance languages.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ee" then round your lips — "ü"
- "tschüss" — *chüss*, short and clipped
- the chain — "adieu", "adjûs", "atschüs", "tschüss"

Before you move on

What does *tschüss* secretly mean? ("To God" — it is *adieu.*) Which Spanish word is its cousin? (*Adiós.*) Whom do you say it to? (Anyone you would call *du.*)

4.6 bis — "until," and the shape of every soft goodbye

You have the formal goodbye and the casual one. Between them sits a whole family of softer partings, and every one of them starts with the same small word.

You'll want to know: bis

bis — "until, up to."

Said *biss*: a short *i* as in English *bit*, and a crisp unvoiced **s** at the end — this one does *not* buzz, because the buzzing rule only applies before a vowel.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bis ← Middle High German *biz* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, most likely two small words meaning "by" and "to" run together.

Grammar Lens: bis plus a time word

bis is a **recipe**, not a phrase. Put a word for time after it and you have a goodbye:

bis + *a time* → "see you *then*"

The other two languages in this book build their soft goodbyes exactly the same way, which means once you own the recipe you own three languages' worth of it:

Language	The preposition	Example
German	*bis*	*bis …*
Spanish	*hasta*	*hasta …*
French	*à*	*à …*

The next three lessons each supply one time word to pour into the slot.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "bis" (*biss*) — short *i*, crisp *s*
- the three prepositions — "bis", "hasta", "à"
- "bis …" and leave the slot open

Before you move on

What does *bis* mean? ("Until, up to.") What has to follow it to make a goodbye? (A word for time.) Which Spanish and French words do the same job? (*Hasta* and *à*.)
And the casual goodbye you already have, *tschüss*: which French word is it, worn down? (***Adieu*** — *à Dieu*, the same *à*.)

4.7 bald — "soon," which is English *bold*

Bis is waiting for a time word. Here is the first one — and it is an English word you would never have guessed.

You'll want to know: bald

bald — "soon."

Said *balt*, not *bald*: the final **d** hardens to **t** by **final devoicing**, the rule you met on *und* and on *Tag*. It has nothing to do with English *bald* (hairless) — that is a pure coincidence of spelling.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bald is English **bold**.
Old High German *bald* meant "bold, brave, quick." Then the sense drifted along a line that is easy to walk: what is done **boldly** is done **without hesitating** → done **quickly** → happening **soon**.
German followed the speed. English followed the courage. One word, two destinations — and English still keeps a trace of the German path in the archaic **"full boldly"** meaning *promptly*, and in the way *bold* can still mean *sudden* in older writing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "bald" (*balt*, hard *t*)
- "bald" and English "bold" — one word, two senses

Before you move on

What does *bald* mean? ("Soon.") Which English word is it? (*Bold* — not *bald*.) How did "brave" become "soon"? (What is done boldly is done quickly.)

4.8 bis bald — "see you soon"

The recipe and the first ingredient are both yours. Pour one into the other.

You'll want to know: bis bald

bis bald — "until soon" → "see you soon."

Said *biss BALT*, with the stress on the second word and that final **d** hardening to **t**.

Use it when you genuinely expect to see the person before long — it carries a small promise the way English "see you soon" does, and it sounds odd to someone you are unlikely to meet again.

Its twins: Spanish *hasta pronto*, French *à bientôt*. All three are the same two-word recipe — preposition plus "soon."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bis bald is *bis* + *bald*. *bald* ← Old High German *baldo*, "boldly, quickly" (EtymDB 2.1) — the same word as English *bold*; "soon" grew out of "quickly".

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "bis bald" — *biss BALT*
- the three twins — "bis bald", "hasta pronto", "à bientôt"
- "Tschüss, bis bald!"

Before you move on

What does *bis bald* mean, word for word? ("Until soon.") When would you not use it? (When you do not expect to see the person before long.) What is the recipe? (*Bis* plus a time word.)

4.9 spät — "late," and *später*, your first comparative

Bis bald is for soon. For a vaguer "see you around," German needs "later" — and it builds that from "late" exactly the way English does.

You'll want to know: spät

spät — "late."

The **ä** is the vowel you met in *Nächte*: roughly the *e* of English *bed*, held a little longer.

Sounds you'll need

- `st-initial-scht` — a German **st** at the *start* of a word is said **sht**. So *spät* opens like English *shp*, not *sp*: **shpayt**.

The same rule gives *Stadt* as *shtat* and *Straße* as *shtrahsse*. It is one of the fastest ways to stop sounding like a beginner, and it costs one rule.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Add **-er** and you have the comparative:

German	English
spät	late
*spät**er***	lat**er**

That **-er** is not a coincidence and not a borrowing — English and German inherited the same comparative ending from the same ancestor. *Late/later*, *spät/später*: one pattern, two languages.
So the second goodbye in the family is **bis später**, "until later" — the twin of Spanish *hasta luego* and French *à plus tard*, and the one to reach for when you have no idea when you will actually meet again.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "spät" (*shpayt*) — *sht*, not *st*
- "spät" then "später" — late, then later

Before you move on

What does *spät* mean, and *später*? ("Late"; "later.") How is an initial **st** pronounced? (*Sht* — *shpayt*.) Which ending makes the comparative, in both languages? (**-er**.)

4.10 bis später — "see you later"

Second ingredient into the same slot — and this one commits to nothing at all, which is exactly why it is the most used.

You'll want to know: bis später

bis später — "until later" → "see you later."

Said *biss SHPAY-ter* — remember the initial **st** is *sht*.

Where *bis bald* promises "before long," *bis später* promises nothing: it is the German equivalent of a wave. That vagueness makes it the safe default when you have no idea when you will meet again.

German	Spanish	French
bis später	*hasta luego*	*à plus tard*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bis später is *bis* + the comparative of *spät*, "late". *spät* ← Old High German *spāti* ← Proto-Germanic **spēdiz* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "bis später" — *biss SHPAY-ter*
- "bis bald" then "bis später" — soon, then vaguely
- the twins — "hasta luego", "à plus tard"

Before you move on

What does *bis später* mean? ("Until later.") How does it differ from *bis bald*? (*Bald* promises soon; *später* promises nothing.) How do you say the initial **st**? (*Sht*.)

4.11 morgen — "tomorrow," the same word doing a second job

No new word this time — a word you have had since chapter one, doing something you have not seen it do.

You'll want to know: morgen

morgen — "tomorrow."

Same spelling as the *Morgen* of *Guten Morgen*, same sound: *MOR-gen*, with the German **r** made at the back of the throat.

Grammar Lens: the capital letter splits the sense

German capitalises every noun. That rule usually just makes text look busy — here it does real work:

Written	Part of speech	Means
der **M**orgen	noun	the morning
morgen	adverb	tomorrow

Guten Morgen! is "good **morning**." Plain *morgen*, small m, is "**tomorrow**." The capital is the only thing telling them apart on the page — and once you know that, German's noun-capitalisation stops being decoration and starts being punctuation you can read.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

This morning-becomes-tomorrow move is not a German quirk. All three languages make "tomorrow" out of "morning":

Language	Morning	Tomorrow
German	*Morgen*	*morgen*
Spanish	*mañana*	*mañana*
French	*matin*	*demain*

And English did it too, then half forgot: **morrow** meant *morning*, and **tomorrow** is literally *to (the) morrow*. German *morgen* ← Old High German *morgan* (EtymDB 2.1), the same word as English *morrow*. So *bis morgen* is "see you on the morrow," almost word for word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Guten Morgen" — good morning, capital M
- "morgen" — tomorrow, small m
- "morrow" then "morgen" — the same old word

Before you move on

What are the two meanings of *morgen*? ("Morning" and "tomorrow.") What tells them apart in writing? (The capital letter — nouns take one.) Which English word is the old "morning"? (*Morrow*, still inside *tomorrow*.)

4.12 bis morgen — "see you tomorrow"

Third ingredient, and the most definite of the three: a goodbye with an actual date on it.

You'll want to know: bis morgen

bis morgen — "until tomorrow" → "see you tomorrow."

Said *biss MOR-gen*. Small **m**: here *morgen* is the adverb "tomorrow," not the noun *der Morgen*, "the morning."

This is the one you say leaving work, or leaving a class you both attend again the next day. Unlike *bis bald* and *bis später*, it makes a claim that can be checked.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bis morgen is *bis* + *morgen*, "tomorrow", which is the word for "morning" ← Old High German *morgan* ← Proto-Germanic **murganaz*. English *morrow* is the same word. (EtymDB 2.1)

Grammar Lens: the bis... family, complete

One preposition, three time words, three goodbyes — and the same three in Spanish and French, built the same way:

German	Means	Spanish / French twin
bis bald	soon	*hasta pronto* / *à bientôt*
bis später	later	*hasta luego* / *à plus tard*
bis morgen	tomorrow	*hasta mañana* / *à demain*

You now hold German's whole farewell set: the formal *auf Wiedersehen*, the casual *tschüss*, and these three soft partings.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "bis morgen" — *biss MOR-gen*, small *m*
- all three — "bis bald", "bis später", "bis morgen"
- "Tschüss, bis morgen!"

Before you move on

What does *bis morgen* mean? ("Until tomorrow.") Why the small **m**? (It is the adverb "tomorrow," not the noun "morning.") Name all three *bis…* goodbyes. (*Bald*, *später*, *morgen.*)

4.13 ß — the letter that is two *s*'s in a coat

German has one letter no other Latin alphabet uses. You have already written it without being told what it was: *heißen.*

You'll want to know: ß

ß — the *eszett*, or *scharfes S*, "sharp S."

It is not a capital *B*, and it is not exotic. It is **ss** wearing a single character, and it always sounds like a plain sharp *s* — never a *z*, never a *b*.

It is a **ligature**: two letters fused into one shape. Its name says which two. *Es-zett* is literally "s-z" — in the old German hand the **long s** (a tall *s* drawn like an *f* without its crossbar) was joined to a following *s* or *z*, and the join hardened into **ß**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ß is a letter, not a word: it comes from a long *s* joined to a following *s* or *z* in the old German hand, which is why it is called *Es-zett*, "s-z".

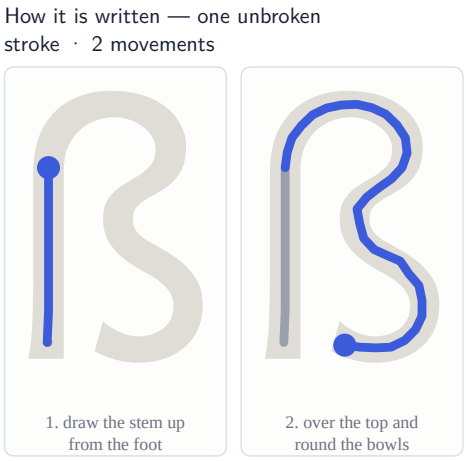
Grammar Lens: ß after long, ss after short

Modern spelling gives it one clean job, and it is a genuinely useful one — the letter tells you how long to hold the vowel *before* it.

ß — long vowel	**ss — short vowel**
Straße (long *a*)	*Fluss* (short *u*)
heiße (diphthong *ei*)	*muss* (short *u*)
groß (long *o*)	*Schloss* (short *o*)

So seeing **ß** means "the vowel before me is long." *Straße* stretches its *a*; *Fluss* clips its *u*. One letter, two pieces of information.

Writing — drawing the eszett



How ß is written, stroke by stroke

Draw it as a tall loop joined to a descending tail — the long-s curve, then the s/z finish. Copy **heiße** once with the model in view, then **Straße**.

Say each word as you finish it, and stretch the vowel the **ß** is telling you to stretch.

Why it's said this way

Two things worth knowing about where you will and will not see it:

- **It has no everyday capital.** No German word begins with *ß*, so in ALL-CAPS you traditionally write **SS**: *STRASSE*. A capital eszett was finally made official in 2017, but *SS* is still what you will see.
- **Switzerland dropped it entirely.** Swiss German always writes *ss* — *Strasse*. So *ß* on a sign is a Germany-and-Austria marker.

Before you move on

What two letters is **ß** made of, and what does its name say? (*s* and *z* — *es-zett*.) What does it tell you about the vowel before it? (That it is long.) How is it written in all-caps, and where is it not used at all? (*SS*; Switzerland.)

4.14 ä ö ü — the two dots that used to be an *e*

You have already made two of these sounds — the **ö** of *schön* and the **ü** of *tschüss*. Now meet the mark itself, and what it is doing there.

You'll want to know: the umlaut

Umlaut — the two dots on **ä ö ü**, which shift the vowel *forward* in the mouth.

Um-laut is "around-sound" (*um*, around + *Laut*, sound). Say the plain vowel, then brighten it toward *ee*:

Plain	Umlauted	How
a → **ä**	*Nacht* → *Nächte* ("nights")	*ah* becomes the *e* of *bed*
o → **ö**	*schon* ("already") → *schön*	*oh* becomes a rounded *eh*
u → **ü**	*gut* → *Güte* ("goodness")	*oo* becomes *ee* with rounded lips

They look like the French tréma and do the opposite job: a tréma **splits** two vowels, an umlaut **changes** one.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The dots are a fossil. The fronting was originally caused by an **e** in the *next* syllable, and scribes marked it by writing a tiny **e above the vowel**. In the old German hand that *e* was two little vertical strokes — which, shrunk and simplified, became two dots.
So an umlaut is a **flattened *e* sitting on top of the vowel**, and that is exactly why the ASCII fallbacks put it back on the line:

With dots	Ghost *e* restored
Müller	Mueller
schön	schoen
Bär	Baer

Grammar Lens: the umlaut does real work

Umlauts are not decoration. Fronting a vowel is how German marks whole grammatical changes, so learn to *expect* it:

Base	Umlauted	What changed
Nacht (night)	*Nächte*	plural
Buch (book)	*Bücher*	plural
groß (big)	*größer*	comparative
Mann (man)	*Männchen*	diminutive

Only *Nacht* is a word you own yet; the other three are here for their dots, with their meanings beside them. When a German word brightens its vowel, something grammatical happened to it — usually *more than one*, *more*, or *smaller*.

Writing — the two dots



How these letters are written, one after another, stroke by stroke: ä, ö, ü

Two dots, side by side, sitting squarely **above** the vowel — not slanted, and not joined. Copy **schön** once with the model in view, then **Nächte**.

Say each word as you finish it, and let the vowel brighten as you write the dots.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Nacht" then "Nächte" — hear the vowel brighten for the plural
- "gut" then "Güte" — *ee* with rounded lips
- "schön" then "schoen" — put the ghost *e* back down

Before you move on

What does *Umlaut* literally mean? ("Around-sound.") What are the dots, historically? (A shrunken *e* that migrated on top.) What is

the fallback spelling for *ü*? (*ue*.) Name one grammar job the umlaut does. (Plural, comparative, or diminutive.)

4.15 Großschreibung — why German capitalises every noun

You met this rule with *der Tag*, and you used it to tell *Morgen* from *morgen*. Now here it is in full — and it turns out to be doing more work than it looks.

You'll want to know: Großschreibung

Großschreibung — "capital-writing." Every noun takes a capital, anywhere in the sentence.

Not just names or sentence starts — *every* noun:

Guten **Abend**, gute **Nacht**, bis morgen! — "Good evening, good night, see you tomorrow!"

Two nouns, two capitals, both mid-sentence. *Guten* is capitalised only because it opens the sentence; *gute* stays small; and *morgen* here means "tomorrow", which is no noun, so it stays small too. Also capitalised: the polite *Sie*, and any word *used as* a noun (*das Gute*, "the good").

(The word itself shows off two things you now know: the **ß**, and the initial **st** said *sht* — *GROHSS-shry-boong*.)

Grammar Lens: the capital is a part-of-speech signal

The capital carries **meaning**. It separates words spelt alike that do different jobs:

Lower-case	Capital, so a noun
essen — to eat	*das Essen* — the food
jung — young	*der Junge* — the boy
laut — loud	*der Laut* — the sound

This is the same machinery that split *morgen* from *Morgen*. With *der/die/das* in front as well, German flags its nouns **twice** — which is why long German sentences are easier to parse, not harder.

Why it's said this way

English used to do this too: read a page of 1700s English and the Nouns are Capitalised. English dropped the habit in the eighteenth century; German kept it and wrote it into the rules. It is a living fossil of older European printing.

Writing — applying the rule

Capitalise the first letter of every noun, wherever it sits. Two tests if you are unsure: is there a *der/die/das* in front, or does it end in *-ung*, *-heit* or *-schaft*? Those are noun factories — *Zeitung*, *Freiheit*, *Freundschaft*.

Copy **Guten Abend, gute Nacht** once, then write *Guten Morgen* and *bis morgen* one under the other and check every capital.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Guten Abend, gute Nacht" — every noun capitalised
- "gut" then "das Gute" — the capital flips it from describing to thing
- "Guten Morgen" then "bis morgen" — the same flip, in a word you own

Before you move on

Which words does German capitalise? (Every noun, anywhere — plus *Sie*.) What does the capital tell you? (That the word is a noun: *gut* versus *das Gute*.) Which language used to do this and stopped? (English, in the 1700s.)

4.16 Practice — hello to goodbye, in one conversation

No new words. This is the first conversation you can run from the first word to the last — everything in it has had its own lesson.

Grammar Lens: which farewell, when

You are...	Say
formal, to a stranger	*Auf Wiedersehen.*
casual, to a friend	*Tschüss.*
meeting again soon	*Bis bald.*
making no promises	*Bis später.*
leaving for the day	*Bis morgen.*

The exchange

Everything from your first greeting to here, in one conversation:

German	English
Hallo! Ich heiße Anna. Wie heißen Sie?	Hello! My name is Anna. What is your name?
Ich heiße Peter. Freut mich.	My name is Peter. Pleased to meet you.
Wie geht es Ihnen?	How are you?
Danke, gut. Und Ihnen?	Well, thanks. And you?
Sehr gut. Bis morgen, Peter.	Very well. See you tomorrow, Peter.
Bis morgen, Anna. Auf Wiedersehen!	See you tomorrow, Anna. Goodbye!

Between friends, that last line becomes *Tschüss, bis morgen!* — and note that the whole exchange stayed formal because it opened formally with *Sie*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the whole exchange, both voices
- the closing pair — "Bis morgen." … "Auf Wiedersehen!"
- the casual version of that close — "Tschüss, bis morgen!"

Twice through: "Wie geht es Ihnen? — Danke, gut. Und Ihnen?"

Before you move on

Run the whole conversation without looking. Which goodbye promises a re-seeing? (*Auf Wiedersehen.*) Which one is secretly "to God"? (*Tschüss.*) Which would you use leaving a class you both attend tomorrow? (*Bis morgen.*)

Chapter 5

The First Verbs

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (15) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 15 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can conjugate any regular German verb, ask where someone lives and what they are doing, and build my own present-tense sentences instead of reciting them.
>
> *Until now the book handed over fixed phrases. This chapter hands over the machine: take the -en off a German verb and the stem that is left accepts six endings, learned once and applied to thousands of words. Three verbs run through it — wohnen, machen, lernen — along with the pronouns the paradigm needs and the question words wo and was. It ends with Ich lerne Deutsch, the first sentence in the book assembled from parts nobody handed over whole, and with the reason German keeps its pronoun when Spanish drops it.*

5.1 wohnen — "to live," and your first regular verb

Until now you have assembled fixed phrases. This chapter hands you the machine itself — and the first verb to run through it.

You'll want to know: wohnen

wohnen — "to live, to dwell."

Not *to be alive* — that is a different verb. *Wohnen* is where your bed is.

Sounds you'll need

- `w-as-v` — the **w** is an English *v*.
- `h-silent-lengthening` — the **h** only stretches the *o*, exactly as in *gehen* and *sehen*.

So: *VOH-nen*, with a long open *oh*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wohnen comes from Old High German *wonēn*, "to dwell, to be accustomed, to be content" — because dwelling somewhere and *being used to* it were the same idea.
That root survives in English, just barely, in **wont**: "as is his *wont*" means "as he is accustomed." It is also kin to **win** and **wish** — all from one root about striving for something, or being content with it. So *wohnen* is not a stranger. It is the word behind *wont*, still doing the older job.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "wohnen" (*VOH-nen*) — *v*, then a long *oh*
- "wohnen" and English "wont" — accustomed, at home
- "wohnen", "gehen", "sehen" — three verbs, one silent *h*

Before you move on

What does *wohnen* mean? ("To live, to dwell.") Which English word is it? (*Wont* — accustomed.) What does the *h* do? (Only lengthens the *o*.)

5.2 der Stamm — drop the *-en*, and you have the machine

You met the ending-swap on *heißen*. Here is the piece underneath it, and it is the reason the swap works on every verb.

You'll want to know: the stem

> **The stem** is what is left when you take **-en** off the dictionary form.

wohnen minus *-en* leaves **wohn-**. That is the part that never changes. The endings attach to it, and the dictionary form you look up is simply the stem already wearing one of them.

Grammar Lens: the three singular endings

Take *wohn-* and add:

Person	Ending	Form
ich	**-e**	*ich wohne*
du	**-st**	*du wohnst*

You saw *-e* on *ich heiße*. The *-st* was hiding: *heißen* ends in **ß**, and *ß + st* collapses to *heißt*, so *du heißt* never showed you the *s*. On a normal stem it is plain — *du wohnst*.

This is not special to *wohnen*. Every regular verb in German runs exactly this, which is why learning one is learning thousands. Grammars call these **weak** verbs — "weak" because they take their endings meekly instead of changing their vowel the way *strong* verbs do. You will meet a strong one soon enough.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "wohnen" then the stem — "wohn-"
- "ich wohne", "du wohnst"
- the endings alone — *-e*, *-st*

Before you move on

How do you get the stem? (Drop *-en*.) What is the stem of *wohnen*? (*Wohn-*.) Which endings go with *ich* and *du*? (*-e* and *-st*.) Why did *du heißt* not show the *s*? (*ß* and *st* collapse together.)

5.3 er · sie · es — "he," "she," "it," and one ending for all three

You can talk about yourself and to one other person. To talk *about* someone you need three more pronouns — and you already own one of them.

You'll want to know: er, sie, es

er — "he." Said *air*, with the soft German *r*.

It pairs with the article you already know: **der** things are *er* things.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sie — "she." Said *zee*.

Yes: the same sound and spelling as the polite *Sie*, and as the *sie* meaning "they." German really does run three jobs through one word, and only the capital and the verb ending tell them apart. You will meet that properly later; for now, small **sie** with a *-t* ending means **she**. The three pronouns line up with the three articles, which is the whole reason German bothers with genders:

Article	Pronoun	English
der	*er*	he
die	*sie*	she
das	*es*	it

All three pronouns are inherited. *Es* is kin to English *it*, and *sie* is usually linked to English *she*, whose own history is disputed.

Grammar Lens: all three take -t

One ending covers all three — attach **-t** to the stem:

er wohnt · *sie wohnt* · *es wohnt*

English does the same thing with *-s* (*he lives*, *she lives*, *it lives*) and nowhere else in the paradigm. German's *-t* is that same odd little marker.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "er", "sie", "es" — he, she, it
- "der/er", "die/sie", "das/es" — article, then pronoun
- "er wohnt", "sie wohnt", "es wohnt" — one ending, three people

Before you move on

Which pronoun goes with *der*? (*Er.*) With *die*? (*Sie.*) What ending do all three take? (*-t — er wohnt.*) Which English ending does the same job? (*-s*, as in *he lives.*)

5.4 wir — "we," and an ending you have already been saying

Three singular people down. Now the plural — and the first one is nearly free.

Say *wohnen*: the *w* is an English *v*, and the *h* only stretches the *o*. *VOH-nen.*

You'll want to know: wir

wir — "we." Said *veer*, with the **w** as a *v* and the soft trailing *r*, so it rhymes with *mir* and *dir.*

It is English **we**, wearing German pronunciation. Nothing else to learn.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wir ← Old High German *wir* ← Proto-Germanic **wīz*, "we" — inherited, the same word as English *we.* (EtymDB 2.1)

Grammar Lens: wir takes -en

Attach **-en** to the stem:

wir wohnen

Which is the dictionary form, unchanged. German's infinitive and its

wir form are identical, for every regular verb — so half of this ending was already in your head before you met it.
You have seen this once: *Sie heißen*, the polite form, is the same *-en*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "wir" (*veer*) — it rhymes with "mir" and "dir"
- "wohnen" then "wir wohnen" — the same word twice
- "ich wohne", "du wohnst", "er wohnt", "wir wohnen"

Before you move on

What does *wir* mean, and what does it rhyme with? ("We"; *mir* and *dir*.) Which ending does it take? (*-en*.) What else looks exactly like *wir wohnen*? (The dictionary form, *wohnen*.)

5.5 ihr — "you all," the plural English threw away

Du is one friend. What if there are several? English has no clean answer any more. German does.

You'll want to know: ihr

ihr — "you all," the plural of *du*.

Said *eer*: the **h** is silent and lengthens the *i*, the same trick as in *Ihnen*.

Use it for a group you would each call *du* — friends, family, a team. For a group of strangers you still use *Sie*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

English used to have this exact system and lost half of it. *Thou* was the singular and *ye*/*you* the plural — then *thou* faded, *you* took over both jobs, and English was left unable to say "you all" without inventing something: *y'all*, *you guys*, *yous*, *you lot*.
German never lost the distinction, so it needs no invention:

	Informal	Formal
one person	*du*	*Sie*
several people	*ihr*	*Sie*

Ihr ← Old High German *ir* ← Proto-Germanic **jīz* (EtymDB 2.1), the same word as English *ye*.

Grammar Lens: ihr takes -t

Attach **-t** to the stem:

ihr wohnt

The same *-t* as *er wohnt*. Two different people, one ending — so context, not the verb, tells you which is meant. That is the only place the German present tense is ever ambiguous, and the pronoun clears it up instantly.
The paradigm is now complete: **-e · -st · -t · -en · -t · -en**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ihr" (*eer*) — you all
- "du wohnst" then "ihr wohnt" — one friend, then several
- the whole six — wohne, wohnst, wohnt, wohnen, wohnt, wohnen

Before you move on

What does *ihr* mean? ("You all.") Which English word did the same job before it was lost? (*Ye* — leaving *y'all* to fill the gap.) Which ending does *ihr* share, and with whom? (*-t*, with *er/sie/es*.)

5.6 The endings you can actually hear

You have all six endings. Before moving on, one fact about them that makes German easier than it looks.

Grammar Lens: German endings are audible

Say them aloud and they genuinely differ:

wohne · *wohnst* · *wohnt* · *wohnen*

French writes just as many endings and pronounces almost none of them — *parle*, *parles*, *parlent* are three spellings of one sound. A French listener gets the person from the pronoun alone, because the verb tells them nothing.
German is the opposite. The verb carries real information, and you could very nearly tell who is speaking from the ending by itself.
That is worth knowing for two reasons. It makes listening easier than reading at first, and it makes the *next* question interesting: if German endings say who the subject is, why does German still insist on the pronoun? That is the end of this chapter.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "wohne", "wohnst", "wohnt" — three different sounds
- them again with your eyes closed, and hear the person change
- the full six in order

Before you move on

Are German verb endings audible? (Yes — *wohne*, *wohnst*, *wohnt* all differ.) And French ones? (Largely silent.) What does that let a German listener do? (Hear the person from the verb, not only the pronoun.)

5.7 in — the word that did not change

Ich wohne — I live. Live *where*? One more word and you have said something true about yourself.

You'll want to know: in

in — "in."

Same spelling, same meaning, near enough the same sound: a short *i* as in English *bit*. This is one of the small handful of words German and English never bothered to change.

You have already met its neighbour *auf* ("on"). Between them they cover most of what English does with *in* and *on*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

in ← Old High German *in* ← Proto-Germanic **in* — inherited, the same word as English *in*. (EtymDB 2.1)

You'll want to know: Ich wohne in …

Put a place after it and the sentence is finished:

Ich wohne in Berlin. — "I live in Berlin."

Swap the city for your own and the sentence is yours. This is the first thing in this book you can say about your actual life without being handed the whole line.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "in" — short *i*, exactly as in English
- "Ich wohne in Berlin."
- the same sentence with the town you actually live in

Before you move on

What does *in* mean? ("In" — unchanged.) Say where you live. (*Ich wohne in …*) Which word covers "on"? (*Auf.*)

5.8 wo — "where," and the German w-questions

You can say where you live. To *ask* it, you need the question word — and it belongs to a family you have already started.

In: the same spelling and meaning as English, with a short *i* as in *bit*.

You'll want to know: wo

wo — "where." Said *voh*, a long *oh*.

Wo wohnst du? — "Where do you live?"

Note there is no extra "do" in German. English needs *do* to ask a question; German simply puts the question word first and the verb straight after it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wo is English **where** with the *-re* worn away. And it is not alone — German's question words are the English ones with **wh-** flattened to **w-**:

German	English
wo	where
wie	how
wer	who
wann	when

English spells them *wh-* and mostly says them *w-*; German just spells what it says. Once you spot the family, each new one costs almost nothing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "wo" (*voh*) — where
- "Wo wohnst du?" — no "do" needed
- the two of the family you own — "wo", "wie"

Before you move on

What does *wo* mean? ("Where.") Ask someone where they live. (*Wo wohnst du?*) What happened to English *wh-* in German? (It flattened to *w-*.)

5.9 machen — "to make," and it is exactly English *make*

Second verb — and it needs no new grammar at all. The stem-plus-ending machine you built on *wohnen* runs it unchanged.

You'll want to know: machen

machen — "to make," and also "to do." German uses one verb for both.

Stem: **mach-**. So *ich mache*, *du machst*, *er macht*, *wir machen*, *ihr macht*, *sie machen*. Nothing new — that is the payoff of a regular pattern.

Sounds you'll need

- `ch-ach` — the **ch** after *a* is the raspy throat sound you met in *Nacht*, the *ch* of Scottish *loch*. Not the soft *ich* sound.

So: *MAKH-en*, with a clean open *ah*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

machen is English **make**, from Germanic *makōn*, "to shape, to fit together." The *k* became the *ch* rasp on the way, by the same High German consonant shift that gave you *gut* from *good*:

English	German
ma**k**e	ma**ch**en
i**k** (old *I*)	i**ch**
boo**k**	Bu**ch**

So *machen* is *make*, wearing German pronunciation.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "machen" (*MAKH-en*) — the *loch* rasp
- "make" then "machen"; "book" then "Buch"
- "ich mache", "du machst", "er macht"

Before you move on

What does *machen* mean? ("To make," and "to do.") Which English word is it? (*Make.*) Which *ch* does it use? (The raspy *ach*, not the soft *ich*.)

5.10 was — "what," and the t-to-s swap one last time

You have *wo*. Here is its most useful sibling, and you can already predict how it is spelt.

You'll want to know: was

was — "what." Said *vass*, short *a*, crisp *s*.

You met the rule that makes it: where English keeps a final **t**, German shows an **s**.

English	German
wha**t**	wa**s**
tha**t**	da**s**
i**t**	e**s**

Third time you have seen this pair, and the last new word it gives you.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

was ← Old High German *waz* ← Proto-Germanic **hwat* — inherited, the same word as English *what*, with German *s* where English kept *t*. (EtymDB 2.1)

You'll want to know: Was machst du?

Was machst du? — "What are you doing?"

Question word first, verb second, subject third — the same shape as *Wo wohnst du?*. And note again that German needs no "do": *machst* carries the whole question.

There is also no separate "am …-ing" form in German. *Was machst du?* covers both "what do you do?" and "what are you doing?" — context decides.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "was" (*vass*) — what
- "what/was", "that/das", "it/es" — the swap three times
- "Was machst du?" then "Wo wohnst du?" — the same shape

Before you move on

What does *was* mean? ("What.") Which swap explains its spelling? (English *t* shows up as German *s*.) Ask what someone is doing. (*Was machst du?*)

5.11 lernen — "to learn," and its noun is *lore*

Third verb, same machine — and this is the one you are going to need to describe what you are doing right now.

You'll want to know: lernen

lernen — "to learn."

Stem **lern-**: *ich lerne*, *du lernst*, *er lernt*. Three verbs now, one pattern.

Sounds you'll need

- `r-uvular-german` — the German **r** is a soft scrape at the back of the throat, nothing like the English *r* made with the tongue tip.

So: *LER-nen*, with a short *e* as in English *bed*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lernen is English **learn** — the same Germanic root, barely disguised. Its relatives are the good part. The German noun is **die Lehre**, "the teaching, the body of what is taught" — and that word is English **lore**. Folklore is the *Lehre* of a folk; the lore of a craft is what its learners have accumulated.
So German kept the verb and the noun in the same family, and English kept both too — it just stopped noticing that *learn* and *lore* were relatives.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "lernen" (*LER-nen*) — scrape the *r* at the back
- "lernen" and English "learn"
- "die Lehre" and English "lore" — folklore

Before you move on

What does *lernen* mean? ("To learn.") What is its noun, and which English word is that? (*Die Lehre*; *lore*.) Give the *ich* form. (*Ich lerne*.)

5.12 Deutsch — the language, and it means "of the people"

One noun stands between you and a sentence about what you are doing right now — the name of the language itself.

You'll want to know: Deutsch

Deutsch — "German," the language.

Capital **D**, because a language name is a noun and German capitalises every noun.

Sounds you'll need

- `eu-diphthong` — German **eu** is the *oy* of English *boy*.
- `tsch-ch` — **tsch** is the *tch* of English *match*, the same cluster that opens *tschüss*.

So: *DOYTCH*, one syllable.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Deutsch comes from Old High German **diutisc**, "of the people, of the folk." The Germanic tribes simply called their own tongue *the people's language* — as opposed to Latin, the language of church and administration.
That root travelled a long way:

Word	Language	Route
Deutsch	German	*diutisc*, "of the people"
Dutch	English	the same word, later narrowed to the Netherlands
Teutonic	English	via Latin *Teutonicus*
Tedesco	Italian	its own echo of *diutisc*

So English **Dutch** and German **Deutsch** are not lookalikes — they are one word that drifted apart, and English simply pointed it at a smaller country.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Deutsch" (*DOYTCH*) — one syllable
- "Deutsch" then "Dutch" — the same old word
- what it meant — "of the people"

Before you move on

What does *Deutsch* literally mean? ("Of the people.") Which English word is the same word? (*Dutch.*) Why the capital **D**? (It is a noun.)

5.13 Ich lerne Deutsch — your first real sentence

Nothing new is coming. Every piece of the next line has had its own lesson — and that is exactly the point.

You'll want to know: Ich lerne Deutsch

Ich lerne Deutsch. — "I am learning German."

Piece	Where it came from
ich	the introductions chapter
lern-	the stem of *lernen*
-e	the *ich* ending
Deutsch	the last lesson

This is the first sentence in the book that was **not handed to you**. You built it: a pronoun, a stem, an ending, a noun. Change any piece and it still works.

Remember there is no separate "am …-ing" in German. *Ich lerne* covers both "I learn" and "I am learning," so this one line does the work of two English tenses.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ich lerne Deutsch is three inherited words: *lernen* ← Old High German *lernēn*, and *Deutsch* ← Old High German *diutisc*, "of the people" ← Proto-Germanic **þiudiskaz* (EtymDB 2.1). *lernen* is a cousin of English *learn*.

Grammar Lens: swap the pieces

The same slots take other words, and you already have all of them:

Ich wohne in Berlin. · *Was machst du?* · *Ich lerne Deutsch.*

Three sentences, one machine. From here the language is combinations, not memorised lines.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Ich lerne Deutsch." — *ikh LER-neh DOYTCH*
- it in pieces — "ich", "lern-", "-e", "Deutsch"
- all three sentences in a row

Before you move on

Say "I am learning German." (*Ich lerne Deutsch.*) Which four pieces is it made of? (*Ich*, the stem *lern-*, the ending *-e*, and *Deutsch.*) How does German say "I am learning" as opposed to "I learn"? (It does not — *ich lerne* is both.)

5.14 Why German keeps the pronoun

Here is the puzzle left open earlier. German endings *do* say who the subject is. So why say *ich* at all?

Grammar Lens: three languages, three reasons

Spanish, French and German each decide differently, and for different reasons:

Language	The pronoun	Why
Spanish	**dropped**	*hablo* already says "I"
French	**kept**	its endings are silent, so the pronoun is the only clue
German	**kept**	its grammar demands an overt subject

The German reason is the interesting one, because it is *not* about sound. German endings are perfectly audible — you proved that a few lessons ago. The pronoun stays because a German sentence is built around the **verb in second position**, with something standing in

front of it. Drop *ich* and there is nothing to hold that first slot. So German keeps the pronoun for **structure**, French for **sound**, and Spanish keeps neither because it needs neither. Three answers, and only one of them is about being understood.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Ich lerne Deutsch." — with the pronoun, always
- the three reasons — Spanish drops, French keeps for sound, German keeps for structure
- "ich wohne", "ich mache", "ich lerne" — never without the *ich*

Before you move on

Why does German keep the pronoun? (Its grammar needs an overt subject — the verb sits second, so something must come first.) Why does French? (Its endings are silent.) Why does Spanish not need to? (*Hablo* already says "I.")

5.15 Practice — building sentences, not reciting them

For the first time you are *building* German rather than repeating it. Run each verb through the three singular persons.

Grammar Lens: three verbs, one pattern

Verb	***ich* · *du* · *er***
wohnen	*wohne* · *wohnst* · *wohnt*
machen	*mache* · *machst* · *macht*
lernen	*lerne* · *lernst* · *lernt*

The same endings every time — **-e**, **-st**, **-t** — and, unlike French, you can hear all three. You still keep the pronoun, because German needs an overt subject.

The exchange

German	English
Wo wohnst du?	Where do you live?
Ich wohne in Berlin. Und du?	I live in Berlin. And you?
Ich wohne in Wien. Was machst du?	I live in Vienna. What are you doing?
Ich lerne Deutsch!	I'm learning German!
Sehr gut!	Very good!
Danke! — Bitte.	Thanks! — You're welcome.

Every line is assembled from pieces you own. Nothing here was memorised whole.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the whole exchange, both voices
- each verb through *ich* / *du* / *er*
- the exchange again with your own city

Twice through: "Wo wohnst du? — Ich wohne in …"

Before you move on

What are the three singular endings, and can you hear them? (*-e*, *-st*, *-t*; yes — unlike French.) Give the *ich* form of all three verbs. (*Ich wohne*, *ich mache*, *ich lerne*.) Why keep the pronoun? (German needs an overt subject.)

Chapter 6

One, Two, Three

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count one, two, three in German and say why each is the English number's twin rather than a Latin borrowing.
>
> *The first three numbers, one per lesson, and then the sound law that explains every difference between them and their English twins. German's numbers were never borrowed from Latin; this chapter is where that stops being a claim and becomes something the reader can hear.*

6.1 eins — "one," and the German *ei*

Here is where German is closer to English than any Romance language gets. Its numbers are not borrowed from Latin — they are German's own, and they are the near-twins of the English ones. Start with the first.

Deutsch: *eu* is the *oy* of *boy*, *tsch* the *tch* of *match*. One syllable.

You'll want to know: eins

eins — "one," the number you say when you are counting.

Sounds you'll need

- `diphthong-ei` — German **ei** is the English word **eye**. Always, in every word, with no exceptions to remember.

So *eins* is *eyns*. You already own this one: *heißen* is *HY-ssen*, and *Wiedersehen* has an *ie*, which is the other way round and says *ee*. **ei** says *eye*; **ie** says *ee*. The second letter tells you which.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

eins is English **one**. Not borrowed from it, not similar to it — the same inherited word, which is why it needs no story to make it stick. English hides the relationship in its spelling. *One* is written as though it rhymed with *bone*, and it did once; the *w*-sound at the front (*wun*) crept in later. Strip that off and *one* and *ein* are the same shape. The same word is also sitting inside English **a** and **an** — *an apple* is *one apple*, worn down. German does exactly the same thing with *eins*, and once the first five are learned there is a lesson on it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "eins" — *eyns*, with the English word *eye* inside it
- "eins" then "one" — the same old word
- "ei" as *eye*, "ie" as *ee* — the second letter decides

Before you move on

What is "one" in German? (*Eins.*) How is **ei** said? (Like the English word *eye*.) And **ie**? (*Ee.*) Which English word is *eins*? (*One* — and *a*/*an* underneath it.)

6.2 zwei — "two," and the *z* that is a *ts*

One down. The second number has the same *ei* you met a moment ago, and one letter that does not say what an English reader expects.

Lernen: the *r* is a soft scrape at the back of the throat. *LER-nen.*

You'll want to know: zwei

zwei — "two."

Said *tsvy*. The **z** is the *ts* of English *cats* — never the buzz of English *zoo*. That is the whole of the German **z**: it has one job and it never does anything else.

The other two letters you already own. The **w** is a *v*, as in *wohnen*, and the **ei** is *eye*, as in *eins*. So *zwei* is three rules you have and one that is new.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

zwei is English **two**, with the *tw-* opening turned into *zw-*.
English still says the *tw-* out loud in the words *two* grew from — **twin** (two born together), **between** (in the space of two), **twice**, **twenty**.
It only lost the *w* in the number itself, which is why *two* is spelt with a letter nobody pronounces. German kept the pair and shifted the *t* to *ts*:

tw- → *zw-*: **two** / *zwei*, **twin** / *Zwilling*, **twelve** / *zwölf*

So the silent *w* in English **two** is not a spelling accident. It is the *w* that German still says.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "zwei" — *tsvy*, the *z* like the end of *cats*
- "eins, zwei"
- "two", "twin", "between" — then "zwei", and hear the *w* come back

Before you move on

What is "two"? (*Zwei.*) How is German **z** said? (*Ts*, as in *cats.*) Which English words still say the *w* that *two* dropped? (*Twin*, *between*, *twice.*)

6.3 drei — "three," and German's missing *th*

Third number, third *ei*. And it shows you something that will keep paying: German has no **th** sound at all, and you can predict what it uses instead.

Was machst du? Question word, then verb, then subject, and no *do*.

You'll want to know: drei

drei — "three."

Said *dry*: the scraped *r* you met in *lernen*, and the *ei* saying *eye*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

drei is English **three**. German has no *th* at all, and where English says one, German says **d**. That is not a fact about numbers — it is a fact about the whole language, and you have been using it since your first *danke*:

English	German
three	**d**rei
the	**d**er, **d**ie, **d**as
thank	**d**anke
that	**d**as

Five words, one swap. Whenever an English word starts with *th*, try a *d* and you will often land on the German.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "drei" — *dry*, scrape the *r*
- "eins, zwei, drei"
- the swap — "three/drei", "the/der", "thank/danke"

Before you move on

What is "three"? (*Drei.*) What does German use where English has **th**? (**D.**) Give three pairs. (*Three/drei*, *the/der*, *thank/danke.*)

6.4 Siblings, not borrowings

Drei, *three*, and Latin *tres* all mean three and all start with a different sound. Before the next seven numbers, it is worth knowing why — because the answer makes each of them cheaper to learn.

Grammar Lens: siblings and cousins

German and English are **siblings**. Latin is a **cousin**.
That is not a figure of speech. All three grew out of one older language, and Germanic — the parent of English and German — split off from the rest first. So *drei* did not come **from** *tres*, and English *three* did not either. All three are what one prehistoric word became along three different roads.
Which is why the German numbers are the easy ones and the Romance numbers are the hard ones, for an English speaker: *three* and *drei* are the same word two doors apart, while *tres* is the same word across the street.

Why it's said this way

The differences are not random. A **sound law** is a change that happened to *every* word in a language at once, so once you know one you can predict the rest.
You have already met one of these. *Gut* is *good* with the **d** turned to a **t**, and *machen* is *make* with the **k** turned to a **ch** — one shift, two words, and it caught every word in German that had those sounds.
The shift that separates Germanic from Latin is older and works the same way. The two turns worth carrying into the next lessons are:

Older sound	Germanic sound	Seen in
t	**th**, and German **d**	Latin *tres*, English *three*, German *drei*
p	**f**	Latin *pes* “foot”, English *foot*

So when a Latin word and a German one sound nothing alike, try the first consonant before deciding they are unrelated. Often they are the same word, one law apart.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “tres”, “three”, “drei” — one word, three roads
- the two turns — “t becomes th”, “p becomes f”
- “good/gut”, “make/machen” — the shift you already knew

Before you move on

Is *drei* borrowed from Latin *tres*? (No — they are cousins, both from one older word.) What is a sound law? (A change that hit every word in the language at once, so it is predictable.) Which two turns should you carry forward? (Old **t** to **th**/**d**, old **p** to **f**.)

Chapter 7

Four, Five, and the Article Hiding in Eins

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count to five in German, run the whole five as one motion, and use ein and eine for "a".
>
> *Four and five complete the first run, which is then said as one motion rather than five remembered words. The chapter closes on ein / eine: the counting form eins with its -s taken off, exactly as English a and an are one worn down.*

7.1 vier — "four," written with a *v* and said with an *f*

The fourth number is the easiest one yet — as long as you do not trust the first letter.

You'll want to know: vier

vier — "four."

Sounds you'll need

- `v-as-f` — German **v** is said as an **f**. It is not a *v* sound; that job belongs to **w**.
- `ie-long-ee` — **ie** is a long *ee*, the mirror of **ei**.

So *vier* is *feer*. Put the two vowel rules side by side and the pair is settled for good:

Spelling	Sound	Example
ei	*eye*	*eins*, *zwei*, *drei*
ie	*ee*	*vier*, *wieder*

Both times, **the second letter is the one you say**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vier is English **four**, and once you know the *v* is an *f* you can hear it: *feer*, *four*. Latin's cousin is *quattuor*, which is where Spanish *cuatro* and French *quatre* come from — so this is a number where English sides with German and not with the Romance languages at all.
The *v*-said-as-*f* is not special to this word. German writes **v** in a handful of its oldest words — *vier*, *Vater*, *von*, *voll* — and says every one of them with an *f*, which is exactly the letter English uses in *four*, *father*, *from*, *full*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "vier" — *feer*, the *v* said as an *f*
- "eins, zwei, drei, vier"
- the vowel pair — "ei" as *eye*, "ie" as *ee*

Before you move on

What is "four"? (*Vier*, said *feer*.) How is German **v** said? (As an *f*.) Which letter carries the *v* sound instead? (**W**.) And how do you tell **ei** from **ie**? (Say the second letter.)

7.2 fünf — "five," and the law you can hear

The fifth number closes the first hand — and it is the clearest example of a sound law anywhere in the language.

You'll want to know: fünf

fünf — "five."

Sounds you'll need

- `umlaut-ue` — **ü** is an *ee* said with your lips rounded for an *oo*. Say *ee*, hold the tongue exactly where it is, and push your lips forward.

So *fünf* is roughly *fewnf*, in one syllable. This is the umlaut doing what you learned it does: it takes the back vowel **u** and drags it to the front of the mouth.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fünf is English **five**, and the two of them are the sound law from the last lesson caught in the act.
The older word for five began with a **p**. Latin kept it — *quinque* still has one in the middle — and Germanic turned every one of those **p**s into an **f**. So English got *five* and German got *fünf*, both starting with the letter that was once a *p*:

old **p** → Germanic **f**: **f**ive / **f**ünf, against Latin's *quinque*

Say *fünf* and *five* one after the other. They are the same word, and the whole distance between them and the Latin one is that single turn.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "fünf" — say *ee*, then round your lips without moving your tongue
- "fünf" then "five" — one word, one law apart
- "eins, zwei, drei, vier, fünf"

Before you move on

What is "five"? (*Fünf.*) How do you make **ü**? (Say *ee* and round your lips.) Which sound turned into the **f** of *five* and *fünf*? (An older **p** — the one Latin kept.)

7.3 eins bis fünf — counting to five

Five words, one at a time. Counting is something else: it is the five of them running together without a pause to think. That is what this lesson is for, and nothing in it is new.

You'll want to know: the run

eins, zwei, drei, vier, fünf

Said straight through: *eyns, tsvy, dry, feer, fewnf.*
Every one is the English number with a German coat on:

German	English	What changed
eins	one	nothing — English hid it in the spelling
zwei	two	the *tw-* German still says
drei	three	**th** flattened to **d**
vier	four	the **v** is said as an **f**
fünf	five	an older **p**, now an **f** in both

Not one of them is borrowed from Latin. All five are what an English speaker already half knows.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "eins, zwei, drei, vier, fünf" — straight through, no gaps
- it again, faster
- it backwards — "fünf, vier, drei, zwei, eins"

Twice through: "eins, zwei, drei, vier, fünf"

Before you move on

Count to five. (*Eins, zwei, drei, vier, fünf.*) Now backwards. (*Fünf, vier, drei, zwei, eins.*) Which of the five is borrowed from Latin? (None of them.)

And the two dots on *fünf*: what letter are they a flattened ghost of? (An **e** — which is why *fünf* can be typed *fuenf*.)

7.4 ein und eine — when "one" becomes "a"

Eins is what you say while counting. Put it in front of a naming word and it changes shape — and English does the very same trick, so this costs almost nothing.

You'll want to know: ein / eine

ein / eine — "a," "an," and also "one" when it sits in front of a naming word.

Which of the two you use follows the same three-way split you already know from *der*, *die*, *das*:

The word takes	So "a" is
der	**ein**
das	**ein**
die	**eine**

Two of the three groups share one form, so there is really only one thing to remember: **die** words take the extra **-e**. On the two nouns inside *guten Tag* and *gute Nacht*:

der Tag → **ein Tag**, "a day" · *die Nacht* → **eine Nacht**, "a night"

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ein ← Old High German *ein* ← Proto-Germanic **ainaz*, "one" — inherited, the same word as English *one*, and English *a*, *an* wore down from it too. (EtymDB 2.1)

Grammar Lens: the counting -s drops

Counting form: *eins*. In front of a naming word: *ein / eine*.
The *-s* belongs to counting and to nothing else.
English does the identical thing, and hides it every bit as well. *One* in front of a naming word wore down to **a** and **an** — *an apple* really is

one apple, said quickly for a thousand years. So both languages have a special worn-down shape of "one", and both use it as the word for "a". The other numbers do not do this. *Zwei*, *drei*, *vier* and *fünf* look exactly the same whether you are counting or putting them in front of something. Only the first number has two shapes, in German as in English.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "eins" — then "ein", dropping the *s*
- "der Tag / ein Tag", "die Nacht / eine Nacht"
- "one apple", then "an apple" — English doing the same thing

Before you move on

What happens to *eins* in front of a naming word? (It drops the *-s*: *ein*.) Which group takes *eine*? (The *die* group.) Which English words are the same worn-down "one"? (*A* and *an*.) Do the other numbers change? (No — only the first.)

Chapter 8

Six, Seven, Eight

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count six, seven and eight in German, and hear the three sounds that make them hard to guess from the spelling.
>
> *Three more numbers, each with the sound that makes it unguessable from the page: the chs of sechs, the buzzing s of sieben, and the throat sound in acht that English spells gh.*

8.1 sechs — "six," where *chs* is a plain *x*

The second hand starts here. And the sixth number quietly settles the last thing German **ch** can do.

You'll want to know: sechs

sechs — "six."

Sounds you'll need

- `ch-none` — in **chs**, the *ch* makes no throat sound at all. The pair is a plain **ks**, exactly the English letter *x*.

So *sechs* is *zeks*, and it rhymes with English *sex* — which is also, as it happens, the Latin word for six.
That completes the **ch**: raspy after *a* as in *machen*, and silent-into-*ks* when an *s* follows. Nothing else to learn about it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sechs is English **six**, and here the two languages have barely moved apart at all — *zeks* against *siks*. Even the Latin cousin *sex* is close enough to hear, because this is one of the few numbers no sound law rearranged much.
Which makes it the cheapest number in the chapter: if you can say *x*, you can say *sechs*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "sechs" — *zeks*, no throat rasp
- "machen" then "sechs" — the two jobs of *ch*
- "sechs" then "six" — barely a step apart

Before you move on

What is "six"? (*Sechs*, said *zeks*.) What does **ch** do in front of an *s*? (Nothing — the pair is a plain *ks*.) And after an *a*? (The raspy throat sound, as in *machen*.)

8.2 sieben — "seven," and the buzzing *s*

You have been saying *sechs* as *zeks* without being told why. Here is the rule, on the number that needs it most.

You'll want to know: sieben

sieben — "seven." Two syllables: *ZEE-ben*.

Sounds you'll need

- `s-voiced` — a German **s** in front of a vowel **buzzes**, like the English letter *z*. At the end of a word it goes back to a plain hiss.
- `ie-long-ee` — the long *ee* again, as in *vier*.

So *sieben* is *ZEE-ben*, not *SEE-ben*. And it explains the two numbers before it: *sechs* is *zeks* and not *seks* for the same reason.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sieben is English **seven**, with the middle consonant softened from a *v* to a *b* — a swap those two letters make in each other's direction constantly, because they are made with the same lips.
This is the one number where the Latin cousin is also unmistakable: *septem*, which English still uses in *September* and in *septet*. Seven is the number almost nobody's language disguised.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "sieben" — *ZEE-ben*, buzz the *s*
- "sechs, sieben" — both start with the buzz
- "sieben" then "seven"

Before you move on

What is "seven"? (*Sieben*, said *ZEE-ben.*) What does a German **s** do in front of a vowel? (It buzzes, like *z*.) And at the end of a word? (It hisses.) Which English word is *sieben*? (*Seven* — the *v* softened to a *b*.)

8.3 acht — "eight," on a rasp you already have

> Nothing new in the mouth for this one. You met its sound on the very first *Gute Nacht*.

You'll want to know: acht

> **acht** — "eight." Said *akht*.

The **ch** is the raspy back-of-the-throat sound from *Nacht* and *machen*: a clean open *ah*, then the scrape. One syllable, no vowel after it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

acht is English **eight** — and the pairing is easier to believe once you notice that English still *writes* the missing sound.

Eight has a **gh** in it that nobody says. It is not decoration. English used to make a real throat scrape there, exactly the one German still makes, and the spelling is the fossil left behind after the sound fell out. So German **-cht-** answers English **-ght-**, and it does it every single time:

German	**English**
a**cht**	ei**ght**
Na**cht**	ni**ght**
Li**cht**	li**ght**
re**cht**	ri**ght**

Nacht and *night* you already own. The pattern is worth more than the number: whenever you see a German word with **cht**, try the English one with **ght**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "acht" — *akht*, open *ah* then the scrape
- "Nacht" then "acht" — the same ending twice
- the pairs — "acht/eight", "Nacht/night", "Licht/light"

Before you move on

What is "eight"? (*Acht.*) What does German **-cht-** answer in English? (**-ght-**.) Why does *eight* have a silent **gh**? (English used to say the same scrape German still says.) Give another pair. (*Nacht*/*night.*)

Chapter 9

Nine, Ten, and the Months That Are Numbers

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count all the way to ten in German, and say which words a language keeps and which it buys.
>
> *Nine and ten finish the count, and the chapter closes on the seam the whole sequence has been building toward: the numbers are homegrown and the month names are Latin imports, so one calendar carries both answers to the same question.*

9.1 neun — "nine," in the vowel of *Deutsch*

> Ninth number, and again nothing new to learn in the mouth — you got this vowel from the name of the language itself.

You'll want to know: neun

> **neun** — "nine." Said *noyn*.

The **eu** is the *oy* of English *boy*, which is exactly what it does in *Deutsch*. So *neun* rhymes with English *coin*, and it is one syllable with an *n* at each end.

Do not let the spelling talk you into *new-n*. German **eu** is never two separate vowels.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

neun is English **nine**, and the two have kept the same skeleton: *n*, a vowel, *n*. Only the vowel wandered — German to *oy*, English to *eye*. The Latin cousin is the odd one out here. *Novem* has a *v* where the Germanic words have nothing, which is why Spanish *nueve* and French *neuf* look like a different word. Between *neun* and *nine* there is nothing to explain.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "neun" — *noyn*, rhyming with *coin*
- "Deutsch" then "neun" — the same *eu*
- "sieben, acht, neun"

Before you move on

What is "nine"? (*Neun*, said *noyn*.) How is **eu** said? (Like the *oy* of *boy*, as in *Deutsch*.) What do *neun* and *nine* share? (*N*, a vowel, *n* — only the vowel moved.)

9.2 zehn — "ten," and one consonant in three photographs

The last one. And it is the number that shows both of German's sound laws working, one after the other, on the same letter.

You'll want to know: zehn

zehn — "ten." Said *tsayn*.

The **z** is the *ts* you met in *zwei*, and the **h** does what it did in *wohnen* and *gehen*: it says nothing and stretches the vowel in front of it. So: *ts*, a long *ay*, and an *n*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Latin *decem*, English **ten**, German **zehn**. One word, photographed at three moments of the same consonant walking:

Stage	Word	The sound
what Latin kept	*decem*	**d**
the first law	**ten**	**d** became **t**
the second law	*zehn*	**t** became **ts**

The first step is the law from the *drei* lesson, the one that separated Germanic from Latin. The second is the *later* shift you already know from *gut* and *machen* — the one that only German went through, which is why English stopped at *ten* and German carried on to *zehn*. So the distance between *ten* and *zehn* is not a different word. It is one extra step down a road English stopped walking.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "zehn" — *tsayn*, long vowel, silent *h*
- "decem, ten, zehn" — the same consonant, three times
- "acht, neun, zehn"

Before you move on

What is "ten"? (*Zehn*, said *tsayn*.) What does the **h** do? (Nothing — it lengthens the vowel.) Walk *decem* to *zehn*. (*D* became *t*, and German took the *t* on to *ts*.)

9.3 sechs bis zehn — finishing the count

Five more words learned one at a time. Same job as before: make them one run, then join the two runs together.

You'll want to know: the second run

sechs, sieben, acht, neun, zehn

Said straight through: *zeks, ZEE-ben, akht, noyn, tsayn.*

And the second five are the same story as the first — English twins, Latin only a cousin:

German	English	What changed
sechs	six	almost nothing; *chs* is *x*
sieben	seven	the *v* softened to a *b*
acht	eight	German still says the scrape English writes as **gh**
neun	nine	only the vowel moved
zehn	ten	an old **d** to **t**, then **t** to **ts**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "sechs, sieben, acht, neun, zehn" — straight through
- all ten from the start, in one breath if you can
- the ten backwards, from "zehn" down to "eins"

Twice through: "eins, zwei, drei, vier, fünf, sechs, sieben, acht, neun, zehn"

Before you move on

Count from six to ten. (*Sechs, sieben, acht, neun, zehn.*) Now all ten. Which of the ten is borrowed from Latin? (None — every one is the English number's twin.)

9.4 Homegrown numbers, imported months

You have ten numbers and not one of them came from Latin. That is worth holding onto, because the very next thing German counts with **did** come from Latin — and you can hear the join.

Grammar Lens: a language keeps some words and buys others

A language does not import evenly. The words people use every hour of every day are the hardest to displace, and the words that arrive with an institution come in whole.
Numbers are the first kind. German counts with its own inherited words, and so does English. Month names are the second kind: they arrived with the Roman calendar, and both languages took them whole.

Why it's said this way

The Roman year began in **March**. Count from there and the last four months of the year land on the Latin words for seven, eight, nine and ten — which is why those four month names are numbers wearing a disguise, in German exactly as in English.
Say each Latin number and then the German one that means the same thing:

The Latin number inside	German counts it
septem — seven	*sieben*
octo — eight	*acht*
novem — nine	*neun*
decem — ten	*zehn*

Not one pair sounds like a pair. The month names came from one language and the counting words from another, and German never reconciled them — because there was never any reason to.
You will meet the German month names themselves in a later chapter. What matters now is that when you get there, they will look Latin, and the numbers you have already learned will still be German.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "sieben, acht, neun, zehn" — the German four
- "septem, octo, novem, decem" — the Latin four
- which kind of word a language keeps, and which it buys

Before you move on

Did German borrow its numbers? (No — they are its own.) Did it borrow its month names? (Yes, from Latin, with the calendar.) Why do four of them carry the wrong number? (The Roman year began in March, so *septem* was the seventh month.)

9.5 Practice — counting, and asking for one

Ten numbers, one article, and one fact about which words a language keeps. Put them to work.

Grammar Lens: the ten, and what each one cost

German	Said	English twin
eins	*eyns*	one
zwei	*tsvy*	two
drei	*dry*	three
vier	*feer*	four
fünf	*fewnf*	five
sechs	*zeks*	six
sieben	*ZEE-ben*	seven
acht	*akht*	eight
neun	*noyn*	nine
zehn	*tsayn*	ten

Ten numbers and not one of them borrowed. Every one is the English word with a predictable coat on, which is the whole reason this chapter was cheap.

The exchange

German	English
Eins, zwei, drei …	One, two, three…
Und?	And?
… vier, fünf, sechs, sieben, acht, neun, zehn!	…four, five, six, seven, eight, nine, ten!
Sehr gut!	Very good!
Danke! — Bitte.	Thanks! — You're welcome.

Every word in that exchange is one you already own, and seven of them you learned this chapter.

Then the article, on the two nouns *guten Tag* and *gute Nacht* are built from:

der Tag → **ein Tag** · *die Nacht* → **eine Nacht**

Eins on its own keeps its **-s**, because nothing follows it. The moment a naming word arrives, the *-s* comes off.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- all ten, straight through
- the exchange, both voices
- "eins" as a count, then "ein" as an article — the *-s* comes off

Twice through: "eins, zwei, drei, vier, fünf, sechs, sieben, acht, neun, zehn"

Before you move on

Count to ten. When does *eins* become *ein*? (In front of a naming word.) Are the German numbers borrowed from Latin? (No — they are the English numbers' twins.) Which German words *were* borrowed from Latin? (The month names.)

Chapter 10

The Gods of the Week

Modes: **voice** (9) **Hands-free start:** all 9 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the five German weekdays, say which god is in each, and explain why one of them has no god at all.
>
> *The Romans named their weekdays for planet-gods and the Germanic peoples swapped in their own, one for one, which is why German and English line up here and Romance does not. Five days are a god's name plus Tag; this chapter meets them one at a time, with the nouns Mond and Donner taught before the days built on them, and ends on Mittwoch — the day the medieval Church took Wodan out of.*

10.1 Gott plus Tag

You have now seen a language keep its numbers and buy its months. The weekdays are the same question asked again, and German answers it a third way.

Grammar Lens: a god, then Tag

A German weekday is a **god's name** with ***Tag*** on the end.

Tag you already own. What sits in front of it is the part worth knowing: the Romans named their weekdays for planet-gods — Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus — and when those names reached the Germanic peoples, they did not translate them and they did not borrow them. They **swapped in their own gods**, one for one. That is why German and English line up here and Romance does not.

Both inherited the same substitutions, made once, long before either language was written down.
Five of the seven days keep that shape. Two do not, and both were edited later for reasons you can name — which is the more interesting half of the chapter.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the shape — "a god, then Tag"
- what the Romans used — "planet-gods"
- what Germanic did — "swapped in its own, one for one"

Twice through: "Gott plus Tag."

Before you move on

What shape does a German weekday have? (**A god's name plus *Tag***.) Whose gods did the Romans use? (**Their planet-gods**.) Did Germanic borrow those names or replace them? (**Replaced them**, one for one.) How many of the seven keep the shape? (**Five**.) Next: the first of them.

10.2 der Mond — "the moon"

Before the first weekday, the thing it is named after.

You'll want to know: der Mond

der Mond — "the moon."

A *der*-word, and the same inherited word as English **moon**. German rounded the vowel and added a *d* on the end; nothing else happened to it.

The moon was the first Germanic god-slot in the week, which is why it comes first here.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mond ← Old High German *māno* ← Proto-Germanic **mēnô*, "moon" — inherited, the same word as English *moon*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `long-o` — a long, round *o*, the vowel of English *moan*, not the *oo* of *moon*.
- `d-t-final` — the final *d* hardens to a *t* at the end of the word, the same hardening you met in *und*. So it comes out *mohnt*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Mond" — *mohnt*, with a hard ending
- the pair — "Mond, moon"
- the vowel warning — "not *moon*; *moan*"

Twice through: "der Mond."

Before you move on

Say "the moon." (**Der Mond**.) Which English word is it? (***Moon***.) How does the final *d* sound? (**Like a t**.) Next: the day named after it.

10.3 Montag — "Monday"

You have the moon and you have the day. Put them together before reading on.

You'll want to know: Montag

Montag — "Monday."

Mon- is *Mond* with its hard ending worn off inside the compound, and *-tag* is the day. The pattern's first instance, and the easiest: English says the same two words in the same order — *moon* and *day*.

That is what an **inherited** name looks like. Nobody translated this; both languages were already saying it before they were separate languages.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Montag ← Middle High German *mōntac* (EtymDB 2.1): *Mond* + *Tag*, "moon's day", built the same way as English *Monday*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Montag"
- its two pieces — "Mond, Tag"
- the English beside it — "Montag, Monday"

Twice through: "Montag — Monday."

Before you move on

Say "Monday." (**Montag**.) What are its two pieces? (***Mond* and *Tag***.) Is the English name a translation of it? (**No** — both inherited it.) Next: a day named for a god you have never heard of.

10.4 Dienstag — "Tuesday"

The second day, and the first god in the week whose name you will not recognise — though you say it every Tuesday.

You'll want to know: Dienstag

Dienstag — "Tuesday."

Diens- plus *-tag*, and the *ie* is the long *ee* you met in *vier*: *DEENS-tahk*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The god is **Tiw**, or **Ziu** in the older German — the Germanic war-god, put in where the Romans had **Mars**. English kept his name almost bare: **Tues**day is *Tiw's day*.

And his name is the oldest thing in this chapter. It comes from the Proto-Indo-European word for the **bright sky**, and the same word became Latin *deus* ("god"), Greek **Zeus**, and the *Ju-* of *Jupiter*. So the god in *Tuesday* and the god in *Jupiter* are the same ancient word, which the Germanic peoples had already demoted from sky-king to war-god long before the Romans arrived to be swapped out.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Dienstag" — *DEENS-tahk*
- the god — "Tiw, Ziu"
- the family — "Tiw, deus, Zeus"

Twice through: "Dienstag — Tuesday."

Before you move on

Say "Tuesday." (**Dienstag**.) Which god is in it? (**Tiw**, or *Ziu*.) Which Roman god did he replace? (**Mars**.) Which Greek god shares his name's root? (**Zeus**.) Next: the noun behind the loudest day of the week.

10.5 der Donner — "thunder"

Run the sound law backwards on this one before you read it. German has no *th*; what would English *thunder* look like in German?

You'll want to know: der Donner

der Donner — "thunder."

Th- becomes *d-*, exactly as it did in *drei*. Take the *th* off *thunder*, put a *d* there, and you have most of the German word already.

This is the second time that rule has paid, and it will keep paying: German *d* answers English *th* right across the vocabulary.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Donner ← Middle High German *doner* (EtymDB 2.1), from Proto-Germanic **þunraz*, "thunder" — inherited, the same word as English *thunder* and the god's name *Thor*.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-o` — short and open, the *o* of English *on*.
- `r-uvular-german` — the *-er* at the end is barely a consonant; it colours the vowel and stops. *DON-ah*, not *DON-err*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Donner"
- the rule that predicts it — "th becomes d: three, drei; thunder, Donner"
- the soft ending — "DON-ah"

Twice through: "der Donner — thunder."

Before you move on

Say "thunder." (**Der Donner**.) Which English sound does German *d* answer? (***Th***.) Name the other word you have that shows it. (***Drei*** / *three*.) Next: the day this noun names, and the god who is both.

10.6 Donnerstag — "Thursday"

You have the thunder and you have the pattern. This one you can build.

You'll want to know: Donnerstag

Donnerstag — "Thursday."

Donner plus *-s-* plus *Tag*. The little *s* in the middle is a joining sound German drops between the halves of a long compound; it carries no meaning of its own.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The thunder-god was **Donar** in the German-speaking south and **Thor** in the Norse north — one god, two names, and *Donner* is his name still doing duty as an ordinary weather word.
English named the day for the Norse form: **Thurs**day is *Thor's day*. He stood in for **Jupiter**, who was the Roman sky-and-thunder king. So this one slot has been filled three times over — Jupiter, Donar, Thor — and every version of it is the god who throws the lightning.
Say *Donnerstag* and *Thursday* back to back and the shift you already own does the rest: German *d* where English has *th*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Donnerstag"
- its pieces — "Donner, s, Tag"
- the three names for one god — "Donar, Thor, Jupiter"

Twice through: "Donnerstag — Thursday."

Before you move on

Say "Thursday." (**Donnerstag**.) Which god is in it? (**Donar** — **Thor** in the north.) Which Roman god did he replace? (**Jupiter**.) What is the *s* in the middle doing? (**Joining the two halves**; it means nothing.) Next: the last of the weekdays, and a goddess.

10.7 Freitag — "Friday"

The last weekday, and the *ei* rule you learned with *eins* is all you need for the sound.

You'll want to know: Freitag

Freitag — "Friday."

Ei is the English word *eye*, always — so the first syllable rhymes with *fry*, never with *free*. *FRY-tahk*.

That one rule has now told you how to say *eins*, *zwei*, *drei* and this. It does not have exceptions to remember.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The goddess is **Frija** — **Frigg** in the Norse — and she stood in for **Venus**. English named the day for her too: **Fri**day. *Freitag* ← Old High German *frīatag*, "Frija's day" (EtymDB 2.1).
This is the one day of the week named for a **goddess**, and it is a goddess in both systems. The Germanic swap did not merely fill the slot; it matched the god in it. Whoever made these substitutions was paying attention to who the Roman deity was, not only to which day was which.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Freitag" — *FRY-tahk*
- the goddess — "Frija, Frigg"
- who she replaced — "Venus"
- the four you own — "Montag, Dienstag, Donnerstag, Freitag"

Twice through: "Freitag — Friday."

Before you move on

Say "Friday." (**Freitag**.) How does *ei* sound? (**Like English *eye***.) Which goddess is in it? (**Frija**, or *Frigg*.) Which Roman goddess did she replace? (**Venus**.) Next: the day that broke the pattern.

10.8 Mittwoch — the day with no god

> Four days in and the shape has held every time. Here is the first one that breaks it, and you can hear the break before you know the reason: this word does not end in *Tag* at all.

You'll want to know: Mittwoch

Mittwoch — "Wednesday," and literally "**mid-week**."

No god, no *Tag*. *Mitt-* is the middle, *Woche* is the week, and the day is named for its position rather than for anybody.

English did **not** do this. *Wednesday* is **Woden's day** — the chief god, sitting exactly where the pattern says he should. So English kept the Germanic name and German threw it away, which is the opposite of what the rest of this chapter would lead you to expect.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mittwoch ← Middle High German *mittewoche* ← Old High German *mittawehha*, "middle of the week" (EtymDB 2.1) — built from "mid" and "week", the same pair as English *midweek*.

Sounds you'll need

- `ch-ach` — the ending is the raspy back-of-the-throat sound you first met in *Nacht*. Same sound, same spelling, and it closes this word too: *MIT-vokh*.

The *w* in the middle is a German *w*, so it is a *v*.

Why it's said this way

The medieval Church disliked naming a day of its week for the chief pagan god. So German dropped Wodan and put a plain description in his place, and the replacement stuck.

That is a decision you can date and attribute, sitting inside an everyday word. Most of the etymology in this book is drift — sounds wearing down over centuries with nobody deciding anything. This one is somebody choosing, and the choice is still in the language a thousand years later.

English, further from that authority, kept its god.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Mittwoch" — *MIT-vokh*, with the *Nacht* sound at the end
- what it means — "mid-week"
- the contrast — "Mittwoch, Wednesday: German dropped the god, English kept him"

Twice through: "Mittwoch — mid-week."

Before you move on

Say "Wednesday." (**Mittwoch**.) What does it literally mean? (**Mid-week**.) Does it end in *Tag*? (**No** — the only weekday that does not.) Which god does English keep there? (**Woden**.) Why did German drop him? (**The Church declined to name a day for the chief pagan god**.) Next: the five weekdays run together.

10.9 Practice — the working week

No new words. Five days, four gods, and one day where the god was taken out.

Grammar Lens: the five, assembled

German	who is in it
Montag	the moon
Dienstag	Tiw, the war-god
Mittwoch	nobody — "mid-week"
Donnerstag	Donar, the thunder-god
Freitag	Frija, the goddess

Four of the five carry a god and end in *Tag*. The one that does neither is the one the Church rewrote.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the five in order — "Montag, Dienstag, Mittwoch, Donnerstag, Freitag"
- them against the English — "Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday, Friday"
- the gods — "the moon, Tiw, nobody, Donar, Frija"
- the two nouns you own underneath — "der Mond, der Donner"

Twice through: "Montag, Dienstag, Mittwoch, Donnerstag, Freitag."

Before you move on

Run the five without prompting. Which one has no god in it? (***Mittwoch***.) Which has a goddess? (***Freitag*** — Frija.) Which two are built on nouns you can say on their own? (***Montag* from** *Mond*, ***Donnerstag* from** *Donner*.) Next: the weekend, where the pattern breaks a second time.

Chapter 11

The German Weekend

Modes: **voice** (6) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 6 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name both German words for Saturday and the word for Sunday, and say which of them German inherited and which it bought.
>
> *The weekend is where the weekday pattern breaks a second time. Samstag is not Saturn's day but the Sabbath — Hebrew shabbāt by way of Greek — while Sonntag is the sun's, a day the Church renamed in Romance and left alone here. It closes on Sonnabend, the northern Saturday, which is transparent the moment Sonne and Abend are both owned.*

11.1 die Sonne — "the sun"

You have *der Mond*. Its opposite number comes with a surprise attached, and the surprise is the article.

You'll want to know: die Sonne

die Sonne — "the sun."

Same word as English **sun**, with the German ending. But notice the pair you now own: ***der*** *Mond* and ***die*** *Sonne*. The moon is masculine and the sun is feminine.

Why it's said this way

That is the **reverse** of what the Romance languages do, where the sun is masculine and the moon feminine — French *le soleil* and *la lune*, Spanish *el sol* and *la luna*.
Neither is a statement about the sun. Grammatical gender is a filing system, not a description, and the two families filed the same two objects in opposite drawers. It is worth meeting early, because it is the clearest possible proof that a German noun's gender is not something you can reason out from the thing itself.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "die Sonne"
- the pair with their articles — "der Mond, die Sonne"
- the other way round — "le soleil, la lune"

Twice through: "der Mond, die Sonne."

Before you move on

Say "the sun." (**Die Sonne**.) Which article does the moon take? (***Der***.) Which way round is French? (**The opposite** — *le soleil*, *la lune*.) Can you work a German noun's gender out from the thing? (**No**.) Next: the day named for it.

11.2 Sonntag — "Sunday"

The pattern again, on the noun from a moment ago.

You'll want to know: Sonntag

Sonntag — "Sunday."

Sonne plus *Tag*, with the *e* dropped in the compound. English says the same two words: *sun* and *day*.

Why it's said this way

Mittwoch showed the Church taking a god out of the week. This day shows where it did **not**.
Romance renamed Sunday completely, for the **Lord**: Spanish *domingo*, French *dimanche*, both from Latin *dies dominicus*. The sun was pushed out entirely. German and English kept the sun.
So the same institution rewrote one German day and left another alone, and the week records both decisions side by side. *Mittwoch* is where it intervened; *Sonntag* is where it did not.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Sonntag"
- its pieces — "Sonne, Tag"
- what Romance did instead — "domingo, dimanche"
- the two decisions — "Mittwoch rewritten, Sonntag left alone"

Twice through: "Sonntag — Sunday."

Before you move on

Say "Sunday." (**Sonntag**.) What are its two pieces? (***Sonne* and *Tag***.) What did Spanish name the day for instead? (**The Lord** — *domingo*.) Which German day did the Church rewrite? (***Mittwoch***.) Next: a word that is not German at all.

11.3 der Sabbat — "the Sabbath"

Every word in this week so far has been Germanic. Here is the one that is not — and it did not come from Latin either.

You'll want to know: der Sabbat

der Sabbat — "the Sabbath," the day of rest.

Hebrew *shabbāt* means "to rest." Greek-speaking Christians took it as *sábbaton* and carried it north, and German has it as *Sabbat*.

Hold the word on its own for a moment before the next lesson does anything with it. Its road is the point: **Hebrew to Greek to German**, with no Germanic ancestor and no Latin one either. It is the only word in the German week that came from outside Europe.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Sabbat"
- the road — "shabbāt, sábbaton, Sabbat"
- what it means — "rest"

Twice through: "der Sabbat — the Sabbath."

Before you move on

Say "the Sabbath." (**Der Sabbat**.) What does the Hebrew root mean? (**To rest**.) Which language carried it north? (**Greek**.) Is it Germanic or Latin? (**Neither**.) Next: the day it became.

11.4 Samstag — the day that is not Saturn's

The second break in the pattern, and a bigger one than *Mittwoch*. That day lost its god. This one was never Germanic at all.

You'll want to know: Samstag

Samstag — "Saturday."

It ends in *Tag*, so the shape looks intact. What sits in front of it is not a god: it is *Sabbat*, worn down. **Sam(s)- + Tag** — "the Sabbath day."

English kept the Roman planet here. *Saturday* is **Saturn's day**, the one Roman name the Germanic swap never replaced. German did replace it, but not with a god of its own.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The road this word travelled is longer than any other in the chapter: Hebrew *shabbāt*, "to rest," became Greek *sábbaton*, and Greek-speaking Christians carried it north into German as *Sabbat*. From there it wore down to the *Sams-* you say now.
So **German *Samstag* and Spanish *sábado* are the same word** — both are the Sabbath. And English, which usually stands beside German in this chapter, is the odd one out: it alone still points at a Roman planet.

Why it's said this way

This is the distinction you were given with the months, arriving again on a different word.
The weekday names are the first kind of word: everyday, inherited, hard to displace — which is why six of them are still Germanic after fifteen hundred years. *Samstag* is the second kind. It came with an institution, and it came in whole, exactly as the month names did.
So one week contains both answers to the same question. Six days a language kept, and one it bought.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Samstag"
- the road — "shabbāt, sábbaton, Sabbat, Samstag"
- the pair — "Samstag, sábado: the same Sabbath"
- the odd one — "Saturday still points at Saturn"

Twice through: "Samstag — the Sabbath, not Saturn."

Before you move on

Say "Saturday." (**Samstag**.) Is it Saturn's day? (**No** — the Sabbath's.) Which language did it reach German through? (**Greek**, from Hebrew.) Which Spanish day is the same word? (***Sábado***.) Which kind of word is it — kept or bought? (**Bought**, like the

month names.) Next: the day the Church left alone.

11.5 Sonnabend — Saturday, in the north

One more Saturday. This one you can read before you are told what it means, because both halves are already yours.

You'll want to know: Sonnabend

Sonnabend — "Saturday," in northern Germany.

Sonn- is the sun and *-abend* is the evening, both of which you own. It is "**Sun-eve**": the evening before Sunday, standing in for the whole day.

That is the same reckoning English keeps in *Christmas Eve* and *New Year's Eve* — the day taking its name from the night that runs up to it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Sonnabend ← Middle High German *sunābent* (EtymDB 2.1): *Sonne* + *Abend*, the eve of Sunday.

Why it's said this way

Both words are correct German and a speaker will use one or the other by where they are from: **Sonnabend** in the north, **Samstag** in the south and west, with *Samstag* the more widely used of the two.
So Saturday has two names in German and neither is a mistake — which is worth knowing before you hear the one you did not learn and assume you misheard it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Sonnabend"
- its two halves — "Sonne, Abend"
- both Saturdays — "Samstag, Sonnabend"

Twice through: "Sonnabend — Sun-eve."

Before you move on

Say the northern word for Saturday. (**Sonnabend**.) What are its two halves? (***Sonne* and *Abend***.) What does it literally mean? (**Sun-eve**.) Which word is used more widely? (***Samstag***.) Next: the whole week, said through.

11.6 Practice — all seven

No new words. Seven days, five gods, and two places where something else got in.

Grammar Lens: the whole week

German	what is in it
Montag	the moon
Dienstag	Tiw
Mittwoch	mid-week — the Church took the god out
Donnerstag	Donar
Freitag	Frija
Samstag	the Sabbath — bought, not inherited
Sonntag	the sun

Five gods, one edit, one import. Run them in order until the list is one motion rather than seven remembered words.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- all seven in order, from *Montag* to *Sonntag*
- the two Saturdays — "Samstag, Sonnabend"
- the two breaks — "Mittwoch: no god. Samstag: not Germanic."
- the shape that holds for the other five — "a god, then Tag"

Twice through: "Montag, Dienstag, Mittwoch, Donnerstag, Freitag, Samstag, Sonntag."

Before you move on

Run all seven without prompting. Which day has no god? (***Mittwoch***.) Which is not a Germanic word at all? (***Samstag*** — the Sabbath.) Which day did the Church rename in Romance but leave alone here? (***Sonntag***.) Which day has two names? (**Saturday** — *Samstag* and *Sonnabend*.)

11.7 spät — one short word with two spelling rules inside it

Say **spät**. Listen to how it starts — the *sp* is not the *sp* of English *spade*. Say what your mouth does instead.

Your turn: the end of a day, in four moves

The week is in your mouth now. These four are what you say when one of its days is running out.

Say these aloud:

- it is late — *es ist spät*
- later, not now — *später*
- until tomorrow — *bis morgen*
- the last thing, at the door — *Gute Nacht*

Gute Nacht is not the night-time *Guten Abend*. It is spoken on parting, not on arriving — you say it to someone who is leaving or going to bed, and saying it on entering a room at ten at night is the kind of mistake that gets you a puzzled look rather than a correction.

Grammar Lens: two marks, two different jobs

Both marks are in words you have been saying for weeks, and they do opposite kinds of work:

mark	what it is	what it tells you
ä in *spät*	two dots that were once an **e**	**grammar** — a changed vowel, marking a form
ß in *heiße*	two s's written as one letter	**sound** — the vowel in front of it is **long**

The umlaut is a *grammatical* signal: it marks that something has happened to the word. The eszett is a *phonetic* one: it tells you how long to hold the vowel before it. One points backwards at the word's history, the other forwards at your mouth.
That is why **spät** → **später** changes nothing about the ä. The comparative is built by adding **-er**, and the vowel was already what it was.

Before you move on

Which of the two marks tells you about a **sound**, and which about **grammar**? (**ß** is sound — a long vowel before it; **umlaut** is grammar.) What were the two dots, originally? (**An e.**) Say goodbye to someone you will see the next day. (*Bis morgen.*)

Chapter 12

Telling the Time

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (10) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 10 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for and tell the time in German.
>
> *The chapter's thesis is a division of labour. Uhr came from Latin hora with the clocks that needed it, and German already had Stunde for the span, so the loan took the clock-reading job and the native word kept the other. Mittag and Mitternacht are German's own compounds, Mitte with Tag and Nacht, the same thought French assembled out of Latin as midi. It closes on the two frames together: a number with Uhr, or a pivot standing alone.*

12.1 die Uhr — "the clock"

> Something changes here. The numbers were German's own and the weekdays were German's gods — this word is neither.

You'll want to know: die Uhr

> **die Uhr** — "the clock," and also "o'clock."

A *die*-word, and one syllable. It does two jobs: the object on the wall, and the word you say when telling the time.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Uhr ← Latin *hōra*, "hour" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, not inherited; it reached German through Old French and Middle Dutch with the

clocks themselves.

Sounds you'll need

- `u-long` — a long *u*, the vowel of English *moor*.
- `r-final` — and then a soft *r* that barely closes: German's final *r* colours the vowel and stops rather than rolling.

Together: *oor*. One syllable, nothing more.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "die Uhr" — *oor*, long and soft
- its two jobs — "the clock; o'clock"
- it beside a word you own — "der Tag, die Uhr"

Twice through: "die Uhr."

Before you move on

Say "the clock." (**Die Uhr**.) Which article? (***Die***.) How many syllables? (**One** — *oor*.) What else does the word mean? (**O'clock**.) Next: where it came from, which is not where the rest of this book's words come from.

12.2 Uhr, taken apart

You have twice met a language keeping some words and buying others. Here is the third time, and it completes a picture.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Uhr comes from Latin ***hōra***, "hour" — the same word that became French *heure*, Italian *ora* and English **hour**. It reached German through medieval Latin and Low German *ūr(e)*.
Timekeeping arrived with Roman and monastic clocks, and the word rode in with the machinery.

Why it's said this way

Three layers of the German day, three different origins:

what	**German**	**where it came from**
the numbers	*eins, zwei, drei*	native Germanic
the weekdays	*Montag, Donnerstag*	Germanic gods
the clock	*Uhr*	Latin, from *hōra*

German kept its own counting and its own gods. For the **machine that measures hours** it reached for Rome.
That is the same rule you were given with the months and again with *Samstag*: the words used every hour of every day are the hardest to displace, and the words that arrive with an institution come in whole. A clock is an institution arriving.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the family — "Uhr, hōra, heure, ora, hour"
- the three layers — "numbers native, weekdays gods, clock Latin"
- the reason — "the clock came in, and its word came with it"

Twice through: "Uhr — from hōra."

Before you move on

Which Latin word is *Uhr*? (***Hōra.***) Which English word is its cousin? (***Hour.***) Which two layers of the German day are **not** borrowed? (**The numbers and the weekdays**.) Why did this one come in? (**It arrived with the clocks**.) Next: the German word that was there already.

12.3 die Stunde — "an hour"

A borrowed word usually arrives because a language needs one. This time German already had a perfectly good word, and took the Latin one anyway.

You'll want to know: die Stunde

> **die Stunde** — "an hour," in the sense of a **span of sixty minutes**.

Native Germanic, and older in the language than *Uhr*. It is the word for a duration: a lesson lasts *eine Stunde*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Stunde ← Old High German *stunta* ← Proto-Germanic **stundō*, "point in time" — inherited; old English *stound*, "a while", is the same word. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `st-initial-scht` — a German *st-* at the start of a word is *sht-*, not *st-*. So this opens *SHTOON-*, which is the single most useful spelling rule in German after *ei* and *ie*.
- `u-long` — the same long *u* you met in *Uhr*.

Why it's said this way

The loan did **not** push the native word out. The two divided the work instead:

for	German uses
reading a clock — "o'clock"	*Uhr*
a length of time — "an hour"	*Stunde*

English has the same split and hides it: *hour* covers both, and *o'clock* is a worn-down phrase (*of the clock*) doing the first job.
This is worth holding on to, because it is what borrowing usually looks like. The loan rarely kills the native word; it takes a slice of the meaning and the two settle into different rooms.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "die Stunde" — *SHTOON-duh*
- the pair and their jobs — "Uhr for the clock, Stunde for the span"

- the spelling rule — "st- at the front is sht-"

Twice through: "die Uhr, die Stunde."

Before you move on

Say "an hour," meaning a span. (**Eine Stunde**.) Which word do you use to read a clock? (***Uhr***.) Which of the two is native German? (***Stunde***.) How is *st-* pronounced at the start of a word? (***Sht-***.) Next: putting *Uhr* into a sentence.

12.4 Es ist zwei Uhr — telling the time

You have the numbers and you have the word. The frame that joins them needs nothing new.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Es ist zwei Uhr — *es*, *ist* and *zwei* are inherited; *Uhr* is borrowed from Latin *hōra*, "hour". (EtymDB 2.1)

Grammar Lens: es ist, a number, Uhr

es ist + the number + **Uhr**

*Es ist **ein** Uhr.* — "It is one o'clock." *Es ist **zwei** Uhr.* — "It is two o'clock." *Es ist **zehn** Uhr.* — "It is ten o'clock."

Word for word that is the English sentence with *o'clock* moved: *it is two o'clock*. Nothing about the order has to be relearned.
One thing to notice: at one o'clock it is ***ein*** Uhr, not *eins* — the counting form drops its *-s* here exactly as it does before a noun, which you met with *ein* and *eine*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the frame — "es ist … Uhr"
- "Es ist zwei Uhr." "Es ist zehn Uhr."

- the odd one — "Es ist ein Uhr", not *eins*
- the hour it is now, wherever you are

Twice through: "Es ist zwei Uhr."

Before you move on

Say "it is ten o'clock." (**Es ist zehn Uhr**.) What are the three pieces? (***Es ist***, **the number**, ***Uhr***.) What happens to *eins* at one o'clock? (**It drops the *-s***: *ein Uhr*.) Next: the plural German does not use here.

12.5 zwei Uhr, not zwei Uhren

Every German noun you have met takes a plural. This one refuses — but only in one of its two jobs.

Grammar Lens: the clock-reading Uhr does not count

Telling the time, *Uhr* stays **singular** however many hours you name.

Zwei Uhr is "two o'clock." Not *zwei Uhren* — that would be **two clocks**, the objects on the wall.

German	English
zwei Uhr	two o'clock
zwei Uhren	two clocks

English does the identical thing and hides it behind an apostrophe. You would never say "two o'clocks" either, because *o'clock* is not a noun being counted — it is a fossilised phrase, *of the clock*. German's *Uhr* is doing that job with no apostrophe to warn you.
So what you are watching is not really about *Uhr*. It is about a word that has stopped being a countable thing and become a **unit of time**, a job nouns take on in every language and mark differently in each.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the time — "zwei Uhr"

- the objects — "zwei Uhren"
- the English that hides it — "two o'clock, two clocks"

Twice through: "zwei Uhr; zwei Uhren."

Before you move on

Say "two o'clock." (**Zwei Uhr**.) Say "two clocks." (**Zwei Uhren**.) Which of the two is the plural? (***Uhren***.) Why does the time not take one? (**It is a unit of time, not a thing being counted**.) Next: the two pivots of the day, and they are German's own.

12.6 die Mitte — "the middle"

The clock-word was Latin. The two pivots of the German day swing straight back to German's own vocabulary, and they share a piece.

You'll want to know: die Mitte

die Mitte — "the middle."

Two syllables, short *i*, and a crisp doubled *t*: *MIT-tuh*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mitte is English **mid** and **middle** — the same inherited word, and you can hear it without being told.
Its Latin cousin is *medius*, "middle," which English borrowed several times over: **medium**, **median**, **mediocre** (literally "middling"), and the *medi-* of *Mediterranean*, the sea in the middle of the land.
So the everyday Germanic word and the learned Latin one sit side by side in English, and German has the first of them. That is the pattern you have been watching all book: two doors into one root, one worn smooth by daily use and one carried in by scholars.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "die Mitte" — *MIT-tuh*

- the Germanic side — "Mitte, mid, middle"
- the Latin side — "medius, medium, median"

Twice through: "die Mitte — the middle."

Before you move on

Say "the middle." (**Die Mitte**.) Which two English words is it? (***Mid* and *middle***.) Which Latin word is its cousin? (***Medius***.) Name an English word from that side. (***Medium***, ***median*** or ***mediocre***.) Next: the middle of the day.

12.7 der Mittag — "noon"

You have the middle and you have the day. Put them together before reading on — you will be right.

You'll want to know: der Mittag

der Mittag — "noon," and literally "**mid-day**."

Mitt- from *Mitte*, *-tag* from *Tag*. Nothing is hidden and nothing had to be learned: this is the third compound in two chapters you could read on sight, after *Montag* and *Sonnabend*.

English has the identical compound — **midday** — built from the identical two inherited words. Neither language got it from the other; each still had the pieces and used them.

To say it is noon: *Es ist Mittag.* No number and no *Uhr*, because noon is not an hour you count to.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mittag is *Mitte* + *Tag*, "mid-day"; EtymDB 2.1 lists it as the same word as English *midday*, Old English *middæġ*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Mittag"

- its two pieces — “Mitte, Tag”
- the English twin — “Mittag, midday”
- “Es ist Mittag.”

Twice through: “der Mittag — midday.”

Before you move on

Say “noon.” (**Der Mittag**.) What are its two pieces? (***Mitte* and *Tag***.) Say “it is noon.” (**Es ist Mittag**.) Does it need a number? (**No**.) Next: what French does with the same idea, and why German did not.

12.8 Mittag and midi

French says *midi* for noon, and it means exactly what *Mittag* means. That is not a borrowing in either direction.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

French *midi* comes from Latin ***medius diēs*** — “middle day.” German *Mittag* is *Mitte* plus *Tag* — “middle day.”
The **same thought**, assembled **twice**, out of different material:

language	built from	result
Latin, then French	*medius* + *diēs*	*midi*
German	*Mitte* + *Tag*	*Mittag*

Both families looked at the sun overhead and named the moment for the middle of the day. Neither copied the other; the idea is obvious enough that two languages reached it independently, and each used the words it had.

Why it’s said this way

This is the counterweight to *Uhr*, and the two are worth holding together.
For the **clock** — a machine that arrived from outside — German took the foreign word whole. For **noon** — something anyone with a sky already has — German built its own out of pieces it owned.
A language borrows what arrives and builds what was always there.

One chapter, both halves of that.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — "Mittag, midi"
- what each is made of — "Mitte plus Tag; medius plus diēs"
- the chapter in one line — "borrow the clock, build the noon"

Twice through: "Mittag, midi — the same thought, built twice."

Before you move on

What is French *midi* made of? (***Medius* + *diēs***, "middle day".) And *Mittag*? (***Mitte* + *Tag***.) Did German borrow it? (**No** — it built its own.) Which word in this chapter **was** borrowed? (***Uhr***.) Next: the other pivot.

12.9 die Mitternacht — "midnight"

The day's other pivot, and the second compound in this chapter you can assemble from words you already have.

You'll want to know: die Mitternacht

die Mitternacht — "midnight," literally "**mid-night**."

Mitter- is *Mitte* with the linking form it takes inside a compound, and *-nacht* is the night. English **midnight** is the same two words again.

To say it: *Es ist Mitternacht.* Like *Mittag*, no number and no *Uhr*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mitternacht is "mid" + *Nacht*, from Old High German *mittinaht*; EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *midnight*.

Sounds you'll need

- `ch-ach` — the raspy back-of-the-throat sound from *Nacht* itself, unchanged inside the longer word.

And that *-cht* is the correspondence you were given with the numbers: German *-cht-* answers English *-ght-* every time.

German	**English**
acht	eight
Nacht	night
Licht	light

You met the first pair counting to ten. Here it is again on a word you now need, which is what a sound correspondence is for — you learn it once and it keeps paying.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "die Mitternacht"
- its pieces — "Mitte, Nacht"
- the correspondence — "acht/eight, Nacht/night, Licht/light"
- "Es ist Mitternacht."

Twice through: "Mittag, Mitternacht."

Before you move on

Say "midnight." (**Die Mitternacht**.) What are its pieces? (***Mitte* and *Nacht***.) What does German *-cht-* answer in English? (***-ght-***.) Give the pair you met with the numbers. (***Acht* / *eight***.) Next: the whole chapter, said through.

12.10 Practice — the clock and the two pivots

No new words. One borrowed word and two built ones, and the difference between them is the chapter. Start by saying the

borrowed one, one long syllable — *Uhr* — and then the piece both pivots begin with, *Mitte*.

Grammar Lens: three ways to say when

when	German
one o'clock	*Es ist ein Uhr.*
ten o'clock	*Es ist zehn Uhr.*
noon	*Es ist Mittag.*
midnight	*Es ist Mitternacht.*

One frame, *es ist*, and then either a number with *Uhr* or a pivot on its own. The pivots take no number because they are not hours you count to.

Why it's said this way

Hold the two halves of the chapter side by side:

- ***Uhr*** came from Latin *hōra*, with the clocks. German had *Stunde* already, so the loan took the clock-reading job and the native word kept the span.
- ***Mittag*** and ***Mitternacht*** are German's own, built from *Mitte* with *Tag* and *Nacht* — the same thought French assembled out of Latin as *midi*.

A language borrows what arrives and builds what was always there. The sky was always there; the clock was delivered.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the four sentences above, in order
- the two hour-words and their jobs — "Uhr for the clock, Stunde for the span"
- the counted and the uncounted — "zwei Uhr; Mittag"
- the chapter in one line — "borrow the clock, build the noon"

Twice through: "Es ist zwei Uhr. Es ist Mittag. Es ist Mitternacht."

Before you move on

Say “it is two o’clock.” (**Es ist zwei Uhr**.) Say “it is midnight.” (**Es ist Mitternacht**.) Which word here is Latin? (***Uhr***, from *hōra*.) Which two did German build itself? (***Mittag* and *Mitternacht***.) Why does *zwei Uhr* have no plural? (**It is a unit of time, not a thing being counted**.)

Chapter 13

The Roman Calendar

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (9) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 9 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the first six German months and say why every one of the twelve came from Latin.
>
> *The unit is German's own – der Monat IS der Mond, one turn of it, exactly as English month is moon. The twelve names inside it are Latin, taken whole with the calendar that ordered them. The chapter walks the first six and stops on the one that arrived twice: Maerz is Mars by name, and Dienstag is the same god by translation, because German already had a week to map onto and no twelve-month calendar at all.*

13.1 der Monat — "the month"

> Twelve names are coming, and every one of them is Latin. The word that holds them is not.

You'll want to know: der Monat

> **der Monat** — "the month."

Say *Mond* and then *Monat* and you have heard the whole etymology. They are the same word: a month is a **moon**, one turn of it. English does this too — *moon* and *month* — and neither language got the idea from the other, because both inherited it.

The plural is *die Monate*, "the months," and it is the form the chapter title uses.

Why it's said this way

Here is the shape of the next two chapters, in one sentence.
The **unit** is German's own, inherited, older than any calendar: a moon. The **names** for the twelve are borrowed whole from Rome, along with the calendar that ordered them.
You met that division in the numbers chapter, where the counting words stayed home and the month names came in. This is where you meet the month names.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — "der Mond, der Monat"
- the English pair — "moon, month"
- singular and plural — "der Monat, die Monate"

Twice through: "der Mond, der Monat."

Before you move on

Say "the month." (**Der Monat**.) What German word is hiding in it? (***Mond***, the moon.) Is *Monat* borrowed? (**No** — it is inherited.) And the twelve names about to arrive? (**Latin**, all of them.) Next: the first one.

13.2 der Januar — "January"

The first of the twelve borrowed names, and it is a doorway.

You'll want to know: der Januar

der Januar — "January."

Latin *Januarius*, the month of **Janus** — the Roman god of doors, gateways and beginnings, shown with two faces because a doorway looks both ways at once.

A first month is exactly that: the year behind you and the year ahead, seen from the same spot.

Sounds you'll need

- `j-as-y` — German *j* is English *y*. *Januar* begins **ya-**, not **ja-**.
- `vowel-a-long` — and the *a* that follows is long and open.

YA-nu-ar, with the weight on the first syllable.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Januar" — YA-nu-ar
- the god in it — "Janus"
- what a first month is — "a door that looks both ways"

Twice through: "der Januar."

Before you move on

Say "January." (**Der Januar**.) How does the *j* sound? (**Like an English** *y*.) Which god? (**Janus**, of doorways.) Why two faces? (**A doorway looks both ways**.) Next: a month named for a washing.

13.3 der Februar — "February"

The second month, and the odd one out among the twelve.

You'll want to know: der Februar

der Februar — "February."

Latin *Februarius*, from the ***Februa*** — a purification festival the Romans held at that point in the year, a washing-clean before the new season.

Every other month you will meet is named for a **god**, an **emperor**, or a **number**. This one is named for something people *did*.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-e-german` — the *e* of *Fe-* is a clear short *e*, not the English *feb*'s flat vowel.
- `r-final` — and the ending is the same soft closing *r* you met on *Uhr*.

FAY-bru-ar, four beats, weight on the first.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Februar" — FAY-bru-ar
- the first two in order — "Januar, Februar"
- what it is named for — "a washing-clean"

Twice through: "Januar, Februar."

Before you move on

Say "February." (**Der Februar**.) Is it named for a god? (**No** — for a **festival**, the *Februa*.) Say the first two months together. (**Januar, Februar**.) Next: a god you have already met, arriving a second time.

13.4 der März — "March"

You already know something about this month from the numbers chapter, though not its name.

You'll want to know: der März

der März — "March."

Latin *Martius*, the month of **Mars**, the war-god. Campaigning weather began here, and so did the Roman year.

That second fact is the one you have already been given: the Roman year opened here. Four of the twelve names still count from this month, and you will meet them in the next chapter.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-ae` — *ä* is a bright open *e*, close to English *bed*. Not the *ar* of English *March*.
- `tz-affricate` — and *-rz* ends on a **ts**, so the word closes *merts*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der März" — merts
- the god — "Mars"
- three in order — "Januar, Februar, März"

Twice through: "der März."

Before you move on

Say "March." (**Der März**.) How does *-rz* end? (**On a** *ts*.) Which god? (**Mars**.) Where did the Roman year begin? (**Here, in March**.) Next: the same god, under a name you already own.

13.5 März and Dienstag

Two German words you now own. They come from the same god, and neither of them looks like the other.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mars entered German **twice**, and by two different routes.

the route	what German got	result
his **name**, borrowed whole	Latin *Martius*	*März*
his **job**, given to Tiw	Germanic *Tiwaz*	*Dienstag*

When the Romans met the Germanic gods, they matched them up by what they did: the war-god here answers the war-god there. Tuesday was Mars's day, so it became Tiw's day, and it still is — in German *Dienstag*, in English **Tuesday**.

The month got no such treatment. Nobody translated *Martius*; German took it as it stood.

Why it's said this way

The difference is worth holding onto, because it is the whole chapter in one example.
The **week** was a thing Germanic speakers already had, so when the Roman scheme arrived they mapped it onto their own gods and kept their own words. The **calendar of twelve months** was not; it came in as an administrative object, name-plates and all, and German took the name-plates.
Same god, same century, two outcomes — decided by whether German already had something to put in the slot.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — "März, Dienstag"
- what each did with the god — "took his name; took his job"
- the reason — "German had a week already; it had no twelve months"

Twice through: "März and Dienstag — one god, two doors."

Before you move on

Which two German words carry Mars? (***März* and *Dienstag***.) Which took his name? (***März***.) Which took his job? (***Dienstag***, through **Tiw**.) Why did the week get translated and the calendar not? (**German already had a week**.) Next: a month that may be named for an opening.

13.6 der April — "April"

Three months in and every name has had an owner. This one does not.

You'll want to know: der April

der April — "April."

Latin *Aprilis*. Where that came from is genuinely unsettled — the Romans of the classical period were already guessing. The oldest and best guess is *aperire*, "to open," for the month when things do.

Say it aloud and notice where the weight sits: German puts it on the **second** syllable, *a-PRIL*, where English puts it on the first.

Sounds you'll need

- `r-uvular` — the *r* in *-pril* is made at the back of the throat, closer to a soft scrape than an English roll.
- `i-short` — and the *i* is short and bright: *pril*, not *preel*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der April" — a-PRIL, weight at the back
- the guess — "aperire, to open"
- four in order — "Januar, Februar, März, April"

Twice through: "der April."

Before you move on

Say "April." (**Der April**.) Which syllable carries the weight? (**The second** — a-PRIL.) Who is it named for? (**Nobody knows** — perhaps *aperire*, "to open".) Next: a goddess of growing things.

13.7 der Mai — "May"

One syllable, and its vowel is one you were given for a number.

You'll want to know: der Mai

der Mai — "May."

Latin *Maius*, the month of **Maia** — a goddess of growth and increase, which is a reasonable thing to call the month when everything is putting on size.

Sounds you'll need

- `ai-as-eye` — *ai* is the vowel of English **eye**.

You already have that vowel under its commoner German spelling, *ei*, from the numbers. German writes the same sound two ways, and *Mai* is the rarer one: *ei* and *ai* both say **eye**.
So *Mai* rhymes with English *my*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Mai" — rhymes with "my"
- the goddess — "Maia, of growing things"
- five in order — "Januar, Februar, März, April, Mai"

Twice through: "der Mai."

Before you move on

Say "May." (**Der Mai**.) What does *ai* sound like? (**English** *eye*.) Which other spelling gives that sound? (***Ei***.) Which goddess? (**Maia**.) Next: the queen of the gods.

13.8 der Juni — "June"

Its first letter behaves exactly as the first month's did.

You'll want to know: der Juni

der Juni — "June."

Latin *Junius*, the month of **Juno** — Jupiter's queen, and the goddess Romans married under, which is why June weddings are a Roman habit that never stopped.

Sounds you'll need

- `j-as-y` — the same *j* as *Januar*: English *y*. *YOO-ni*, never *joon*.
- `ie-long-ee` — and the final *i* is a long *ee*.

Spoken German often lengthens this one to *Juno* when a date has to be clear over the phone, because the month after it sounds far too close. That is a real habit, not something you have to learn now.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Juni" — YOO-nee
- the goddess — "Juno"
- six in order — "Januar, Februar, März, April, Mai, Juni"

Twice through: "der Juni."

Before you move on

Say "June." (**Der Juni**.) How does the *j* sound? (**Like English** *y*.) Which other month opens the same way? (***Januar***.) Which goddess? (**Juno**.) Next: all six, said through.

13.9 Practice — half a Roman year

No new words. Six names and the container they sit in.

Grammar Lens: what German owns and what it bought

what	German	where from
the **unit**	*der Monat*	inherited — it is *der Mond*
the **names**	*Januar … Juni*	Latin, taken whole

One line, and it is the chapter. German had a moon and needed no help naming the span. It had no twelve-month calendar, so when one arrived it took the labels that came with it.

Why it's said this way

Notice what the six names are *for*, because they are not one kind of thing:

Januar — *a god,* ***Janus*** *of doorways.* ***Februar*** — not a god at all, but a **festival**, the *Februa.* **März** — *a god,* ***Mars****, who is also in* Dienstag *under another name.* ***April*** — unknown, and unknown already in Rome. **Mai** — *a goddess,* ***Maia*** *of growth.* ***Juni*** — a goddess, **Juno**, queen of the gods.

Four deities, one ritual, one shrug. A calendar is not a designed object; it is a pile of things people happened to call months, kept because nobody stopped.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- all six in order — "Januar, Februar, März, April, Mai, Juni"
- the two that begin with an English y — "Januar, Juni"
- the one that ends on a ts — "März"
- the unit and its cousin — "der Monat, der Mond"

Twice through: "Januar, Februar, März, April, Mai, Juni."

Before you move on

Say the first six months. (**Januar, Februar, März, April, Mai, Juni**.) Which word for the span is German's own? (***Der Monat***, from *Mond*.) Which month shares a god with *Dienstag*? (***März***.)

Which one is named for a festival? (***Februar***.) Which one nobody can explain? (***April***.)

Chapter 14

When the Calendar Stopped Naming

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the last six German months and say which of them are numbers rather than names.
>
> *Two months named for men who could order it – Julius Caesar, who rebuilt the calendar, and Augustus, who took the next one – and then the naming stops. September through Dezember are septem, octo, novem and decem, counted from Maerz where the Roman year began. German's own seven, eight, nine and ten sound like none of them, and never had to.*

14.1 der Juli — "July"

> Six months named for gods, festivals and guesses. From here the calendar changes what it is doing.

You'll want to know: der Juli

> **der Juli** — "July."

Latin *Julius*, and not a god: **Julius Caesar**. He rebuilt the Roman calendar into something that tracked the sun, and the month of his birth was renamed for him while he was alive to see it.

Juni and *Juli* differ by one letter and one sound. Take them slowly as a pair: *YOO-nee*, *YOO-lee*.

Sounds you'll need

- `j-as-y` — English *y* again, as in *Januar* and *Juni*.
- `ie-long-ee` — and a long *ee* at the end.

Because the two are so close, German speakers arranging a date will often say *Julei* for July, stretching it away from *Juni*. You will hear it; you do not have to say it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Juli" — YOO-lee
- the pair, slowly — "Juni, Juli"
- who it is — "Julius Caesar, not a god"

Twice through: "Juni, Juli."

Before you move on

Say "July." (**Der Juli**.) And "June"? (**Der Juni**.) Which one is a god? (***Juni*** — **Juno**.) Which one is a man? (***Juli*** — **Caesar**.) Next: the man who took the hint.

14.2 der August — "August"

Caesar took a month. His heir noticed.

You'll want to know: der August

der August — "August."

The emperor **Augustus**, Caesar's adopted son, who had the next month renamed for himself. Two men in a row, side by side in the year, and then it stops: **no month after this one is named for anybody at all.**

The weight falls on the second syllable in German — *au-GUST* — where English puts it on the first.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

August ← Latin *Augustus*, the emperor's title, from *augustus*, "venerable" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `au-diphthong` — *au* is one gliding vowel, the *ow* of English *how*.
- `st-initial-scht` — the *st* here is **inside** the word, not at the start, so it stays a plain *st*. German's *sht* happens at the beginning of a word, and this is the contrast that shows you where the boundary is.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der August" — au-GUST
- the two men, in order — "Juli, August"
- what happens next — "the naming stops"

Twice through: "Juli, August."

Before you move on

Say "August." (**Der August**.) Which syllable is stressed? (**The second** — au-GUST.) Who is it? (**The emperor Augustus**.) How many months are named for men? (**Two** — and they are next to each other.) Next: what the calendar does once it runs out of names.

14.3 der September — "September"

You have the Latin number for seven from a chapter about counting. Here it is again, wearing a month.

You'll want to know: der September

der September — "September."

Latin *september*, from ***septem*** — **seven**. Count from *März*, where the Roman year started, and September lands seventh.

The year was later moved to start in January. The name was not moved with it, so a word meaning "seventh" now sits in the ninth slot, in German exactly as in English, and has done for two thousand years.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-e-german` — three clear short *e*s: *sep-TEM-ber*.
- `r-final` — closing on the soft *r*.

The stress is on the middle syllable, as in English.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der September" — sep-TEM-ber
- the Latin number inside it — "septem, seven"
- the German seven beside it — "sieben"
- where the count starts — "März"

Twice through: "September — septem — sieben."

Before you move on

Say "September." (**Der September**.) What number is inside it? (***Septem*** — **seven**.) Which position does it actually hold now? (**Ninth**.) Why the mismatch? (**The year used to start in März**.) What is German's own seven? (***Sieben***.) Next: eight.

14.4 der Oktober — "October"

The same trick as September, one number along.

You'll want to know: der Oktober

der Oktober — "October."

Latin *october*, from ***octo*** — **eight**. Eighth from *März*, tenth on the calendar you use.

Notice the spelling. English writes *Oc-*, keeping the Latin *c*. German writes *Ok-*, because German spells that sound with a **k** and applies its own rule to a borrowed word. Same word, same origin, one letter of local habit.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-o-german` — a clean rounded *o*, held steady rather than gliding as English *oh* does.
- `r-final` — and the soft closing *r*.

ok-TOH-ber, weight in the middle.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Oktober" — ok-TOH-ber
- the Latin number — "octo, eight"
- the German eight — "acht"
- the pair so far — "September, Oktober"

Twice through: "Oktober — octo — acht."

Before you move on

Say "October." (**Der Oktober**.) Which letter does German use where English keeps a *c*? (**A** *k*.) What number is inside? (***Octo*** — **eight**.) German's own eight? (***Acht***.) Next: nine.

14.5 der November — "November"

Spelled exactly as in English. Said differently, on one letter.

You'll want to know: der November

der November — "November."

Latin *november*, from ***novem*** — **nine**. Ninth from *März*, eleventh now.

German and English write this month with the same eleven letters. That is rarer than it looks, and it happens here because both took the word from Latin without touching it.

Sounds you'll need

- `v-as-f` — German *v* is an **f**. The month is *no-FEM-ber*.
- `r-final` — soft closing *r*, as on the two before it.

This is the one letter where the identical spelling stops being identical. A German reading *November* aloud produces something an English ear does not expect, and nothing about the page warns you.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der November" — no-FEM-ber
- the Latin number — "novem, nine"
- the German nine — "neun"
- three in order — "September, Oktober, November"

Twice through: "November — no-FEM-ber."

Before you move on

Say "November." (**Der November** — no-FEM-ber.) How is German *v* said? (**As an** *f*.) What number is inside? (***Novem*** — **nine**.) German's own nine? (***Neun***.) Next: ten, and the end of the year.

14.6 der Dezember — "December"

The last month, and a letter whose sound you were given with a number.

You'll want to know: der Dezember

der Dezember — "December."

Latin *december*, from ***decem*** — **ten**. Tenth from *März*, twelfth now, and the last of the four months that are nothing but numbers.

Where English writes *De-c-*, German writes *De-z-*.

Sounds you'll need

- `z-ts` — German *z* is **ts**, the sound you were given on *zehn*. So the month opens *de-TSEM-*, not *de-SEM-*.
- `r-final` — and it closes on the same soft *r* as the other three.

That is the whole difference between the German and English versions of one Latin word: *c* became *z*, because German already had a letter for that sound.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Dezember" — de-TSEM-ber
- the German ten, same opening sound — "zehn"
- the Latin number — "decem, ten"
- the four in order — "September, Oktober, November, Dezember"

Twice through: "Dezember — de-TSEM-ber."

Before you move on

Say "December." (**Der Dezember**.) How does German *z* sound? (**Ts**.) Which number gave you that? (***Zehn***.) What number is inside the month? (***Decem*** — **ten**.) Next: the four of them together.

14.7 Practice — the second half of the year

No new words. Six names, of which four are not really names.

Grammar Lens: the four that count in Latin

the month	the Latin inside	German's own word
September	*septem*	*sieben*
Oktober	*octo*	*acht*
November	*novem*	*neun*
Dezember	*decem*	*zehn*

Say each row through and hear that nothing rhymes. German counts in one language and dates in another, and never reconciled the two — because there was never any occasion to.

Why it's said this way

The second half of the year is a record of a calendar running out of ideas.

Juli — ***Julius Caesar****, who rebuilt the calendar and took a month.* ***August*** — **Augustus**, who took the next one. **September** *to* **Dezember** — *nobody at all. Seven, eight, nine, ten, counted from* März*, where the year used to begin.*

Two men who could order a month renamed did so, one after the other, and then the practice stopped. What was left was arithmetic, and the arithmetic stopped being true the moment the year moved to January — which nobody thought worth fixing, and so it stands.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- all six — "Juli, August, September, Oktober, November, Dezember"
- the two men — "Caesar, Augustus"
- each Latin number with its German twin — "septem, sieben; octo, acht; novem, neun; decem, zehn"
- the one that begins with a ts — "Dezember"
- the one whose v is an f — "November"

Twice through: "September, Oktober, November, Dezember."

Before you move on

Say the last four months. (**September, Oktober, November, Dezember**.) What are they named for? (**Numbers — seven, eight, nine, ten**.) Counted from where? (***März***.) Which two are named for men? (***Juli* and *August***.) Do German's own numbers sound like the Latin ones inside the months? (**No** — and they never had to.)

Chapter 15

The Seasons Go Native

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (11) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 11 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the four German seasons and say which of them German built and which it inherited.
>
> *The months were bought; the year, the time and the seasons were not. Jahr is English year, Zeit is English tide, and Jahreszeit is the two of them stuck together – year-time – where English borrowed season from French. Frühling was built inside German out of früh, and Herbst is English harvest: one inherited word that English narrowed to the act of gathering before buying Latin autumn for the season German never stopped naming with it.*

15.1 das Jahr — "the year"

> *Januar* to *Dezember*. Twelve months. There is a word for the whole of that, and it is not from Latin.

You'll want to know: das Jahr

> **das Jahr** — "the year."

Germanic *jēra*, the twin of English **year**.

Every one of the twelve names inside it was bought from Rome. The container was not, any more than *Monat* was. German bought the labels and kept the measurements.

Sounds you'll need

- `j-as-y` — the *j* is English *y*, as in *Januar* and *Juni*: *yaar*.
- `h-silent-lengthening` — the *h* is not pronounced. It **stretches** the *a* in front of it, which is the job that *h* does inside a German word.

So *Jahr* is two letters of sound and two letters of instruction. Written, it looks nothing like *year*; said, it is the same word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "das Jahr" — yaar, long
- the English twin — "Jahr, year"
- what the h is doing — "stretching the a"

Twice through: "das Jahr."

Before you move on

Say "the year." (**Das Jahr**.) Is the *h* pronounced? (**No** — it lengthens the *a*.) What is its English twin? (***Year***.) Borrowed or inherited? (**Inherited** — like *Monat*, unlike every month name.) Next: the second half of a compound you are about to build.

15.2 die Zeit — "time"

You have a clock and you have an hour. This is the thing they measure.

You'll want to know: die Zeit

die Zeit — "time."

Germanic, through and through, and the twin of an English word you would not guess: **tide**.

Tide once meant a stretch of time, and it still does in the leftovers — *Yuletide*, *eventide*, *in good time*. Then the sea took the word, and English had to borrow *time*'s job out to a different root. German never had that problem and kept *Zeit* for the whole idea.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Zeit ← Old High German *zīt* ← Proto-Germanic **tīdiz*, "time, period" — inherited, the same word as English *tide*, with German *z* where English kept *t*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `z-ts` — German *z* is **ts**, as it was at the front of *Dezember*.
- `diphthong-ei` — and *ei* is the vowel of English **eye**.

Put them together: *tsite*, rhyming with English *sight*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "die Zeit" — tsite
- the English leftover — "Yuletide"
- the three together — "die Uhr, die Stunde, die Zeit"

Twice through: "die Zeit."

Before you move on

Say "time." (**Die Zeit**.) How does *z* sound? (**Ts**.) What is its English twin? (***Tide***.) Where does English still use it that way? (***Yuletide***.) Now hold *Jahr* and *Zeit* together — the next word is both of them.

15.3 die Jahreszeit — "season"

Year. Time. Put them together and say what you think it means before reading on.

You'll want to know: die Jahreszeit

die Jahreszeit — "season," and literally "**year-time**."

Jahres- is *Jahr* with the linking *-es-* German puts between the halves of a compound, and *-zeit* is *Zeit*. Nothing is hidden. The plural is *die Jahreszeiten*, and it is the title of this chapter.

Why it's said this way

English does not do this. English has ***season***, from French *saison*, from Latin *satio* — "the sowing." A borrowed word, opaque unless somebody explains it, which is what the previous sentence had to do. German assembled its word out of two it already owned, and the result explains itself to anyone who has the halves. You had the halves two lessons ago.
That is the difference between the two halves of this chapter and the last one. The months arrived as labels. The year, the time and the seasons were already here, and German named them out of stock.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "die Jahreszeit"
- its two halves — "Jahr, Zeit"
- what it says — "year-time"
- the plural — "die Jahreszeiten"

Twice through: "Jahr, Zeit, Jahreszeit."

Before you move on

Say "season." (**Die Jahreszeit**.) What are its halves? (***Jahr* and *Zeit***.) What does it literally say? (**Year-time**.) Is English *season* built the same way? (**No** — it is borrowed from French.) Next: the first of the four.

15.4 früh — "early"

One small word first, because the first season is built out of it.

You'll want to know: früh

früh — "early."

Not a noun and not capitalised: an adjective, and one you will meet constantly — *früh aufstehen*, to get up early.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

früh ← Old High German *fruoji* ← Proto-Germanic **frōwijaz*, "early" — inherited. Dutch *vroeg* is the same word. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `umlaut-ue` — *ü* is a sound English does not have. Say **ee**. Hold it. Now round your lips as if for **oo**, and do not let your tongue move. That is *ü*.
- `h-silent-lengthening` — and the *h* is silent again, stretching the vowel, as it did in *Jahr*.

fr-ü-h: one syllable, the middle held long.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the vowel alone — "ee, then round the lips"
- "früh"
- what the h is doing — "stretching, not sounding"
- it beside a word with the same trick — "Jahr, früh"

Twice through: "früh."

Before you move on

Say "early." (***Früh.***) How do you make *ü*? (**Say** *ee*, **then round the lips**.) Is the *h* sounded? (**No** — it lengthens.) Next: what German calls the early season.

15.5 der Frühling — "spring"

You have *früh*. Add three letters.

You'll want to know: der Frühling

der Frühling — "spring," and literally "**the early one**."

The ending **-ling** takes a quality and makes a thing that has it. *Früh* is early; a *Frühling* is the early one — the year's first *Jahreszeit*.

You will meet *-ling* again elsewhere, and it does the same job every time.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Frühling is *früh*, "early" ← Old High German *fruoji* (EtymDB 2.1), with the ending *-ling*: "the early one".

Sounds you'll need

- `umlaut-ue` — the same *ü* as in *früh*, unchanged by the ending.
- `ng-cluster` — and *-ling* ends on the *ng* of English *sing*, with no hard *g* after it.

Two syllables, and the weight sits on *früh*, the half that carries the meaning.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the small word — "früh"
- the season — "der Frühling"
- what it says — "the early one"
- it with its category — "der Frühling ist eine Jahreszeit"

Twice through: "früh, Frühling."

Before you move on

Say "spring." (**Der Frühling**.) What is it built from? (***Früh* plus *-ling***.) What does *-ling* do? (**Makes "the one that is like that"**.) Borrowed or built? (**Built**.) Next: two seasons that need no explaining at all.

15.6 der Sommer — "summer"

After the built one, an inherited one. This is the easiest word in the chapter.

You'll want to know: der Sommer

der Sommer — "summer."

One Germanic word, kept whole by both languages: *Sommer*, **summer**. The difference between them is the vowel letter and nothing else.

Words survive like this when nobody ever has a reason to replace them, and a hot season is one of those things every generation needs to talk about.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Sommer ← Old High German *sumar* ← Proto-Germanic **sumaraz* — inherited, the same word as English *summer*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-o-german` — a short, rounded *o*, steadier than the English vowel.
- `r-final` — and the ending is the soft *r* you have on *Uhr* and *November*.

SOM-mer, weight on the first.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Sommer"

- the pair — “Sommer, summer”
- two seasons in order — “der Frühling, der Sommer”

Twice through: “der Frühling, der Sommer.”

Before you move on

Say “summer.” (**Der Sommer**.) Is it borrowed? (**No — inherited**, like English *summer*.) Say the first two seasons. (**Der Frühling, der Sommer**.) Next: the one with a surprise in it.

15.7 der Herbst — “autumn”

The third season, and the only one whose name you will not recognise at first hearing.

You’ll want to know: der Herbst

der Herbst — “autumn,” or “fall.”

It is the **reaping** season: the stretch of the year when the crop comes in. That meaning is the whole of the word, and the next lesson is about where else you already have it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Herbst ← Old High German *herbist* ← Proto-Germanic **harbistaz* — inherited, the same word as English *harvest*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you’ll need

- `herz-short-e` — a short, open *e*, the vowel of English *bed*, with the German *r* colouring it from behind.
- `st-initial-scht` — the *-st* here is at the **end**, so it stays a plain *st*, exactly as it did inside *August*.

hairpst, one syllable, no vowel between the *b* and the *st*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Herbst" — one syllable
- what it means — "the reaping season"
- three in order — "der Frühling, der Sommer, der Herbst"

Twice through: "der Herbst."

Before you move on

Say "autumn." (**Der Herbst**.) How many syllables? (**One**.) What does the word mean underneath? (**The reaping season**.) Next: the English word that is the same word.

15.8 Herbst and harvest

Say *Herbst* once more and then say the English word **harvest**. Those are the same word.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Germanic *harbistaz*, "the reaping season," went into both languages and then each did something different with it.

language	what it kept	what it did next
German	*Herbst*, the **season**	nothing — it was enough
English	*harvest*, the **act**	borrowed Latin *autumn* for the season

English narrowed the inherited word to the *gathering itself* — you harvest a field — and then found it had no word left for the time of year, so it took one from Latin. German never split the meaning and never needed the loan.

Why it's said this way

This is the clearest example in the book of something worth knowing: two languages can inherit **the same word** and end up looking unrelated, without either of them doing anything strange.

Nobody replaced *harvest*. Its meaning drifted a little, a gap opened where the season used to be, and a Latin word was standing nearby. That is how most borrowing happens — not because a language lacks a word, but because one of its words moved.
And it is the last turn of this chapter's argument. The months were bought outright. The seasons were not, and *Herbst* is the one place you can watch the English side buy what German kept.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — "Herbst, harvest"
- what each language kept — "the season; the work"
- what English had to buy — "autumn, from Latin"

Twice through: "Herbst, harvest — one word, two jobs."

Before you move on

What English word is *Herbst*? (***Harvest***.) What does English use it for now? (**The act of gathering**.) So what did English borrow, and from where? (***Autumn***, **from Latin**.) Did German need a loan? (**No**.) Next: the coldest one, and then a word most Germans never say.

15.9 der Winter — "winter"

The fourth season, spelled exactly as you would expect, and said exactly as you would not.

You'll want to know: der Winter

der Winter — "winter."

Same six letters as English, same inherited Germanic word, and like *Sommer* it was never worth replacing.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Winter ← Middle High German *winter* ← Old High German *wintar* — inherited, from Proto-Germanic **wintruz*. EtymDB 2.1 traces English *winter* to the same **wintruz*.

Sounds you'll need

- `w-as-v` — German *w* is an English **v**. The season is *VIN-ter*.
- `i-short` — and the *i* is short and bright.

November had the mirror of this: a *v* that is said as an *f*. German's *v* and *w* have swapped the jobs an English reader expects of them, and these two words put both halves of the swap on one page.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Winter" — VIN-ter
- the rule you will need again — "German w is an English v"
- the swap — "w is v, v is f"
- all four — "der Frühling, der Sommer, der Herbst, der Winter"

Twice through: "der Winter."

Before you move on

Say "winter." (**Der Winter** — VIN-ter.) How is German *w* said? (**As a** *v*, **every time**.) And German *v*? (**As an** *f*.) How many *Jahreszeiten* have you now? (**Four**.) Next: a fifth name for a season you already have.

15.10 der Lenz — "spring," the old word

German has a second word for spring. You will read it far more often than you will hear it.

You'll want to know: der Lenz

der Lenz — "spring," in poetry and in set phrases.

Frühling is the word you use. *Lenz* is the word that turns up in songs, in older writing, and in the odd fixed expression. Recognise it; reach for *Frühling*.

It is older than *Frühling*, and it is the twin of English **Lent** — which was the *spring* season before the Church attached a fast to it. Both go back to a root about the **lengthening** of the days, which is the one thing a northern spring reliably does.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Lenz ← Old High German *lenzo* ← Proto-Germanic **langatīnaz*, "spring", built from "long" and "day" — inherited, a cousin of English *Lent*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `z-ts` — the *z* is **ts**, as in *Zeit* and *Dezember*: *lents*.
- `herz-short-e` — with the short open *e* of *Herbst*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Lenz" — lents
- the everyday word beside it — "der Frühling"
- the English twin — "Lent"
- which one you use — "Frühling"

Twice through: "Frühling, Lenz."

Before you move on

What does *Lenz* mean? (**Spring**.) Which word do you use in speech? (***Frühling***.) What is *Lenz*'s English twin? (***Lent***.) What did the root mean? (**The lengthening of the days**.) Next: the whole year, said through.

15.11 Practice — the four, and the seam

No new words. A year, a time, and the four things they make between them.

Grammar Lens: the four seasons

German	built from	English
der Frühling	*früh* + *-ling*	spring
der Sommer	inherited whole	summer
der Herbst	inherited whole	autumn
der Winter	inherited whole	winter

Three of the four are the plain twins of their English words. The fourth was built inside German out of a word you learned one lesson earlier. Not one of them was borrowed.

Why it's said this way

Hold the last three chapters together and the seam is exact.
*The **months** came from Rome, all twelve, names and calendar together.* The **year**, the **time**, and the **seasons** did not. *Jahr*, *Zeit*, *Jahreszeit*, and the four seasons are German's own, and *Frühling* was still being built out of German parts long after the month names had arrived.
Herbst is the sharpest place to see it, because there English went the other way: it kept the inherited word for the **work** and bought *autumn* for the **season**. Two languages, one starting word, opposite outcomes — and the German one is the one that needed no purchase.
And German kept a spare. *Lenz* is still there for spring, older than *Frühling*, unneeded and unretired.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- all four — "der Frühling, der Sommer, der Herbst, der Winter"
- the category — "die Jahreszeiten"
- the built one and its part — "Frühling, from früh"
- the compound and its halves — "Jahreszeit: Jahr, Zeit"

- the pair that split — “Herbst, harvest”

Twice through: “Frühling, Sommer, Herbst, Winter.”

Before you move on

Name the four seasons. (**Der Frühling, der Sommer, der Herbst, der Winter**.) Which one was built rather than inherited? (***Frühling***, from *früh*.) Which one is English *harvest*? (***Herbst***.) How many of the four did German borrow? (**None**.) And how many of the twelve month names? (**All of them**.)

Chapter 16

The Pair That Proves Grimm's Law

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (13) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 13 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can identify close family members in German and say who someone is.
>
> *Four people and two words for groups of them, and a sound law legible across all four. Vater against pater is p becoming f; Mutter against mater is t becoming th and then moving again inside German; Bruder against frater is a breathy b flattening one way in Germanic and turning to f in Latin, so the swap runs the opposite way; and Schwester against soror is the one that did not move at all, because the law touches stops and leaves an s alone. Every word in the chapter is inherited, where every month name was bought.*

16.1 der Vater — "father"

> The months were bought from Rome. Nothing in this chapter was.

You'll want to know: der Vater

der Vater — "father."

A *der*-word, two syllables, and the first letter is a trap for an English eye.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Vater ← Old High German *fater* ← Proto-Germanic **fadēr* — inherited, the same word as English *father*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `v-as-f` — German *v* is an **f**. You were given this on *vier*, "four," and it has not changed: *Vater* opens *FAH-*, never *VAH-*.
- `vowel-a-long` — the *a* is long and open, the *ah* of English *father*.
- `r-final` — and it closes on the soft *r* you have been ending words with since *Uhr*.

FAH-ter. Say it beside English **father** and the only real difference is the middle consonant.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Vater" — FAH-ter
- the letter and the sound — "V on the page, f in the mouth"
- it beside its English twin — "Vater, father"

Twice through: "der Vater."

Before you move on

Say "father." (**Der Vater**.) Which article? (***Der***.) How is the *V* said? (**As an** *f*.) Which number gave you that? (***Vier***.) Next: why that *f* is there at all.

16.2 Vater and pater

You were given a sound law once, on *Donner* and *thunder*. Here it is again, on the oldest word in the language.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

One ancient word, reconstructed as **ph₂tér*, went into every branch of the family. Then the Germanic branch did something the others did not.

branch	what it did to the first sound	result
Latin, and Romance after it	kept the **p**	*pater*, French *père*
Germanic	turned it into an **f**	**f**ather, **V**ater

The German *V* is an old spelling of that *f*. Take the letter away and the two Germanic words are the same word.

Why it's said this way

That $p \to f$ is one line of Grimm's law, the shift that separated the Germanic languages from the rest. It ran through the whole vocabulary at once, which is why it is a law and not an anecdote. And it is why German and English **agree** here while French sits on the other side. They agree because they are on the same side of one ancient change — not because either borrowed from the other. The month names came from Rome. This word never went anywhere.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the two Germanic ones — "Vater, father"
- the Latin one — "pater"
- the change — "p became f"

Twice through: "pater, Vater — p to f."

Before you move on

What did Latin keep? (**The** *p* — *pater*.) What did Germanic do with it? (**Turned it into an** *f*.) What is that shift called? (**Grimm's law**.) So why do German and English match? (**Same side of the change**.) Next: the mother, and the second leg of the same law.

16.3 die Mutter — "mother"

The father's first sound changed. This one held.

You'll want to know: die Mutter

die Mutter — "mother."

A *die*-word beside *der Vater*, and the pair is how the two articles are usually first met in a sentence about people.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mutter ← Old High German *muoter* ← Proto-Germanic **mōdēr* — inherited, the same word as English *mother*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `mund-short-u` — the *u* is **short**, the vowel of English *put*, not the *uh* of English *mother*.
- `d-t-final` — and the *-tt-* is a crisp double *t*.

MOO-ter, with the *oo* clipped short. Weight on the first syllable, as it is on *Vater*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "die Mutter" — MOO-ter, short
- the pair with their articles — "der Vater, die Mutter"
- the English pair — "father, mother"

Twice through: "der Vater, die Mutter."

Before you move on

Say "mother." (**Die Mutter**.) Which article? (***Die***.) Is the *u* long or short? (**Short**.) Say both parents together. (**Der Vater, die Mutter**.) Next: the consonant in the middle, which did move.

16.4 Mutter and mater

The father moved at the front. The mother moves in the middle.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The first sound of this word never changed anywhere: *m* in Latin, *m* in English, *m* in German. The **middle** one did, twice.

stage	the middle sound	word
Latin, untouched	**t**	*mater*, French *mère*
Germanic, first shift	**th**	mo**th**er
German, its own later shift	**tt**	Mu**tt**er

English stopped after one change. German kept going and ran a second shift of its own, which is why *mother* and *Mutter* differ where *father* and *Vater* barely do.

Why it's said this way

Two shifts, one after the other, both of them laws rather than accidents. The first separated Germanic from Latin; the second separated German from English.
So the distance between any two of these words is a count of how many shifts have run between them. *Mater* to *mother* is one. *Mother* to *Mutter* is one more. That is the whole reason the family looks scattered from the outside and is perfectly orderly from the inside.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three in order — "mater, mother, Mutter"
- the middle sound each time — "t, th, tt"
- what never changed — "the m"

Twice through: "mater, mother, Mutter."

Before you move on

What is the Latin? (***Mater.***) What did the first shift make of the middle *t*? (***Th.***) And the second? (**The** *tt* **of** *Mutter.*) How many shifts separate *mater* from *Mutter*? (**Two.**) Next: the word for both of them at once.

16.5 die Eltern — "parents"

You have a father and a mother. German has one word for the two of them, and it only comes in the plural.

You'll want to know: die Eltern

die Eltern — "parents."

It takes *die*, like every plural you have met, and there is no singular form of it. You cannot say "one *Eltern*"; a single one is *der Vater* or *die Mutter*.

Underneath, it is a **comparative** that hardened into a noun: it means "the **older** ones." English had the same formation and kept it as **elders**, narrowed to people of standing rather than to the two who raised you.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Eltern ← Old High German *eltirōn* ← Proto-Germanic **alþizô*, "older" — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 sets it beside English *elders*.

Why it's said this way

Every word in this chapter is inherited. Not one of them was bought. That is not an accident of this list. The words a language uses every hour of every day are the ones an incoming language cannot displace, and there is nothing more everyday than the people in a house. Rome ran the calendar, so German took the calendar's words. Rome did not run anybody's family.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "die Eltern"

- the two it stands for — "der Vater, die Mutter"
- what it literally means — "the older ones"
- the English word from the same formation — "elders"

Twice through: "die Eltern."

Before you move on

Say "parents." (**Die Eltern**.) What is the singular? (**There is none** — use *der Vater* or *die Mutter*.) What does it mean underneath? (**The older ones**.) Was any word in this chapter borrowed? (**No** — all inherited.) Next: the brother.

16.6 der Bruder — "brother"

Out of the parents and into their children. This one you can almost read already.

You'll want to know: der Bruder

der Bruder — "brother."

A *der*-word. Set it beside English **brother** and one vowel is the whole distance: *oo* where English has *uh*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bruder ← Old High German *bruoder* ← Proto-Germanic **brōþēr* — inherited, the same word as English *brother*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-u-long` — a long *oo*, as in English *food*.
- `r-uvular` — the *r* after *B* is made at the back of the throat, a light scrape rather than a roll.
- `r-final` — and the ending is the soft closing *r* again.

BROO-der, weight on the first, exactly the rhythm of *Vater* and *Mutter*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Bruder" — BROO-der
- the English twin — "Bruder, brother"
- three of the family so far — "der Vater, die Mutter, der Bruder"

Twice through: "der Bruder."

Before you move on

Say "brother." (**Der Bruder**.) Which article? (***Der***.) Long or short *u*? (**Long** — *BROO*.) Next: what Latin did to the front of it.

16.7 Bruder and frater

On the father, Latin had the *p* and Germanic had the *f*. Here it is the other way round, and that is not a contradiction.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The ancient word is reconstructed as $*b^{h}réh_{2}tēr$ — it begins with a **breathy b**, a sound neither language kept.

branch	**what it did with the breathy b**	**result**
Latin	turned it into an **f**	*frater*, French *frère*
Germanic	flattened it to a plain **b**	**b**rother, **B**ruder

So *Bruder* and *frater* really are one word, and the *b* against the *f* is the mark of which branch you are standing in.

Why it's said this way

It looks reversed against *Vater* and *pater*, where Germanic held the *f*. It is not. The two words started from **different ancient sounds**: a plain *p* in one, a breathy *b* in the other. Grimm's law moved each of them once, in its own direction, and the results cross over.
That is what makes it a law worth the name. It does not say

"Germanic prefers *f*." It says each old sound goes to one particular new one, every time — and you can run it forwards on a word you have never seen.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — "frater, Bruder"
- which branch has which — "Latin f, Germanic b"
- the father pair beside it — "pater, Vater"

Twice through: "frater, Bruder."

Before you move on

What is the Latin for *Bruder*? (***Frater***.) Which branch has the *b*? (**Germanic**.) Does that contradict *pater* and *Vater*? (**No** — they started from different old sounds.) Next: a cluster of three letters that says two sounds.

16.8 schw- — three letters, two sounds

One sound cluster before the next word, because the word is unreadable without it.

Sounds you'll need

- `sch-sh` — **sch** is **one** sound, and it is the *sh* of English *ship*. Not *s-k-h*, not *sk*. Three letters, one consonant.
- `w-as-v` — and German *w* is a **v**, the rule you were given on *Winter*.
- `schw-cluster` — put them together and *schw-* comes out **shv-**.

English can say *sh* and English can say *v*, but it never puts them side by side at the start of a word. Say *shhh*, hold it, then let it fall straight into *v* without a vowel between: *shv*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the first sound alone — "sh"
- the second alone — "v"
- the two joined, no vowel — "shv"
- it again, slower — "shv"

Twice through: "shv."

Before you move on

How many sounds is *sch*? (**One** — English *sh*.) How is German *w* said? (**As a** *v*.) So what does *schw-* sound like? (***Shv-***.) Is there a vowel between them? (**No**.) Next: the word that starts with it.

16.9 die Schwester — "sister"

You have the cluster. Here is the word it was for.

You'll want to know: die Schwester

die Schwester — "sister."

SHVES-ter. A *die*-word, and the counterpart of *der Bruder*.

On the page it looks unrelated to **sister**. In the mouth it is not: take the *shv* back to a plain *s* and what is left — *s-e-s-t-e-r* — is the English word with one vowel moved.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schwester ← Old High German *swester* ← Proto-Germanic **swestēr* — inherited, the same word as English *sister*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `schw-cluster` — *shv-*, straight into the vowel.
- `herz-short-e` — a short open *e*, the vowel of English *bed*.

- `r-final` — and the same soft ending as *Vater*, *Mutter* and *Bruder*.

Four family words now, and all four end the same way.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "die Schwester" — SHVES-ter
- the pair — "der Bruder, die Schwester"
- all four — "der Vater, die Mutter, der Bruder, die Schwester"

Twice through: "die Schwester."

Before you move on

Say "sister." (**Die Schwester**.) How does it start? (***Shv-***.) Which article? (***Die***.) Say the brother beside it. (***Der Bruder***.) Next: what Latin did with the same word.

16.10 Schwester and soror

The brother's first sound split the two branches. The sister's did not split anything.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The ancient word is reconstructed as **swésōr*, and all three descendants keep its **s**:

language	the word	the first sound
German	*Schwester*	*sch* is a later German dressing on an **s**
English	*sister*	plain **s**
Latin	*soror*	plain **s**

Grimm's law had nothing to do to an *s*. It moved the stops — the *p*s, *t*s and *b*s — and left this one where it stood, which is why the sister is the one family word whose front sound matches across the whole

family.

Why it's said this way

Latin *soror* is behind French *sœur*, and behind English **sorority** — which English borrowed back from Latin centuries after it already had *sister* from the same root. The two came in by different doors and nobody noticed they were relatives.
That is the ordinary condition of a big vocabulary: the same ancient word arriving twice, once inherited and once bought, sitting in the dictionary without recognising each other.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three — "Schwester, sister, soror"
- what they share — "the s"
- the English word borrowed back from Latin — "sorority"

Twice through: "Schwester, sister, soror."

Before you move on

What is the Latin? (***Soror***.) What do all three share? (**The** *s*.) Why did Grimm's law leave it? (**It moved stops, not** *s*.) What is the *sch* then? (**Later German dressing on the same** *s*.) Next: the word English does not have.

16.11 die Geschwister — "siblings"

German has one word for the brother and the sister together. English has *siblings*, which almost nobody says at a kitchen table.

You'll want to know: die Geschwister

die Geschwister — "siblings," brothers and sisters as a set.

Consider what is inside it. Take off the *Ge-* at the front and *-schwister* is *Schwester*, which you own — the same *shv*, the same ending. A plural, so *die*, and like *Eltern* it has no singular.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Geschwister ← Middle High German *geswister* ← Old High German *giswestar* (EtymDB 2.1): the gathering prefix *ge-* on *Schwester*.

Why it's said this way

The odd part is that a word built on *Schwester* covers the **brothers** too. Two boys and no girls in a house are still *die Geschwister*. German built the collective on the word that happened to be there, and the collective then outranked the piece it was made from. English never built one at all: it says *brothers and sisters*, and for a single term it revived *siblings*, an Old English word for "relatives".

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "die Geschwister"
- the word inside it — "Schwester"
- the two it covers — "der Bruder, die Schwester"
- what English says instead — "brothers and sisters"

Twice through: "die Geschwister."

Before you move on

Say "siblings." (**Die Geschwister**.) Which word is inside it? (***Schwester***.) Does it cover brothers? (**Yes** — all of them.) Is there a singular? (**No**.) Next: what that *Ge-* on the front is doing.

16.12 The gathering Ge-

One prefix, one job, and the last word showed you it working.

Grammar Lens: one member in, a whole set out

Put **Ge-** on the front of a word for one member of something, and you get a word for **the whole set of them**.

in	**out**
Schwester, one member	*Geschwister*, the set

That is the machine. It is old, it is Germanic, and German still runs it: a mountain becomes a mountain range, a piece of luggage becomes the luggage, a vegetable becomes the vegetables — each one a bare noun with *Ge-* welded on.
English had this prefix and wore it away to nothing. What is left of it in English are fossils nobody parses any more.

Why it's said this way

Both plural-only family words in this chapter are made rather than borrowed, and each is made a different way.
Eltern takes an adjective and freezes it: **the older ones**. *Geschwister* takes a noun and gathers it: **the set of them**.
Neither has a singular, because neither was ever about one person. They name a group directly, and German got both of them out of parts it already had.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- what the prefix does — "one member in, the set out"
- the pair it made — "Schwester, Geschwister"
- the two plural-only words — "die Eltern, die Geschwister"

Twice through: "Schwester, Geschwister."

Before you move on

What does the gathering *Ge-* do? (**Makes a set out of one member**.) Which word in this chapter was built with it? (***Geschwister***.) And how was *Eltern* built instead? (**From a comparative — the older ones**.) Do either of them have a

singular? (**No.**)

16.13 Practice — the household, and the law that runs through it

No new words. Four people, two words for groups of them, and one sound law with three lines.

Grammar Lens: the four, and their two collectives

one person	the set they belong to
der Vater	*die Eltern*
die Mutter	*die Eltern*
der Bruder	*die Geschwister*
die Schwester	*die Geschwister*

Both collectives take *die* and neither has a singular. One was frozen out of a comparative, the other gathered with a prefix.

Why it's said this way

Set the four against their Latin cousins and the law is legible in a line:

- ***Vater*** against *pater* — the **p** became an **f**.
- ***Mutter*** against *mater* — the **t** became **th**, and then German moved it again.
- ***Bruder*** against *frater* — a breathy **b** flattened one way in Germanic and turned to **f** in Latin, so the swap runs the opposite way.
- ***Schwester*** against *soror* — nothing moved. The law does not touch an **s**.

Three moved and one did not, and which is which was decided by the sound, not by the word. That is what makes it predictable.

Why it's said this way

And every word here is **inherited**. Not one was bought, where every month name was.
The pattern holds across the whole book: the words a language uses every hour resist replacement, and the words that arrive with an institution come in whole. A calendar is an institution. A household is not.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the four with their articles — "der Vater, die Mutter, der Bruder, die Schwester"
- the two collectives — "die Eltern, die Geschwister"
- the one that starts shv — "die Schwester"
- each pair against its Latin — "Vater, pater; Mutter, mater; Bruder, frater; Schwester, soror"
- the one Latin word that did not move — "soror"

Twice through: "der Vater, die Mutter, der Bruder, die Schwester."

Before you move on

Name the four. (**Der Vater, die Mutter, der Bruder, die Schwester**.) The word for the two older ones? (***Die Eltern***.) For the two younger? (***Die Geschwister***.) Which of the four is unchanged from Latin at the front? (***Schwester*** — the *s* never moved.) And how many of these words did German borrow? (**None**.)

Chapter 17

Bread, Water, Wine

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name and request bread, water, and wine in German.
>
> *Three things you could put on one table and two histories between them. Brot is Germanic braudam, English bread, where French took Latin panis and German did not. Wasser is Germanic watar with German's own later shift turning the t into ss, the same shift that put the tt into Mutter. Wein is Latin vinum, borrowed whole with the grapevine the legions carried north – and you can tell it is borrowed without being told, because the inherited pair have drifted from their English twins and the loan has not.*

17.1 das Brot — "bread"

> *Der Vater. Die Mutter.* You were given a third article in the first chapter and have had no noun for it. Here it is.

You'll want to know: das Brot

> **das Brot** — "bread."

A ***das***-word. That completes the set on real nouns: *der Vater*, *die Mutter*, *das Brot* — one of each, and now you have met all three doing their job rather than sitting in a list.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Brot ← Old High German *brōt* ← Proto-Germanic **braudą* — inherited, the same word as English *bread*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `long-o` — a long *o*, the vowel of English *boat*, held steady.
- `r-uvular` — the *r* is made far back in the throat.
- `d-t-final` — and the final *t* is crisp.

broht. One syllable, and capitalised on the page like every German noun, whether it names a person or a loaf.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "das Brot" — broht
- one noun of each gender — "der Vater, die Mutter, das Brot"
- the three articles alone — "der, die, das"
- why it has a capital — "every German noun does"

Twice through: "das Brot."

Before you move on

Say "bread." (**Das Brot**.) Which article? (***Das*** — the neuter.) Say all three with a noun each. (**Der Vater, die Mutter, das Brot**.) Why the capital *B*? (**German capitalises every noun**.) Next: where the word comes from, and where it does not.

17.2 Brot and bread

A word can be interesting for what happened to it. This one is interesting for what did not.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Brot comes from Germanic **braudam*, and English **bread** comes from the same word. No Latin anywhere in it.
Now the other side of the line. Latin *pānis* went into every Romance language and stayed there:

language	**the word**	**from**
German	*Brot*	Germanic **braudam*
French	*pain*	Latin *pānis*
Italian	*pane*	Latin *pānis*

Why it's said this way

Rome sold German a calendar and a clock. It did not sell German bread.
The pattern is the one you have been given four times now and it holds again here: a thing people handle every single day already has a word, and an incoming language does not get to replace it. Months were an administrative object and arrived with their labels. A loaf on a table was not waiting for a name.
That is why *Brot* sits with *Vater* and *Mutter* rather than with *Januar*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the Germanic pair — "Brot, bread"
- the Romance word it is not — "pain"
- which kind of word this is — "inherited, not bought"

Twice through: "Brot, bread."

Before you move on

What is the English twin of *Brot*? (***Bread.***) What does French say? (***Pain*, from Latin** *pānis*.) Did German borrow that? (**No.**) Why not? (**A daily thing already had a word.**) Next: the second of the three.

17.3 das Wasser — "water"

> Bread, and then something to drink beside it. Its first letter you have met twice already.

You'll want to know: das Wasser

das Wasser — "water."

Another ***das***-word, so it takes the same article as *Brot*. Two neuters in a row is a useful accident: it lets you say *das Brot und das Wasser* without having to decide anything.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wasser ← Old High German *wazzar* ← Proto-Germanic **watōr* — inherited, the same word as English *water*, with German *ss* where English kept *t*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `w-as-v` — German *w* is an English **v**. *Wasser* opens *VAH-*.
- `vowel-a-german` — a clean open *a*.
- `r-final` — and the soft closing *r*.

VAH-ser. You have had that *w* on *Winter*, and inside the *shv-* of *Schwester*; this is the third time and the first where it sits on its own at the front of a word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "das Wasser" — VAH-ser
- the letter and the sound — "W on the page, v in the mouth"
- the two together — "das Brot und das Wasser"

Twice through: "das Wasser."

Before you move on

Say "water." (**Das Wasser**.) Which article? (***Das***, like *Brot*.) How is the *W* said? (**As a** *v*.) Where did you meet that before? (**On** *Winter*, **and inside** *Schwester*.) Next: its English twin.

17.4 Wasser and water

Say *Wasser* and then **water**. The difference is one consonant, and you have met it before.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Both come from Germanic **watar*. English kept the **t**. German turned it into **ss**.
That is German's own later shift — the second of the two you met on *Mutter*, where English stopped at *mother* and German kept going. It ran through the vocabulary the same way, so once you have it you can predict it:

English	German
wa**t**er	Wa**ss**er
mo**th**er	Mu**tt**er

Why it's said this way

Two chapters, four inherited words, and the same two shifts explaining every difference between the German and the English.
That is the payoff of a sound law: you stop memorising pairs. *Wasser* is not a word to be learned beside *water* — it **is** *water*, with one predictable change applied, and the change is one you can now run yourself.
And like *Brot*, nothing here was bought. Water is as everyday as a word gets.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — "Wasser, water"

- what changed — "t became ss"
- the other pair with the same shift — "Mutter, mother"

Twice through: "Wasser, water."

Before you move on

What is the English twin? (***Water***.) What did German do to the *t*? (**Made it** *ss*.) Which other word did the same shift? (***Mutter***.) Inherited or borrowed? (**Inherited**.) Next: the one on this table that was borrowed.

17.5 der Wein — "wine"

Two *das*-words so far. The third drink takes a different article, and that is the smaller of the two things different about it.

You'll want to know: der Wein

der Wein — "wine."

A ***der***-word, where *Brot* and *Wasser* are both *das*. So the three now run one of each: *das Brot*, *das Wasser*, *der Wein*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wein ← Old High German *wīn* ← Proto-Germanic **wīną* ← Latin *vīnum* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed from Latin very early, as English *wine* was.

Sounds you'll need

- `w-as-v` — the *W* is a **v** again, as in *Wasser*.
- `diphthong-ei` — and *ei* is the vowel of English **eye**, which you were given on *eins*.

Put the two together and *Wein* comes out sounding like English **vine**. Hold on to that, because the next lesson is about why.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Wein" — like English "vine"
- the two vowels you know — "ei is eye, as in eins"
- all three with their articles — "das Brot, das Wasser, der Wein"

Twice through: "der Wein."

Before you move on

Say "wine." (**Der Wein**.) Which article? (***Der*** — not *das*, like the other two.) What does *ei* sound like? (**English** *eye*.) So what English word does it sound like? (***Vine***.) Next: why it does.

17.6 Wein and vinum

Wasser and *water* differ by a consonant. *Wein* and **wine** differ by nothing you can hear. That difference is the lesson.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wein is **not** an inherited Germanic word. It was **borrowed from Latin *vīnum*** in Roman times, when the legions brought the grapevine north of the Alps.
Here is how you can tell without being told. Inherited words drift apart, because a sound law runs through them:

pair	**how far apart**
Wasser / water	a whole consonant — *ss* against *t*
Mutter / mother	two shifts of distance
Wein / wine / *vīnum*	**no distance at all**

Three words that match this closely are not three cousins who happen to look alike. They are **one word, borrowed**, arriving too late for the law to touch it.

Why it's said this way

The vine did not grow north of the Alps until Rome carried it there. A people who have never had a thing have no word for it, and when the thing arrives the word arrives with it — which is the same reason *Uhr* is Latin and the twelve months are Latin.
So one table holds both halves of the rule. *Brot* and *Wasser* were always here and are German's own. *Wein* came on a cart, and its name was in the same load.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three that match — "Wein, wine, vinum"
- what that closeness means — "one loan, not three cousins"
- what came with the word — "the vine itself"
- the two that were always here — "das Brot, das Wasser"

Twice through: "Wein, wine, vinum — one loan."

Before you move on

Is *Wein* inherited? (**No — borrowed from Latin** *vīnum*.) How can you tell? (**It is too close** — a law would have moved it.) What arrived with the word? (**The grapevine**.) And *Wasser*? (**Always here**.)

17.7 Practice — one table, two histories

No new words. Three things you could put on a table, and one of them is a different kind of word from the other two.

Grammar Lens: three nouns, three articles

German	English
das Brot	the bread
das Wasser	the water
der Wein	the wine

Two neuters and a masculine, every one of them capitalised. There is no rule behind which is which — the article comes with the noun and is learned with it, which is why every word in this book arrives wearing one.

Why it's said this way

Now the histories, which do have a rule behind them:

- ***Brot*** — Germanic **braudam*, English **bread**. French took Latin *pānis* and German did not.
- ***Wasser*** — Germanic **watar*, English **water**, with German's own later shift turning the *t* into *ss*.
- ***Wein*** — Latin *vīnum*, borrowed whole, matching English **wine** and the Latin too closely to be anything else.

Two were always here; one came north on a cart with the plant it names. You can read that off the words themselves without knowing any history: the inherited pair have **drifted** from their English twins, and the borrowed one has not.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- all three with their articles — "das Brot, das Wasser, der Wein"
- the two with a v sound — "Wasser, Wein"
- which two are German's own — "Brot, Wasser"
- which one Rome supplied — "Wein"
- how you can tell — "it did not drift"

Twice through: “das Brot, das Wasser, der Wein.”

Before you move on

Say the three with their articles. (**Das Brot, das Wasser, der Wein**.) Which is masculine? (***Der Wein***.) Which two did German inherit? (***Brot* and *Wasser***.) Which came from Latin? (***Wein*, from** *vīnum*.) And what arrived with it? (**The vine**.)

Chapter 18

One Left Over

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say eleven and twelve in German and explain why neither of them follows the counting pattern.
>
> *elf and zwoelf are not irregular numbers, they are a different rule, and it is a rule about hands. ainlif is one-left and twalif is two-left: left over from ten, because ten is where your fingers stop. English inherited both words unchanged, which is why eleven and twelve are odd there in exactly the same way – when two languages share an irregularity this precisely they did not agree on it, they were one language when it was made. The rule covers two numbers and then stops.*

18.1 elf — "eleven"

> You can count to ten. Both languages then do something odd for two numbers, and they do the same odd thing.

You'll want to know: elf

> **elf** — "eleven."

Not *einszehn*. Not "oneteen" in English either. Eleven is the first of two numbers that refuse the pattern, in German and in English alike.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

elf ← Old High German *einlif* ← Proto-Germanic **ainalif*, "one left" — inherited, the same word as English *eleven*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `herz-short-e` — a short open *e*, the vowel of English *bed*.
- `f-final` — and a clean *f* to close.

elf, one syllable, said as it looks. This is the rare German word an English reader can pronounce on sight.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "elf"
- the two in order — "zehn, elf"
- what it is not — "not einszehn"

Twice through: "zehn, elf."

Before you move on

Say "eleven." (***Elf***.) Does it end in *-zehn*? (**No**.) Does English say "oneteen"? (**No** — *eleven*.) Next: the second of the two.

18.2 zwölf — "twelve"

Short on the page, and three rules deep in the mouth. You own all three already.

You'll want to know: zwölf

zwölf — "twelve."

The second number to refuse the pattern, and the last. After this one German turns regular and stays regular.

You can hear *zwei* inside it if you listen for the opening: *zw-* is the same start.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

zwölf goes back to Proto-Germanic **twalif*, "two left" — inherited. EtymDB 2.1 traces English *twelve* to **twalif* and lists *zwölf* beside it.

Sounds you'll need

- `z-ts` — German *z* is **ts**.
- `w-as-v` — German *w* is a **v**, as on *Winter* and *Wasser*.
- `umlaut-oe` — and *ö* is the rounded vowel from *schön*: shape your lips for *oh* and say *eh*.

So the word opens *tsv-* and runs *tsvölf*. Three rules, one syllable, nothing new.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the opening alone — "tsv"
- the vowel alone — lips for "oh", say "eh"
- "zwölf"
- the pair — "elf, zwölf"

Twice through: "elf, zwölf."

Before you move on

Say "twelve." (***Zwölf.***) How does it open? (***Tsv-.***) Why? (***z*** **is** *ts*, ***w*** **is** *v*.) Which number is hiding at the front? (***Zwei.***) Next: what both of them actually mean.

18.3 -lif — "left over"

Two words that look like exceptions. They are not exceptions. They are an older rule, and it is a rule about hands.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Both words are compounds, and both end in the same piece:

word	**older form**	**the pieces**
elf	*ainlif*	*ain* "one" + *lif*
zwölf	*twalif*	*twa* "two" + *lif*

And ***-lif*** means "**to leave, to remain**." So *elf* is "**one left over**" and *zwölf* is "**two left over**."

Why it's said this way

Left over from **what**? From **ten** — from your ten fingers.
You count along them, you reach *zehn*, you run out of hand, and there is one left. That is eleven. Not a number in a sequence but a **remainder**, named by people counting on the only calculator they had.
And English says the identical thing. *Eleven* is *ain-lif*; *twelve* is *twa-lif*. Not similar words — **the same two words**, inherited side by side, the way *Vater* and *father* are. The Germanic twinning you have been tracking through the household and the meal reaches all the way into the counting.
It also explains why the trick stops at two. Ten fingers leave room for one and two before the hands are hopeless, and after that a language needs a real rule.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the two pieces of eleven — "ain, lif"
- what the ending means — "left over"
- the whole idea — "one left over from ten"
- the English pair that says the same — "eleven, twelve"

Twice through: "elf, zwölf — one left, two left."

Before you move on

What does *-lif* mean? (**Left over**.) Left over from what? (**Ten — your fingers**.) So what is *elf*? (**One left over**.) Are *eleven* and *twelve* the same words? (**Yes** — inherited, not borrowed.) Next: both of them together.

18.4 Practice — one left, two left

No new words. Two numbers, and the reason they look strange in both languages at once.

Grammar Lens: what the two are made of

German	is	and means
elf	*ain* + *lif*	one left over
zwölf	*twa* + *lif*	two left over

Two words, one ending, and the ending is a verb: to leave, to remain. Neither number was ever irregular — they were built by a rule that only had room to run twice.

Why it's said this way

Left over from *zehn*, from ten fingers. A counting system built on hands has to say something when the hands run out, and what Germanic said was *and one is left*.

English inherited both words unchanged, which is why *eleven* and *twelve* are equally odd there, and odd in exactly the same way. When two languages share an irregularity this precisely, they did not agree on it — they were one language when it was made.

From the next number on, both of them turn regular and never break again.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- count the last three — "zehn, elf, zwölf"
- the opening of the second — "tsv"

- what each one means — "one left over, two left over"
- the English pair — "eleven, twelve"

Twice through: "zehn, elf, zwölf."

Before you move on

Say eleven and twelve. (***Elf, zwölf***.) What does the ending mean? (**Left over**.) Left over from what? (***Zehn*** — **ten fingers**.) Why are the English words odd in the same way? (**They are the same two words**.) How many numbers does this rule cover? (**Two — and then it stops**.)

Chapter 19

The Pattern That Never Breaks

Modes: **voice** (12) **Hands-free start:** all 12 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count from thirteen to twenty in German and build every one of those numbers from a digit I already know.
>
> *One rule run eight times: a digit you already own with zehn welded on the end, which is what English -teen is too, because -teen IS ten. Two digits are trimmed at the join – sechs loses its s and sieben loses its -en – and that is the mouth economising, not the rule breaking, exactly as English wore three down to thir- and five to fif-. Twenty stops using zehn and uses -zig, which is the same word worn further, and so is English -ty. The Romance sisters all break partway through the teens; German does not break at all.*

19.1 Ziffer plus zehn — the rule

The leftover trick covered two numbers and stopped. From here German uses one rule, and it does not break once.

Grammar Lens: a digit, then zehn

Take a digit you already own. Put ***zehn*** on the end. That is the number.

take a digit	weld on	and say it
drei	*zehn*	—

No space, no linking piece, no change to either half. Say that row out loud and you have made the number yourself; the next lesson only

confirms it.
You are not learning eight new words in this chapter — you are running one machine eight times.
English does the identical thing and hides it slightly: **-teen is *ten***. *Thir-teen* is "three-ten," which is why it rhymes with nothing and means exactly what German means.

Sounds you'll need

- `z-ts` — every one of these ends in *zehn*, and German *z* is **ts**, so every one ends *-TSAYN*.

Say *zehn* on its own until the *ts* is automatic. It is about to appear eight times in a row.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the ending alone — "zehn"
- the rule — "a digit, then zehn"
- run it once — "drei", then "zehn", then the two joined
- what English hides — "-teen is ten"

Twice through: "Ziffer plus zehn."

Before you move on

What is the rule? (**A digit, then** *zehn*.) Does anything go between them? (**No**.) Run it on *drei* and say what comes out. How does every one of them end? (***-tsayn***.) And what is English *-teen*? (***Ten***.) Next: the rule's first run.

19.2 dreizehn — "thirteen"

You have the rule and you have the digit. Say the number before you read it.

You'll want to know: dreizehn

dreizehn — "thirteen." *drei* + *zehn*.

Nothing added, nothing changed. If you predicted it, that is the point of the chapter working.

English wore its digit down — *three* became *thir-* — and German did not touch its own.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dreizehn ← Old High German *drīzehan* ← Proto-Germanic **þritehun*, "three-ten" — the same compound as English *thirteen*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `diphthong-ei` — *ei* is the vowel of English **eye**, unchanged from *drei*.
- `z-ts` — and the second half is -*TSAYN*.

DREI-tsayn, with the weight on the digit, not the ending. That stress pattern holds for every number in this chapter.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the parts — "drei, zehn"
- joined — "dreizehn"
- the English one and its worn-down digit — "thirteen, from three"

Twice through: "drei, zehn, dreizehn."

Before you move on

Say "thirteen." (***Dreizehn***.) What are its halves? (***Drei* and *zehn***.) Did either change? (**No**.) Which syllable is stressed? (**The first** — the digit.) Next: fourteen, the same way.

19.3 vierzehn — "fourteen"

Same rule, next digit — and its first letter is one you have been warned about twice.

You'll want to know: vierzehn

vierzehn — "fourteen." *vier* + *zehn*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vierzehn ← Old High German *fiorzehan* ← Proto-Germanic **fedurtehun*, "four-ten" — the same compound as English *fourteen*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `v-as-f` — the *V* is an **f**, exactly as in *vier* and *Vater*.
- `z-ts` — and *-TSAYN* again.

FEER-tsayn. Third time for that *v*: a number, a father, and now a teen.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the parts — "vier, zehn"
- joined — "vierzehn"
- the two so far — "dreizehn, vierzehn"

Twice through: "dreizehn, vierzehn."

Before you move on

Say "fourteen." (***Vierzehn.***) How is the *V* said? (**As an** *f*.) What are its halves? (***Vier* and *zehn*.**) Next: fifteen.

19.4 fünfzehn — "fifteen"

> Third run of the rule, and the first place English is the messier of the two languages.

You'll want to know: fünfzehn

fünfzehn — "fifteen." *fünf* + *zehn*.

The digit is whole. English is not: **five** became *fif-*, so *fifteen* no longer shows its own number. German keeps *fünf* visible and audible.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fünfzehn is *fünf* + *zehn*, both inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *fifteen*, Old English *fīftīene*.

Sounds you'll need

- `umlaut-ue` — the *ü* from *fünf*, unchanged: say *ee*, then round the lips.
- `z-ts` — and *-TSAYN*.

Two syllables, the weight on *fünf* and the ending unstressed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the parts — "fünf, zehn"
- joined — "fünfzehn"
- three in a row — "dreizehn, vierzehn, fünfzehn"
- what English lost — "five became fif-"

Twice through: "dreizehn, vierzehn, fünfzehn."

Before you move on

Say "fifteen." (***Fünfzehn.***) Is the digit whole? (**Yes.**) Is English's? (**No** — *five* **became** *fif-*.) Say the three you have. (**Dreizehn,**

vierzehn, fünfzehn.) Next: where German clips too.

19.5 The two clipped digits

The rule holds for every number in this chapter. Two of them shorten the digit first, and it is worth knowing which before you meet them.

Grammar Lens: two digits get shortened

the digit	before *zehn* it becomes	why
sechs	*sech-*	the *s* would collide with the *ts* of *zehn*
sieben	*sieb-*	the *-en* is an unstressed syllable too many

Both are the mouth economising, not the grammar changing. It is still a digit with *zehn* on the end; the digit has been worn smooth at the join and nothing more.

Why it's said this way

English did the same thing and did more of it. *Three* became *thir-* and *five* became *fif-*, and nobody thinks of *thirteen* as irregular — it is a worn compound, exactly like these two.
So the honest scoreboard is: **English clips two digits, German clips two digits, and they are not the same two.** German keeps *fünf* whole where English does not; English keeps *six* and *seven* whole where German does not. Neither language is tidier. Both are old, and old words get worn.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the full digits — "sechs, sieben"
- their clipped forms — "sech-, sieb-"

- what English clipped instead — "three to thir-, five to fif-"
- what has not changed — "still a digit, then zehn"

Twice through: "sechs to sech-, sieben to sieb-."

Before you move on

Which two German digits shorten? (***Sechs* and *sieben***.) What do they become? (***Sech-* and *sieb-***.) Is the rule broken? (**No** — the digit is worn, the rule holds.) Which two did English clip? (***Three* and *five***.) Next: the first of the two.

19.6 sechzehn — "sixteen"

First of the two clipped ones. You already know what it drops.

You'll want to know: sechzehn

sechzehn — "sixteen." *sech-* + *zehn*, with the *s* of *sechs* gone.

Try it with the *s* left in and you will hear the problem: *sechs-zehn* puts an *s* immediately before a *ts*, and the two will not sit next to each other.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sechzehn ← Old High German *sehszehan* ← Proto-Germanic **sehstehun*, "six-ten" — the same compound as English *sixteen*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `ch-ach` — the *ch* is the raspy one from *acht* and *Nacht*, made at the back.
- `z-ts` — and then straight into *-TSAYN*.

ZECH-tsayn, where the first sound is the buzzed German *s*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the whole digit — "sechs"
- the clipped one — "sech-"
- the number — "sechzehn"
- four in a row — "dreizehn, vierzehn, fünfzehn, sechzehn"

Twice through: "sechs, sechzehn."

Before you move on

Say "sixteen." (***Sechzehn.***) What did the digit lose? (**Its** *s.*) Why? (**It would collide with the** *ts.*) Is the rule still digit + *zehn*? (**Yes.**) Next: the other clipped one.

19.7 siebzehn — "seventeen"

Second and last of the clipped ones. After this the rule runs clean to twenty.

You'll want to know: siebzehn

siebzehn — "seventeen." *sieb-* + *zehn*, with the *-en* of *sieben* gone.

Sieben-zehn would be four syllables for one number, three of them unstressed. German trimmed the middle and kept the meaning.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

siebzehn ← Old High German *sibunzehan* ← Proto-Germanic **sebuntehun*, "seven-ten" — the same compound as English *seventeen.* (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `ie-long-ee` — *ie* is a long **ee**, as in *sieben.*
- `consonant-b-final` — the *b* stays a *b* here, because it is not really at the end of a word: *zehn* is welded on behind it.
- `z-ts` — and *-TSAYN.*

ZEEB-tsayn.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the whole digit — "sieben"
- the clipped one — "sieb-"
- the number — "siebzehn"
- the two clipped ones together — "sechzehn, siebzehn"

Twice through: "sieben, siebzehn."

Before you move on

Say "seventeen." (***Siebzehn.***) What did the digit lose? (**Its** *-en.*) Name both clipped numbers. (***Sechzehn, siebzehn.***) How many are left to clip? (**None.**) Next: eighteen, whole again.

19.8 achtzehn — "eighteen"

The clipping is over. From here the digits go in whole.

You'll want to know: achtzehn

achtzehn — "eighteen." *acht* + *zehn*, both whole.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

achtzehn ← Old High German *ahtozehan* ← Proto-Germanic **ahtōutehun*, "eight" + "ten" — the same compound as English *eighteen.* (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `ch-ach` — the raspy *ch* of *acht*, unchanged.
- `z-ts` — and *-TSAYN.*

That *-cht* is the one you were given twice: *acht* against English **eight**,

Nacht against **night**. Where German rasps, English writes *-ght* and says nothing at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the parts — "acht, zehn"
- joined — "achtzehn"
- the pair that shares the rasp — "acht, Nacht"
- their silent English twins — "eight, night"

Twice through: "acht, achtzehn."

Before you move on

Say "eighteen." (***Achtzehn.***) Was the digit clipped? (**No** — whole.) What does English write where German rasps? (***-ght.***) Next: nineteen.

19.9 neunzehn — "nineteen"

Eighth and last run of the rule. You should be able to say it before reading on.

You'll want to know: neunzehn

neunzehn — "nineteen." *neun* + *zehn*, both whole.

Seven numbers built from one rule and not one of them broke it. Two shortened a digit at the join and kept the rule intact.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

neunzehn ← Old High German *niunzehan* ← Proto-Germanic **newuntehun*, "nine-ten" — the same compound as English *nineteen.* (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `diphthong-eu` — *eu* is the *oy* of English *boy*, unchanged from *neun*.
- `z-ts` — and *-TSAYN* for the last time.

NOYN-tsayn.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the parts — "neun, zehn"
- joined — "neunzehn"
- the last four — "sechzehn, siebzehn, achtzehn, neunzehn"

Twice through: "achtzehn, neunzehn."

Before you move on

Say "nineteen." (***Neunzehn.***) Its halves? (***Neun* and *zehn.***) How many numbers has the rule built? (**Seven.**) How many times did it break? (**None.**) Next: twenty, which stops using *zehn*.

19.10 zwanzig — "twenty"

Eight numbers ended in *zehn*. This one does not, and the ending it takes instead is worth a lesson of its own.

You'll want to know: zwanzig

zwanzig — "twenty."

It opens like *zwei* and *zwölf* — *tsv-* — and then closes on **-zig** where every number before it closed on *-zehn*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

zwanzig is inherited: "two" plus an old Germanic word for "tens", the same build as English *twenty*. EtymDB 2.1 lists *zwanzig* beside *twenty* and Dutch *twintig*.

Sounds you'll need

- `z-ts` — twice: *tsv-* at the front, *-ts-* in the middle.
- `w-as-v` — the *w* is a **v**, as always.
- `ich-laut` — and the final *-ig* is said as the soft *ich*-sound from the very first chapters: *-ikh*, not *-ig*.

TSVAHN-tsikh. That final *-ig* rule holds for every German word ending the same way, so it is worth more than this one number.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the ending alone — "-ikh"
- "zwanzig" — TSVAHN-tsikh
- the last two — "neunzehn, zwanzig"
- the three that open the same way — "zwei, zwölf, zwanzig"

Twice through: "neunzehn, zwanzig."

Before you move on

Say "twenty." (***Zwanzig.***) How does the ending sound? (***-ikh*** — the soft *ich*-sound.) Does it end in *zehn*? (**No** — *-zig.*) Which number is at the front? (***Zwei.***) Next: what *-zig* actually is.

19.11 -zig and -ty

The ending changed at twenty. It did not change subject.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Older Germanic *twaintig*, which is *twain* — "two" — plus *tig*, and ***tig* is ten**.

word	**is**	**and means**
zwanzig	*zwei* + *-zig*	two tens
twenty	twain + *-ty*	two tens

So *-zig* and *-ty* are the **same ending**, both of them *ten* worn down by being said a great many times. German's *zehn* stayed whole because it kept being used on its own; the version welded onto twenty wore out instead.

Why it's said this way

Stand back and the whole span from eleven to twenty is three ideas, and you have all three.

- **Eleven and twelve** count what is *left over* after ten fingers.
- **Thirteen to nineteen** are a digit with *ten* on the end.
- **Twenty** is *two tens*, with the same *ten* worn to *-zig*.

Every one of those is a compound. Not one number in this chapter is a word you had to be given — they are all built, and the parts were yours before the chapter started.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- what twenty is — "two tens"
- the German pair — "zwei, zwanzig"
- the English pair — "twain, twenty"
- the two endings that are one word — "-zig, -ty, both ten"

Twice through: "zwanzig — two tens."

Before you move on

What does *zwanzig* mean underneath? (**Two tens**.) What is *-zig*? (***Ten*, worn down**.) And English *-ty*? (**The same word**.) So how many of this chapter's numbers are compounds? (**All of them**.)

19.12 Practice — thirteen to twenty

No new words. One rule, run eight times, and two small wearings-down along the way.

Grammar Lens: the rule and its two exceptions that are not exceptions

number	digit	joined
13	*drei*	*dreizehn*
14	*vier*	*vierzehn*
15	*fünf*	*fünfzehn*
16	*sech-*	*sechzehn*
17	*sieb-*	*siebzehn*
18	*acht*	*achtzehn*
19	*neun*	*neunzehn*

Six digits go in whole and two are trimmed at the join. The rule never changes.

Why it's said this way

Eleven to twenty is three ideas and you now hold all three: two **leftovers**, seven **digit-plus-ten** compounds, and one **two-tens**. Here is the contrast worth carrying. The Romance sisters all **break** partway through the teens and switch to a different construction — Portuguese at sixteen, French and Italian at seventeen. German does not break at all. Two leftovers, then one clean rule to twenty, and English marches beside it the whole distance because it is doing the same thing with the same worn-down words.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- count from thirteen — “dreizehn, vierzehn, fünfzehn, sechzehn, siebzehn, achtzehn, neunzehn, zwanzig”
- the two trimmed digits — “sech-, sieb-”
- the one that stops using zehn — “zwanzig”
- count the whole span — “elf, zwölf, dreizehn … zwanzig”

Twice through: “dreizehn, vierzehn, fünfzehn, sechzehn.”

Before you move on

What is the rule from thirteen up? (**A digit, then** *zehn*.) Which two digits are trimmed? (***Sechs* and *sieben***.) Does the rule ever break? (**No**.) What is *zwanzig* underneath? (**Two tens**.) And where do the Romance languages break? (**Partway through the teens** — sixteen or seventeen.)

Chapter 20

The Colour German Lent Away

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say black and white in German, and name the German word Romance borrowed for white.
>
> *German's colour words are home-grown, with no Latin borrowed in – and one of them emigrated. schwarz is Germanic swartaz, which English kept only in the dusty corner of swarthy; weiss is hwitaz, which English kept whole as white. Then blank, a German word for shining, went the other way: it became the word for WHITE in French, Italian and Portuguese, pushing Latin albus out of everyday use. After nineteen chapters of German buying words from Rome, this is the chapter where Rome's daughters buy from German.*

20.1 schwarz — "black"

Four colours are coming, and not one of them was borrowed. That is rarer than it sounds.

You'll want to know: schwarz

schwarz — "black."

One word, two consonant clusters, and no Latin in sight. German's colour vocabulary is **home-grown**: where the months came in wholesale from Latin, the colours stayed Germanic.

Sounds you'll need

- `schw-cluster` — *sch* is English *sh*, and the *w* after it is a *v*. So the word opens *shv-*, which English never does at the start of a word. Take it slowly: *sh* … *v* … and then run them together.
- `z-ts` — a German *z* is always *ts*, never English *z*. The word ends *-arts*.

Put together: *SHVARTS*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the opening cluster alone — "shv, shv"
- "schwarz" — *SHVARTS*
- the two clusters apart, then together — "shv … arts … schwarz"

Twice through: "schwarz, schwarz."

Before you move on

Say "black." (**Schwarz**.) How does the word open? (***Shv-*** — *sch* plus a *w* that is a *v*.) How is a German *z* sounded? (**Ts**.) Was it borrowed from Latin? (**No** — the colours are inherited.) Next: the English cousin it left behind.

20.2 schwarz, taken apart

English has this word too. It has been reduced to one dusty corner of the dictionary.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schwarz comes from Germanic **swartaz*. English inherited the same word — and then *black* took over the everyday job, leaving the old one alive in exactly one place:

swarthy — "dark-complexioned"

That is *schwarz*, worn down and pushed to the edge. Say the pair aloud and the family shows: *schwarz* · *swarthy*.
Further back there is a Latin relative, and it is not flattering. The root behind **swartaz* also gave Latin *sordēs*, "**dirt**" — which English took as **sordid**. Black and grubby turn out to be one idea seen twice: the colour of soot, and the state of being covered in it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — "schwarz, swarthy"
- the Latin relative — "sordēs, sordid"
- the idea they share — "the colour, and being covered in it"

Twice through: "schwarz, swarthy."

Before you move on

Which English word is *schwarz*'s cousin? (***Swarthy***.) What does it mean? (**Dark-complexioned**.) Which English word comes from the Latin relative? (***Sordid***, from *sordēs* "dirt".) Next: the second colour, and the letter that only German has.

20.3 weiß — "white"

Black's opposite, and the first ordinary word in this book that needs the letter you were shown back in the writing chapter.

You'll want to know: weiß

weiß — "white."

Three letters and every one of them is a trap for an English eye. It is pronounced, near enough, like English **vice**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

weiß ← Old High German *wīz* ← Proto-Germanic **hwītaz* — inherited, the same word as English *white*, with German *ß* where English kept *t*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `w-is-v` — German *w* is English *v*. The word opens *v*-.
- `diphthong-ei` — German *ei* is the vowel of English *eye*. Never "ee".
- `ss-eszett-long` — and here is the **ß**, doing exactly what you were told it does: marking a sharp *s* after a **long** vowel. You met that in the writing chapter with nothing to spend it on. *Ei* is long, so the *s* is written **ß** and sounded sharp. This is the word that spends it.

So *weiß* rhymes with **vice** — not with the second half of *vice versa*, where the *s* is soft.
You already know what Switzerland does with that letter, and *weiß* is the word where you will see it: Swiss German writes **weiss**, with the ß spelled out.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "weiß" — like English *vice*
- the pair — "schwarz, weiß"
- the rule out loud — "long vowel, sharp s, written ß"

Twice through: "schwarz, weiß."

Before you move on

Say "white." (**Weiß**.) Which English word does it rhyme with? (***Vice***.) Why is the *s* written **ß**? (**The vowel before it is long**.) How does Switzerland write it? (***Weiss***.) Next: the English word it is, under the spelling.

20.4 weiß, taken apart

Schwarz needed a fossil to show its English cousin. This one needs nothing.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Weiß comes from Germanic **hwītaz*, and so does English **white**. Not a cousin, not a borrowing — the **same word**, and neither language moved its meaning by a hair.
What separates them is spelling and nothing else:

	German	**English**
the vowel	*ei*	*i*
the sharp *s*	**ß**	*t* plus a silent *e*

That is the whole distance. *Weiß* and *white* look unrelated on the page and are identical underneath, which is a useful warning about judging these pairs by eye: **schwarz**/*swarthy* looked close and had drifted in meaning, while *weiß*/*white* looks distant and has not drifted at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — "weiß, white"
- the ancestor — "hwītaz"
- both colours and both cousins — "schwarz swarthy, weiß white"

Twice through: "weiß, white — one word."

Before you move on

Which English word is *weiß*? (***White*** — the same word.) Did its meaning drift? (**No**.) Which of this chapter's two pairs drifted in meaning? (***Schwarz***/*swarthy*.) Next: a German colour word the Romance languages took.

20.5 blank — "shiny"

A word that looks English, is German, and means neither of the things you would guess.

You'll want to know: blank

blank — "shiny," "polished," "bare."

Not "blank" in the English sense of empty-of-writing, and **not** a colour. A polished shoe is *blank*; a bare sword is *blank*. The idea underneath is **shining**.

Hold on to that meaning exactly as it is, because the next lesson is about what happened when the neighbours borrowed it and let it drift.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

blank ← Old High German *blanc*, "shining, bright" ← Proto-Germanic **blankaz* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) French *blanc*, "white", was borrowed from the Germanic word.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-a` — short and clipped, the *a* of English *hat*.
- `ng-cluster` — the *-nk* closes with the back-of-the-mouth *n* that English puts in *bank*, and then a real *k*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "blank" — shiny, not empty
- what it is not — "not a colour"
- the three colours so far and the odd one out — "schwarz, weiß … blank"

Twice through: "blank — shiny."

Before you move on

What does *blank* mean in German? (**Shiny, polished, bare**.) Is it a colour? (**No**.) Does it mean English "blank"? (**No**.) Next: what the Romance languages did with it.

20.6 The word that emigrated

Blank means shining. In three languages next door, it means **white**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

In its Frankish form *blank*, "shining," this word was **borrowed into Romance**. Once there it stopped meaning shiny and started meaning white — and it displaced Latin's own word for white, *albus*, almost entirely:

language	**"white"**
French	**blanc**
Italian	**bianco**
Portuguese	**branco**
German	*blank* — still only "**shiny**"

Latin's *albus* survives in English only in learned scraps: *albino*, *album* (originally a white tablet), *albumen*. The everyday Romance word for the commonest colour there is came **from Germanic**.

Why it's said this way

This runs **against the usual current**. Almost everywhere else in this book the lending goes the other way: Latin hands words to Germanic, and German takes them. *Wein* came from Latin *vīnum*; the month names came over wholesale and are still Latin under a German spelling. Here, once, Germanic did the lending — and the two sides then went different ways with it. German kept the original sense and never made it a colour; the borrowers made it a colour and let the shine fall away. A word does not carry its meaning with it when it crosses a border. It carries only its sound, and the new language decides the rest.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three borrowers — "blanc, bianco, branco"
- the German original — "blank, and it still means shiny"
- the direction — "Germanic lent this one; usually Latin lends"

Twice through: "blank, blanc — one word, two meanings."

Before you move on

Which three Romance words came from *blank*? (**Blanc, bianco, branco**.) Which Latin word did they push out? (***Albus***.) Does German *blank* mean white? (**No** — still shiny.) Which way does the lending usually run? (**Latin to Germanic** — as with *Wein* and the month names.) Next: the two colours together.

20.7 Practice — black, white, and the one that left

No new words. Two colours, three words, and two families that behaved in opposite ways.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

German	where it came from	what English or Romance did with it
schwarz	Germanic **swartaz*	English kept it only in *swarthy*
weiß	Germanic **hwītaz*	English kept it whole, as *white*
blank	Frankish *blank*	Romance took it and made it *white*

Three words, three fates: one nearly lost, one perfectly preserved, one emigrated and changed job.
You cannot put these into a sentence yet — German needs a verb for that and it is still several chapters away. Bank the words; the sentence comes later.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the two colours — "schwarz, weiß"
- them with their English cousins — "schwarz swarthy, weiß white"

- the emigrant and its children — "blank; blanc, bianco, branco"
- the three fates — "kept, lost, emigrated"

Twice through: "schwarz, weiß, blank."

Before you move on

Say both colours. (**Schwarz, weiß**.) Which one is the same word as its English cousin? (***Weiß***/*white*.) Which survives in English only as *swarthy*? (***Schwarz***.) Which German word became "white" abroad? (***Blank***.) Why is *weiß* written with **ß**? (**Long vowel before a sharp s**.) Next: the other two colours, and a cousin that is not a borrowing.

Chapter 21

An Ancient Cousin and a Second Emigrant

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say red and blue in German, and say which of them Romance borrowed.
>
> *The second half of the same argument, with a twist in each colour. rot is Germanic raudaz and goes back to one of the oldest reconstructable colour words – and Latin ruber is its COUSIN rather than its source, so the resemblance is inheritance from far enough back that neither borrowed. blau is the second emigrant: Germanic blewaz went into French as bleu, and English then borrowed its own blue back from French rather than keeping the word it had inherited.*

21.1 rot — "red"

> You have black and white. The next colour is not a matter of taste — languages the world over reach for the same one third.

You'll want to know: rot

> **rot** — "red."

Three letters, one syllable, and very close to the English word underneath the spelling.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rot ← Old High German *rōt* ← Proto-Germanic **raudaz* — inherited, the same word as English *red*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `long-o` — the *o* is **long**, the vowel of English *road*, not the short *o* of *rot*. The German word does not rhyme with the English word spelled the same way.
- `d-t-final` — the closing *t* is crisp and fully released: *roht*.

Why it's said this way

If a language has only two colour words, they are dark and light. If it has a third, it is **red** — before green, before blue, before yellow. That holds across unrelated families on every continent, which is why *schwarz*, *weiß* and *rot* are the three this chapter and the last one reach for first.
Blood and fire are the guess most people make, and it may be right; what is certain is the order, not the reason.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "rot" — long *o*, as in *road*
- the three in order — "schwarz, weiß, rot"
- the warning — "rot does not rhyme with English *rot*"

Twice through: "rot, rot — roht."

Before you move on

Say "red." (**Rot**.) Is the *o* long or short? (**Long** — as in *road*.) Which colour do languages name third? (**Red**.) And the first two? (**Dark and light** — black and white.) Next: the cousin it has in French, and why it is not a borrowing.

21.2 rot, taken apart

The last lesson had a German word the Romance languages borrowed. This one has a German word they did **not** borrow — and they have it anyway.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Rot comes from Germanic **raudaz*, and behind that from Proto-Indo-European **h₁rewdʰ-* — one of the oldest colour words that can be reconstructed at all. It went everywhere:

language	what it became
German	**rot**
English	**red**, and *rust*, *ruddy*
Latin	*ruber*, *rubeus* — and so French **rouge**, plus *ruby*, *rubric*

So *rot* and *rouge* are **cousins, not borrowings**. They did not pass from one language to the other; they split apart thousands of years before either language existed, and each walked its own road to a word for red.

That is a different relationship from the one *blank* has with *blanc*. There, a word crossed a border within recorded history. Here, two words inherited the same ancestor and never met again.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the family — "rot, red, rouge"
- the English extras — "rust, ruddy"
- the two relationships — "blank and blanc: borrowed. Rot and rouge: cousins."

Twice through: "rot, red, rouge."

Before you move on

Which French word is *rot*'s relative? (***Rouge***.) Did French borrow it from German? (**No** — they are cousins.) Which Latin word is in the

line? (***Ruber***.) Name two English words from the same root besides *red*. (***Rust***, ***ruddy***.) Next: the fourth colour, which **was** borrowed.

21.3 blau — "blue"

The fourth and last colour of the set — and the second one German lent abroad.

You'll want to know: blau

blau — "blue."

Four letters, one syllable, and the vowel is the trap.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

blau ← Middle High German *blā* (EtymDB 2.1), from Proto-Germanic **blēwaz*, "blue" — inherited. English *blue* is the same Germanic word, brought back through French.

Sounds you'll need

- `diphthong-au` — German *au* is the vowel of English *house* or *cow*. It is **not** the *aw* of *law* and not the *oo* of *blue*.

So *blau* rhymes with English **cow**: *blow* as in *plough*, never *blow* as in *blew*.
That one vowel is what stops an English speaker recognising the word by ear even though it is the same word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "blau" — rhyming with *cow*
- the wrong one, then the right one — "not *bloo* … *blau*"
- all four — "schwarz, weiß, rot, blau"

Twice through: "blau, blau — rhymes with *cow*."

Before you move on

Say "blue." (**Blau**.) Which English word does it rhyme with? (***Cow***.) Does it rhyme with *blue*? (**No**.) Say all four colours. (**Schwarz, weiß, rot, blau**.) Next: the journey this word took, and the odd route English used to get it back.

21.4 blau, taken apart

Blank emigrated. So did this one — and then English did something strange to get it back.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Blau comes from Germanic **blēwaz*, and like *blank* before it, this word was **borrowed into Romance**:

language	**"blue"**
German	**blau**
French	**bleu**
Italian	**blu**
English	**blue** — taken from **French**, not from Germanic

Go over that last row twice. English is Germanic. It had inherited **blēwaz* itself — the word was already sitting in Old English — and it borrowed the French form anyway.

So the word went **Germanic** → **French** → **English**, and arrived home wearing Romance clothes. English *blue* is a German word that took the long way round and is no longer recognisable as one — which is exactly why *blau* does not sound like *blue*.

Why it's said this way

Portuguese went somewhere else entirely: its blue is **azul**, from **Arabic**. One colour, and within a few hundred miles you can find a Germanic word, a Germanic word laundered through French, and an Arabic one.

Colour words travel more than almost any other kind, because they are easy to borrow: you can point at the thing. Verbs and grammar stay home; the names of shades move with cloth, dye and trade.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the family — "blau, bleu, blu"
- the long way round — "Germanic, French, English"
- the outlier — "azul, from Arabic"

Twice through: "blau, bleu, blue — one word, three stops."

Before you move on

Which two German colour words did Romance borrow? (***Blank* and *blau***.) Where did English get *blue* from? (**French** — not directly from Germanic.) Which language's blue is Arabic? (**Portuguese** — *azul*.) Next: all four colours, and what each of them did.

21.5 Practice — four colours, four histories

No new words. Four colours, and no two of them got where they are the same way.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

German	source	did Romance take it?
schwarz	Germanic **swartaz*	no
weiß	Germanic **hwītaz*	no — but *blank* went instead
rot	Germanic **raudaz*	no — Latin had its **own** cousin
blau	Germanic **blēwaz*	**yes** — *bleu*, *blu*

Four native Germanic words and not a Latin borrowing among them, which is worth saying plainly: German did not get its colours from Rome. Two of them went the other way.

And the "no" in row three is a different kind of no from the ones above it. *Schwarz* and *weiß* stayed home. *Rot* has a Romance relative anyway — because Latin inherited the same ancient word rather than borrowing the German one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- all four — "schwarz, weiß, rot, blau"
- the two traps — "rot as *road*, blau as *cow*"
- the cousins that prove the family — "rot · red · rouge"
- the two that emigrated — "blank, blau"

Twice through: "schwarz, weiß, rot, blau."

Before you move on

Run the four colours. How many were borrowed from Latin? (**None**.) Which two did Romance take from German? (***Blank* and *blau***.) Is *rouge* a borrowing from *rot*? (**No** — a cousin.) Which English colour word came home through French? (***Blue***.)

Chapter 22

To Have

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (8) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can use every present form of German's verb for "to have", building the four the ending machine already gives me and knowing the two it gets wrong.
>
> *haben is the weak ending machine on the stem hab-, and the chapter is organised around where that machine fails: it predicts four of the six forms correctly, so those get one lesson that makes the reader build them rather than read them, and du hast and er hat get a lesson each because nothing generates them. The b-drop, the einen that Ich habe einen Bruder needs, and the habēre false cognate follow; the grid is printed only in the practice lesson.*

22.1 haben — "to have"

> German's workhorse verb, and the twin of a word you have said every day of your life.

You'll want to know: haben

> **haben** — "to have."

Same word as English *have*, worn differently. Chop the *-en* the way you did with *machen* and the stem is *hab-*, which is where every form in this chapter starts.

Two syllables, and the first one carries the weight: *HAH-ben*.

Sounds you'll need

- `long-a` — the *a* of *haben* is long and open, the vowel of English *father*, not the clipped *a* of *hat*.
- `d-t-final` — that long *a* does **not** survive into every form. Two of them coming up are short and clipped, and both end in a crisp, fully released *t*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "haben" — long *a*, soft second syllable
- the stem on its own — "hab-"
- the twins — "haben, have"

Twice through: "haben, haben — to have."

Before you move on

Say "to have." (**Haben**.) What is its stem? (***Hab-***.) Is the *a* long or short? (**Long** — as in *father*.) Which English verb is it? (***Have***.) Next: the stem through the ending machine you already own.

22.2 hab- through the machine

You own an ending machine: a stem, and *-e*, *-st*, *-t*, *-en*. Run *hab-* through it before reading on, and keep what you get.

Grammar Lens: four forms you already knew

On *hab-*, the machine is **right four times out of six**.

Ich takes *-e*, so *ich* **habe**. *Wir* takes *-en*, so *wir* **haben** — which is the infinitive over again, the way the *wir* form goes throughout German. *Ihr* takes *-t*, so *ihr* **habt**. And *sie* takes *-en* like *wir*, so *sie* **haben**. Nothing there is new. Those four are the rule from your first verbs applied to one more stem — so do not read them off the page. Take each ending, put it on *hab-*, and hear that you already knew the answer.

The chapter is about the other two.

Your turn

Build each one before you say it — take the ending first, then put it on *hab-*. Say these aloud:

- the ending *ich* takes, then the form — "-e … ich habe"
- the ending *wir* takes, then the form — "-en … wir haben"
- the ending *ihr* takes, then the form — "-t … ihr habt"
- *sie* borrows *wir*'s ending — "sie haben"
- now prove the machine is not about this verb — run *wohn-* through it: "ich wohne, wir wohnen, ihr wohnt"

Twice through: "ich habe, wir haben, ihr habt, sie haben."

Before you move on

Build "we have" without being given it. (**Wir haben**.) Build "you all have." (**Ihr habt**.) Which other form does *wir haben* match? (**The infinitive**.) Did you have to learn any of those four, or work them out? (**Work them out** — the endings were already yours.) How many of the six does the rule get right? (**Four**.) Next: the first one it gets wrong.

22.3 du hast — "you have"

The machine says *du* plus *-st* on the stem *hab-*. Say what that would give, and then hear what German actually says.

You'll want to know: du hast

du hast — "you have," to one person you are on familiar terms with.

The rule predicts *hab-st*. German says **hast**. The *b* is simply gone, and the long *a* goes with it: the vowel is short and clipped now, and the *-st* lands crisply on the end.

This is not a spelling convenience. It is one of exactly two places in the whole verb where the machine fails, and it is worth meeting on its own so that it is a form you know rather than a form you derive wrongly.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hast is a form of *haben* ← Old High German *habēn* ← Proto-Germanic **habjanǫ* — inherited, the same verb as English *have*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-a` — short and clipped, the *a* of English *hat*, not the long *a* of *haben*. The form is one syllable: *hast*, rhyming with English *mast*.
- `d-t-final` — the *-st* is fully released; German does not soften it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "du hast"
- the long against the short — "ich habe, du hast"
- what the rule wanted, then what German says — "hab-st … hast"

Twice through: "du hast, du hast."

Before you move on

Say "you have," informally. (**Du hast**.) Which letter went missing? (**The b**.) What happened to the vowel? (**It shortened**.) What would the rule have predicted? (***Hab-st***.) Next: the second place the machine fails, and it fails the same way.

22.4 er hat — "he has"

One more break, and then the verb behaves for good. The machine says *-t* on *hab-*.

You'll want to know: er hat

er hat — "he has." Also *sie hat*, "she has," and *es hat*, "it has."

The rule predicts *hab-t*. German says **hat**: the same *b* gone, the same vowel shortened. One syllable, rhyming with English *hut* rather than *hat* — the German *a* sits further back than the English one.

One form covers *er*, *sie* and *es*, exactly as the third-person *-t* always does. So the two breaks in this verb are neighbours: *du* **hast**, *er* **hat**, and every other form is the machine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hat is a form of *haben* ← Old High German *habēn* ← Proto-Germanic **habjanǫ* — inherited, the same verb as English *have*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "er hat, sie hat, es hat"
- the two breaks together — "du hast, er hat"
- the whole shape — "habe … hast … hat … haben"

Twice through: "du hast, er hat."

Before you move on

Say "he has." (**Er hat**.) Say "she has." (**Sie hat**.) Which two forms of this verb break the rule? (***Hast* and *hat***.) What do both of them drop? (**The b**.) Next: why they drop it, and the English verb that does the identical thing.

22.5 The b that fell out

Hast and *hat* both lost a *b*. That is not two accidents.

Grammar Lens: one shortcut, in exactly two cells

> *Haben* keeps its **b** everywhere except before a *-st* or a *-t* ending, where the *b* drops and the vowel shortens with it.

Say *hab-st* and *hab-t* at speed and you can feel why: a *b* squeezed between a vowel and a hard *t* is work, and centuries of speakers declined to do it. The consonant wore away and the two shortest forms are what is left.
Now listen to English, which is the same verb:

person	**English**	**German**
infinitive	*have*	*haben*
second person, older	*thou ha**st***	*du ha**st***
third person	*he ha**s***	*er ha**t***

English lost the same consonant, in the same two cells, of the same verb — and kept the archaic *hast* long enough for us to see it. Two languages, one shortcut, inherited together rather than invented twice.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- where the b survives — "habe, haben, habt"
- where it does not — "hast, hat"
- the English echo — "thou hast, du hast; he has, er hat"

Twice through: "hast, hat — no b."

Before you move on

In which two forms does the *b* drop? (***Hast* and *hat***.) What else changes with it? (**The vowel shortens**.) Which English form still shows the same loss? (***He has*** — or archaic ***thou hast***.) Next: something to actually have.

22.6 einen — "a," when it is the thing you have

> *Ich habe …* wants something after it. The commonest thing to put there is "a something," and German asks one small question

first.

You'll want to know: einen

einen — "a," for a **der**-word that is the thing you have.

Ein is the number *one* doing a second job, which is exactly what English *a* is — a worn-down *one*. German keeps the resemblance visible: *ein*, *eins*.

The *-en* on the end is the part English threw away. German marks a *der*-word differently when it is the thing being had rather than the thing doing the having, and *einen* is that marked form:

Ich habe einen Bruder. — "I have a brother."

Der Bruder is a *der*-word, and he is what you have, so *ein* becomes *einen*. Nothing else in the sentence moves.

Take this one as a word for now, not as a system. The system behind it — German's cases — gets a chapter of its own later; this is the first place the book cannot avoid it, because a sentence with *haben* in it needs something to have.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

einen is a form of *ein* ← Old High German *ein* ← Proto-Germanic **ainaz*, "one" — inherited, the same word as English *one*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "einen"
- "Ich habe einen Bruder."
- it with the two broken forms — "du hast einen Bruder; er hat einen Bruder"

Twice through: "Ich habe einen Bruder."

Before you move on

Say "I have a brother." (**Ich habe einen Bruder**.) Which word did *ein* become? (***Einen***.) Why? (**Because *der Bruder* is the thing being had**.) Which English word is *ein* underneath? (***One***.) Next: the trap this verb is famous for.

22.7 haben is not habēre

German *haben*, Latin *habēre*. Same consonants, same meaning, and the best false cognate in the business.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Two verbs that look like one word:

language	verb	meaning
German	**haben**	to have
Latin	**habēre**	to have

They are not related. It is a coincidence, and one of the most famous in linguistics. Follow each one back and they go in opposite directions.

Haben comes from Germanic **habjaną*, from Proto-Indo-European **kap-*, "**to seize**." That root's Latin child is *capere* — which is where English gets **capture**, **captive**, **capable** and **accept**.

Habēre comes from a different root entirely, **$g^h ab^h$-*, and its English descendant is … **give**.

So German *haben* is a cousin of *capture*, and Latin *habēre* — the source of French *avoir* and Italian *avere* — is a cousin of *give*. Seizing and giving, which is about as far apart as two verbs get.

Why it's said this way

This is worth carrying beyond one verb. Resemblance is not evidence. Two words can match in sound and sense and still have nothing to do with each other, and the only way to tell is to follow both back rather than to compare them where they stand.

Most of this book's cousin pairs are real. This one is the control that proves the others were checked.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair that is not a pair — "haben, habēre"
- where German's goes — "haben, kap-, capture"
- where Latin's goes — "habēre, $g^{h}ab^{h}$-, give"

Twice through: "haben is not habēre."

Before you move on

Are *haben* and *habēre* related? (**No** — a coincidence.) Which English word is *haben*'s cousin? (***Capture***, from *capere*.) And *habēre*'s? (***Give***.) What did *haben*'s root originally mean? ("**To seize**.") Next: the whole verb, said through.

22.8 Practice — the whole of haben

No new words. Four of the six forms below cost you nothing, and the other two have each had a lesson, so this is the first place it is safe to set them out together.

Grammar Lens: the six, assembled

singular	**plural**
ich **habe**	wir **haben**
du **hast**	ihr **habt**
er/sie/es **hat**	sie/Sie **haben**

Run it aloud and hear where the *b* goes missing: *habe* … **hast** … **hat** … *haben*. Four forms carry it, two do not, and the two that do not are the two shortest.

The exchange

German	English
Hast du einen Bruder?	Do you have a brother?
Und du?	And you?
Ich habe eine Schwester.	I have a sister.
Wir haben Brot und Wein.	We have bread and wine.
Gut! Dann haben wir alles.	Good! Then we have everything.

Two things slip in without lessons of their own, because the translation carries them: **eine**, which is what *ein* becomes for a *die*-word, and **alles** ("everything"). And notice *Hast du …?* — a question puts the verb first, which is the one move German makes that English needs *do* for.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the six in order — "habe, hast, hat, haben, habt, haben"
- the two breaks alone — "hast, hat"
- "Ich habe einen Bruder." "Wir haben Brot und Wein."
- the whole exchange, both voices

Twice through: "habe, hast, hat, haben, habt, haben."

Before you move on

Run the six without looking. Which two drop the *b*? (***Hast* and *hat***.) Say "I have a brother." (**Ich habe einen Bruder**.) Is *haben* related to Latin *habēre*? (**No**.) Which English word is it related to? (***Capture***.) Next: the one everyday sentence where German refuses this verb altogether.

Chapter 23

The Wrapped Participle

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (8) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can turn any regular German verb I know into its past participle, and hear that the marking arrives at both ends of the word at once.
>
> *The weak participle is a circumfix, so it is met as one concrete word first — gesagt — and only then as the recipe behind it. Three more verbs run through that recipe one at a time, the ge- gets its own lesson because it is the half English threw away, and the infinitive-to-participle table appears only at the end, where it recaps six lessons instead of introducing four words.*

23.1 sagen — "to say"

> One more weak verb before the past tense starts, and it is the verb the whole chapter will be built on.

You'll want to know: sagen

> **sagen** — "to say."

Two syllables, *ZAH-gen*. It behaves like *machen* and *lernen* in every respect: chop the *-en* and you have the stem *sag-*, and onto that stem go the endings you already own — *ich* ***sage***, *du* ***sagst***.

Nothing new is happening in those endings. *Sagen* is here so that when the past tense arrives in the next lesson, the only unfamiliar thing in it is the past.

Sounds you'll need

- `long-a` — the *a* of *sagen* is long and open, the vowel of English *father*, not the clipped *a* of *hat*.
- `ge-prefix` — the *-gen* at the end is unstressed and swallowed, a soft *gn* more than a full syllable. The same mumble will open every participle in this chapter, so it is worth getting comfortable now.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Sagen is the same word as English *say*. Germanic **sagjanǫ* went to both, and then English quietly dropped the *g* out of the middle:

German	English
sagen	**say**
Tag	**day**
Weg	**way**

Three pairs, one habit. Whenever a German *g* sits between vowels or at the end of a short word, English is likely to have thinned it to a *y* sound — so a German *g* you cannot place is often an English *y* in disguise.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "sagen" — long *a*, soft ending
- "ich sage, du sagst, wir sagen"
- the three pairs — "sagen–say, Tag–day, Weg–way"

Twice through: "sagen, sagen — to say."

Before you move on

Say "to say." (**Sagen**.) Say "I say." (**Ich sage**.) Is the *a* long or short? (**Long** — as in *father*.) Which English word is *sagen*? (**Say**.) Next: what happens to this verb when the saying is already over.

23.2 gesagt — "said"

You have *sagen*. Now the form German uses when the saying is already finished — and it is longer at **both** ends than the word it came from.

You'll want to know: gesagt

gesagt — "said."

Hear where it grew. *Sag-* is still sitting in the middle, untouched. In front of it a *ge-* has appeared; behind it the *-en* has gone and a *-t* has taken its place:

sagen — **ge**-*sag*-**t**

That is the word English calls a **past participle**: the form that goes with *have* in *I have said*. German's has a hat on as well as boots.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gesagt is *ge-* + the stem of *sagen* + *-t*. *sagen* ← Old High German *sagēn* ← Proto-Germanic **sagjanǫ*, the same verb as English *say*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `ge-prefix` — unstressed, almost swallowed: *guh*, never *gay*. The stress stays on *sagt*, exactly where it was in *sagen*.
- `final-t` — the closing *t* is crisp and fully released. The *g* in front of it hardens to a *k* on the way out, the same hardening you met when *und* came out as *unt*: say *guh-ZAHKT*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "gesagt" — soft opening, hard ending
- the pair — "sagen, gesagt"
- the three pieces — "ge, sag, t"

Twice through: "sagen, gesagt. Sagen, gesagt."

Before you move on

Say "said." (**Gesagt**.) Which part of *sagen* survives inside it? (**Sag-**, the stem.) What appeared in front? (**Ge-**.) What replaced the *-en*? (**-t**.) Next: the same two additions, on any weak verb you like.

23.3 ge-…-t — the wrap that makes a participle

Sagen, *gesagt*. One verb did that; the recipe behind it works on every regular verb you own.

Grammar Lens: ge- in front, -t behind

Take a regular verb. Strip the *-en*. Put **ge-** in front of what is left and **-t** on the end.

That is the whole operation for the regular verbs — the ones grammarians call **weak**, because they build their past out of endings rather than by changing the vowel inside.
The thing worth noticing is that the ending has a beginning. English marks its participle in one place: *walk* becomes *walk-**ed***, and the front of the word sits untouched. German marks it in two, one piece of grammar arriving at both ends of the stem at once.
Grammar has a name for a piece that wraps like that: a **circumfix**. It is not a prefix plus a suffix that happen to co-occur — neither half means anything without the other. **Gesag* is not a word, and **sagt* on its own is "he says." Only both together make "said."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the recipe — "ge in front, t behind"
- the wrap on its own — "ge … t"
- "sagen, gesagt" and hear both ends move

Twice through: "ge- in front, -t behind."

Before you move on

Which two pieces make a weak participle? (**Ge-** in front, **-t** behind.) What is a piece of grammar that wraps a word called? (A **circumfix**.) Where does English put its own participle marker? (**Only at the end** — *walked*.) Build the participle of *sagen*. (**Gesagt**.) Next: the same wrap on a verb you met long before this one.

23.4 gemacht — "made," "done"

You know the recipe. Run it on *machen* before reading on: strip the *-en*, wrap what is left.

You'll want to know: gemacht

gemacht — "made," and also "done."

Machen gives up its *-en*, leaving *mach-*. The wrap goes round it and out comes *gemacht*. No stem was harmed: the *a* is the same *a*, and the *ch* is the same *ch*.

German uses this one participle where English chooses between two different words. *Ich habe das gemacht* is "I made that" and "I did that" alike; German never had to pick.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gemacht is *ge-* + the stem of *machen* + *-t*. *machen* is the same verb as English *make*, which EtymDB 2.1 traces to Proto-Germanic **makōną*.

Sounds you'll need

- `ch-ach` — after *a*, *o* or *u*, German *ch* is the scrape at the back of the throat, the sound in *Bach* and in *Nacht*. It sits in the middle of *gemacht* untouched.
- `final-t` — and the *t* on the end is crisp: *guh-MAHKHT*, three consonants landing together at the finish.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "machen, gemacht"
- both participles together — "gesagt, gemacht"
- one word for two English ones — "made, done — gemacht"

Twice through: "machen, gemacht."

Before you move on

Build the participle of *machen*. (**Gemacht**.) Which two English words does it cover? (**Made** and **done**.) What happened to the *ch* on the way? (**Nothing** — the wrap only touches the edges.) Next: the verb you have been doing to German itself.

23.5 gelernt — "learned"

Third time through the recipe, and this one describes what you have been doing since page one.

You'll want to know: gelernt

gelernt — "learned."

Lernen loses its *-en*, leaving *lern-*; the wrap closes round it. The English cousin is doing the very same job with the very same stem — *learn*, *learned* — and differs only in where the marking sits. German puts a piece at each end; English puts both pieces at the back.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gelernt is *ge-* + the stem of *lernen* + *-t*. *lernen* ← Middle High German *lernen* ← Old High German *lernēn* (EtymDB 2.1), a cousin of English *learn*.

Sounds you'll need

- `r-uvular-german` — the *r* inside *gelernt* is made at the back of the mouth and, before a consonant, is barely a consonant at all: it colours the vowel more than it rolls. *Guh-LEHRNT*, with the *r* almost swallowed.
- `final-t` — *-nt* at the end, both consonants sounded, the *t*

released.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "lernen, gelernt"
- the English twin — "learn, learned; lernen, gelernt"
- all three so far — "gesagt, gemacht, gelernt"

Twice through: "lernen, gelernt."

Before you move on

Build the participle of *lernen*. (**Gelernt**.) Which English verb is its twin? (**Learn**.) Where does English put its marking? (**All of it at the end**.) Next: the fourth verb, and the last one before the recipe is yours.

23.6 gewohnt — "lived"

Fourth and last of the four. Run the recipe on *wohnen* yourself first.

You'll want to know: gewohnt

gewohnt — "lived," in the sense of dwelt somewhere.

Wohn- takes the wrap and nothing else changes. Four verbs, four participles, one recipe: it has not bent once.

Sounds you'll need

- `w-is-v` — the *w* buried in the middle is a German *w*, which is English *v*. *Guh-VOHNT*.
- `final-t` — *-nt* to close, exactly as in *gelernt*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wohnen began by meaning something closer to "to be accustomed" than "to reside," and *gewohnt* still carries that older sense alongside the newer one: in modern German it is also the ordinary word for *used to something*.
English kept the same word and only the old meaning:

word	meaning
German **gewohnt**	lived; accustomed
English **wont**	accustomed, as in *he was wont to sing*

Two languages split one word between them — Germany took the address and England took the habit. *Wohnen* ← Old High German *wonēn* ← Proto-Germanic **wunjanǫ*, "to be wont; to dwell" (EtymDB 2.1).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "wohnen, gewohnt" — with a *v* in the middle
- the fossil — "gewohnt, wont"
- the whole set — "gesagt, gemacht, gelernt, gewohnt"

Twice through: "wohnen, gewohnt."

Before you move on

Build the participle of *wohnen*. (**Gewohnt**.) How is the *w* sounded? (**Like English v**.) Which English word preserves its older sense? (***Wont*** — accustomed.) Next: where that *ge-* came from, and the English word still hiding it.

23.7 The ge- that English lost

Four participles, four *ge*-s. That syllable is not decoration, and English used to have it too.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

German *ge-* comes from Germanic **ga-*, a prefix meaning "**together, completely**." Its job was to mark an action as **finished** — what grammarians call *perfective* — which is exactly the work a past participle does. A finished saying is *gesagt*.
English inherited the same prefix and spelled it *y-*. Chaucer still wrote it. Then English let it go, and two fossils were left behind with the prefix welded on:

English word	**what is hiding inside**
enough	Old English *ge*nōg — "completely sufficient"
yclept (archaic, "named")	*ge*cleopod — "called," finished and done

Say the German wrap out loud — *ge-sag-t* — and then the English fossil: *en-ough*, from *genōg*. It is the same syllable, worn down to a vowel and carried inside a word nobody thinks of as a participle at all. So English once wrapped its participles the same way German still does. German simply never stopped.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- what it meant — "together, completely"
- the fossil — "enough, from genōg"
- four finished actions — "gesagt, gemacht, gelernt, gewohnt"

Twice through: "ge- means completely."

Before you move on

What did *ge-* originally mean? ("**Completely**," marking an action finished.) How did English spell the same prefix? (***Y-***.) Which everyday English word still carries it? (***Enough***, from *genōg*.) And the archaic one? (***Yclept***.) Next: the four participles side by side, and then the verb that puts them to work.

23.8 Practice — four verbs, one wrap

No new words. Every participle here has had its own lesson, so this is the first place they are safe to put side by side — as a recap of work already done, not as a list to swallow.

Grammar Lens: the four, assembled

infinitive	**participle**
sagen	**ge**sag**t**
machen	**ge**mach**t**
lernen	**ge**lern**t**
wohnen	**ge**wohn**t**

Cover: the right-hand side, and rebuild it from the left
Cover: the left, and work backwards
Given *gemacht*, what was the infinitive? The recipe runs both ways, which is what makes it worth having.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the four in order — "gesagt, gemacht, gelernt, gewohnt"
- the four infinitives back — "sagen, machen, lernen, wohnen"
- the recipe out loud — "ge in front, t behind"
- the fossil — "enough, from genōg"

Twice through: "gesagt, gemacht, gelernt, gewohnt."

Before you move on

Run the four participles without prompting. Which infinitive gives *gemacht*? (***Machen***.) What are the two pieces of the wrap? (**Ge-** and **-t**.) What did the front piece originally mean? ("**Completely**.") Next: the verb that carries all four of these into a sentence.

Chapter 24

The Past Built From Have

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (9) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 9 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I did in German — haben in second place, the participle waiting at the end of the clause — and read it as a plain past rather than as "have done".
>
> *The Perfekt is haben plus a participle, and its cost is the four person slots rather than the recipe: ich habe, du hast, er hat, wir haben each get their own lesson before any of them share a page. The bracket that leaves the participle stranded at the end of the clause gets one of its own too, then gestern to fill the gap it opens, and finally the translation trap — ich habe gesagt is "I said".*

24.1 haben plus a participle — the everyday past

A participle on its own says nothing about who or when. It needs a partner, and German picks the same partner English does.

Grammar Lens: the recipe

haben, conjugated for whoever did it, plus the **participle**.

That two-part past has a name in German: the ***Perfekt***. *Haben* carries everything that changes — the person, and the fact that this is a finished action — while the participle sits there in one shape for everybody. Only one of the two words has to agree with anything, which is why the *Perfekt* costs far less to learn than its size suggests. English assembled the identical machine out of the identical parts: a verb meaning "have," plus a finished-action participle. *I have said* and

ich habe gesagt line up word for word. The next few lessons take *haben*'s forms one at a time and hang a participle off each.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the recipe — "haben, conjugated, plus the participle"
- the name — "das Perfekt"
- which half moves — "haben changes, the participle does not"

Twice through: "haben plus participle."

Before you move on

Which two pieces make the *Perfekt*? (**Haben** plus the **participle**.) Which of the two changes for the person? (***Haben***.) Which English tense is built the same way? (**I have said** — *have* plus a participle.) Next: the first person, and the first whole sentence about the past.

24.2 ich habe gesagt — "I said"

The recipe, filled in for the person you talk about most.

You'll want to know: ich habe gesagt

ich habe gesagt — "I said."

Three words, three jobs. *Ich* is who; *habe* is the form of *haben* that goes with *ich*; *gesagt* is what happened. Nothing here is new except the way the last two sit together.

Say it as one run rather than three separate words. The stress lands on *gesagt*, and *habe* shrinks in ordinary speech to something close to *hab*: *ich HAB gezahkt*. That contraction is not sloppy — it is how the sentence sounds when a German says it at speed.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ich habe gesagt — *habe* ← Old High German *habēn* ← Proto-Germanic **habjanǫ*, English *have*; *gesagt* from *sagēn*, English *say*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `ich-laut` — *ich* still ends in the soft breathy sound from the very first chapter, not a *k*.
- `ge-prefix` — and the *ge-* that follows two words later is just as soft. The sentence has two unstressed mumbles in it and one loud syllable.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich habe gesagt"
- it at speed — "ich hab gesagt"
- the English beside it — "I said; ich habe gesagt"

Twice through: "ich habe gesagt, ich habe gesagt."

Before you move on

Say "I said." (**Ich habe gesagt**.) Which word carries the person? (***Habe***.) Which syllable is stressed? (***Sagt***.) Next: the same sentence, aimed at the person in front of you.

24.3 du hast gesagt — "you said"

Same sentence, different person — and *haben* loses a letter on the way.

You'll want to know: du hast gesagt

du hast gesagt — "you said," to one person you are on familiar terms with.

The *b* of *haben* has gone. Not worn away here and kept elsewhere — this is one of the two forms where German drops it, and you met both when you learned the verb.

English does exactly the same thing to exactly the same verb: *I have*, but *thou ha**st***, and still today *he ha**s***. Two languages, one shortcut, inherited together rather than invented twice.

The participle has not moved. *Gesagt* is *gesagt* whoever did the saying, so half of every sentence in this chapter is already yours.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

du hast gesagt — *hast* ← Old High German *habēn*, English *have*; *gesagt* ← Old High German *sagēn*, English *say*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "du hast gesagt"
- the pair — "ich habe gesagt, du hast gesagt"
- the English echo — "du hast, thou hast"

Twice through: "du hast gesagt."

Before you move on

Say "you said," informally. (**Du hast gesagt**.) Which letter of *haben* disappeared? (**The b**.) Which English form does the same? (***Thou hast***, and *he has*.) Did the participle change? (**No**.) Next: the same sentence about somebody else.

24.4 er hat das gemacht — "he did that"

Third person, and the first sentence in this chapter with a word standing between *haben* and the participle.

You'll want to know: er hat das gemacht

er hat das gemacht — "he did that."

Hat is the second of *haben*'s two *b*-less forms, the twin of English *has*. And *das*, the little word you met as an article, doubles as "that" — the thing he did.

Notice where it went. *Das* did not follow *gemacht*; it slipped in **before** it. The participle stayed at the far end of the sentence and let the rest of the words file in ahead of it. That is not a quirk of this one sentence, and the next lesson but one is about it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

er hat das gemacht — *hat* ← Old High German *habēn*, English *have*; *gemacht* is built on *machen*, the same verb as English *make*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `ch-ach` — the throat scrape is back, in the middle of *gemacht*.
- `final-t` — three of the four words in this sentence end in a *t*. Release each one; German does not let a final *t* go soft.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "er hat das gemacht"
- the b-less pair — "du hast, er hat"
- with the other participle — "er hat das gesagt"

Twice through: "er hat das gemacht."

Before you move on

Say "he did that." (**Er hat das gemacht**.) Which two forms of *haben* have no *b*? (***Hast*** and ***hat***.) Where did *das* land — before or after the participle? (**Before**.) Next: the same past, said about a group.

24.5 wir haben gesagt — “we said”

> The fourth person, and the easiest of the four, because its form is one you have been saying since the verb was introduced.

You’ll want to know: wir haben gesagt

> **wir haben gesagt** — “we said.”

The helper here is *haben* itself, unchanged from the dictionary form. German does that everywhere: the *wir* form of any verb is the infinitive over again, which is one of the few completely free pieces of the ending system.

So the sentence has *haben* in it twice over in a sense — as the recipe’s helper and as its own plain shape — and the participle at the back is still *gesagt*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wir haben gesagt — *haben* ← Old High German *habēn* ← Proto-Germanic **habjanǫ*, English *have*; *gesagt* from *sagēn*, English *say*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “wir haben gesagt”
- the four helpers in order — “habe, hast, hat, haben”
- “wir haben das gemacht”

Twice through: “wir haben gesagt.”

Before you move on

Say “we said.” (**Wir haben gesagt**.) Which other form of the verb does *wir haben* match exactly? (**The infinitive**, *haben*.) Say “we did that.” (**Wir haben das gemacht**.) Next: why the participle keeps ending up at the back.

24.6 The participle waits at the back

> *Er hat das gemacht.* Something happened in that sentence that has not been named yet, and it is the one thing about the *Perfekt* English cannot copy.

Grammar Lens: where the participle goes

> The participle goes to the **end of the clause**, not next to *haben*.

You already know that the working verb takes the second position in a German sentence. The *Perfekt* splits the verb in two and puts the halves at opposite ends: *haben* in its usual second slot, the participle at the very back. Between them sits everything else the sentence has to say.
Grammarians call that shape a **bracket**, and once you hear it you cannot unhear it — a German sentence opens a verb and does not close it until the last word. It is also why German listeners wait: until the bracket shuts, you do not yet know what was done.
English refuses this outright. *I have German learned* is not a sentence, and no amount of context rescues it, because English keeps its two verb pieces welded together and pushes everything else behind them.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the shape — "haben second, participle last"
- "er hat das gemacht" and hear the bracket close
- "wir haben das gesagt"

Twice through: "The participle waits at the back."

Before you move on

Where does the participle sit? (**At the end of the clause**.) Where does *haben* sit? (**Second**, as any working verb does.) What is between them? (**Everything else**.) Can English do this? (**No**.) Next: a word to put in that middle space.

24.7 gestern — “yesterday”

The bracket leaves a gap in the middle of every past sentence. Here is the first word worth putting in it.

You’ll want to know: gestern

gestern — “yesterday.”

It pairs with *morgen*, which you already have for “tomorrow.” One word each side of today, and both of them slide into the middle of a sentence rather than onto its end.

Now put it to work with a participle you own:

Ich habe gestern Deutsch gelernt. *(word for word: I have yesterday German learned.)*

Three things stacked between *habe* and *gelernt*, and the participle still waiting at the back. Say the English gloss aloud and hear how badly it fails as an English sentence; that failure is the shape of German.

Sounds you’ll need

- `ge-prefix` — the opening *ge-* is the same unstressed mumble as in a participle, though here it is simply part of the word: *GES-tern*, stress on the first syllable.
- `r-uvular-german` — the *r* before *n* barely sounds; it colours the vowel and gets out of the way.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gestern and *yesterday* are the same word. Germanic **gestra-* meant “the day before”; German kept it as it was, and English glued *day* onto the end of it, which is why the English word is two syllables longer for no extra meaning.

Latin took the same ancient root to *heri*, which is where French *hier* and Spanish *ayer* come from — so the word for yesterday is one of the oldest things in the room.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "gestern" — stress on the front
- the pair — "gestern, morgen"
- "Ich habe gestern Deutsch gelernt."

Twice through: "Ich habe gestern Deutsch gelernt."

Before you move on

Say "yesterday." (**Gestern**.) Say "I learned German yesterday." (**Ich habe gestern Deutsch gelernt**.) Which word comes last? (***Gelernt***.) Which English word is *gestern*? (***Yesterday***.) Next: what that sentence actually means in English, which is not what it looks like.

24.8 It means "I said," not only "I have said"

The last thing about this tense is a translation trap, and it is the one that trips up English speakers hardest.

Grammar Lens: one German past for two English ones

Ich habe gesagt covers both "**I said**" and "**I have said**."

English keeps those apart and makes the difference do work: *I said it yesterday* against *I have said it already.* Pick the wrong one and an English speaker hears something slightly off.
Spoken German mostly does not bother. The *Perfekt* took over the whole territory and answers both questions, so *ich habe gestern Deutsch gelernt* is "I learned German yesterday" — plain past, no "have" anywhere in the English.
That is the trap: the German sentence has a word that looks like *have* in it, and the English translation usually does not. Read the German for its meaning rather than its parts, and the sentence stops sounding stilted.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich habe gesagt — I said"

- it the other way too — "ich habe gesagt — I have said"
- "Ich habe gestern Deutsch gelernt — I learned German yesterday"

Twice through: "ich habe gesagt — I said."

Before you move on

Translate *ich habe gesagt* into plain English. ("**I said**.") Does the English need the word "have"? (**Usually not**.) Which language keeps *I said* and *I have said* apart? (**English**.) Next: the whole chapter, said through.

24.9 Practice — the Perfekt, all four persons

No new words. Each of the four slots below has had a lesson of its own, so this is the first place it is safe to set them out together.

Grammar Lens: the four slots, assembled

German	English
ich **habe** gesagt	I said
du **hast** gesagt	you said
er **hat** gesagt	he said
wir **haben** gesagt	we said

One half of the sentence moves and the other does not. Run the four aloud and hear that *gesagt* never budges.

The exchange

German	English
Was hast du gestern gemacht?	What did you do yesterday?
Ich habe Deutsch gelernt.	I learned German.
Und du?	And you?
Wir haben das auch gemacht.	We did that too.
Gut gemacht!	Well done!

Two joining words slip in without lessons of their own, because the translation carries them: **was** ("what") and **auch** ("too"). And the last line is

already an idiom — *gut gemacht* is exactly English *well done*, participle and all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the four in order — "ich habe, du hast, er hat, wir haben — gesagt"
- the same four with the other participle — "…gemacht"
- "Ich habe gestern Deutsch gelernt."
- the whole exchange, both voices

Twice through: "ich habe, du hast, er hat, wir haben."

Before you move on

Run the four helpers without prompting. Say "we did that." (**Wir haben das gemacht**.) Where is the participle in every one of those sentences? (**Last**.) Translate *ich habe gesagt* into plain English. ("**I said**.") Next: the other past tense German has, and why you meet it mostly in books.

Chapter 25

The Simple Past

Modes: **voice** (10) **Hands-free start:** all 10 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can recognise the one-word past German uses in writing, produce the handful of its forms that people actually say out loud, and explain why the rest of it retreated.
>
> *German's second past means exactly what the first one means, so this chapter separates the two by register rather than by tense: produce the Perfekt, recognise the Präteritum, and learn the short list of forms that ignore the rule. It ends with the reason the tense retreated at all — the same change ran through French and Italian over the same centuries, because their speakers are neighbours.*

25.1 -te — the one-word past

German has a second past tense. It needs no helper verb and no participle — just a stem and an ending.

Grammar Lens: add -te to the stem

Take a regular verb's stem and put **-te** on it.

The tense that ending builds is called the ***Präteritum***. Where the *Perfekt* spends two words and a bracket, this one spends a single word: *sag-* plus *-te* and the sentence is done.
The two tenses report the same events. That is worth saying plainly, because a learner reasonably expects a language with two pasts to be drawing a distinction with them, the way English draws one between *I said* and *I have said*. German draws none. What separates its two

pasts is something else entirely, and it takes a few more lessons to arrive at.
The *-te* itself has a history reaching well beyond German, and that comes first.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the recipe — "stem plus te"
- the name — "das Präteritum"
- how many words it takes — "one"

Twice through: "stem plus -te."

Before you move on

Which ending builds the *Präteritum* on a regular verb? (**-te**.) How many words does it need? (**One**.) How many does the *Perfekt* need? (**Two**.) Do the two tenses mean different things? (**No**.)
Next: the first verb through the new ending.

25.2 ich sagte — "I said," in one word

Run the new ending on the verb this chapter started from.

Wir haben gesagt: for *wir*, the helper is the infinitive itself, unchanged.

You'll want to know: ich sagte

ich sagte — "I said."

Stem *sag-*, ending *-te*. Two syllables and it is finished, where the *Perfekt* took three words to say the same thing:

ich ***sagte*** · *ich habe* ***gesagt***

Both are "I said." Neither is more past than the other, neither is more polite, and neither is wrong. Hold that in mind while the differences that do exist arrive.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sagte is the stem of *sagen* + the past ending *-te*. *sagen* ← Old High German *sagēn* ← Proto-Germanic **sagjanǫ*, the same verb as English *say*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `long-a` — the stem vowel is the same long *a* as in *sagen*; the new ending does not shorten it.
- `final-te` — the *-te* is a full unstressed syllable, *tuh*, not a bare *t*. Hear the difference against the participle: *ge-SAHKT* has one syllable at the end, *SAHK-tuh* has two.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich sagte"
- the pair back to back — "ich sagte … ich habe gesagt"
- the two endings apart — "gesagt, sagte"

Twice through: "ich sagte, ich habe gesagt."

Before you move on

Say "I said" in one word. (**Ich sagte**.) And in three. (**Ich habe gesagt**.) Which of them is further in the past? (**Neither**.) How many syllables does *sagte* have? (**Two**.) Next: the same ending on the verb for doing.

25.3 ich machte — "I made," "I did"

You have *gemacht*. Build the other past of the same verb before reading on.

Ich habe gesagt covers both *I said* and *I have said*. Spoken German keeps one past for both.

You'll want to know: ich machte

ich machte — "I made," "I did."

Mach- plus *-te*. Notice what the two pasts of this verb have in common: the stem. *Gemacht* wrapped it and *machte* suffixed it, and neither touched a letter inside it.

That is the whole promise of a weak verb. Whatever German asks of it, the middle stays put — which is why the four participles of the last chapter and the *-te* forms of this one can be built from any regular verb you meet, on the spot, without a list.

er machte das · *er hat das gemacht*

Same person, same event, two tenses.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

machte is the stem of *machen* + the past ending *-te*. *machen* is the same verb as English *make*, which EtymDB 2.1 traces to Proto-Germanic **makōną*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich machte"
- the pair — "er machte das … er hat das gemacht"
- both new forms — "sagte, machte"

Twice through: "ich sagte, ich machte."

Before you move on

Say "I did" in one word. (**Ich machte**.) What do *machte* and *gemacht* share? (**The stem** *mach-*.) Does either change the stem? (**No**.) Say "he did that" both ways. (**Er machte das**; **er hat das gemacht**.) Next: where that *-te* came from, and the English ending that is the same thing.

25.4 The dental preterite — a Germanic invention

Say *sagte*, then say *walked*. Both endings are made with the tongue against the teeth, and that is not a coincidence.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The German *-te* is what linguists call the **dental preterite**: a past tense made by bolting a *t* or *d* sound onto a stem. Dental, because those sounds are made at the teeth.

language	present	past
German	*sag-*	sag**te**
English	*walk*	walk**ed**
Dutch	*werk-*	werk**te**

Three languages, one device, inherited rather than borrowed — this is a **Germanic invention**, and it is one of the features that identifies the family. Everything with a *-t* or *-d* past in Germanic comes from the same ancestor.

Latin built nothing of the kind. Its past came from inherited perfect endings and from reduplication, and its descendants carried that on: French *parla*, Spanish *habló*. So *sagte* and *walked* are one machine, and *parla* and *habló* are a different one — which is why an English speaker recognises the German ending on sight and a Spanish speaker does not.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three together — "sagte, walked, werkte"
- the name — "the dental preterite"
- the two machines — "sagte and walked; parla and habló"

Twice through: "sagte, walked — the same ending."

Before you move on

What is the *-te* called? (**The dental preterite**.) Why *dental*? (**It is made at the teeth**.) Which English ending is the same thing?

(**-ed**.) Did Latin have it? (**No** — Romance builds its past another way.) Next: the one verb whose *-te* form you will hear constantly.

25.5 ich hatte — "I had"

The dental ending on the verb you have been leaning on for two chapters.

You'll want to know: ich hatte

ich hatte — "I had."

Haben drops its *b* — the same *b* that goes missing in *du hast* and *er hat* — and the dental ending lands on what is left, doubling the *t* in the spelling: *hat-te*. Two syllables, both short.

English did the identical thing to the identical verb and then wore the result down further: *have* lost its consonant and took a *-d*, giving *had*. So *hatte* and *had* are the same word doing the same job.

Haben has a *Perfekt* of its own as well — *ich habe gehabt*, "I have had" — built by the ordinary recipe, since *haben* is a perfectly ordinary verb when it is not busy helping another one.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hatte is the past of *haben* ← Old High German *habēn* ← Proto-Germanic **habjanǫ*, the same verb as English *have*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `d-t-final` — the doubled *tt* is one sharp *t*, and the vowel in front of it is short and clipped. *HAT-tuh*, never *HAH-tuh*.
- `final-te` — the ending is still a full unstressed syllable.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich hatte"

- the pair — “ich hatte … ich habe gehabt”
- the English twin — “hatte, had”

Twice through: “ich hatte, ich hatte.”

Before you move on

Say “I had.” (**Ich hatte**.) Which letter of *haben* is missing? (**The b**.) Say the same thing in the *Perfekt*. (**Ich habe gehabt**.) Which English word is *hatte*? (***Had***.) Next: which of the two pasts a German actually reaches for, and where.

25.6 Which past, and where

Two tenses, one meaning. Time to answer the question that has been waiting since the *-te* arrived: when does a German say which?

Grammar Lens: speech takes one, writing takes the other

The *Perfekt* belongs to **speech**. The *Präteritum* belongs to **narrative writing**.

tense	**where it lives**
Perfekt	everyday conversation, and dominant there
Präteritum	novels, reports, anything told on the page

Open a German novel and the story runs in *Präteritum* from the first page to the last. Stand in a German kitchen and you will barely hear it. Neither audience thinks it is choosing a tense; each is simply doing what that setting does.

So the practical instruction for a speaker is lopsided and easy: **produce** the *Perfekt*, **recognise** the *Präteritum*. You will read far more of it than you will ever need to say.

Why it's said this way

There is a second axis, and it is geographic. Spoken *Präteritum* has largely vanished from conversation in southern Germany, Austria and Switzerland; further north it survives noticeably better. A Hamburg speaker will use forms in conversation that a Munich speaker would find bookish.
That map is not decoration — the next lessons turn out to explain it — and it means the honest answer to "do Germans say *ich sagte*?" is: some of them, some of the time, and it depends where you are standing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the split — "Perfekt for speech, Präteritum for writing"
- your own instruction — "produce the Perfekt, recognise the Präteritum"
- the map — "weaker in the south, stronger in the north"

Twice through: "Perfekt spoken, Präteritum written."

Before you move on

Which past does a novel use? (**The Präteritum**.) Which does a conversation use? (**The Perfekt**.) Which should you produce? (**The Perfekt**.) Where is spoken *Präteritum* weakest? (**The south**.) Next: the forms that ignore all of this and stay spoken everywhere.

25.7 ich konnte — "I could"

The last new form of the chapter, and a *Präteritum* nobody thinks twice about saying out loud.

You'll want to know: ich konnte

ich konnte — "I could," "I was able to."

The dental ending again, doubled in the spelling as it was in *hatte*: *konnte*. It belongs to a small family of verbs German calls *modal* — the ones that lean on another verb, the way English *can*, *must* and *may* do.

Those verbs are the *Präteritum*'s stronghold in ordinary speech. Nobody in Munich says *ich habe gekonnt* over dinner; they say *ich konnte*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Konnte and English *could* descend from one Germanic verb, **kunnanǫ*, which meant "**to know how**" rather than "to be physically able." Ability arrived later, out of knowledge.
That older sense is still visible in the English relatives: *know*, *cunning* (originally "knowing"), and *uncouth*, which began as "unknown." The *l* that English wrote into *could* is pure accident — it was copied from *would* and *should* centuries after anyone stopped pronouncing it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich konnte"
- the two doubled forms — "hatte, konnte"
- the old meaning — "konnte, could — knew how"

Twice through: "ich konnte, ich hatte."

Before you move on

Say "I could." (**Ich konnte**.) What did the verb behind it originally mean? ("**To know how**.") Name an English cousin. (***Know***, *cunning*, or *uncouth*.) Is *konnte* bookish? (**No** — it is said out loud everywhere.) Next: why a handful of forms get that exemption.

25.8 The forms that stayed spoken

> *Hatte*. *Konnte*. Both are *Präteritum*, and both come out of a German mouth without a second thought. So the writing-only rule has holes in it.

Grammar Lens: a short list of survivors

A handful of very common verbs keep their one-word past **in speech**, everywhere in the German-speaking world.

Three groups make up almost the whole list:

- **hatte** — the past of *haben*;
- **konnte** and its modal siblings — *musste*, *wollte*, *durfte*;
- the past of the verb for "to be," which arrives two chapters from now and is the most-said of them all.

Everything else in the *Präteritum* obeys the split you learned last: written, not spoken.
Why these? Because they are the verbs said most often, and frequency protects a form the way it protects an irregularity. A shape you produce fifty times a day is never up for replacement; a shape you produce once a month quietly gets swapped for the compound version and nobody notices the swap happening.
So the practical list is genuinely short, and it is worth having by heart rather than by rule.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the survivors you own — "hatte, konnte"
- the modal siblings — "musste, wollte, durfte"
- the reason — "frequency protects a form"

Twice through: "hatte, konnte — spoken everywhere."

Before you move on

Name two *Präteritum* forms a German says out loud. (***Hatte***, ***konnte***.) Which family does *konnte* belong to? (**The modals**.) Why did these survive? (**They are said most often**.) Next: why the rest of the tense retreated, and where the retreat came from.

25.9 The same retreat, three times over

German is not the only language that let a two-word past crowd out a one-word one. Two of its neighbours did the identical thing at the identical time.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

language	one-word past	what took it over in speech
German	*Präteritum*	*Perfekt*
French	*passé simple*	*passé composé*
Italian	*passato remoto*	*passato prossimo*

Two Romance languages and one Germanic one, doing the same thing over the same centuries — and not by coincidence. The dental *-te* and the Romance endings came from completely different ancestors, so nothing inherited can account for three languages arriving at the same answer.

Geography can. Southern Germany, France and northern Italy are one connected block of territory, and the change spread through it by **contact**: speakers who live near each other borrow habits, and a habit of speech travels across a language boundary as easily as across a dialect one. Linguists call a change that spreads that way an ***areal*** change.

Why it's said this way

Two pieces of evidence make the contact story stick rather than merely sound good.

The first is what did **not** happen at the western edge. Spanish and Portuguese kept their one-word past far more fully in speech, and they are the two languages furthest from that connected block.

The second is the map inside German itself, which you already met: the *Präteritum* is weakest in the **south**, nearest the centre of the change, and strongest in the **north**, furthest from it. A change spreading outward from a region should thin as it goes, and that is exactly what German shows.

Geography did not dictate any single sentence. But it explains why a Germanic language and two Romance ones moved in step, and why one end of Germany sounds older than the other.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three languages — "German, French, Italian: the same retreat"
- the name — "an areal change, spread by contact"
- the inside map — "south more Perfekt, north more Präteritum"

Twice through: "areal change — it spread by contact."

Before you move on

Which two neighbours made the same change? (**French** and **Italian**.) Did German inherit it from Latin? (**No** — the two families build their pasts from different material.) What is a change that spreads by contact called? (An ***areal*** change.) Which two languages at the western edge kept their one-word past? (**Spanish** and **Portuguese**.) Next: the chapter run through end to end.

25.10 Practice — the two pasts, side by side

No new words. The point of this one is to hear, in your own voice, that two different-sounding sentences report the same event.

Grammar Lens: one meaning, two shapes

meaning	Präteritum	Perfekt
I said	*ich sagte*	*ich habe gesagt*
I made	*ich machte*	*ich habe gemacht*
I had	*ich hatte*	*ich habe gehabt*

Say each pair back to back — *ich sagte … ich habe gesagt* — and then *er machte das … er hat das gemacht*. Nothing about the meaning has moved. All that has changed is which room you are standing in.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — "ich sagte … ich habe gesagt"

- the other pair — "er machte das … er hat das gemacht"
- the survivors — "ich hatte, ich konnte"
- your own instruction — "produce the Perfekt, recognise the Präteritum"

Twice through: "ich sagte, ich habe gesagt."

Before you move on

Say "I made" both ways. (**Ich machte**; **ich habe gemacht**.) Which of the two would a novel use? (**The Präteritum**.) Which would you say out loud? (**The Perfekt** — except for the survivors.) What is the *-te* called? (**The dental preterite**.) What kind of change pushed the tense out of speech? (An ***areal*** one.) Next: the verb every one of these sentences has been waiting for.

Chapter 26

I Am, You Are

Modes: **voice** (8) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 8 of 9 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what someone is in German, using any of the six present forms of the verb for "to be" — and say that I am tired.
>
> *sein is the one German verb whose forms cannot be guessed from its infinitive, so this chapter meets them one at a time — bin, bist, ist, sind, seid, sind — and only assembles the grid once every cell has had its own lesson. It closes with müde, the adjective that finishes ich bin, and a short exchange that runs on nothing but this verb.*

26.1 sein — "to be"

> You have met the German verb for *to have*. Here is its partner — the most irregular verb in German, and the one verb whose forms you will not be able to guess.

You'll want to know: sein

> **sein** — "to be."

The **-en** on the end is the infinitive ending you already own from *gehen* and *sehen*: the dictionary form of a German verb wears it, and *sein* wears it too.

That is where the resemblance stops. *Gehen* and *sehen* keep their stem in every form — *ich gehe*, *ich sehe*. *Sein* keeps nothing. Not one of its present forms contains the letters *s-e-i-n* in that order.

This is the only verb in the book that has to be met one form at a time, and the next several lessons do exactly that: one form each, said until it is automatic, before any of them are ever seen side by side.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sein ← Middle High German *sīn* — inherited. Its forms come from three old roots; *ist* is the same word as English *is*, which EtymDB 2.1 traces to Proto-Germanic **isti*.

Sounds you'll need

- `s-voiced` — a German **s** before a vowel buzzes like English **z**, exactly as it does in *sehen*. So *sein* opens with a *z*.
- `diphthong-ei` — German **ei** is the vowel of English *eye*, never "ee".
- `final-t` — worth having ready now, because two of the forms coming up end in a crisp, fully released **t**.

Put together, *sein* sounds like English **zine**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "sein" (*zine*) — buzzing *z*, *ei* as in *eye*
- "gehen, sehen, sein" — three infinitives, one ending
- "sein — to be"

Twice through: "sein, sein — *zine*."

Before you move on

What does *sein* mean? ("**To be**.") Which ending does it share with *gehen* and *sehen*? (**-en**, the infinitive.) How does the *s* sound? (Like English **z**.) And the *ei*? (Like English **eye**.) Next: the first form, and it looks nothing like the word you just learned.

26.2 ich bin — "I am"

> You have *ich*, and you have the infinitive *sein*. Put them together and you get a form that shares no letters with either half of that sentence except the *i*.

You'll want to know: ich bin

ich bin — "I am."

One syllable, short *i*, ordinary *b*, ordinary *n*. There is no rule behind it and nothing to derive it from: *bin* is simply the form that goes with *ich*, and it is learned the way you learned *hallo*.

It rhymes with English *bin*, and that rhyme is not an accident — see below.

Sounds you'll need

- `ich-laut` — *ich* still ends in the soft breathy sound you met when you first said "I": tongue where it sits for *ee*, air pushed past it, no scrape.
- `i-short` — the *i* of *bin* is short and clipped, the vowel of English *bin*, not the long *ee* of *ihm*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bin rhymes with English *be* for a reason, even though the vowels have drifted apart. Both come from Proto-Indo-European ****bʰuH-*** — "to grow, to become."
So German kept that ancient root in the **present tense** and English kept it as the **infinitive**: *be* and *bin* are the same old word wearing different jobs. Hold on to that; two lessons from now it explains something about the whole verb.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich bin" — short *i*, soft ending on *ich*
- "ich bin Anna." "ich bin Peter."

- "bin — be" — the same old root

Twice through: "ich bin, ich bin."

Before you move on

Say "I am." (**Ich bin**.) Is the *i* of *bin* long or short? (**Short** — English *bin*.) Which English word comes from the same root as *bin*? (**Be**.) Next: the same verb for the person you are talking to.

26.3 du bist — "you are"

Du is the familiar "you" — the one for a friend. Its verb ending is **-st**, and for once *sein* uses it.

You'll want to know: du bist

du bist — "you are."

Take *bin*, drop the *n*, add the familiar **-st**: *bi-* plus *-st* is *bist*. That is the same ending as *du gehst*, *du heißt*, *du siehst*.

Of the six present forms of *sein*, this is the only one that can be derived from another one. Enjoy it; it does not happen again.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bist ← Old High German *bist* — inherited, from the same root as Old High German *bim*, "I am", which EtymDB 2.1 traces to Proto-Germanic **beunǫ*, "to be, to become". English *be* shares it.

Sounds you'll need

- `u-long` — *du* has a long, rounded **oo**, the vowel of English *do*, held.
- `final-t` — German releases a final **t** fully and audibly. *Bist* ends with a small puff of air; English tends to swallow it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "du bist" — long *u*, crisp final *t*
- "ich bin … du bist" — the pair
- "du bist Peter."

Twice through: "ich bin, du bist."

Before you move on

Say "you are," to a friend. (**Du bist**.) Which ending is that? (**-st**, the familiar one.) Which form is *bist* built on? (***Bin***.) Is the final *t* released or swallowed? (**Released**.) Next: the form for everybody else.

26.4 er ist — "he is"

Bin and *bist* both start with *b*. The third form does not, and it is the one you will hear most.

You'll want to know: er ist

er ist — "he is."

er is "he." The same **ist** serves three more subjects without changing at all: **sie ist** ("she is"), **es ist** ("it is"), and **das ist** ("that is") — *es* and *das* both already yours.

So one two-letter word covers everything that is not *ich* and not *du*, in the singular. It is the workhorse of the whole verb.

Sounds you'll need

- `r-final` — the *r* at the end of *er* is not a full English *r*. It softens towards a vowel, close to *air* said without the tongue curling.
- `final-t` — *ist* ends in the same released **t** as *bist*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ist is the one form of *sein* whose relatives you can name on sight:

language	"is"
German	**ist**
English	**is**
Latin	*est*
French	*est*

All from Proto-Indo-European ****h₁es-***, "to be" — and the infinitive **sein** is built on that root too. So *sein* and *ist* really do belong to each other; it is *bin* and *bist* that came from somewhere else.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "er ist, sie ist, es ist"
- "Das ist gut." — "that is good"
- "ich bin, du bist, er ist"

Twice through: "Das ist gut."

Before you move on

Say "he is." (**Er ist**.) Which other subjects take the same form? (***Sie***, ***es***, ***das***.) Say "that is good." (**Das ist gut**.) Which Latin word is *ist*? (***Est***.) Next: the form for more than one.

26.5 wir sind — "we are"

Three singular forms down. The plural starts here, and after *bin*, *bist*, *ist*, this one will finally look like the verb it belongs to.

You'll want to know: wir sind

wir sind — "we are."

wir is "we." And **sind** shares its first two letters with the infinitive *sein*, which is the first visible family resemblance in this verb.

Its Latin twin is *sunt*, "they are" — same **s**, same **n**, same closing stop, the same root wearing a different vowel.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sind ← Old High German *sint* — inherited, from the same root as English *is* and Latin *sunt*, "they are". EtymDB 2.1 traces English *is* to Proto-Germanic **isti*.

Sounds you'll need

- `w-as-v` — German **w** is English **v**. *Wir* begins like *veer*.
- `ie-long-ee` — **ie** is a long **ee**. *Wir* is *veer*, not *wire*.
- `d-t-final` — the **d** at the end of *sind* is spoken as a **t**, the same final devoicing you met on *und*. Say *zint*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "wir sind" — *veer zint*, final *d* as *t*
- "wir sind gut."
- "sein … sind" — the family resemblance

Twice through: "wir sind, wir sind."

Before you move on

Say "we are." (**Wir sind**.) How is the final *d* pronounced? (As a **t**.) How does *wir* begin? (Like English **v**.) Which Latin word is *sind*? (***Sunt***.) Next: the plural "you."

26.6 ihr seid — "you are," to several people

Du is one friend. For two or more friends German has a separate word, and English used to have one as well.

You'll want to know: ihr seid

ihr seid — "you are," said to more than one person you would each call *du*.

ihr is the familiar plural "you" — a crowd of friends, a group of children, your own family. English once had *ye* here and let it go, which is why one English *you* now does the work of four German words.

seid opens exactly like the infinitive: *sei-* is *sein* without its *n*. Both the *s* and the *ei* behave as they did there.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ihr ← Old High German *ir* ← Proto-Germanic **jīz* — inherited, the same word as English *ye*. (EtymDB 2.1) *seid* is a form of *sein*.

Sounds you'll need

- `ie-long-ee` — *ihr* is *eer*, one long vowel; the *h* only stretches it.
- `s-voiced` — *seid* opens with the buzzing **z** of *sein*.
- `diphthong-ei` — and carries the *eye* vowel through. Say *zite*.

Wir sind and *ihr seid* are the two plural forms, and they sound nothing alike, which makes them easy to keep apart.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ihr seid" — *eer zite*
- "wir sind … ihr seid"
- "sein … seid" — the same opening

Twice through: "ihr seid, ihr seid."

Before you move on

Say "you are" to a group of friends. (**Ihr seid**.) Which English word did that job before English dropped it? (***Ye***.) Which part of *seid* comes straight out of *sein*? (**sei-**.) Next: the last form, and the one that does double duty.

26.7 sie sind / Sie sind — "they are," and "you are," politely

The polite **Sie** is literally the word for "they," worn as a courtesy. Its verb form follows from that, and costs you nothing new.

You'll want to know: sie sind and Sie sind

sie sind — "they are." **Sie sind** — "you are," to someone you would address formally.

The form is **sind**, the very same word you learned for *wir*. Nothing changes in the mouth at all: *wir sind*, *sie sind*, *Sie sind* are three subjects and one verb form.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sind ← Old High German *sint* — inherited, from the same root as English *is* (EtymDB 2.1 traces *is* to Proto-Germanic **isti*). The polite *Sie* is the word for "they", capitalised.

Grammar Lens: the capital carries the politeness

On the page, *sie* and *Sie* differ by exactly one capital letter — and German already spends capitals on grammar rather than decoration. In speech there is no difference at all; the context tells you which one is meant.

written	means
sie sind	they are
Sie sind	you are, formally

That is the whole of it. Six subjects, and you have now met every present form of the verb.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "sie sind" — "they are"
- "Sie sind Herr Peter Schmidt?" — politely
- "wir sind, sie sind, Sie sind" — one form, three subjects

Twice through: "sie sind, Sie sind."

Before you move on

Say "they are." (**Sie sind**.) Say "you are" to a stranger. (**Sie sind** — same sound.) What separates the two on paper? (**The capital S**.) How many different present forms of this verb have you now met? (**Five** — *bin, bist, ist, sind, seid.*) Next: one adjective, so you can finally say something about yourself.

26.8 müde — "tired"

Ich bin is a sentence waiting for one more word. Here is the word that finishes it most often.

You'll want to know: müde

müde — "tired."

Ich bin müde. — "I am tired."

Two syllables, stress on the first: *mü-duh*. It is an adjective, and after *sein* an adjective takes **no ending at all** — the same bare form serves every subject. *Ich bin müde*, *du bist müde*, *wir sind müde*.

That is worth noticing, because German adjectives are famous for their endings. They only take them in front of a noun. Standing after *sein*, they stand still.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

müde ← Old High German *muodi*, "tired" ← Proto-Germanic **mōþijaz* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `umlaut-ue` — **ü** is the vowel you make by rounding your lips for *oo* and then saying *ee* without moving them. The dots are the fronting mark you already know: the mouth shifts forward, the lips stay round.

The final **-e** is a soft *uh*, never silent. *mü-duh*, two beats, the weight on the first.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "müde" — round the lips, say *ee*
- "Ich bin müde."
- "Er ist müde. Wir sind müde." — the adjective never changes

Twice through: "Ich bin müde."

Before you move on

Say "I am tired." (**Ich bin müde**.) How do you make the **ü**? (**Round for *oo*, say *ee*.**) Does *müde* change after *sein*? (**No** — no ending.) Say "we are tired." (**Wir sind müde**.) Next: everything at once, on purpose.

26.9 Practice — the whole present of sein

No new words. Every form below has had its own lesson, so this is the first time it is safe to put them all on one page — as a recap, not as something to memorise from cold.

Grammar Lens: the six forms, assembled

singular	**plural**
ich **bin**	wir **sind**
du **bist**	ihr **seid**
er/sie/es **ist**	sie/Sie **sind**

Six subjects, five different forms — *sind* does double duty. Look at that with fresh eyes now that you can say all of it: *bin* and *ist* do not look like forms of the same word, and the next chapter explains why they aren't.

The exchange

German	English
Hallo! Wie geht es dir?	Hello! How are you?
Danke, ich bin müde.	Thanks — I am tired.
Du bist müde? Ich auch.	You are tired? Me too.
Dann sind wir müde. Das ist gut.	Then we are tired. That is good.
Bis morgen!	See you tomorrow!

Two small joining words slip in there without needing lessons of their own, because each can be read straight off the translation: **auch** ("too") and **dann** ("then").

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the six in order — "ich bin, du bist, er ist, wir sind, ihr seid, sie sind"
- the same six backwards
- "Ich bin müde." "Du bist müde." "Wir sind müde."
- the whole exchange, both voices

Twice through: "ich bin, du bist, er ist, wir sind, ihr seid, sie sind."

Before you move on

Run the six forms without looking. Which one form covers *wir*, *sie* and *Sie*? (***Sind***.) Which is the only form built out of another one? (***Bist***, from *bin*.) Say "that is good." (**Das ist gut**.) Say "you are tired" to a group. (**Ihr seid müde**.) Next: where these forms came from — three different verbs, none of them each other.

Chapter 27

Being Your Years

Modes: **voice** (8) **Hands-free start:** all 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask how old somebody is and say my own age in German, using the verb German insists on for it.
>
> *This material was the second half of the hand-written haben chapter, and it could not stay there: ich bin zwanzig Jahre alt needs ich bin, and Wie alt bist du? needs du bist — both of which the chapter on sein teaches. It sits here instead, immediately after that chapter, where every word it needs is already owned, and it closes the haben chapter's open question by showing the one everyday sentence where German refuses that verb.*

27.1 alt — "old"

> You can say *ich bin müde*. Here is a second adjective to put in the same slot, and it opens a sentence you will be asked for constantly.

You'll want to know: alt

> **alt** — "old."

One syllable. It behaves exactly as *müde* did: after *sein* an adjective takes no ending at all, so *ich bin alt* needs nothing added.

It is the same word as English **old**, and you can nearly hear it — German kept the *a* where English rounded it.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-a` — short and clipped, the *a* of English *hat*.
- `d-t-final` — the *-lt* closes crisply, both consonants sounded.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "alt"
- the pair — "alt, old"
- with the verb — "ich bin alt", "ich bin müde"

Twice through: "alt, alt — old."

Before you move on

Say "old." (**Alt**.) Does it take an ending after *bin*? (**No**.) Which English word is it? (***Old***.) Next: the noun that goes with it.

27.2 die Jahre — the form the age sentence uses

A noun you were given ten chapters ago. The age sentence wants it in a shape you have not used yet.

You'll want to know: die Jahre

die Jahre — the plural of *das Jahr*.

The plural adds *-e* and takes *die*, as plurals do, and it stays capitalised because German capitalises every noun in every number.

Here is why it matters. The age sentence counts, and a count takes a plural: you are so many *Jahre* old, never so many *Jahr*. From here on it is *Jahre* that does the work, and *das Jahr* that sits behind it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Jahre is the plural of *Jahr* ← Old High German *jār* ← Proto-Germanic **jērą* — inherited, the same word as English *year*.

(EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `j-as-y` — German *j* is the *y* of English *yes*. So *Jahr* opens like *year*, not like *jar*.
- `h-silent-lengthening` — that *h* is not pronounced. It is the silent lengthening *h* you met inside *gehen*, and *Jahr* was named there as one of the three words that hide it, beside *sehr* and *Ihnen*. Here it is.
- `long-a` — so the vowel runs long: *YAAR*. Say it beside English *year* and the two are almost the same noise.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- singular and plural — "das Jahr, die Jahre"
- the plural alone, which is the one you need — "die Jahre"
- the two words the sentence will need — "Jahre, alt"

Twice through: "das Jahr, die Jahre."

Before you move on

Say "the year." (**Das Jahr**.) And the plural. (**Die Jahre**.) Which of the two does an age sentence use? (**The plural** — you are counted.) What does the plural add? (**An** *-e*, **and** *die*.) Next: where *Jahr* and *alt* both come from.

27.3 Jahr and alt, taken apart

Two words, both inherited rather than borrowed, and one of them has a Latin cousin you would never guess.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

German	from	English
Jahr	Germanic **jēra*	**year**
alt	Germanic **aldaz*	**old**

Neither line passes through Latin, which is worth noticing in a chapter about age: German borrowed its **month** names wholesale from Latin, and kept its own words for the year and for being old.
Now the cousin. The root behind **aldaz* also went into Latin, as *alere* — "to **nourish**, to grow." From *alere* English took **adult**, which is literally "grown up."
So *alt* and *adult* are the same idea taken down two roads: something that has been fed and has grown. Ageing as growth rather than as decay, which is a kinder picture than English usually admits to.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the two twins — "Jahr, year; alt, old"
- the Latin cousin — "alt, alere, adult"
- what the root meant — "to nourish, to grow"

Twice through: "Jahr, year. Alt, old."

Before you move on

Which English word is *Jahr*? (***Year***.) And *alt*? (***Old***.) Which English word comes from *alt*'s Latin cousin? (***Adult***.) What did that cousin mean? ("**To nourish, to grow**.") Next: the question you will be asked with these two words.

27.4 Wie alt bist du?

You have *wie*, you have *alt*, and you have *du bist*. That is the whole question.

You'll want to know: Wie alt bist du?

Wie alt bist du? — "How old are you?"

Four words, and every one of them is already yours. Set it against the English and nothing has moved: *how* — *old* — *are* — *you*.

That is not a coincidence to be grateful for; it is inheritance. Neither language borrowed this question from the other. They have been asking it the same way since before either was called German or English.

The verb sits second, as it does in every German statement and question with a question word in front — *Wie* first, *bist* second, and the rest behind.

To someone you would address formally, it is *Wie alt sind Sie?* — the same question with the polite form of the verb.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

alt ← Old High German *alt* ← Proto-Germanic **aldaz* — inherited, the same word as English *old*. (EtymDB 2.1) The other three words are inherited too.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Wie alt bist du?"
- it against the English — "how old are you; wie alt bist du"
- the formal one — "Wie alt sind Sie?"

Twice through: "Wie alt bist du?"

Before you move on

Ask how old someone is, informally. (**Wie alt bist du?**) And formally. (**Wie alt sind Sie?**) Which word sits second? (***Bist***.) How many of the four words were new? (**None**.) Next: how to answer it.

27.5 ich bin zwanzig Jahre alt

The answer, and it is as English as the question was.

You'll want to know: ich bin zwanzig Jahre alt

Ich bin zwanzig Jahre alt. — "I am twenty years old."

Word for word, that is the English sentence: *I — am — twenty — years — old*. Put any number you own in the middle and the sentence is yours.

And German shortens it the same way English does. *Ich bin zwanzig* is complete and ordinary, exactly as "I'm twenty" is — the *Jahre alt* can go, and in speech usually does.

Notice which verb is doing the work: *bin*. Not *habe*. Hold on to that, because it is the whole point of the next lesson.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

alt ← Old High German *alt* ← Proto-Germanic **aldaz*, English *old*; **Jahre** ← Old High German *jār* ← Proto-Germanic **jērą*, English *year*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Ich bin zwanzig Jahre alt."
- the short form — "Ich bin zwanzig."
- your own age, in both lengths
- the question and the answer together

Twice through: "Ich bin zwanzig Jahre alt."

Before you move on

Say "I am twenty years old." (**Ich bin zwanzig Jahre alt**.) Shorten it. (**Ich bin zwanzig**.) Which verb does it use? (***Bin***.) Which does it **not** use? (***Habe***.) Next: why that choice puts German and English on one side and every Romance language on the other.

27.6 sein, not haben

You spent a whole chapter on *haben*. Here is the everyday sentence where German refuses to let you use it.

Grammar Lens: you ARE your years

German states age with **sein**, never with *haben*.

**Ich habe zwanzig Jahre* is not German. It is not a clumsy way of putting it; it is not a sentence.
Look what happens when you line the languages up:

language	how age works	literally
German	*ich **bin** … Jahre alt*	I **am** …
English	*I **am** twenty*	I **am** …
French	*j'**ai** vingt ans*	I **have** …
Spanish	*t**engo** veinte años*	I **have** …
Italian	*h**o** venti anni*	I **have** …
Portuguese	*t**enho** vinte anos*	I **have** …

Two on one side, four on the other, and the line falls exactly where the families do.

Why it's said this way

Romance has its years; Germanic is its years. Age as something you carry against age as something you are — two pictures of the same fact, and each family committed to one of them long ago.
What makes German's choice worth pointing at is that German did *not* hold the Latin line out generally. Its month names are Latin borrowings wholesale; *Januar*, *Februar* and the rest came in and stayed. But on this sentence, said several times a week for a lifetime, German kept its own logic.
The words a language uses most are the ones it is least willing to trade — which is the same force that keeps its commonest verbs irregular.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the rule — "age takes sein, not haben"

- the two sides — “ich bin zwanzig; j’ai vingt ans”
- the picture — “Romance has its years, Germanic is its years”

Twice through: “Ich bin zwanzig Jahre alt — bin, not habe.”

Before you move on

Which verb does German use for age? (***Sein***.) Which does French use? (***Avoir*** — “to have”.) Which two languages sit together here? (**German and English**.) Did German borrow its month names from Latin? (**Yes** — which is what makes keeping this sentence its own worth noticing.) Next: the chapter said through.

27.7 Practice — asking and answering an age

No new words. One question, one answer, and one thing to keep hearing: which verb carries it.

The exchange

German	English
Wie alt bist du?	How old are you?
Zwanzig Jahre alt. Und du?	Twenty years old. And you?
Ich bin achtzehn.	I am eighteen.
Und du bist müde.	And you are tired.
Müde, nicht alt!	Tired, not old!

Every line runs on the same verb, and two of them drop it the way speech does — *zwanzig Jahre alt* answers the question on its own. Nothing here needs *haben*, and the last two lines put *müde* and *alt* side by side in the slot they share.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the question, then your own answer
- the answer short, then long
- the two sides — “ich bin zwanzig; j’ai vingt ans”

- the twins — "Jahr, year; alt, old; alt, adult"
- the whole exchange, both voices

Twice through: "Wie alt bist du? Ich bin zwanzig Jahre alt."

Before you move on

Ask someone's age. (**Wie alt bist du?**) Answer with your own, both long and short. Which verb does German use, and which does it refuse? (***Sein***; **not** *haben*.) Which English word shares a root with *alt*? (***Adult***.) Which four languages say "I have twenty years"? (**French, Spanish, Italian, Portuguese**.)

27.8 Uhr, Mitternacht, Lenz, Ge- — four the calendar left lying there

The hour at which one day becomes the next. Say it. Then say the adjective for anything happening near it.

Your turn: four, cold

Say these aloud:

- two o'clock — and say why it is **not** *zwei Uhren*
- midnight — *Mitternacht*
- the old poetic word for spring — *Lenz*
- what the prefix **Ge-** does to a single thing

Grammar Lens: a word can be a counter without being countable

Two of these four are about **number**, and they pull in opposite directions:

	what it does	example shape
Uhr, telling the time	refuses a plural — it is a unit, like English *o'clock*	*zwei Uhr*, never *zwei Uhren*
Ge-	manufactures a collective from a single thing	one thing → the set of them

Uhr meaning **clock** pluralises perfectly well. It is only *Uhr* meaning **o'clock** that will not, and that is the distinction to hold: the same noun behaves differently depending on the job it is doing in the sentence.

Why it's said this way

Every one of the four words above is written with a capital, and that is not decoration or emphasis. **German capitalises nouns as a part of speech**, so the capital is a piece of grammatical information printed on the page: it tells a reader which word in a long sentence is the thing being talked about, before they have parsed anything else.

Which makes **Ge-** worth a second look. A prefix that manufactures a noun also manufactures a capital letter — the two are the same event.

And **Lenz** is the one here you should recognise rather than reach for. It is the old, poetic word for spring; meeting it in a song or a poem should not stop you, and using it to tell someone the season would sound like reciting verse. *Gute Nacht* has the reverse property — ordinary to say, and only at parting.

Before you move on

Why is it *zwei Uhr* and not *zwei Uhren*? (**Uhr meaning o'clock is a unit, not a countable thing.**) Is *Lenz* a word to use, or to recognise? (**To recognise.**) What does a capital letter tell a German reader? (**That the word is a noun.**)

Chapter 28

Three Verbs Under One Roof

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (8) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can put the German verb for "to be" into the past, and say why its forms look like three unrelated words — because they are.
>
> *The past of sein is the tidy half of the verb: one stem war-, ordinary endings, and ich war identical to er war. The chapter teaches those four cells one at a time and then answers the question the present tense raised — bin, ist and war come from three different Proto-Indo-European verbs, which is called suppletion, and it survives because the words you never have to guess at are the words analogy never reaches.*

28.1 ich war — "I was"

> You know the simple past is mostly a written tense in German, and that a handful of very common verbs keep it in speech. This is the most common of them.

You'll want to know: ich war

ich war — "I was."

Nobody says *ich bin gewesen* in ordinary speech when *ich war* will do. This is the past-tense form Germans actually use, in every region, out loud.

And hear the shape of it. *Bin* has a *b*. *Ist* has an *s* and a *t*. *War* has a *w* and an *r*, and no sound in common with either. That is now three completely unalike stems inside one verb.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

war — inherited, from Old High German *wesan*, "to be" ← Proto-Germanic **wesanǫ*; EtymDB 2.1 traces English *was* to the same verb.

Sounds you'll need

- `w-as-v` — German **w** is English **v**, so *war* begins like *var*.
- `vowel-a-long` — the **a** is long and open, the *a* of English *father*.
- `r-final` — the final **r** softens towards a vowel rather than curling.

The result sounds close to English *var*, and nothing like English *war*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich war" — *var*, long open *a*
- "ich bin … ich war" — now and then
- "Ich war müde."

Twice through: "ich bin, ich war."

Before you move on

Say "I was." (**Ich war**.) How does the *w* sound? (Like English **v**.) Is this form used in speech or only in writing? (**In speech, everywhere** — it is one of the survivors.) How many unlike stems does this verb now have? (**Three**.) Next: the same form for *du*.

28.2 du warst — "you were"

You have *ich war*. The familiar "you" wants the ending it always wants.

You'll want to know: du warst

du warst — "you were."

War plus **-st**, with nothing else moved. The same ending that made *bist* out of *bin*, and *gehst* out of *gehen*.

So the past tense of this verb is better behaved than its present: you take one stem, *war-*, and add ordinary endings to it. Everything difficult about *sein* happens in the present.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

warst is the past stem *war* + *-st*. The stem goes back to Old High German *wesan*, "to be" ← Proto-Germanic **wesanǫ*, the verb behind English *was*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Sounds you'll need

- `u-long` — *du* keeps its long rounded **oo**.
- `final-t` — and *warst* ends on the fully released **t** German always gives you, after the *s*. Say the *s* and the *t* both: *varst*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "du warst" — *varst*, both consonants released
- "ich war … du warst"
- "du bist … du warst" — now and then

Twice through: "ich war, du warst."

Before you move on

Say "you were," to a friend. (**Du warst**.) Which ending is that? (**-st**.) Which stem is it added to? (***War-***.) Is the past of this verb regular or irregular in its endings? (**Regular** — one stem, ordinary endings.) Next: the form for everyone else, and a surprise.

28.3 er war — "he was"

In the present, *ich* and *er* took different words — *bin* against *ist*. In the past they take the same one.

You'll want to know: er war

er war — "he was."

Not a new form. It is *war*, unchanged, the very word you learned for *ich*. And as with *ist*, it covers **sie war** ("she was"), **es war** ("it was") and **das war** ("that was") as well.

This is a habit of the German simple past, not a quirk of this verb: the I-form and the he-form are always identical there. *Ich sagte* and *er sagte*. *Ich hatte* and *er hatte*. The present tense never does this; the past always does.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

war goes back to Old High German *wesan*, "to be" ← Proto-Germanic **wesanǫ*; EtymDB 2.1 traces English *was* to the same verb.

Sounds you'll need

- `r-final` — two softening *r* sounds in a row now, one closing *er* and one closing *war*. Neither curls.
- `vowel-a-long` — and the long open **a** between them carries the phrase.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "er war, sie war, es war"
- "Das war gut."
- "ich war … er war" — the same word twice

Twice through: "Das war gut."

Before you move on

Say "he was." (**Er war**.) How is it different from *ich war*? (**It isn't** — same word.) Does the present do that? (**No** — *bin* against *ist*.) Say "that was good." (**Das war gut**.) Next: the plural.

28.4 wir waren — "we were"

One more form, and the verb is finished — present and past, all of it.

You'll want to know: wir waren

wir waren — "we were."

War plus the plural ending **-en**, the one *wir* takes on every verb. And just as *sind* served three subjects at once, *waren* covers **sie waren** ("they were") and **Sie waren** ("you were," politely) with no change.

The one plural form left over is **ihr wart**, for a group of friends. It takes the plural-*you* **-t**, and it is the rarest form in the whole verb.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

English does the identical thing and nobody notices:

	German	English
singular	*war*	**was**
plural	*waren*	**were**

An **s** in the singular, an **r** in the plural, in both languages, inherited from the same ancestor. English *was/were* and German *war/waren* are the same pair of words.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "wir waren, sie waren, Sie waren"
- "ich war, du warst, er war, wir waren"
- "war — was; waren — were"

Twice through: "ich war, wir waren."

Before you move on

Say "we were." (**Wir waren**.) Which English pair matches *war/waren*? (***Was/were***.) What is the plural ending on it? (**-en**.) Say "they were." (**Sie waren**.) Next: why one verb needed three different stems.

28.5 bin, ist, war — three verbs under one roof

Say *bin*, *ist*, *war* one after another. They do not look like forms of the same word — and they aren't.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Three separate Proto-Indo-European verbs each handed German a slice of this paradigm, and each of them left cousins in languages you can check:

forms	from	which also gave
ist, sind, seid, sein	*h_1es- — "to be"	Latin *est, sunt*; French *est, sont*
bin, bist	*b^huH- — "to grow, become"	English **be**; Latin *fuī*
war, waren	**wes*- — "to dwell, remain"	English **was, were**

Go over the middle row again. *b^huH- did not mean "to be" at all. It meant "to grow" — and the reason English says *be* and German says *bin* is that a verb about growing got promoted into a verb about existing, in both languages, before either of them existed.
The bottom row is the same story with a different verb: **wes*- meant "to dwell, to remain." Staying somewhere became having been.

Why it's said this way

Bin has a cousin further afield than English. Latin *fuī*, "I was," is from the same ****b^huH-*** — and *fuī* is the direct source of Spanish **fui**, "I was / I went."
So German *bin* and Spanish *fui* are the same ancient word. One landed in the present tense, the other in the past, and the two languages now

use it to mean opposite ends of time.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three roots — "ist from *h_1es-, bin from *b^huH-, war from *wes-"
- "ist — est — is"
- "war — was; waren — were"
- the cousin abroad — "German bin, Spanish fui, one root"

Before you move on

How many ancient roots is *sein* built from? (**Three**.) Which one gives *ist* — and which Latin word proves it? (***h_1es-**; Latin *est*.) What did the root behind *bin* originally mean? ("**To grow, to become**.") Which Spanish word shares it? (***Fui***.) Which root gives English *was* and *were*? (***wes-**, the same one as *war*.) Next: the name for what this verb is doing.

28.6 Suppletion — filling a verb in from another verb

Three roots, one verb. There is a name for that, and once you have it you will find the same thing in English.

Grammar Lens: what suppletion is

When one verb's forms are filled in from a **different** verb, that is **suppletion**.

Sein has no forms of its own for "I am" or "I was." It borrowed them, long ago, from two other verbs, and then all three grew together into a single paradigm that native speakers use without ever noticing the seam.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

English does the identical thing with its own commonest verbs, and you have never thought twice about it:

present	past	where the past came from
go	**went**	*wend*, a different verb entirely
am	**was**	the same **wes-* that gave German *war*
good	**better**	a different word again

Went belonged to *wend* — "to make one's way," still alive in *wend your way*. English took it, gave it to *go*, and left *wend* with a regular past of its own. That is precisely what German did to build *sein*. Suppletion is not a German oddity, and it is not rare. It is simply what languages do to the words they use most — and every language you have looked at in this book has done it to its verb for "to be."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the definition — "one verb's forms, filled in from another verb"
- "go, went" — English doing it
- "bin, war" — German doing it

Before you move on

What is suppletion? (**One verb's forms filled in from another verb**.) Name the English example. (***Go / went***.) Which verb did *went* actually belong to? (***Wend***.) How many verbs are hiding inside *sein*? (**Three**.) Next: why this always happens to the commonest words.

28.7 Why "to be" is the messiest word in every language

Every language you have ever met has a broken verb for "to be." That is too consistent to be an accident, and it isn't one.

Grammar Lens: frequency protects irregularity

The most-used words are the most irregular.

Regularity spreads by **analogy**. You meet an unfamiliar verb, you do not know its forms, so you guess them from the pattern — the *-e*, *-st*, *-t*, *-en* machine you learned early. Guess often enough and the guess becomes the form: the odd old shape is sanded down and the verb joins the regular crowd.
But you never have to guess at "to be." You hear it a hundred times a day, from the day you start speaking. Every one of those hearings reinforces the strange shape faster than analogy can wear it away.
Rare words get regularised. Common words are protected fossils.

Why it's said this way

This also tells you where the irregularity will sit inside a verb, and *sein* proves it. Its present tense — the part you say constantly — is the wreckage: three roots, five unlike forms. Its past tense, which you say far less often, has quietly become well-behaved: one stem *war-*, ordinary endings, *warst* built exactly like *bist* was not.
So the mess is not spread evenly. It clusters where the traffic is.
The practical consequence is a comfort. There is no long list of verbs this strange, because a verb has to be *this* common to survive being this strange — and there are only a handful of words in any language that common.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the rule — "the most-used words are the most irregular"
- why — "you never have to guess at them"
- "bin, bist, ist" against "war, warst, waren" — mess, then order

Before you move on

State the rule. (**The most-used words are the most irregular**.)
What spreads regularity? (**Analogy** — guessing from the pattern.)
Why does analogy never reach "to be"? (**You never have to**

guess at it.) Which half of *sein* is the tidy half? (**The past** — one stem, ordinary endings.) Next: the chapter together.

28.8 Practice — was, were, and why

No new words. Present and past, side by side, and then the account of how one verb ended up like this.

Grammar Lens: the past, assembled

Six forms, one stem, four endings, no surprises. Said in order:

- **ich war**, **du warst**, **er war** — and the first and third are the same word, which the present tense would never allow;
- **wir waren**, **ihr wart**, **sie waren**.

Compare that with the present, where five different shapes came from three different verbs. The past of *sein* is the part of the paradigm that behaved.

The exchange

German	English
Wo warst du?	Where were you?
Ich war in Berlin.	I was in Berlin.
Wie war es?	How was it?
Es war gut, und ich bin müde.	It was good, and I am tired.

Wo ("where") and *in* are read straight off the English here; neither is asked of you yet.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich war, du warst, er war, wir waren, ihr wart, sie waren"
- the pairs — "ich bin / ich war", "wir sind / wir waren"
- the three roots — "ist, bin, war — three verbs"

- the whole exchange, both voices

Twice through: "Wie war es? Es war gut."

Before you move on

Run the six past forms. Which two are identical? (***Ich war*** and ***er war***.) Name the three roots this verb is built from, by their German forms. (***Ist***, ***bin***, ***war***.) What is the technical name for that? (**Suppletion**.) Why has nothing tidied this verb up? (**It is too common — you never guess at it, so analogy never reaches it**.) Next: the past tense that is built on this verb rather than out of it.

Chapter 29

The Past That Takes To Be

Modes: **voice** (8) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 8 of 9 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can build the German past of verbs of motion and change with the verb for "to be" instead of the verb for "to have", and say why the participle never changes.
>
> *Motion and change of state build their perfect on sein rather than haben — ich bin gegangen beside ich habe gelernt. The chapter teaches the rule, then the four verbs that follow it (kommen, fahren, werden, bleiben), then the short list that has to be learned outright, and finally the one place German is simpler than French: the participle in the perfect agrees with nothing at all.*

29.1 ich bin gegangen — the perfect built on sein

> You built the everyday past with *haben* — **ich habe gelernt**. A particular family of verbs refuses *haben* and takes this chapter's verb instead.

Grammar Lens: which verbs take sein

> Verbs of **motion** and **change of state** build their perfect with **sein**, not *haben*.

An action that leaves you somewhere else, or leaves you something else, takes *sein*. An ordinary activity that leaves you where you were keeps *haben*: *ich habe gearbeitet*, *ich habe getanzt*.
Gehen is the model, and because every present form of *sein* now belongs to you, the whole thing reads off without a single new word:

German	English
ich ***bin*** *gegangen*	I went / I have gone
du ***bist*** *gegangen*	you went
er ***ist*** *gegangen*	he went
wir ***sind*** *gegangen*	we went

The recipe is the one you already know, with the helper swapped:

> present form of **sein** + past participle, and the participle goes **last**

Sounds you'll need

- `ge-prefix` — *gegangen* opens with the same unstressed **ge-** that wrapped *gelernt* and *gesagt*. It is never stressed; the weight falls on *-gang-*.
- `ich-laut` — and *ich* keeps its soft ending right before it, so the phrase runs *ich bin ge-GANG-en* without a break.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich bin gegangen; du bist gegangen; er ist gegangen; wir sind gegangen"
- the contrast — "ich habe gelernt … ich bin gegangen"
- the rule — "motion and change take sein"

Twice through: "ich bin gegangen."

Before you move on

Which family of verbs takes *sein*? (**Motion and change of state**.) Say "I went." (**Ich bin gegangen**.) Where does the participle sit? (**At the end**.) Which helper does *arbeiten* take? (***Haben*** — it is an activity, not a change.) Next: the first of the family, and it is the one you say most.

29.2 kommen — “to come”

Motion takes *sein*. Here is the motion verb you will use as often as *gehen*, and it is an English word you already own.

Wir waren, we were. *Sie waren* and *Sie waren*, polite, use the same form.

You’ll want to know: kommen

kommen — “to come.”

ich bin gekommen — “I came.”

The infinitive wears the **-en** you know. The participle is **gekommen**: the *ge-* wrap in front, and *-en* rather than *-t* at the back, because this is one of the old strong verbs rather than a regular one.

Coming is arriving somewhere you were not. That is motion with a result, so it takes *sein*, exactly as *gehen* does.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

kommen and English **come** are the same word, both from Germanic ***kwemanǫ**. No Latin anywhere in the line — French *venir* and Spanish *venir* come from Latin *venīre* instead, which is where English gets *advent*, *convene* and *venue*.
So English, as usual, owns both halves: the everyday **come** from the Germanic side, the formal **convene** from the Latin.

Sounds you’ll need

- `vowel-o` — the **o** is short and open, the vowel of English *cot*, not the *uh* English puts in *come*.
- `ge-prefix` — *gekommen* keeps the unstressed **ge-**; the stress is on *-KOMM-*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “kommen” — short open *o*
- “ich bin gekommen”

- "ich bin gegangen … ich bin gekommen"

Twice through: "ich bin gekommen."

Before you move on

What does *kommen* mean? ("**To come**.") Say "I came." (**Ich bin gekommen**.) Which helper, and why? (***Sein*** — it is motion.) Which English word is it? (**Come**.) Next: the verb that covers everything with a vehicle under it.

29.3 fahren — "to travel, to drive"

Gehen is going on your feet. When there is a vehicle under you, German changes the verb.

You'll want to know: fahren

fahren — "to travel, to go by vehicle, to drive."

ich bin gefahren — "I travelled, I drove."

German keeps two verbs where English makes do with *go*. You **gehen** on foot and you **fahren** in anything with wheels — a car, a bus, a train, a bicycle. Getting that pair right is one of the first things that makes a learner sound German rather than translated.

It is motion, so the helper is *sein*.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-a-long` — the **a** is long and open, as in *war*.
- `h-silent-lengthening` — and the **h** after it is the silent stretcher you met in *gehen* and *sehen*: it is not breathed, it only holds the vowel. *FAH-ren* rhymes with the way *gehen* and *sehen* are built.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fahren is English **fare** — the old verb meaning "to travel," which English demoted to a noun and then almost forgot. It is still there in:

English word	what it is really saying
farewell	travel well
thoroughfare	a way you can travel through
seafaring	sea-travelling
the **fare** you pay	what the travelling costs

So *auf Wiedersehen* and *farewell* are built the same way: both are a wish handed over at the door, one about seeing again, one about travelling well.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "fahren" — long *a*, silent *h*
- "ich bin gefahren"
- the pair — "gehen on foot, fahren with wheels"
- "fahren — fare — farewell"

Twice through: "Ich bin gefahren."

Before you move on

What does *fahren* mean? ("**To travel, to go by vehicle**.") Which verb would you use walking to the shop? (***Gehen***.) Say "I drove." (**Ich bin gefahren**.) Which English word is *fahren*? (**Fare** — as in *farewell*.) Next: the verb for becoming something else.

29.4 werden — "to become"

The rule has two halves. *Gehen*, *kommen* and *fahren* are the motion half. This one word is the whole of the other half.

You'll want to know: werden

werden — "to become."

ich bin geworden — "I became."

Sein says what you are. *Werden* says what you turn into. Where *sein* sits still, *werden* moves — and that is exactly why it takes *sein* as its helper: becoming is change of state in its purest form.

Ich bin müde geworden. — "I got tired."

Notice what that sentence does. The adjective you learned with *sein* now describes an arrival rather than a condition. German makes the difference with the verb; English does it with *be* against *get*.

Sounds you'll need

- `w-as-v` — the **w** is English **v**, as in *war* and *wir*.
- `d-t-final` — and in **wird** ("he becomes") the final **d** devoices to a **t**, the same rule that turned *sind* into *zint*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

werden is a lost English verb — *weorthan*, "to turn, to come to be" — and its bones are still in the language:

English	the buried meaning
to**ward**	turning to
back**ward**	turning back
worth	what a thing turns out to be

So *werden* means "to turn into," and every time you say *toward* you are using the same root without knowing it. *Werden* ← Old High German *werdan*, "to turn" (EtymDB 2.1).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "werden" — *VAIR-den*
- "ich bin geworden"
- "Ich bin müde geworden." — "I got tired"
- "werden — toward — worth"

Twice through: "Ich bin müde geworden."

Before you move on

What does *werden* mean? ("**To become**.") Why does it take *sein*? (**It is change of state** — the other half of the rule.) Say "I became." (**Ich bin geworden**.) Which English words hide the same root? (***Toward***, ***backward***, ***worth***.) Next: the two verbs that break the rule by standing still.

29.5 bleiben — "to stay"

Werden takes *sein* because it is pure change. This verb takes *sein* too — and it means staying exactly where you are.

You'll want to know: bleiben

bleiben — "to stay, to remain."

ich bin geblieben — "I stayed."

By the rule as stated, this verb should take *haben*. Staying is not motion and it is not change; it is the absence of both. It takes *sein* anyway, and every German learner meets it as a fact rather than a consequence.

The honest way to hold it: *bleiben* is on the *sein* list because it is about **where you are** rather than **what you do**, and that is the deeper thing the motion rule was pointing at all along.

Sounds you'll need

- `diphthong-ei` — **ei** is the *eye* vowel again, exactly as in *sein*. So *bleiben* is *BLY-ben*, never *blee-ben*. The two verbs of this chapter that break the rule both carry that vowel.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bleiben is **be-** plus an old Germanic verb *lība-*, "to remain." English lost the verb and kept its leavings — literally: what **remains** after everything else has gone is what English calls the **leftovers**, and *leave* in the sense of *what is left* belongs to the same family.
German still uses the verb every day; English kept only the residue of it, which is a fitting fate for a word meaning "to be left over."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "bleiben" — *BLY-ben*, the *eye* vowel
- "ich bin geblieben"
- the odd pair — "ich bin geworden … ich bin geblieben"

Twice through: "Ich bin geblieben."

Before you move on

What does *bleiben* mean? ("**To stay**.") Say "I stayed." (**Ich bin geblieben**.) Does the motion rule predict its helper? (**No** — it has to be learned.) How is *ei* pronounced? (Like English **eye**.) Next: the rest of the verbs that have to be learned, including this chapter's own verb.

29.6 ich bin gewesen — and the rest of the learned list

Bleiben was the first verb the rule failed to predict. Here is the whole of the rest of that list, and it is short.

Grammar Lens: the verbs you simply learn

Besides motion and change, a small fixed set of verbs takes *sein* and has to be **learned**.

verb	perfect	meaning
sein	*ich bin* ***gewesen***	I have been
bleiben	*ich bin* ***geblieben***	I stayed
gelingen	*es ist* ***gelungen***	it succeeded
geschehen	*es ist* ***geschehen***	it happened
passieren	*es ist* ***passiert***	it happened
begegnen	*ich bin* ***begegnet***	I met

Sein and *bleiben* head the list because they are the two that most clearly contradict the rule: one says a thing simply is, the other says it stays. The rest are events that arrive of their own accord —

succeeding, happening, running into somebody — and German treats an arrival as a change.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Listen closely to **gewesen**. Strip the *ge-* wrap and the *-en* ending and what is left is ***wes-*** — the third of the three roots inside this verb, the one that gave *war* and English *was*.
So *sein* reaches for that root twice: once for its past tense, once for its participle. The infinitive comes from one root, the present from two, the past and participle from a third. There is no part of this verb that belongs to all of it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich bin gewesen; ich bin geblieben"
- "es ist passiert" — "it happened"
- "war … gewesen" — the same root twice

Twice through: "ich bin gewesen."

Before you move on

Name the two verbs at the head of the learned list. (***Sein*** and ***bleiben***.) Say "I have been." (**Ich bin gewesen**.) Say "it happened." (**Es ist passiert** — or *es ist geschehen*.) Which root is hiding inside *gewesen*? (***wes-**, the one behind *war*.) Next: the ending German does not put on any of these.

29.7 gegangen — the participle that never changes

French draws the same *have*-against-*be* line German does. Here is the place the two languages part company, and German comes out easier.

Grammar Lens: German agrees with nothing here

Inside the perfect, the German participle takes **no ending at all**. *Gegangen* is *gegangen* for every person, number and gender.

	French	**German**
he went	*il est* ***allé***	*er ist* ***gegangen***
she went	*elle est* ***allée***	*sie ist* ***gegangen***
they went	*ils sont* ***allés***	*sie sind* ***gegangen***

French makes the participle agree with its subject and spells the agreement out three different ways. German changes the helper — *ist*, *sind* — and leaves the participle exactly where it found it.
Old High German did inflect it here, at least some of the time. Modern German lost that, along with most of its other adjective-like endings in this position. So the simplicity is not a design; it is an erosion, and German happens to have come out ahead.

Why it's said this way

It would be easy to assume German copied this split from Latin, the way it borrowed so much else. It did not.
The *haben*-perfect and the *sein*-perfect are **native Germanic developments**. They grew up alongside the Romance ones rather than out of them: neighbouring languages drifting the same way over centuries of contact, the same areal spread that pushed the simple past out of everyday speech in French, German and Italian together.
Two things to carry forward, and they point in opposite directions:

- the **split** between the two helpers is shared with French;
- the **agreement** is not.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "er ist gegangen; sie ist gegangen; sie sind gegangen"
- the participle, unchanged, three times — "gegangen, gegangen, gegangen"

- the comparison — "elle est allée … sie ist gegangen"

Twice through: "sie ist gegangen; sie sind gegangen."

Before you move on

Does the German participle agree with its subject in the perfect? (**No** — never.) What changes instead? (**The helper** — *ist*, *sind*.) Does French agree? (**Yes**.) Did German take this split from Latin? (**No** — it grew in parallel.) Next: the one place a German participle does take an ending.

29.8 der angekommene Zug — where the ending comes back

The participle takes no ending in the perfect. That is a fact about the perfect, not about participles — and the difference matters.

Grammar Lens: in front of a noun, it inflects

A German participle standing **in front of a noun** is working as an adjective, and it takes the endings adjectives take there.

German	English
*ein geschriebene**r** Brief*	a written letter
der angekommene Zug	the arrived train
die eingeschlafene Mutter	the fallen-asleep mother

Each noun keeps its capital, and each participle now carries a small ending chosen by the article in front of it. That is the ordinary German adjective machine, applied to a participle.
So German did not lose participle endings everywhere. It lost them in exactly one construction: the perfect.

Sounds you'll need

- `ge-prefix` — all three participles above still carry their **ge-** wrap, and it is still unstressed. In *angekommen* it has slid into the middle of the word, behind *an-*, which is where German puts

it when a prefix comes first.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der angekommene Zug"
- "die eingeschlafene Mutter"
- the contrast — "sie ist gegangen" (no ending) … "die eingeschlafene Mutter" (ending)
- "die müde Mutter" — an ordinary adjective doing the same thing

Before you move on

Where does a German participle still take an ending? (**In front of a noun**, as an adjective.) Where does it never take one? (**In the perfect**.) Say "the arrived train." (**Der angekommene Zug**.) What is the participle behaving as, in that phrase? (**An adjective**.) Next: choosing between the two helpers, on the spot.

29.9 Practice — haben or sein?

No new words. The only skill left in this chapter is picking the right helper without stopping to think, and that is drill.

Grammar Lens: the whole family in one place

verb	perfect	why
gehen	*ich bin gegangen*	motion
kommen	*ich bin gekommen*	motion
fahren	*ich bin gefahren*	motion
werden	*ich bin geworden*	change of state
bleiben	*ich bin geblieben*	learned
sein	*ich bin gewesen*	learned
lernen	*ich* ***habe*** *gelernt*	ordinary activity
machen	*ich* ***habe*** *gemacht*	ordinary activity

Read the right-hand column and you can see how much of the work

the motion rule does on its own: only two rows have to be memorised outright.

The exchange

German	English
Wo bist du gewesen?	Where have you been?
Ich bin nach Berlin gefahren.	I travelled to Berlin.
Und Anna? Ist sie gekommen?	And Anna? Did she come?
Anna ist zu Hause geblieben.	Anna stayed at home.
Ich habe viel gelernt. Jetzt bin ich müde.	I learned a lot. Now I am tired.

Note the third and fourth lines: *ist sie gekommen*, *Anna ist geblieben* — a feminine subject both times, and not one letter added to either participle.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the contrast pair — "ich habe gelernt … ich bin gegangen"
- the family — "bin gekommen, bin gefahren, bin geworden, bin geblieben, bin gewesen"
- the French comparison — "elle est allée … sie ist gegangen", no ending at all
- the one place the ending returns — "der angekommene Zug"
- the whole exchange, both voices

Twice through: "ich habe gelernt … ich bin gegangen."

What you've built — where this volume pauses

You have gone from *guten Tag* to two working past tenses, and the method has not changed once: take the word apart, find the English cousin sleeping inside it, and let the family tree do the memorising for you.
The next volume picks the thread back up with describing what you see.

Before you move on

Which helper for *tanzen*, "to dance"? (***Haben*** — an activity.) Which for *fahren*? (***Sein*** — motion.) Which two verbs on the *sein* list mean the opposite of change? (***Sein*** and ***bleiben***.) Say "she stayed." (**Sie ist geblieben** — no ending on the participle.)

Chapter 30

Head and Hand

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the head and the hand in German, devoice the final d of Hand, and say where the Germanic and Latin families stop matching.
>
> *Run the wellbeing ladder cold and complain of Kopfschmerzen, say where Kopf and Haupt came from and what French tête shares with Kopf, say die Hand with its final d spoken as t and bring the d back in die Hände, and name the gap: main, mano, mão — but Hand.*

30.1 Der Kopf — "the head"

> Learn the first body part with its article and its characteristic final sound.
>
> In front of a noun, a participle takes an ending like an adjective: *der angekommene Zug*, *ein geschriebener Brief*.

You'll want to know: der Kopf

> **der Kopf** — the head

It is masculine and capitalised because every German noun begins with a capital letter.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kopf ← Old High German *kopf*, "drinking vessel" (EtymDB 2.1) — usually traced to Late Latin *cuppa*, "cup", so a borrowing whose sense moved from bowl to head.

Sounds you'll need

At the end of **Kopf**, close for *p* and release directly into *f*. English has no identical native ending, so practise it slowly:

Ko-p-f → **Kopf**

Grammar Lens: Kopf + Schmerzen

A useful phrase is:

Ich habe Kopfschmerzen. — I have a headache.

German compounds simply place nouns together: **Kopf** (head) + **Schmerzen** (pains).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Kopf" — release *p* into *f*
- "Ich habe Kopfschmerzen."
- "Kopf — cup or bowl"

Twice through: "Der Kopf — masculine, capitalised."

Before you move on

Say "the head." (**Der Kopf**.) Give its gender. (**Masculine**.) Why the capital? (It is a **noun**.) What did *Kopf* first mean? (A **cup or bowl**.) Name the related English word. (**Cup**.) Next: find the inherited word *Haupt*.

30.2 (der Kopf, continued) — The old cup

Before going on: say **der Kopf** again, and what it means.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kopf originally meant a **cup or bowl**. It is related to English **cup**; both were early borrowings of Late Latin ***cuppa***. A container word became slang for the skull and eventually took over the everyday job. German's older inherited head-word did not disappear completely. The next micro-lesson follows it into compounds and compares the same container metaphor in French.

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **der Kopf**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **der Kopf**? Say it once more, without looking.

30.3 Kopf / Haupt — two head-words

Kopf began as "cup." German's inherited word for "head" is **Haupt**, a cousin of English *head* and Latin *caput*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

language	inherited form
Latin	*caput*
German	**Haupt**
English	**head**

The initial $k \rightarrow h$ relationship reflects Grimm's law, the same systematic Germanic sound shift seen in Latin *pater* beside English *father*. The later consonants have their own history; use the initial pair as the clear signal.

Haupt survives in compounds and formal vocabulary:

- **Hauptstadt** — capital, literally "head city";

- **Hauptbahnhof** — main station;
- **Hauptsache** — main thing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Kopf — everyday cup-word"
- "Haupt — inherited head-word"
- "Hauptstadt, Hauptbahnhof"

Twice through: "Kopf took the job; Haupt stayed in compounds."

Before you move on

Which word is everyday "head"? (**Kopf**.) Which inherited word survives in compounds? (**Haupt**.) Name two compounds. (**Hauptstadt, Hauptbahnhof**.) What parallel metaphor did French use? (**Tête**, originally a pot.) Next: the hand.

30.4 (Kopf / Haupt, continued) — Two container metaphors

Before going on: say **Kopf / Haupt** again, and what it means.

Why it's said this way

language	everyday word	older picture
German	**Kopf**	*cuppa*, cup
French	*tête*	*testa*, pot

Both languages independently promoted a vessel-word to "head," while keeping the older head-root in words for chiefs, capitals, or main things. The vocabulary sources are both Latin loans, but the **metaphor** was applied separately: heads look like bowls in many languages.

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **Kopf / Haupt**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **Kopf / Haupt**? Say it once more, without looking.

30.5 die Hand — "the hand"

After the tangle of *Kopf* and *Haupt*, here is the easiest word in the chapter — and a useful lesson about when languages **don't** match.

You'll want to know: die Hand

die Hand — the hand. **Feminine**, and spelled exactly like English.

Sounds you'll need

One pronunciation note: the final **d** is said as a **t**. German devoices a consonant at the end of a word, so *Hand* **ends** like English *hunt* — but with the open *ah* of *Tag*, not *hunt*'s vowel. Add an ending and the *d* comes back: *die Hän**d**e* ("the hands").

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Hand is Germanic **handuz*, and English inherited it directly. Same word, same meaning, two thousand years apart. German and English are close relatives, and body parts are where you feel it most:

German	English
Hand	hand
Arm	arm
Finger	finger
Fuß	foot
Herz	heart

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "die Hand" — final **d** said as **t**
- the plural, and hear the *d* return — "die Hän**d**e"
- the Germanic match — "Hand" beside English "hand", one word
- the gap — "*main*, *mano*, *mão* … but **Hand**"

Before you move on

Say "the hand." (*Die Hand* — **feminine**.) How is the final **d** pronounced, and why? (As a **t** — German **devoices** final consonants; the *d* returns in *Hände*.) Is *Hand* related to French *main*? (**No** — Germanic **handuz* against Latin *manus*; the families differ here.) How did *manus* reach German anyway? (As **borrowed** learned words — *Manuskript*, *manuell*.) Next: the rest of the body.

30.6 (die Hand, continued) — Where the family tree stops

Before going on: say **die Hand** again, and what it means.

Why it's said this way

Now the interesting part. Every Romance language builds "hand" on Latin ***manus***:

French	*la main*
Italian	*la mano*
Portuguese	*a mão*
Spanish	*la mano*

And Germanic — German, English — has **handuz*, which is **not related to *manus* at all**. The two families simply have different words here.

That is worth noticing, because these connections keep turning up, and it can start to feel as though everything must connect. It doesn't.

Indo-European languages share a great deal, and then diverge, and "hand" is one of the places where they diverged early and completely. The Latin word did reach German — but only as **borrowed vocabulary**: *Manuskript*, *Maniküre*, *manuell*. Learned imports, sitting beside the native word without displacing it.

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **die Hand**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **die Hand**? Say it once more, without looking.

30.7 Wie geht es dir? — and the whole ladder of answers

Ask a friend how they are. Then ask a stranger. One word moves, and the capital letter moves with it — say which.

Your turn: four rungs, top to bottom

Say these aloud:

- the question, informally — *Wie geht es dir?*
- the good answer — *gut*
- the middle, sing-song — *so lala*
- the shrug — *es geht*
- the question, formally — *Wie geht es Ihnen?*

Why it's said this way

es geht says *it goes* and nothing more — and that is the point. German does not wave *how are you* past as a greeting, so an answer with no adjective is heard as an answer: somewhere between *I'm managing* and *don't ask*, and it may well draw a follow-up.

dir → Ihnen makes the same fact from the other side: one word that changes not the question but who you are allowed to be to the person.

Your turn: and the first thing that can be wrong

Say these aloud:

- the head — *Kopf*, and hold that final **pf** as one sound
- what you have when it hurts — *Kopfschmerzen*

A compound built the ordinary German way: the part of you, then the pains, run together into a single word. Say the seam out loud once, then stop hearing it.

Your turn — head and hand, from memory

- What did *der Kopf* first mean? (A **cup** — Late Latin *cuppa*, English *cup*.) The older head-word? (**Haupt**, as in *Hauptstadt* — beside *caput* and *head*, its $k \to h$ is **Grimm's law**.)
- Which French word took the same road? (***tête***, once a pot.)
- Say "the hand", then "the hands". (***die Hand***, *d* said as *t*; ***die Hände***, *d* back.)
- Is *Hand* kin to French *main*? (**No** — Germanic **handuz*, English *hand*; *manus* came in only as loans, like *Manuskript*.)

Before you move on

Which answer invites a follow-up question — *gut*, *so lala*, or *es geht*? (***Es geht***.) What two words are inside *Kopfschmerzen*? (**Kopf** and **Schmerzen**.)

Chapter 31

Yes and No

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can answer yes or no in German and take nein apart into ni + ein, the same 'not one' English froze into none.
>
> *Say nein to rhyme with nine, split it into ni + ein and match it to English none, then run the PIE *ne chain — nōn, non, nein, nahīm̥.*

31.1 ja — yes

The easiest German word to say, and one English almost shares.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ja = yes. Said *yah* — remember German **j** is pronounced like English **y**, never the English "j."
It's an ancient **Germanic** word, and English kept the very same root in the one word that still clearly shows it:

- **yea** — the old, formal "yes" (*the yeas and the nays* in a vote) — this is *ja*'s direct cousin, same Proto-Germanic root.
- **aye** — the sailor's and parliament's "yes" (*Aye, aye, captain*) — *sounds* like a cousin, but its origin is actually **uncertain**; it may come from a different word entirely, so don't bank on it.

So German *ja* and English *yea* are the same little word, split between two cousin languages. (English's everyday *yes* is a compound of that

same *yea* with an old "be it so.")

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ja" — *yah*, the j like English y
- the English cousin — "yea… ja" (and maybe *aye*)
- the contradiction preview — "Du kommst nicht? — Doch!"

Before you move on

How do you say yes in German? (**ja**, *yah*.) How is the **j** pronounced? (Like English **y**.) Which English word is *ja*'s firm direct cousin? (**yea** — *aye* only looks like one; its origin is uncertain.) What German word answers *yes* specifically to contradict a **negative**? (**doch**.)

31.2 (ja, continued) — A German habit to file away

Before going on: say **ja** again, and what it means.

Which old English word is *ja*'s direct cousin? (***Yea*** — as in *the yeas and the nays*.)

Grammar Lens: A German habit to file away

German also has a **third** answer-word, **doch**, for one special job: contradicting a **negative** — exactly like French *si*. If someone says something *isn't* so and you insist it *is*, you say **doch**, not *ja*:

> *Du kommst nicht?* ("You're not coming?") — ***Doch!*** ("Yes I am!")

You'll drill *doch* on its own later; for now, keep *ja* for a plain yes and know *doch* is waiting for the contradictions.

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **ja**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **ja**? Say it once more, without looking.

31.3 nein — no

German's "no" is a tiny sentence with a number hidden inside it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nein = **no**. Said to rhyme with English *nine* (the **ei** in German is always *eye*).
Take it apart and it's two words fused: **ni + ein** — literally **"not one."** English did the *exact same trick*: **ne + one → none**. So German *nein* and English *none* are the same idea — "not a single one" — hardened into a bare "no."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "nein" — rhymes with *nine*
- taken apart — "ni + ein = not one", like English *none*
- the family — "nōn… non… nein… nahīm̥" — all the PIE *ne*

Before you move on

How do you say no in German? (**nein**, rhymes with *nine*.) What two words is it fused from, and what do they mean? (***ni + ein*** — "not one.") Which English word is built the same way? (**none** = *ne + one*.) What ancient sound links German *nein*, Latin *nōn* and Hindi *nahīm̥*? (**PIE *ne**, the negator.)

31.4 (nein, continued) — One "no" runs across the whole chain

Before going on: say **nein** again, and what it means.

Why it's said this way

That **n-** at the front is not a coincidence. A single ancient sound — linguists write it **PIE *ne** — is the negator behind an astonishing sweep of languages you're learning:

from PIE **ne*	
Latin	*nōn* → Spanish **no**, French **non**
German	**nein** (*ni*-ein)
Hindi	**nahīṃ** (from *na*)
English	**no, not, none**

Learn *nein* and you've really met the same "n-of-no" that will greet you again in Hindi, and that also sits inside Spanish and French. One negative, half the world.

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **nein**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **nein**? Say it once more, without looking.

Chapter 32

Please

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** its only lesson.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask politely for something in German by putting bitte after the thing I want — Wasser, bitte.
>
> *Assemble a complete polite request out of two words already learned — Wasser, bitte — and hear the request still living inside bitte via bitten, English bid and bead. The chapter's only lesson, so the payoff covers everything it introduces.*

32.1 bitte — turn a known word into a polite request

You already use **bitte** after **danke** to mean "you're welcome." Now give that same small word its other everyday job: **please**.

You'll want to know: A complete small request

Wasser, bitte. — Water, please.

Nothing here is new except the job **bitte** is doing. You learned **Wasser** with the food. Put **bitte** after the thing you want and the two known words become a complete, polite small request. The comma marks the little pause you will naturally hear before **bitte**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bitte is the request form of **bitten**, "to ask, request, pray." Its cousins in English are **bid**—as in "I bid you welcome"—and **bead**, whose oldest meaning was a prayer. A prayer bead was first the object used to count those requests.
So when you add **bitte**, the word itself is already doing the asking.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Wasser." — water
- "Wasser, bitte." — water, please
- the root family — "bitten, bitte, bid, bead"

Before you move on

Ask politely for water. (**Wasser, bitte.**) What older lesson supplied both words? (**Bitte** came from the courtesy loop; **Wasser** came from the food chapter.) Which verb is **bitte** built from? (**Bitten**, "to ask or request.") Name its two English cousins. (**Bid** and **bead**.)

Chapter 33

Sorry

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** both lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can apologise or excuse myself in German with Entschuldigung, and reach for es tut mir leid when I mean it more.
>
> *Say Schuld, then Entschuldigung as the 'un-guilting' built on it, and switch to es tut mir leid for real regret rather than a bump in the hallway. The chapter's only lesson, so the payoff covers everything it introduces.*

33.1 Entschuldigung — "sorry" / "excuse me"

You already know **bitte** does triple duty for "please," "you're welcome," and "here you go." German's word for **sorry** is just as hard-working: **Entschuldigung** covers both "**excuse me**" and "**I'm sorry**."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

- **ent-** = a "removal / undoing" prefix — the same shape as in **ent**decken ("un-cover" → discover) or **ent**fernen ("un-distance" → remove).
- **Schuld** = "**guilt, fault, blame**" (also, separately, "debt" — a *Schuld* can be money owed or wrong done).
- **-igung** = a noun-forming suffix, roughly "-ing/-ation."

So **Entschuldigung** is literally "**an un-guilting**" — the act of

removing blame. Saying it hands the guilt back: *I release you from any fault* (when getting someone's attention or brushing past) or *I ask you to release me from mine* (when apologizing).
Schuld has a striking cousin: it traces to the same ancient Germanic root as English **shall** and **should** — a verb that originally meant **"to owe."** *Schuld* (what is owed, guilt) and *shall* (what one is obliged to do) are, at root, the same idea of an obligation outstanding.

Why it's said this way

For **deeper regret** — real sorrow, not a bump in the hallway — German often reaches for **es tut mir leid**, literally "**it does to-me sorrow**":

- **es** = "it," **tut** = "does" (from **tun**, "to do"), **mir** = "to me," **Leid** = "sorrow, suffering" (a cousin of English **loath**, both from a root meaning "hateful, painful").

Use **Entschuldigung** for the everyday sorry/excuse-me (stepping on a foot, interrupting), and **es tut mir leid** when you mean it more — condolences, a real regret. The two overlap; native speakers move between them by feel.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Schuld" — guilt/fault — then "Entschuldigung," sorry / excuse me
- the deeper phrase — "es tut mir leid," it pains me / I'm so sorry

Before you move on

What does **Entschuldigung** literally mean, piece by piece? (**"Un-guilting"** — *ent-* "away" + *Schuld* "guilt/fault.") What English word shares Schuld's ancient root? (**Shall/should** — both from a root meaning "to owe.") What's the deeper phrase for real regret? (**Es tut mir leid**, "it does to me sorrow.")

33.2 danke, bitte, Entschuldigung — and the sizes each of them comes in

Thank someone. Then say the word that answers it. Both are two syllables ending in the same unstressed **-e** — say them back to back and let that ending stay weak.

Your turn: three sizes, smallest first

Say these aloud:

- the plain one — *danke*
- the one that upgrades it with an adjective — *danke schön*
- the warmest everyday one — *vielen Dank*

Notice what changed in the third. *Danke* is a verb form — *I thank* — but *vielen Dank* is **the noun**, capitalised, with *viel* agreeing in front of it. That is why *viel* has an ending there and *schön* does not: one is describing a noun, the other is not.

Your turn: the word that answers everything

bitte is four words in one coat. Say it four times, meaning something different each time:

Say these aloud:

- *please*, asking for something
- *you're welcome*, answering a thank-you
- *here you go*, offering something
- *pardon?*, when you did not catch it
- and the two shortest answers there are — *ja*, *nein*

Why it's said this way

Entschuldigung is built out of **Schuld**, *guilt* or *fault*, with a prefix that undoes it: an *un-guilting*. The word is a request that the blame be removed, which is why it works both for bumping into someone and

for getting their attention in the first place.
That is worth holding against English, where *sorry* and *excuse me* split the job in two. German runs one word across both, and the size of the apology is carried by your voice rather than by a different word.

Before you move on

Why is it *vielen Dank* and not *viel Dank*? (**Dank is a noun, so viel takes an ending.**) What is inside *Entschuldigung*? (**Schuld**, guilt — the word asks for it to be undone.) Name two things *bitte* can mean.
Which old sound says *no* in *nein*, English *no* and Latin *nōn* alike? (The ***n-*** — one negative behind all three.) And what is *bitte* doing, at root? (**Asking** — *bitten*, cousin of English *bid*.)

Chapter 34

Weather

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** both lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the weather in German — das Wetter, es ist heiß, es ist kalt, es regnet.
>
> *Say das Wetter as English weather's own cousin, build hot and cold with sein rather than a Romance 'make', and say es regnet on the same root as English rain. The chapter's only lesson, so the payoff covers everything it introduces.*

34.1 das Wetter, es regnet — German's own native words, English's own cousins

> Every Romance language you've met so far shares the exact same Latin word for "weather" (*tempus*). German breaks completely from that family — with a word that's actually a much closer cousin of English.

The two words: das Wetter and weather

das Wetter = "**weather**" — from Proto-Germanic ***wedrą*** — the **exact same word** as English **weather** itself (both descend from the same Germanic ancestor, not one borrowed from the other). Unlike Spanish's *tiempo*, French's *temps*, or Latin's own *tempus*-family, German's weather word has **no connection to Latin at all** — it's a native Germanic inheritance, cousin to English rather than to Romance.

Grammar Lens: Es ist heiß / Es ist kalt

Es ist heiß. — "It's hot." — literally "it **is** hot." **Es ist kalt.** — "It's cold." — literally "it **is** cold."

German uses **sein** ("to be") here — matching the same "**be**" pattern you already met in German's own AGE lesson (*ich bin zwanzig*), not the Romance "make" periphrasis (*hacer*/*faire*).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Wetter" — weather, the same word as English "weather"
- "Es ist heiß. Es ist kalt." — it's hot/cold
- "Es regnet" — it's raining, same root as English "rain"

Before you move on

Does **Wetter** come from Latin, like the Romance languages' weather words? (**No** — it's native Germanic, the same word as English "weather.") What verb does German use for "it's hot/cold" — *sein* ("be") or a *hacer*-style "make"? (***Sein***, "to be" — matching German's own AGE pattern.) What English word is **regnet** related to? (**Rain** — same Proto-Germanic root, *regnōną*.)

34.2 (das Wetter, es regnet, continued) — es regnet

Before going on: say **das Wetter, es regnet** again, and what it means.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Es regnet. — "It's raining." — from **regnen** ← Proto-Germanic ***regnōną*** — the **same root** as English **rain**. Just like *Wetter*/ "weather," this is a genuine Germanic cousin-pair, not a shared Latin borrowing the way Spanish's *llueve* and French's *pleut* are.

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **das Wetter, es regnet**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **das Wetter, es regnet**? Say it once more, without looking.

Chapter 35

Dog and Cat

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** both lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a dog and a cat in German and say which of the two words German inherited and which one it borrowed.
>
> *Say Hund beside English hound and the unexplained dog that displaced it, then say Katze and admit it is the borrowed Late Latin cattus — widespread, but not universal: Romanian pisică and Serbian mačka went their own way. The chapter's only lesson, so the payoff covers everything it introduces.*

35.1 Hund, Katze — one native word, one surprising loan

Here's a real surprise to end this comparison on: German's word for "dog" is native and expected — but its word for "cat" secretly isn't native at all.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Hund ("**dog**") is native Germanic, from **Proto-Indo-European **kwon-*** — and it has a direct cousin sitting inside English itself: **hound**. Old English **hund** was the ordinary, everyday word for "dog" for centuries — until, for reasons nobody fully understands, **dog** (Old English *docga*) pushed it out by the 16th century, leaving *hound* to narrow down to just hunting dogs. English's *dog* is, honestly, its **own** unexplained mystery word, with no confirmed cognates in any other

language — the exact same *shape* of story as Spanish's *perro* displacing *can*, just in a completely different language family.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Hund" — dog, native Germanic, cousin of English "hound"
- the parallel — English replaced "hound" with the still-mysterious "dog," the same shape as Spanish's perro/can
- "Katze" — cat, surprisingly a Latin loanword, not native at all

Before you move on

Is **Hund** native Germanic, and what's its English cousin? (**Yes** — cousin of English **hound**.) What word did English replace *hound* with, and is that word's origin known? (**Dog** — genuinely **unexplained**, no confirmed cognates anywhere.) Is **Katze** native Germanic? (**No** — surprisingly, it's the same borrowed Late Latin *cattus* behind French's *chat* and Spanish's *gato*.)

35.2 (Hund, Katze, continued) — Katze

Before going on: say **Hund, Katze** again, and what it means.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Here's the twist: **Katze** ("**cat**") looks like it should be native Germanic too, sitting right next to native *Hund* — but it isn't. **Katze** descends from Proto-Germanic ***kattuz**, which is itself a borrowing of the **same Late Latin cattus** you already met with French's *chat* and Spanish's *gato* — most likely ultimately **Afro-Asiatic**, traveling out of Egypt along Roman trade routes. Every Germanic language shows this **same** borrowing (Dutch *kat*, Swedish *katt*, Icelandic *köttur*) — so unlike "dog" words, which go their own separate ways in nearly every language, "cat" words are remarkably **widespread** across both Germanic and Romance, because the word traveled **with the animal itself**. Be honest that this isn't a universal rule, though: **Romanian**

(*pisică*) and much of **South Slavic** (Serbian/Croatian *mačka*) built their own onomatopoeic cat-words instead, imitating the sound of a cat's call rather than inheriting *cattus* — so the spread is wide, but not without real exceptions.

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **Hund, Katze**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **Hund, Katze**? Say it once more, without looking.

Chapter 36

Green and Yellow

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** both lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name green and yellow in German, and say why grün is English green's own cousin while gelb's link to French jaune is only probable.
>
> *Say grün as the direct cousin of English green from a root unrelated to Latin viridis, say gelb, and state the gelb / jaune cousinhood as probable rather than airtight. The chapter's only lesson, so the payoff covers everything it introduces.*

36.1 grün, gelb — English's own cousin, and a secret cousin of French

German's green word is a direct cousin of English's own word. Its yellow word has a cousin too — but a much more surprising one, sitting inside French.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grün ("**green**") is native Germanic, from Proto-Germanic ****grōniz***, ultimately from **Proto-Indo-European *$\acute{g}^{h}reh_1$-**, "**to grow, to become green**" — the **exact same root** as English's own **green**. Be careful, though: this is a **completely different** root from Latin's **viridis** (source of Spanish's *verde*, French's *vert*), which traces to its own, separate "to grow/flourish" root, ****weis-***. Two unrelated language families each independently built a "green" word out of a verb meaning "to grow" — a real coincidence of logic, not a shared word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "grün" — green, direct cousin of English's own "green"
- "gelb" — yellow, probable hidden cousin of French's jaune
- the contrast — grün's root is unrelated to Latin's viridis, but gelb's root is PROBABLY shared with French's jaune

Before you move on

Is **grün** related to Latin's *viridis*? (**No** — a completely different root, though both independently mean "grow" → "green"; *grün* IS a direct cousin of English's own "green.") What French word is **gelb**'s probable PIE cousin, and how solid is that link? (**Jaune** — both usually traced to PIE **ghel-*, "to shine," though modern Latin scholarship treats *galbus*'s origin as genuinely unknown, so the connection is probable, not certain.)

36.2 (grün, gelb, continued) — gelb

Before going on: say **grün, gelb** again, and what it means.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gelb ("**yellow**") is native too, from Proto-Germanic ****gelwaz*** — and the same word as English's **yellow**. Trace it back far enough, to **Proto-Indo-European **ghel-*** ("**to shine**," with derivatives covering yellow, green, and gold), and it is usually said to land on the **same ancient root** behind Latin's **galbus/galbinus** — the source of **French**'s **jaune**. Honesty check, though: that particular link is **less secure** than it looks — some modern Latin scholarship treats *galbus*'s origin as genuinely unknown rather than confirming the **ghel-* connection. So *gelb* and *jaune* are **probably** PIE-level cousins, despite belonging to completely different language families and reaching German and French by entirely separate paths — just don't treat the link as airtight.

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **grün, gelb**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **grün, gelb**? Say it once more, without looking.

Chapter 37

Verbs of the Mind

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I think, I understand, I read and I write in German, break a strong verb's vowel in the du and er forms, and say which of the four German borrowed rather than inherited.
>
> *The chapter closes on schreiben, the one loan among four inherited verbs: the reader produces all four ich forms and all four er forms, names liest as the only vowel-breaker, and takes Manuskript apart into the Latin hand German never inherited plus the Latin verb it did. It reaches back past its own chapter to reassess Chapter 17's Hand, the Hand/manus gap, and Grimm's law.*

37.1 denken — the verb that was inside *danke* all along

You learned early on that **danke** is built on a verb meaning "to think." Here is that verb, with its own forms at last.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-e-german` — a short, open *e*.
- `ng-cluster` — *n* before *k* is the *ng* of *sing*: **denken** = *DENG-ken*.

You'll want to know: denken

denken means "**to think**," with the same audible endings you drilled on *wohnen*, *machen* and *lernen*:

- **ich denke** — I think · **wir denken** — we think
- **du denkst** — you think · **ihr denkt** — you all think
- **er denkt** — he thinks · **sie denken** — they think

Ich denke, also bin ich. — "I think, therefore I am."

It also carries the weather straight into a new sentence:

Ich denke, es ist kalt. — "I think it is cold."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

denken is Proto-Germanic ****þankijanǫ***. English **think** is that same inherited word — a loan in neither direction.
One consonant separates them, and you have been taught how to read it. With **Haupt** beside *head* you met **Grimm's law**, which turned Proto-Indo-European **k* into Germanic *h*. The same law turned PIE **t* into Germanic **þ*, the *th* sound. English kept it and spells it **th**: *think*. German later softened it to **d**.
Germanic **þankō* meant both "a thought" and "gratitude" — hence German **Dank** and **Gedanke**, and English **thank** beside **think**. To thank was to hold someone in thought. German also kept a sibling verb, **dünken**, "to seem"; English had that one too and let it collapse into *think*.

Grammar Lens: also does not mean "also"

In *Ich denke, also bin ich*, the word **also** means "**therefore**." English *also* is *eall swā*, "all so," meaning *likewise*; German *also* is *al* + *so*, meaning *thus*. Same bricks, different building. A German saying **also** is drawing a conclusion, not adding to a list.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich denke, du denkst, er denkt"

- "wir denken, ihr denkt, sie denken"
- "Ich denke, also bin ich."
- "Ich denke, es ist kalt. Das Wetter ist gut."
- the family — "denken, danke, Dank, Gedanke"
- the shift — PIE *t*, Germanic *th*, German *d*: think, denken

Before you move on

Which chapter-3 word is built on **denken**? (**Danke**.) Is English *think* a borrowing? (**No** — both inherited **þankijanǫ*.) Which law turned PIE **t* into the Germanic *th* German made a *d*? (**Grimm's law**, as in *Haupt* and *head*.) What does German **also** mean? (**Therefore**.)

37.2 verstehen — standing around a thing until you see it

You can say **ich denke**. Thinking happens in the **Kopf**; this is the verb for when it lands — and English built its own word from the same picture, separately.

Sounds you'll need

- `v-as-f` — German **v** is said *f*, so *ver-* is *fair-*.
- `h-silent-lengthening` — the **h** is silent; it marks the vowel before it as long. **verstehen** = *fair-SHTAY-en*.

You'll want to know: verstehen

verstehen means "**to understand**," with the ordinary endings:

- **ich verstehe** · **wir verstehen**
- **du verstehst** · **ihr versteht**
- **er versteht** · **sie verstehen**

Ich verstehe. — said on its own, constantly. **Ich verstehe Deutsch.** — "I understand German."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Break it in two: **ver-** plus **stehen**, "to stand." *Stehen* is English **stand**, the same inherited word, Proto-Germanic ****standanǫ***. The prefix **ver-** is old and worn, and here it carries its ancient sense "around, about." So *verstehen* is literally "**to stand around**" a thing. Now English. **Understand** is *under* + *stand* — and that *under* is not "underneath." The usual explanation is that Old English *under* also carried the sense "among, between," a cousin of Latin *inter*; so *understand* is "to stand **among**" a thing. That reading is standard but not certain, and no honest account will claim otherwise.
Either way the important fact holds: **each language welded a prefix onto its own inherited verb "to stand" and got a word for comprehension.** Neither borrowed the compound. The green-and-yellow lesson showed the same move with **grün**: Germanic and Latin each built "green" from a verb for "grow," independently. This is that coincidence one family closer in.
The verb underneath is one of the family's biggest roots, PIE ****steh₂-***: German **der Verstand** ("reason"), English **stand**, **stead**, **stall**, and — from Latin's *stāre* — **state**, **station**, **stable**, **constant**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich verstehe, du verstehst, er versteht"
- "Ich verstehe Deutsch."
- both verbs — "Ich denke. Ich verstehe."
- the pieces — "ver- + stehen → verstehen", like "under + stand → understand"
- the parallel — like *grün* beside *viridis*, built, not shared
- where it happens — "der Kopf" — and what stands in it, "der Verstand"

Before you move on

Which English verb hides inside **verstehen**? (**Stand** — German built its own "under-stand" from its own pieces.) Did English borrow *understand* from German? (**No** — each built its own compound.) How solid is the "under = among" account? (**Standard, but not certain**.) Say "I think" and "I understand." (***Ich denke. Ich verstehe.***)

37.3 lesen — gathering, and the first verb that changes its vowel

Every German verb so far has kept its vowel in every form. This one does not — and its older meaning is **gathering**.

Sounds you'll need

- `long-e` — a long *e*, English *ay* without the glide.
- `s-voiced` — a single **s** between vowels buzzes like *z*: *LAY-zen*.

You'll want to know: lesen

lesen means "**to read**."

- **ich lese** — I read · **wir lesen** — we read
- **du liest** — you read · **ihr lest** — you all read
- **er liest** — he reads · **sie lesen** — they read

Ich lese Deutsch. — "I read German."

Grammar Lens: the vowel that breaks in the middle

Four forms keep the **e** of *lesen*. Two swap it for a long **ie**: *du* ***liest***, *er* ***liest***.
That is the mark of a **strong verb**: the vowel changes inside the word, in exactly two present-tense forms — **du** and **er/sie/es**. Nothing else moves; the endings stay the familiar *-e / -st / -t*. It is a rule about a whole class of verbs, not about *lesen*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lesen is Proto-Germanic ****lesanǫ***, "**to gather**." That sense still lives in **die Weinlese**, the grape harvest — the *wine-gathering*, built on the **Wein** you already have. Reading came second: you pick the letters up, one after another.

Now the trap. Latin **legere** also meant "to gather," also came to mean "to read," and stands behind **legible**, **lecture**, **lesson** and **collect**. It looks like one shared word. It probably is **not**: the sounds do not correspond as they should, and the standard account ties *lesen* to a separate root, whose clearest cousin is Lithuanian *lèsti*, "to peck up grain." Treat it as you treated **grün** beside *viridis*.

English **read** is a third story: Old English *rædan*, "to advise," which is German **raten** and **das Rätsel** ("riddle"). *Lesen* and *read* are no relation.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich lese, du liest, er liest" — hear the vowel break
- "wir lesen, ihr lest, sie lesen" — and back
- "Ich lese Deutsch. Ich verstehe Deutsch."
- the old meaning — "die Weinlese"
- the three so far — "denken, verstehen, lesen"
- why *lesen* is not *legere* — the reason *grün* is not *viridis*

Before you move on

Which two forms of a strong verb break their vowel, and what are they here? (**Du** and **er/sie/es** — ***du liest, er liest***.) What did *lesen* mean first? (**To gather** — *die Weinlese*.) Is it Latin *legere*? (**Probably not** — the sounds do not correspond.) And English *read*? (**No relation** — it meant "to advise," and is German *raten*.)

37.4 schreiben — the one borrowed verb

Three verbs in, all three English's own blood relatives. The fourth breaks the run: **German borrowed it; English did not.**

Sounds you'll need

- `sch-sh` — **sch** is one sound, English *sh*.
- `diphthong-ei` — **ei** is said *eye*: **schreiben** = *SHRY-ben*.

You'll want to know: schreiben

schreiben means "**to write**."

- **ich schreibe** — I write · **wir schreiben** — we write
- **du schreibst** — you write · **ihr schreibt** — you all write
- **er schreibt** — he writes · **sie schreiben** — they write

Ich schreibe Deutsch. · **Die Hand schreibt.**

Grammar Lens: strong, but not here

Lesen taught you to watch **du** and **er**. Here: *du schreibst*, *er schreibt* — **the vowel does not move.** *Schreiben* is strong (its past is *schrieb*), but its present is smooth. So the rule is exact: a strong verb *may* break its vowel there. Hold the pair: *du liest*, but *du schreibst*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schreiben is Latin ***scrībere***, and before that "**to scratch**." German took it in with the writing itself, and early: the loan passed through German sound changes — *sc-* became *sch-* — and joined the native strong verbs, its past becoming *schrieb*. A late loan would have done neither.

English refused it. **Write** is Old English *wrītan*, also "**to scratch**," because runes were cut; German **reißen** and **ritzen** are its relatives. Two languages, two writing-words, both meaning *scratch*. Latin's verb reached English anyway: **scribe**, **script**, **describe**, **transcript**.

And one closes a circle back to **die Hand**. German **Hand** has **no**

Latin cousin — Latin says *manus* — yet *manus* reached German as a loan: **Manuskript**. *Manu-* is *manus*, the hand; *-skript* is *scrīptum*, this verb. A **Manuskript** is written *by hand*: the Latin hand-word German never inherited, bolted to the Latin writing-verb it did.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Die Hand schreibt. Ich schreibe Deutsch."
- the four "I" forms — "ich denke, ich verstehe, ich lese, ich schreibe"
- the four "he" forms — "er denkt, er versteht, er liest, er schreibt" — only *liest* broke
- three inherited, one borrowed — "denken/think, verstehen/stand, lesen/gather", then "schreiben/scrībere"
- denken's *d* — PIE *t*, Germanic *th*: Grimm's law
- "Ich denke, also bin ich." — and what *also* does
- *Manuskript* — *manus* plus *scrīptum*

Before you move on

Say all four "I" forms. (***Ich denke, ich verstehe, ich lese, ich schreibe***.) Which is the loan? (***Schreiben***, from *scrībere*, "to scratch" — as English *write* also meant.) Which "he" form breaks its vowel? (Only ***liest***.) Which half of *Manuskript* did German never inherit? (***Manus***, its own **Hand**.) And German *also*? (**Therefore**.)

Chapter 38

Taking, Asking, Helping, Liking

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I take, I ask, I help and I like in German, sort all eight verbs of these two chapters into the three present-tense patterns, and use gern to say I like doing something.
>
> *The chapter closes on mögen, lieben and gern: the reader produces all eight ich forms of Chapters 24 and 25, sorts them into vowel-stays, vowel-breaks and the old third pattern, hangs gern on four verbs already learned, and runs the nine-word cousin roll-call. It reaches back to every atom of Chapter 24 and to Chapters 21 and 22 — Ich mag das Wetter, Ich mag die Katze, Der Hund mag Wasser.*

38.1 nehmen — the verb English threw away

Four verbs about doing rather than thinking. **Schreiben** was a Latin word German took and English refused; this one is the reverse — a Germanic word English threw away and German kept.

Sounds you'll need

- `long-e` — a long *e*: **nehmen** = *NAY-men*.
- `h-silent-lengthening` — the **h** is silent, marking the long vowel.

You'll want to know: nehmen

nehmen means "**to take**." It is what a **Hand** does.

- **ich nehme** — I take · **wir nehmen** — we take
- **du nimmst** — you take · **ihr nehmt** — you all take
- **er nimmt** — he takes · **sie nehmen** — they take

Grammar Lens: the rule again, and harder

You know where to look: **du** and **er**. Long *e* becomes short **i** — *du* ***nimmst***, *er* ***nimmt*** — while *wir*, *ihr* and *sie* keep the *e*.
This goes further than *lesen* did: once the vowel shortens the silent *h* has no job, so it drops and the **m** doubles: *nehmen* but *nimmt*. Say them back to back — *NAY-men*, *NIMT*.
Three shapes now: *du liest* breaks its vowel; *du nimmst* breaks it and respells the word; *du schreibst* does not break at all.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nehmen is Proto-Germanic ****nemanǫ***, "to take." English had it — Old English *niman* — and then **lost it**, because Norse settlers brought *taka* and English took **take** instead.
A lost word leaves fossils, and English carries two. **Numb** is the old past participle of *nim*: a hand *taken* by the cold. **Nimble** is "quick to take hold."
Beyond Germanic the root ***nem-** meant "to assign, to allot," and Greek's version is unexpectedly familiar: *némein*, "to distribute," gives **nomad**, **economy** and **nemesis**.

Why it's said this way

German **bekommen** means "**to receive, to get**" — not "to become." Both are built from the same prefix and the same verb of motion, and then the meanings walked off in opposite directions. A German saying **Ich bekomme...** in a café is being served, not transformed.
Recognise *bekommen*; **say** *nehmen*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich nehme, du nimmst, er nimmt" — *NAY-me, NIMST, NIMT*
- "wir nehmen, ihr nehmt, sie nehmen" — the long *e* is back
- "Die Hand nimmt. Die Hand schreibt."
- the three shapes — "du liest, du nimmst, du schreibst"
- the fossils — "nehmen, numb, nimble"
- borrowed against lost — "schreiben came in from Latin; niman went out"
- the trap — "bekommen is *receive*"

Before you move on

Give the *du* and *er* forms. (***Du nimmst, er nimmt*** — the *h* drops, the *m* doubles.) Which verb replaced the English cousin of *nehmen*? (**Take**, from Norse.) Name the two fossils it left. (**Numb** and **nimble**.) What does **bekommen** mean? (**To receive**.) And say "the hand takes." (***Die Hand nimmt.***)

38.2 fragen — asking, and the three answers German gives back

After two vowel-breaking verbs, a rest: this one keeps its vowel everywhere. And you already own its answers — all **three** of them.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-a-german` — a pure open *ah*: **fragen** = *FRAH-gen.*
- `r-uvular-german` — the soft guttural *r* you first met in *lernen.*

You'll want to know: fragen

fragen means "**to ask**."

- **ich frage** · **wir fragen**
- **du fragst** · **ihr fragt**

- **er fragt** · **sie fragen**

The noun sits beside it: **die Frage**, "the question."

Grammar Lens: the vowel that stays

Check the two forms that break in a strong verb. *Du fragst. Er fragt.* The *a* has not moved.
fragen is a **weak** verb — the ordinary kind, built like *lernen* and *machen*: endings only, stem untouched. That matters, because after *lesen* and *nehmen* it is easy to start breaking vowels everywhere. Most German verbs are weak; the strong ones are a closed club, learned one at a time. Hold the pair: **du nimmst**, but **du fragst**.

Why it's said this way

An asked question wants an answer, and you have the whole German set already. English has two. German has **three**:

- **ja** — yes.
- **nein** — no.
- **doch** — the one English has no word for: *yes, against what you just said.* It exists to contradict a negative.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fragen goes back to Proto-Indo-European ****prek̑-***, "to ask." Germanic turned that opening *p* into an *f* — the Grimm's-law step that puts *father* beside Latin *pater*.
English once had the cousin, Old English *frignan*, and dropped it, just as it dropped the cousin of *nehmen*. The word it uses instead, **ask**, is a different Germanic word and no relation.
So English gets the root back only the long way round. Latin *precārī*, "to beg, to pray," is the same verb, and gives **pray**, **prayer** and **precarious** — literally "held only by asking for it."
One caution: Latin *rogāre*, "to ask," behind *interrogate*, looks like a candidate and is **not** related — it belongs with *rēx* and *right*, a root about straightening and ruling.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich frage, du fragst, er fragt" — the *a* never moves
- "die Frage" — the question
- the contrast — "du liest, du nimmst", then "du fragst"
- the three answers — "ja, nein, doch"
- the Latin cousins — "pray, prayer, precarious"
- the two verbs English dropped — "nehmen, fragen"

Before you move on

Is **fragen** strong or weak, and how do you know? (**Weak** — *du fragst*, the vowel never breaks.) Name German's three answers. (***Ja***, ***nein***, ***doch*** — the last contradicts a negative.) Is English *ask* a relative? (**No**.) Which English words carry the root instead? (**Pray**, **precarious**, through Latin *precārī*.) Say "I ask" and "I take." (***Ich frage. Ich nehme.***)

38.3 helfen — one word, one sound law, two languages

Almost nothing sits between the two words: **helfen** *is* **help**. The lesson is the single sound that separates them — and it is not the law you already know.

Sounds you'll need

- `h-pronounced` — a real, breathed *h*, unlike the silent one in *nehmen*.
- `f-final` — a clean *f*: **helfen** = *HEL-fen*.

You'll want to know: helfen

helfen means "**to help**," and it is strong, so you know where to look:

- **ich helfe** · **wir helfen**
- **du hilfst** · **ihr helft**
- **er hilft** · **sie helfen**

The *e* becomes **i** in *du* and *er*, exactly as in *nehmen* — the third verb to do it, so by now you can predict it.

One honest limit: when German names the person helped, that person's word takes a noun form this book has not taught. Keep to **Ich helfe** on its own.

Why it's said this way

The noun is **die Hilfe**, "help" — the same *e* to *i* change, frozen. And **bitte** gave you the shape for asking politely: name the thing, then say **bitte**.

Hilfe, bitte. — "Help, please."

A whole request, from one new noun and one old word.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

helfen is Proto-Germanic ****helpaną***, and English **help** is the same inherited word.

The only difference is **p** against **f**, from a different law than the one behind **Haupt**. That was **Grimm's law**, the *first* shift, PIE sounds into Germanic ones — seen again in *fragen*'s *p* becoming *f*. This is the **second**, High German shift, much later, and the event that split German from English. After a vowel, Germanic **p** became German **f**: *helpan* → **helfen**; *ship* → **Schiff**; *open* → **offen**; *sharp* → **scharf**; *deep* → **tief**.

Outside Germanic, be honest: *helfen* has **no secure cousins** — a proposed link to Lithuanian *šelpti* is disputed.

English keeps a fossil, though. *Helfen* is still strong — *helfen, half, geholfen* — and *help* was too: its old **holp** and **holpen** survive in old Bibles and dialect. English let the shape go within recorded memory.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich helfe, du hilfst, er hilft" — the *e* breaks to *i*
- "Hilfe, bitte."
- the strong pair — "du nimmst, du hilfst" — then the weak "du fragst"
- the second shift five times — "helfen/help, Schiff/ship, offen/open, scharf/sharp, tief/deep"
- which law was which — Grimm's law gave *Haupt*; the second shift gave *helfen*

Before you move on

Give the *du* and *er* forms. (***Du hilfst, er hilft.***) Which shift separates *helfen* from *help*, and is it the one behind *Haupt* and *head*? (The **second**, High German shift — **no**, *Haupt* was **Grimm's law**.) Name two more pairs from it. (**Schiff/ship**, **offen/open**, **scharf/sharp**.) Cousins outside Germanic? (**None secure**.) Ask for help politely. (***Hilfe, bitte.***)

38.4 mögen, lieben, gern — German's three ways of liking

English says "I like." German has **three** ways, and the commonest is not a verb.

You'll want to know: mögen and lieben

mögen ("to like", *MER-gen* — **ö** is *ay* with rounded lips) is a **third** pattern, an old verb whose *ich* and *er* forms take no ending:

- **ich mag · wir mögen**
- **du magst · ihr mögt**
- **er mag · sie mögen**

lieben ("to love", *LEE-ben* — **ie** is a long *ee*) is weak: *ich liebe, du liebst, er liebt.*

> **Ich mag die Katze.** · **Der Hund mag Wasser.** · **Ich mag das Wetter.** · **Ich liebe Deutsch.**

A masculine **der** noun changes its article after *mögen* — untaught here, so these use **die** and **das** words.

Grammar Lens: gern hangs on any verb

gern is an adverb, "**gladly**," dropped in after a verb:

> **Ich lese gern.** — "I read gladly": **I like reading**. **Ich schreibe gern.** · **Ich helfe gern.**

English must rebuild the sentence, with *like* plus a verb in *-ing*; German changes nothing. So: **mögen** for a thing, **gern** for an activity, **lieben** for love.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

All three are English words you already own.
mögen is ***maganą***, "**to have power**" — English **may**. The meaning slid from being able, to being inclined, to liking; the power sense survives in **might** and **die Macht**.
lieben is ***leubaz***, "dear" — English **love** exactly, with **lief** and **believe** (to *hold dear*). **gern** is ***gernaz***, "eager" — English **yearn**. So *Ich lese gern* is "I read yearningly."

What you've built across these two chapters

- **vowel stays**: *denken*, *verstehen*, *fragen*, *schreiben* (strong only in its past).
- **vowel breaks**: *du liest*, *du nimmst*, *du hilfst.*
- **third pattern**: *ich mag*, *du magst*, *er mag.*
- **the traps**: **bekommen** is "receive," never "become"; **also** is "therefore," never "also."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich mag, du magst, er mag"
- "Ich mag die Katze. Der Hund mag Wasser. Ich mag das Wetter."
- *gern* on four — "Ich lese gern. Ich schreibe gern. Ich helfe gern. Ich frage gern."
- the breakers, then not — "du liest, du nimmst, du hilfst", "du fragst"
- all eight "I" forms — "ich denke, ich verstehe, ich lese, ich schreibe, ich nehme, ich frage, ich helfe, ich mag"
- the roll-call — "denken/think, verstehen/stand, lesen/gather, schreiben/scrībere, nehmen/numb, fragen/pray, helfen/help, mögen/may, lieben/love, gern/yearn"

Before you move on

How does German say "I like reading," literally? (***Ich lese gern*** — "I read gladly.") Say: you like the cat; the dog likes water. (***Ich mag die Katze. Der Hund mag Wasser.***) Which three of the eight break their vowel? (***Lesen, nehmen, helfen***.) And the two traps — **bekommen**, **also**? (**Receive**; **therefore**.)

Chapter 39

Sitting, Standing, Sleeping, Hearing

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say I sit, I stand, I sleep and I hear in German, tell the second shift's t-branch from its p-branch, break a verb's a to ä for du and er, and say which of the four changes German made alone and which it made alongside English.

The chapter closes on hören, the one verb of the four whose vowel cannot break because it was born umlauted: the reader produces all four ich forms and all four er forms, names schlafen as the only breaker, tells Grimm's law on the h of hören and Hund from the second shift on sitzen and schlafen, and hangs gern on the new verb. It reaches back past its own chapter to Chapter 17's Grimm's law, Chapter 22's Hund and Katze with the Hund etymology that had never been revisited, and Chapter 25's mögen, lieben and gern, all three of which were orphans until here.

39.1 sitzen — the same word as *sit*, respelt by one law

Helfen *is* **help**, split by the second sound shift: Germanic **p** became German **f**. That law has other branches. This verb rides one.

Sounds you'll need

- `tz-affricate` — **tz** is one squeezed sound, *ts*, as in English *cats*.
- `i-short` — a short, tight *i*: **sitzen** = *ZIT-sen*, buzzed at the front because German **s** before a vowel is voiced.

You'll want to know: sitzen

sitzen means "**to sit**."

- **ich sitze** — I sit · **wir sitzen** — we sit
- **du sitzt** — you sit · **ihr sitzt** — you all sit
- **er sitzt** — he sits · **sie sitzen** — they sit

Ich sitze. — a whole sentence, two words.

Grammar Lens: strong does not mean it breaks

Sitzen is a **strong** verb — its past is *saß*, not *sitzte*. But its present never breaks its vowel: *du sitzt, er sitzt*. Beside it, *helfen* breaks to *du hilfst*.
So "strong" is a fact about a verb's **past**; the *du/er* break is a separate habit only some strong verbs have.
The doing verbs gave two ways to say you like something: **ich mag** with a thing, **gern** hung on a verb. This verb takes the second.

Ich sitze gern. — "I like sitting."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sitzen is Proto-Germanic ****sitjanǫ***, and English **sit** is the same inherited word — Old English *sittan*, Old High German *sizzen*.
The second, High German shift moved Germanic **p** to **f** in *helfen*. It moved Germanic **t** just as hard, to **z** (said *ts*) or **ss**: *sittan* → **sitzen**, *water* → **Wasser**, *eat* → **essen**, *ten* → **zehn**, *bite* → **beißen**. The food lesson handed you *Wasser* and the first numbers handed you *zehn* long before there was a name for what had happened to them.
Under both lies PIE ****sed-***, "to sit," one of the family's great providers. Latin *sedēre* gives **session**, **sedentary** and **preside**; Latin *sedēs*, "a seat," gives the bishop's **see**. Greek *hédra*, also "a seat," gives

cathedral — the church with the bishop's chair — and **polyhedron**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich sitze, du sitzt, er sitzt" — the *i* never moves
- the contrast — "du sitzt" beside "du hilfst"
- "Ich sitze gern."
- the *t* branch four times — "sitzen/sit, Wasser/water, essen/eat, zehn/ten"
- the *p* branch beside it — "helfen/help"
- the seat words — "sitzen, sedēre, hédra, cathedral"

Before you move on

Give the *du* and *er* forms of *sitzen*. (***Du sitzt, er sitzt*** — no break.) Which of the doing verbs does break, and how? (***Helfen*** — *du hilfst*.) Which sound did the second shift turn German's **z** and **ss** out of? (An old **t**.) Name two pairs from that branch. (**Wasser/water**, **essen/eat**, **zehn/ten**.) Say you like sitting. (***Ich sitze gern***.)

39.2 stehen — the verb that was hiding inside *verstehen*

Verstehen was broken into *ver-* plus *stehen*, and named *stehen* as English **stand**. Here is that verb alone, and the letter the two languages disagree about.

Sounds you'll need

- `st-initial-scht` — **st** at the start of a German word is said *sht*.
- `h-silent-lengthening` — the **h** is silent and marks the long vowel: **stehen** = *SHTAY-en*.

You'll want to know: stehen

stehen means "**to stand**."

- **ich stehe** — I stand · **wir stehen** — we stand
- **du stehst** — you stand · **ihr steht** — you all stand
- **er steht** — he stands · **sie stehen** — they stand

Like *sitzen*, it keeps its vowel all the way through. Two postures, two sentences:

Ich sitze. Ich stehe.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Germanic ran two stems off one root here: a short ****stānǫ*** and a longer ****standanǫ*** with an **n** wedged inside. English generalised the long one and got **stand**; German took the short one and got **stehen**, Old High German *stān*.
German did not lose the *n*. It kept it in the past: **ich stand**, and the participle **gestanden**. German's past tense is spelt the way English's present is, out of the same drawer of stems.
The root is PIE ****steh₂-***, the one *verstehen* named, and it is everywhere. Latin *stāre* gave **state**, **station**, **stable**, **constant**. Greek *hístēmi*, "I set up," gave **static**, **system** and **ecstasy** — standing outside yourself. German built **die Stadt**, a city: a standing-place. English built **stead**, **steady** and **instead**.

Why it's said this way

Notice the shape of what has happened. *Sitzen* goes back to ****sed-***, and so does Latin's *sedēre*. *Stehen* goes back to ****steh₂-***, and so does Latin's *stāre*.
Nothing was borrowed in either direction. Two families inherited the same two roots and held them to the same two meanings for thousands of years, because sitting and standing are things everybody does.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich stehe, du stehst, er steht" — *SHTAY*, not *STAY*
- both postures — "Ich sitze. Ich stehe."
- the verb inside the verb — "stehen, verstehen"
- where the *n* went — "ich stehe, ich stand, gestanden"
- the Latin pair — "sitzen/sedēre, stehen/stāre"
- what stands in English — "state, station, stable, stead"

Before you move on

Give the *du* and *er* forms. (***Du stehst, er steht.***) Which letter does English's *stand* carry that German's *stehen* does not? (An **n**.) Where does German still keep it? (In the **past** — *ich stand, gestanden.*) Which longer verb already taught has *stehen* inside it? (***Verstehen.***) Say "I sit. I stand." (***Ich sitze. Ich stehe.***)

39.3 schlafen — *sleep*, under two coats of paint

Sitzen and *stehen* held their vowels still. This one does not — and it does not break the way the mind verbs broke either.

Sounds you'll need

- `sch-sh` — **sch** is English *sh*: **schlafen** = *SHLAH-fen.*
- `vowel-ae` — **ä** is a flat *eh*: **schläft** = *SHLEFT.*

You'll want to know: schlafen

schlafen means "**to sleep**."

- **ich schlafe** · **wir schlafen**
- **du schläfst** · **ihr schlaft**
- **er schläft** · **sie schlafen**

Die Katze schläft. — "The cat is sleeping."

Grammar Lens: the second kind of break

Lesen gave you one break: long *e* goes to **i** for *du* and *er* — *du liest*, *er hilft*. Here is the other: **a** takes two dots and becomes **ä** — *du schläfst*, *er schläft*.
Those two dots are the umlaut, the mark that turns *Buch* into *Bücher*. The break lands in the same slot as before, **du** and **er** and nobody else, so only its raw material is new: *e* verbs brighten to *i*, *a* verbs to *ä*.

Es regnet. Die Katze schläft.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schlafen is Proto-Germanic ****slēpanǫ***, and English **sleep** is the same inherited word — Old English *slæpan*, Old High German *slāfan*.
Two German changes sit between them. The first you know: the second shift, Germanic **p** to German **f**, as in *helfen*. The second is new — German turned **s** into *sh* before *l*, *m*, *n* and *w*, and wrote it down: *sleep* → **schlafen**, *swim* → **schwimmen**, *snow* → **Schnee**, *smith* → **Schmied**. It did the same before *p* and *t* and never spelt it, which is why *stehen* is said *SHTAY-en*.
Now the honest part. The old Indo-European verb for sleeping was ****swep-***, still in plain view: Latin *somnus* gives **insomnia** and **somnolent**, Latin *sopor* gives **soporific**, Greek *hýpnos* gives **hypnosis**, and Old Norse *sofa* is Swedish *sova* today. German and English both threw that verb away and built a new one on ****sleb-***, "to be slack" — German still has **schlaff**, "limp." They made that swap **together**, before they were two languages.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich schlafe, du schläfst, er schläft" — the *a* brightens to *ä*
- the three verbs — "Ich sitze. Ich stehe. Ich schlafe."
- "Es regnet. Die Katze schläft."
- both breaks in the same slot — "du hilfst" beside "du schläfst"
- the *sch* row — "schlafen, schwimmen, Schnee, Schmied"

- the verb they both threw away — "somnus, hypnos, sova"

Before you move on

Give the *du* and *er* forms. (***Du schläfst, er schläft*** — two dots on the *a*.) Which two people does a German verb break for? (**Du** and **er**, always.) Name the two changes between *sleep* and *schlafen*. (**p** to **f**, and **s** to **sch**.) Why is *stehen* said *SHTAY-en*? (**Same change**, never spelt.) Say "the cat is sleeping." (***Die Katze schläft***.)

39.4 hören — *hear*, and the end of a chapter that never moved

Ich sitze. Ich stehe. Ich schlafe. Three verbs that stay put. Here is the fourth — the sense that works with your eyes shut.

Sounds you'll need

- `umlaut-oe` — **ö** is the *e* of *bed* said with rounded lips.
- `r-uvular` — the **r** is a soft scrape at the back: **hören** = *HUR-en*.

You'll want to know: hören

hören means "**to hear**."

- **ich höre · wir hören**
- **du hörst · ihr hört**
- **er hört · sie hören**

The **ö** never moves. *Schlafen* grew its dots for *du* and *er*; *hören* was born with them, so nothing is left to break.

Der Hund hört. Die Katze hört.

Grammar Lens: liking it, the mögen way

gern hangs on this verb like any other:

Ich höre gern. — "I like listening."

Gern is English **yearn**: underneath, "I hear yearningly." Beside it is the other way of liking, **ich mag** — English **may**, with the power drained out.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hören is Proto-Germanic ****hauzijanǫ***, and English **hear** is the same inherited word.
This time the change is one they **share**. Gothic still says *hausjan*, with an **s**; Old English *hīeran* and Old High German *hōren* had both turned it to **r**. *Sitzen* shows where German left English; *hören* shows a road they walked together.
The **h** is Grimm's law, the first shift: an old **k** became Germanic **h**. Greek kept the *k* — *akoúein*, "to hear," which English borrowed back as **acoustic**. Same swap that made **kwon-* into **Hund** while Latin kept *canis*.
Some break the root up further, into "sharp" plus "ear" — which would make *hören* "sharp-eared" and put **das Ohr** inside it. Cited often, not settled.

Why it's said this way

gehören means "**to belong**." It is *ge-* welded onto *hören*, and began as "to hearken to": what belongs to you answers when called.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- all four — "Ich sitze. Ich stehe. Ich schlafe. Ich höre."
- the four *er* forms — "er sitzt, er steht, er schläft, er hört"
- "Der Hund hört. Die Katze schläft."
- "Ich höre gern."
- the shared change — "hausjan, hīeran, hōren"
- the *h* row — "hören/akoúein, Hund/canis"
- "gehören is *belong*"

Before you move on

Give all four *ich* forms of this chapter. (***Ich sitze, ich stehe, ich schlafe, ich höre***.) Which breaks its vowel? (***Schlafen*** — *a* to *ä*.) Which letter did Gothic keep where German and English have *r*? (An **s**.) Which law put the *h* on *hören* and *Hund*? (**Grimm's law**.)

Chapter 40

Going, Running, Opening, Closing

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I go, I run and I open and close my hand in German, split a separable verb so its prefix waits at the end of the sentence, and say why German's line between walking and running is not where English draws it.
>
> *The chapter closes on schließen, the second verb in these chapters that German kept and English lost: the reader produces all of Chapter 27's verbs, splits both aufmachen and zumachen around die Hand, names Schloss, Schlüssel and Schluss as the household built on the kept verb, and runs the eight-verb morning that closes Chapters 26 and 27 together. It reaches back to Chapter 25's nehmen and the second shift on helfen, to Chapter 17's Hand and its final-d devoicing, which had never been revisited, and to Chapter 26's sitzen, stehen and hören.*

40.1 gehen — *go*, and the word German never needed for *walk*

Four verbs that stayed put — sitting, standing, sleeping, hearing. Now a chapter that moves, opening on the verb German uses where English has two.

Sounds you'll need

- `h-silent-lengthening` — the **h** is silent and lengthens: **gehen** = *GAY-en*, built exactly like *stehen*, *SHTAY-en*.
- `ge-prefix` — **ge-** at the front is said *guh*, never *jee*.

You'll want to know: gehen

gehen means "**to go**" — and also "**to walk**." German does not split those.

- **ich gehe** · **wir gehen**
- **du gehst** · **ihr geht**
- **er geht** · **sie gehen**

Ich stehe. Ich gehe.

Two verbs cut to the same short shape, each with a silent *h* propping the vowel up. Say them together and you hear a matched pair: *SHTAY-en, GAY-en.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gehen is Proto-Germanic ****gānǫ*** and English **go** is the same inherited word, Old English *gān*.
Both languages then hit the same problem: the verb had no usable past, and each went shopping. English took **went**, really the past of *wend*, and left *wend* stranded. German took **ging** and **gegangen** from another old verb, ****ganganǫ***, "to walk" — which English still owns in **gangway**, **gangplank**, and Scots *gang*, "to go."
Gegangen carries the same *ge-* you met on **gehören**: an old prefix German fastens to a past participle.
Beyond Germanic, be honest — the deeper root of *go* is **disputed**, with no agreed list of cousins. It is the one verb here that cannot be followed back.

Why it's said this way

Because **walk** is not an old word for travelling on foot. Old English *wealcan* meant "to roll, to toss," and its German cousin **walken** still means what it always meant: **to full cloth**, to work wool by trampling it.
English promoted that trampling verb around 1200. German never did, so *gehen* covers both jobs.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich gehe, du gehst, er geht"
- the matched pair — "Ich stehe. Ich gehe."
- the borrowed pasts — "go/went" beside "gehen/ging/gegangen"
- where English kept the other verb — "gangway, gangplank"
- the *ge-* on both — "gehören, gegangen"
- what *walken* does — it fulls cloth, it does not travel

Before you move on

Give the *du* and *er* forms. (***Du gehst, er geht.***) Which English verb is *gehen*? (**Go**, and **walk** as well.) Where did *went* come from? (From ***wend.***) What does German's cousin of *walk* mean? (**To full cloth.**) How far back can *gehen* be traced? (**Not past Germanic.**)

40.2 laufen — the verb that lies across English's line

Ich gehe covers going and walking. German has two words for *run*, and one of them is not only about running.

Sounds you'll need

- `diphthong-au` — **au** is the *ow* of *house*: **laufen** = *LOW-fen.*
- `diphthong-eu` — **äu** is the *oy* of *boy*: **läuft** = *LOYFT.*

You'll want to know: laufen

laufen means "**to run**" — and often "to walk."

- **ich laufe** · **wir laufen**
- **du läufst** · **ihr lauft**
- **er läuft** · **sie laufen**

The *schlafen* break is here too, in the same *du* and *er* slot: **au** brightens to **äu**.

Der Hund läuft.

Why it's said this way

English draws a hard line between *walk* and *run*. German draws it elsewhere, and leaves one verb lying across it.

- **gehen** — on foot, unhurried.
- **laufen** — on foot at any speed at all.
- **rennen** — flat out. *ich renne, du rennst, er rennt.*

So **Wir laufen** is "we're walking" or "we're running," and only the situation tells you which. That holds across most of Germany. In **Austria** it does not: there *laufen* means *run*. This book teaches the German usage.

Der Hund rennt. — no ambiguity left.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

laufen is Proto-Germanic ****hlaupaną***, and English kept it as **leap** — Old English *hlēapan*. One more **p** against **f**, the second shift, on the pattern of *helfen/help*, *offen/open* and *schlafen/sleep*.
English holds three more scraps: **lope**, and — through Dutch relatives of the same verb — **elope** and **interloper**, both people running off. Outside Germanic there are **no secure cousins**.
Rennen is a sharper story. Germanic had **rinnaną*, "to run, to flow," and beside it a causative **rannijaną*, "to make something run." German fused the two into **rennen** and kept *rinnen*, "to trickle," alongside. English fused the same two into **run** — one merger, carried out separately in each language.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich laufe, du läufst, er läuft" — *LOW-fuh, LOYFST, LOYFT*
- the three speeds — "Ich gehe. Ich laufe. Ich renne."
- "Der Hund läuft. Der Hund rennt."
- the *p*/*f* row now four long — "helfen/help, offen/open, schlafen/sleep, laufen/leap"

- the runaways — “lope, elope, interloper”
- the doubled merger — “rinnen, rennen” beside English’s one *run*

Before you move on

Give the *du* and *er* forms of *laufen*. (***Du läufst, er läuft*** — *au* to *äu*.) Which English verb is *laufen*? (**Leap** — and it means *run*.) Which German verb means only “run fast”? (***Rennen***.) Does **Wir laufen** mean walking or running? (**Either** — except in Austria, where it is running.) Say “the dog runs.” (***Der Hund rennt***.)

40.3 öffnen — *open*, which was always the word *up*

Ich gehe. Ich laufe. Ich renne. Now something done with the hands, and the German habit that breaks a verb in two.

Sounds you’ll need

- `umlaut-oe` — **ö** is the *e* of *bed* with rounded lips.
- `fn-cluster` — **-fn-** runs straight together: **öffnen** = *UFF-nen*.

You’ll want to know: öffnen

öffnen means “**to open**.”

- **ich öffne** · **wir öffnen**
- **du öffnest** · **ihr öffnet**
- **er öffnet** · **sie öffnen**

An extra **e** slips in for *du*, *er* and *ihr*, because *öffnst* cannot be said. Now a noun you already have, whose **d** is spoken as a **t**:

Ich öffne die Hand. — “I open my hand.” (*dee Hant*)

Grammar Lens: a verb that comes apart

Öffnen is the neutral, slightly formal word. What people say out loud is **aufmachen**, and both halves are yours already: **auf** from *auf Wiedersehen*, **machen** from your first verbs.
Here is the German part. In an ordinary sentence, **the prefix leaves the verb and waits at the end**:

> **Ich mache die Hand auf.** — literally "I make the hand up."

Machen takes the slot after *ich*; *auf* goes to the back and sits there. German does this to hundreds of verbs, and calls them **separable**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Behind the verb is the adjective **offen**, "open" — which the doing verbs already put beside **open** as a **p**-to-**f** pair from the second shift. The better secret is that **neither word is a root**. Old English *open* goes back to Proto-Germanic ****upana-***, "put up," formed on the word that is now English **up** — it has the shape of a past participle, though no such verb "to up" is attested. German ran the same sum and got *offen*, which is why *offen* and **auf** are relatives and not merely neighbours.
So *aufmachen* is not a quaint compound. It is the ancient recipe for "open," rebuilt out loud — and German pulls it apart every time you use it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich öffne, du öffnest, er öffnet" — the extra *e*
- "Ich öffne die Hand." — *dee Hant*
- the split — "Ich mache die Hand auf."
- the *p*/*f* pair — "offen/open"
- what it is made of — "auf, up, offen, open"
- the feet verbs before the hand one — "Ich gehe. Ich laufe. Ich renne."

Before you move on

Give the *du* and *er* forms. (***Du öffnest, er öffnet.***) Which older word is *offen* built from? (**Auf** — English **up**.) Where does *auf* go in **Ich mache die Hand auf**? (**To the end**.) What is such a verb called? (**Separable**.) How is the *d* of *Hand* spoken? (As a **t**.)

40.4 schließen — the second verb English lost

You can open a hand two ways, **ich öffne** and **ich mache ... auf**. Closing works the same, and the closing verb has the stranger history.

Sounds you'll need

- `ie-long-ee` — **ie** is a long *ee*: **schließen** = *SHLEE-sen*.
- `eszett` — **ß** is a sharp *s*, and it appears here because the *ee* before it is long.

You'll want to know: schließen

schließen means "**to close**," and also "to lock."

- **ich schließe** · **wir schließen**
- **du schließt** · **ihr schließt**
- **er schließt** · **sie schließen**

Its everyday partner is **zumachen** — *zu* plus *machen* — splitting exactly as *aufmachen* did:

Ich schließe die Hand. Ich mache die Hand zu.

The vowel shortens in the past, and the moment it does the **ß** becomes **ss**: *schließen*, but *schloss*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schließen is Proto-Germanic ****sleutanǫ***, "to shut, to bolt." Dutch kept it as *sluiten*. **English has nothing** — no inherited cousin at all.

So English closes things with borrowed and unrelated words. **Close** is Latin *claudere*, by way of French. **Shut** is native but a different verb entirely: Old English *scyttan*, to **shoot** a bolt across a door.
That makes two verbs here with the same shape of story. The doing verbs gave you *nehmen*, which English lost to Norse *take*. This is the second.
On the verb it kept, German built a household: **das Schloss**, a lock — and, because a castle is the locked place, a castle; **der Schlüssel**, a key; **der Schluss**, the end. English says **conclusion** for that last one, from *claudere* — the same idea out of the other family's parts.
A link between the Germanic verb and Latin *claudere* has been **proposed**. It is not established.

What you've built across these two chapters

Eight verbs, and a whole small morning:

> **Ich schlafe. Ich höre. Ich stehe. Ich gehe. Ich laufe. Ich renne. Ich sitze. Ich mache die Hand auf. Ich mache die Hand zu.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ich schließe, du schließt, er schließt"
- the pair — "Ich mache die Hand auf. Ich mache die Hand zu."
- the spelling swap — "schließen, schloss"
- the household — "Schloss, Schlüssel, Schluss"
- the two lost verbs — "nehmen, schließen; English took *take* and *close*"
- the four *p*/*f* pairs — "helfen/help, offen/open, schlafen/sleep, laufen/leap"
- the whole morning — "Ich schlafe. Ich höre. Ich stehe. Ich gehe. Ich laufe. Ich renne. Ich sitze."

Before you move on

Give the *du* and *er* forms. (***Du schließt, er schließt.***) Which English verb is the cousin of *schließen*? (**None** — English lost it.) Where did *close* and *shut* come from? (**Latin**, and from **shoot**.) Name three words German hung on the verb. (**Schloss**, **Schlüssel**, **Schluss**.) Say *I close my hand* both ways, then run the eight verbs.

Chapter 41

Coffee, Tea, and Milk

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can politely ask for coffee, tea, or milk in German, and say which of the three words is native and which two are loans.

The chapter closes on Milch, the native word beside two loans: the reader produces all three drinks with der/die articles, extends Chapter 19's Wasser, bitte pattern to Kaffee, bitte and Tee, bitte, and states each word's route — Kaffee overland through Arabic, Turkish and Italian; Tee by sea from Hokkien Chinese by way of Dutch; Milch never borrowed at all. It reaches back to Chapter 19's bitte pattern and rescues Chapter 27's final atoms, GE-LEX-SCHLIESSEN-10 and GE-ETYMON-SCHLIESSEN-11, which no lesson had revisited.

41.1 der Kaffee — the drink that closes one chapter and opens another

The last chapter ended by closing a hand. Now open the day with something to drink — and a new use for a request pattern you already own.

Two false friends before the café: *bekommen* is to receive, not to become; *gehören* is to belong, not to hear.

You'll want to know: der Kaffee

der Kaffee — coffee. Masculine.

Bitte taught you a complete polite request out of two known words: **Wasser, bitte.** The same pattern takes any drink you can name:

Kaffee, bitte. — Coffee, please.

Sounds you'll need

Kaffee is said two ways, and both are standard: many speakers in the north stress the first syllable, **KAF**-fay; many in the south, and most international learners' material, stress the second, kaf-**FAY**. Unlike *gehen* and *laufen*'s Germany/Austria split, this one is not regional in any strict sense — you will hear both from native speakers in the same city.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kaffee is a loanword, and a young one by this book's standard — nothing like *Wein*'s two-thousand-year-old borrowing from Latin *vīnum*. The word travelled **Arabic *qahwa* → Ottoman Turkish *kahve* → Italian *caffè* → German *Kaffee*.** English *coffee* and French *café* took the same Italian step, which is why the whole spread of European words for the drink still rhymes with each other despite crossing four language families to get here.
The last chapter closed on **schließen**, a verb Proto-Germanic built and English lost outright. *Kaffee* is the opposite kind of word: nothing here is inherited, and nothing needed to be — German simply took the whole word, sound and all, the way it took *Wein* centuries earlier.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Kaffee" — either stress, both correct
- "Kaffee, bitte." — the *bitte* pattern, one word swapped
- the route — "qahwa, kahve, caffè, Kaffee"

Before you move on

Give "coffee" with its article. (**Der Kaffee**.) Ask for it politely. (**Kaffee, bitte.**) Name the three languages the word crossed before

German. (**Arabic, Turkish, Italian.**) Is *Kaffee* inherited like *schließen*, or borrowed like *Wein*? (**Borrowed.**)

41.2 der Tee — the same loan as English, by the same ship

Kaffee came overland through Turkey and Italy. The next drink took a completely different road — by sea.

You'll want to know: der Tee

der Tee — tea. Masculine.

Tee, bitte. — Tea, please.

Sounds you'll need

Tee is spelled almost exactly like the English word it translates, and said nothing like it. German **ee** is a long, steady *ay*: **Tee** = *TAY*, not *tea*'s *ee*. Looking alike on the page and sounding different is its own small trap — worth naming so it doesn't catch you.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Tee is Hokkien Chinese ***tê***, the word for the plant in the coastal Chinese dialect that Dutch traders dealt with directly. Dutch **thee** carried it into Europe by sea, and German took the word from Dutch — the same route English **tea** followed, which is why *Tee* and *tea* match as closely as they do.

That is not the only road this word took. Languages reached by the **overland** trade routes out of northern China took a different syllable of the same Chinese word: **Hindi *chai*, Russian *chai*, Turkish *çay***. One plant, one Chinese word, two pronunciations of it — split by whether a language got the word from a ship or a caravan. *Kaffee*'s three-hop route through Turkish and Italian was its own single path; tea forked into two.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Tee" — say it *TAY*, not *tea*
- "Tee, bitte." — "Kaffee, bitte." — same pattern, two drinks
- the fork — "tê, thee, Tee, tea" by sea; "chai, chai, çay" overland

Before you move on

Give "tea" with its article, and say it correctly. (**Der Tee** — *TAY*.) Which language gave German the word, and by what route? (**Hokkien Chinese *tê*, by way of Dutch sea trade.**) Name one language that got the same Chinese word overland instead. (**Hindi, Russian, or Turkish.**) Does *Tee* sound the way it's spelled in English? (**No** — same letters, different vowel.)

41.3 die Milch — the one that was never borrowed

Kaffee came from Arabic by way of Turkish and Italian. *Tee* came from Chinese by way of Dutch. The third drink needed no ship and no caravan — German already had it.

You'll want to know: die Milch

die Milch — milk. Feminine.

Milch, bitte. — Milk, please.

Sounds you'll need

German's **ch** is not one sound but two. After a back vowel like the *a* of *Nacht*, it is a rasp at the back of the throat. After a front vowel or consonant like the *i* of **Milch**, it is soft, made further forward — closer to a hissed *h*. Say *ich* (your own word for "I") right before *Milch* and you are making the same sound twice.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Milch is native Germanic, from ***meluks**, and further back from Proto-Indo-European ****h₂melg-***, "to milk" — the action came first, and the word for the substance is simply that verb, frozen into a noun.

English **milk** is the exact same word, inherited rather than borrowed, which makes it the cousin of German *Melker* ("milker") the way *denken* is the cousin of *Dank*.
So the trio closes the way the food lesson did: **Wasser** was native beside the loanword **Wein**; here, **Milch** is native beside the loanwords **Kaffee** and **Tee**. Two loans, one inherited word, in both chapters — but this time the loans arrived from opposite directions on the map, one overland and one by sea, and only the native word needed no journey at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "die Milch" — the soft *ch*, as in *ich*
- all three requests — "Kaffee, bitte. Tee, bitte. Milch, bitte."
- the shape of the chapter — "Wasser native, Wein borrowed; Milch native, Kaffee and Tee borrowed"

Before you move on

Give "milk" with its article. (**Die Milch**.) Is it native or borrowed? (**Native** — inherited **meluks*, the twin of English *milk*.) Which two drinks in this chapter were borrowed, and from where? (**Kaffee** from Arabic/Turkish/Italian; **Tee** from Hokkien Chinese by way of Dutch.) Which earlier chapter set up the exact same native/borrowed shape? (**Chapter 11 — Wasser and Wein.**)

Chapter 42

Friend and Family

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a friend, male or female, and my family in German, build a feminine person-noun with -in, and say which of the three words is native and which is borrowed.
>
> *The chapter closes on Familie, the one Latin loan beside two native words: the reader produces der Freund, die Freundin and die Familie with articles, builds the feminine -in suffix on a masculine person-noun and names its one English fossil (vixen), and states that Familie gathers the very members Chapter 10 already named (Vater, Mutter, Bruder, Schwester, Geschwister). It reaches back to Chapter 2's freut mich, which shares Freund's root, and to Chapter 10's family words.*

42.1 der Freund — a word that was already a compliment

You were taught **freut mich** — "pleased to meet you," literally "it gladdens me." The person doing the gladdening has a name of their own, and it is built from the very same root.

You'll want to know: der Freund

der Freund — friend (male, or a friend in general). Masculine.

Das ist der Freund. — "This/That is the friend."

Sounds you'll need

eu is a diphthong said *oy*, exactly as in English *boy*: **Freund** = *FROYND*. It is the same sound spelled **äu** in *Häuser* and *läuft*, just without the umlaut in front of it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Freund and English **friend** are not merely cousins — they are the exact same inherited word, Proto-Germanic ***frijōnds***. That word was never a plain noun to begin with: it is a **frozen present participle** of the verb ***frijōną***, "to love," so *Freund* literally means "the one who is loving." *freut mich* is built on the same family: both trace to Proto-Indo-European ***preyH-***, "to love, to please." The goddess **Frigg** — whose day German keeps as *Freitag* and English as **Friday** — carries the same root one step further.
Milch needed no journey to reach German; *Freund* did not either — but where *Milch* is a noun that was always a noun, *Freund* is a verb that stopped moving and became one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Freund" — *FROYND*
- "Das ist der Freund."
- the family — "Freund, freut mich, Frigg, Friday — all one root"

Before you move on

Give "friend" with its article. (**Der Freund**.) What part of speech did *Freund* start out as? (**A verb** — a frozen present participle of "to love.") Which greeting phrase shares its root? (**Freut mich**.) Which day of the week carries the same PIE root one step further? (**Freitag / Friday**, from the goddess **Frigg**.)

42.2 die Freundin — one suffix, and the fox that kept it in English

You have **der Freund**. German does not need a new word for the feminine — it needs one small, reusable ending.

You'll want to know: die Freundin

die Freundin — friend (female). Feminine.

Das ist die Freundin. — "This/That is the (female) friend."

Grammar Lens: the ending that builds a whole class of nouns

Add **-in** to a masculine noun for a person and you get the feminine: **der Lehrer** → **die Lehrerin** ("teacher"), **der Student** → **die Studentin** ("student"), **der Freund** → **die Freundin**. It is entirely regular, and it works on almost any such noun you will ever meet — one rule, not a new word each time.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

-in is native Germanic, not a Latin import — English inherited the same suffix and mostly stopped using it. Almost mostly: one English word still carries it, fossilized, unrecognized as a suffix by most speakers who use it — **vixen**, "female fox," built the same way *Freundin* is built. English did not lose this pattern by borrowing over it; it simply stopped reaching for it, and later borrowed French *-ess* (**princess, actress**) to do the same job instead. German never stopped.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "die Freundin" — Freund plus -in
- "Das ist die Freundin."
- the pattern — "Lehrer/Lehrerin, Student/Studentin, Freund/Freundin"
- the English fossil — "fox, vixen — the same -in, once"

Before you move on

Give "friend (female)" with its article. (**Die Freundin**.) What suffix builds it from *Freund*, and what does that suffix do generally? (**-in** — it makes the feminine of a person-noun.) Is *-in* borrowed or native? (**Native** — English inherited it too.) Name the one English word that still shows it. (**Vixen.**)

42.3 die Familie — the word that gathers Eltern and Geschwister

You have **der Freund** and **die Freundin**, both native, both built on a verb meaning "to love." The word for the group at home has a completely different history.

You'll want to know: die Familie

die Familie — family. Feminine.

Das ist die Familie. — "This/That is the family."

You already have the members: **Vater, Mutter, Bruder, Schwester** — and the collective **Geschwister**, "siblings." *Familie* is the word that gathers all of them into one group.

Sounds you'll need

Familie keeps all three vowels distinct: *fa-MEE-lee-eh*, four syllables in careful speech, with the stress on the second. It does not collapse the way English *family* does.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Familie is a Latin loan: **familia**, "household," related to **famulus**, "servant" or "slave" — a Roman household word, not originally a word about blood relation at all. English **family** borrowed the very same Latin root, by way of Old French, well before German did; German took *Familie* directly from Latin later, in the early modern period, which is why the two loans look so close to identical without one having been copied from the other.

So this small chapter runs the same shape twice: **Freund** and

Freundin are native, built from a Germanic verb meaning "to love"; **Familie** is borrowed, from a Roman word that first meant "household staff." The food lesson set up exactly this pattern with **Wasser** native beside **Wein** borrowed, and the drinks just ran it a third time with **Milch** beside **Kaffee** and **Tee**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "die Familie" — *fa-MEE-lee-eh*
- "Das ist die Familie."
- the members inside it — "Vater, Mutter, Bruder, Schwester, Geschwister"
- native beside borrowed — "Freund, Freundin native; Familie borrowed"

Before you move on

Give "family" with its article. (**Die Familie**.) Is it native or borrowed? (**Borrowed** — Latin *familia*, "household.") What did *familia* first mean, before "relatives"? (**Household** — kin to *famulus*, "servant.") Which two words from this chapter are native instead? (**Freund** and **Freundin**.)

42.4 Nine sounds, said without looking at what they mean

gut and **du**. Same vowel, held long in both. Say them, then say what an English speaker's mouth wants to do to that vowel instead.

Your turn: nine, for sound only

You know what all of these mean. This time say them for the noise alone.

Say these aloud:

- *gut* — one long **u**, no glide after it

- *du*, then *Sie* — the second is a long **ee** with an initial **z**
- *heißen* — **ei** is the English word *eye*, and the **ß** keeps it long
- *freut mich* — **eu** is the English *oy*, nothing like the letters
- *danke* — the final **-e** is weak, never *-ay*
- *bitte* — short **i**, and the same weak ending
- *sehen* — the **h** is silent and only marks the long **e**
- *auf* — **au** is *ow*, and the **f** is a clean stop

Why it's said this way

Three of the nine share one habit, and it is the habit that makes German spelling honest once you know it:

written	**said**	**what the extra letter is doing**
ei in *heißen*	*eye*	a pair naming one sound, not two
eu in *freut*	*oy*	the same, and neither letter is a clue
h in *sehen*	silent	**length**, not a sound of its own

German spelling is far more regular than English spelling — but regular is not the same as obvious. Each of these is a fixed rule you can rely on everywhere, and none of them can be guessed from the letters by someone reading English habits into them.

Before you move on

What is the **h** in *sehen* doing? (**Marking the vowel long — it is silent.**) What does **eu** sound like? (***oy***.) And of the nine words above, which one is capitalised mid-sentence, and why? (***Sie*** — the formal *you*, capitalised to tell it from *sie*, *she* or *they*.)

Chapter 43

Eyes, Ears, Mouth, Nose

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the eye, ear, mouth, and nose in German, and say which of the four traces to a confirmed ancient root and which does not.
>
> *The chapter closes on Nase, cousin of both English nose and Latin nasus by separate descent: the reader produces all four face parts with articles and plurals, names Auge and Ohr as words with confirmed Proto-Indo-European roots, names Mund as inherited but not traced further, and completes Chapter 17's face by running Kopf, Auge, Ohr, Mund, Nase, Hand together. It reaches back to Chapter 17's Kopf and Hand and to Chapter 26's hören, rescuing the disputed 'sharp-eared' link between hören and Ohr.*

43.1 das Auge — back to the head, one part at a time

> You already have **der Kopf** and **die Hand**. The head has more in it than its own name — starting with what you see with.

You'll want to know: das Auge

> **das Auge** — eye. Neuter.
>
> **Das ist das Auge.** — "This/That is the eye."

The plural is **die Augen** — both eyes together, the form you will hear far more often than the singular.

Sounds you'll need

au is a diphthong said *ow*, as in English *how*: **Auge** = *OW-geh*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Auge is Proto-Germanic ***augô***, the direct cousin of English **eye** — both inherited, no loan in either direction, from Proto-Indo-European ***h_3ek^w-***. That root did not stay hidden in only the Germanic family: Latin turned it into **oculus** (giving English **ocular**, **binoculars**), and Greek into **ophthalmós** (giving English **ophthalmology**). Three branches of one family tree, and English ended up borrowing back two Latin and Greek reflexes of the very root it had already inherited natively as *eye*.
Kopf was a container word that took over the everyday job. *Auge* needed no such replacement — it has meant "eye" the whole way down.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "das Auge" — *OW-geh*; "die Augen" — both eyes
- "Das ist das Auge."
- the three-family root — "Auge/eye, Latin oculus, Greek ophthalmós"

Before you move on

Give "eye" with its article, and its plural. (**Das Auge, die Augen**.) Is it native or borrowed? (**Native** — cousin of English *eye*.) Name one English word borrowed from the *same* PIE root by way of Latin or Greek. (**Ocular**, **binoculars**, or **ophthalmology**.)

43.2 das Ohr — the part hören was named for

You have the eye. You already have the verb for what the next part does — **hören**, "to hear" — without ever naming the part itself.

You'll want to know: das Ohr

das Ohr — ear. Neuter.

Das ist das Ohr. — "This/That is the ear."

Plural: **die Ohren**.

Sounds you'll need

Ohr is a single long *o*, said the way you'd say the letter itself in English: **Ohr** = *OHR*, no glide, no second vowel.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ohr is Proto-Germanic ****auzô***, the direct cousin of English **ear** — both from Proto-Indo-European ****h₂ous-***. One disputed idea about **hören** was already flagged: some accounts break its root into "sharp" plus "ear," which would put this very word, *Ohr*, hiding inside the verb for using it. That analysis was marked cited but unsettled there, and it stays unsettled here — a tidy story is not the same as a confirmed one. What is confirmed: *Ohr* and *ear* are not two words that happen to sound alike. They are one Germanic word, unbroken since before English and German were different languages.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "das Ohr" — a plain long *o*; "die Ohren"
- "Das ist das Ohr."
- the maybe-link — "hören, Ohr — sharp-eared, unsettled"

Before you move on

Give "ear" with its article and plural. (**Das Ohr, die Ohren**.) Is it native or borrowed? (**Native** — cousin of English *ear*.) What disputed idea would put this word inside *hören*? (**The "sharp-eared" root analysis** — cited, not settled.)

43.3 der Mund — where the family tree runs out

Auge and *Ohr* both trace cleanly to Proto-Indo-European. This one does not go nearly as far back with any certainty — and saying so honestly is the lesson.

You'll want to know: der Mund

der Mund — mouth. Masculine.

Das ist der Mund. — "This/That is the mouth."

Plural: **die Münder**.

Sounds you'll need

Mund takes a short, closed *u*, as in English *put*: **Mund** = *MOONT* (final *d* devoiced, as in *Hand*).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mund is Proto-Germanic ****munþaz***, and English **mouth** is that same inherited word — no loan in either direction, exactly like *Ohr* and *ear*. Here the two words part company. *Ohr* and *Auge* both trace on to confirmed Proto-Indo-European roots. *Munþaz* does not: proposed deeper connections exist, but no single one is agreed upon by standard references. Rather than hand you a tidy-sounding root that is not actually settled, this lesson stops at Proto-Germanic. An honest "we don't fully know" is worth more than an invented ancestor.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Mund" — *MOONT*; "die Münder"
- "Das ist der Mund."
- the honest stop — "Mund and mouth, inherited — but no further-back root is agreed"

Before you move on

Give "mouth" with its article and plural. (**Der Mund, die Münder**.) Is it native or borrowed? (**Native** — cousin of English *mouth*.) Does its root trace to a confirmed PIE ancestor, the way *Auge* and *Ohr* do? (**No** — the trail goes cold at Proto-Germanic.)

43.4 die Nase — the face, complete

Auge. Ohr. Mund. One part of the face is left, and it closes what *Kopf* opened and never finished.

You'll want to know: die Nase

die Nase — nose. Feminine.

Das ist die Nase. — "This/That is the nose."

Plural: **die Nasen**.

Sounds you'll need

Nase opens on a long, open *a*: **Nase** = *NAH-zeh*, with the *s* voiced to *z* between two vowels — the mirror image of *Hand*'s final *d* devoicing to *t*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Nase is Proto-Germanic ****nasō***, the inherited cousin of English **nose** — and, further back, of Latin **nasus**, which gave English **nasal** and **nostril**. One Proto-Indo-European root, ****nas-***, split into Germanic and into Latin independently; German *Nase* and the Latin-derived word are family by **descent**, exactly like *rot* and *rouge*, never by borrowing.

That gives this small face four parts with four different shapes of story: **Auge** and **Ohr** trace cleanly to confirmed PIE roots; **Mund** is inherited but its root before Proto-Germanic is not agreed upon; **Nase** traces to a root Latin also inherited, on its own branch. Four native words, four different depths of certainty — which is the honest way etymology actually looks, not four identical tidy stories.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "die Nase" — *NAH-zeh*; "die Nasen"
- "Das ist die Nase."
- the whole face — "Kopf, Auge, Ohr, Mund, Nase, Hand"
- the cousin — "Nase, nose, nasus — one PIE root, two families"

Before you move on

Give "nose" with its article and plural. (**Die Nase, die Nasen**.) Which Latin word is its distant cousin, and what English word does that Latin word give? (**Nasus**, giving **nasal**.) Name all five face and head words from Chapters 17 and 30. (**Kopf, Auge, Ohr, Mund, Nase**.) Which of the four words of this chapter does not trace past Proto-Germanic? (**Mund**.)

43.5 Kopf und Haupt — two words for one head, and only one of them survived

The nose. Say it — long **a**, and the **s** buzzes like a *z*. Then say the verb for what the eyes above it do.

Across the family

German has two words for a head, and the one it uses every day is the one that did not start out meaning a head at all.

word	where it came from	where it is now
Haupt	the inherited Germanic head-word, cousin of English *head*	formal, poetic, and alive mainly in compounds
Kopf	a word for a **cup** or **bowl**	the ordinary, everyday head

A container word pushed the inherited word aside — the same move that gave French *tête* from Latin *testa*, a pot. Bodies get named after

the things they resemble, and the joke outlives the people who made it. Which is why the pains go on **Kopf** and not on *Haupt*: *Kopfschmerzen* is built from the everyday word, because that is the word you reach for when something hurts.

Your turn

Four you have not been asked for in a long while.

Say these aloud:

- *auf* — **au** as *ow*
- *freut mich* — **eu** as *oy*
- the noun inside the warm thank-you — *Dank*
- the shrug that answers *how are you* — *es geht*

Before you move on

Which of the two head-words is the inherited one, and which is the one you actually use? (***Haupt*** inherited; ***Kopf*** everyday.) What did *Kopf* mean first? (**A cup or bowl.**) Say the nose, and keep the **s** buzzing.

Chapter 44

Arm, Finger, Foot, Heart

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the arm, finger, foot, and heart in German, completing the Hand/Arm/Finger/Fuß/Herz table Chapter 17 named but did not finish teaching, and say which of the four shows Grimm's law and which sits outside it.
>
> *The chapter closes on Herz, the third word in the book to show Grimm's law's k-to-h swap: the reader produces all four words with articles, names Arm as a word outside Grimm's law's reach entirely, Fuß as a second p-to-f case beside Vater, and Finger's disputed link to fünf, and finally completes the five-word table Chapter 17 printed but only taught one-fifth of. It reaches back to Chapter 17's Hand and Grimm's law, Chapter 26's hören, and Chapter 22's Hund, all three of which supply the k-to-h comparison.*

44.1 der Arm — the word Hand's own table already named

The *Hand* lesson ran a table of five body words — **Hand** and **Arm** among them — to show how closely German and English match on the body. Only *Hand* was actually taught. Here is the second name from that table.

You'll want to know: der Arm

der Arm — arm. Masculine.

Das ist der Arm. — "This/That is the arm."

Plural: **die Arme**.

Sounds you'll need

Arm is said almost exactly as it is spelled, with German's open *ah* vowel: **Arm** = *AHRM*. Of everything in this chapter, it is the smallest gap between the German word and its English cousin.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Arm is Proto-Germanic ****armaz***, the direct cousin of English **arm**, from Proto-Indo-European ****h₂er-***, "to fit together, to join." That same root, by a separate Latin path, gave English **art** (a fitting-together of skill) and **harmony** by way of Greek. *Vater*/*father* and *Fuß*/*foot* both show Grimm's law loudly, because their starting consonants were exactly the ones the law changed. *Arm* shows why the law is a **rule about specific sounds**, not a blanket difference between German and English: the consonants in **armaz* were never in the law's path, so nothing had to move, and *Arm* and *arm* still look like the same word today for the same reason *Hand* and *hand* do.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Arm" — *AHRM*; "die Arme"
- "Das ist der Arm."
- the point — "Grimm's law only moves the sounds in its path; Arm's sounds were never in it"

Before you move on

Give "arm" with its article and plural. (**Der Arm, die Arme**.) Which earlier table already named this word? (**Hand**'s table of five body words.) Why does *Arm* look almost identical to English *arm*, when *Vater*/*father* do not? (**Its sounds were never in Grimm's law's path.**)

44.2 der Finger — maybe “one of the five”

The third name from the *Hand* table, and the first numbers come back for a cameo.

You’ll want to know: der Finger

der Finger — finger. Masculine, spelled and said almost exactly like English.

Das ist der Finger. — “This/That is the finger.”

Plural: **die Finger** — unchanged, one of the small set of German plurals that add nothing at all.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Finger is Proto-Germanic ****fingraz***, inherited straight into English with no change of shape at all — the closest match of any word in this chapter.

Why it’s said this way

You were taught **fünf**, “five,” from Germanic ***fimf**. One proposed account connects **fingraz* to that very number, as if a finger were once simply “one of the five.” It is a satisfying story, and it shows up often — but it is reported by standard references as **plausible, not proven**: the sound changes needed to get from **fimf* to **fingraz* are not fully regular, so the link stays a proposal rather than a settled fact. Held loosely, the way *hören* held “sharp-eared”.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “der Finger” — “die Finger”, unchanged plural
- “Das ist der Finger.”
- the maybe-link — “Finger, fünf — plausible, not proven”

Before you move on

Give "finger" with its article and plural. (**Der Finger, die Finger** — unchanged.) What number might *Finger* be built on, and how certain is that link? (**Fünf, "five" — plausible, not proven.**) Name one other word in this book that carries the same kind of unsettled-but-cited etymology. (**Hören**'s "sharp-eared" account.)

44.3 der Fuß — Grimm's law, on a second word

One name left on the *Hand* table, and it turns out to run the very same sound-law you already learned on a completely different word.

You'll want to know: der Fuß

der Fuß — foot. Masculine.

Das ist der Fuß. — "This/That is the foot."

Plural: **die Füße** — the umlaut marking more than one, the same fronting pattern behind *Mann* → *Männer*.

Sounds you'll need

Fuß = *FOOSS*, a long *u* followed by the sharp *s* spelled **ß**. The colour words already gave you the rule this word follows exactly: **ß** after a **long** vowel, **ss** after a short one — the same reason *weiß* keeps its ß while *Fluss* does not.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Fuß is Proto-Germanic ****fōts***, cousin of English **foot**, from Proto-Indo-European ****pṓds***. That opening **p** → **f** is the very shift **Vater**/**father** showed you — Grimm's law, run again here on an unrelated word, with the identical result: Latin kept the old *p* in **ped-** (giving English **pedal**, **pedestrian**), Germanic moved it to *f* in both *Fuß* and *foot*.

This chapter has now shown you two shapes of Grimm's law and one word that never needed it at all: **Vater** and **Fuß** both shift *p* → *f*; **Arm** sits outside the law's reach entirely, unchanged in both languages.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "der Fuß" — *FOOSS*; "die Füße"
- "Das ist der Fuß."
- the shift, twice — "Vater/father, Fuß/foot — both p to f"

Before you move on

Give "foot" with its article and plural. (**Der Fuß, die Füße**.) Which family word already showed this same sound-law step? (**Vater/father**, both *p* → *f*.) Why does *Fuß* keep its **ß** while *Fluss* does not? (**Long vowel before it, by the eszett rule.**)

44.4 das Herz — the body list, complete at last

The *Hand* lesson printed a five-word table and taught you one of them. This lesson teaches the fifth and closes it.

You'll want to know: das Herz

das Herz — heart. Neuter — the one organ word in this chapter that breaks the masculine pattern of *Arm*, *Finger* and *Fuß*.

Das ist das Herz. — "This/That is the heart."

Plural: **die Herzen**.

Sounds you'll need

Herz takes a short, open *e*, as in English *bed*: **Herz** = *HAIRTS*, the *z* said *ts*, exactly as in *Katze*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Herz is Proto-Germanic ****hertan***, cousin of English **heart**, from Proto-Indo-European ****ḱērd-***. The opening consonant is Grimm's law again — old **k** became Germanic **h** — the identical step already heard on **hören** (against Greek *akoúein*, English *acoustic*) and on **Hund**

(against Latin *canis*). Three separate words, one law, heard a third time: k stays k in the languages that didn't shift, and softens to h in every Germanic one.
That five-word list is finally complete. **Hand** was taught that chapter; **Arm**, **Finger**, **Fuß** and now **Herz** waited fourteen chapters for their turn. All five are native Germanic, all five are direct cousins of their English translations, and not one of them was borrowed from anywhere.

Grammar Lens: the whole chapter, run once more

Run this chapter's four words back to back: **der Arm**, said almost exactly as spelled, sitting outside Grimm's law entirely; **der Finger**, identical to English and maybe — not certainly — built on **fünf**; **der Fuß**, the $p \to f$ Grimm's-law twin of *Vater*, its **ß** long-vowel-marked exactly as Chapter 13 taught; and **das Herz**, the $k \to h$ twin of *hören* and *Hund*. Four words, four different sound-law stories, and not one of them borrowed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "das Herz" — *HAIRTS*; "die Herzen"
- "Das ist das Herz."
- the whole list, complete — "Hand, Arm, Finger, Fuß, Herz"
- the k-to-h swap, three times — "Hund/canis, hören/akoúein, Herz/kardia"

Before you move on

Give "heart" with its article and plural. (**Das Herz, die Herzen**.) Which two earlier words showed the same Grimm's-law $k \to h$ swap? (**Hören** and **Hund**.) Name all five words from that original table, now that all five are taught. (**Hand, Arm, Finger, Fuß, Herz**.) Which one breaks the chapter's masculine pattern, and how? (**Herz** — it is **neuter**.)

44.5 Herz — and the last few this book showed you exactly once

The heart. Say it, and let the **z** land as *ts* rather than as an English *z*.

Across the family

Herz and English **heart** are the same word, separated by one regular sound change: the **k** of the older form became **h** in the Germanic line, the same swap already heard between *hören* and *hear*, and between *Hund* and *hound*. Once you have seen it three times it stops being a curiosity and becomes something you can use to guess.
Haupt and **head** are that same pair — and this is the one place the guess would mislead you, because the word it predicts is not the word Germans say. For the thing on your shoulders they reach for the old cup-word instead. A sound law tells you which words are cousins. It does not tell you which cousin people chose.

Your turn: the apology, and the two warm thank-yous

Say these aloud:

- bump into someone — *Entschuldigung*
- stop a stranger to ask something — and notice it is the same word
- the thank-you with the adjective — *danke schön*
- the warmest everyday one — *vielen Dank*

English splits *sorry* from *excuse me*; German does not, and your voice carries the difference the vocabulary declines to.

Before you move on

What sound does **z** make in *Herz*? (***ts***.) Which sound change links *Herz* to *heart*? (**k becoming h** in the Germanic line.) Does German use one word or two for *sorry* and *excuse me*? (**One.**)
Two more Germanic pairs: the English cousins of *es regnet* and of *gelb*? (***Rain*** and ***yellow*** — inherited, not borrowed from Latin.)

Chapter 45

Not One, Not a Scrap

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say that I have none of a thing, choose correctly between German's two negatives, and put the second one where the sentence wants it.

Every noun the book owns is cancelled and every verb it owns is refused, in one pass: the six things on the table, the household, the four words on the face, and the verbs. The chapter costs two new words and one welded ending, because kein is ein with two letters on the front and keinen carries the -en that the einen lesson already handed over as a bare word.

45.1 kein — "no," and the two words hiding inside it

Say the four words that closed the last chapter — **Arm, Finger, Fuß, Herz** — and then say **nicht** and **eins**. Two of those six are about to be welded together.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the four words for what is on your face — *Auge, Ohr, Mund, Nase*

You'll want to know: kein

kein — "no," "not a," in front of a *der*-word or a *das*-word.

Said *kine*, rhyming with English *mine*: the **ei** is the *eye* sound you have had since **eins**, and the final **n** is plain.

Where you would say **ein**, say **kein** to cancel it:

ein Hund → **kein Hund** — "a dog" → "no dog"

ein Brot → **kein Brot** — "a loaf" → "no loaf"

Nothing else in the phrase moves. The **k** goes on the front of the word you already have, and the noun stands exactly as it stood.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

kein comes from Old High German ***nihein***, which is **ni** ("not") plus **ein** ("one"). *Not one.* The *ni-* wore down to nothing over a thousand years and left the *k* that had crept in beside it, and the modern word no longer looks like its own parts.

English did the identical thing with its own two words, and English still shows the seam:

the pieces	**what they made**
ne + *ān* ("not" + "one")	**nān** → **none**, **no**
ni + *ein* ("not" + "one")	**nihein** → **kein**

So *"kein Brot"* and *"no bread"* are the same sentence, built twice out of the same two ideas by two languages doing it separately.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "kein" — *kine*, rhyming with English *mine*
- the pair — "ein Hund", then "kein Hund"
- it with food — "kein Brot"
- it with the body words from the last chapter — "kein Arm", "kein Finger"
- the two pieces, then the word — "ni … ein … kein"

Twice through: "ein Hund, kein Hund."

Before you move on

Which word does *kein* cancel? (***ein***.) What two pieces are inside it? (**Ni** and **ein**.) Which English word was built from the same two? (**None**.) Which body word from the last chapter shows Grimm's *p* → *f*? (***Fuß***.) Next: *kein* in front of a *die*-word.

45.2 keine — the same word, in front of a *die*

Kein Hund. Now do the same to **eine Katze** before you read on. You already know the answer; you learned it on *ein* and *eine* long ago.

You'll want to know: keine

keine — the shape *kein* takes in front of a *die*-word.

eine Katze → keine Katze — "a cat" → "no cat"

eine Nacht → keine Nacht — "a night" → "no night"

And it is the shape in front of a **plural**, whatever the noun's own gender, because a German plural takes *die*:

keine Hände — "no hands"

The extra **-e** is not a new ending. It is *eine*'s **-e**, unmoved. Put the *k* on the front of the word you already say and stop there.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

keine is a form of *kein*, which grew from Old High German *nihein*, "not one": a negative fused onto the word for "one", later worn down to *kein*.

Grammar Lens: one word cancels the whole family

Something worth noticing before the next lesson complicates it: German gets **two** jobs out of these two shapes. *Keine Katze* is "no cat" — one cat, and there is not one. *Keine Hände* is "no hands" — however many there might have been, there are none.
English needs *no* for the first and *no* for the second and *not any* for a

third case, and never had to decide which; German lets the noun's own article decide it, so there is nothing extra to remember.
Mass words take *kein* and *keine* too, on the same reasoning — **die Milch** is a *die*-word, so:

Ich habe keine Milch. — "I have no milk."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — "eine Katze", then "keine Katze"
- the other pair, from the chapter before — "ein Hund, kein Hund"
- with a mass word — "Ich habe keine Milch."
- with a face word — "keine Nase"
- with a plural — "keine Hände"
- the sentence everyone says — "Ich habe keine Zeit."

Twice through: "Ich habe keine Zeit."

Before you move on

Which shape goes in front of *Katze*, and why? (***Keine*** — *Katze* is a *die*-word, so it takes *eine*, so it takes *keine*.) Which shape goes in front of a plural? (***Keine***, because every German plural takes *die*.) Say "I have no time." (**Ich habe keine Zeit**.) Next: what happens when the thing you do not have is the *object* of *haben*.

45.3 keinen — for the thing you do *not* have

Say "I have a brother" — **Ich habe einen Bruder**. That lesson handed you *einen* as a single word and promised the system behind it would come later. Some of it arrives now, and it costs nothing, because you are about to watch a word you met yesterday do the identical thing.

You'll want to know: keinen

> **keinen** — "no," "not a," for a *der*-word that is the thing being had.
>
> **Ich habe einen Bruder. → Ich habe keinen Bruder.**

The *-en* is the one from *einen*, unchanged. You are not learning a second ending; you are watching the ending you already own ride along on the negative word, because *kein* is *ein* with two letters welded to the front and nothing else touched.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

keinen is a form of *kein*, which grew from Old High German *nihein*, "not one": the word for "one" with a negative fused on the front.

Grammar Lens: three shapes, and the one that moves

Line the three up against what they stand in front of and one thing jumps out:

in front of	naming it	having it
a *der*-word (*Hund*)	**kein** Hund	**keinen** Hund
a *die*-word (*Schwester*)	**keine** Schwester	**keine** Schwester
a *das*-word (*Brot*)	**kein** Brot	**kein** Brot

Only the *der* line changes. *Die* and *das* words look identical whether they are the thing doing or the thing done to — which is why you have got this far without meeting the question at all, and why *einen* could be handed over as a plain word for twenty-three chapters.
That is the whole of what German asks of you here, and it is much less than the reputation suggests: **one line out of three moves, and it is the *der* line.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — "Ich habe einen Bruder", then "Ich habe keinen Bruder"
- with the broken forms of *haben* — "du hast keinen Hund", "er hat keinen Hund"

- the drink that is a *der*-word — "Ich habe keinen Kaffee."
- the drink that is a *der*-word too — "Ich habe keinen Tee."
- the *die*-word, which does not move — "Ich habe keine Schwester."

Twice through: "Ich habe keinen Bruder und keine Schwester."

Before you move on

Which of the three shapes changes when the noun is the thing being had? (Only the ***der*** one — *kein* becomes *keinen*.) Where have you seen that *-en* before? (On ***einen***, in *ich habe einen Bruder*.) Say "I have no brother and no sister." (**Ich habe keinen Bruder und keine Schwester.**) Next: which negative word to reach for when there is no noun to cancel.

45.4 kein oder nicht — picking the right one

You now own two words that both mean "not". Say them: **kein** and **nicht**. German makes you choose, and the choosing turns out to be mechanical.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the two words for what you hear with and what you eat with — *Ohr* and *Mund*

Grammar Lens: one cancels a noun, one cancels the rest

kein goes in front of a noun that would otherwise have carried *ein*. **nicht** cancels anything else at all.

Test it by asking whether *ein* could stand where you are about to negate. If it could, reach for *kein*; if it could not, reach for *nicht*.

Ich habe keinen Hund. — no *Hund*. A noun, so *kein*.

Das ist nicht gut. — nothing to put *ein* in front of. *Gut* is a quality, so *nicht*.

Ich verstehe nicht. — the verb itself is what fails. *Nicht*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The two words are cousins, and knowing it makes the split easier to hold. Both begin life as the ancient negative particle **ni**, and each picked up a different second half:

- **ni** + **ein** ("one") → **nihein** → **kein**, which cancels *a thing.*
- **ni** + a word meaning *a whit, a scrap* → **niwiht** → **nicht**, which cancels *anything at all.*

English ran the same fork: *ne* + *ān* gave **none**, *ne* + *ā-wiht* gave **naught** and then **not**. The choice is a fossil of what each word once counted.

Your turn

Say which negative each one wants, out loud, before you say the sentence.

Say these aloud:

- a noun, so *kein* — "Ich habe keinen Hund."
- a quality, so *nicht* — "Ich bin nicht müde."
- a verb, so *nicht* — "Ich verstehe nicht."
- a noun, so *kein* — "Ich habe keine Zeit."
- a verb, so *nicht* — "Ich schlafe nicht."
- the three verbs of the body at rest, all cancelled — "ich sitze nicht, ich stehe nicht, ich schlafe nicht"

Twice through: "Ich habe keinen Hund. Ich bin nicht müde."

Before you move on

What question decides the choice? (Could ***ein*** have stood there? If yes, *kein*; if no, *nicht.*) Which one cancels a quality? (***Nicht.***) Which ancient word starts both of them? (***Ni.***) Say "I do not understand." (**Ich verstehe nicht.**) Next: where in the sentence that *nicht* has to stand.

45.5 nicht am Ende — where the "not" goes

You can pick the right negative. Now the last piece of this chapter: German is fussy about *where* **nicht** stands, and the fussiness has one cause you can see through.

Grammar Lens: it stands in front of what it cancels

nicht stands **immediately in front of the word it cancels** — and when what it cancels is the verb itself, there is nothing in front of it to stand before, so it goes to the **end**.

Both halves of that are one habit, seen from two sides:

Das ist nicht gut. — the quality is cancelled, so *nicht* leads it.

Ich wohne nicht in Berlin. — the place is cancelled, so *nicht* leads it.

Ich verstehe nicht. — the verbing is cancelled. There is no word left to lead, and *nicht* falls to the far end.

English parks its *not* beside the helper verb and leaves it — *I do not live in Berlin* — so German's *nicht* sounds to an English ear as though it drifts. It is being aimed.

Why it's said this way

The end-of-sentence habit has a history. **Nicht** began as a **noun** — *niwiht*, "not a whit", a scrap of a thing — and a German object goes late. So the old sentence was something like *"I understand not-a-scrap"*, with the scrap sitting where any object sits.
The meaning drained out of the noun and left the position behind. A separable prefix goes to that same far end, for a related reason: German finishes a sentence with the piece that completes its sense.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- cancelling a quality — "Das ist nicht gut."
- cancelling a place — "Ich wohne nicht in Berlin."
- cancelling the verb, so *nicht* goes last — "Ich verstehe nicht."
- the four verbs of taking things in and putting them out, each cancelled — "ich höre nicht, ich sehe nicht, ich lese nicht, ich schreibe nicht"
- aim it, then move it — "Das ist nicht gut", then "Ich höre nicht"

Twice through: "Ich verstehe nicht. Das ist nicht gut."

Before you move on

Where does *nicht* stand against an adjective? (**Straight in front** — *nicht gut.*) Against the verb? (**At the end**.) What was *nicht* before it was a negative? (A **noun**, *niwiht.*) Say the three sentences.

45.6 Nichts davon — the chapter, run cold

Two questions before you say anything. Which negative goes in front of a noun, and what decides which of its three shapes you use? Then: where does the other negative stand?

Your turn: everything on the table, cancelled

Six things this book has put in front of you to eat and drink. Say each one's article first, then cancel it.

Say these aloud:

- *das* Brot → "kein Brot"
- *das* Wasser → "kein Wasser"
- *der* Wein → "kein Wein", and having it, "keinen Wein"
- *der* Kaffee → "kein Kaffee", "keinen Kaffee"
- *der* Tee → "kein Tee", "keinen Tee"
- *die* Milch → "keine Milch", which does not move

Your turn: the distant band — the people and the face

Now reach further back — the animals, the household, and the four words on your face. Nothing here is new; the negative in front of it is.

Say these aloud:

- the two animals — "kein Hund" and "keine Katze"
- the household, having none of them — "keinen Bruder, keine Schwester, keine Mutter, keinen Vater"
- the pair the *-in* suffix made — "keinen Freund, keine Freundin"
- the collective — "keine Familie"
- the four on your face — "kein Auge, kein Ohr, keinen Mund, keine Nase"
- which of those four is a *die*-word, and prove it by its negative — "*die* Nase, keine Nase"

Your turn: the verbs, refused

Say these aloud:

- the verb cancelled, so *nicht* goes last — "Ich verstehe nicht."
- the quality cancelled, so *nicht* leads it — "Das ist nicht gut."
- "Ich bin nicht müde."
- the noun, so *kein* — "Ich habe keine Zeit."
- both in one breath — "Ich habe keine Zeit und ich verstehe nicht."

Before you move on

Say the three shapes and what each stands in front of. (***Kein*** before a *der* or *das* word, ***keine*** before a *die* word and every plural, ***keinen*** before a *der* word that is being had.) What two pieces is *kein* built from? (**Ni** and **ein** — "not one".) And when does the other negative go to the end of the sentence? (When what it cancels is **the verb**.) Next: the question that has no question word in it.

Chapter 46

When the Verb Steps to the Front

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask a question that expects yes or no, give a one-word command, and ask who, when and why.
>
> *Every statement in the book becomes a question and every verb becomes a command. Three of the six W-words were already owned, so the chapter buys the whole interrogative system for three new words plus two sentence shapes – and the fourth, fifth and sixth W arrive predicted rather than memorised, because Grimm's law lines German w- up against English wh- one word at a time.*

46.1 Wohnst du in Berlin? — the question that has no question word

You have owned **ja**, **nein** and **doch** since the yes-and-no chapter, and you have never been shown the question they answer. Say the three first, then go on.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the two negatives and what each cancels — *kein* for a noun, *nicht* for the rest

Grammar Lens: the verb moves to the front

To ask something answerable with *ja* or *nein*, take the statement and put the **verb first**.

Nothing else changes. No extra word, no rising list of rules:

Du wohnst in Berlin. → Wohnst du in Berlin? · **Er**

hat einen Bruder. → Hat er einen Bruder?

The verb has stood in slot two for the whole book. Move it one place left and the sentence becomes a question.

Why it's said this way

English used to do this and stopped. *"Speak you German"* is ordinary Elizabethan word order. Somewhere after Shakespeare, English stopped moving its verbs and built a machine instead — the **do** in *do you speak German*, which means nothing at all. German never built it, because it never lost the habit. The German question is the older one; the English *do* is the innovation.

Your turn

Say the statement, then flip it.

Say these aloud:

- "Du wohnst in Berlin." → "Wohnst du in Berlin?"
- "Er hat einen Bruder." → "Hat er einen Bruder?"
- the three drinks, asked for — "Hast du Kaffee, Tee, Milch?"
- answer with last chapter's negative — "Nein, ich habe keinen Kaffee."
- the contradiction — a negative question, answered "Doch!"

Twice through: "Wohnst du in Berlin? — Ja. / Nein."

Before you move on

What turns a German statement into a yes-or-no question? (**The verb moves to first place.**) What did English build when it stopped? (The empty **do**.) Which answer-word contradicts a negative question? (***Doch***.)

46.2 Komm! — the sentence with no subject at all

Take **kommen** and strip the *-en* off it. What is left is the stem, **komm-**, and it is about to be a whole sentence on its own.

Grammar Lens: the stem, alone

To tell one person you are on *du* terms with to do something, say the **stem and nothing else**.

Komm! — "Come!" · **Geh!** — "Go!" · **Sag!** — "Say!"

Two things are missing, and both matter. There is **no ending** — this is the one shape of a German verb that wears none. And there is **no pronoun**, in a language that has spent forty chapters insisting the subject slot be filled.
A command is the single place German lets that slot stay empty, because the person addressed is standing right there.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The bare stem is the oldest shape a verb has anywhere in this family. English kept it too — *come*, *go*, *say*, *open*, *listen* — which is why an English command and a German one line up word for word and syllable for syllable:

Hör! — *Hear!* · **Sieh!** — *See!* · **Lies!** — *Read!* · **Schreib!** — *Write!*

Two of those hide something you already know: the vowel of *sehen* and *lesen* breaks in the *du* form, and the command takes the broken vowel with it. **Sieh** and **lies**, not *seh* and *les*.

Your turn

Find the stem before you say the command.
Say these aloud:

- kommen → "Komm!"
- gehen → "Geh!"

- sagen → "Sag!"
- the pair that opens and closes — "Öffne!" and "Schließ!"
- the one that hears — "Hör!"
- the two with a broken vowel — "Lies!" and "Sieh!"

Twice through: "Komm! Geh! Hör!"

Before you move on

What shape is a German command? (**The bare stem** — no ending.) What does it leave out that German otherwise demands? (**The pronoun.**) Both this and a yes-or-no question begin with the verb — so what tells them apart? (The question **has a subject after the verb**; the command has none.) Next: the six question words, and the letter they all begin with.

46.3 wer — "who," and the letter the whole family shares

You already own three question words — **was**, **wo**, **wie**. Say them, and notice what all three start with.

You'll want to know: wer

wer — "who."

Said *vair*: the **w** is a *v*, as it has been since *wie* and *wir*, and the **e** is long.

Wer ist das? — "Who is that?"

Take care with one trap. German **wer** means *who*; German **wo** means *where*, and an English eye reads it as *who*. The two swap appearances across the languages, and only practice fixes it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wer is Latin **quis** and English **who**, from Proto-Indo-European ****kʷis***. Grimm's law turned **kʷ** into Germanic **hw**; English wrote *hw* and

flipped it to **wh**; German wore the *h* off. That one step lines the two languages up letter for letter:

German	English
wer	**wh**o
was	**wh**at
wo	**wh**ere
wann	**wh**en
warum	**wh**y

Five of those six you can now predict rather than memorise, and the sixth breaks the pattern in both languages at once: German **wie** against English **how**, where English lost the *w* instead of the *h*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "wer" — *vair*, and "Wer ist das?"
- the trap, both ways — "wer" is *who*, "wo" is *where*
- about the people you know — "Wer ist der Freund? Wer ist die Freundin?"
- "Wer ist die Mutter? Wer ist der Vater?"
- the command from the last lesson, then the question — "Sag!" then "Wer ist das?"

Twice through: "Wer ist das?"

Before you move on

What does *wer* mean, and what is the trap? (***Who*** — and *wo*, which looks like it, means *where*.) Which Latin word is its cousin? (***Quis***.) What sound law turns English *wh-* into German *w-*? (**Grimm's law**, which made k^w into *hw*; English kept the *h*, German dropped it.) Next: the fifth W.

46.4 wann — "when," and the question the calendar was waiting for

Predict this one before you read it. English *when* begins *wh-*. What must the German be?

You'll want to know: wann

wann — "when."

Said *vann*, with a short flat *a* and the *v*-sound on the front. The double **nn** keeps the vowel short, which is the same spelling habit you met in *Mann* and *kann*.

Wann ist das? — "When is that?"

The clock chapter gave you **Es ist ein Uhr** and no way to ask for it. Now you have one:

Wann? — Um ein Uhr.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wann and English **when** are one word, on the same ****kʷ-*** root that gave *wer* and *who*. So the second row of the table is filled in by the rule rather than by memory, and the vocabulary this book spent five chapters on is suddenly askable:

Wann? — Am Montag. · **Wann? — Im Januar.** · **Wann? — Im Dezember.**

Seven weekdays, twelve months and four seasons have been sitting in your head with no question attached to them. One word attaches all twenty-three.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "wann" — *vann*, short *a*
- "Wann ist das?"

- two weekdays as answers — "Am Montag", "Am Samstag"
- the day the sun owns — "Am Sonntag"
- two months — "Im Januar", "Im Dezember"
- the four seasons — "im Frühling, im Sommer, im Herbst, im Winter"

Twice through: "Wann? — Am Montag."

Before you move on

Say "when" in German and name the English word it is. (***Wann***; *when.*) Which root does it share with *wer*? (****kʷ-***.) Answer *wann* with a weekday and with a month. (**Am Montag. Im Januar.**) Which season is English *harvest*? (***Herbst***.) Next: the sixth W, and the two words hiding inside it.

46.5 warum — "why," and the two words welded inside it

Five W-words are yours: **wer, was, wo, wann, wie**. Say all five, then take the sixth.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the negative for a *der*-word you do not have — *keinen*

You'll want to know: warum

warum — "why."

Said *va-ROOM*, and the stress is on the **second** syllable — which is unusual enough to be worth marking, because almost every German word you have met so far leans on its first.

Warum? — "Why?"

Warum lernst du Deutsch? — "Why are you learning German?"

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

warum is two words that stopped being two. It is Old High German *wār umbe* (EtymDB 2.1): **war-** is the old form of **wo**, "where", here meaning "what"; **-um** is **um**, "about". *About what.*
English built its own *why*-word the identical way and it is still readable: **wherefore** is *where* plus *for*, "for what". Shakespeare's *"wherefore art thou Romeo"* is not asking where Romeo is. It is asking **why**.
So both languages fused a question word to a small preposition, and both ended up with a *why* that once meant *about what* or *for what.* German's fusion went further and hid the seam; English's is still visible.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "warum" — *va-ROOM*, stress on the second half
- the two pieces, then the word — "war … um … warum"
- "Warum lernst du Deutsch?"
- the whole set, in one breath — "wer, was, wo, wann, warum, wie"
- ask about the drink — "Warum Tee?"

Twice through: "Warum lernst du Deutsch?"

Before you move on

Which syllable of *warum* is stressed? (**The second** — *va-ROOM.*) What two words are welded inside it? (An old **wo**, "where", and **um**, "about".) Which English word was built the same way? (***Wherefore*** — *where* plus *for.*) Say all six W-words. Next: the chapter, run cold.

46.6 Frag mich! — the chapter, run cold

Two sentence shapes put the verb first, and they mean different things. Name both. Then say the six W-words in one breath.

Your turn: ask about the people and the clock

Say these aloud:

- "Wer ist das?" about each — "der Bruder, die Schwester, die Mutter, der Vater", and the four Latin cousins they keep: *frater, soror, mater, pater*
- "Wann?" answered by the clock — "Um ein Uhr", and the Latin word inside *Uhr*: *hora*

Your turn: the distant band — flip every statement you own

Every statement in this book can now be a question. Take the verb and move it left.

Say these aloud:

- "Du wohnst in Berlin." → "Wohnst du in Berlin?"; "Du lernst Deutsch." → "Lernst du Deutsch?"
- the six things to eat and drink, asked for — "Hast du Kaffee, Tee, Milch, Brot, Wasser, Wein?"
- the two animals, then last chapter's answer — "Hast du einen Hund?" "Nein, ich habe keinen Hund." "Hast du eine Katze?" "Nein, ich habe keine Katze."
- which of those words German bought and which it always had — *Kaffee* and *Tee* came from far away, *Milch* and *Brot* did not

Your turn: commands

Strip the *-en*, then say it.

Say these aloud:

- "Komm! Geh! Sag!"
- "Hör! Öffne! Schließ!"
- "Schreib!"
- the two whose vowel breaks — "Lies! Sieh!"

Before you move on

What turns a statement into a yes-or-no question? (**The verb moves to first place**.) What does a command leave out? (**The pronoun**.) Which sound law lines German *w-* up with English *wh-*? (**Grimm's**.) And which of the six W-words is two words welded together? (***Warum*** — an old *wo* plus *um*.)

Chapter 47

Which One, and the Form the Book Owed You

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask which one and how many, put a der-word into the shape it takes when something is done to it, say that a thing exists, and leave an adjective alone when it follows the verb.
>
> *Every der-word in the book is run through the shape it takes when something happens to it, and every adjective is run through the shape it takes when nothing does. The chapter costs five items and pays a debt the einen lesson wrote down in plain sight: GE-C14-einen told the reader to take einen 'as a word for now, not as a system', and named the chapter that would explain it. This is that chapter.*

47.1 welcher — "which," and the two pieces inside it

Wer asks which person. *Was* asks which thing. Neither can ask **which one of these**, and that is the word this lesson buys.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the three shapes of the negative article — *kein*, *keine*, *keinen*

You'll want to know: welcher

welcher — "which", standing in front of a noun.

The ending copies the article the noun already takes, so you have nothing new to learn once you know its gender: **welcher** for a *der*-word, **welche** for a *die*-word, **welches** for a *das*-word.

Welcher Hund? · Welche Katze? · Welches Brot?

Said *VEL-cher*, with the soft ich-sound of *ich* and *nicht* in the middle.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

welcher ← Proto-Germanic **hwilīkaz* (EtymDB 2.1), two ancient pieces: ***hwa-*** — the *what* at the front of every W-word — and ***-lîk***, "like, bodily form", the ancestor of English **-ly** and of the word **like** itself. *What-like.*
English built its own word out of the very same two: *hwā* + *līc* gave **hwilc**, which wore down to **which**. So both languages ask "which one" by asking "what kind", and the seam shows if you set *wel-cher* beside *wh-ich.*

Your turn

Say the article first, then the matching shape.

Say these aloud:

- *der* Hund → "Welcher Hund?"
- *die* Katze → "Welche Katze?"
- *das* Brot → "Welches Brot?"
- *der* Kaffee → "Welcher Kaffee?"
- *die* Milch → "Welche Milch?"

Twice through: "Welcher Hund? Welche Katze? Welches Brot?"

Before you move on

What decides the ending on *welcher*? (**The article the noun takes.**) Give all three. (***Welcher, welche, welches.***) What two pieces is it built from? (**Hwa-** and **-lîk** — "what-like".) Which English word was built the same way? (***Which.***)

47.2 wie viel, wie viele — how much and how many

You can count to twenty and you cannot ask anybody for a number. Say **zwölf** and **zwanzig**, then take the question that was missing.

You'll want to know: wie viel · wie viele

wie viel — "how much", for something you would not count.
wie viele — "how many", for things you would.

Wie viel Milch? — how much milk. · **Wie viele Hunde?** — how many dogs.

English draws the identical line with two words too, *much* against *many*, so nothing is new except the German for it. The **-e** on *viele* is the plural ending you have carried since *die*.

One phrase to bank whole: **Wie viel Uhr ist es?**, literally *how much clock is it*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

viel is Proto-Indo-European ****pelh₁-***, "to fill". Grimm's law turned that **p** into **f**, as it did in *Fuß* against Latin *pes*, and the word reached English as **full**. The same root sits in Greek *poly-* and Latin *plenus*. German asks *how full* where English asks *how much*.

Your turn

Decide countable or not before you speak.

Say these aloud:

- not countable — "Wie viel Milch, Wasser, Kaffee?"
- countable — "Wie viele Hunde? Wie viele Katzen?"
- the clock phrase, then the answer — "Wie viel Uhr ist es?" "Es ist ein Uhr."
- the *p* that became *f*, twice — "Fuß und viel"

- the two questions side by side — "Welcher Kaffee?" and "Wie viel Kaffee?"

Twice through: "Wie viel Milch? Wie viele Hunde?"

Before you move on

Which one goes with milk, and why? (***Wie viel*** — milk is not counted.) Which goes with dogs? (***Wie viele***.) What English word is *viel*? (***Full***, by the same $p \to f$ step that gave *Fuß*.) Ask the time. (**Wie viel Uhr ist es?**)

47.3 den — the form the book has owed you since einen

Say **einen** and **keinen**. Both wear an *-en* that no other shape of their word wears, and both were handed to you as plain words with the promise that the system behind them would come later. It comes now.

You'll want to know: den

den — "the", for a *der*-word that is the thing being done to.

Der Hund ist hier. → **Ich habe den Hund.**

The dog standing is *der Hund*; the dog being had is *den Hund*. German writes the difference on the article rather than on the noun.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

den is a form of *der*, inherited from the Germanic pointing word behind English *the* and *that*.

Grammar Lens: one row of three moves

When a noun is the thing being done to, only the **der**-words change shape.

naming it	**doing something to it**
der Hund	**den** Hund
die Milch	**die** Milch
das Brot	**das** Brot

That is the whole announcement, and it is smaller than German's reputation suggests. *Die* and *das* stand still. So do their *ein* and *kein* partners — **eine**, **keine**, **ein**, **kein** — while *ein* becomes **einen** and *kein* becomes **keinen** on exactly the row where *der* becomes *den*.

Why it's said this way

English ran this system too and threw nearly all of it away. Three survivors remain, all pronouns: **whom**, **him**, **them**. *"Whom did you see"* is precisely what *den* does. English kept the marking only where it was shortest; German kept it on the article, where it stays visible on every noun.

Your turn

Name it, then do something to it.

Say these aloud:

- "der Hund" → "Ich habe den Hund."
- "der Wein" → "Ich habe den Wein."
- "der Kaffee" → "Ich habe den Kaffee."
- the two that do not move — "das Brot", "das Wasser"
- the three that move together — "den, einen, keinen"
- ask about it first — "Wie viele Hunde?", then "Ich habe den Hund"; "Wie viel Kaffee?", then "Ich habe den Kaffee"

Twice through: "Der Hund — den Hund."

Before you move on

Which of the three articles changes when its noun is done to? (**Only *der*, which becomes *den*.**) Which two words you already

say change on the same row? (***Einen*** and ***keinen***.) Which three English words are the last survivors of the same system? (**Whom, him, them**.)

47.4 Der Tag ist gut — the adjective that stays still

Say **gut**, then **guten Tag**, then **gute Nacht**. The same adjective wears three shapes, and you have never been told what decides which.

Grammar Lens: the ending comes from standing in front

A German adjective takes an ending only when it stands **in front of** its noun. After *ist*, it stands bare.

Der Tag ist gut. — bare. The adjective comes after the verb.

Guten Tag. — an ending. The adjective comes before the noun.

So the greeting and the verdict are the same word in two positions, and the position is the whole story. This is the single most economical thing in German adjectives: half of all the adjective forms in the language are **the dictionary word, unchanged**, and you get that half free.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

English does the opposite of both halves: it never inflects an adjective at all, in either position. *The day is good*, *good day* — one shape, always.
So every German adjective you own is already usable after *ist* with no work:

Die Katze ist schwarz. · **Der Wein ist rot.** · **Ich bin müde.**

The colours from the colour chapters, the *müde* from the wellbeing chapter and the *gut* from page one all behave the same way the

moment a verb stands in front of them.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- bare, after the verb — "Der Tag ist gut."
- with an ending, in front — "Guten Tag."
- the colours, all bare — "Der Wein ist rot", "Die Katze ist schwarz", "Das Brot ist weiß"
- two more bare ones — "Ich bin müde", "Das ist schön"
- the two that emigrated to Romance — "blau" and "blank"

Twice through: "Der Tag ist gut. Guten Tag."

Before you move on

When does a German adjective take an ending? (**Only in front of its noun.**) What shape does it wear after *ist*? (**The dictionary shape, bare.**) Say the pair that has been on page one since the beginning. (***Der Tag ist gut / guten Tag.***)

47.5 es gibt — "it gives," which is German for "there is"

You met **es** as the weather's subject — the *es* that stands for nobody. It has one more famous job, and it needs the form you learned two lessons ago.

You'll want to know: es gibt

es gibt — "there is", "there are". Literally: *it gives.*

Es gibt Kaffee. — "There is coffee."

Es gibt einen Hund. — "There is a dog."

Es gibt keinen Kaffee. — "There is no coffee."

The phrase never changes shape. Whether one thing exists or twenty, it stays **es gibt** — the *es* is the same empty subject as in the weather, standing in a slot German insists on filling.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gibt is a form of the verb "to give" ← Old High German *geban* ← Proto-Germanic **gebanǫ* — inherited, the same verb as English *give*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Grammar Lens: what follows it is an object

Because *geben* means *give*, the thing that exists is grammatically the thing being **given** — so it takes the done-to form this chapter has taught.

> **Es gibt den Hund. · Es gibt einen Hund. · Es gibt keinen Hund.**

Every one of those is a *der*-word wearing its *-n*, and that is not a special rule for *es gibt*. It is the ordinary rule, arriving in the commonest sentence you will ever want it in.
Four languages, four different verbs for the same idea: German **gives** it, French **has it there**, Spanish **has** it outright, English **puts** it there. Only German's choice makes the thing an object, and that is why *es gibt* is the place a learner meets the case system whether or not anyone explained it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Es gibt Kaffee." and "Es gibt Tee."
- with the marked article — "Es gibt einen Hund.", "Es gibt einen Wein."
- negated — "Es gibt keinen Kaffee.", "Es gibt keine Milch."
- the two uses of the empty *es*, side by side — the weather, then existence
- "Es gibt Brot und Wasser."

Twice through: "Es gibt keinen Kaffee."

Before you move on

What does *es gibt* say word for word? (***It gives***.) Does it change when there are many things? (**No** — it never moves.) What form does the thing after it take? (**The done-to form** — *einen*, *keinen*, *den*.) Say "there is no coffee." (**Es gibt keinen Kaffee.**)

47.6 Welchen? — the chapter, run cold

Three questions first. Which row of the three articles moves? When does an adjective take an ending? What does *es gibt* say word for word?

Your turn: which one, and how many

Say these aloud:

- the three shapes — "Welcher Hund? Welche Katze? Welches Brot?"
- the uncounted, then the counted — "Wie viel Milch, Wasser, Kaffee?" and "Wie viele Hunde, Katzen?"; then "Welcher Wein? Welcher Tee?"
- refuse each, choosing the negative — "Es ist kein Wein" against "Das ist nicht gut", and name the test
- as a command — "Sieh den Hund!" and "Hör den Hund!"

Your turn: the distant band — every der-word, done to

Every *der*-word this book owns, moved. Name the article, then move it. Say these aloud:

- the drinks — "der Kaffee, den Kaffee; der Tee, den Tee; der Wein, den Wein"
- the people — "der Bruder, den Bruder; der Vater, den Vater; der Freund, den Freund"
- the body — "der Arm, den Arm; der Finger, den Finger; der Fuß, den Fuß; der Mund, den Mund; der Kopf, den Kopf"

- the animal and the times of day — “den Hund, den Tag, den Abend”
- three with *es gibt* — “Es gibt den Hund. Es gibt einen Bruder. Es gibt keinen Kaffee.”
- the two bought far away against the two never lent — *Kaffee* and *Tee* against *Fuß* and *Mund*

Your turn: adjectives that stay still

Say these aloud:

- the colours after a verb, bare — “Der Wein ist rot. Das Brot ist weiß. Die Katze ist schwarz.” Then “grün, gelb, blau”
- “Ich bin müde. Das ist schön. Der Tag ist gut.” Then four verbs of the body, still yours — “gehen, laufen, sitzen, stehen”

Before you move on

Name the three words that change together on the *der* row. (***Den, einen, keinen.***) Which two articles never move? (***Die*** and ***das***.) And what does *es gibt* demand of what follows it? (**The done-to form.**)

Chapter 48

Two Thoughts, One Sentence

Modes: **voice** (5) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can join two thoughts with and, or, but, but-rather and because, and I know which of them sends the verb to the end.
>
> *Every verb the book owns is given a reason, twice: once with denn and the verb in slot two, once with weil and the verb walked to the far end. The chapter is where the reader learns that German saves its last position for the piece that completes the sense – the third time the book has sent something there, after the separable prefix and the nicht that cancels a verb.*

48.1 oder — "or," and the question every German ends with

Und has been yours since the wellbeing lessons and is the only joining word in the book. Say "Kaffee und Tee", then take the second one.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the two shapes of *how many* — *wie viel* for what you cannot count, *wie viele* for what you can

You'll want to know: oder

oder — "or".

Said *OH-der*, long *o*, soft trailing *r*.

Kaffee oder Tee? · Milch oder Wasser?

Nothing moves around it. Like *und*, it stands between two things and joins them, and the verb stays where it was.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

oder and English **or** are the same Germanic word, ****efþau*** — English wore it to one syllable, German kept two. German then gave it a job English builds a whole clause for. Put **oder?** on the end of a statement:

Das ist gut, oder? — "That's good, isn't it?"

English needs *isn't it*, *doesn't he*, *haven't they* — a different tag for every verb and person. German needs one word, unchanged. You will hear it constantly.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Kaffee oder Tee?" and "Milch oder Wasser?"
- the animals — "Hund oder Katze?"
- both joiners in one breath — "Brot und Wein", "Brot oder Wein"
- the tag — "Das ist gut, oder?"
- a choice with a quantity in it — "Wie viel Kaffee oder wie viel Tee?" and "Wie viele Hunde oder wie viele Katzen?"

Twice through: "Kaffee oder Tee? — Das ist gut, oder?"

Before you move on

Say "coffee or tea". What English word is *oder*? (***Or***, the same word with a syllable worn off.) What does *oder?* do at the end of a sentence? (**Turns it into a question expecting agreement** — English's *isn't it*.)

48.2 aber — "but," the word that turns a sentence around

Und adds. *Oder* offers a choice. Neither can say that the second half disagrees with the first.

You'll want to know: aber

aber — "but".

Said *AH-ber*, long *a*, soft *r*.

Der Tag ist gut, aber ich bin müde. — "The day is good, but I'm tired."

Das ist schön, aber teuer. — "That's lovely, but expensive."

The verb does not move. *Aber* joins two whole sentences without disturbing either — which is what makes it, *und* and *oder* one family, and worth knowing before the two words in this chapter that **do** disturb things.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aber was once ****afar***, "after, again" — a cousin of German **ab** ("off") and of Greek **apo-**, which English carries in *apostrophe* and *apology*. A word about position became a word about contrast.
English did the identical thing with different pieces. **But** is Old English ***be-ūtan***, "by-out" — *without*, *outside of*. Two languages, two small words about where a thing stands, both promoted to mean *however*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Der Tag ist gut, aber ich bin müde."
- "Das ist schön, aber ich habe keine Zeit."
- with last chapter's negative — "Ich habe Tee, aber keinen Kaffee."
- the three joiners in a row — "und, oder, aber"

Twice through: "Der Tag ist gut, aber ich bin müde."

Before you move on

Say the three joiners you now own. (***Und, oder, aber***.) Does the verb move after any of them? (**No.**) What did *aber* mean before it meant "but"? (**After, again** — a word about position.) Next: the fourth "but", which German keeps for one job only.

48.3 sondern — the "but" that corrects

German already has one word that exists only to contradict a negative: **doch**, which answers *"Hast du keinen Hund?"* with *yes I do*. It has a second, and it does the same job inside a sentence.

You'll want to know: sondern

sondern — "but rather", after a negative, when the second half **replaces** what the first half denied.

Das ist nicht schwarz, sondern weiß. — "That isn't black, it's white."

Compare it with the word from the last lesson, which cannot do this job:

Das ist schwarz, aber schön. — two things, both true. **Das ist nicht schwarz, sondern weiß.** — the second corrects the first.

The test is short: if the first half is negative and the second half puts something in its place, German wants *sondern*. Otherwise it wants *aber*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sondern is also a verb, meaning **to separate**, and English keeps that verb too: **sunder**, and the *asunder* of *torn asunder*. So the joiner that corrects a negative is, underneath, the word for keeping two things apart — which is exactly what it does to the wrong answer and the right one.

English has no separate word here and never did. It says *but* both times and lets the tone do the work. German marks the difference, and it marks it a second time with **doch** in answers, so the pattern is one

you have already met.
The word ← Old High German *suntar*, "apart" (EtymDB 2.1), the same family as English *sunder*.

Your turn

Decide which "but" the sentence wants before you say it.
Say these aloud:

- a correction — "Das ist nicht schwarz, sondern weiß."
- a correction — "Das ist kein Kaffee, sondern Tee."
- two things both true, so *aber* — "Der Wein ist rot, aber gut."
- the answer-word that does the same job — "Doch!"

Twice through: "Das ist nicht schwarz, sondern weiß."

Before you move on

When does German want *sondern* rather than *aber*? (**After a negative, when the second half replaces what was denied.**) What English verb is *sondern*? (**To sunder** — to separate.) Which answer-word does the same job in one syllable? (***Doch***.)

48.4 denn — "because," with nothing moved

Four joiners are yours and none of them can give a reason. Say the four, and note that the verb has stayed in slot two after every one of them.

You'll want to know: denn

denn — "for", "because".

Ich bin müde, denn ich habe nicht geschlafen. — "I'm tired, because I didn't sleep."

Look at the second half. **Ich** first, **habe** second — the ordinary order the book has used since your first question. *Denn* gives a reason and changes nothing, which makes it the easiest reason-word German has and the one to reach for first.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

denn and **dann** ("then") were one word. German split the pair and gave each half a job: *dann* says **when**, *denn* says **why**. English is a cousin of both and kept only the *when* — **then** — so the *why* half has no English survivor at all.
You can still hear the join. *"It rained, then I stayed home"* and *"It rained, so I stayed home"* are nearly the same sentence, and a reason is very often a *before* wearing different clothes. *Dann* ← Old High German *danne* ← Proto-Germanic **þan*, "then" (EtymDB 2.1), and *denn* split off from it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Ich bin müde, denn ich habe keine Zeit."
- with the past you already own — "Ich bin müde, denn ich habe gelernt."
- all five joiners — "und, oder, aber, sondern, denn"
- prove the verb has not moved — "denn ich habe …", subject first, verb second
- the question this word answers — "Warum?" then "…, denn ich habe keine Zeit."
- the other two W-words, each answered with *denn* — "Wer lernt Deutsch?" and "Wann lernst du?", and their English twins, *who* and *when*, which begin with the *wh-* Grimm's law left behind

Twice through: "Ich bin müde, denn ich habe gelernt."

Before you move on

Where does the verb stand after *denn*? (**Second, as always.**) What word was *denn* once the same as? (***Dann***, "then" — English kept only that half.) Next: the other word for "because", which does not leave the sentence alone.

48.5 weil — "because," and the verb goes to the end

Denn gave a reason and moved nothing. This word gives the same reason and moves the most important thing in the sentence.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the phrase that says a thing exists — *es gibt*, and the marked form it demands

You'll want to know: weil

weil — "because".

Said *vile*, rhyming with *mile*: the same *ei* you say in *kein* and *nein*.

Grammar Lens: the verb travels to the far end

After **weil**, the verb leaves slot two and goes **last**.

Set the two reason-words side by side and only one thing differs:

Ich bin müde, denn ich habe **keine Zeit. Ich bin müde, weil ich keine Zeit** habe**.**

Same words, same meaning, and *habe* has walked to the end of the line. This is the third time the book has sent something to the far end of a German sentence. A separable prefix goes there. *Nicht* goes there when it cancels the verb. Now the verb itself goes there, whenever a word like *weil* opens the clause. German saves its last position for the piece that completes the sense, and it is worth expecting from here on.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

weil is a worn-down **dieweil**, "during the while that" — and **die Weile** is English **while**, the same word. So German's *because* began as a word about **time**.
English walked the same road with **since**: *"since Tuesday"* is time, *"since you asked"* is cause, and nobody notices the crossing. A reason and a before-and-after are close enough that both languages made the trip.

Your turn

Say the *denn* version first, then move the verb.

Say these aloud:

- "…, denn ich habe keine Zeit." → "…, weil ich keine Zeit habe."
- "Ich lerne Deutsch, weil ich in Berlin wohne."
- the verb travelling, out loud — "habe … keine Zeit habe"
- the three things German sends to the end — a prefix, *nicht*, and now the verb

Twice through: "Ich bin müde, weil ich keine Zeit habe."

Before you move on

What happens to the verb after *weil*? (**It goes to the end.**) And after *denn*? (**Nothing** — it stays in slot two.) What word is hiding inside *weil*? (**Die Weile** — English *while*.) Which English reason-word made the same journey from time to cause? (***Since***.)

48.6 Zwei Gedanken — the chapter, run cold

Six joiners. Five leave the verb where it stands and one does not. Name all six, then name the one that moves it.

Your turn: joining, without moving anything

Say these aloud:

- joined — “Brot und Wein”, “Kaffee oder Tee”, “Milch oder Wasser”
- contrasted — “Der Wein ist rot, aber gut.”
- corrected — “Das ist nicht weiß, sondern schwarz.”
- the six colours, two of them corrections — “Nicht grün, sondern gelb. Nicht blau, sondern rot.”

Your turn: the distant band — reasons over everything

Every verb the book owns can now carry a reason. Say each pair twice — once with *denn* and the verb in place, once with *weil* and the verb at the end.

Say these aloud:

- “Ich lerne Deutsch, denn ich wohne in Berlin.” → “…, weil ich in Berlin wohne.”
- “Ich bin müde, denn ich habe keine Zeit.” → “…, weil ich keine Zeit habe.”
- the verbs of taking in and putting out, each given a reason — *lesen, schreiben, hören, sehen*
- the verbs of the body — *schlafen, sitzen, stehen, gehen, laufen, rennen*
- the pair with a prefix that already goes to the end — *öffnen* and *schließen*
- the three things German sends last — a prefix, *nicht*, the verb after *weil*

Before you move on

Which joiner corrects a negative? (***Sondern.***) Which two give a reason, and what is the difference? (***Denn***, verb in slot two; ***weil***, verb at the end.) Which of the six is also a tag question? (***Oder?***) And which one is *die Weile* in disguise? (***Weil.***)

Chapter 49

Mine, Yours, His, Hers

Modes: **voice** (5) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 4 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say whose something is with all four possessives, and introduce somebody who is not me.
>
> *Every person and every object the book owns is claimed and then done something to. The four possessives cost their first two letters and nothing else, because they wear the endings ein bought, kein banked and den confirmed – six words, one ending set, and the reader had already paid for it three times.*

49.1 mein — the word you have been saying since you first gave your name

Say **mein Name ist ...**. You have said it since the second chapter as a single block. The first word of it is about to become a word of its own.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the phrase that says a thing exists — *es gibt*

You'll want to know: mein

mein — "my".

mein Bruder · **meine Schwester** · **mein Brot**

English splits this word in two — *my* in front of a noun, *mine* standing alone — and the split is late and unnecessary. **mein** and **mine** are one word, Proto-Germanic ****mīnaz***, and German never divided it.

Grammar Lens: the family of six

> **mein** takes the endings **ein** takes. So does **kein**, and so will the three words in the next three lessons.

You paid for this two chapters ago without being told. *Ein* becomes **eine** before a *die*-word and **einen** when a *der*-word is done to. *Kein* does the same. **Mein** does the same:

> **mein Bruder → Ich habe meinen Bruder. meine Schwester → Ich habe meine Schwester.**

One ending set, six words wearing it. Learning the fourth, fifth and sixth costs nothing at all, because the endings were bought with *ein*, banked again with *kein*, and confirmed a third time with *den*.

Your turn

Say the article first, so the ending falls out of it.

Say these aloud:

- *der* Bruder → "mein Bruder", then done-to, "meinen Bruder"
- *die* Schwester → "meine Schwester", which does not move
- "meine Mutter, mein Vater"
- "mein Freund, meine Freundin"
- the three that move on the same row — "einen, keinen, meinen"

Twice through: "mein Bruder — meinen Bruder."

Before you move on

Which endings does *mein* take? (**The ones *ein* takes** — and *kein*.)
Say "my brother" as the thing you have. (**Meinen Bruder**.)
Which two English words are *mein*? (***My*** and ***mine***, split late and needlessly.)

49.2 dein — "your," and the third *th* that became a *d*

Say **du** and **dir**. Both were once English *thou* and *thee*. Predict the German for *thine* before you read on.

You'll want to know: dein

dein — "your", to somebody you call *du*.

dein Bruder · **deine Schwester** · **deinen Bruder**

The endings are *mein*'s endings, which were *ein*'s endings. Nothing new is being learned here except the first two letters.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Three words, one shift, and you have now seen all three:

English	German
thou	**d**u
thee	**d**ir
thine	**d**ein

Germanic ***þ*** hardened into German **d** across the board, so any English word beginning *th-* is worth testing against a German *d-*. *That* is **das**. *Three* is **drei**. *Thank* is **danken**. The rule has been paying out since your first article and it will keep paying.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "dein Bruder, deine Schwester"
- the pair — "mein Freund, dein Freund"
- a question with it — "Wer ist deine Freundin?"
- the *th* to *d* rule, four times — "that/das, three/drei, thank/danke, thine/dein"

Twice through: "Wer ist dein Bruder?"

Before you move on

Say "your sister" and "your brother". Which English word is *dein*? (***Thine***.) Which sound law lines the two up? (**Germanic *þ* becoming German *d***.) Whose endings does *dein* wear? (***Ein*'s** — like *kein* and *mein*.)

49.3 sein — "his," and a collision worth meeting head-on

Sein is the verb *to be*, the one with three roots braided into it. Say **er ist**. Now meet a second, unrelated word spelled the same way.

You'll want to know: sein

sein — "his".

sein Bruder · **seine Schwester** · **seinen Bruder**

Same endings again — *ein*'s. Third word in a row that costs nothing but its first letters.

The two *sein*s are genuinely two words. The possessive is Proto-Germanic ****sīnaz***, a cousin of Latin **suus**. The verb is the braided one. They arrived at the same spelling from opposite directions and German never separated them.

Grammar Lens: how a reader tells them apart

The position settles it, every time, without exception:

sein Bruder — a noun follows, so this is *his*. **Ich will sein** — no noun follows, so this is *to be*.

A possessive is always leaning on a noun. An infinitive is not. German has more of these collisions than English does — *sie* alone runs three jobs — and each time, what resolves it is the shape of the sentence around the word rather than the word itself.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "sein Bruder, seine Schwester"
- the three so far — "mein Vater, dein Vater, sein Vater"
- "Das ist sein Hund."
- the collision, both ways — "sein Bruder" and the bare verb, "sein"

Twice through: "mein Vater, dein Vater, sein Vater."

Before you move on

Say "his mother" and "his brother". What else is the word *sein*? (**The verb *to be*.**) What tells them apart? (**Whether a noun follows.**) Say the three possessives you now own. (***Mein, dein, sein***.)

49.4 ihr — "her," and a word with three jobs

Ihr already means *you all*. **Sie** already means *she*, *they* and formal *you*. German is comfortable with a word doing several jobs, and this lesson adds one more.

You'll want to know: ihr

ihr — "her".

ihr Bruder · **ihre Schwester** · **ihren Bruder**

Said *eer*: the **h** is silent and stretches the *i*, exactly as it does in *Ihnen*. The endings are *ein*'s, for the fourth time.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ihr ← Old High German *iru*, *iro*, "her, their" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, a form of the pronoun for "she".

Grammar Lens: three jobs, all settled by position

Where the word stands says which job it is doing:

- **ihr wohnt** — a verb with *-t* follows, so this is *you all*.
- **ihr Bruder** — a noun follows, so this is *her*.
- **Ihr Bruder**, capitalised — the formal *your*, which the capital marks the same way it marks formal *Sie*.

Nothing here is ambiguous in a real sentence, and the capital does real work — a third reason for the capitalisation rule the writing chapter taught.
The same *ihr* also means *their*, which is one job too many to add today; the book will come back to it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ihr Bruder, ihre Schwester"
- all four — "mein, dein, sein, ihr"
- the two jobs side by side — "ihr wohnt" and "ihr Hund"
- "Das ist ihre Mutter."

Twice through: "mein, dein, sein, ihr."

Before you move on

Name the four possessives. (***Mein, dein, sein, ihr***.) What tells you which job *ihr* is doing? (**What follows it** — a verb or a noun.) What does the capital on *Ihr* mean? (**The formal *your***.)

49.5 das ist — introducing somebody who is not you

You can give your own name three ways and shake hands afterwards. You cannot yet introduce anybody else, and the phrase that does it is two words you already have.

You'll want to know: das ist

das ist — "this is", "that is".

Das ist mein Bruder. — "This is my brother."

Das ist meine Schwester. — "This is my sister."

And the reply is one you have owned since your first introduction: **Freut mich.**

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Das ist mein Bruder — *mein* ← Old High German *mīn* ← Proto-Germanic **mīnaz*, English *mine*; *Bruder* ← Proto-Germanic **brōþēr*, English *brother*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Grammar Lens: the das that ignores gender

Look at the second sentence again. **Schwester** is a *die*-word, and the phrase still opens with **das**. That is not a mistake, and it is not the article.
The **das** at the front of the sentence is the older, pointing word the article descends from — the demonstrative behind English **that**. It points at a person without committing to a gender, so it stays **das** in front of everybody:

> **Das ist mein Vater.** · **Das ist meine Mutter.** · **Das ist mein Hund.**

English does the same thing and hides it as well: *that is my sister* uses a word that started life as the neuter *þæt* and long ago stopped caring.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Das ist mein Bruder." — then answer, "Freut mich."
- "Das ist meine Schwester." — the *das* does not become *die*
- the household — "Das ist meine Mutter. Das ist mein Vater."

- with the other three possessives — "Das ist dein Freund. Das ist seine Freundin. Das ist ihr Hund."

Twice through: "Das ist meine Schwester. — Freut mich."

Before you move on

Introduce your sister. (**Das ist meine Schwester.**) Why is it not *die ist*? (**That *das* is the old pointing word, not the article**, and it ignores gender.) What do you say back? (**Freut mich.**)

49.6 Wer ist das? — the chapter, run cold

Name the four possessives. Then name the two older words whose endings all four borrow, and say why that means the four cost almost nothing.

Your turn: introduce everybody

Every person this book has named, introduced and claimed.

Say these aloud:

- "Das ist mein Bruder. Das ist meine Schwester."
- "Das ist meine Mutter. Das ist mein Vater."
- the two collective words — "meine Eltern, meine Geschwister"
- the pair the *-in* suffix built — "mein Freund, meine Freundin"
- "Das ist meine Familie." then answer, "Freut mich."
- the four Latin cousins those words keep — *frater, soror, mater, pater*

Your turn: the distant band — everything, claimed

Put *mein* in front of everything, and then do something to it.

Say these aloud:

- the animals — "mein Hund, meinen Hund; meine Katze"
- the table — "mein Kaffee, meinen Kaffee; mein Brot; meine Milch"

- the body, all of it — "mein Kopf, meine Hand, mein Arm, mein Fuß, mein Herz, mein Auge, mein Ohr, mein Mund, meine Nase"
- the two abstractions — "mein Name", "meine Zeit"
- the six words on one ending set — "ein, kein, mein, dein, sein, ihr"
- the *der*-row, five words deep — "den, einen, keinen, meinen, deinen"

Your turn: the far band — the last three chapters, over one family

Everything since the negation chapter, said about one family.

Say these aloud:

- joined and corrected — "Das ist nicht mein Bruder, sondern mein Vater." "Das ist meine Schwester, aber sie ist müde."
- with a reason both ways — "Das ist mein Bruder, denn er hat meinen Namen." "Ich frage meine Mutter, weil ich keine Zeit habe."
- existence and its marked form — "Es gibt keinen Kaffee." "Es gibt einen Bruder oder eine Schwester."
- the three W-words, aimed at people — "Wer ist das? Wann? Warum?"
- the two words built out of *not* and *one* — German's **kein** and English's **none**
- the two W-words whose English twins begin *wh-* — "wer/who, wann/when"

Before you move on

Say all six words that share one ending set. (***Ein, kein, mein, dein, sein, ihr.***) Which row of endings moves? (**The *der* row.**) Introduce your sister and answer yourself. (**Das ist meine Schwester. — Freut mich.**) Which other job does *sein* do, and which other two does *ihr* do?

Chapter 50

The One It Happens To

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say who a verb is aimed at with all six object pronouns, and bend a verb back onto its own subject.
>
> *Every verb of address in the book is pointed at every person, and the der-row is run six words deep – den, einen, keinen, meinen, deinen and now ihn, all moving together. The reflexive costs one word rather than six, because mich, dich, uns and euch already did that job; and freut mich, said since the reader's first introduction as an unexplained block, turns out to have been a reflexive all along.*

50.1 dich — "you," as the one it happens to

You own **mich** ("me") and **mir** ("to me"), and on the *du* side you own **du**, **dir** and now **dein**. One shape is missing from that row.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the joiner that sends the verb to the end — *weil*

You'll want to know: dich

dich — "you", when you are the one being done to.

Said *dikh*, with the soft ich-sound of *ich*, *mich* and *nicht*.

Ich sehe dich. — "I see you."

Ich höre dich. — "I hear you."

It is *mich*'s partner exactly: **ich** → **mich**, **du** → **dich**. One vowel apart, one job apart, and the pattern is visible without being taught.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

English once had this whole row and let it collapse. *Thou* was the doer, *thee* was both the done-to and the to-whom, *thine* the possessive. German kept four distinct shapes where English kept three and then lost all of them:

du · **dich** · **dir** · **dein**

Every one begins with the *d* that was English *th*, so the row is predictable from a rule you have had since the second chapter. *Du* and English *thou* are one inherited word, Proto-Germanic **þū* (EtymDB 2.1).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Ich sehe dich." and "Ich höre dich."
- "Ich verstehe dich." and "Ich frage dich."
- the pair — "Ich sehe dich", "Du siehst mich"
- the whole *du* row — "du, dich, dir, dein"

Twice through: "Ich sehe dich. Du siehst mich."

Before you move on

Say the four shapes of *du*. (***Du, dich, dir, dein.***) Which one is the done-to? (***Dich.***) Say "I hear you." (**Ich höre dich.**)

50.2 ihn — "him," on the row that always moves

One row of German keeps changing shape and the other two do not. Say **der** → **den**, **ein** → **einen**, **kein** → **keinen**, **mein** → **meinen**. The pronoun does it too.

You'll want to know: ihn

ihn — "him", and also "it" when the *it* is a *der*-word.

Said *een*: the **h** is silent and stretches the vowel, as in *ihr* and *Ihnen*.

Ich sehe ihn. — "I see him."

Der Hund? Ich sehe ihn. — "The dog? I see it."

That second sentence is the one an English speaker forgets. A German *der*-word is *ihn*, whatever it is made of, because German picks the pronoun by the article and not by whether the thing is alive.

Sie and **es** do not move at all — the *die* row and the *das* row stand still here exactly as their articles do.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

English **him** looks like a translation of *ihn* and is not the same form. *Him* was originally the **to-whom** shape, and it swallowed the done-to shape *hine* somewhere in the Middle Ages. German never let that merger happen, which is why it still has **ihn** for the done-to and **ihm** for the to-whom.
English lost the distinction; German lost nothing. *Ihn* ← Old High German *inan*; *him* is from another stem, Proto-Germanic **himmai* (EtymDB 2.1).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Ich sehe ihn." and "Ich höre ihn."
- the thing, not the person — "Der Hund? Ich sehe ihn."
- "Der Kaffee? Ich trinke ihn." and "Der Wein? Ich sehe ihn."
- the row that does not move — "Die Katze? Ich sehe sie."
- the three done-to pronouns so far — "mich, dich, ihn"

Twice through: "Ich sehe ihn. Ich sehe sie."

Before you move on

Which pronoun replaces a *der*-word being done to? (***Ihn*** — alive or not.) Which two do not change at all? (***Sie*** and ***es***.) What was English *him* originally? (**The to-whom form**, which swallowed the done-to one.)

50.3 uns — "us," and the one place German is simpler

Ich has three shapes — *ich*, *mich*, *mir*. Say them, then take the plural, which has two.

You'll want to know: uns

uns — "us", and also "to us".

Er sieht uns. — "He sees us."

Er gibt uns Kaffee. — "He gives us coffee."

One word, both jobs. Where *ich* needed *mich* and *mir*, **wir** needs only **uns**, and the language stops distinguishing exactly where it had been insisting.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

uns is the same word as English **us**, worn to the same length in both languages. English *us* also does both jobs — *he sees us*, *he gives us coffee* — so this is one row where the two languages agree completely and nothing has to be learned twice.

It is worth noticing *why* the agreement happened. German kept its distinctions in the singular, where the words are short and said constantly; it let them go in the plural, where they are longer and rarer. English did the same thing to *thou* and *thee* four centuries later, only more thoroughly.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Er sieht uns." and "Er hört uns."
- both jobs at once — "Er sieht uns" and "Er gibt uns Kaffee"
- the four done-to pronouns — "mich, dich, ihn, uns"
- "Verstehst du uns?"

Twice through: "Er sieht uns. Er gibt uns Kaffee."

Before you move on

How many shapes does *wir* have? (**One** — *uns*, for both jobs.) How many does *ich* have? (**Three** — *ich, mich, mir.*) Say "he sees us."

50.4 euch — "you all," and the word English promoted

Ihr is *you all.* It needs a done-to shape, and the shape it has is the most quietly famous word in this chapter.

You'll want to know: euch

euch — "you all", when you are the ones being done to. It also covers *to you all*, exactly as *uns* covers both jobs.

Said *oykh*: the **eu** is the *oy* of English *boy*, and the **ch** is the soft one.

Ich sehe euch. — "I see you all."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

English had this word. Old English **ēow** was the done-to shape of **ġē** ("ye"), and *ēow* is the same word as German *euch.*
Then English did something strange. It let *ēow* — the **object** form — take over the subject job as well, so *ye* died out and **you** became the only word left for the second person, singular or plural, doer or done-to. Modern English addresses everybody with what was once a plural object pronoun.
German still has the whole set standing: **du, dich, dir** for one person, **ihr, euch** for several, **Sie, Ihnen** for a stranger. English boiled all of

that down to **you**, and *y'all* is the attempt to build the plural back.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Ich sehe euch." and "Ich höre euch."
- the five done-to pronouns — "mich, dich, ihn, uns, euch"
- the three ways to address people — "dich, euch, Ihnen"
- the English word all of them collapsed into — *you*

Twice through: "mich, dich, ihn, uns, euch."

Before you move on

What is the done-to shape of *ihr*? (***Euch.***) Which English word is it? (***You*** — by way of Old English *ēow.*) Which English word did *ēow* push out? (***Ye.***) Say all five done-to pronouns you now own.

50.5 sich — the verb bent back on itself

You have said **freut mich** since the second chapter without asking what the *mich* is doing there. This lesson answers it.

Grammar Lens: when the doer and the done-to are the same

When the person doing something is also the person it happens to, German puts the done-to pronoun in anyway.

Ich wasche mich. — "I wash." Literally *I wash me.*

English drops the pronoun in most of these — *I wash*, *I shave*, *I dress* — and German never does. Every done-to pronoun you own is already the right one: *mich*, *dich*, *uns*, *euch*. Nothing new is needed for four of the six.

You'll want to know: sich

> **sich** — the one shape German uses for *himself*, *herself*, *itself*, *themselves* and formal *yourself*.

Said *zikh*, with a *z* at the front and the soft ich-sound at the back.

> **Er wäscht sich.** · **Sie wäscht sich.** · **Sie waschen sich.**

Where English needs four different words with *-self* welded on, German needs one, and it never changes.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sich is Latin **sē** and French **se**, all descended from Proto-Indo-European ****swe-***, "one's own". English lost the pronoun and kept the root inside words built on it: **self**, **suicide**, and — by a long road — **sibling**, a person of one's own kin.
Which finally explains **freut mich**: *freuen* is one of these verbs, so *es freut mich* is "it gladdens me", and the greeting you have said a hundred times was a reflexive construction all along.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Ich wasche mich." and "Er wäscht sich."
- the whole set, four owned and one new — "mich, dich, sich, uns, euch"
- the greeting, taken apart — "freut mich"
- "Sie freut sich."

Twice through: "Ich wasche mich. Er wäscht sich."

Before you move on

How many English words does *sich* cover? (**Four or more** — himself, herself, itself, themselves.) Which four done-to pronouns did you already own for this job? (***Mich, dich, uns, euch.***) And what has *freut mich* been all along? (**A reflexive** — "it gladdens me".)

50.6 mich, dich, sich — the chapter, run cold

> Say the six done-to pronouns. Then name the two that did not have to be learned as new words, and say why.

Your turn: point every verb at somebody

Six verbs of address, six pronouns. Run the grid by ear, not by reading it.

Say these aloud:

- "Ich sehe dich. Ich sehe ihn. Ich sehe euch."
- "Ich höre dich. Er hört uns. Wir hören euch."
- "Ich verstehe dich." and "Verstehst du mich?"
- "Ich frage dich." and "Ich helfe dir." — one takes the done-to shape, one takes the to-whom
- the two verbs of the page — "Ich lese es. Ich schreibe es."

Your turn: the distant band — the row that moves

Six words now move together on one row. Say the article, then the whole family, then the pronoun that replaces it.

Say these aloud:

- "der Hund → den Hund, einen Hund, keinen Hund, meinen Hund → ihn"
- "der Kaffee → den Kaffee → ihn"; "der Tee → den Tee → ihn"; "der Wein → den Wein → ihn"
- the people — "den Bruder, den Vater, den Freund → ihn"
- the body — "den Arm, den Fuß, den Finger, den Kopf, den Mund → ihn"
- the two rows that stand still — "die Katze → sie", "die Milch → sie", "das Brot → es"

Your turn: bent back

Say these aloud:

- "Ich wasche mich. Du wäschst dich. Er wäscht sich."
- "Wir waschen uns. Ihr wascht euch."
- the greeting that turns out to be one of these — "Freut mich."

Before you move on

Which pronoun replaces a *der*-word being done to? (***Ihn***.) Which two pronouns never change shape? (***Sie*** and ***es***.) How many English words does *sich* cover? (**Four or more**.) And which English pronoun is *euch*? (***You*** — the object form that took the whole job.)

Chapter 51

The Bracket

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I can, must and would like to do, hold the second verb until the end of the sentence, and build both families of past participle.
>
> *Every verb in the book is put inside a bracket, and then the seven preceding chapters are run in one breath over one small set of nouns. The chapter names a habit the reader has met three times already – a separable prefix, a past participle and a nicht that cancels a verb all go to the same last slot – so the modal bracket arrives as the fourth instance of one rule rather than a fourth rule.*

51.1 können — "can," and the verb that meant *know*

The simple-past chapter gave you **konnte**, "could". You have been able to say what you could do and not what you can do, which is an odd way round. This lesson fixes it.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the four possessives — *mein, dein, sein, ihr*

You'll want to know: können

können — "to be able", "can".

Ich kann. — "I can." · **Du kannst.** — "You can."

Notice the *ich* form. It is **kann**, not *könne*: this verb takes no ending at all in the first person, and its vowel changes as well. A small closed family of German verbs behaves like this, and every one of them is a word you will say constantly — which is the usual bargain, since the commonest words are the ones worn irregular by use.

> **Ich kann Deutsch.** — "I can speak German", with no second verb at all.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

können and English **can** are one word, and both began as a word for **knowing**. The root is Proto-Indo-European ***ǵneh₃-**, which also gave English **know**, Scots **ken**, Latin **nōscō** and Greek **gnosis**.
So *I can* once meant *I know how*, and the drift from knowledge to ability happened before English and German separated. That is why *ich kann Deutsch* — "I know German" — still sounds entirely ordinary with no verb after it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Ich kann." then "Du kannst."
- the pair with the past you already had — "Ich kann" and "Ich konnte"
- "Ich kann Deutsch."
- the old meaning, out loud — *can* was *know*

Twice through: "Ich kann Deutsch."

Before you move on

What is the *ich* form of *können*? (***Kann*** — no ending, and a changed vowel.) What did the word mean before it meant *be able*? (**To know** — the root behind *know* and *ken*.) Say "I can speak German" without a second verb. (**Ich kann Deutsch.**)

51.2 möchten — "I would like," the politest verb in the book

> **Mögen** is yours, and so is **bitte**. Between them you can say what you like and you can say please, and you still cannot order a coffee.

You'll want to know: möchten

möchten — "would like".

Ich möchte einen Kaffee, bitte. — "I'd like a coffee, please."

That sentence is the single most useful one in this chapter, and every piece of it is already yours except the verb: the *einen* from the having lessons, the *bitte* from the requests lesson, and the *Kaffee* from the drinks chapter.

Like *kann*, the *ich* form takes no ending: **ich möchte**, **du möchtest**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

möchten is **mögen** with its vowel bent — the umlaut doing grammatical work again, as it has done in every plural that took one. The bent form is historically a *past* shape pressed into service for the present, and that is precisely what makes it polite.
English runs the identical trick and nobody notices:

> *I **will** have a coffee → I **would** like a coffee **Can** you help → **Could** you help*

A past-shaped verb standing in the present puts a little distance between the speaker and the demand. Both languages found the same politeness strategy, and German marks it with two dots. *Mögen* ← Old High German *mugan* ← Proto-Germanic **maganą* (EtymDB 2.1), the same verb as English *may*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Ich möchte einen Kaffee, bitte."

- "Ich möchte einen Tee, bitte." and "Ich möchte Wasser, bitte."
- the blunt one, then the polite one — "Ich mag Kaffee" and "Ich möchte einen Kaffee"
- the two modals so far — "ich kann, ich möchte"

Twice through: "Ich möchte einen Kaffee, bitte."

Before you move on

Which verb is *möchten* a bent form of? (***Mögen***.) What is the bend doing? (**Making it polite** — a past-shaped form used in the present.) Which English pair does the same? (***Will*** and ***would***.) Order a coffee.

51.3 müssen — "must," and the ending that is missing in both languages

Say **ich kann** and **ich möchte**. Neither took the *-e* that ordinary verbs take. Say **er wohnt** and hear the *-t* that ordinary verbs do take, and then watch the third modal do without it too.

You'll want to know: müssen

müssen — "to have to", "must".

Ich muss. · **Du musst.** · **Er muss.**

The **ich** form and the **er** form are identical, and both are bare. That is the mark of this small family: no *-e*, no *-t*, and a vowel that changes.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

English has exactly the same hole, in exactly the same words, and every English speaker has been ignoring it for life:

> *he walk**s**, he live**s**, he think**s*** — but *he **must**, he **can**, he **may***, with no *-s* at all.

The reason is one accident, eight hundred years old and shared. This handful of verbs were once **past tenses**, and a past tense took no

ending in the present because it was not a present. They then drifted into meaning present things and kept their bare shape.
So the missing *-t* in *er muss* and the missing *-s* in *he must* are the same missing ending, and if the English one has never bothered you, the German one need not either. *Müssen* ← Old High German *muozan* ← Proto-Germanic **mōtanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1), the same verb as English *must*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Ich muss." "Du musst." "Er muss."
- the three modals — "ich kann, ich möchte, ich muss"
- an ordinary verb beside them — "er wohnt" against "er muss"
- the English hole out loud — "he walks" against "he must"

Twice through: "Ich kann, ich möchte, ich muss."

Before you move on

What ending does *er muss* take? (**None** — and neither does *er kann*.) Which English verbs have the same hole? (***Must, can, may*** — no *-s*.) Why? (**They were past tenses once**, and a past tense took no present ending.) Next: where the second verb goes.

51.4 die Verbklammer — the bracket German has been building all along

Name three things this book has already sent to the end of a German sentence. Take your time; you have met all three.

Grammar Lens: the modal holds slot two, the other verb waits at the end

A modal takes slot two, and the verb it governs goes **last**, in its dictionary form.

Ich kann Deutsch sprechen. — "I can speak German."

Ich muss Deutsch lernen. — "I must learn German."

Ich möchte einen Kaffee trinken. — "I'd like to drink a coffee."

Two verbs, one at each end, and everything the sentence is about held between them. German grammarians call that shape a **Klammer**, a bracket, and it is the skeleton of an ordinary German sentence.

Why it's said this way

This is not a new rule. It is the fourth appearance of one habit, and the four were taught chapters apart:

- a **separable prefix** goes to the end — *ich mache die Tür auf*;
- a **past participle** goes to the end — *ich habe Deutsch gelernt*;
- **nicht** goes to the end when it cancels the verb — *ich verstehe nicht*;
- and now an **infinitive** goes to the end after a modal.

Four different pieces, one position. German reserves the last slot of a sentence for whatever completes the sense, and asks its listener to wait. That is the single most-remarked feature of the language, and by the time it is named here you have already met three quarters of it.

Your turn

Say the modal, then hold the second verb until the end.

Say these aloud:

- "Ich kann Deutsch lernen."
- "Ich muss schlafen." and "Ich möchte gehen."
- with the verbs of the page — "Ich kann lesen. Ich kann schreiben."
- "Ich möchte dir helfen."
- the four things that go last — a prefix, a participle, *nicht*, an infinitive

Twice through: "Ich muss Deutsch lernen."

Before you move on

Where does the modal stand, and where does the other verb stand? (**Slot two, and last.**) In what form is the second verb? (**The dictionary form.**) Name the four things German sends to the end of a sentence. Next: the participle that ends in *-en*.

51.5 gegangen — the other half of the past

Say **ich habe gelernt**. The participle is wrapped in **ge-** and ends in **-t**, which the past chapter taught. Now say **ich bin gegangen** — which you have also said, and which ends in something else entirely.

Grammar Lens: the second family ends in -en

German builds participles two ways. The weak family wraps the stem in **ge-** and **-t**. The strong family wraps it in **ge-** and **-en**, and very often changes the vowel as well.

gehen → gegangen · sehen → gesehen · lesen → gelesen · schreiben → geschrieben

The **ge-** is the same unstressed wrapper in both families, so half of every participle in the language is already yours. What the strong family adds is the **-en** ending and a vowel that may move — and the moving vowel is the same strong-verb behaviour that gave you *du liest* and *du siehst*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

English split its participles the same way, into the same two shapes, and every English speaker sorts them without thinking:

weak	**strong**
walk**ed**, learn**ed**, ask**ed**	go**ne**, see**n**, writt**en**, giv**en**

That *-en* on *given* and *written* is German's *-en* on *gegeben* and *geschrieben* — the same ending, in the same job, inherited rather than borrowed. English then lost the *ge-* wrapper, which German kept, so

the German participle is the fuller survival of a shape both languages had.

Your turn

Say the dictionary form, then wrap it.

Say these aloud:

- "gehen → gegangen", "sehen → gesehen"
- "lesen → gelesen", "schreiben → geschrieben"
- the weak family beside it — "gelernt, gesagt, gemacht"
- the two helpers with the two families — "Ich habe gelesen." "Ich bin gegangen."
- the English pair that proves the split — "walked" against "written"

Twice through: "Ich habe gelesen. Ich bin gegangen."

Before you move on

What are the two participle endings? (***-t*** for the weak family, ***-en*** for the strong.) What do both families share? (**The *ge-* wrapper**, never stressed.) Which English participles end in *-en*? (***Gone, seen, written, given*** — the same family, the same ending.)

51.6 Was kann ich? — the chapter, and the seven before it, run cold

Name the four things German sends to the end of a sentence. Then say the two participle endings and what both families share.

Your turn: the bracket over every verb

Every verb the book owns, held at the end of a bracket. Say the modal first and make yourself wait for the second verb.

Say these aloud:

- “Ich kann lesen, schreiben, hören, sehen.”
- “Ich muss schlafen, gehen, laufen, lernen.”
- “Ich möchte fragen, helfen, nehmen.”
- the pair that opens and closes — “Ich muss die Tür öffnen. Ich muss die Tür schließen.”
- the two of rest — “Ich möchte sitzen. Ich möchte stehen.”
- the chapter’s own sentence — “Ich kann Deutsch lernen.”

Your turn: the distant band — eight chapters in one breath

Everything the last seven chapters bought, in order, over one small set of nouns.

Say these aloud:

- negation — “Ich habe keinen Hund. Ich verstehe nicht.”
- a question and a command — “Hast du einen Hund?” “Komm!”
- the three new W-words — “Wer? Wann? Warum?”
- which and how many — “Welcher Hund? Wie viele Hunde?”
- the marked row and existence — “Ich sehe den Hund. Es gibt keinen Kaffee.”
- an adjective that stays still — “Der Kaffee ist gut.”
- two joined thoughts, both ways — “Ich möchte Kaffee, aber ich habe keine Zeit.” “Ich bin müde, weil ich keine Zeit habe.”
- whose, and who — “Das ist mein Bruder. Das ist sein Hund.”
- the done-to row — “Ich sehe ihn. Ich sehe dich. Ich sehe euch.”
- bent back — “Er wäscht sich.”
- and all of it in one sentence — “Ich möchte meinen Bruder fragen, weil ich ihn nicht verstehe.”

Before you move on

Say the three modals. (***Kann, möchte, muss*** — none of them with an ending.) Where does the second verb go, and in what form? (**Last, in the dictionary form.**) Name the four things German sends to that same last slot. (**A separable prefix, a past participle, the *nicht* that cancels a verb, and an infinitive after a modal.**) And which participle ending marks the strong family? (***-en***.)

Chapter 52

Reading — Nouns, Sentences, and a First Paragraph

Modes: **eyes** (3) **Hands-free start:** none of the 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can read German nouns off a page, follow a sentence whose verb waits at the end, and hold a whole paragraph without translating it word by word.
>
> *Forty-eight words of German with no new word in them, including the one line where weil sends the verb to the far end and the reader has to hold the sentence open.*

52.1 (reading) — six nouns, and a capital letter doing real work

Every word below you have met. Not one is new.

What is new is that nobody says them first.

Read this

Brot Kaffee Wasser Buch Bruder Schwester

Read it: down the list once, without stopping
Read it: the list again, and notice they all begin with a capital
Every one of them.

Grammar Lens: the capital is information

German capitalises every noun. Spoken, that rule is invisible and costs nothing. Written, it is the single most useful thing on a German page for a beginner.
It means you can find the nouns in a sentence before you understand the sentence. In a language that puts its verb at the end and its cases on the articles, knowing which words are the things is most of the way to a reading.
That is the trade: a writer capitalises a hundred nouns so a reader can skip a hundred decisions.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six words down the list, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many of the six were new? (**None.**)
What do all six have in common on the page? (**A capital letter** — and it tells you they are nouns.)

52.2 (reading) — six sentences, and a wait at the end

The last lesson gave you nouns. These are whole sentences.

You have said every one of them.

Read this

Ich kann Deutsch. Ich möchte lernen. Ich muss arbeiten.
Wer ist das? Das ist mein Bruder. Danke!

Read it: the six lines down once, without stopping
Read it: the six lines again, and this time notice where the second verb sits in the first three

Grammar Lens: the bracket, from the outside

You have been building the bracket from the inside: choose the modal, park the verb at the end. Reading it, the bracket arrives the other way round — **möchte** comes early and then you wait.
That wait is what German reading is. A reader holds the front of the sentence open until the last word closes it, and the modal at the front is the signal to start holding.
Six lines, and three of them ask you to wait.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six lines, once, in order, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many of the six were new? (**None.**)
What does a modal at the front tell a reader? (**To wait** — the sentence is not finished until the last word.)

52.3 (reading) — the first paragraph

Six nouns, then six sentences. Now a whole paragraph.

Forty-eight words, and not one of them is new.

Read this

Guten Tag! Ich heiße Anna. Das ist mein Bruder. Er ist sehr gut. Wir trinken Kaffee und essen Brot. Ich lese ein Buch. Das Buch ist schön und alt. Ich kann Deutsch. Ich möchte viel lernen, weil Deutsch schön ist. Morgen muss ich arbeiten. Danke und auf Wiedersehen.

Read it: the passage once without stopping; do not translate as you go — let the sentences arrive
Read it: the passage again, and find the one line where the verb is last

Grammar Lens: the word that moves a verb

Ich möchte viel lernen, weil Deutsch schön ist. That **ist** at the end is not a mistake and not a style. **Weil** put it there.
Und does not do that. Nor does **aber**. Four of the shortest words in German, and one of them rearranges the sentence after it while the others leave it alone.
Reading is where that stops being a rule you apply and becomes something you see coming. The comma and the **weil** together are the warning: hold on, the verb is at the far end.
This is the first whole paragraph the book has asked you to hold at once, and it works because everything in it was paid for.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the paragraph aloud, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many words in that paragraph were new? (**None.**)
Which joiner moves the verb, and which two leave it alone? (**Weil** moves it; **und** and **aber** do not.)

Chapter 53

Writing — Your Own Line

Modes: ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none (1 lesson).

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write one line about myself from a closed supply of known words, with nothing to copy, and capitalise every noun.
>
> *Complete GE-W02-eigene-zeile: a greeting and a name chosen rather than copied, with the capitals checked before anything else.*

53.1 Your own line — the first writing with no model

> You have written **Hallo** four ways: traced, copied, copied from memory, and written from the sound alone.
>
> Every one of those had something to reach for. This one does not.

Writing — controlled composition

Write **one line** about yourself: a greeting, then your name.

Nothing is supplied. You choose the words, and the supply you are choosing from is closed — only what this book has taught you.

Before you write, one thing to decide deliberately rather than by accident: **which nouns get a capital?** In German the answer is *all of them*, not only the ones that name a person or a place. Your line will have at least one, and an English-trained hand will lower-case it without noticing.

Write the line. Then read it back and check the capitals **before** you check anything else.

Before you move on

Which German nouns take a capital letter? (**All of them.**)
And what did you have to choose, that the last four lessons chose for you? (**The words.**)

Chapter 54

Writing — With A Clock

Modes: ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none (1 lesson).

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can complete the Start Deutsch 1 writing paper's two parts inside its published twenty minutes, filling all five fields and keeping the text near thirty words.
>
> *Complete GE-W03-mit-der-uhr: six minutes for the five fields and fourteen for the thirty-word text, then count the words and check the capitals last.*

54.1 The same writing, with a clock

You wrote your own line with as long as you liked.

A task you can only do untimed is not yet a task you can do. Here are the exam's own conditions.

Writing — timed production

What Goethe publishes. The Start Deutsch 1 writing paper runs **20 minutes** and holds **two** parts: a form with **five** fields to complete, and a short personal text of about **thirty words**.

Those numbers are read out of `task-shapes/a1.json`, which transcribes the Goethe materials. They are not invented for this page.

Split the time the way the paper does. **Six minutes** for the five fields, starting now. Fill every one — a blank field scores nothing and cannot be argued with.

Now **fourteen minutes** for the thirty-word text.

When the time is up, stop even mid-word. An unfinished paper is information. An untimed one is not.

Before you move on

Count your words. **Thirty** is the published length, and it is a target rather than a floor: a text of fifteen has not done the task, and one of sixty has spent time the paper did not give you.
Now the German-specific check, and do it last because it is the one a clock destroys first: **the capitals**. Under time pressure a hand reverts to the habits it learned first, and for most readers of this book those habits are English ones.
Goethe awards the certificate on **60 of 100 overall** and publishes no separate pass mark for writing — which means a weak writing paper can be carried by the other three. Knowing that is not permission to write badly; it is the reason to know exactly how weak yours is.

Chapter 55

Writing — Four Lines, And The Joiner You Can See

Modes: ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none (1 lesson).

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write four connected lines to a named reader, joining with und and aber and giving a reason with weil, and check that weil actually moved the verb to the end.
>
> *Complete GE-W04-vier-zeilen: four lines to one reader, at least one joined with und or aber and one with weil, then point at the verb in the weil line and check it is last.*

55.1 Four lines, and the joiner you can see

The last lesson asked for writing that was **finished on time**. This one asks for writing that **holds together**.

Pick one person who will read it.

What to know first

Connected writing is not **longer** writing. Four short lines can be connected; one long line can fail to be. What makes it connected is that a sentence stops standing on its own.

You hold three joiners, and German does something with the third that the first two do not. **und** adds. **aber** sets against. Both leave the sentence they join exactly as it was.

weil does not. It picks the verb up and puts it at the **end**.

That is worth stopping on, because it means German shows you the join in the word order itself. In most languages you can only tell that two clauses were joined by reading the joining word. In German the second clause visibly rearranges — and a reader who sees a verb arrive late knows a reason is being given before they have finished the sentence.

Writing — connected composition

Write **four lines** to the person you picked.

At least one must use **und** or **aber**. At least one must use **weil** — and in that one, check the verb has actually moved.

Use only words you already write. This lesson adds no vocabulary; the whole exercise is the joining.

Before you move on

Cover your first line and read the second alone. Does it still make sense without the first? If it does, you wrote a **list** — which is where you were one lesson ago.
Then find your **weil** line and point at the verb. Is it last? If it is sitting where it would sit in a sentence on its own, the word is doing nothing: you wrote *und* with a different spelling.

Chapter 56

Leg, Tooth, Neck, Shoulder, Knee

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a leg, a tooth, the neck, a shoulder and a knee.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 56: I can say a leg, a tooth, the neck, a shoulder and a knee.*

56.1 das Bein — a leg

Before the new one: say the German for to open, then the German for to close.

You'll want to know: das Bein

das Bein — "a leg".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bein ← Old High German *bein*, "bone" ← Proto-Germanic **bainą* — inherited. English *bone* is the same word; German moved it from the bone to the whole leg. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Bein*
- *Say it: das Bein*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Bein*
- *Recall:* say the German for to open, then the German for to close, then say *das Bein* again

Before you move on

What does das Bein mean? ("A leg".) Say it once more.

56.2 der Zahn — a tooth

Before the new one: say the German for to close, then the German for a leg.

You'll want to know: der Zahn

der Zahn — "a tooth".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Zahn ← Old High German *zand* ← Proto-Germanic **tanþs*, "tooth" — inherited, the same word as English *tooth*, with German *z* where English kept *t*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Zahn*
- *Say it: der Zahn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Zahn*
- *Recall:* say the German for to close, then the German for a leg, then say *der Zahn* again

Before you move on

What does der Zahn mean? ("A tooth".) Say it once more.

56.3 der Hals — the neck; the throat

Before the new one: say the German for a leg, then the German for a tooth.

You'll want to know: der Hals

der Hals — "the neck; the throat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Hals ← Old High German *hals* ← Proto-Germanic **halsaz*, "neck" — inherited. Old English *heals*, "neck", is the same word. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Hals*
- *Say it: der Hals*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Hals*
- *Recall:* say the German for a leg, then the German for a tooth, then say *der Hals* again

Before you move on

What does der Hals mean? ("The neck; the throat".) Say it once more.

56.4 die Schulter — a shoulder

Before the new one: say the German for a tooth, then the German for the neck; the throat.

You'll want to know: die Schulter

die Schulter — "a shoulder".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schulter is inherited, from Old High German *scultirra*. EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *shoulder*, Dutch *schouder* and Swedish *skuldra* — the same Germanic word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Schulter*
- *Say it: die Schulter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Schulter*
- *Recall:* say the German for a tooth, then the German for the neck; the throat, then say *die Schulter* again

Before you move on

What does die Schulter mean? ("A shoulder".) Say it once more.

56.5 das Knie — a knee

Before the new one: say the German for the neck; the throat, then the German for a shoulder.

You'll want to know: das Knie

das Knie — "a knee".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Knie ← Old High German *kneo* ← Proto-Germanic **knewą* — inherited, the same word as English *knee*, whose *k* English stopped saying. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Knie*
- *Say it: das Knie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Knie*
- *Recall:* say the German for the neck; the throat, then the German for a shoulder, then say *das Knie* again

Before you move on

What does das Knie mean? ("A knee".) Say it once more.

Chapter 57

Face, Blood, Skin, Hair, Belly

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say the face, blood, skin, a hair and the belly.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 57: I can say the face, blood, skin, a hair and the belly.*

57.1 das Gesicht — the face

Before the new one: say the German for a shoulder, then the German for a knee.

You'll want to know: das Gesicht

das Gesicht — "the face".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gesicht ← Middle High German *gesiht*, "sight": *ge-* on the stem of *sehen*, "to see", which EtymDB 2.1 traces to Proto-Germanic **sehwanǫ*. The face is what is seen; English *sight* comes from the same verb.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Gesicht*
- *Say it: das Gesicht*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Gesicht*
- *Recall:* say the German for a shoulder, then the German for a knee, then say *das Gesicht* again

Before you move on

What does das Gesicht mean? ("The face".) Say it once more.

57.2 das Blut — blood

Before the new one: say the German for a knee, then the German for the face.

You'll want to know: das Blut

das Blut — "blood".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Blut ← Old High German *bluot* ← Proto-Germanic **blōþą* — inherited, the same word as English *blood*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Blut*
- *Say it: das Blut*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Blut*
- *Recall:* say the German for a knee, then the German for the face, then say *das Blut* again

Before you move on

What does das Blut mean? (“Blood”.) Say it once more.

57.3 die Haut — skin

Before the new one: say the German for the face, then the German for blood.

You’ll want to know: die Haut

die Haut — “skin”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Haut ← Old High German *hūt* ← Proto-Germanic **hūdiz*, “hide” — inherited, the same word as English *hide*, an animal’s skin. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Haut*
- *Say it: die Haut*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Haut*
- *Recall:* say the German for the face, then the German for blood, then say *die Haut* again

Before you move on

What does die Haut mean? (“Skin”.) Say it once more.

57.4 das Haar — a hair; hair

Before the new one: say the German for blood, then the German for skin.

You'll want to know: das Haar

das Haar — "a hair; hair".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Haar ← Old High German *hār* ← Proto-Germanic **hērą* — inherited, the same word as English *hair*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Haar*
- *Say it: das Haar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Haar*
- *Recall:* say the German for blood, then the German for skin, then say *das Haar* again

Before you move on

What does das Haar mean? ("A hair; hair".) Say it once more.

57.5 der Bauch — the belly

Before the new one: say the German for skin, then the German for a hair; hair.

You'll want to know: der Bauch

der Bauch — "the belly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bauch ← Old High German *būh* ← Proto-Germanic **būkaz*, "belly" — inherited. Old English *būc*, "belly", is the same word. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Bauch*
- *Say it: der Bauch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Bauch*
- *Recall:* say the German for skin, then the German for a hair; hair, then say *der Bauch* again

Before you move on

What does der Bauch mean? ("The belly".) Say it once more.

Chapter 58

Back, Tongue, Lip, Toe, Stomach

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say the back, the tongue, a lip, a toe and the stomach.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 58: I can say the back, the tongue, a lip, a toe and the stomach.*

58.1 der Rücken — the back (of the body)

Before the new one: say the German for a hair; hair, then the German for the belly.

You'll want to know: der Rücken

der Rücken — "the back (of the body)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Rücken is inherited, from Old High German *rucki*, "back". EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *ridge*, Dutch *rug* and Swedish *rygg*; Old English *hrycg* still meant "back".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Rücken*
- *Say it: der Rücken*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Rücken*
- *Recall:* say the German for a hair; hair, then the German for the belly, then say *der Rücken* again

Before you move on

What does der Rücken mean? ("The back (of the body)".) Say it once more.

58.2 die Zunge — the tongue

Before the new one: say the German for the belly, then the German for the back.

You'll want to know: die Zunge

die Zunge — "the tongue".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Zunge ← Old High German *zunga* ← Proto-Germanic **tungōn* — inherited, the same word as English *tongue*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Zunge*
- *Say it: die Zunge*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Zunge*
- *Recall:* say the German for the belly, then the German for the back, then say *die Zunge* again

Before you move on

What does die Zunge mean? (“The tongue”.) Say it once more.

58.3 die Lippe — a lip

Before the new one: say the German for the back, then the German for the tongue.

You’ll want to know: die Lippe

die Lippe — “a lip”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Lippe is the Germanic word for “lip”, Proto-Germanic **lipjô*. EtymDB 2.1 traces English *lip* to **lipjô* and lists *Lippe* beside it. Standard German borrowed this form from Low German.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Lippe*
- *Say it: die Lippe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Lippe*
- *Recall:* say the German for the back, then the German for the tongue, then say *die Lippe* again

Before you move on

What does die Lippe mean? (“A lip”.) Say it once more.

58.4 die Zehe — a toe

Before the new one: say the German for the tongue, then the German for a lip.

You'll want to know: die Zehe

die Zehe — "a toe".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Zehe ← Old High German *zēha* ← Proto-Germanic **taihwōn*, "toe" — inherited, the same word as English *toe*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Zehe*
- *Say it: die Zehe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Zehe*
- *Recall:* say the German for the tongue, then the German for a lip, then say *die Zehe* again

Before you move on

What does die Zehe mean? ("A toe".) Say it once more.

58.5 der Magen — the stomach

Before the new one: say the German for a lip, then the German for a toe.

You'll want to know: der Magen

der Magen — "the stomach".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Magen ← Old High German *mago* ← Proto-Germanic **magô*, "stomach" — inherited, the same word as English *maw*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Magen*
- *Say it: der Magen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Magen*
- *Recall:* say the German for a lip, then the German for a toe, then say *der Magen* again

Before you move on

What does der Magen mean? ("The stomach".) Say it once more.

Chapter 59

Fever, Doctor, Doctor, Hospital, Ill

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a fever, a doctor, a doctor, a hospital and ill, sick.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 59: I can say a fever, a doctor, a doctor, a hospital and ill, sick.*

59.1 das Fieber — a fever

Before the new one: say the German for a toe, then the German for the stomach.

You'll want to know: das Fieber

das Fieber — "a fever".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Fieber ← Old High German *fiebar* ← Latin *febris*, "fever" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed from Latin, as English *fever* was.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Fieber*
- *Say it: das Fieber*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Fieber*
- *Recall:* say the German for a toe, then the German for the stomach, then say *das Fieber* again

Before you move on

What does das Fieber mean? ("A fever".) Say it once more.

59.2 der Arzt — a doctor (a man)

Before the new one: say the German for the stomach, then the German for a fever.

You'll want to know: der Arzt

der Arzt — "a doctor (a man)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Arzt ← Old High German *arzat* ← Late Latin *archiāter* ← Greek *arkhiātros*, "chief physician" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, the title of a court doctor worn down to the everyday word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Arzt*
- *Say it: der Arzt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Arzt*
- *Recall:* say the German for the stomach, then the German for a fever, then say *der Arzt* again

Before you move on

What does der Arzt mean? (“A doctor (a man)”.) Say it once more.

59.3 die Ärztin — a doctor (a woman)

Before the new one: say the German for a fever, then the German for a doctor.

You’ll want to know: die Ärztin

die Ärztin — “a doctor (a woman)”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ärztin is *Arzt* + *-in*, the ending that names a woman. *Arzt* ← Late Latin *archiāter*, “chief physician” — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Ärztin*
- *Say it: die Ärztin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Ärztin*
- *Recall:* say the German for a fever, then the German for a doctor, then say *die Ärztin* again

Before you move on

What does die Ärztin mean? (“A doctor (a woman)”.) Say it once more.

59.4 das Krankenhaus — a hospital

Before the new one: say the German for a doctor, then the German for a doctor.

You'll want to know: das Krankenhaus

das Krankenhaus — "a hospital".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Krankenhaus is built from the word for "ill" and the word for "house": a house of the sick. The "ill" word ← Old High German *krank* ← Proto-Germanic **krangaz*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Krankenhaus*
- *Say it: das Krankenhaus*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Krankenhaus*
- *Recall:* say the German for a doctor, then the German for a doctor, then say *das Krankenhaus* again

Before you move on

What does das Krankenhaus mean? ("A hospital".) Say it once more.

59.5 krank — ill, sick

Before the new one: say the German for a doctor, then the German for a hospital.

You'll want to know: krank

krank — "ill, sick".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

krank ← Old High German *krank* ← Proto-Germanic **krangaz* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) Its older sense was "weak"; "ill" took over in

Middle High German.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: krank*
- *Say it: krank*, once more
- *Say it:* say *krank*
- *Recall:* say the German for a doctor, then the German for a hospital, then say *krank* again

Before you move on

What does krank mean? ("Ill, sick".) Say it once more.

Chapter 60

Healthy, Thirst, Hunger, Sad, Happy

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say healthy, thirst, hunger, sad and happy.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 60: I can say healthy, thirst, hunger, sad and happy.

60.1 gesund — healthy

Before the new one: say the German for a hospital, then the German for ill.

You'll want to know: gesund

gesund — "healthy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gesund ← Old High German *gisunt* ← Proto-Germanic **gasundaz*, "sound, whole, healthy" — inherited, a cousin of English *sound*, as in "safe and sound". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gesund*
- *Say it: gesund*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gesund*
- *Recall:* say the German for a hospital, then the German for ill, then say *gesund* again

Before you move on

What does gesund mean? ("Healthy".) Say it once more.

60.2 der Durst — thirst

Before the new one: say the German for ill, then the German for healthy.

You'll want to know: der Durst

der Durst — "thirst".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Durst ← Old High German *durst* ← Proto-Germanic **þurstuz*, "dryness, thirst" — inherited, the same word as English *thirst*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Durst*
- *Say it: der Durst*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Durst*
- *Recall:* say the German for ill, then the German for healthy, then say *der Durst* again

Before you move on

What does der Durst mean? (“Thirst”.) Say it once more.

60.3 der Hunger — hunger

Before the new one: say the German for healthy, then the German for thirst.

You’ll want to know: der Hunger

der Hunger — “hunger”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Hunger ← Old High German *hungar* ← Proto-Germanic **hungruz* — inherited, the same word as English *hunger*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Hunger*
- *Say it: der Hunger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Hunger*
- *Recall:* say the German for healthy, then the German for thirst, then say *der Hunger* again

Before you move on

What does der Hunger mean? (“Hunger”.) Say it once more.

60.4 traurig — sad

Before the new one: say the German for thirst, then the German for hunger.

You'll want to know: traurig

traurig — "sad".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

traurig ← Middle High German *trūrec* ← Old High German *trūrag* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited. A link to English *dreary* is often suggested, but it is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: traurig*
- *Say it: traurig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *traurig*
- *Recall:* say the German for thirst, then the German for hunger, then say *traurig* again

Before you move on

What does traurig mean? ("Sad".) Say it once more.

60.5 glücklich — happy

Before the new one: say the German for hunger, then the German for sad.

You'll want to know: glücklich

glücklich — "happy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

glücklich is the word for "luck", Middle High German *gelücke* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-lich*. English *luck* is the same word, taken from Low German or Dutch; where *gelücke* itself came from is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: glücklich*
- *Say it: glücklich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *glücklich*
- *Recall:* say the German for hunger, then the German for sad, then say *glücklich* again

Before you move on

What does glücklich mean? ("Happy".) Say it once more.

Chapter 61

Fear, Joy, Son, Daughter, Grandfather

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say fear, joy, a son, a daughter and a grandfather.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 61: I can say fear, joy, a son, a daughter and a grandfather.

61.1 die Angst — fear

Before the new one: say the German for sad, then the German for happy.

You'll want to know: die Angst

die Angst — "fear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Angst ← Old High German *angust* ← Proto-Germanic **angustiz*, from **anguz*, "narrow" — inherited: fear as a tightness in the chest. (EtymDB 2.1) English later borrowed *angst* from German.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Angst*
- *Say it: die Angst*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Angst*
- *Recall:* say the German for sad, then the German for happy, then say *die Angst* again

Before you move on

What does die Angst mean? ("Fear".) Say it once more.

61.2 die Freude — joy

Before the new one: say the German for happy, then the German for fear.

You'll want to know: die Freude

die Freude — "joy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Freude ← Old High German *frouwida* (EtymDB 2.1), a noun built on the old adjective for "glad", Old High German *frō* — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Freude*
- *Say it: die Freude*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Freude*
- *Recall:* say the German for happy, then the German for fear, then say *die Freude* again

Before you move on

What does die Freude mean? (“Joy”.) Say it once more.

61.3 der Sohn — a son

Before the new one: say the German for fear, then the German for joy.

You’ll want to know: der Sohn

der Sohn — “a son”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Sohn ← Old High German *sunu* ← Proto-Germanic **sunuz* — inherited, the same word as English *son*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Sohn*
- *Say it: der Sohn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Sohn*
- *Recall:* say the German for fear, then the German for joy, then say *der Sohn* again

Before you move on

What does der Sohn mean? (“A son”.) Say it once more.

61.4 die Tochter — a daughter

Before the new one: say the German for joy, then the German for a son.

You'll want to know: die Tochter

die Tochter — "a daughter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Tochter ← Old High German *tohter* ← Proto-Germanic **duhtēr* — inherited, the same word as English *daughter*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Tochter*
- *Say it: die Tochter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Tochter*
- *Recall:* say the German for joy, then the German for a son, then say *die Tochter* again

Before you move on

What does die Tochter mean? ("A daughter".) Say it once more.

61.5 der Großvater — a grandfather

Before the new one: say the German for a son, then the German for a daughter.

You'll want to know: der Großvater

der Großvater — "a grandfather".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Großvater is the word for "great, big" + *Vater*: a "great father", modelled on French *grand-père*. The "great" word ← Old High German *grōz* ← Proto-Germanic **grautaz*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Großvater*
- *Say it: der Großvater*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Großvater*
- *Recall:* say the German for a son, then the German for a daughter, then say *der Großvater* again

Before you move on

What does der Großvater mean? ("A grandfather".) Say it once more.

Chapter 62

Grandmother, Woman, Girl, Uncle, Aunt

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a grandmother, a woman, a girl, an uncle and an aunt.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 62: I can say a grandmother, a woman, a girl, an uncle and an aunt.

62.1 die Großmutter — a grandmother

Before the new one: say the German for a daughter, then the German for a grandfather.

You'll want to know: die Großmutter

die Großmutter — "a grandmother".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Großmutter is the word for "great, big" + *Mutter*: a "great mother", modelled on French *grand-mère*. The "great" word ← Old High German *grōz* ← Proto-Germanic **grautaz*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Großmutter*
- *Say it: die Großmutter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Großmutter*
- *Recall:* say the German for a daughter, then the German for a grandfather, then say *die Großmutter* again

Before you move on

What does die Großmutter mean? ("A grandmother".) Say it once more.

62.2 die Frau — a woman; a wife

Before the new one: say the German for a grandfather, then the German for a grandmother.

You'll want to know: die Frau

die Frau — "a woman; a wife".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Frau ← Old High German *frouwa*, "lady, mistress" ← Proto-Germanic **frawjōn* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The Norse goddess name *Freyja* is the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Frau*
- *Say it: die Frau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Frau*

- *Recall:* say the German for a grandfather, then the German for a grandmother, then say *die Frau* again

Before you move on

What does die Frau mean? ("A woman; a wife".) Say it once more.

62.3 das Mädchen — a girl

Before the new one: say the German for a grandmother, then the German for a woman; a wife.

You'll want to know: das Mädchen

das Mädchen — "a girl".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mädchen is a worn-down older form, *Mägdchen*, "little maid": the word for "maid" ← Old High German *magad* ← Proto-Germanic **magaþs* (EtymDB 2.1), + the diminutive *-chen*. English *maid* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Mädchen*
- *Say it: das Mädchen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Mädchen*
- *Recall:* say the German for a grandmother, then the German for a woman; a wife, then say *das Mädchen* again

Before you move on

What does das Mädchen mean? ("A girl".) Say it once more.

62.4 der Onkel — an uncle

Before the new one: say the German for a woman; a wife, then the German for a girl.

You'll want to know: der Onkel

der Onkel — "an uncle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Onkel ← French *oncle* ← Latin *avunculus*, "mother's brother" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, as English *uncle* was.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Onkel*
- *Say it: der Onkel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Onkel*
- *Recall:* say the German for a woman; a wife, then the German for a girl, then say *der Onkel* again

Before you move on

What does der Onkel mean? ("An uncle".) Say it once more.

62.5 die Tante — an aunt

Before the new one: say the German for a girl, then the German for an uncle.

You'll want to know: die Tante

die Tante — "an aunt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Tante ← French *tante* ← Old French *ante* ← Latin *amita*, "father's sister" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed. English *aunt* comes from the same Old French word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Tante*
- *Say it: die Tante*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Tante*
- *Recall:* say the German for a girl, then the German for an uncle, then say *die Tante* again

Before you move on

What does die Tante mean? ("An aunt".) Say it once more.

Chapter 63

Neighbour, Guest, Grandson, Pupil, Pupil

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a neighbour, a guest, a grandson, a pupil and a pupil.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 63: I can say a neighbour, a guest, a grandson, a pupil and a pupil.

63.1 der Nachbar — a neighbour

Before the new one: say the German for an uncle, then the German for an aunt.

You'll want to know: der Nachbar

der Nachbar — "a neighbour".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Nachbar ← Middle High German *nāchbūre* (EtymDB 2.1), "the one who dwells near": the word for "near" + an old word for "dweller". English *neighbour* is built the same way.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Nachbar*
- *Say it: der Nachbar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Nachbar*
- *Recall:* say the German for an uncle, then the German for an aunt, then say *der Nachbar* again

Before you move on

What does der Nachbar mean? ("A neighbour".) Say it once more.

63.2 der Gast — a guest

Before the new one: say the German for an aunt, then the German for a neighbour.

You'll want to know: der Gast

der Gast — "a guest".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gast ← Old High German *gast* ← Proto-Germanic **gastiz*, "guest, stranger" — inherited, the same word as English *guest*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Gast*
- *Say it: der Gast*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Gast*
- *Recall:* say the German for an aunt, then the German for a neighbour, then say *der Gast* again

Before you move on

What does der Gast mean? (“A guest”.) Say it once more.

63.3 der Enkel — a grandson

Before the new one: say the German for a neighbour, then the German for a guest.

You’ll want to know: der Enkel

der Enkel — “a grandson”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Enkel ← Middle High German *enikel* ← Old High German *eniklīn*, a diminutive of *ano*, “grandfather” (EtymDB 2.1) — a grandson was once a “little grandfather”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Enkel*
- *Say it: der Enkel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Enkel*
- *Recall:* say the German for a neighbour, then the German for a guest, then say *der Enkel* again

Before you move on

What does der Enkel mean? (“A grandson”.) Say it once more.

63.4 der Schüler — a pupil (a boy)

Before the new one: say the German for a guest, then the German for a grandson.

You'll want to know: der Schüler

der Schüler — "a pupil (a boy)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schüler ← Middle High German *schuolære*, built on the word for "school", Old High German *scuola* ← Latin *schola* (EtymDB 2.1) — a borrowed stem with the German ending *-er*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Schüler*
- *Say it: der Schüler*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Schüler*
- *Recall:* say the German for a guest, then the German for a grandson, then say *der Schüler* again

Before you move on

What does der Schüler mean? ("A pupil (a boy)".) Say it once more.

63.5 die Schülerin — a pupil (a girl)

Before the new one: say the German for a grandson, then the German for a pupil.

You'll want to know: die Schülerin

die Schülerin — "a pupil (a girl)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schülerin is *Schüler* + *-in*, the ending that names a woman or girl (EtymDB 2.1). The stem goes back to Latin *schola*, "school".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Schülerin*
- *Say it: die Schülerin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Schülerin*
- *Recall:* say the German for a grandson, then the German for a pupil, then say *die Schülerin* again

Before you move on

What does die Schülerin mean? ("A pupil (a girl)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 64

To buy, To play, To know, To find, To look for

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to buy, to play, to know, to find and to look for.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 64: I can say to buy, to play, to know, to find and to look for.

64.1 kaufen — to buy

Before the new one: say the German for a pupil, then the German for a pupil.

You'll want to know: kaufen

kaufen — "to buy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

kaufen ← Old High German *koufōn* ← Proto-Germanic **kaupōną*, from **kaupô*, "merchant" ← Latin *caupō*, "tradesman, innkeeper" (EtymDB 2.1) — an early loan. English *cheap* comes from the same Latin word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaufen*
- *Say it: kaufen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaufen*
- *Recall:* say the German for a pupil, then the German for a pupil, then say *kaufen* again

Before you move on

What does kaufen mean? ("To buy".) Say it once more.

64.2 spielen — to play

Before the new one: say the German for a pupil, then the German for to buy.

You'll want to know: spielen

spielen — "to play".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

spielen ← Proto-Germanic **spilōną*, "to revel, to play" — inherited, beside Old High German *spil*, "game, dance". (EtymDB 2.1) Dutch *spelen* is the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: spielen*
- *Say it: spielen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *spielen*
- *Recall:* say the German for a pupil, then the German for to buy, then say *spielen* again

Before you move on

What does spielen mean? ("To play".) Say it once more.

64.3 wissen — to know (a fact)

Before the new one: say the German for to buy, then the German for to play.

You'll want to know: wissen

wissen — "to know (a fact)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wissen ← Old High German *wizzan* ← Proto-Germanic **witanǫ*, "to know" — inherited, with German *ss* where English kept *t*. (EtymDB 2.1) English *wit* and *wise* share the root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: wissen*
- *Say it: wissen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *wissen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to buy, then the German for to play, then say *wissen* again

Before you move on

What does wissen mean? ("To know (a fact)".) Say it once more.

64.4 finden — to find

Before the new one: say the German for to play, then the German for to know.

You'll want to know: finden

finden — "to find".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

finden ← Old High German *findan* ← Proto-Germanic **finþanǫ*, "to come upon" — inherited, the same verb as English *find*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: finden*
- *Say it: finden*, once more
- *Say it:* say *finden*
- *Recall:* say the German for to play, then the German for to know, then say *finden* again

Before you move on

What does finden mean? ("To find".) Say it once more.

64.5 suchen — to look for

Before the new one: say the German for to know, then the German for to find.

You'll want to know: suchen

suchen — "to look for".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

suchen ← Old High German *suohhen* ← Proto-Germanic **sōkijanǫ*, "to seek" — inherited, the same verb as English *seek*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: suchen*
- *Say it: suchen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *suchen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to know, then the German for to find, then say *suchen* again

Before you move on

What does suchen mean? ("To look for".) Say it once more.

Chapter 65

To wait, To pay, To cook, To laugh, To cry

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to wait, to pay, to cook, to laugh and to cry.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 65: I can say to wait, to pay, to cook, to laugh and to cry.*

65.1 warten — to wait

> Before the new one: say the German for to find, then the German for to look for.

You'll want to know: warten

warten — "to wait".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

warten ← Old High German *wartēn*, "to watch, to look after" ← Proto-Germanic **wardānǫ*, "to guard" — inherited, a cousin of English *ward*. (EtymDB 2.1) Waiting began as keeping watch.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: warten*
- *Say it: warten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *warten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to find, then the German for to look for, then say *warten* again

Before you move on

What does warten mean? ("To wait".) Say it once more.

65.2 bezahlen — to pay

Before the new one: say the German for to look for, then the German for to wait.

You'll want to know: bezahlen

bezahlen — "to pay".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bezahlen is *be-* + the verb "to pay", which is built on the word for "number", Old High German *zala* ← Proto-Germanic **talō* (EtymDB 2.1). English *tale* and *tell* share the root: paying was counting out.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bezahlen*
- *Say it: bezahlen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bezahlen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to look for, then the German for to wait, then say *bezahlen* again

Before you move on

What does bezahlen mean? ("To pay".) Say it once more.

65.3 kochen — to cook

Before the new one: say the German for to wait, then the German for to pay.

You'll want to know: kochen

kochen — "to cook".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

kochen ← Old High German *kohhōn* ← Latin *coquere*, "to cook" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed from Roman kitchens, as English *cook* was.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kochen*
- *Say it: kochen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kochen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to wait, then the German for to pay, then say *kochen* again

Before you move on

What does kochen mean? ("To cook".) Say it once more.

65.4 lachen — to laugh

Before the new one: say the German for to pay, then the German for to cook.

You'll want to know: lachen

lachen — "to laugh".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lachen ← Old High German *lahhan* ← Proto-Germanic **hlahjanǫ* — inherited, the same verb as English *laugh*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lachen*
- *Say it: lachen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lachen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to pay, then the German for to cook, then say *lachen* again

Before you move on

What does lachen mean? ("To laugh".) Say it once more.

65.5 weinen — to cry

Before the new one: say the German for to cook, then the German for to laugh.

You'll want to know: weinen

weinen — "to cry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

weinen ← Old High German *weinōn* ← Proto-Germanic **wainōną*, built on the cry *wai*, "woe" — inherited, and unrelated to *Wein*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *weinen*
- *Say it:* *weinen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *weinen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to cook, then the German for to laugh, then say *weinen* again

Before you move on

What does weinen mean? ("To cry".) Say it once more.

Chapter 66

To sing, To travel, To show, To bring, To forget

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to sing, to travel, to show, to bring and to forget.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 66: I can say to sing, to travel, to show, to bring and to forget.*

66.1 singen — to sing

> Before the new one: say the German for to laugh, then the German for to cry.

You'll want to know: singen

singen — "to sing".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

singen ← Old High German *singan* ← Proto-Germanic **singwanǫ* — inherited, the same verb as English *sing*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: singen*
- *Say it: singen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *singen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to laugh, then the German for to cry, then say *singen* again

Before you move on

What does singen mean? ("To sing".) Say it once more.

66.2 reisen — to travel

Before the new one: say the German for to cry, then the German for to sing.

You'll want to know: reisen

reisen — "to travel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

reisen ← Old High German *reisōn*, "to set out on a journey" ← Proto-Germanic **raisōną* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) It is related to English *rise*: a journey began by getting up and going.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: reisen*
- *Say it: reisen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *reisen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to cry, then the German for to sing, then say *reisen* again

Before you move on

What does reisen mean? (“To travel”.) Say it once more.

66.3 zeigen — to show

Before the new one: say the German for to sing, then the German for to travel.

You’ll want to know: zeigen

zeigen — “to show”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

zeigen ← Middle High German *zeigen* ← Old High German *zeigōn* — inherited. EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *teach*: both grew from an old root meaning “to point out”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zeigen*
- *Say it: zeigen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zeigen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to sing, then the German for to travel, then say *zeigen* again

Before you move on

What does zeigen mean? (“To show”.) Say it once more.

66.4 bringen — to bring

Before the new one: say the German for to travel, then the German for to show.

You'll want to know: bringen

bringen — "to bring".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bringen ← Old High German *bringan* ← Proto-Germanic **bringanǫ* — inherited, the same verb as English *bring*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bringen*
- *Say it: bringen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bringen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to travel, then the German for to show, then say *bringen* again

Before you move on

What does bringen mean? ("To bring".) Say it once more.

66.5 vergessen — to forget

Before the new one: say the German for to show, then the German for to bring.

You'll want to know: vergessen

vergessen — "to forget".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vergessen ← Old High German *firgezzan* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, and built like English *forget*: *ver-*, "away", + an old verb meaning "to get".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vergessen*
- *Say it:* *vergessen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vergessen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to show, then the German for to bring, then say *vergessen* again

Before you move on

What does vergessen mean? ("To forget".) Say it once more.

Chapter 67

To lose, To believe, To need, To live, To call

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to lose, to believe, to need, to live and to call.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 67: I can say to lose, to believe, to need, to live and to call.*

67.1 verlieren — to lose

Before the new one: say the German for to bring, then the German for to forget.

You'll want to know: verlieren

verlieren — "to lose".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

verlieren ← Old High German *firliosan* ← Proto-Germanic **fraleusanǫ*, "to lose" — inherited. English *forlorn*, "lost", is built on the same verb. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: verlieren*
- *Say it: verlieren*, once more
- *Say it:* say *verlieren*
- *Recall:* say the German for to bring, then the German for to forget, then say *verlieren* again

Before you move on

What does verlieren mean? ("To lose".) Say it once more.

67.2 glauben — to believe

Before the new one: say the German for to forget, then the German for to lose.

You'll want to know: glauben

glauben — "to believe".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

glauben ← Old High German *gilouben* ← Proto-Germanic **galaubijanˀ*, "to hold dear, to believe" — inherited, a cousin of English *believe*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: glauben*
- *Say it: glauben*, once more
- *Say it:* say *glauben*
- *Recall:* say the German for to forget, then the German for to lose, then say *glauben* again

Before you move on

What does glauben mean? (“To believe”.) Say it once more.

67.3 brauchen — to need

Before the new one: say the German for to lose, then the German for to believe.

You’ll want to know: brauchen

brauchen — “to need”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

brauchen ← Old High German *brūhhan* ← Proto-Germanic **brūkanǫ*, “to use, to enjoy” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) English *brook*, “to put up with”, is the same verb.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: brauchen*
- *Say it: brauchen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *brauchen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to lose, then the German for to believe, then say *brauchen* again

Before you move on

What does brauchen mean? (“To need”.) Say it once more.

67.4 leben — to live

Before the new one: say the German for to believe, then the German for to need.

You'll want to know: leben

leben — "to live".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

leben ← Old High German *lebēn* ← Proto-Germanic **libjanǫ*, "to live" — inherited, the same verb as English *live*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: leben*
- *Say it: leben*, once more
- *Say it:* say *leben*
- *Recall:* say the German for to believe, then the German for to need, then say *leben* again

Before you move on

What does leben mean? ("To live".) Say it once more.

67.5 rufen — to call

Before the new one: say the German for to need, then the German for to live.

You'll want to know: rufen

rufen — "to call".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rufen ← Old High German *ruofan* ← Proto-Germanic **hrōpanǫ* — inherited; Dutch *roepen*, "to call out", is the same verb. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rufen*
- *Say it: rufen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rufen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to need, then the German for to live, then say *rufen* again

Before you move on

What does rufen mean? ("To call".) Say it once more.

Chapter 68

To carry, To send, To count, To paint, To clean

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to carry, to send, to count, to paint and to clean.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 68: I can say to carry, to send, to count, to paint and to clean.

68.1 tragen — to carry; to wear

Before the new one: say the German for to live, then the German for to call.

You'll want to know: tragen

tragen — "to carry; to wear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tragen ← Old High German *tragan* ← Proto-Germanic **draganą*, "to draw, to drag" — inherited, a cousin of English *draw* and *drag*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tragen*
- *Say it: tragen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tragen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to live, then the German for to call, then say *tragen* again

Before you move on

What does tragen mean? ("To carry; to wear".) Say it once more.

68.2 schicken — to send

Before the new one: say the German for to call, then the German for to carry; to wear.

You'll want to know: schicken

schicken — "to send".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schicken ← Middle High German *schicken*, "to arrange, to put in order" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited; "to send" grew out of arranging for something to go.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schicken*
- *Say it: schicken*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schicken*
- *Recall:* say the German for to call, then the German for to carry; to wear, then say *schicken* again

Before you move on

What does schicken mean? (“To send”.) Say it once more.

68.3 zählen — to count

Before the new one: say the German for to carry; to wear, then the German for to send.

You’ll want to know: zählen

zählen — “to count”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

zählen ← Old High German *zellen* ← Proto-Germanic **taljanǫ* — inherited, the same verb as English *tell* in its old sense “to count”, as in a bank *teller*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zählen*
- *Say it: zählen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zählen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to carry; to wear, then the German for to send, then say *zählen* again

Before you move on

What does zählen mean? (“To count”.) Say it once more.

68.4 malen — to paint

Before the new one: say the German for to send, then the German for to count.

You'll want to know: malen

malen — "to paint".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

malen ← Old High German *mālōn*, "to paint, to draw" — inherited, built on the old word for "a mark, a spot", Old High German *māl* ← Proto-Germanic **mēlą*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: malen*
- *Say it: malen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *malen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to send, then the German for to count, then say *malen* again

Before you move on

What does malen mean? ("To paint".) Say it once more.

68.5 putzen — to clean

Before the new one: say the German for to count, then the German for to paint.

You'll want to know: putzen

putzen — "to clean".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

putzen is inherited: it is the verb of Middle High German *butze*, "lump, piece" (EtymDB 2.1), so cleaning was first picking the lumps off.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: putzen*
- *Say it: putzen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *putzen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to count, then the German for to paint, then say *putzen* again

Before you move on

What does putzen mean? ("To clean".) Say it once more.

Chapter 69

Fish, Meat, Chicken, Fruit, Apple

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a fish, meat, a chicken, fruit and an apple.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 69: I can say a fish, meat, a chicken, fruit and an apple.*

69.1 der Fisch — a fish

Before the new one: say the German for to paint, then the German for to clean.

You'll want to know: der Fisch

der Fisch — "a fish".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Fisch ← Old High German *fisk* ← Proto-Germanic **fiskaz* — inherited, the same word as English *fish*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Fisch*
- *Say it: der Fisch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Fisch*
- *Recall:* say the German for to paint, then the German for to clean, then say *der Fisch* again

Before you move on

What does der Fisch mean? ("A fish".) Say it once more.

69.2 das Fleisch — meat

Before the new one: say the German for to clean, then the German for a fish.

You'll want to know: das Fleisch

das Fleisch — "meat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Fleisch ← Old High German *fleisk* ← Proto-Germanic **flaiską* — inherited, the same word as English *flesh*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Fleisch*
- *Say it: das Fleisch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Fleisch*
- *Recall:* say the German for to clean, then the German for a fish, then say *das Fleisch* again

Before you move on

What does das Fleisch mean? (“Meat”.) Say it once more.

69.3 das Huhn — a chicken

Before the new one: say the German for a fish, then the German for meat.

You’ll want to know: das Huhn

das Huhn — “a chicken”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Huhn ← Old High German *huon* ← Proto-Germanic **hōnąz*, “hen, chicken” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) It shares its root with English *hen*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Huhn*
- *Say it: das Huhn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Huhn*
- *Recall:* say the German for a fish, then the German for meat, then say *das Huhn* again

Before you move on

What does das Huhn mean? (“A chicken”.) Say it once more.

69.4 das Obst — fruit

Before the new one: say the German for meat, then the German for a chicken.

You'll want to know: das Obst

das Obst — "fruit".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Obst ← Old High German *obaz*, "fruit" ← Proto-Germanic **ubatjǫ*, "produce" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The final *t* was added in later German.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Obst*
- *Say it: das Obst*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Obst*
- *Recall:* say the German for meat, then the German for a chicken, then say *das Obst* again

Before you move on

What does das Obst mean? ("Fruit".) Say it once more.

69.5 der Apfel — an apple

Before the new one: say the German for a chicken, then the German for fruit.

You'll want to know: der Apfel

der Apfel — "an apple".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Apfel ← Old High German *apful* ← Proto-Germanic **aplaz* — inherited, the same word as English *apple*, with German *pf* where English kept *p*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Apfel*
- *Say it: der Apfel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Apfel*
- *Recall:* say the German for a chicken, then the German for fruit, then say *der Apfel* again

Before you move on

What does der Apfel mean? ("An apple".) Say it once more.

Chapter 70

Banana, Potato, Tomato, Onion, Carrot

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a banana, a potato, a tomato, an onion and a carrot.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 70: I can say a banana, a potato, a tomato, an onion and a carrot.*

70.1 die Banane — a banana

> Before the new one: say the German for fruit, then the German for an apple.

You'll want to know: die Banane

die Banane — "a banana".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Banane ← Portuguese or Spanish *banana*, from a West African language — borrowed. EtymDB 2.1 traces English *banana* to Wolof *banaana*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Banane*
- *Say it: die Banane*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Banane*
- *Recall:* say the German for fruit, then the German for an apple, then say *die Banane* again

Before you move on

What does die Banane mean? ("A banana".) Say it once more.

70.2 die Kartoffel — a potato

Before the new one: say the German for an apple, then the German for a banana.

You'll want to know: die Kartoffel

die Kartoffel — "a potato".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kartoffel ← older German *Tartuffel* ← Italian *tartufolo*, "truffle" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: the potato, another lump dug from the earth, was named after the truffle.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Kartoffel*
- *Say it: die Kartoffel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Kartoffel*
- *Recall:* say the German for an apple, then the German for a banana, then say *die Kartoffel* again

Before you move on

What does die Kartoffel mean? ("A potato".) Say it once more.

70.3 die Tomate — a tomato

Before the new one: say the German for a banana, then the German for a potato.

You'll want to know: die Tomate

die Tomate — "a tomato".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Tomate ← Spanish *tomate* ← Nahuatl *tomatl* — borrowed; EtymDB 2.1 traces English *tomato* the same way.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Tomate*
- *Say it: die Tomate*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Tomate*
- *Recall:* say the German for a banana, then the German for a potato, then say *die Tomate* again

Before you move on

What does die Tomate mean? ("A tomato".) Say it once more.

70.4 die Zwiebel — an onion

Before the new one: say the German for a potato, then the German for a tomato.

You'll want to know: die Zwiebel

die Zwiebel — "an onion".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Zwiebel ← Old High German *zwibollo* ← Late Latin *cēpulla*, "little onion", from *cēpa*, "onion" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, its front reshaped to sound German.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Zwiebel*
- *Say it: die Zwiebel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Zwiebel*
- *Recall:* say the German for a potato, then the German for a tomato, then say *die Zwiebel* again

Before you move on

What does die Zwiebel mean? ("An onion".) Say it once more.

70.5 die Möhre — a carrot

Before the new one: say the German for a tomato, then the German for an onion.

You'll want to know: die Möhre

die Möhre — "a carrot".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Möhre ← Old High German *morha* ← Proto-Germanic **murhōn*, "carrot" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Möhre*
- *Say it: die Möhre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Möhre*
- *Recall:* say the German for a tomato, then the German for an onion, then say *die Möhre* again

Before you move on

What does die Möhre mean? ("A carrot".) Say it once more.

Chapter 71

Cake, Soup, Honey, Oil, Lunch

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a cake, a soup, honey, oil and lunch.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 71: I can say a cake, a soup, honey, oil and lunch.*

71.1 der Kuchen — a cake

Before the new one: say the German for an onion, then the German for a carrot.

You'll want to know: der Kuchen

der Kuchen — "a cake".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kuchen ← Old High German *kuohho* ← Proto-Germanic **kōkô*, "cake" — inherited; Dutch *koek* is the same word. (EtymDB 2.1) English *cake* is a cousin, through Norse.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Kuchen*
- *Say it: der Kuchen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Kuchen*
- *Recall:* say the German for an onion, then the German for a carrot, then say *der Kuchen* again

Before you move on

What does der Kuchen mean? ("A cake".) Say it once more.

71.2 die Suppe — a soup

Before the new one: say the German for a carrot, then the German for a cake.

You'll want to know: die Suppe

die Suppe — "a soup".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Suppe came in from French *soupe* and Middle Low German *suppe*, *sope*; EtymDB 2.1 traces *sope* to Proto-Germanic **supô*, "sop". So German borrowed back a Germanic word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Suppe*
- *Say it: die Suppe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Suppe*
- *Recall:* say the German for a carrot, then the German for a cake, then say *die Suppe* again

Before you move on

What does die Suppe mean? (“A soup”.) Say it once more.

71.3 der Honig — honey

Before the new one: say the German for a cake, then the German for a soup.

You’ll want to know: der Honig

der Honig — “honey”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Honig ← Old High German *honag* — inherited. EtymDB 2.1 traces *honag* and English *honey* to Proto-Germanic **hunagą*: one word.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Honig*
- *Say it: der Honig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Honig*
- *Recall:* say the German for a cake, then the German for a soup, then say *der Honig* again

Before you move on

What does der Honig mean? (“Honey”.) Say it once more.

71.4 das Öl — oil

Before the new one: say the German for a soup, then the German for honey.

You'll want to know: das Öl

das Öl — "oil".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Öl ← Old High German *oli* ← Latin *oleum* ← Greek *élaion*, "olive oil" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed with the olive, as English *oil* was.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Öl*
- *Say it: das Öl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Öl*
- *Recall:* say the German for a soup, then the German for honey, then say *das Öl* again

Before you move on

What does das Öl mean? ("Oil".) Say it once more.

71.5 das Mittagessen — lunch

Before the new one: say the German for honey, then the German for oil.

You'll want to know: das Mittagessen

das Mittagessen — "lunch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mittagessen is *Mittag* + the word for "a meal", which is the verb "to eat" ← Old High German *ezzan* ← Proto-Germanic **etanǫ*, the same verb as English *eat*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Mittagessen*
- *Say it: das Mittagessen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Mittagessen*
- *Recall:* say the German for honey, then the German for oil, then say *das Mittagessen* again

Before you move on

What does das Mittagessen mean? ("Lunch".) Say it once more.

Chapter 72

Dinner, Breakfast, Rice, Pear, Lemon

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say dinner, breakfast, rice, a pear and a lemon.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 72: I can say dinner, breakfast, rice, a pear and a lemon.

72.1 das Abendessen — dinner

Before the new one: say the German for oil, then the German for lunch.

You'll want to know: das Abendessen

das Abendessen — "dinner".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Abendessen is *Abend* + the word for "a meal", which is the verb "to eat" ← Old High German *ezzan* ← Proto-Germanic **etanǫ*, English *eat*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Abendessen*
- *Say it: das Abendessen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Abendessen*
- *Recall:* say the German for oil, then the German for lunch, then say *das Abendessen* again

Before you move on

What does das Abendessen mean? ("Dinner".) Say it once more.

72.2 das Frühstück — breakfast

Before the new one: say the German for lunch, then the German for dinner.

You'll want to know: das Frühstück

das Frühstück — "breakfast".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Frühstück is *früh*, "early", + the word for "a piece", Old High German *stucki* (EtymDB 2.1): the early bite of bread.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Frühstück*
- *Say it: das Frühstück*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Frühstück*
- *Recall:* say the German for lunch, then the German for dinner, then say *das Frühstück* again

Before you move on

What does das Frühstück mean? (“Breakfast”.) Say it once more.

72.3 der Reis — rice

Before the new one: say the German for dinner, then the German for breakfast.

You’ll want to know: der Reis

der Reis — “rice”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Reis ← Middle High German *rīs* ← Latin *oryza* ← Greek *óryza* — borrowed, like English *rice*. (EtymDB 2.1 has the Latin and Greek step; its German *Reis* row is a different word, “twig”.)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Reis*
- *Say it: der Reis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Reis*
- *Recall:* say the German for dinner, then the German for breakfast, then say *der Reis* again

Before you move on

What does der Reis mean? (“Rice”.) Say it once more.

72.4 die Birne — a pear

Before the new one: say the German for breakfast, then the German for rice.

You'll want to know: die Birne

die Birne — "a pear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Birne ← Middle High German *bir* (EtymDB 2.1), from Latin *pira*, "pears" — borrowed, like English *pear*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Birne*
- *Say it: die Birne*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Birne*
- *Recall:* say the German for breakfast, then the German for rice, then say *die Birne* again

Before you move on

What does die Birne mean? ("A pear".) Say it once more.

72.5 die Zitrone — a lemon

Before the new one: say the German for rice, then the German for a pear.

You'll want to know: die Zitrone

die Zitrone — "a lemon".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Zitrone ← French *citron*, "lemon" ← Latin *citrus* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Zitrone*
- *Say it: die Zitrone*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Zitrone*
- *Recall:* say the German for rice, then the German for a pear, then say *die Zitrone* again

Before you move on

What does die Zitrone mean? ("A lemon".) Say it once more.

Chapter 73

Grape, Jam, Cheese, Salt, Sugar

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a grape, jam, cheese, salt and sugar.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 73: I can say a grape, jam, cheese, salt and sugar.*

73.1 die Traube — a grape

Before the new one: say the German for a pear, then the German for a lemon.

You'll want to know: die Traube

die Traube — "a grape".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Traube ← Old High German *drūbo* ← Proto-Germanic **þrūbô*, "grape" — inherited; Dutch *druif* is the same word. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Traube*
- *Say it: die Traube*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Traube*
- *Recall:* say the German for a pear, then the German for a lemon, then say *die Traube* again

Before you move on

What does die Traube mean? (“A grape”.) Say it once more.

73.2 die Marmelade — jam

Before the new one: say the German for a lemon, then the German for a grape.

You’ll want to know: die Marmelade

die Marmelade — “jam”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Marmelade ← French *marmelade* ← Portuguese *marmelada*, “quince jam”, from *marmelo*, “quince” (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Marmelade*
- *Say it: die Marmelade*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Marmelade*
- *Recall:* say the German for a lemon, then the German for a grape, then say *die Marmelade* again

Before you move on

What does die Marmelade mean? ("Jam".) Say it once more.

73.3 der Käse — cheese

Before the new one: say the German for a grape, then the German for jam.

You'll want to know: der Käse

der Käse — "cheese".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Käse ← Old High German *chāsi* ← Latin *cāseus*, "cheese" (EtymDB 2.1) — an early loan, as English *cheese* was.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Käse*
- *Say it: der Käse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Käse*
- *Recall:* say the German for a grape, then the German for jam, then say *der Käse* again

Before you move on

What does der Käse mean? ("Cheese".) Say it once more.

73.4 das Salz — salt

Before the new one: say the German for jam, then the German for cheese.

You'll want to know: das Salz

das Salz — "salt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Salz ← Old High German *salz* ← Proto-Germanic **saltą* — inherited, the same word as English *salt*, with German *z* where English kept *t*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Salz*
- *Say it: das Salz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Salz*
- *Recall:* say the German for jam, then the German for cheese, then say *das Salz* again

Before you move on

What does das Salz mean? ("Salt".) Say it once more.

73.5 der Zucker — sugar

Before the new one: say the German for cheese, then the German for salt.

You'll want to know: der Zucker

der Zucker — "sugar".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Zucker ← Italian *zucchero* ← Arabic *sukkar* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed with the trade in sugar.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Zucker*
- *Say it: der Zucker*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Zucker*
- *Recall:* say the German for cheese, then the German for salt, then say *der Zucker* again

Before you move on

What does der Zucker mean? ("Sugar".) Say it once more.

Chapter 74

Juice, Sausage, Ham, Salad, Noodles

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say juice, a sausage, ham, a salad and noodles, pasta.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 74: I can say juice, a sausage, ham, a salad and noodles, pasta.*

74.1 der Saft — juice

> Before the new one: say the German for salt, then the German for sugar.

You'll want to know: der Saft

der Saft — "juice".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Saft ← Middle High German *saf* — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *sap*, from Proto-Germanic **sapą*, "sap, juice".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Saft*
- *Say it: der Saft*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Saft*
- *Recall:* say the German for salt, then the German for sugar, then say *der Saft* again

Before you move on

What does der Saft mean? ("Juice".) Say it once more.

74.2 die Wurst — a sausage

Before the new one: say the German for sugar, then the German for juice.

You'll want to know: die Wurst

die Wurst — "a sausage".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wurst ← Old High German *wurst* — inherited. EtymDB 2.1 derives it from Proto-Germanic **wurstiz*, "something twisted", but that account is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Wurst*
- *Say it: die Wurst*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Wurst*
- *Recall:* say the German for sugar, then the German for juice, then say *die Wurst* again

Before you move on

What does die Wurst mean? (“A sausage”.) Say it once more.

74.3 der Schinken — ham

Before the new one: say the German for juice, then the German for a sausage.

You’ll want to know: der Schinken

der Schinken — “ham”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schinken ← Old High German *scinco* ← Proto-Germanic **skinkô*, “shank, thigh” — inherited; ham is the cured thigh. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Schinken*
- *Say it: der Schinken*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Schinken*
- *Recall:* say the German for juice, then the German for a sausage, then say *der Schinken* again

Before you move on

What does der Schinken mean? (“Ham”.) Say it once more.

74.4 der Salat — a salad; lettuce

Before the new one: say the German for a sausage, then the German for ham.

You'll want to know: der Salat

der Salat — "a salad; lettuce".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Salat ← Middle High German *salāt* (EtymDB 2.1), from Italian *insalata*, "salted" — borrowed: greens dressed with salt.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Salat*
- *Say it: der Salat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Salat*
- *Recall:* say the German for a sausage, then the German for ham, then say *der Salat* again

Before you move on

What does der Salat mean? ("A salad; lettuce".) Say it once more.

74.5 die Nudeln — noodles, pasta

Before the new one: say the German for ham, then the German for a salad; lettuce.

You'll want to know: die Nudeln

die Nudeln — "noodles, pasta".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Nudeln is the plural of *Nudel*. Its origin is uncertain; EtymDB 2.1 has the word but no source for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Nudeln*
- *Say it: die Nudeln*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Nudeln*
- *Recall:* say the German for ham, then the German for a salad; lettuce, then say *die Nudeln* again

Before you move on

What does die Nudeln mean? ("Noodles, pasta".) Say it once more.

Chapter 75

Cream, Pepper, Nut, Beer, To cut

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say cream, pepper, a nut, beer and to cut.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 75: I can say cream, pepper, a nut, beer and to cut.*

75.1 die Sahne — cream

> Before the new one: say the German for a salad; lettuce, then the German for noodles.

You'll want to know: die Sahne

die Sahne — "cream".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Sahne was borrowed into standard German from Low German and Dutch. Its origin is uncertain; EtymDB 2.1 has the word but no source for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Sahne*
- *Say it: die Sahne*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Sahne*
- *Recall:* say the German for a salad; lettuce, then the German for noodles, then say *die Sahne* again

Before you move on

What does die Sahne mean? ("Cream".) Say it once more.

75.2 der Pfeffer — pepper

Before the new one: say the German for noodles, then the German for cream.

You'll want to know: der Pfeffer

der Pfeffer — "pepper".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Pfeffer ← Old High German *pheffar*, from Latin *piper* ← Greek *péperi* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed so early that its *p* shifted to *pf*, as in *Apfel*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Pfeffer*
- *Say it: der Pfeffer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Pfeffer*
- *Recall:* say the German for noodles, then the German for cream, then say *der Pfeffer* again

Before you move on

What does der Pfeffer mean? (“Pepper”.) Say it once more.

75.3 die Nuss — a nut

Before the new one: say the German for cream, then the German for pepper.

You’ll want to know: die Nuss

die Nuss — “a nut”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Nuss ← Old High German *nuz* ← Proto-Germanic **hnuts* — inherited, the same word as English *nut*, with German *ss* where English kept *t*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Nuss*
- *Say it: die Nuss*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Nuss*
- *Recall:* say the German for cream, then the German for pepper, then say *die Nuss* again

Before you move on

What does die Nuss mean? (“A nut”.) Say it once more.

75.4 das Bier — beer

Before the new one: say the German for pepper, then the German for a nut.

You'll want to know: das Bier

das Bier — "beer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bier ← Old High German *bior* ← Proto-Germanic **beuzą* — inherited, the same word as English *beer*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Bier*
- *Say it: das Bier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Bier*
- *Recall:* say the German for pepper, then the German for a nut, then say *das Bier* again

Before you move on

What does das Bier mean? ("Beer".) Say it once more.

75.5 schneiden — to cut

Before the new one: say the German for a nut, then the German for beer.

You'll want to know: schneiden

schneiden — "to cut".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schneiden ← Old High German *snīdan* ← Proto-Germanic **snīþaną*, "to cut" — inherited; Dutch *snijden* is the same verb. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schneiden*
- *Say it: schneiden*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schneiden*
- *Recall:* say the German for a nut, then the German for beer, then say *schneiden* again

Before you move on

What does schneiden mean? ("To cut".) Say it once more.

Chapter 76

Window, Chair, Table, Wall, Roof

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a window, a chair, a table, a wall and a roof.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 76: I can say a window, a chair, a table, a wall and a roof.*

76.1 das Fenster — a window

Before the new one: say the German for beer, then the German for to cut.

You'll want to know: das Fenster

das Fenster — "a window".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Fenster ← Old High German *fenstar* ← Latin *fenestra*, "window" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, one of the building words German took from Roman builders.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Fenster*
- *Say it: das Fenster*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Fenster*
- *Recall:* say the German for beer, then the German for to cut, then say *das Fenster* again

Before you move on

What does das Fenster mean? (“A window”.) Say it once more.

76.2 der Stuhl — a chair

Before the new one: say the German for to cut, then the German for a window.

You’ll want to know: der Stuhl

der Stuhl — “a chair”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Stuhl ← Old High German *stuol* ← Proto-Germanic **stōlaz*, “seat” — inherited, the same word as English *stool*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Stuhl*
- *Say it: der Stuhl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Stuhl*
- *Recall:* say the German for to cut, then the German for a window, then say *der Stuhl* again

Before you move on

What does der Stuhl mean? (“A chair”.) Say it once more.

76.3 der Tisch — a table

Before the new one: say the German for a window, then the German for a chair.

You’ll want to know: der Tisch

der Tisch — “a table”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Tisch ← Old High German *tisc*, “plate” ← Latin *discus* (EtymDB 2.1) — an early loan; English *dish* and *desk* come from the same Latin word.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Tisch*
- *Say it: der Tisch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Tisch*
- *Recall:* say the German for a window, then the German for a chair, then say *der Tisch* again

Before you move on

What does der Tisch mean? (“A table”.) Say it once more.

76.4 die Wand — a wall

Before the new one: say the German for a chair, then the German for a table.

You'll want to know: die Wand

die Wand — "a wall".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wand ← Old High German *want* ← Proto-Germanic **wanduz*, "rod; a fence of woven rods" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) Early walls were woven; English *wand* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Wand*
- *Say it: die Wand*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Wand*
- *Recall:* say the German for a chair, then the German for a table, then say *die Wand* again

Before you move on

What does die Wand mean? ("A wall".) Say it once more.

76.5 das Dach — a roof

Before the new one: say the German for a table, then the German for a wall.

You'll want to know: das Dach

das Dach — "a roof".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Dach ← Old High German *dah* ← Proto-Germanic **þaką*, "thatch, roof" — inherited, the same word as English *thatch*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Dach*
- *Say it: das Dach*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Dach*
- *Recall:* say the German for a table, then the German for a wall, then say *das Dach* again

Before you move on

What does das Dach mean? ("A roof".) Say it once more.

Chapter 77

Garden, Lamp, Bath, Room, Bed

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a garden, a lamp, a bath, a room and a bed.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 77: I can say a garden, a lamp, a bath, a room and a bed.*

77.1 der Garten — a garden

Before the new one: say the German for a wall, then the German for a roof.

You'll want to know: der Garten

der Garten — "a garden".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Garten ← Old High German *garto* ← Proto-Germanic **gardô*, "enclosed yard" — inherited, the same word as English *yard*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Garten*
- *Say it: der Garten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Garten*
- *Recall:* say the German for a wall, then the German for a roof, then say *der Garten* again

Before you move on

What does der Garten mean? ("A garden".) Say it once more.

77.2 die Lampe — a lamp

Before the new one: say the German for a roof, then the German for a garden.

You'll want to know: die Lampe

die Lampe — "a lamp".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Lampe ← Middle High German *lampe*, from French *lampe* ← Latin *lampas* ← Greek *lampás*, "torch" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *lamp*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Lampe*
- *Say it: die Lampe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Lampe*
- *Recall:* say the German for a roof, then the German for a garden, then say *die Lampe* again

Before you move on

What does die Lampe mean? (“A lamp”.) Say it once more.

77.3 das Bad — a bath; a bathroom

Before the new one: say the German for a garden, then the German for a lamp.

You’ll want to know: das Bad

das Bad — “a bath; a bathroom”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bad ← Old High German *bad* ← Proto-Germanic **baþą* — inherited, the same word as English *bath*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Bad*
- *Say it: das Bad*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Bad*
- *Recall:* say the German for a garden, then the German for a lamp, then say *das Bad* again

Before you move on

What does das Bad mean? (“A bath; a bathroom”.) Say it once more.

77.4 das Zimmer — a room

Before the new one: say the German for a lamp, then the German for a bath; a bathroom.

You'll want to know: das Zimmer

das Zimmer — "a room".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Zimmer ← Old High German *zimbar*, "timber, a wooden building" ← Proto-Germanic **timrą* — inherited, the same word as English *timber*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Zimmer*
- *Say it: das Zimmer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Zimmer*
- *Recall:* say the German for a lamp, then the German for a bath; a bathroom, then say *das Zimmer* again

Before you move on

What does das Zimmer mean? ("A room".) Say it once more.

77.5 das Bett — a bed

Before the new one: say the German for a bath; a bathroom, then the German for a room.

You'll want to know: das Bett

das Bett — "a bed".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bett ← Old High German *betti* ← Proto-Germanic **badją* — inherited, the same word as English *bed*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Bett*
- *Say it: das Bett*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Bett*
- *Recall:* say the German for a bath; a bathroom, then the German for a room, then say *das Bett* again

Before you move on

What does das Bett mean? ("A bed".) Say it once more.

Chapter 78

Cupboard, Floor, Stairs, Mirror, Flat

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a cupboard, the floor, the stairs, a mirror and a flat, an apartment.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 78: I can say a cupboard, the floor, the stairs, a mirror and a flat, an apartment.*

78.1 der Schrank — a cupboard

Before the new one: say the German for a room, then the German for a bed.

You'll want to know: der Schrank

der Schrank — "a cupboard".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schrank ← Middle High German *schranc*, "a closed-off space" — inherited, and related to the word for "a barrier". Its older history is uncertain, and EtymDB 2.1 has no source for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Schrank*
- *Say it: der Schrank*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Schrank*
- *Recall:* say the German for a room, then the German for a bed, then say *der Schrank* again

Before you move on

What does der Schrank mean? ("A cupboard".) Say it once more.

78.2 der Boden — the floor; the ground

Before the new one: say the German for a bed, then the German for a cupboard.

You'll want to know: der Boden

der Boden — "the floor; the ground".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Boden ← Old High German *bodam*, "floor, bottom" ← Proto-Germanic **butmaz* — inherited, the same word as English *bottom*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Boden*
- *Say it: der Boden*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Boden*
- *Recall:* say the German for a bed, then the German for a cupboard, then say *der Boden* again

Before you move on

What does der Boden mean? (“The floor; the ground”.) Say it once more.

78.3 die Treppe — the stairs

Before the new one: say the German for a cupboard, then the German for the floor; the ground.

You’ll want to know: die Treppe

die Treppe — “the stairs”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Treppe was borrowed into standard German from Low German: Middle Low German *treppe* meant “step, stair” (EtymDB 2.1). It is related to an old verb for “to tread”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Treppe*
- *Say it: die Treppe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Treppe*
- *Recall:* say the German for a cupboard, then the German for the floor; the ground, then say *die Treppe* again

Before you move on

What does die Treppe mean? (“The stairs”.) Say it once more.

78.4 der Spiegel — a mirror

Before the new one: say the German for the floor; the ground, then the German for the stairs.

You'll want to know: der Spiegel

der Spiegel — "a mirror".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Spiegel ← Middle High German *spiegel*, from Latin *speculum*, "mirror", built on *specere*, "to look" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Spiegel*
- *Say it: der Spiegel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Spiegel*
- *Recall:* say the German for the floor; the ground, then the German for the stairs, then say *der Spiegel* again

Before you move on

What does der Spiegel mean? ("A mirror".) Say it once more.

78.5 die Wohnung — a flat, an apartment

Before the new one: say the German for the stairs, then the German for a mirror.

You'll want to know: die Wohnung

die Wohnung — "a flat, an apartment".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wohnung ← Middle High German *wonunge* ← Old High German *wonunga* — *wohnen* + *-ung*: "a dwelling". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Wohnung*
- *Say it: die Wohnung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Wohnung*
- *Recall:* say the German for the stairs, then the German for a mirror, then say *die Wohnung* again

Before you move on

What does die Wohnung mean? ("A flat, an apartment".) Say it once more.

Chapter 79

Cup, Plate, Glass, Fork, Knife

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a cup, a plate, a glass, a fork and a knife.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 79: I can say a cup, a plate, a glass, a fork and a knife.*

79.1 die Tasse — a cup

Before the new one: say the German for a mirror, then the German for a flat.

You'll want to know: die Tasse

die Tasse — "a cup".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Tasse ← French *tasse* ← Arabic *ṭās*, "bowl, cup" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Tasse*

- *Say it: die Tasse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Tasse*
- *Recall:* say the German for a mirror, then the German for a flat, then say *die Tasse* again

Before you move on

What does die Tasse mean? ("A cup".) Say it once more.

79.2 der Teller — a plate

Before the new one: say the German for a flat, then the German for a cup.

You'll want to know: der Teller

der Teller — "a plate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Teller ← Middle High German *teller* (EtymDB 2.1), from Italian *tagliere*, "cutting board" — borrowed: a plate was first a board to cut meat on.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Teller*
- *Say it: der Teller*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Teller*
- *Recall:* say the German for a flat, then the German for a cup, then say *der Teller* again

Before you move on

What does der Teller mean? (“A plate”.) Say it once more.

79.3 das Glas — a glass

Before the new one: say the German for a cup, then the German for a plate.

You’ll want to know: das Glas

das Glas — “a glass”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Glas ← Old High German *glas* ← Proto-Germanic **glasą* — inherited, the same word as English *glass*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Glas*
- *Say it: das Glas*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Glas*
- *Recall:* say the German for a cup, then the German for a plate, then say *das Glas* again

Before you move on

What does das Glas mean? (“A glass”.) Say it once more.

79.4 die Gabel — a fork

Before the new one: say the German for a plate, then the German for a glass.

You'll want to know: die Gabel

die Gabel — "a fork".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gabel ← Old High German *gabala* ← Proto-Germanic **gabalō*, "fork" — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 links it to a Celtic **gablā*, "forked branch". At first a *Gabel* was a pitchfork.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Gabel*
- *Say it: die Gabel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Gabel*
- *Recall:* say the German for a plate, then the German for a glass, then say *die Gabel* again

Before you move on

What does die Gabel mean? ("A fork".) Say it once more.

79.5 das Messer — a knife

Before the new one: say the German for a glass, then the German for a fork.

You'll want to know: das Messer

das Messer — "a knife".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Messer ← Old High German *mezzisahs* ← Proto-Germanic **matisahsą*, "food-knife" (EtymDB 2.1): the old word for "food", English *meat*, + *sahs*, "knife", worn down to one word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Messer*
- *Say it: das Messer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Messer*
- *Recall:* say the German for a glass, then the German for a fork, then say *das Messer* again

Before you move on

What does das Messer mean? ("A knife".) Say it once more.

79.6 The body, people and food — a first pass

Say the words for a fork and a knife.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a leg, a tooth, the neck; the throat, a shoulder, a knee
- the face, blood, skin, a hair; hair, the belly
- the back, the tongue, a lip, a toe, the stomach
- a fever, a doctor, a doctor, a hospital, ill
- healthy, thirst, hunger, sad, happy
- fear, joy, a son, a daughter, a grandfather
- a grandmother, a woman; a wife, a girl, an uncle, an aunt
- a neighbour, a guest, a grandson, a pupil, a pupil
- to buy, to play, to know, to find, to look for

- to wait, to pay, to cook, to laugh, to cry
- to sing, to travel, to show, to bring, to forget
- to lose, to believe, to need, to live, to call

Before you move on

A leg? (**das Bein**.) A tooth? (**der Zahn**.) The neck; the throat? (**der Hals**.) A shoulder? (**die Schulter**.) A knee? (**das Knie**.) The face? (**das Gesicht**.) Blood? (**das Blut**.) Skin? (**die Haut**.) A hair; hair? (**das Haar**.) The belly? (**der Bauch**.) The back? (**der Rücken**.) The tongue? (**die Zunge**.) A lip? (**die Lippe**.) A toe? (**die Zehe**.) The stomach? (**der Magen**.) A fever? (**das Fieber**.) A doctor? (**der Arzt**.) A doctor? (**die Ärztin**.) A hospital? (**das Krankenhaus**.) Ill? (**krank**.) Healthy? (**gesund**.) Thirst? (**der Durst**.) Hunger? (**der Hunger**.) Sad? (**traurig**.) Happy? (**glücklich**.) Fear? (**die Angst**.) Joy? (**die Freude**.) A son? (**der Sohn**.) A daughter? (**die Tochter**.) A grandfather? (**der Großvater**.) A grandmother? (**die Großmutter**.) A woman; a wife? (**die Frau**.) A girl? (**das Mädchen**.) An uncle? (**der Onkel**.) An aunt? (**die Tante**.) A neighbour? (**der Nachbar**.) A guest? (**der Gast**.) A grandson? (**der Enkel**.) A pupil? (**der Schüler**.) A pupil? (**die Schülerin**.) To buy? (**kaufen**.) To play? (**spielen**.) To know? (**wissen**.) To find? (**finden**.) To look for? (**suchen**.) To wait? (**warten**.) To pay? (**bezahlen**.) To cook? (**kochen**.) To laugh? (**lachen**.) To cry? (**weinen**.) To sing? (**singen**.) To travel? (**reisen**.) To show? (**zeigen**.) To bring? (**bringen**.) To forget? (**vergessen**.) To lose? (**verlieren**.) To believe? (**glauben**.) To need? (**brauchen**.) To live? (**leben**.) To call? (**rufen**.)

79.7 The house, school things and nature — a second pass

Say the words for to carry; to wear and to send.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to carry; to wear, to send, to count, to paint, to clean
- a fish, meat, a chicken, fruit, an apple
- a banana, a potato, a tomato, an onion, a carrot
- a cake, a soup, honey, oil, lunch
- dinner, breakfast, rice, a pear, a lemon
- a grape, jam, cheese, salt, sugar
- juice, a sausage, ham, a salad; lettuce, noodles
- cream, pepper, a nut, beer, to cut
- a window, a chair, a table, a wall, a roof
- a garden, a lamp, a bath; a bathroom, a room, a bed
- a cupboard, the floor; the ground, the stairs, a mirror, a flat
- a cup, a plate, a glass, a fork, a knife

Before you move on

To carry; to wear? (**tragen**.) To send? (**schicken**.) To count? (**zählen**.) To paint? (**malen**.) To clean? (**putzen**.) A fish? (**der Fisch**.) Meat? (**das Fleisch**.) A chicken? (**das Huhn**.) Fruit? (**das Obst**.) An apple? (**der Apfel**.) A banana? (**die Banane**.) A potato? (**die Kartoffel**.) A tomato? (**die Tomate**.) An onion? (**die Zwiebel**.) A carrot? (**die Möhre**.) A cake? (**der Kuchen**.) A soup? (**die Suppe**.) Honey? (**der Honig**.) Oil? (**das Öl**.) Lunch? (**das Mittagessen**.) Dinner? (**das Abendessen**.) Breakfast? (**das Frühstück**.) Rice? (**der Reis**.) A pear? (**die Birne**.) A lemon? (**die Zitrone**.) A grape? (**die Traube**.) Jam? (**die Marmelade**.) Cheese? (**der Käse**.) Salt? (**das Salz**.) Sugar? (**der Zucker**.) Juice? (**der Saft**.) A sausage? (**die Wurst**.) Ham? (**der Schinken**.) A salad; lettuce? (**der Salat**.) Noodles? (**die Nudeln**.) Cream? (**die Sahne**.) Pepper? (**der Pfeffer**.) A nut? (**die Nuss**.) Beer? (**das Bier**.) To cut? (**schneiden**.) A window? (**das Fenster**.) A chair? (**der Stuhl**.) A table? (**der Tisch**.) A wall? (**die Wand**.) A roof? (**das Dach**.) A garden? (**der Garten**.) A lamp? (**die Lampe**.) A bath; a bathroom? (**das**

Bad.) A room? (**das Zimmer**.) A bed? (**das Bett**.) A cupboard? (**der Schrank**.) The floor; the ground? (**der Boden**.) The stairs? (**die Treppe**.) A mirror? (**der Spiegel**.) A flat? (**die Wohnung**.) A cup? (**die Tasse**.) A plate? (**der Teller**.) A glass? (**das Glas**.) A fork? (**die Gabel**.) A knife? (**das Messer**.)

Chapter 80

Spoon, Bottle, Exercise book, Pen, Paper

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a spoon, a bottle, an exercise book, a pen, a pencil and paper.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 80: I can say a spoon, a bottle, an exercise book, a pen, a pencil and paper.

80.1 der Löffel — a spoon

Before the new one: say the German for a fork, then the German for a knife.

You'll want to know: der Löffel

der Löffel — "a spoon".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Löffel ← Old High German *leffil* ← Proto-Germanic **lapilaz*, "spoon" — inherited; Dutch *lepel* is the same word. (EtymDB 2.1) It is related to English *lap*, "to lick up".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Löffel*
- *Say it: der Löffel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Löffel*
- *Recall:* say the German for a fork, then the German for a knife, then say *der Löffel* again

Before you move on

What does der Löffel mean? ("A spoon".) Say it once more.

80.2 die Flasche — a bottle

Before the new one: say the German for a knife, then the German for a spoon.

You'll want to know: die Flasche

die Flasche — "a bottle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Flasche ← Old High German *flasca* ← Proto-Germanic **flaskōn*, "a wicker-covered bottle", from a verb for "to plait" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Flasche*
- *Say it: die Flasche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Flasche*
- *Recall:* say the German for a knife, then the German for a spoon, then say *die Flasche* again

Before you move on

What does die Flasche mean? ("A bottle".) Say it once more.

80.3 das Heft — an exercise book

Before the new one: say the German for a spoon, then the German for a bottle.

You'll want to know: das Heft

das Heft — "an exercise book".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Heft comes from a verb meaning "to fasten" ← Old High German *heften* ← Proto-Germanic **haftijanǫ*, "to bind" (EtymDB 2.1): a booklet is sheets fastened together.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Heft*
- *Say it: das Heft*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Heft*
- *Recall:* say the German for a spoon, then the German for a bottle, then say *das Heft* again

Before you move on

What does das Heft mean? ("An exercise book".) Say it once more.

80.4 der Stift — a pen, a pencil

Before the new one: say the German for a bottle, then the German for an exercise book.

You'll want to know: der Stift

der Stift — "a pen, a pencil".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Stift ← Middle High German *stift*, "pin, spike" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, and probably related to the word for "stiff". A pencil is a pointed rod.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Stift*
- *Say it: der Stift*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Stift*
- *Recall:* say the German for a bottle, then the German for an exercise book, then say *der Stift* again

Before you move on

What does der Stift mean? ("A pen, a pencil".) Say it once more.

80.5 das Papier — paper

Before the new one: say the German for an exercise book, then the German for a pen.

You'll want to know: das Papier

das Papier — "paper".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Papier ← Middle High German *papier* ← Latin *papyrus* ← Greek *pápyros* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *paper*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Papier*
- *Say it: das Papier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Papier*
- *Recall:* say the German for an exercise book, then the German for a pen, then say *das Papier* again

Before you move on

What does das Papier mean? ("Paper".) Say it once more.

Chapter 81

School, Card, Picture, Bag, Money

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a school, a card, a picture, a bag and money.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 81: I can say a school, a card, a picture, a bag and money.*

81.1 die Schule — a school

Before the new one: say the German for a pen, then the German for paper.

You'll want to know: die Schule

die Schule — "a school".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schule ← Old High German *scuola* ← Latin *schola* ← Greek *scholḗ* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *school*. The Greek word first meant "leisure".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Schule*
- *Say it: die Schule*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Schule*
- *Recall:* say the German for a pen, then the German for paper, then say *die Schule* again

Before you move on

What does die Schule mean? ("A school".) Say it once more.

81.2 die Karte — a card; a map; a ticket

Before the new one: say the German for paper, then the German for a school.

You'll want to know: die Karte

die Karte — "a card; a map; a ticket".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Karte ← Latin *charta* ← Greek *chártēs*, "sheet of papyrus" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, by way of French. English *card* and *chart* come from the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Karte*
- *Say it: die Karte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Karte*
- *Recall:* say the German for paper, then the German for a school, then say *die Karte* again

Before you move on

What does die Karte mean? (“A card; a map; a ticket”.) Say it once more.

81.3 das Bild — a picture

Before the new one: say the German for a school, then the German for a card; a map; a ticket.

You’ll want to know: das Bild

das Bild — “a picture”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bild ← Old High German *bilidi*, “image, figure” ← Proto-Germanic **biliþją* — inherited; Dutch *beeld* is the same word. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Bild*
- *Say it: das Bild*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Bild*
- *Recall:* say the German for a school, then the German for a card; a map; a ticket, then say *das Bild* again

Before you move on

What does das Bild mean? (“A picture”.) Say it once more.

81.4 die Tasche — a bag; a pocket

Before the new one: say the German for a card; a map; a ticket, then the German for a picture.

You'll want to know: die Tasche

die Tasche — "a bag; a pocket".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Tasche ← Old High German *tasca*, "pouch" (EtymDB 2.1). Where *tasca* itself came from is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Tasche*
- *Say it: die Tasche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Tasche*
- *Recall:* say the German for a card; a map; a ticket, then the German for a picture, then say *die Tasche* again

Before you move on

What does die Tasche mean? ("A bag; a pocket".) Say it once more.

81.5 das Geld — money

Before the new one: say the German for a picture, then the German for a bag; a pocket.

You'll want to know: das Geld

das Geld — "money".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Geld ← Old High German *gelt*, "payment" ← Proto-Germanic **geldą*, "reward, payment" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) English *yield*, first "to pay", shares its root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Geld*
- *Say it: das Geld*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Geld*
- *Recall:* say the German for a picture, then the German for a bag; a pocket, then say *das Geld* again

Before you move on

What does das Geld mean? ("Money".) Say it once more.

Chapter 82

Telephone, Tree, Flower, Leaf, Mountain

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a telephone, a tree, a flower, a leaf and a mountain.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 82: I can say a telephone, a tree, a flower, a leaf and a mountain.

82.1 das Telefon — a telephone

Before the new one: say the German for a bag; a pocket, then the German for money.

You'll want to know: das Telefon

das Telefon — "a telephone".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Telefon ← French *téléphone*, a modern coinage from Greek *tēle*, "far", and *phōnē*, "sound" — borrowed; EtymDB 2.1 traces English *telephone* the same way.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Telefon*
- *Say it: das Telefon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Telefon*
- *Recall:* say the German for a bag; a pocket, then the German for money, then say *das Telefon* again

Before you move on

What does das Telefon mean? ("A telephone".) Say it once more.

82.2 der Baum — a tree

Before the new one: say the German for money, then the German for a telephone.

You'll want to know: der Baum

der Baum — "a tree".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Baum ← Old High German *boum* ← Proto-Germanic **baumaz*, "tree, beam" — inherited, the same word as English *beam*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Baum*
- *Say it: der Baum*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Baum*
- *Recall:* say the German for money, then the German for a telephone, then say *der Baum* again

Before you move on

What does der Baum mean? ("A tree".) Say it once more.

82.3 die Blume — a flower

Before the new one: say the German for a telephone, then the German for a tree.

You'll want to know: die Blume

die Blume — "a flower".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Blume ← Old High German *bluomo* ← Proto-Germanic **blōmô*, "flower" — inherited, the same word as English *bloom*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Blume*
- *Say it: die Blume*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Blume*
- *Recall:* say the German for a telephone, then the German for a tree, then say *die Blume* again

Before you move on

What does die Blume mean? ("A flower".) Say it once more.

82.4 das Blatt — a leaf; a sheet of paper

Before the new one: say the German for a tree, then the German for a flower.

You'll want to know: das Blatt

das Blatt — "a leaf; a sheet of paper".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Blatt ← Old High German *blat* ← Proto-Germanic **bladą*, "leaf" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) English *blade*, first a leaf of grass, is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Blatt*
- *Say it: das Blatt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Blatt*
- *Recall:* say the German for a tree, then the German for a flower, then say *das Blatt* again

Before you move on

What does das Blatt mean? ("A leaf; a sheet of paper".) Say it once more.

82.5 der Berg — a mountain

Before the new one: say the German for a flower, then the German for a leaf; a sheet of paper.

You'll want to know: der Berg

der Berg — "a mountain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Berg ← Old High German *berg* ← Proto-Germanic **bergaz*, "mountain, hill" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) English *barrow*, "burial mound", is a cousin, and *iceberg* came in from Dutch.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Berg*
- *Say it: der Berg*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Berg*
- *Recall:* say the German for a flower, then the German for a leaf; a sheet of paper, then say *der Berg* again

Before you move on

What does der Berg mean? ("A mountain".) Say it once more.

Chapter 83

Forest, Stone, Island, Field, Sky

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a forest, a stone, an island, a field and the sky.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 83: I can say a forest, a stone, an island, a field and the sky.*

83.1 der Wald — a forest

> Before the new one: say the German for a leaf; a sheet of paper, then the German for a mountain.

You'll want to know: der Wald

der Wald — "a forest".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wald ← Old High German *wald* ← Proto-Germanic **walþuz*, "high land covered with wood" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) English *wold*, as in the Cotswolds, is the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Wald*
- *Say it: der Wald*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Wald*
- *Recall:* say the German for a leaf; a sheet of paper, then the German for a mountain, then say *der Wald* again

Before you move on

What does der Wald mean? ("A forest".) Say it once more.

83.2 der Stein — a stone

Before the new one: say the German for a mountain, then the German for a forest.

You'll want to know: der Stein

der Stein — "a stone".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Stein ← Old High German *stein* ← Proto-Germanic **stainaz* — inherited, the same word as English *stone*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Stein*
- *Say it: der Stein*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Stein*
- *Recall:* say the German for a mountain, then the German for a forest, then say *der Stein* again

Before you move on

What does der Stein mean? ("A stone".) Say it once more.

83.3 die Insel — an island

Before the new one: say the German for a forest, then the German for a stone.

You'll want to know: die Insel

die Insel — "an island".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Insel ← Middle High German *insel* ← Latin *īnsula*, "island" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed. English *insular* and *peninsula* share the Latin word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Insel*
- *Say it: die Insel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Insel*
- *Recall:* say the German for a forest, then the German for a stone, then say *die Insel* again

Before you move on

What does die Insel mean? ("An island".) Say it once more.

83.4 das Feld — a field

Before the new one: say the German for a stone, then the German for an island.

You'll want to know: das Feld

das Feld — "a field".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Feld ← Old High German *feld* ← Proto-Germanic **felþą* — inherited, the same word as English *field*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Feld*
- *Say it: das Feld*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Feld*
- *Recall:* say the German for a stone, then the German for an island, then say *das Feld* again

Before you move on

What does das Feld mean? ("A field".) Say it once more.

83.5 der Himmel — the sky; heaven

Before the new one: say the German for an island, then the German for a field.

You'll want to know: der Himmel

der Himmel — "the sky; heaven".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Himmel ← Old High German *himil* ← Proto-Germanic **himilaz* — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *heaven* and Dutch *hemel*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Himmel*
- *Say it: der Himmel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Himmel*
- *Recall:* say the German for an island, then the German for a field, then say *der Himmel* again

Before you move on

What does der Himmel mean? ("The sky; heaven".) Say it once more.

Chapter 84

Star, Cloud, Rain, Pond, Fire

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a star, a cloud, rain, a pond and fire.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 84: I can say a star, a cloud, rain, a pond and fire.*

84.1 der Stern — a star

Before the new one: say the German for a field, then the German for the sky; heaven.

You'll want to know: der Stern

der Stern — "a star".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Stern ← Old High German *sterno* ← Proto-Germanic **sternô*, "star" — inherited, a cousin of English *star*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Stern*
- *Say it: der Stern*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Stern*
- *Recall:* say the German for a field, then the German for the sky; heaven, then say *der Stern* again

Before you move on

What does der Stern mean? (“A star”.) Say it once more.

84.2 die Wolke — a cloud

Before the new one: say the German for the sky; heaven, then the German for a star.

You’ll want to know: die Wolke

die Wolke — “a cloud”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wolke ← Old High German *wolkan* ← Proto-Germanic **wulkanǫ*, “cloud” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The old English word *welkin*, “the sky”, is a cousin.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Wolke*
- *Say it: die Wolke*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Wolke*
- *Recall:* say the German for the sky; heaven, then the German for a star, then say *die Wolke* again

Before you move on

What does die Wolke mean? (“A cloud”.) Say it once more.

84.3 der Regen — rain

Before the new one: say the German for a star, then the German for a cloud.

You’ll want to know: der Regen

der Regen — “rain”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Regen ← Old High German *regan* ← Proto-Germanic **regnaz* — inherited, the same word as English *rain*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Regen*
- *Say it: der Regen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Regen*
- *Recall:* say the German for a star, then the German for a cloud, then say *der Regen* again

Before you move on

What does der Regen mean? (“Rain”.) Say it once more.

84.4 der Teich — a pond

Before the new one: say the German for a cloud, then the German for rain.

You'll want to know: der Teich

der Teich — "a pond".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Teich ← Old High German *tīh* ← Proto-Germanic **dīkaz*, "pool" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) English *ditch* and *dike*, a dug channel and its bank, are cousins.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Teich*
- *Say it: der Teich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Teich*
- *Recall:* say the German for a cloud, then the German for rain, then say *der Teich* again

Before you move on

What does der Teich mean? ("A pond".) Say it once more.

84.5 das Feuer — fire

Before the new one: say the German for rain, then the German for a pond.

You'll want to know: das Feuer

das Feuer — "fire".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Feuer ← Old High German *fiur* ← Proto-Germanic **fōr* — inherited, the same word as English *fire*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Feuer*
- *Say it: das Feuer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Feuer*
- *Recall:* say the German for rain, then the German for a pond, then say *das Feuer* again

Before you move on

What does das Feuer mean? ("Fire".) Say it once more.

Chapter 85

Ice, Hill, Desert, Horse, Cow

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say ice, a hill, a desert, a horse and a cow.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 85: I can say ice, a hill, a desert, a horse and a cow.*

85.1 das Eis — ice; ice cream

Before the new one: say the German for a pond, then the German for fire.

You'll want to know: das Eis

das Eis — "ice; ice cream".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Eis ← Old High German *īs* ← Proto-Germanic **īsą* — inherited, the same word as English *ice*. (EtymDB 2.1) "Ice cream" is a later sense.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Eis*
- *Say it: das Eis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Eis*
- *Recall:* say the German for a pond, then the German for fire, then say *das Eis* again

Before you move on

What does das Eis mean? ("Ice; ice cream".) Say it once more.

85.2 der Hügel — a hill

Before the new one: say the German for fire, then the German for ice; ice cream.

You'll want to know: der Hügel

der Hügel — "a hill".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Hügel spread into standard German from central German dialects. It is built from Middle High German *houc*, "hill", as a diminutive, related to the word for "high"; compare Old Norse *haugr*, "mound".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Hügel*
- *Say it: der Hügel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Hügel*
- *Recall:* say the German for fire, then the German for ice; ice cream, then say *der Hügel* again

Before you move on

What does der Hügel mean? (“A hill”.) Say it once more.

85.3 die Wüste — a desert

Before the new one: say the German for ice; ice cream, then the German for a hill.

You’ll want to know: die Wüste

die Wüste — “a desert”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wüste ← Old High German *wuostī* ← Proto-Germanic **wōstinjō*, “wasteland” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) English *waste*, which came through French from Latin *vastus*, is a cousin.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Wüste*
- *Say it: die Wüste*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Wüste*
- *Recall:* say the German for ice; ice cream, then the German for a hill, then say *die Wüste* again

Before you move on

What does die Wüste mean? (“A desert”.) Say it once more.

85.4 das Pferd — a horse

Before the new one: say the German for a hill, then the German for a desert.

You'll want to know: das Pferd

das Pferd — "a horse".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Pferd ← Old High German *pfarifrit* ← Late Latin *paraverēdus*, "spare post horse" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed and worn down. English *palfrey* comes from the same Latin word through French.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Pferd*
- *Say it: das Pferd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Pferd*
- *Recall:* say the German for a hill, then the German for a desert, then say *das Pferd* again

Before you move on

What does das Pferd mean? ("A horse".) Say it once more.

85.5 die Kuh — a cow

Before the new one: say the German for a desert, then the German for a horse.

You'll want to know: die Kuh

die Kuh — "a cow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kuh ← Old High German *kuo* ← Proto-Germanic **kūz* — inherited, the same word as English *cow*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Kuh*
- *Say it: die Kuh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Kuh*
- *Recall:* say the German for a desert, then the German for a horse, then say *die Kuh* again

Before you move on

What does die Kuh mean? ("A cow".) Say it once more.

Chapter 86

Pig, Bird, Mouse, Fox, Snake

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a pig, a bird, a mouse, a fox and a snake.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 86: I can say a pig, a bird, a mouse, a fox and a snake.*

86.1 das Schwein — a pig

Before the new one: say the German for a horse, then the German for a cow.

You'll want to know: das Schwein

das Schwein — "a pig".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schwein ← Old High German *swīn* ← Proto-Germanic **swīnǫ*, "swine, pig" — inherited, the same word as English *swine*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Schwein*
- *Say it: das Schwein*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Schwein*
- *Recall:* say the German for a horse, then the German for a cow, then say *das Schwein* again

Before you move on

What does das Schwein mean? (“A pig”.) Say it once more.

86.2 der Vogel — a bird

Before the new one: say the German for a cow, then the German for a pig.

You’ll want to know: der Vogel

der Vogel — “a bird”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Vogel ← Old High German *fogal* ← Proto-Germanic **fuglaz*, “bird” — inherited, the same word as English *fowl*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Vogel*
- *Say it: der Vogel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Vogel*
- *Recall:* say the German for a cow, then the German for a pig, then say *der Vogel* again

Before you move on

What does der Vogel mean? (“A bird”.) Say it once more.

86.3 die Maus — a mouse

Before the new one: say the German for a pig, then the German for a bird.

You’ll want to know: die Maus

die Maus — “a mouse”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Maus ← Old High German *mūs* ← Proto-Germanic **mūs* — inherited, the same word as English *mouse*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Maus*
- *Say it: die Maus*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Maus*
- *Recall:* say the German for a pig, then the German for a bird, then say *die Maus* again

Before you move on

What does die Maus mean? (“A mouse”.) Say it once more.

86.4 der Fuchs — a fox

Before the new one: say the German for a bird, then the German for a mouse.

You'll want to know: der Fuchs

der Fuchs — "a fox".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Fuchs ← Old High German *fuhs* ← Proto-Germanic **fuhsaz* — inherited, the same word as English *fox*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Fuchs*
- *Say it: der Fuchs*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Fuchs*
- *Recall:* say the German for a bird, then the German for a mouse, then say *der Fuchs* again

Before you move on

What does der Fuchs mean? ("A fox".) Say it once more.

86.5 die Schlange — a snake; a queue

Before the new one: say the German for a mouse, then the German for a fox.

You'll want to know: die Schlange

die Schlange — "a snake; a queue".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schlange ← Old High German *slango* ← Proto-Germanic **slangô*, "snake" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) A queue is a line that winds like a snake.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Schlange*
- *Say it: die Schlange*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Schlange*
- *Recall:* say the German for a mouse, then the German for a fox, then say *die Schlange* again

Before you move on

What does die Schlange mean? ("A snake; a queue".) Say it once more.

Chapter 87

Duck, Sheep, Goat, Lion, Monkey

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a duck, a sheep, a goat, a lion and a monkey.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 87: I can say a duck, a sheep, a goat, a lion and a monkey.*

87.1 die Ente — a duck

> Before the new one: say the German for a fox, then the German for a snake; a queue.

You'll want to know: die Ente

die Ente — "a duck".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ente ← Old High German *anut* ← Proto-Germanic **anadz*, "duck" — inherited; Dutch *eend* is the same word. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Ente*
- *Say it: die Ente*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Ente*
- *Recall:* say the German for a fox, then the German for a snake; a queue, then say *die Ente* again

Before you move on

What does die Ente mean? ("A duck".) Say it once more.

87.2 das Schaf — a sheep

Before the new one: say the German for a snake; a queue, then the German for a duck.

You'll want to know: das Schaf

das Schaf — "a sheep".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schaf ← Old High German *scāf* ← Proto-Germanic **skēpą* — inherited, the same word as English *sheep*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Schaf*
- *Say it: das Schaf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Schaf*
- *Recall:* say the German for a snake; a queue, then the German for a duck, then say *das Schaf* again

Before you move on

What does das Schaf mean? (“A sheep”.) Say it once more.

87.3 die Ziege — a goat

Before the new one: say the German for a duck, then the German for a sheep.

You’ll want to know: die Ziege

die Ziege — “a goat”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ziege ← Old High German *ziga* ← Proto-Germanic **tigōn*, “goat” — inherited, with German *z* for an older *t*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Ziege*
- *Say it: die Ziege*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Ziege*
- *Recall:* say the German for a duck, then the German for a sheep, then say *die Ziege* again

Before you move on

What does die Ziege mean? (“A goat”.) Say it once more.

87.4 der Löwe — a lion

Before the new one: say the German for a sheep, then the German for a goat.

You'll want to know: der Löwe

der Löwe — "a lion".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Löwe ← Old High German *leo*, from Latin *leō* ← Greek *léōn* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *lion*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Löwe*
- *Say it: der Löwe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Löwe*
- *Recall:* say the German for a sheep, then the German for a goat, then say *der Löwe* again

Before you move on

What does der Löwe mean? ("A lion".) Say it once more.

87.5 der Affe — a monkey

Before the new one: say the German for a goat, then the German for a lion.

You'll want to know: der Affe

der Affe — "a monkey".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Affe ← Old High German *affo* ← Proto-Germanic **apô*, "monkey, ape" — inherited, the same word as English *ape*, with German *ff* where English kept *p*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Affe*
- *Say it: der Affe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Affe*
- *Recall:* say the German for a goat, then the German for a lion, then say *der Affe* again

Before you move on

What does der Affe mean? ("A monkey".) Say it once more.

Chapter 88

Bee, Ant, Elephant, To fetch, To wish

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a bee, an ant, an elephant, to fetch and to wish.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 88: I can say a bee, an ant, an elephant, to fetch and to wish.*

88.1 die Biene — a bee

> Before the new one: say the German for a lion, then the German for a monkey.

You'll want to know: die Biene

die Biene — "a bee".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Biene ← Old High German *bini* ← Proto-Germanic **biniz*, "bee" — inherited, a cousin of English *bee*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Biene*
- *Say it: die Biene*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Biene*
- *Recall:* say the German for a lion, then the German for a monkey, then say *die Biene* again

Before you move on

What does die Biene mean? (“A bee”.) Say it once more.

88.2 die Ameise — an ant

Before the new one: say the German for a monkey, then the German for a bee.

You’ll want to know: die Ameise

die Ameise — “an ant”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ameise ← Old High German *āmeiza* ← Proto-Germanic **ēmaitijōn*, built from **ē-*, “off”, and **maitanǫ*, “to cut”: the one that cuts things off. (EtymDB 2.1) English *emmet*, an old word for “ant”, is the same word.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Ameise*
- *Say it: die Ameise*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Ameise*

- *Recall:* say the German for a monkey, then the German for a bee, then say *die Ameise* again

Before you move on

What does die Ameise mean? (“An ant”.) Say it once more.

88.3 der Elefant — an elephant

Before the new one: say the German for a bee, then the German for an ant.

You’ll want to know: der Elefant

der Elefant — “an elephant”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Elefant ← Latin *elephantus* ← Greek *eléphas* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *elephant*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Elefant*
- *Say it: der Elefant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Elefant*
- *Recall:* say the German for a bee, then the German for an ant, then say *der Elefant* again

Before you move on

What does der Elefant mean? (“An elephant”.) Say it once more.

88.4 holen — to fetch

Before the new one: say the German for an ant, then the German for an elephant.

You'll want to know: holen

holen — "to fetch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

holen ← Middle High German *holen* ← Old High German *holōn*, "to get, to fetch" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited. English *haul* is a cousin that came back through French.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: holen*
- *Say it: holen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *holen*
- *Recall:* say the German for an ant, then the German for an elephant, then say *holen* again

Before you move on

What does holen mean? ("To fetch".) Say it once more.

88.5 wünschen — to wish

Before the new one: say the German for an elephant, then the German for to fetch.

You'll want to know: wünschen

wünschen — "to wish".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wünschen ← Middle High German *wünschen*, from Proto-Germanic **wunskijanǫ*, "to wish" — inherited, the same verb as English *wish*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: wünschen*
- *Say it: wünschen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *wünschen*
- *Recall:* say the German for an elephant, then the German for to fetch, then say *wünschen* again

Before you move on

What does wünschen mean? ("To wish".) Say it once more.

Chapter 89

Small, Short, Fast, Slow, Light

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say small, short, fast, slow and light.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 89: I can say small, short, fast, slow and light.*

89.1 klein — small

Before the new one: say the German for to fetch, then the German for to wish.

You'll want to know: klein

klein — "small".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

klein ← Old High German *kleini*, "fine, delicate" ← Proto-Germanic **klainiz*, "shining, fine" — inherited, the same word as English *clean*. (EtymDB 2.1) German moved from "fine" to "small".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: klein*
- *Say it: klein*, once more
- *Say it:* say *klein*
- *Recall:* say the German for to fetch, then the German for to wish, then say *klein* again

Before you move on

What does klein mean? ("Small".) Say it once more.

89.2 kurz — short

Before the new one: say the German for to wish, then the German for small.

You'll want to know: kurz

kurz — "short".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

kurz ← Old High German *kurz* ← Latin *curtus*, "shortened" (EtymDB 2.1) — an early loan from Latin. English *curt* comes from the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kurz*
- *Say it: kurz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kurz*
- *Recall:* say the German for to wish, then the German for small, then say *kurz* again

Before you move on

What does kurz mean? (“Short”.) Say it once more.

89.3 schnell — fast

Before the new one: say the German for small, then the German for short.

You’ll want to know: schnell

schnell — “fast”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schnell ← Old High German *snel*, “nimble, brave, quick” ← Proto-Germanic **snellaz* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schnell*
- *Say it: schnell*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schnell*
- *Recall:* say the German for small, then the German for short, then say *schnell* again

Before you move on

What does schnell mean? (“Fast”.) Say it once more.

89.4 langsam — slow

Before the new one: say the German for short, then the German for fast.

You'll want to know: langsam

langsam — "slow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

langsam ← Old High German *lancsam* ← Proto-Germanic **langasamaz*, "lengthy": the word for "long" + *-sam* (EtymDB 2.1). Slow is what takes long.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *langsam*
- *Say it:* *langsam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *langsam*
- *Recall:* say the German for short, then the German for fast, then say *langsam* again

Before you move on

What does langsam mean? ("Slow".) Say it once more.

89.5 leicht — light; easy

Before the new one: say the German for fast, then the German for slow.

You'll want to know: leicht

leicht — "light; easy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

leicht ← Old High German *līht* ← Proto-Germanic **linhtaz* — inherited, the same word as English *light* in the sense "not heavy". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: leicht*
- *Say it: leicht*, once more
- *Say it:* say *leicht*
- *Recall:* say the German for fast, then the German for slow, then say *leicht* again

Before you move on

What does leicht mean? ("Light; easy".) Say it once more.

Chapter 90

Heavy, Cheap, High, Low, Empty

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say heavy, cheap, high, tall, low and empty.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 90: I can say heavy, cheap, high, tall, low and empty.*

90.1 schwer — heavy; difficult

Before the new one: say the German for slow, then the German for light; easy.

You'll want to know: schwer

schwer — "heavy; difficult".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schwer ← Old High German *swār* ← Proto-Germanic **swēraz*, "heavy" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schwer*
- *Say it: schwer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schwer*
- *Recall:* say the German for slow, then the German for light; easy, then say *schwer* again

Before you move on

What does schwer mean? (“Heavy; difficult”.) Say it once more.

90.2 billig — cheap

Before the new one: say the German for light; easy, then the German for heavy; difficult.

You’ll want to know: billig

billig — “cheap”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

billig ← Old High German *billīh*, “appropriate, fair” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited. A fair price slid into a cheap one.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: billig*
- *Say it: billig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *billig*
- *Recall:* say the German for light; easy, then the German for heavy; difficult, then say *billig* again

Before you move on

What does billig mean? (“Cheap”.) Say it once more.

90.3 hoch — high, tall

Before the new one: say the German for heavy; difficult, then the German for cheap.

You’ll want to know: hoch

hoch — “high, tall”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hoch ← Old High German *hōh*, “high, tall” ← Proto-Germanic **hauhaz* — inherited, the same word as English *high*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hoch*
- *Say it: hoch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hoch*
- *Recall:* say the German for heavy; difficult, then the German for cheap, then say *hoch* again

Before you move on

What does hoch mean? (“High, tall”.) Say it once more.

90.4 niedrig — low

Before the new one: say the German for cheap, then the German for high.

You'll want to know: niedrig

niedrig — "low".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

niedrig is the word for "down" + *-ig*. That word ← Old High German *nidar* ← Proto-Germanic **niþer* (EtymDB 2.1); English *nether*, "lower", is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: niedrig*
- *Say it: niedrig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *niedrig*
- *Recall:* say the German for cheap, then the German for high, then say *niedrig* again

Before you move on

What does niedrig mean? ("Low".) Say it once more.

90.5 leer — empty

Before the new one: say the German for high, then the German for low.

You'll want to know: leer

leer — "empty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

leer ← Middle High German *lære*, "empty" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, from Old High German *lāri*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: leer*
- *Say it: leer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *leer*
- *Recall:* say the German for high, then the German for low, then say *leer* again

Before you move on

What does leer mean? ("Empty".) Say it once more.

Chapter 91

Strong, Weak, Rich, Ugly, Sweet

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say strong, weak, rich, ugly and sweet.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 91: I can say strong, weak, rich, ugly and sweet.*

91.1 stark — strong

> Before the new one: say the German for low, then the German for empty.

You'll want to know: stark

stark — "strong".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

stark ← Old High German *stark* ← Proto-Germanic **starkuz*, "stiff, strong" — inherited, the same word as English *stark*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stark*
- *Say it: stark*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stark*
- *Recall:* say the German for low, then the German for empty, then say *stark* again

Before you move on

What does stark mean? ("Strong".) Say it once more.

91.2 schwach — weak

Before the new one: say the German for empty, then the German for strong.

You'll want to know: schwach

schwach — "weak".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schwach ← Middle High German *swach* ← Proto-Germanic **swakaz*, "weak" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schwach*
- *Say it: schwach*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schwach*
- *Recall:* say the German for empty, then the German for strong, then say *schwach* again

Before you move on

What does schwach mean? ("Weak".) Say it once more.

91.3 reich — rich

Before the new one: say the German for strong, then the German for weak.

You'll want to know: reich

reich — "rich".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

reich ← Old High German *rīhhi*, "mighty" ← Proto-Germanic **rīkijaz*, from a Celtic word for "king" — inherited, the same word as English *rich*. (EtymDB 2.1) Power came first, wealth after.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: reich*
- *Say it: reich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *reich*
- *Recall:* say the German for strong, then the German for weak, then say *reich* again

Before you move on

What does reich mean? ("Rich".) Say it once more.

91.4 hässlich — ugly

Before the new one: say the German for weak, then the German for rich.

You'll want to know: hässlich

hässlich — "ugly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hässlich ← Middle High German *hezzelich*, "hateful" (EtymDB 2.1): the word for "hate" + *-lich*. What was hateful came to mean ugly.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hässlich*
- *Say it: hässlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hässlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for weak, then the German for rich, then say *hässlich* again

Before you move on

What does hässlich mean? ("Ugly".) Say it once more.

91.5 süß — sweet

Before the new one: say the German for rich, then the German for ugly.

You'll want to know: süß

süß — "sweet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

süß ← Old High German *suozi* — inherited. EtymDB 2.1 traces *suozi* and English *sweet* to Proto-Germanic **swōtuz*: one word, with German *ß* where English kept *t*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: süß*
- *Say it: süß*, once more
- *Say it:* say *süß*
- *Recall:* say the German for rich, then the German for ugly, then say *süß* again

Before you move on

What does süß mean? ("Sweet".) Say it once more.

Chapter 92

Clean, Dirty, Thick, Thin, Quiet

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say clean, dirty, thick, thin and quiet.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 92: I can say clean, dirty, thick, thin and quiet.*

92.1 sauber — clean

Before the new one: say the German for ugly, then the German for sweet.

You'll want to know: sauber

sauber — "clean".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sauber ← Old High German *sūbar*, from Latin *sōbrius*, "sober" — an early loan. EtymDB 2.1 traces English *sober* to the same Latin word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sauber*
- *Say it: sauber*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sauber*
- *Recall:* say the German for ugly, then the German for sweet, then say *sauber* again

Before you move on

What does sauber mean? ("Clean".) Say it once more.

92.2 schmutzig — dirty

Before the new one: say the German for sweet, then the German for clean.

You'll want to know: schmutzig

schmutzig — "dirty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schmutzig is the word for "dirt" + *-ig*. That word ← Middle High German *smuz*, and EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *smut*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schmutzig*
- *Say it: schmutzig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schmutzig*
- *Recall:* say the German for sweet, then the German for clean, then say *schmutzig* again

Before you move on

What does schmutzig mean? (“Dirty”.) Say it once more.

92.3 dick — thick; fat

Before the new one: say the German for clean, then the German for dirty.

You’ll want to know: dick

dick — “thick; fat”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dick ← Proto-Germanic **pekuz*, “thick” — inherited, the same word as English *thick*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dick*
- *Say it:* *dick*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dick*
- *Recall:* say the German for clean, then the German for dirty, then say *dick* again

Before you move on

What does dick mean? (“Thick; fat”.) Say it once more.

92.4 dünn — thin

Before the new one: say the German for dirty, then the German for thick; fat.

You'll want to know: dünn

dünn — "thin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dünn ← Old High German *dunni*, "slender, thin" ← Proto-Germanic **þunnuz* — inherited, the same word as English *thin*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dünn*
- *Say it: dünn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dünn*
- *Recall:* say the German for dirty, then the German for thick; fat, then say *dünn* again

Before you move on

What does dünn mean? ("Thin".) Say it once more.

92.5 leise — quiet

Before the new one: say the German for thick; fat, then the German for thin.

You'll want to know: leise

leise — "quiet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

leise ← Old High German *līso*, "weak, slow, quiet" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: leise*
- *Say it: leise*, once more
- *Say it:* say *leise*
- *Recall:* say the German for thick; fat, then the German for thin, then say *leise* again

Before you move on

What does leise mean? ("Quiet".) Say it once more.

Chapter 93

Right, Wrong, Important, Simple, Brown

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say right, correct, wrong, important, simple and brown.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 93: I can say right, correct, wrong, important, simple and brown.

93.1 richtig — right, correct

Before the new one: say the German for thin, then the German for quiet.

You'll want to know: richtig

richtig — "right, correct".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

richtig ← Old High German *rihtīg*, built from *reht*, "right", + *-ig*; *reht* ← Proto-Germanic **rehtaz*, the same word as English *right*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: richtig*
- *Say it: richtig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *richtig*
- *Recall:* say the German for thin, then the German for quiet, then say *richtig* again

Before you move on

What does richtig mean? ("Right, correct".) Say it once more.

93.2 falsch — wrong

Before the new one: say the German for quiet, then the German for right.

You'll want to know: falsch

falsch — "wrong".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

falsch ← Middle High German *vals* (EtymDB 2.1), from Old French *fals* ← Latin *falsus* — borrowed, like English *false*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: falsch*
- *Say it: falsch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *falsch*
- *Recall:* say the German for quiet, then the German for right, then say *falsch* again

Before you move on

What does falsch mean? (“Wrong”.) Say it once more.

93.3 wichtig — important

Before the new one: say the German for right, then the German for wrong.

You’ll want to know: wichtig

wichtig — “important”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wichtig was borrowed from Middle Low German *wichtich*, “weighty”, built on the word for “weight”; EtymDB 2.1 lists that word beside English *weight*. What matters carries weight.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: wichtig*
- *Say it: wichtig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *wichtig*
- *Recall:* say the German for right, then the German for wrong, then say *wichtig* again

Before you move on

What does wichtig mean? (“Important”.) Say it once more.

93.4 einfach — simple

Before the new one: say the German for wrong, then the German for important.

You'll want to know: einfach

einfach — "simple".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

einfach is *ein*, "one", + *-fach*, "-fold" (Middle High German *vach*, EtymDB 2.1): "onefold", the opposite of manifold.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: einfach*
- *Say it: einfach*, once more
- *Say it:* say *einfach*
- *Recall:* say the German for wrong, then the German for important, then say *einfach* again

Before you move on

What does einfach mean? ("Simple".) Say it once more.

93.5 braun — brown

Before the new one: say the German for important, then the German for simple.

You'll want to know: braun

braun — "brown".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

braun ← Old High German *brūn* ← Proto-Germanic **brūnaz* — inherited, the same word as English *brown*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *braun*
- *Say it:* *braun*, once more
- *Say it:* say *braun*
- *Recall:* say the German for important, then the German for simple, then say *braun* again

Before you move on

What does braun mean? ("Brown".) Say it once more.

Chapter 94

Grey, Purple, Second, Always, Immediately

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say grey, purple, a second, always and immediately.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 94: I can say grey, purple, a second, always and immediately.*

94.1 grau — grey

Before the new one: say the German for simple, then the German for brown.

You'll want to know: grau

grau — "grey".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grau ← Old High German *grāo* ← Proto-Germanic **grēwaz* — inherited, the same word as English *grey*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: grau*
- *Say it: grau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *grau*
- *Recall:* say the German for simple, then the German for brown, then say *grau* again

Before you move on

What does grau mean? ("Grey".) Say it once more.

94.2 lila — purple

Before the new one: say the German for brown, then the German for grey.

You'll want to know: lila

lila — "purple".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lila is the colour of lilac, from French *lilas* (EtymDB 2.1 has the French word), which came west from Persian through Arabic — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lila*
- *Say it: lila*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lila*
- *Recall:* say the German for brown, then the German for grey, then say *lila* again

Before you move on

What does lila mean? ("Purple".) Say it once more.

94.3 die Sekunde — a second (of time)

Before the new one: say the German for grey, then the German for purple.

You'll want to know: die Sekunde

die Sekunde — "a second (of time)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Sekunde ← Medieval Latin *secunda*, "the second" small division of an hour, from *secundus*, "following, second" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Sekunde*
- *Say it: die Sekunde*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Sekunde*
- *Recall:* say the German for grey, then the German for purple, then say *die Sekunde* again

Before you move on

What does die Sekunde mean? ("A second (of time)".) Say it once more.

94.4 immer — always

Before the new one: say the German for purple, then the German for a second.

You'll want to know: immer

immer — "always".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

immer ← Middle High German *immer* (EtymDB 2.1), from Old High German *io mēr*, "ever more": the word for "ever" + the word for "more".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: immer*
- *Say it: immer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *immer*
- *Recall:* say the German for purple, then the German for a second, then say *immer* again

Before you move on

What does immer mean? ("Always".) Say it once more.

94.5 sofort — immediately

Before the new one: say the German for a second, then the German for always.

You'll want to know: sofort

sofort — "immediately".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sofort is *so* + an adverb meaning "forth": "so forth", straight on without a pause. The two grew together into one word. *So* ← Proto-Germanic **swa* (EtymDB 2.1), and *fort* is the same word as

English *forth*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sofort*
- *Say it: sofort*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sofort*
- *Recall:* say the German for a second, then the German for always, then say *sofort* again

Before you move on

What does sofort mean? ("Immediately".) Say it once more.

Chapter 95

Today, Sometimes, There, Far, On the right

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say today, sometimes, there, far and on the right.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 95: I can say today, sometimes, there, far and on the right.

95.1 heute — today

Before the new one: say the German for always, then the German for immediately.

You'll want to know: heute

heute — "today".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

heute ← Middle High German *hiute* ← Old High German *hiutu*, "on this day", which ends in the old form of *Tag* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: heute*
- *Say it: heute*, once more
- *Say it:* say *heute*
- *Recall:* say the German for always, then the German for immediately, then say *heute* again

Before you move on

What does heute mean? (“Today”.) Say it once more.

95.2 manchmal — sometimes

Before the new one: say the German for immediately, then the German for today.

You’ll want to know: manchmal

manchmal — “sometimes”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

manchmal is “many a” + the word for “a time”, Old High German *māl* ← Proto-Germanic **mēlą* (EtymDB 2.1): many a time.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: manchmal*
- *Say it: manchmal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *manchmal*
- *Recall:* say the German for immediately, then the German for today, then say *manchmal* again

Before you move on

What does manchmal mean? (“Sometimes”.) Say it once more.

95.3 dort — there

Before the new one: say the German for today, then the German for sometimes.

You’ll want to know: dort

dort — “there”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dort ← Old High German *dorot* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, built on the same pointing stem as English *there*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dort*
- *Say it: dort*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dort*
- *Recall:* say the German for today, then the German for sometimes, then say *dort* again

Before you move on

What does dort mean? (“There”.) Say it once more.

95.4 weit — far

Before the new one: say the German for sometimes, then the German for there.

You'll want to know: weit

weit — "far".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

weit ← Old High German *wīt* ← Proto-Germanic **wīdaz*, "wide, far" — inherited, the same word as English *wide*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *weit*
- *Say it:* *weit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *weit*
- *Recall:* say the German for sometimes, then the German for there, then say *weit* again

Before you move on

What does weit mean? ("Far".) Say it once more.

95.5 rechts — on the right

Before the new one: say the German for there, then the German for far.

You'll want to know: rechts

rechts — "on the right".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rechts is the word for "right" + the adverb ending *-s*. That word ← Old High German *reht* ← Proto-Germanic **rehtaz*, the same word as English *right*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rechts*
- *Say it: rechts*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rechts*
- *Recall:* say the German for there, then the German for far, then say *rechts* again

Before you move on

What does rechts mean? ("On the right".) Say it once more.

Chapter 96

Shop, Market, Railway station, Aeroplane, Car

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a shop, a market, a railway station, an aeroplane and a car.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 96: I can say a shop, a market, a railway station, an aeroplane and a car.*

96.1 der Laden — a shop

> Before the new one: say the German for far, then the German for on the right.

You'll want to know: der Laden

der Laden — "a shop".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Laden ← Middle High German *lade*, "board, plank, shutter" ← Old High German *lado* ← Proto-Germanic **laþô* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: a shop was first the shutter-board goods were laid out on.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Laden*
- *Say it: der Laden*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Laden*
- *Recall:* say the German for far, then the German for on the right, then say *der Laden* again

Before you move on

What does der Laden mean? (“A shop”.) Say it once more.

96.2 der Markt — a market

Before the new one: say the German for on the right, then the German for a shop.

You’ll want to know: der Markt

der Markt — “a market”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Markt ← Old High German *marcāt* ← Latin *mercātus*, “trade, market” (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *market*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Markt*
- *Say it: der Markt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Markt*
- *Recall:* say the German for on the right, then the German for a shop, then say *der Markt* again

Before you move on

What does der Markt mean? ("A market".) Say it once more.

96.3 der Bahnhof — a railway station

Before the new one: say the German for a shop, then the German for a market.

You'll want to know: der Bahnhof

der Bahnhof — "a railway station".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bahnhof is built from the word for "way, track" (Old High German *bana*, "path") and the word for "yard, court" (Old High German *hof*) — both inherited (EtymDB 2.1): the railway's yard.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Bahnhof*
- *Say it: der Bahnhof*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Bahnhof*
- *Recall:* say the German for a shop, then the German for a market, then say *der Bahnhof* again

Before you move on

What does der Bahnhof mean? ("A railway station".) Say it once more.

96.4 das Flugzeug — an aeroplane

Before the new one: say the German for a market, then the German for a railway station.

You'll want to know: das Flugzeug

das Flugzeug — "an aeroplane".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Flugzeug is built from the word for "flight", Old High German *flug* ← Proto-Germanic **flugiz*, and the word for "gear, stuff", Old High German *giziug* (EtymDB 2.1): a flying device.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Flugzeug*
- *Say it: das Flugzeug*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Flugzeug*
- *Recall:* say the German for a market, then the German for a railway station, then say *das Flugzeug* again

Before you move on

What does das Flugzeug mean? ("An aeroplane".) Say it once more.

96.5 das Auto — a car

Before the new one: say the German for a railway station, then the German for an aeroplane.

You'll want to know: das Auto

das Auto — "a car".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Auto is short for the longer word for "automobile", taken from French and built from Greek *autós*, "self", and Latin *mōbilis*, "movable": a carriage that moves itself. EtymDB 2.1 has the French *auto* as its source.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Auto*
- *Say it: das Auto*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Auto*
- *Recall:* say the German for a railway station, then the German for an aeroplane, then say *das Auto* again

Before you move on

What does das Auto mean? ("A car".) Say it once more.

Chapter 97

Bridge, Church, Pharmacy, Village, Police

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a bridge, a church, a pharmacy, a village and the police.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 97: I can say a bridge, a church, a pharmacy, a village and the police.

97.1 die Brücke — a bridge

Before the new one: say the German for an aeroplane, then the German for a car.

You'll want to know: die Brücke

die Brücke — "a bridge".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Brücke ← Old High German *brugga* ← Proto-Germanic **brugjōn* — inherited, the same word as English *bridge*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Brücke*
- *Say it: die Brücke*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Brücke*
- *Recall:* say the German for an aeroplane, then the German for a car, then say *die Brücke* again

Before you move on

What does die Brücke mean? ("A bridge".) Say it once more.

97.2 die Kirche — a church

Before the new one: say the German for a car, then the German for a bridge.

You'll want to know: die Kirche

die Kirche — "a church".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kirche is an early West Germanic loan (Old High German *chirihha*, Old English *cirice*) from Greek *kyriakón*, "(the house) of the Lord" (EtymDB 2.1). English *church* and Scots *kirk* are the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Kirche*
- *Say it: die Kirche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Kirche*
- *Recall:* say the German for a car, then the German for a bridge, then say *die Kirche* again

Before you move on

What does die Kirche mean? ("A church".) Say it once more.

97.3 die Apotheke — a pharmacy

Before the new one: say the German for a bridge, then the German for a church.

You'll want to know: die Apotheke

die Apotheke — "a pharmacy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Apotheke ← Greek *apothḗkē*, "storehouse", from *apotíthēmi*, "to put away" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed through Latin: a store where medicines were kept.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Apotheke*
- *Say it: die Apotheke*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Apotheke*
- *Recall:* say the German for a bridge, then the German for a church, then say *die Apotheke* again

Before you move on

What does die Apotheke mean? ("A pharmacy".) Say it once more.

97.4 das Dorf — a village

Before the new one: say the German for a church, then the German for a pharmacy.

You'll want to know: das Dorf

das Dorf — "a village".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Dorf ← Old High German *dorf* ← Proto-Germanic **þurpą*, "village, estate" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) English place names ending in *-thorpe* keep the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Dorf*
- *Say it: das Dorf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Dorf*
- *Recall:* say the German for a church, then the German for a pharmacy, then say *das Dorf* again

Before you move on

What does das Dorf mean? ("A village".) Say it once more.

97.5 die Polizei — the police

Before the new one: say the German for a pharmacy, then the German for a village.

You'll want to know: die Polizei

die Polizei — "the police".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Polizei ← Medieval Latin *politia* ← Greek *politeía*, "government", from *pólis*, "city" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed. English *police* and *policy* share the word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Polizei*
- *Say it: die Polizei*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Polizei*
- *Recall:* say the German for a pharmacy, then the German for a village, then say *die Polizei* again

Before you move on

What does die Polizei mean? ("The police".) Say it once more.

Chapter 98

Library, Bicycle, Bus or tram stop, Clothes, Shirt

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a library, a bicycle, a bus or tram stop, clothes and a shirt.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 98: I can say a library, a bicycle, a bus or tram stop, clothes and a shirt.

98.1 die Bibliothek — a library

Before the new one: say the German for a village, then the German for the police.

You'll want to know: die Bibliothek

die Bibliothek — "a library".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bibliothek ← Latin *bibliothēca* ← Greek *bibliothḗkē*, built from *biblíon*, "book", and *thḗkē*, "store" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Bibliothek*
- *Say it: die Bibliothek*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Bibliothek*
- *Recall:* say the German for a village, then the German for the police, then say *die Bibliothek* again

Before you move on

What does die Bibliothek mean? ("A library".) Say it once more.

98.2 das Fahrrad — a bicycle

Before the new one: say the German for the police, then the German for a library.

You'll want to know: das Fahrrad

das Fahrrad — "a bicycle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Fahrrad is *fahren*, "to travel", + the word for "wheel", a cousin of Latin *rota*, "wheel" (EtymDB 2.1): a wheel you ride.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Fahrrad*
- *Say it: das Fahrrad*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Fahrrad*
- *Recall:* say the German for the police, then the German for a library, then say *das Fahrrad* again

Before you move on

What does das Fahrrad mean? (“A bicycle”.) Say it once more.

98.3 die Haltestelle — a bus or tram stop

Before the new one: say the German for a library, then the German for a bicycle.

You’ll want to know: die Haltestelle

die Haltestelle — “a bus or tram stop”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Haltestelle is the verb “to hold, to stop” (Old High German *haltan* ← Proto-Germanic **haldanǫ*, English *hold*, EtymDB 2.1) + the word for “place”: the stopping place.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Haltestelle*
- *Say it: die Haltestelle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Haltestelle*
- *Recall:* say the German for a library, then the German for a bicycle, then say *die Haltestelle* again

Before you move on

What does die Haltestelle mean? (“A bus or tram stop”.) Say it once more.

98.4 die Kleidung — clothes

Before the new one: say the German for a bicycle, then the German for a bus or tram stop.

You'll want to know: die Kleidung

die Kleidung — "clothes".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kleidung ← Middle High German *kleidunge*, from the verb "to clothe" + *-ung* (EtymDB 2.1). Its root is the word for "dress", Proto-Germanic **klaiþą*, "cloth", English *cloth*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Kleidung*
- *Say it: die Kleidung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Kleidung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a bicycle, then the German for a bus or tram stop, then say *die Kleidung* again

Before you move on

What does die Kleidung mean? ("Clothes".) Say it once more.

98.5 das Hemd — a shirt

Before the new one: say the German for a bus or tram stop, then the German for clothes.

You'll want to know: das Hemd

das Hemd — "a shirt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Hemd ← Middle High German *hemde* ← Old High German *hemidi* ← Proto-Germanic **hamiþiją*, "clothing, shirt" — inherited; Dutch *hemd* is the same word. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Hemd*
- *Say it: das Hemd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Hemd*
- *Recall:* say the German for a bus or tram stop, then the German for clothes, then say *das Hemd* again

Before you move on

What does das Hemd mean? ("A shirt".) Say it once more.

Chapter 99

Dress, Trousers, Shoe, Cap, Sock

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a dress, trousers, a shoe, a cap, a woollen hat and a sock.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 99: I can say a dress, trousers, a shoe, a cap, a woollen hat and a sock.*

99.1 das Kleid — a dress

Before the new one: say the German for clothes, then the German for a shirt.

You'll want to know: das Kleid

das Kleid — "a dress".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kleid ← Old High German *kleid* ← Proto-Germanic **klaiþą*, "cloth" — inherited, the same word as English *cloth*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Kleid*
- *Say it: das Kleid*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Kleid*
- *Recall:* say the German for clothes, then the German for a shirt, then say *das Kleid* again

Before you move on

What does das Kleid mean? ("A dress".) Say it once more.

99.2 die Hose — trousers

Before the new one: say the German for a shirt, then the German for a dress.

You'll want to know: die Hose

die Hose — "trousers".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Hose ← Old High German *hosa* ← Proto-Germanic **husōn*, "leg coverings" — inherited, the same word as English *hose*, as in stockings. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Hose*
- *Say it: die Hose*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Hose*
- *Recall:* say the German for a shirt, then the German for a dress, then say *die Hose* again

Before you move on

What does die Hose mean? ("Trousers".) Say it once more.

99.3 der Schuh — a shoe

Before the new one: say the German for a dress, then the German for trousers.

You'll want to know: der Schuh

der Schuh — "a shoe".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schuh ← Old High German *scuoh* ← Proto-Germanic **skōhaz* — inherited, the same word as English *shoe*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Schuh*
- *Say it: der Schuh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Schuh*
- *Recall:* say the German for a dress, then the German for trousers, then say *der Schuh* again

Before you move on

What does der Schuh mean? ("A shoe".) Say it once more.

99.4 die Mütze — a cap, a woollen hat

Before the new one: say the German for trousers, then the German for a shoe.

You'll want to know: die Mütze

die Mütze — "a cap, a woollen hat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mütze ← Middle High German *almuz* ← Medieval Latin *almutia*, "hood, cowl" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, and its first syllable was later dropped.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Mütze*
- *Say it: die Mütze*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Mütze*
- *Recall:* say the German for trousers, then the German for a shoe, then say *die Mütze* again

Before you move on

What does die Mütze mean? ("A cap, a woollen hat".) Say it once more.

99.5 die Socke — a sock

Before the new one: say the German for a shoe, then the German for a cap.

You'll want to know: die Socke

die Socke — "a sock".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Socke ← Old High German *soc* ← Latin *soccus*, "slipper, low shoe" (EtymDB 2.1) — an early loan, like English *sock*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Socke*
- *Say it: die Socke*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Socke*
- *Recall:* say the German for a shoe, then the German for a cap, then say *die Socke* again

Before you move on

What does die Socke mean? ("A sock".) Say it once more.

Chapter 100

Belt, Jacket, Border, World, Language

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a belt, a jacket, a border, the world and a language.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 100: I can say a belt, a jacket, a border, the world and a language.*

100.1 der Gürtel — a belt

> Before the new one: say the German for a cap, then the German for a sock.

You'll want to know: der Gürtel

der Gürtel — "a belt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gürtel ← Old High German *gurtil* ← Proto-Germanic **gurdilaz*, from **gurdijanǫ*, "to gird" — inherited, the same word as English *girdle*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Gürtel*
- *Say it: der Gürtel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Gürtel*
- *Recall:* say the German for a cap, then the German for a sock, then say *der Gürtel* again

Before you move on

What does der Gürtel mean? ("A belt".) Say it once more.

100.2 die Jacke — a jacket

Before the new one: say the German for a sock, then the German for a belt.

You'll want to know: die Jacke

die Jacke — "a jacket".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Jacke ← Old French *jaque*, "a short padded coat" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed. English *jacket* is a diminutive of the same French word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Jacke*
- *Say it: die Jacke*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Jacke*
- *Recall:* say the German for a sock, then the German for a belt, then say *die Jacke* again

Before you move on

What does die Jacke mean? ("A jacket".) Say it once more.

100.3 die Grenze — a border

Before the new one: say the German for a belt, then the German for a jacket.

You'll want to know: die Grenze

die Grenze — "a border".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Grenze ← Middle High German *grenize*, from a Slavic word, Proto-Slavic **granica*, "boundary" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed at the eastern frontier.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Grenze*
- *Say it: die Grenze*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Grenze*
- *Recall:* say the German for a belt, then the German for a jacket, then say *die Grenze* again

Before you move on

What does die Grenze mean? ("A border".) Say it once more.

100.4 die Welt — the world

Before the new one: say the German for a jacket, then the German for a border.

You'll want to know: die Welt

die Welt — "the world".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Welt ← Old High German *weralt* ← Proto-Germanic **weraldiz*, built from **weraz*, "man", and **aldiz*, "age" (EtymDB 2.1): "the age of man". English *world* is the same compound.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Welt*
- *Say it: die Welt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Welt*
- *Recall:* say the German for a jacket, then the German for a border, then say *die Welt* again

Before you move on

What does die Welt mean? ("The world".) Say it once more.

100.5 die Sprache — a language

Before the new one: say the German for a border, then the German for the world.

You'll want to know: die Sprache

die Sprache — "a language".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Sprache ← Old High German *sprāhha* ← Proto-Germanic **sprēkijō*, "speech, language" — inherited, a cousin of English *speech*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Sprache*
- *Say it: die Sprache*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Sprache*
- *Recall:* say the German for a border, then the German for the world, then say *die Sprache* again

Before you move on

What does die Sprache mean? ("A language".) Say it once more.

Chapter 101

Thirty, Forty, Fifty, Hundred, Thousand

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say thirty, forty, fifty, a hundred and a thousand.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 101: I can say thirty, forty, fifty, a hundred and a thousand.*

101.1 dreißig — thirty

> Before the new one: say the German for the world, then the German for a language.

You'll want to know: dreißig

dreißig — "thirty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dreißig ← Old High German *drīzzug* ← Proto-Germanic **þrīz tigiwiz*, "three tens" — the same build as English *thirty*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dreißig*
- *Say it: dreißig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dreißig*
- *Recall:* say the German for the world, then the German for a language, then say *dreißig* again

Before you move on

What does dreißig mean? ("Thirty".) Say it once more.

101.2 vierzig — forty

Before the new one: say the German for a language, then the German for thirty.

You'll want to know: vierzig

vierzig — "forty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vierzig ← Old High German *fiorzug* ← Proto-Germanic **fedwōr tigiwiz*, "four tens" — the same build as English *forty*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vierzig*
- *Say it: vierzig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vierzig*
- *Recall:* say the German for a language, then the German for thirty, then say *vierzig* again

Before you move on

What does vierzig mean? ("Forty".) Say it once more.

101.3 fünfzig — fifty

Before the new one: say the German for thirty, then the German for forty.

You'll want to know: fünfzig

fünfzig — "fifty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fünfzig is *fünf* + *-zig*, "tens" — the same build as English *fifty*. EtymDB 2.1 traces *fünf* to Old High German *fimf* ← Proto-Germanic **fimf*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fünfzig*
- *Say it: fünfzig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fünfzig*
- *Recall:* say the German for thirty, then the German for forty, then say *fünfzig* again

Before you move on

What does fünfzig mean? ("Fifty".) Say it once more.

101.4 hundert — a hundred

Before the new one: say the German for forty, then the German for fifty.

You'll want to know: hundert

hundert — "a hundred".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hundert ← Old High German *hundert* ← Proto-Germanic **hundaradą*, built from **hundą*, "hundred", and **radą*, "count" (EtymDB 2.1). English *hundred* is the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hundert*
- *Say it: hundert*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hundert*
- *Recall:* say the German for forty, then the German for fifty, then say *hundert* again

Before you move on

What does hundert mean? ("A hundred".) Say it once more.

101.5 tausend — a thousand

Before the new one: say the German for fifty, then the German for a hundred.

You'll want to know: tausend

tausend — "a thousand".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tausend ← Old High German *dūsunt* ← Proto-Germanic **þūsundī*, "thousand" — inherited, the same word as English *thousand*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tausend*
- *Say it: tausend*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tausend*
- *Recall:* say the German for fifty, then the German for a hundred, then say *tausend* again

Before you move on

What does tausend mean? ("A thousand".) Say it once more.

Chapter 102

Zero, Word, Answer, Work, Music

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say zero, a word, an answer, work and music.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 102: I can say zero, a word, an answer, work and music.*

102.1 null — zero

Before the new one: say the German for a hundred, then the German for a thousand.

You'll want to know: null

null — "zero".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

null came in with Arabic numerals from Italian *nulla*, "nothing" ← Latin *nūllus*, "none", built from *ne*, "not", and *ūllus*, "any" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: null*
- *Say it: null*, once more
- *Say it:* say *null*
- *Recall:* say the German for a hundred, then the German for a thousand, then say *null* again

Before you move on

What does null mean? (“Zero”.) Say it once more.

102.2 das Wort — a word

Before the new one: say the German for a thousand, then the German for zero.

You’ll want to know: das Wort

das Wort — “a word”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wort ← Old High German *wort* ← Proto-Germanic **wurdą* — inherited, the same word as English *word*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Wort*
- *Say it: das Wort*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Wort*
- *Recall:* say the German for a thousand, then the German for zero, then say *das Wort* again

Before you move on

What does das Wort mean? (“A word”.) Say it once more.

102.3 die Antwort — an answer

Before the new one: say the German for zero, then the German for a word.

You’ll want to know: die Antwort

die Antwort — “an answer”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Antwort ← Old High German *antwurti* ← Proto-Germanic **andawurdiją* (EtymDB 2.1): *ant-*, “against”, + *Wort* — a word given back. English *answer* pairs the same “against” with a verb meaning “to swear”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Antwort*
- *Say it: die Antwort*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Antwort*
- *Recall:* say the German for zero, then the German for a word, then say *die Antwort* again

Before you move on

What does die Antwort mean? (“An answer”.) Say it once more.

102.4 die Arbeit — work

Before the new one: say the German for a word, then the German for an answer.

You'll want to know: die Arbeit

die Arbeit — "work".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Arbeit ← Old High German *arbeit* ← Proto-Germanic **arbaidiz*, "toil, hardship" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) Work began as hardship.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Arbeit*
- *Say it: die Arbeit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Arbeit*
- *Recall:* say the German for a word, then the German for an answer, then say *die Arbeit* again

Before you move on

What does die Arbeit mean? ("Work".) Say it once more.

102.5 die Musik — music

Before the new one: say the German for an answer, then the German for work.

You'll want to know: die Musik

die Musik — "music".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Musik ← Latin *mūsica* ← Greek *mousikḗ*, "the art of the Muses" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *music*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *die Musik*
- *Say it:* *die Musik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Musik*
- *Recall:* say the German for an answer, then the German for work, then say *die Musik* again

Before you move on

What does die Musik mean? ("Music".) Say it once more.

Chapter 103

Song, Game, Colour, Journey, Holiday

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a song, a game, a colour, a journey and a holiday.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 103: I can say a song, a game, a colour, a journey and a holiday.*

103.1 das Lied — a song

Before the new one: say the German for work, then the German for music.

You'll want to know: das Lied

das Lied — "a song".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Lied ← Old High German *liod*, "song" ← Proto-Germanic **leuþą* — inherited; Old English *lēoþ*, "song, poem", is the same word. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Lied*
- *Say it: das Lied*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Lied*
- *Recall:* say the German for work, then the German for music, then say *das Lied* again

Before you move on

What does das Lied mean? ("A song".) Say it once more.

103.2 das Spiel — a game

Before the new one: say the German for music, then the German for a song.

You'll want to know: das Spiel

das Spiel — "a game".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Spiel ← Old High German *spil* ← Proto-Germanic **spilą*, "game, dance" — inherited, the noun beside *spielen*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Spiel*
- *Say it: das Spiel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Spiel*
- *Recall:* say the German for music, then the German for a song, then say *das Spiel* again

Before you move on

What does das Spiel mean? (“A game”.) Say it once more.

103.3 die Farbe — a colour

Before the new one: say the German for a song, then the German for a game.

You’ll want to know: die Farbe

die Farbe — “a colour”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Farbe ← Old High German *farawa* ← Proto-Germanic **farwō*, “colour” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Farbe*
- *Say it: die Farbe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Farbe*
- *Recall:* say the German for a song, then the German for a game, then say *die Farbe* again

Before you move on

What does die Farbe mean? (“A colour”.) Say it once more.

103.4 die Reise — a journey

Before the new one: say the German for a game, then the German for a colour.

You'll want to know: die Reise

die Reise — "a journey".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Reise ← Middle High German *reise*, "journey, expedition" (EtymDB 2.1) — the noun beside *reisen*, both inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Reise*
- *Say it: die Reise*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Reise*
- *Recall:* say the German for a game, then the German for a colour, then say *die Reise* again

Before you move on

What does die Reise mean? ("A journey".) Say it once more.

103.5 der Urlaub — a holiday

Before the new one: say the German for a colour, then the German for a journey.

You'll want to know: der Urlaub

der Urlaub — "a holiday".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Urlaub ← Middle High German *urloup*, "permission, leave to go" (EtymDB 2.1) — built from *ur-*, "out", and a word for "permission". A holiday is leave granted.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Urlaub*
- *Say it: der Urlaub*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Urlaub*
- *Recall:* say the German for a colour, then the German for a journey, then say *der Urlaub* again

Before you move on

What does der Urlaub mean? ("A holiday".) Say it once more.

103.6 Nature, animals and describing words — a first pass

Say the words for a journey and a holiday.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a spoon, a bottle, an exercise book, a pen, paper
- a school, a card; a map; a ticket, a picture, a bag; a pocket, money
- a telephone, a tree, a flower, a leaf; a sheet of paper, a mountain
- a forest, a stone, an island, a field, the sky; heaven
- a star, a cloud, rain, a pond, fire
- ice; ice cream, a hill, a desert, a horse, a cow
- a pig, a bird, a mouse, a fox, a snake; a queue
- a duck, a sheep, a goat, a lion, a monkey

- a bee, an ant, an elephant, to fetch, to wish
- small, short, fast, slow, light; easy
- heavy; difficult, cheap, high, low, empty
- strong, weak, rich, ugly, sweet

Before you move on

A spoon? (**der Löffel**.) A bottle? (**die Flasche**.) An exercise book? (**das Heft**.) A pen? (**der Stift**.) Paper? (**das Papier**.) A school? (**die Schule**.) A card; a map; a ticket? (**die Karte**.) A picture? (**das Bild**.) A bag; a pocket? (**die Tasche**.) Money? (**das Geld**.) A telephone? (**das Telefon**.) A tree? (**der Baum**.) A flower? (**die Blume**.) A leaf; a sheet of paper? (**das Blatt**.) A mountain? (**der Berg**.) A forest? (**der Wald**.) A stone? (**der Stein**.) An island? (**die Insel**.) A field? (**das Feld**.) The sky; heaven? (**der Himmel**.) A star? (**der Stern**.) A cloud? (**die Wolke**.) Rain? (**der Regen**.) A pond? (**der Teich**.) Fire? (**das Feuer**.) Ice; ice cream? (**das Eis**.) A hill? (**der Hügel**.) A desert? (**die Wüste**.) A horse? (**das Pferd**.) A cow? (**die Kuh**.) A pig? (**das Schwein**.) A bird? (**der Vogel**.) A mouse? (**die Maus**.) A fox? (**der Fuchs**.) A snake; a queue? (**die Schlange**.) A duck? (**die Ente**.) A sheep? (**das Schaf**.) A goat? (**die Ziege**.) A lion? (**der Löwe**.) A monkey? (**der Affe**.) A bee? (**die Biene**.) An ant? (**die Ameise**.) An elephant? (**der Elefant**.) To fetch? (**holen**.) To wish? (**wünschen**.) Small? (**klein**.) Short? (**kurz**.) Fast? (**schnell**.) Slow? (**langsam**.) Light; easy? (**leicht**.) Heavy; difficult? (**schwer**.) Cheap? (**billig**.) High? (**hoch**.) Low? (**niedrig**.) Empty? (**leer**.) Strong? (**stark**.) Weak? (**schwach**.) Rich? (**reich**.) Ugly? (**hässlich**.) Sweet? (**süß**.)

103.7 Town, clothes, numbers and more — a second pass

Say the words for clean and dirty.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- clean, dirty, thick; fat, thin, quiet
- right, wrong, important, simple, brown
- grey, purple, a second, always, immediately
- today, sometimes, there, far, on the right
- a shop, a market, a railway station, an aeroplane, a car
- a bridge, a church, a pharmacy, a village, the police
- a library, a bicycle, a bus or tram stop, clothes, a shirt
- a dress, trousers, a shoe, a cap, a sock
- a belt, a jacket, a border, the world, a language
- thirty, forty, fifty, a hundred, a thousand
- zero, a word, an answer, work, music
- a song, a game, a colour, a journey, a holiday

Before you move on

Clean? (**sauber**.) Dirty? (**schmutzig**.) Thick; fat? (**dick**.) Thin? (**dünn**.) Quiet? (**leise**.) Right? (**richtig**.) Wrong? (**falsch**.) Important? (**wichtig**.) Simple? (**einfach**.) Brown? (**braun**.) Grey? (**grau**.) Purple? (**lila**.) A second? (**die Sekunde**.) Always? (**immer**.) Immediately? (**sofort**.) Today? (**heute**.) Sometimes? (**manchmal**.) There? (**dort**.) Far? (**weit**.) On the right? (**rechts**.) A shop? (**der Laden**.) A market? (**der Markt**.) A railway station? (**der Bahnhof**.) An aeroplane? (**das Flugzeug**.) A car? (**das Auto**.) A bridge? (**die Brücke**.) A church? (**die Kirche**.) A pharmacy? (**die Apotheke**.) A village? (**das Dorf**.) The police? (**die Polizei**.) A library? (**die Bibliothek**.) A bicycle? (**das Fahrrad**.) A bus or tram stop? (**die Haltestelle**.) Clothes? (**die Kleidung**.) A shirt? (**das Hemd**.) A dress? (**das Kleid**.) Trousers? (**die Hose**.) A shoe? (**der Schuh**.) A cap? (**die Mütze**.) A sock? (**die Socke**.) A belt? (**der Gürtel**.) A jacket? (**die Jacke**.) A border? (**die Grenze**.) The world? (**die Welt**.) A language? (**die Sprache**.) Thirty? (**dreißig**.) Forty? (**vierzig**.) Fifty? (**fünfzig**.) A hundred? (**hundert**.) A thousand? (**tausend**.)

Zero? (**null**.) A word? (**das Wort**.) An answer? (**die Antwort**.) Work? (**die Arbeit**.) Music? (**die Musik**.) A song? (**das Lied**.) A game? (**das Spiel**.) A colour? (**die Farbe**.) A journey? (**die Reise**.) A holiday? (**der Urlaub**.)

Chapter 104

Airport, Square, Museum, Hotel, Post office

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an airport, a square, a museum, a hotel and the post office.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 104: I can say an airport, a square, a museum, a hotel and the post office.

104.1 der Flughafen — an airport

Before the new one: say the German for a journey, then the German for a holiday.

Before the new places: name the three words for "the", *der, die, das*, and say *der Tag*.

You'll want to know: der Flughafen

der Flughafen — "an airport".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Flughafen is built from the word for "flight", Old High German *flug* (EtymDB 2.1), and the word for "harbour", which came from Low German: a harbour for planes.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Flughafen*
- *Say it: der Flughafen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Flughafen*
- *Recall:* say the German for a journey, then the German for a holiday, then say *der Flughafen* again

Before you move on

What does der Flughafen mean? ("An airport".) Say it once more.

104.2 der Platz — a square; a seat

Before the new one: say the German for a holiday, then the German for an airport.

You'll want to know: der Platz

der Platz — "a square; a seat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Platz ← Middle High German *plaz* ← Old French *place* ← Latin *platēa*, "courtyard, broad street" ← Greek *plateîa* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *place*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Platz*
- *Say it: der Platz*, once more

- *Say it:* say *der Platz*
- *Recall:* say the German for a holiday, then the German for an airport, then say *der Platz* again

Before you move on

What does der Platz mean? ("A square; a seat".) Say it once more.

104.3 das Museum — a museum

Before the new one: say the German for an airport, then the German for a square; a seat.

You'll want to know: das Museum

das Museum — "a museum".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Museum ← Latin *museum* ← Greek *mouseîon*, "seat of the Muses", from *moûsa*, "Muse" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Museum*
- *Say it: das Museum*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Museum*
- *Recall:* say the German for an airport, then the German for a square; a seat, then say *das Museum* again

Before you move on

What does das Museum mean? ("A museum".) Say it once more.

104.4 das Hotel — a hotel

Before the new one: say the German for a square; a seat, then the German for a museum.

You'll want to know: das Hotel

das Hotel — "a hotel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Hotel ← French *hôtel* ← Old French *hostel* ← Latin *hospitāle*, "guesthouse" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed. English *hostel* and *hospital* come from the same Latin word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Hotel*
- *Say it: das Hotel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Hotel*
- *Recall:* say the German for a square; a seat, then the German for a museum, then say *das Hotel* again

Before you move on

What does das Hotel mean? ("A hotel".) Say it once more.

104.5 die Post — the post office; the post

Before the new one: say the German for a museum, then the German for a hotel.

You'll want to know: die Post

die Post — "the post office; the post".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Post ← Italian *posta*, from *posto*, "placed", ← Latin *positus* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: the post was a chain of stations placed along the road.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Post*
- *Say it: die Post*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Post*
- *Recall:* say the German for a museum, then the German for a hotel, then say *die Post* again

Before you move on

What does die Post mean? ("The post office; the post".) Say it once more.

Chapter 105

Restaurant, Bakery, Cinema, Theatre, Town hall

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a restaurant, a bakery, a cinema, a theatre and a town hall.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 105: I can say a restaurant, a bakery, a cinema, a theatre and a town hall.*

105.1 das Restaurant — a restaurant

Before the new one: say the German for a hotel, then the German for the post office; the post.

An evening at the restaurant: say *Guten Abend*, then *der Abend*.

You'll want to know: das Restaurant

das Restaurant — "a restaurant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Restaurant ← French *restaurant*, "restoring", from *restaurer*, "to restore" ← Latin *restaurāre* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: a place that restores you.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Restaurant*
- *Say it: das Restaurant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Restaurant*
- *Recall:* say the German for a hotel, then the German for the post office; the post, then say *das Restaurant* again

Before you move on

What does das Restaurant mean? ("A restaurant".) Say it once more.

105.2 die Bäckerei — a bakery

Before the new one: say the German for the post office; the post, then the German for a restaurant.

You'll want to know: die Bäckerei

die Bäckerei — "a bakery".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bäckerei is the word for "baker" + *-ei*, the ending that names a trade's workplace (EtymDB 2.1). The baker is the one who bakes.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Bäckerei*
- *Say it: die Bäckerei*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Bäckerei*
- *Recall:* say the German for the post office; the post, then the German for a restaurant, then say *die Bäckerei* again

Before you move on

What does die Bäckerei mean? (“A bakery”.) Say it once more.

105.3 das Kino — a cinema

Before the new one: say the German for a restaurant, then the German for a bakery.

You’ll want to know: das Kino

das Kino — “a cinema”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kino is short for the word for the cinematograph, a modern coinage from Greek *kínēma*, “movement”, and *gráphein*, “to write”: the machine that records movement. EtymDB 2.1 has no source for *Kino*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Kino*
- *Say it: das Kino*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Kino*
- *Recall:* say the German for a restaurant, then the German for a bakery, then say *das Kino* again

Before you move on

What does das Kino mean? (“A cinema”.) Say it once more.

105.4 das Theater — a theatre

Before the new one: say the German for a bakery, then the German for a cinema.

You'll want to know: das Theater

das Theater — "a theatre".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Theater ← Greek *théatron*, "a place for viewing", from *theáomai*, "to watch" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed through Latin *theātrum*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Theater*
- *Say it: das Theater*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Theater*
- *Recall:* say the German for a bakery, then the German for a cinema, then say *das Theater* again

Before you move on

What does das Theater mean? ("A theatre".) Say it once more.

105.5 das Rathaus — a town hall

Before the new one: say the German for a cinema, then the German for a theatre.

You'll want to know: das Rathaus

das Rathaus — "a town hall".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Rathaus is built from the word for "council", Old High German *rāt* ← Proto-Germanic **rēdaz*, "advice" (EtymDB 2.1), and the word for "house". English *rede*, "counsel", is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Rathaus*
- *Say it: das Rathaus*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Rathaus*
- *Recall:* say the German for a cinema, then the German for a theatre, then say *das Rathaus* again

Before you move on

What does das Rathaus mean? ("A town hall".) Say it once more.

Chapter 106

Supermarket, Petrol station, Swimming pool, Stadium, Factory

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a supermarket, a petrol station, a swimming pool, a stadium and a factory.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 106: I can say a supermarket, a petrol station, a swimming pool, a stadium and a factory.

106.1 der Supermarkt — a supermarket

Before the new one: say the German for a theatre, then the German for a town hall.

Say *der Morgen*, then the one article German uses for every plural: *die*.

You'll want to know: der Supermarkt

der Supermarkt — "a supermarket".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Supermarkt is Latin *super*, "above, beyond", + *Markt*, modelled on English *supermarket*. *Markt* ← Latin *mercātus*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Supermarkt*
- *Say it: der Supermarkt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Supermarkt*
- *Recall:* say the German for a theatre, then the German for a town hall, then say *der Supermarkt* again

Before you move on

What does der Supermarkt mean? ("A supermarket".) Say it once more.

106.2 die Tankstelle — a petrol station

Before the new one: say the German for a town hall, then the German for a supermarket.

You'll want to know: die Tankstelle

die Tankstelle — "a petrol station".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Tankstelle is *Tank*, taken from English *tank* (EtymDB 2.1), + the word for "place": the place where you fill the tank.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Tankstelle*
- *Say it: die Tankstelle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Tankstelle*
- *Recall:* say the German for a town hall, then the German for a supermarket, then say *die Tankstelle* again

Before you move on

What does die Tankstelle mean? (“A petrol station”.) Say it once more.

106.3 das Schwimmbad — a swimming pool

Before the new one: say the German for a supermarket, then the German for a petrol station.

You’ll want to know: das Schwimmbad

das Schwimmbad — “a swimming pool”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schwimmbad is the verb “to swim” (Old High German *swimman*, the same verb as English *swim*) + *Bad*, “bath”: a swimming bath. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Schwimmbad*
- *Say it: das Schwimmbad*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Schwimmbad*
- *Recall:* say the German for a supermarket, then the German for a petrol station, then say *das Schwimmbad* again

Before you move on

What does das Schwimmbad mean? (“A swimming pool”.) Say it once more.

106.4 das Stadion — a stadium

Before the new one: say the German for a petrol station, then the German for a swimming pool.

You'll want to know: das Stadion

das Stadion — "a stadium".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Stadion ← Greek *stádion* (EtymDB 2.1), a measure of about 180 metres and the racecourse of that length — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Stadion*
- *Say it: das Stadion*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Stadion*
- *Recall:* say the German for a petrol station, then the German for a swimming pool, then say *das Stadion* again

Before you move on

What does das Stadion mean? ("A stadium".) Say it once more.

106.5 die Fabrik — a factory

Before the new one: say the German for a swimming pool, then the German for a stadium.

You'll want to know: die Fabrik

die Fabrik — "a factory".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Fabrik ← French *fabrique* ← Latin *fabrica*, "workshop", from *faber*, "smith, craftsman" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed. English *fabric* shares the word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Fabrik*
- *Say it: die Fabrik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Fabrik*
- *Recall:* say the German for a swimming pool, then the German for a stadium, then say *die Fabrik* again

Before you move on

What does die Fabrik mean? ("A factory".) Say it once more.

Chapter 107

Office, Corner, Crossroads, Traffic lights, Car park

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an office, a corner, a crossroads, traffic lights and a car park.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 107: I can say an office, a corner, a crossroads, traffic lights and a car park.*

107.1 das Büro — an office

> Before the new one: say the German for a stadium, then the German for a factory.
>
> Say *die Jahre*, the plural of *das Jahr*. And remember that German IS its years: *ich bin*, not *ich habe*.

You'll want to know: das Büro

das Büro — "an office".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Büro ← French *bureau*, "desk, office", from *bure*, "woollen cloth" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: the cloth covered the desk, then named the desk and the room.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Büro*
- *Say it: das Büro*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Büro*
- *Recall:* say the German for a stadium, then the German for a factory, then say *das Büro* again

Before you move on

What does das Büro mean? ("An office".) Say it once more.

107.2 die Ecke — a corner

Before the new one: say the German for a factory, then the German for an office.

You'll want to know: die Ecke

die Ecke — "a corner".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ecke ← Old High German *ecka* ← Proto-Germanic **agjō*, "edge" — inherited, the same word as English *edge*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Ecke*
- *Say it: die Ecke*, once more

- *Say it:* say *die Ecke*
- *Recall:* say the German for a factory, then the German for an office, then say *die Ecke* again

Before you move on

What does die Ecke mean? ("A corner".) Say it once more.

107.3 die Kreuzung — a crossroads

Before the new one: say the German for an office, then the German for a corner.

You'll want to know: die Kreuzung

die Kreuzung — "a crossroads".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kreuzung is the verb "to cross" + *-ung*: a crossing. The verb is built on the word for "a cross", Old High German *chrūzi* ← Latin *crux* (EtymDB 2.1), a borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Kreuzung*
- *Say it: die Kreuzung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Kreuzung*
- *Recall:* say the German for an office, then the German for a corner, then say *die Kreuzung* again

Before you move on

What does die Kreuzung mean? ("A crossroads".) Say it once more.

107.4 die Ampel — traffic lights

Before the new one: say the German for a corner, then the German for a crossroads.

You'll want to know: die Ampel

die Ampel — "traffic lights".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ampel ← Old High German *ampula* ← Latin *ampulla*, "small flask" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed. It named a hanging lamp in church before it named the traffic light.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Ampel*
- *Say it: die Ampel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Ampel*
- *Recall:* say the German for a corner, then the German for a crossroads, then say *die Ampel* again

Before you move on

What does die Ampel mean? ("Traffic lights".) Say it once more.

107.5 der Parkplatz — a car park

Before the new one: say the German for a crossroads, then the German for traffic lights.

You'll want to know: der Parkplatz

der Parkplatz — "a car park".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Parkplatz is *park-*, from English "to park", + *Platz*, "place" (EtymDB 2.1 links *Parkplatz* to *Platz*). *Platz* ← Latin *platēa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Parkplatz*
- *Say it: der Parkplatz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Parkplatz*
- *Recall:* say the German for a crossroads, then the German for traffic lights, then say *der Parkplatz* again

Before you move on

What does der Parkplatz mean? ("A car park".) Say it once more.

Chapter 108

North, South, East, West, Straight on

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say the north, the south, the east, the west and straight on.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 108: I can say the north, the south, the east, the west and straight on.*

108.1 der Norden — the north

> Before the new one: say the German for traffic lights, then the German for a car park.
>
> Two old family words from earlier chapters: say *die Katze*, then the colour *gelb*.

You'll want to know: der Norden

der Norden — "the north".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Norden ← Old High German *nordan*, "from the north" — inherited. EtymDB 2.1 traces English *north* to Proto-Germanic **nurþrą*: the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Norden*
- *Say it: der Norden*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Norden*
- *Recall:* say the German for traffic lights, then the German for a car park, then say *der Norden* again

Before you move on

What does der Norden mean? ("The north".) Say it once more.

108.2 der Süden — the south

Before the new one: say the German for a car park, then the German for the north.

You'll want to know: der Süden

der Süden — "the south".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Süden came into German through Middle Dutch *suden* (EtymDB 2.1). EtymDB traces English *south* to Proto-Germanic **sunþrą*, "southward", an adverb of **sunþaz*, "south", and lists German *Süd* beside it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Süden*
- *Say it: der Süden*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Süden*
- *Recall:* say the German for a car park, then the German for the north, then say *der Süden* again

Before you move on

What does der Süden mean? ("The south".) Say it once more.

108.3 der Osten — the east

Before the new one: say the German for the north, then the German for the south.

You'll want to know: der Osten

der Osten — "the east".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Osten is built on *Ost* ← Old High German *ōst* ← Proto-Germanic **austrą*, "east" — inherited, the same word as English *east*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Osten*
- *Say it: der Osten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Osten*
- *Recall:* say the German for the north, then the German for the south, then say *der Osten* again

Before you move on

What does der Osten mean? (“The east”.) Say it once more.

108.4 der Westen — the west

Before the new one: say the German for the south, then the German for the east.

You’ll want to know: der Westen

der Westen — “the west”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Westen is built on *West* ← Old High German *west* ← Proto-Germanic **westrą* — inherited, the same word as English *west*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Westen*
- *Say it: der Westen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Westen*
- *Recall:* say the German for the south, then the German for the east, then say *der Westen* again

Before you move on

What does der Westen mean? (“The west”.) Say it once more.

108.5 geradeaus — straight on

Before the new one: say the German for the east, then the German for the west.

You'll want to know: geradeaus

geradeaus — "straight on".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

geradeaus is built from the word for "straight" and the word for "out" (EtymDB 2.1): straight out ahead. The "out" word is the same as English *out*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *geradeaus*
- *Say it:* *geradeaus*, once more
- *Say it:* say *geradeaus*
- *Recall:* say the German for the east, then the German for the west, then say *geradeaus* again

Before you move on

What does geradeaus mean? ("Straight on".) Say it once more.

Chapter 109

Up, Down, At the front, At the back, Opposite

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say up, down, at the front, at the back and opposite.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 109: I can say up, down, at the front, at the back and opposite.*

109.1 oben — up, upstairs

> Before the new one: say the German for the west, then the German for straight on.

You'll want to know: oben

oben — "up, upstairs".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

oben ← Old High German *obana*, "from above" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, from the same root as English *over* and *above*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: oben*
- *Say it: oben*, once more
- *Say it:* say *oben*
- *Recall:* say the German for the west, then the German for straight on, then say *oben* again

Before you move on

What does oben mean? ("Up, upstairs".) Say it once more.

109.2 unten — down, downstairs

Before the new one: say the German for straight on, then the German for up.

You'll want to know: unten

unten — "down, downstairs".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

unten ← Old High German *untana*, "from below" — inherited, built on the root that gave English *under*, which EtymDB 2.1 traces to Proto-Germanic **under*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: unten*
- *Say it: unten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *unten*
- *Recall:* say the German for straight on, then the German for up, then say *unten* again

Before you move on

What does unten mean? (“Down, downstairs”.) Say it once more.

109.3 vorne — at the front

Before the new one: say the German for up, then the German for down.

You’ll want to know: vorne

vorne — “at the front”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vorne ← Old High German *forna*, “in front” — inherited, built on the word for “before”. EtymDB 2.1 lists that word beside Dutch *voor*; English *fore* is a cousin.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vorne*
- *Say it: vorne*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vorne*
- *Recall:* say the German for up, then the German for down, then say *vorne* again

Before you move on

What does vorne mean? (“At the front”.) Say it once more.

109.4 hinten — at the back

Before the new one: say the German for down, then the German for at the front.

You'll want to know: hinten

hinten — "at the back".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hinten ← Old High German *hintana*, "from behind" — inherited, a cousin of English *behind* and *hind*, which EtymDB 2.1 traces to Proto-Germanic **hinder*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hinten*
- *Say it: hinten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hinten*
- *Recall:* say the German for down, then the German for at the front, then say *hinten* again

Before you move on

What does hinten mean? ("At the back".) Say it once more.

109.5 gegenüber — opposite

Before the new one: say the German for at the front, then the German for at the back.

You'll want to know: gegenüber

gegenüber — "opposite".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gegenüber is the word for "toward, against", Old High German *gagan*, + the word for "over", Old High German *ubiri* (EtymDB 2.1): "over against" you.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gegenüber*
- *Say it: gegenüber*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gegenüber*
- *Recall:* say the German for at the front, then the German for at the back, then say *gegenüber* again

Before you move on

What does gegenüber mean? ("Opposite".) Say it once more.

Chapter 110

Next to, Between, Behind, Underground, Tram

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say next to, between, behind, the underground and a tram.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 110: I can say next to, between, behind, the underground and a tram.*

110.1 neben — next to

Before the new one: say the German for at the back, then the German for opposite.

You'll want to know: neben

neben — "next to".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

neben ← Middle High German *eneben*, "level with": *in* + the word for "even, level", which EtymDB 2.1 lists beside English *even*. Next to is "on a level with".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: neben*
- *Say it: neben*, once more
- *Say it:* say *neben*
- *Recall:* say the German for at the back, then the German for opposite, then say *neben* again

Before you move on

What does neben mean? (“Next to”.) Say it once more.

110.2 zwischen — between

Before the new one: say the German for opposite, then the German for next to.

You’ll want to know: zwischen

zwischen — “between”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

zwischen ← Old High German *in zwiskēn*, “among the two”, from *zwiski*, “twofold”, built on **twai*, “two” (EtymDB 2.1). Between is in the middle of two.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zwischen*
- *Say it: zwischen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zwischen*
- *Recall:* say the German for opposite, then the German for next to, then say *zwischen* again

Before you move on

What does zwischen mean? (“Between”.) Say it once more.

110.3 hinter — behind

Before the new one: say the German for next to, then the German for between.

You’ll want to know: hinter

hinter — “behind”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hinter ← Old High German *hintar* ← Proto-Germanic **hinder* — inherited, the same word as English *hinder*, “rear”, as in *hindquarters*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hinter*
- *Say it: hinter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hinter*
- *Recall:* say the German for next to, then the German for between, then say *hinter* again

Before you move on

What does hinter mean? (“Behind”.) Say it once more.

110.4 die U-Bahn — the underground

Before the new one: say the German for between, then the German for behind.

You'll want to know: die U-Bahn

die U-Bahn — "the underground".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

U-Bahn is short for "underground railway": the *U* is the first letter of the word for "underground". *Bahn* ← Old High German *bana* ← Proto-Germanic **banō*, "path, cleared way" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die U-Bahn*
- *Say it: die U-Bahn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die U-Bahn*
- *Recall:* say the German for between, then the German for behind, then say *die U-Bahn* again

Before you move on

What does die U-Bahn mean? ("The underground".) Say it once more.

110.5 die Straßenbahn — a tram

Before the new one: say the German for behind, then the German for the underground.

You'll want to know: die Straßenbahn

die Straßenbahn — "a tram".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Straßenbahn is the word for "street" + *Bahn*, "way, railway": a street railway. The "street" word ← Middle High German *strāze* (EtymDB 2.1), from Latin *strāta*, "paved road" — an early loan, like English *street*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Straßenbahn*
- *Say it: die Straßenbahn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Straßenbahn*
- *Recall:* say the German for behind, then the German for the underground, then say *die Straßenbahn* again

Before you move on

What does die Straßenbahn mean? ("A tram".) Say it once more.

Chapter 111

Taxi, Ticket, Suitcase, Lift, To fly

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a taxi, a ticket, a suitcase, a lift and to fly.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 111: I can say a taxi, a ticket, a suitcase, a lift and to fly.*

111.1 das Taxi — a taxi

Before the new one: say the German for the underground, then the German for a tram.

You'll want to know: das Taxi

das Taxi — "a taxi".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Taxi ← French *taxi* (EtymDB 2.1), short for *taximètre*, "fare meter", from *taxe*, "charge", and Greek *métron*, "measure" — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Taxi*
- *Say it: das Taxi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Taxi*
- *Recall:* say the German for the underground, then the German for a tram, then say *das Taxi* again

Before you move on

What does das Taxi mean? ("A taxi".) Say it once more.

111.2 die Fahrkarte — a ticket

Before the new one: say the German for a tram, then the German for a taxi.

You'll want to know: die Fahrkarte

die Fahrkarte — "a ticket".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Fahrkarte is *fahren*, "to travel", + *Karte*, "card": a card for the journey. *Karte* ← Latin *charta*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Fahrkarte*
- *Say it: die Fahrkarte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Fahrkarte*
- *Recall:* say the German for a tram, then the German for a taxi, then say *die Fahrkarte* again

Before you move on

What does die Fahrkarte mean? (“A ticket”.) Say it once more.

111.3 der Koffer — a suitcase

Before the new one: say the German for a taxi, then the German for a ticket.

You’ll want to know: der Koffer

der Koffer — “a suitcase”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Koffer ← French *coffre*, “chest” ← Latin *cophinus*, “basket” ← Greek *kóphinos* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed. English *coffer* and *coffin* come from the same word.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Koffer*
- *Say it: der Koffer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Koffer*
- *Recall:* say the German for a taxi, then the German for a ticket, then say *der Koffer* again

Before you move on

What does der Koffer mean? (“A suitcase”.) Say it once more.

111.4 der Aufzug — a lift

Before the new one: say the German for a ticket, then the German for a suitcase.

You'll want to know: der Aufzug

der Aufzug — "a lift".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Aufzug is *auf*, "up", + *Zug*, "a pull", the noun of the verb "to pull", Old High German *ziohan* ← Proto-Germanic **teuhanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1): what is pulled up.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Aufzug*
- *Say it: der Aufzug*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Aufzug*
- *Recall:* say the German for a ticket, then the German for a suitcase, then say *der Aufzug* again

Before you move on

What does der Aufzug mean? ("A lift".) Say it once more.

111.5 fliegen — to fly

Before the new one: say the German for a suitcase, then the German for a lift.

You'll want to know: fliegen

fliegen — "to fly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fliegen ← Old High German *fliogan* ← Proto-Germanic **fleuganǫ*, "to fly" — inherited, the same verb as English *fly*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fliegen*
- *Say it: fliegen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fliegen*
- *Recall:* say the German for a suitcase, then the German for a lift, then say *fliegen* again

Before you move on

What does fliegen mean? ("To fly".) Say it once more.

Chapter 112

Rug, Television, Computer, Fridge, Cooker

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a rug, a television, a computer, a fridge and a cooker.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 112: I can say a rug, a television, a computer, a fridge and a cooker.*

112.1 der Teppich — a rug, a carpet

Before the new one: say the German for a lift, then the German for to fly.

Read it: der Flughafen, das Hotel, das Kino aloud as one line, without stopping between the words

You'll want to know: der Teppich

der Teppich — "a rug, a carpet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Teppich ← Old High German *teppih*, from Latin *tapētum*, "carpet, tapestry" (EtymDB 2.1 has the Latin word), itself from Greek — borrowed. English *tapestry* shares the word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Teppich*
- *Say it: der Teppich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Teppich*
- *Recall:* say the German for a lift, then the German for to fly, then say *der Teppich* again

Before you move on

What does der Teppich mean? ("A rug, a carpet".) Say it once more.

112.2 der Fernseher — a television

Before the new one: say the German for to fly, then the German for a rug.

You'll want to know: der Fernseher

der Fernseher — "a television".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Fernseher is the word for "far" + *sehen*, "to see", + *-er*: "the far-seer". It translates *television* piece by piece, Greek *tēle*, "far", + Latin *vīsiō*, "seeing". *sehen* ← Proto-Germanic **sehwaną*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Fernseher*
- *Say it: der Fernseher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Fernseher*
- *Recall:* say the German for to fly, then the German for a rug, then say *der Fernseher* again

Before you move on

What does der Fernseher mean? ("A television".) Say it once more.

112.3 der Computer — a computer

Before the new one: say the German for a rug, then the German for a television.

You'll want to know: der Computer

der Computer — "a computer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Computer ← English *computer*, from *compute* + *-er* (EtymDB 2.1), and *compute* ← Latin *computāre*, "to reckon" — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Computer*
- *Say it: der Computer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Computer*
- *Recall:* say the German for a rug, then the German for a television, then say *der Computer* again

Before you move on

What does der Computer mean? ("A computer".) Say it once more.

112.4 der Kühlschrank — a fridge

Before the new one: say the German for a television, then the German for a computer.

You'll want to know: der Kühlschrank

der Kühlschrank — "a fridge".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kühlschrank is the word for "cool" + *Schrank*, "cupboard": a cooling cupboard. The "cool" word, Old High German *kuoli*, is listed in EtymDB 2.1 beside English *cool*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Kühlschrank*
- *Say it: der Kühlschrank*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Kühlschrank*
- *Recall:* say the German for a television, then the German for a computer, then say *der Kühlschrank* again

Before you move on

What does der Kühlschrank mean? ("A fridge".) Say it once more.

112.5 der Herd — a cooker

Before the new one: say the German for a computer, then the German for a fridge.

You'll want to know: der Herd

der Herd — "a cooker".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Herd ← Old High German *herd* ← Proto-Germanic **herþaz*, "hearth" — inherited, the same word as English *hearth*. (EtymDB 2.1) A cooker took over the hearth's job.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Herd*
- *Say it: der Herd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Herd*
- *Recall:* say the German for a computer, then the German for a fridge, then say *der Herd* again

Before you move on

What does der Herd mean? ("A cooker".) Say it once more.

Chapter 113

Shower, Bathtub, Shelf, Curtain, Cushion

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a shower, a bathtub, a shelf, a curtain and a cushion.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 113: I can say a shower, a bathtub, a shelf, a curtain and a cushion.*

113.1 die Dusche — a shower

> Before the new one: say the German for a fridge, then the German for a cooker.
>
> *Read it:* the two sentences aloud, as one run — *Das Hotel ist gegenüber. Das Kino ist hinten.*

You'll want to know: die Dusche

die Dusche — "a shower".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Dusche ← French *douche* ← Italian *doccia*, "water pipe", from Latin *ductus*, "a leading, a conduit" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Dusche*
- *Say it: die Dusche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Dusche*
- *Recall:* say the German for a fridge, then the German for a cooker, then say *die Dusche* again

Before you move on

What does die Dusche mean? ("A shower".) Say it once more.

113.2 die Badewanne — a bathtub

Before the new one: say the German for a cooker, then the German for a shower.

You'll want to know: die Badewanne

die Badewanne — "a bathtub".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Badewanne is "bath, to bathe" (see *Bad*) + *Wanne*, "tub" ← Old High German *wanna* ← Latin *vannus*, "winnowing basket" (EtymDB 2.1) — a borrowed vessel.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Badewanne*
- *Say it: die Badewanne*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Badewanne*
- *Recall:* say the German for a cooker, then the German for a shower, then say *die Badewanne* again

Before you move on

What does die Badewanne mean? (“A bathtub”.) Say it once more.

113.3 das Regal — a shelf

Before the new one: say the German for a shower, then the German for a bathtub.

You’ll want to know: das Regal

das Regal — “a shelf”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Regal, “shelf”, is a word of uncertain origin. EtymDB 2.1’s only row for *Regal* ties it to Latin *rēgālia*, “royal things”, which belongs to a different word, so no source is given here.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Regal*
- *Say it: das Regal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Regal*
- *Recall:* say the German for a shower, then the German for a bathtub, then say *das Regal* again

Before you move on

What does das Regal mean? (“A shelf”.) Say it once more.

113.4 der Vorhang — a curtain

Before the new one: say the German for a bathtub, then the German for a shelf.

You'll want to know: der Vorhang

der Vorhang — "a curtain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Vorhang is the word for "before, in front" + the stem of the verb "to hang" (Old High German *hengen*, EtymDB 2.1): what hangs in front.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Vorhang*
- *Say it: der Vorhang*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Vorhang*
- *Recall:* say the German for a bathtub, then the German for a shelf, then say *der Vorhang* again

Before you move on

What does der Vorhang mean? ("A curtain".) Say it once more.

113.5 das Kissen — a cushion, a pillow

Before the new one: say the German for a shelf, then the German for a curtain.

You'll want to know: das Kissen

das Kissen — "a cushion, a pillow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kissen ← Old High German *kussīn* (EtymDB 2.1), from Old French *coissin* — borrowed, like English *cushion*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Kissen*
- *Say it: das Kissen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Kissen*
- *Recall:* say the German for a shelf, then the German for a curtain, then say *das Kissen* again

Before you move on

What does das Kissen mean? ("A cushion, a pillow".) Say it once more.

113.6 Places and getting around — a first pass

Say the words for a curtain and a cushion.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- an airport, a square; a seat, a museum, a hotel, the post office; the post
- a restaurant, a bakery, a cinema, a theatre, a town hall
- a supermarket, a petrol station, a swimming pool, a stadium, a factory
- an office, a corner, a crossroads, traffic lights, a car park
- the north, the south, the east, the west, straight on

Before you move on

An airport? (**der Flughafen**.) A square; a seat? (**der Platz**.) A museum? (**das Museum**.) A hotel? (**das Hotel**.) The post office; the post? (**die Post**.) A restaurant? (**das Restaurant**.) A bakery? (**die Bäckerei**.) A cinema? (**das Kino**.) A theatre? (**das Theater**.) A town hall? (**das Rathaus**.) A supermarket? (**der Supermarkt**.) A petrol station? (**die Tankstelle**.) A swimming pool? (**das Schwimmbad**.) A stadium? (**das Stadion**.) A factory? (**die Fabrik**.) An office? (**das Büro**.) A corner? (**die Ecke**.) A crossroads? (**die Kreuzung**.) Traffic lights? (**die Ampel**.) A car park? (**der Parkplatz**.) The north? (**der Norden**.) The south? (**der Süden**.) The east? (**der Osten**.) The west? (**der Westen**.) Straight on? (**geradeaus**.)

113.7 The house and things you carry — a second pass

Say the words for up and down.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- up, down, at the front, at the back, opposite
- next to, between, behind, the underground, a tram
- a taxi, a ticket, a suitcase, a lift, to fly
- a rug, a television, a computer, a fridge, a cooker
- a shower, a bathtub, a shelf, a curtain, a cushion

Before you move on

Up? (**oben**.) Down? (**unten**.) At the front? (**vorne**.) At the back? (**hinten**.) Opposite? (**gegenüber**.) Next to? (**neben**.) Between? (**zwischen**.) Behind? (**hinter**.) The underground? (**die U-Bahn**.) A tram? (**die Straßenbahn**.) A taxi? (**das Taxi**.) A ticket? (**die Fahrkarte**.) A suitcase? (**der Koffer**.) A lift? (**der Aufzug**.) To

fly? (**fliegen**.) A rug? (**der Teppich**.) A television? (**der Fernseher**.) A computer? (**der Computer**.) A fridge? (**der Kühlschrank**.) A cooker? (**der Herd**.) A shower? (**die Dusche**.) A bathtub? (**die Badewanne**.) A shelf? (**das Regal**.) A curtain? (**der Vorhang**.) A cushion? (**das Kissen**.)

Chapter 114

Blanket, Towel, Soap, Toothbrush, Toothpaste

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a blanket, a towel, soap, a toothbrush and toothpaste.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 114: I can say a blanket, a towel, soap, a toothbrush and toothpaste.

114.1 die Decke — a blanket; a ceiling

Before the new one: say the German for a curtain, then the German for a cushion, a pillow.

You'll want to know: die Decke

die Decke — "a blanket; a ceiling".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Decke ← Old High German *decchī*, from the verb "to cover" ← Proto-Germanic **þakjaną*, built on **þaką*, "roof" (EtymDB 2.1) — a cousin of *Dach* and English *thatch*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Decke*
- *Say it: die Decke*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Decke*
- *Recall:* say the German for a curtain, then the German for a cushion, a pillow, then say *die Decke* again

Before you move on

What does die Decke mean? ("A blanket; a ceiling".) Say it once more.

114.2 das Handtuch — a towel

Before the new one: say the German for a cushion, a pillow, then the German for a blanket; a ceiling.

You'll want to know: das Handtuch

das Handtuch — "a towel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Handtuch is *Hand* + the word for "cloth", Old High German *tuoh* ← Proto-Germanic **dōkaz* (EtymDB 2.1): a cloth for the hands.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Handtuch*
- *Say it: das Handtuch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Handtuch*
- *Recall:* say the German for a cushion, a pillow, then the German for a blanket; a ceiling, then say *das Handtuch* again

Before you move on

What does das Handtuch mean? (“A towel”.) Say it once more.

114.3 die Seife — soap

Before the new one: say the German for a blanket; a ceiling, then the German for a towel.

You’ll want to know: die Seife

die Seife — “soap”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Seife ← Old High German *seifa* ← Proto-Germanic **saipōn*, “soap, salve” — inherited, the same word as English *soap*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Seife*
- *Say it: die Seife*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Seife*
- *Recall:* say the German for a blanket; a ceiling, then the German for a towel, then say *die Seife* again

Before you move on

What does die Seife mean? (“Soap”.) Say it once more.

114.4 die Zahnbürste — a toothbrush

Before the new one: say the German for a towel, then the German for soap.

You'll want to know: die Zahnbürste

die Zahnbürste — "a toothbrush".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Zahnbürste is *Zahn*, "tooth", + the word for "brush". *Zahn* ← Proto-Germanic **tanþs*, English *tooth*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Zahnbürste*
- *Say it: die Zahnbürste*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Zahnbürste*
- *Recall:* say the German for a towel, then the German for soap, then say *die Zahnbürste* again

Before you move on

What does die Zahnbürste mean? ("A toothbrush".) Say it once more.

114.5 die Zahnpasta — toothpaste

Before the new one: say the German for soap, then the German for a toothbrush.

You'll want to know: die Zahnpasta

die Zahnpasta — "toothpaste".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Zahnpasta is *Zahn*, "tooth", + *Pasta*, "paste", from Italian *pasta*. *Zahn* ← Proto-Germanic **tanþs*, English *tooth*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Zahnpasta*
- *Say it: die Zahnpasta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Zahnpasta*
- *Recall:* say the German for soap, then the German for a toothbrush, then say *die Zahnpasta* again

Before you move on

What does die Zahnpasta mean? ("Toothpaste".) Say it once more.

Chapter 115

Comb, Bin, Broom, Washing machine, Armchair

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a comb, a bin, a broom, a washing machine and an armchair.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 115: I can say a comb, a bin, a broom, a washing machine and an armchair.*

115.1 der Kamm — a comb

> Before the new one: say the German for a toothbrush, then the German for toothpaste.

You'll want to know: der Kamm

der Kamm — "a comb".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kamm ← Old High German *chamb* ← Proto-Germanic **kambaz*, "comb" — inherited, the same word as English *comb*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Kamm*
- *Say it: der Kamm*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Kamm*
- *Recall:* say the German for a toothbrush, then the German for toothpaste, then say *der Kamm* again

Before you move on

What does der Kamm mean? ("A comb".) Say it once more.

115.2 der Mülleimer — a bin

Before the new one: say the German for toothpaste, then the German for a comb.

You'll want to know: der Mülleimer

der Mülleimer — "a bin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mülleimer is the word for "rubbish" + the word for "bucket" (EtymDB 2.1). The bucket word, Middle High German *eimer*, goes back to Latin *amphora*, reshaped as if it meant "one-carrier".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Mülleimer*
- *Say it: der Mülleimer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Mülleimer*
- *Recall:* say the German for toothpaste, then the German for a comb, then say *der Mülleimer* again

Before you move on

What does der Mülleimer mean? ("A bin".) Say it once more.

115.3 der Besen — a broom

Before the new one: say the German for a comb, then the German for a bin.

You'll want to know: der Besen

der Besen — "a broom".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Besen ← Old High German *besamo* ← Proto-Germanic **besamô*, "broom" — inherited, the same word as English *besom*, a broom of twigs. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Besen*
- *Say it: der Besen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Besen*
- *Recall:* say the German for a comb, then the German for a bin, then say *der Besen* again

Before you move on

What does der Besen mean? ("A broom".) Say it once more.

115.4 die Waschmaschine — a washing machine

Before the new one: say the German for a bin, then the German for a broom.

You'll want to know: die Waschmaschine

die Waschmaschine — "a washing machine".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Waschmaschine is the verb "to wash", Old High German *wascan*, English *wash*, + the word for "machine" ← French *machine* ← Latin *māchina* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Waschmaschine*
- *Say it: die Waschmaschine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Waschmaschine*
- *Recall:* say the German for a bin, then the German for a broom, then say *die Waschmaschine* again

Before you move on

What does die Waschmaschine mean? ("A washing machine".) Say it once more.

115.5 der Sessel — an armchair

Before the new one: say the German for a broom, then the German for a washing machine.

You'll want to know: der Sessel

der Sessel — "an armchair".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Sessel ← Middle High German *sezzel* ← Proto-Germanic **setlaz*, "seat" — inherited, the same word as English *settle*, a long wooden

bench. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Sessel*
- *Say it: der Sessel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Sessel*
- *Recall:* say the German for a broom, then the German for a washing machine, then say *der Sessel* again

Before you move on

What does der Sessel mean? ("An armchair".) Say it once more.

Chapter 116

Alarm clock, Mobile phone, Camera, Glasses, Umbrella

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an alarm clock, a mobile phone, a camera, glasses and an umbrella.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 116: I can say an alarm clock, a mobile phone, a camera, glasses and an umbrella.*

116.1 der Wecker — an alarm clock

> Before the new one: say the German for a washing machine, then the German for an armchair.
>
> An alarm clock is for the morning: say *der Morgen*, then *der Tag*.

You'll want to know: der Wecker

der Wecker — "an alarm clock".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wecker is the verb "to wake someone" + *-er*: "the waker". The verb ← Old High German *wecchen* ← Proto-Germanic **wakjanǫ*, a cousin of English *wake*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Wecker*
- *Say it: der Wecker*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Wecker*
- *Recall:* say the German for a washing machine, then the German for an armchair, then say *der Wecker* again

Before you move on

What does der Wecker mean? ("An alarm clock".) Say it once more.

116.2 das Handy — a mobile phone

Before the new one: say the German for an armchair, then the German for an alarm clock.

You'll want to know: das Handy

das Handy — "a mobile phone".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Handy is taken from English *handy* (EtymDB 2.1), but German made it a noun for the mobile phone, a use English does not have.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Handy*
- *Say it: das Handy*, once more

- *Say it:* say *das Handy*
- *Recall:* say the German for an armchair, then the German for an alarm clock, then say *das Handy* again

Before you move on

What does das Handy mean? ("A mobile phone".) Say it once more.

116.3 die Kamera — a camera

Before the new one: say the German for an alarm clock, then the German for a mobile phone.

You'll want to know: die Kamera

die Kamera — "a camera".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kamera ← New Latin *camera obscura*, "dark chamber" ← Latin *camera*, "vaulted room" ← Greek *kamára* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: the first cameras were dark rooms.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Kamera*
- *Say it: die Kamera*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Kamera*
- *Recall:* say the German for an alarm clock, then the German for a mobile phone, then say *die Kamera* again

Before you move on

What does die Kamera mean? ("A camera".) Say it once more.

116.4 die Brille — glasses

Before the new one: say the German for a mobile phone, then the German for a camera.

You'll want to know: die Brille

die Brille — "glasses".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Brille ← Middle High German *brille* (EtymDB 2.1), from *berille*, "beryl", ← Latin *bēryllus*: the first eyeglass lenses were ground from beryl. Borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Brille*
- *Say it: die Brille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Brille*
- *Recall:* say the German for a mobile phone, then the German for a camera, then say *die Brille* again

Before you move on

What does die Brille mean? ("Glasses".) Say it once more.

116.5 der Regenschirm — an umbrella

Before the new one: say the German for a camera, then the German for glasses.

You'll want to know: der Regenschirm

der Regenschirm — "an umbrella".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Regenschirm is *Regen*, "rain", + *Schirm*, "screen, shield" (EtymDB 2.1): a shield against rain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Regenschirm*
- *Say it: der Regenschirm*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Regenschirm*
- *Recall:* say the German for a camera, then the German for glasses, then say *der Regenschirm* again

Before you move on

What does der Regenschirm mean? ("An umbrella".) Say it once more.

Chapter 117

Purse, Ring, Chain, Present, Photo

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a purse, a ring, a chain, a present and a photo.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 117: I can say a purse, a ring, a chain, a present and a photo.*

117.1 die Geldbörse — a purse, a wallet

Before the new one: say the German for glasses, then the German for an umbrella.

Say *der Abend*. Then: which of *der, die, das* goes with *Geldbörse*? (*die*.)

You'll want to know: die Geldbörse

die Geldbörse — "a purse, a wallet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Geldbörse is *Geld*, "money", + *Börse*, "purse", which came through Dutch and Old French from Late Latin *bursa*, "leather bag" (EtymDB 2.1). English *purse* shares it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Geldbörse*
- *Say it: die Geldbörse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Geldbörse*
- *Recall:* say the German for glasses, then the German for an umbrella, then say *die Geldbörse* again

Before you move on

What does die Geldbörse mean? ("A purse, a wallet".) Say it once more.

117.2 der Ring — a ring

Before the new one: say the German for an umbrella, then the German for a purse.

You'll want to know: der Ring

der Ring — "a ring".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ring ← Old High German *ring* — inherited. EtymDB 2.1 traces English *ring*, Old English *hring*, to Proto-Germanic **hringaz*, "something bent": the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Ring*

- *Say it: der Ring*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Ring*
- *Recall:* say the German for an umbrella, then the German for a purse, then say *der Ring* again

Before you move on

What does der Ring mean? (“A ring”.) Say it once more.

117.3 die Kette — a chain; a necklace

Before the new one: say the German for a purse, then the German for a ring.

You’ll want to know: die Kette

die Kette — “a chain; a necklace”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kette ← Middle High German *keten* (EtymDB 2.1), from Latin *catēna*, “chain” — borrowed. English *chain* comes from the same Latin word through French.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Kette*
- *Say it: die Kette*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Kette*
- *Recall:* say the German for a purse, then the German for a ring, then say *die Kette* again

Before you move on

What does die Kette mean? ("A chain; a necklace".) Say it once more.

117.4 das Geschenk — a present

Before the new one: say the German for a ring, then the German for a chain; a necklace.

You'll want to know: das Geschenk

das Geschenk — "a present".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Geschenk is *ge-* + the stem of the verb "to give as a present", which first meant "to pour out a drink for someone". A present began as a drink poured for a guest. *Schenken* ← Old High German *scenken*, "to pour, to give drink" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Geschenk*
- *Say it: das Geschenk*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Geschenk*
- *Recall:* say the German for a ring, then the German for a chain; a necklace, then say *das Geschenk* again

Before you move on

What does das Geschenk mean? ("A present".) Say it once more.

117.5 das Foto — a photo

Before the new one: say the German for a chain; a necklace, then the German for a present.

You'll want to know: das Foto

das Foto — "a photo".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Foto is short for the word for "photography", a modern coinage from Greek *phōs*, "light", and *gráphein*, "to write": writing with light. EtymDB 2.1 has no source for *Foto*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Foto*
- *Say it: das Foto*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Foto*
- *Recall:* say the German for a chain; a necklace, then the German for a present, then say *das Foto* again

Before you move on

What does das Foto mean? ("A photo".) Say it once more.

Chapter 118

Candle, Calendar, Jumper, Tie, Gloves

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a candle, a calendar, a jumper, a tie and gloves.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 118: I can say a candle, a calendar, a jumper, a tie and gloves.

118.1 die Kerze — a candle

Before the new one: say the German for a present, then the German for a photo.

You'll want to know: die Kerze

die Kerze — "a candle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kerze ← Middle High German *kerze* ← Old High German *kerza* (EtymDB 2.1). Its origin is uncertain; one account derives it from Latin *charta*, "papyrus", used as a wick.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Kerze*
- *Say it: die Kerze*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Kerze*
- *Recall:* say the German for a present, then the German for a photo, then say *die Kerze* again

Before you move on

What does die Kerze mean? (“A candle”.) Say it once more.

118.2 der Kalender — a calendar

Before the new one: say the German for a photo, then the German for a candle.

You’ll want to know: der Kalender

der Kalender — “a calendar”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kalender ← Latin *calendārium*, “account book”, from *calendae*, “the first day of the month”, when debts fell due (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Kalender*
- *Say it: der Kalender*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Kalender*
- *Recall:* say the German for a photo, then the German for a candle, then say *der Kalender* again

Before you move on

What does der Kalender mean? (“A calendar”.) Say it once more.

118.3 der Pullover — a jumper

Before the new one: say the German for a candle, then the German for a calendar.

You’ll want to know: der Pullover

der Pullover — “a jumper”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Pullover ← English *pullover*, from *pull* + *over* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: a garment you pull over your head.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Pullover*
- *Say it: der Pullover*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Pullover*
- *Recall:* say the German for a candle, then the German for a calendar, then say *der Pullover* again

Before you move on

What does der Pullover mean? (“A jumper”.) Say it once more.

118.4 die Krawatte — a tie

Before the new one: say the German for a calendar, then the German for a jumper.

You'll want to know: die Krawatte

die Krawatte — "a tie".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Krawatte ← French *cravate*, from the Croatian word for "Croat" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: the neckcloths of Croatian soldiers in French service set the fashion.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Krawatte*
- *Say it: die Krawatte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Krawatte*
- *Recall:* say the German for a calendar, then the German for a jumper, then say *die Krawatte* again

Before you move on

What does die Krawatte mean? ("A tie".) Say it once more.

118.5 die Handschuhe — gloves

Before the new one: say the German for a jumper, then the German for a tie.

You'll want to know: die Handschuhe

die Handschuhe — "gloves".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Handschuhe is the plural of *Handschuh* ← Middle High German *hantschuoch*: *Hand* + *Schuh* (EtymDB 2.1). A glove is a shoe for the hand.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Handschuhe*
- *Say it: die Handschuhe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Handschuhe*
- *Recall:* say the German for a jumper, then the German for a tie, then say *die Handschuhe* again

Before you move on

What does die Handschuhe mean? ("Gloves".) Say it once more.

Chapter 119

Scarf, Boots, Skirt, Coat, Shoes

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a scarf, boots, a skirt, a coat and shoes.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 119: I can say a scarf, boots, a skirt, a coat and shoes.*

119.1 der Schal — a scarf

> Before the new one: say the German for a tie, then the German for gloves.

You'll want to know: der Schal

der Schal — "a scarf".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schal ← English *shawl* ← Persian *šāl*, "shawl, scarf" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Schal*

- *Say it: der Schal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Schal*
- *Recall:* say the German for a tie, then the German for gloves, then say *der Schal* again

Before you move on

What does der Schal mean? ("A scarf".) Say it once more.

119.2 die Stiefel — boots

Before the new one: say the German for gloves, then the German for a scarf.

You'll want to know: die Stiefel

die Stiefel — "boots".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Stiefel ← Old High German *stival*, from Old French *estivel* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, probably from Latin *aestīvāle*, a light summer shoe.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Stiefel*
- *Say it: die Stiefel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Stiefel*
- *Recall:* say the German for gloves, then the German for a scarf, then say *die Stiefel* again

Before you move on

What does die Stiefel mean? ("Boots".) Say it once more.

119.3 der Rock — a skirt

Before the new one: say the German for a scarf, then the German for boots.

You'll want to know: der Rock

der Rock — "a skirt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Rock ← Old High German *roc*, "tunic" ← Proto-Germanic **hrukkaz*, "robe, tunic" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) It first named a coat and later a skirt.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Rock*
- *Say it: der Rock*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Rock*
- *Recall:* say the German for a scarf, then the German for boots, then say *der Rock* again

Before you move on

What does der Rock mean? ("A skirt".) Say it once more.

119.4 der Mantel — a coat

Before the new one: say the German for boots, then the German for a skirt.

You'll want to know: der Mantel

der Mantel — "a coat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mantel ← Old High German *mantal*, from Latin *mantellum*, "cloak" — borrowed, like English *mantle*. EtymDB 2.1 has the Latin word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Mantel*
- *Say it: der Mantel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Mantel*
- *Recall:* say the German for boots, then the German for a skirt, then say *der Mantel* again

Before you move on

What does der Mantel mean? ("A coat".) Say it once more.

119.5 die Schuhe — shoes

Before the new one: say the German for a skirt, then the German for a coat.

You'll want to know: die Schuhe

die Schuhe — "shoes".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schuhe is the plural of *Schuh* ← Old High German *scuoh* ← Proto-Germanic **skōhaz*, the same word as English *shoe*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Schuhe*
- *Say it: die Schuhe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Schuhe*
- *Recall:* say the German for a skirt, then the German for a coat, then say *die Schuhe* again

Before you move on

What does die Schuhe mean? (“Shoes”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 120

Socks, Blouse, Beef, Vegetables, Mushroom

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say socks, a blouse, beef, vegetables and a mushroom.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 120: I can say socks, a blouse, beef, vegetables and a mushroom.

120.1 die Socken — socks

Before the new one: say the German for a coat, then the German for shoes.

You'll want to know: die Socken

die Socken — "socks".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Socken is the plural of *Socke* ← Old High German *soc* ← Latin *soccus*, "slipper" (EtymDB 2.1) — an early loan, like English *sock*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Socken*
- *Say it: die Socken*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Socken*
- *Recall:* say the German for a coat, then the German for shoes, then say *die Socken* again

Before you move on

What does die Socken mean? ("Socks".) Say it once more.

120.2 die Bluse — a blouse

Before the new one: say the German for shoes, then the German for socks.

You'll want to know: die Bluse

die Bluse — "a blouse".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bluse ← French *blouse* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *blouse*. Where the French word came from is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Bluse*
- *Say it: die Bluse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Bluse*
- *Recall:* say the German for shoes, then the German for socks, then say *die Bluse* again

Before you move on

What does die Bluse mean? (“A blouse”.) Say it once more.

120.3 das Rindfleisch — beef

Before the new one: say the German for socks, then the German for a blouse.

You’ll want to know: das Rindfleisch

das Rindfleisch — “beef”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Rindfleisch is the word for “cattle”, Old High German *hrind* ← Proto-Germanic **hrinþaz*, + *Fleisch*, “meat” (EtymDB 2.1).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Rindfleisch*
- *Say it: das Rindfleisch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Rindfleisch*
- *Recall:* say the German for socks, then the German for a blouse, then say *das Rindfleisch* again

Before you move on

What does das Rindfleisch mean? (“Beef”.) Say it once more.

120.4 das Gemüse — vegetables

Before the new one: say the German for a blouse, then the German for beef.

You'll want to know: das Gemüse

das Gemüse — "vegetables".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gemüse ← Middle High German *gemüese*: *ge-* + the word for "mash, food", Old High German *muos* ← Proto-Germanic **mōsą* (EtymDB 2.1). Vegetables were what went into the pot.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Gemüse*
- *Say it: das Gemüse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Gemüse*
- *Recall:* say the German for a blouse, then the German for beef, then say *das Gemüse* again

Before you move on

What does das Gemüse mean? ("Vegetables".) Say it once more.

120.5 der Pilz — a mushroom

Before the new one: say the German for beef, then the German for vegetables.

You'll want to know: der Pilz

der Pilz — "a mushroom".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Pilz ← Old High German *buliz*, from Latin *bōlētus*, "edible mushroom" ← Greek *bōlítēs* — borrowed. EtymDB 2.1 has the Latin and Greek step.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Pilz*
- *Say it: der Pilz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Pilz*
- *Recall:* say the German for beef, then the German for vegetables, then say *der Pilz* again

Before you move on

What does der Pilz mean? ("A mushroom".) Say it once more.

Chapter 121

Beans, Cucumber, Strawberry, Cherry, Melon

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say beans, a cucumber, a strawberry, a cherry and a melon.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 121: I can say beans, a cucumber, a strawberry, a cherry and a melon.*

121.1 die Bohnen — beans

Before the new one: say the German for vegetables, then the German for a mushroom.

Beans come in the plural: say *die Bohnen* with its plural *die*, and then *die Jahre*.

You'll want to know: die Bohnen

die Bohnen — "beans".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bohnen is the plural of *Bohne* ← Old High German *bōna* ← Proto-Germanic **baunō* — inherited, the same word as English *bean*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Bohnen*
- *Say it: die Bohnen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Bohnen*
- *Recall:* say the German for vegetables, then the German for a mushroom, then say *die Bohnen* again

Before you move on

What does die Bohnen mean? ("Beans".) Say it once more.

121.2 die Gurke — a cucumber

Before the new one: say the German for a mushroom, then the German for beans.

You'll want to know: die Gurke

die Gurke — "a cucumber".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gurke came in from a West Slavic word, like Polish *ogórek*, which goes back to Medieval Greek — borrowed. EtymDB 2.1 has the German word but not its source.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Gurke*
- *Say it: die Gurke*, once more

- *Say it:* say *die Gurke*
- *Recall:* say the German for a mushroom, then the German for beans, then say *die Gurke* again

Before you move on

What does die Gurke mean? ("A cucumber".) Say it once more.

121.3 die Erdbeere — a strawberry

Before the new one: say the German for beans, then the German for a cucumber.

You'll want to know: die Erdbeere

die Erdbeere — "a strawberry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Erdbeere is the word for "earth", Old High German *erda*, English *earth*, + the word for "berry", English *berry* (EtymDB 2.1): the berry that grows on the ground.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Erdbeere*
- *Say it: die Erdbeere*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Erdbeere*
- *Recall:* say the German for beans, then the German for a cucumber, then say *die Erdbeere* again

Before you move on

What does die Erdbeere mean? ("A strawberry".) Say it once more.

121.4 die Kirsche — a cherry

Before the new one: say the German for a cucumber, then the German for a strawberry.

You'll want to know: die Kirsche

die Kirsche — "a cherry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kirsche ← Old High German *chirsa* ← Vulgar Latin *ceresia*, "cherry" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *cherry*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Kirsche*
- *Say it: die Kirsche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Kirsche*
- *Recall:* say the German for a cucumber, then the German for a strawberry, then say *die Kirsche* again

Before you move on

What does die Kirsche mean? ("A cherry".) Say it once more.

121.5 die Melone — a melon

Before the new one: say the German for a strawberry, then the German for a cherry.

You'll want to know: die Melone

die Melone — "a melon".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Melone ← Italian *melone* ← Latin *mēlo*, from Greek *mēlopépōn*, "apple-melon" — borrowed. EtymDB 2.1 has no row for the German word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *die Melone*
- *Say it:* *die Melone*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Melone*
- *Recall:* say the German for a strawberry, then the German for a cherry, then say *die Melone* again

Before you move on

What does die Melone mean? ("A melon".) Say it once more.

Chapter 122

Garlic, Flour, Chocolate, Biscuit, Bread roll

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say garlic, flour, chocolate, a biscuit and a bread roll.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 122: I can say garlic, flour, chocolate, a biscuit and a bread roll.

122.1 der Knoblauch — garlic

Before the new one: say the German for a cherry, then the German for a melon.

You'll want to know: der Knoblauch

der Knoblauch — "garlic".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Knoblauch ← Middle High German *knobelouch* (EtymDB 2.1), older *klobelouch*, "split leek" for its cloves: the "leek" word ← Proto-Germanic **laukaz*, English *leek*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Knoblauch*
- *Say it: der Knoblauch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Knoblauch*
- *Recall:* say the German for a cherry, then the German for a melon, then say *der Knoblauch* again

Before you move on

What does der Knoblauch mean? ("Garlic".) Say it once more.

122.2 das Mehl — flour

Before the new one: say the German for a melon, then the German for garlic.

You'll want to know: das Mehl

das Mehl — "flour".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mehl ← Old High German *melo* ← Proto-Germanic **melwą*, "meal, flour" — inherited, the same word as English *meal* in *oatmeal*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Mehl*
- *Say it: das Mehl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Mehl*
- *Recall:* say the German for a melon, then the German for garlic, then say *das Mehl* again

Before you move on

What does das Mehl mean? (“Flour”.) Say it once more.

122.3 die Schokolade — chocolate

Before the new one: say the German for garlic, then the German for flour.

You’ll want to know: die Schokolade

die Schokolade — “chocolate”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schokolade ← French *chocolat* ← Spanish *chocolate*, from a Nahuatl word (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Schokolade*
- *Say it: die Schokolade*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Schokolade*
- *Recall:* say the German for garlic, then the German for flour, then say *die Schokolade* again

Before you move on

What does die Schokolade mean? (“Chocolate”.) Say it once more.

122.4 der Keks — a biscuit

Before the new one: say the German for flour, then the German for chocolate.

You'll want to know: der Keks

der Keks — "a biscuit".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Keks ← English *cakes* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, and the English plural became a German singular.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Keks*
- *Say it: der Keks*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Keks*
- *Recall:* say the German for flour, then the German for chocolate, then say *der Keks* again

Before you move on

What does der Keks mean? ("A biscuit".) Say it once more.

122.5 das Brötchen — a bread roll

Before the new one: say the German for chocolate, then the German for a biscuit.

You'll want to know: das Brötchen

das Brötchen — "a bread roll".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Brötchen is *Brot* + *-chen*, "little": a little bread. *Brot* ← Proto-Germanic **braudą*, English *bread*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Brötchen*
- *Say it: das Brötchen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Brötchen*
- *Recall:* say the German for chocolate, then the German for a biscuit, then say *das Brötchen* again

Before you move on

What does das Brötchen mean? ("A bread roll".) Say it once more.

Chapter 123

Butter, Sauce, Vinegar, Dessert, Meal

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say butter, a sauce, vinegar, a dessert and a meal.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 123: I can say butter, a sauce, vinegar, a dessert and a meal.

123.1 die Butter — butter

Before the new one: say the German for a biscuit, then the German for a bread roll.

You'll want to know: die Butter

die Butter — "butter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Butter ← Old High German *butira* ← Latin *būtyrum* ← Greek *boútyron*, "cow cheese" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *butter*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Butter*
- *Say it: die Butter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Butter*
- *Recall:* say the German for a biscuit, then the German for a bread roll, then say *die Butter* again

Before you move on

What does die Butter mean? ("Butter".) Say it once more.

123.2 die Soße — a sauce

Before the new one: say the German for a bread roll, then the German for butter.

You'll want to know: die Soße

die Soße — "a sauce".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Soße ← French *sauce* ← Latin *salsa*, "salted (thing)" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *sauce*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Soße*
- *Say it: die Soße*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Soße*
- *Recall:* say the German for a bread roll, then the German for butter, then say *die Soße* again

Before you move on

What does die Soße mean? (“A sauce”.) Say it once more.

123.3 der Essig — vinegar

Before the new one: say the German for butter, then the German for a sauce.

You’ll want to know: der Essig

der Essig — “vinegar”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Essig ← Old High German *ezzih* ← Latin *acētum*, “vinegar” (EtymDB 2.1) — an early loan whose consonants swapped places.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Essig*
- *Say it: der Essig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Essig*
- *Recall:* say the German for butter, then the German for a sauce, then say *der Essig* again

Before you move on

What does der Essig mean? (“Vinegar”.) Say it once more.

123.4 der Nachtisch — a dessert

Before the new one: say the German for a sauce, then the German for vinegar.

You'll want to know: der Nachtisch

der Nachtisch — "a dessert".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Nachtisch is the word for "after" + *Tisch*, "table" (EtymDB 2.1): what comes after the meal.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Nachtisch*
- *Say it: der Nachtisch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Nachtisch*
- *Recall:* say the German for a sauce, then the German for vinegar, then say *der Nachtisch* again

Before you move on

What does der Nachtisch mean? ("A dessert".) Say it once more.

123.5 die Mahlzeit — a meal

Before the new one: say the German for vinegar, then the German for a dessert.

You'll want to know: die Mahlzeit

die Mahlzeit — "a meal".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mahlzeit is the word for "meal", English *meal*, + *Zeit*, "time": mealtime. EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *mealtide*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Mahlzeit*
- *Say it: die Mahlzeit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Mahlzeit*
- *Recall:* say the German for vinegar, then the German for a dessert, then say *die Mahlzeit* again

Before you move on

What does die Mahlzeit mean? ("A meal".) Say it once more.

123.6 Clothes, food and work — a first pass

Say the words for a dessert and a meal.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a blanket; a ceiling, a towel, soap, a toothbrush, toothpaste
- a comb, a bin, a broom, a washing machine, an armchair
- an alarm clock, a mobile phone, a camera, glasses, an umbrella
- a purse, a ring, a chain; a necklace, a present, a photo
- a candle, a calendar, a jumper, a tie, gloves

Before you move on

A blanket; a ceiling? (**die Decke**.) A towel? (**das Handtuch**.) Soap? (**die Seife**.) A toothbrush? (**die Zahnbürste**.) Toothpaste? (**die Zahnpasta**.) A comb? (**der Kamm**.) A bin? (**der Mülleimer**.) A broom? (**der Besen**.) A washing machine? (**die**

Waschmaschine.) An armchair? (**der Sessel**.) An alarm clock? (**der Wecker**.) A mobile phone? (**das Handy**.) A camera? (**die Kamera**.) Glasses? (**die Brille**.) An umbrella? (**der Regenschirm**.) A purse? (**die Geldbörse**.) A ring? (**der Ring**.) A chain; a necklace? (**die Kette**.) A present? (**das Geschenk**.) A photo? (**das Foto**.) A candle? (**die Kerze**.) A calendar? (**der Kalender**.) A jumper? (**der Pullover**.) A tie? (**die Krawatte**.) Gloves? (**die Handschuhe**.)

123.7 School, free time and colours — a second pass

Say the words for a scarf and boots.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a scarf, boots, a skirt, a coat, shoes
- socks, a blouse, beef, vegetables, a mushroom
- beans, a cucumber, a strawberry, a cherry, a melon
- garlic, flour, chocolate, a biscuit, a bread roll
- butter, a sauce, vinegar, a dessert, a meal

Before you move on

A scarf? (**der Schal**.) Boots? (**die Stiefel**.) A skirt? (**der Rock**.) A coat? (**der Mantel**.) Shoes? (**die Schuhe**.) Socks? (**die Socken**.) A blouse? (**die Bluse**.) Beef? (**das Rindfleisch**.) Vegetables? (**das Gemüse**.) A mushroom? (**der Pilz**.) Beans? (**die Bohnen**.) A cucumber? (**die Gurke**.) A strawberry? (**die Erdbeere**.) A cherry? (**die Kirsche**.) A melon? (**die Melone**.) Garlic? (**der Knoblauch**.) Flour? (**das Mehl**.) Chocolate? (**die Schokolade**.) A biscuit? (**der Keks**.) A bread roll? (**das Brötchen**.) Butter? (**die Butter**.) A sauce? (**die Soße**.) Vinegar? (**der Essig**.) A dessert? (**der Nachtisch**.) A meal? (**die**

Mahlzeit.)

Chapter 124

Yoghurt, Nurse, Cook, Police officer, Shop assistant

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a yoghurt, a nurse, a cook, a police officer and a shop assistant.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 124: I can say a yoghurt, a nurse, a cook, a police officer and a shop assistant.*

124.1 der Joghurt — a yoghurt

> Before the new one: say the German for a dessert, then the German for a meal.
>
> From the animal and colour chapters: say *die Katze* and *gelb* once more.

You'll want to know: der Joghurt

der Joghurt — "a yoghurt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Joghurt ← Turkish *yoğurt* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Joghurt*
- *Say it: der Joghurt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Joghurt*
- *Recall:* say the German for a dessert, then the German for a meal, then say *der Joghurt* again

Before you move on

What does der Joghurt mean? ("A yoghurt".) Say it once more.

124.2 die Krankenschwester — a nurse

Before the new one: say the German for a meal, then the German for a yoghurt.

You'll want to know: die Krankenschwester

die Krankenschwester — "a nurse".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Krankenschwester is *krank*, "ill", + *Schwester*, "sister": the sister who tends the sick, a title from nursing orders. *Schwester* ← Proto-Germanic **swestēr* (EtymDB 2.1), the same word as English *sister*; *krank* ← Old High German *krank*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Krankenschwester*
- *Say it: die Krankenschwester*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Krankenschwester*

- *Recall:* say the German for a meal, then the German for a yoghurt, then say *die Krankenschwester* again

Before you move on

What does die Krankenschwester mean? ("A nurse".) Say it once more.

124.3 der Koch — a cook

Before the new one: say the German for a yoghurt, then the German for a nurse.

You'll want to know: der Koch

der Koch — "a cook".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Koch ← Old High German *koch* ← Latin *coquus*, "cook" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *cook*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Koch*
- *Say it: der Koch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Koch*
- *Recall:* say the German for a yoghurt, then the German for a nurse, then say *der Koch* again

Before you move on

What does der Koch mean? ("A cook".) Say it once more.

124.4 der Polizist — a police officer

Before the new one: say the German for a nurse, then the German for a cook.

You'll want to know: der Polizist

der Polizist — "a police officer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Polizist is *Polizei* + *-ist*, the ending for a person who does a job. *Polizei* ← Medieval Latin *politia* ← Greek *politeía*, "government". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Polizist*
- *Say it: der Polizist*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Polizist*
- *Recall:* say the German for a nurse, then the German for a cook, then say *der Polizist* again

Before you move on

What does der Polizist mean? ("A police officer".) Say it once more.

124.5 der Verkäufer — a shop assistant

Before the new one: say the German for a cook, then the German for a police officer.

You'll want to know: der Verkäufer

der Verkäufer — "a shop assistant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Verkäufer is the verb "to sell" + *-er*: the seller. That verb is *ver-*, "away", + *kaufen*, "to buy", which goes back to Latin *caupō*, "tradesman" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Verkäufer*
- *Say it: der Verkäufer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Verkäufer*
- *Recall:* say the German for a cook, then the German for a police officer, then say *der Verkäufer* again

Before you move on

What does der Verkäufer mean? ("A shop assistant".) Say it once more.

Chapter 125

Farmer, Baker, Driver, Lawyer, Engineer

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a farmer, a baker, a driver, a lawyer and an engineer.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 125: I can say a farmer, a baker, a driver, a lawyer and an engineer.

125.1 der Bauer — a farmer

Before the new one: say the German for a police officer, then the German for a shop assistant.

You'll want to know: der Bauer

der Bauer — "a farmer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bauer ← Middle High German *būr*, *gebūre* ← Old High German *būr*, "peasant" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, from a root meaning "to dwell, to farm". English *neighbour* hides the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Bauer*
- *Say it: der Bauer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Bauer*
- *Recall:* say the German for a police officer, then the German for a shop assistant, then say *der Bauer* again

Before you move on

What does der Bauer mean? ("A farmer".) Say it once more.

125.2 der Bäcker — a baker

Before the new one: say the German for a shop assistant, then the German for a farmer.

You'll want to know: der Bäcker

der Bäcker — "a baker".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bäcker is the verb "to bake" + *-er*: the one who bakes. The verb ← Old High German *backan*, the same verb as English *bake*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Bäcker*
- *Say it: der Bäcker*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Bäcker*
- *Recall:* say the German for a shop assistant, then the German for a farmer, then say *der Bäcker* again

Before you move on

What does der Bäcker mean? ("A baker".) Say it once more.

125.3 der Fahrer — a driver

Before the new one: say the German for a farmer, then the German for a baker.

You'll want to know: der Fahrer

der Fahrer — "a driver".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Fahrer is *fahren*, "to travel, to drive", + *-er*: the driver. EtymDB 2.1 lists *fahren* beside English *fare*, as in "farewell".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Fahrer*
- *Say it: der Fahrer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Fahrer*
- *Recall:* say the German for a farmer, then the German for a baker, then say *der Fahrer* again

Before you move on

What does der Fahrer mean? ("A driver".) Say it once more.

125.4 der Anwalt — a lawyer

Before the new one: say the German for a baker, then the German for a driver.

You'll want to know: der Anwalt

der Anwalt — "a lawyer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Anwalt ← Middle High German *anwalte*, "one who acts with authority": *an-* + the verb "to rule, to have power", Old High German *waltan* ← Proto-Germanic **waldanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Anwalt*
- *Say it: der Anwalt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Anwalt*
- *Recall:* say the German for a baker, then the German for a driver, then say *der Anwalt* again

Before you move on

What does der Anwalt mean? ("A lawyer".) Say it once more.

125.5 der Ingenieur — an engineer

Before the new one: say the German for a driver, then the German for a lawyer.

You'll want to know: der Ingenieur

der Ingenieur — "an engineer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ingenieur ← French *ingénieur* (EtymDB 2.1), from Latin *ingenium*, "inborn talent, invention" — borrowed. English *engineer* and *engine* share the Latin word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Ingenieur*
- *Say it: der Ingenieur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Ingenieur*
- *Recall:* say the German for a driver, then the German for a lawyer, then say *der Ingenieur* again

Before you move on

What does der Ingenieur mean? ("An engineer".) Say it once more.

Chapter 126

Postman, Waiter, Customer, Till, Boss

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a postman, a waiter, a customer, a till and a boss.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 126: I can say a postman, a waiter, a customer, a till and a boss.*

126.1 der Briefträger — a postman

Before the new one: say the German for a lawyer, then the German for an engineer.

You'll want to know: der Briefträger

der Briefträger — "a postman".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Briefträger is the word for "letter" + *Träger*, "carrier", from *tragen*. The letter word ← Old High German *briaf* ← Latin *brevis*, "short (document)" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Briefträger*
- *Say it: der Briefträger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Briefträger*
- *Recall:* say the German for a lawyer, then the German for an engineer, then say *der Briefträger* again

Before you move on

What does der Briefträger mean? ("A postman".) Say it once more.

126.2 der Kellner — a waiter

Before the new one: say the German for an engineer, then the German for a postman.

You'll want to know: der Kellner

der Kellner — "a waiter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kellner ← Old High German *kelnere* ← Medieval Latin *cellenārius*, "cellar master" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: the man who kept the wine cellar.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Kellner*
- *Say it: der Kellner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Kellner*
- *Recall:* say the German for an engineer, then the German for a postman, then say *der Kellner* again

Before you move on

What does der Kellner mean? ("A waiter".) Say it once more.

126.3 der Kunde — a customer

Before the new one: say the German for a postman, then the German for a waiter.

You'll want to know: der Kunde

der Kunde — "a customer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kunde ← Old High German *cundo*, "one who is known", from *kund*, "known" ← Proto-Germanic **kunþaz* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited. English *uncouth*, "unknown, strange", shares the root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Kunde*
- *Say it: der Kunde*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Kunde*
- *Recall:* say the German for a postman, then the German for a waiter, then say *der Kunde* again

Before you move on

What does der Kunde mean? ("A customer".) Say it once more.

126.4 die Kasse — a till, a checkout

Before the new one: say the German for a waiter, then the German for a customer.

You'll want to know: die Kasse

die Kasse — "a till, a checkout".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kasse ← Italian *cassa*, "box" ← Latin *capsa*, "case, box" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed. English *cash* and *case* come from the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Kasse*
- *Say it: die Kasse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Kasse*
- *Recall:* say the German for a waiter, then the German for a customer, then say *die Kasse* again

Before you move on

What does die Kasse mean? ("A till, a checkout".) Say it once more.

126.5 der Chef — a boss

Before the new one: say the German for a customer, then the German for a till.

You'll want to know: der Chef

der Chef — "a boss".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Chef ← French *chef*, "head" ← Latin *caput* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed. English *chief* is the same word; English *chef* kept only the kitchen sense.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Chef*
- *Say it: der Chef*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Chef*
- *Recall:* say the German for a customer, then the German for a till, then say *der Chef* again

Before you move on

What does der Chef mean? ("A boss".) Say it once more.

Chapter 127

Job, Class, Exam, Board, Rubber

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a job, a class, an exam, a board and a rubber.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 127: I can say a job, a class, an exam, a board and a rubber.*

127.1 der Beruf — a job, a profession

Before the new one: say the German for a till, then the German for a boss.

You'll want to know: der Beruf

der Beruf — "a job, a profession".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Beruf is *be-* + the noun of *rufen*, "to call", Old High German *hruof* (EtymDB 2.1): a calling, the sense Luther gave the word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Beruf*
- *Say it: der Beruf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Beruf*
- *Recall:* say the German for a till, then the German for a boss, then say *der Beruf* again

Before you move on

What does der Beruf mean? ("A job, a profession".) Say it once more.

127.2 die Klasse — a class

Before the new one: say the German for a boss, then the German for a job.

You'll want to know: die Klasse

die Klasse — "a class".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Klasse ← Latin *classis*, "a division of the Roman people" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed through French, like English *class*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Klasse*
- *Say it: die Klasse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Klasse*
- *Recall:* say the German for a boss, then the German for a job, then say *die Klasse* again

Before you move on

What does die Klasse mean? ("A class".) Say it once more.

127.3 die Prüfung — an exam

Before the new one: say the German for a job, then the German for a class.

You'll want to know: die Prüfung

die Prüfung — "an exam".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Prüfung is the verb "to test" + *-ung*. The verb ← Middle High German *brüeven* (EtymDB 2.1), from Old French *prover* ← Latin *probāre*, "to test" — borrowed, like English *prove*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Prüfung*
- *Say it: die Prüfung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Prüfung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a job, then the German for a class, then say *die Prüfung* again

Before you move on

What does die Prüfung mean? ("An exam".) Say it once more.

127.4 die Tafel — a board

Before the new one: say the German for a class, then the German for an exam.

You'll want to know: die Tafel

die Tafel — "a board".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Tafel ← Old High German *tavala* (EtymDB 2.1), from Latin *tabula*, "board, tablet" — borrowed, like English *table*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Tafel*
- *Say it: die Tafel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Tafel*
- *Recall:* say the German for a class, then the German for an exam, then say *die Tafel* again

Before you move on

What does die Tafel mean? ("A board".) Say it once more.

127.5 der Radiergummi — a rubber, an eraser

Before the new one: say the German for an exam, then the German for a board.

You'll want to know: der Radiergummi

der Radiergummi — "a rubber, an eraser".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Radiergummi is the verb "to rub out", from Latin *rādere*, "to scrape", + *Gummi*, "rubber" ← Latin *cummi* ← Greek *kómmi* (EtymDB 2.1): a rubber for erasing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Radiergummi*
- *Say it: der Radiergummi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Radiergummi*
- *Recall:* say the German for an exam, then the German for a board, then say *der Radiergummi* again

Before you move on

What does der Radiergummi mean? ("A rubber, an eraser".) Say it once more.

Chapter 128

Homework, Idea, Sentence, Page, Drawing

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say homework, an idea, a sentence, a page and a drawing.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 128: I can say homework, an idea, a sentence, a page and a drawing.

128.1 die Hausaufgabe — homework

Before the new one: say the German for a board, then the German for a rubber.

You'll want to know: die Hausaufgabe

die Hausaufgabe — "homework".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Hausaufgabe is the word for "house" + the word for "task", itself built from "up" and "to give": a task given out to be done at home.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Hausaufgabe*
- *Say it: die Hausaufgabe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Hausaufgabe*
- *Recall:* say the German for a board, then the German for a rubber, then say *die Hausaufgabe* again

Before you move on

What does die Hausaufgabe mean? ("Homework".) Say it once more.

128.2 die Idee — an idea

Before the new one: say the German for a rubber, then the German for homework.

You'll want to know: die Idee

die Idee — "an idea".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Idee ← French *idée* ← Latin *idea* ← Greek *idéa*, "form, pattern" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Idee*
- *Say it: die Idee*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Idee*
- *Recall:* say the German for a rubber, then the German for homework, then say *die Idee* again

Before you move on

What does die Idee mean? ("An idea".) Say it once more.

128.3 der Satz — a sentence

Before the new one: say the German for homework, then the German for an idea.

You'll want to know: der Satz

der Satz — "a sentence".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Satz ← Middle High German *saz*, "what is set", from the verb "to set", Old High German *sezzen* ← Proto-Germanic **satjanǫ*, English *set* (EtymDB 2.1). A sentence is words set together.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Satz*
- *Say it: der Satz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Satz*
- *Recall:* say the German for homework, then the German for an idea, then say *der Satz* again

Before you move on

What does der Satz mean? ("A sentence".) Say it once more.

128.4 die Seite — a page; a side

Before the new one: say the German for an idea, then the German for a sentence.

You'll want to know: die Seite

die Seite — "a page; a side".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Seite ← Old High German *sīta* ← Proto-Germanic **sīdōn*, "side, flank" — inherited, the same word as English *side*. (EtymDB 2.1) A page is one side of a leaf.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Seite*
- *Say it: die Seite*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Seite*
- *Recall:* say the German for an idea, then the German for a sentence, then say *die Seite* again

Before you move on

What does die Seite mean? ("A page; a side".) Say it once more.

128.5 die Zeichnung — a drawing

Before the new one: say the German for a sentence, then the German for a page; a side.

You'll want to know: die Zeichnung

die Zeichnung — "a drawing".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Zeichnung is the verb "to draw" + *-ung*. The verb is built on the word for "a sign", Old High German *zeihhan* ← Proto-Germanic **taiknǫ*, the same word as English *token*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Zeichnung*
- *Say it: die Zeichnung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Zeichnung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a sentence, then the German for a page; a side, then say *die Zeichnung* again

Before you move on

What does die Zeichnung mean? ("A drawing".) Say it once more.

Chapter 129

Sport, Film, Football, Concert, Celebration

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say sport, a film, football, a concert and a celebration.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 129: I can say sport, a film, football, a concert and a celebration.*

129.1 der Sport — sport

Before the new one: say the German for a page; a side, then the German for a drawing.

You'll want to know: der Sport

der Sport — "sport".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Sport ← English *sport* (EtymDB 2.1), short for *disport*, "amusement" — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Sport*
- *Say it: der Sport*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Sport*
- *Recall:* say the German for a page; a side, then the German for a drawing, then say *der Sport* again

Before you move on

What does der Sport mean? ("Sport".) Say it once more.

129.2 der Film — a film

Before the new one: say the German for a drawing, then the German for sport.

You'll want to know: der Film

der Film — "a film".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Film ← English *film*, Old English *filmen*, "thin skin" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: the coated strip in the camera.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Film*
- *Say it: der Film*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Film*
- *Recall:* say the German for a drawing, then the German for sport, then say *der Film* again

Before you move on

What does der Film mean? ("A film".) Say it once more.

129.3 der Fußball — football

Before the new one: say the German for sport, then the German for a film.

You'll want to know: der Fußball

der Fußball — "football".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Fußball is *Fuß*, "foot", + *Ball* ← Old High German *bal* ← Proto-Germanic **balluz* (EtymDB 2.1), built after English *football*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Fußball*
- *Say it: der Fußball*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Fußball*
- *Recall:* say the German for sport, then the German for a film, then say *der Fußball* again

Before you move on

What does der Fußball mean? ("Football".) Say it once more.

129.4 das Konzert — a concert

Before the new one: say the German for a film, then the German for football.

You'll want to know: das Konzert

das Konzert — "a concert".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Konzert ← Italian *concerto*, "agreement, playing together" — borrowed. EtymDB 2.1 has the Italian word but not its Latin source.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Konzert*
- *Say it: das Konzert*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Konzert*
- *Recall:* say the German for a film, then the German for football, then say *das Konzert* again

Before you move on

What does das Konzert mean? ("A concert".) Say it once more.

129.5 das Fest — a celebration, a festival

Before the new one: say the German for football, then the German for a concert.

You'll want to know: das Fest

das Fest — "a celebration, a festival".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Fest ← Middle High German *fëst* ← Latin *fēstum*, "holiday, feast" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed. English *feast* and *festival* share the word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Fest*
- *Say it: das Fest*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Fest*
- *Recall:* say the German for football, then the German for a concert, then say *das Fest* again

Before you move on

What does das Fest mean? ("A celebration, a festival".) Say it once more.

Chapter 130

Pink, Orange, Pretty, Round, Wide

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say pink, orange, pretty, round and wide.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 130: I can say pink, orange, pretty, round and wide.*

130.1 rosa — pink

Before the new one: say the German for a concert, then the German for a celebration.

Count *eins*, then say *ein*, the same word with its counting -s dropped. Then say *sieben*, with the s that buzzes.

You'll want to know: rosa

rosa — "pink".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rosa is Latin *rosa*, "rose": the colour of the flower — borrowed. EtymDB 2.1 has the German word but not its Latin source.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rosa*
- *Say it: rosa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rosa*
- *Recall:* say the German for a concert, then the German for a celebration, then say *rosa* again

Before you move on

What does rosa mean? (“Pink”.) Say it once more.

130.2 orange — orange (the colour)

Before the new one: say the German for a celebration, then the German for pink.

You’ll want to know: orange

orange — “orange (the colour)”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

orange ← French *orange*, the fruit (EtymDB 2.1), whose name came west from Persian *nārang* through Arabic — borrowed; the colour is named after the fruit.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: orange*
- *Say it: orange*, once more
- *Say it:* say *orange*
- *Recall:* say the German for a celebration, then the German for pink, then say *orange* again

Before you move on

What does orange mean? (“Orange (the colour)”.) Say it once more.

130.3 hübsch — pretty

Before the new one: say the German for pink, then the German for orange.

You’ll want to know: hübsch

hübsch — “pretty”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hübsch ← Middle High German *hübesch*, “courtly” (EtymDB 2.1), built on the word for “court”, itself copying French *courtois*. Pretty was what suited the court.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hübsch*
- *Say it: hübsch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hübsch*
- *Recall:* say the German for pink, then the German for orange, then say *hübsch* again

Before you move on

What does hübsch mean? (“Pretty”.) Say it once more.

130.4 rund — round

Before the new one: say the German for orange, then the German for pretty.

You'll want to know: rund

rund — "round".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rund ← Middle High German *runt* ← Old French *ront*, "circular" (EtymDB 2.1), from Latin *rotundus* — borrowed, like English *round*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rund*
- *Say it: rund*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rund*
- *Recall:* say the German for orange, then the German for pretty, then say *rund* again

Before you move on

What does rund mean? ("Round".) Say it once more.

130.5 breit — wide

Before the new one: say the German for pretty, then the German for round.

You'll want to know: breit

breit — "wide".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

breit ← Old High German *breit* ← Proto-Germanic **braidaz* — inherited, the same word as English *broad*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: breit*
- *Say it: breit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *breit*
- *Recall:* say the German for pretty, then the German for round, then say *breit* again

Before you move on

What does breit mean? ("Wide".) Say it once more.

Chapter 131

Busy, Free, Closed, Quiet, Narrow

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say busy, free, closed, quiet and narrow.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 131: I can say busy, free, closed, quiet and narrow.*

131.1 beschäftigt — busy

Before the new one: say the German for round, then the German for wide.

Say *sechs*, where chs sounds as an x, and then *haben*.

You'll want to know: beschäftigt

beschäftigt — "busy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

beschäftigt means "kept busy", from the verb built on the word for "business", Old High German *giscaft*, and that from the verb "to make, to create", Old High German *scaffan*, English *shape* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: beschäftigt*
- *Say it: beschäftigt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *beschäftigt*
- *Recall:* say the German for round, then the German for wide, then say *beschäftigt* again

Before you move on

What does beschäftigt mean? ("Busy".) Say it once more.

131.2 frei — free

Before the new one: say the German for wide, then the German for busy.

You'll want to know: frei

frei — "free".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

frei ← Old High German *frī* — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *free* and Dutch *vrij*, all from Proto-Germanic **frijaz*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: frei*
- *Say it: frei*, once more
- *Say it:* say *frei*
- *Recall:* say the German for wide, then the German for busy, then say *frei* again

Before you move on

What does frei mean? (“Free”.) Say it once more.

131.3 geschlossen — closed

Before the new one: say the German for busy, then the German for free.

You’ll want to know: geschlossen

geschlossen — “closed”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

geschlossen is the past participle of *schließen*, “to close” ← Old High German *sliozan* ← Proto-Germanic **sleutanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: geschlossen*
- *Say it: geschlossen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *geschlossen*
- *Recall:* say the German for busy, then the German for free, then say *geschlossen* again

Before you move on

What does geschlossen mean? (“Closed”.) Say it once more.

131.4 ruhig — quiet, calm

Before the new one: say the German for free, then the German for closed.

You'll want to know: ruhig

ruhig — "quiet, calm".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ruhig ← Middle High German *ruowec*: the word for "rest, quiet", Old High German *ruowa* ← Proto-Germanic **rōwō*, + *-ig* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ruhig*
- *Say it: ruhig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ruhig*
- *Recall:* say the German for free, then the German for closed, then say *ruhig* again

Before you move on

What does ruhig mean? ("Quiet, calm".) Say it once more.

131.5 eng — narrow; tight

Before the new one: say the German for closed, then the German for quiet.

You'll want to know: eng

eng — "narrow; tight".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

eng ← Old High German *engi* ← Proto-Germanic **anguz*, "narrow" — inherited, from the same root as *Angst*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: eng*
- *Say it: eng*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eng*
- *Recall:* say the German for closed, then the German for quiet, then say *eng* again

Before you move on

What does eng mean? ("Narrow; tight".) Say it once more.

Chapter 132

Hard-working, Lazy, Awake, Nice, Friendly

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say hard-working, lazy, awake, nice and friendly.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 132: I can say hard-working, lazy, awake, nice and friendly.

132.1 fleißig — hard-working

Before the new one: say the German for quiet, then the German for narrow; tight.

You'll want to know: fleißig

fleißig — "hard-working".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fleißig is the word for "diligence" + *-ig*. That word ← Middle High German *vlīz*, "zeal, effort" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fleißig*
- *Say it: fleißig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fleißig*
- *Recall:* say the German for quiet, then the German for narrow; tight, then say *fleißig* again

Before you move on

What does fleißig mean? (“Hard-working”.) Say it once more.

132.2 faul — lazy

Before the new one: say the German for narrow; tight, then the German for hard-working.

You’ll want to know: faul

faul — “lazy”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

faul ← Old High German *fūl*, “rotten” ← Proto-Germanic **fūlaz* — inherited, the same word as English *foul*. (EtymDB 2.1) “Lazy” grew out of “rotten, sluggish”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: faul*
- *Say it: faul*, once more
- *Say it:* say *faul*
- *Recall:* say the German for narrow; tight, then the German for hard-working, then say *faul* again

Before you move on

What does faul mean? (“Lazy”.) Say it once more.

132.3 wach — awake

Before the new one: say the German for hard-working, then the German for lazy.

You’ll want to know: wach

wach — “awake”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wach comes from the verb “to be awake, to keep watch”, Old High German *wahhēn*, which EtymDB 2.1 lists beside English *wake* and *watch*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: wach*
- *Say it: wach*, once more
- *Say it:* say *wach*
- *Recall:* say the German for hard-working, then the German for lazy, then say *wach* again

Before you move on

What does wach mean? (“Awake”.) Say it once more.

132.4 nett — nice, kind

Before the new one: say the German for lazy, then the German for awake.

You'll want to know: nett

nett — "nice, kind".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nett ← Middle Dutch *net* ← Old French *net*, "neat, clean" ← Latin *nitidus*, "shining" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed. English *neat* is the same French word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nett*
- *Say it: nett*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nett*
- *Recall:* say the German for lazy, then the German for awake, then say *nett* again

Before you move on

What does nett mean? ("Nice, kind".) Say it once more.

132.5 freundlich — friendly

Before the new one: say the German for awake, then the German for nice.

You'll want to know: freundlich

freundlich — "friendly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

freundlich ← Middle High German *vriuntlich*: *Freund* + *-lich*, built like English *friendly*. *Freund* ← Proto-Germanic **frijōndz*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: freundlich*
- *Say it: freundlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *freundlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for awake, then the German for nice, then say *freundlich* again

Before you move on

What does freundlich mean? ("Friendly".) Say it once more.

132.6 Describing people and things — a first pass

Say the words for nice and friendly.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a yoghurt, a nurse, a cook, a police officer, a shop assistant
- a farmer, a baker, a driver, a lawyer, an engineer
- a postman, a waiter, a customer, a till, a boss
- a job, a class, an exam, a board, a rubber

Before you move on

A yoghurt? (**der Joghurt**.) A nurse? (**die Krankenschwester**.) A cook? (**der Koch**.) A police officer? (**der Polizist**.) A shop assistant? (**der Verkäufer**.) A farmer? (**der Bauer**.) A baker? (**der Bäcker**.) A driver? (**der Fahrer**.) A lawyer? (**der Anwalt**.) An engineer? (**der Ingenieur**.) A postman? (**der Briefträger**.) A

waiter? (**der Kellner**.) A customer? (**der Kunde**.) A till? (**die Kasse**.) A boss? (**der Chef**.) A job? (**der Beruf**.) A class? (**die Klasse**.) An exam? (**die Prüfung**.) A board? (**die Tafel**.) A rubber? (**der Radiergummi**.)

132.7 More describing words — a second pass

Say the words for homework and an idea.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- homework, an idea, a sentence, a page; a side, a drawing
- sport, a film, football, a concert, a celebration
- pink, orange, pretty, round, wide
- busy, free, closed, quiet, narrow; tight
- hard-working, lazy, awake, nice, friendly

Before you move on

Homework? (**die Hausaufgabe**.) An idea? (**die Idee**.) A sentence? (**der Satz**.) A page; a side? (**die Seite**.) A drawing? (**die Zeichnung**.) Sport? (**der Sport**.) A film? (**der Film**.) Football? (**der Fußball**.) A concert? (**das Konzert**.) A celebration? (**das Fest**.) Pink? (**rosa**.) Orange? (**orange**.) Pretty? (**hübsch**.) Round? (**rund**.) Wide? (**breit**.) Busy? (**beschäftigt**.) Free? (**frei**.) Closed? (**geschlossen**.) Quiet? (**ruhig**.) Narrow; tight? (**eng**.) Hard-working? (**fleißig**.) Lazy? (**faul**.) Awake? (**wach**.) Nice? (**nett**.) Friendly? (**freundlich**.)

Chapter 133

Angry, Funny, Serious, Famous, Interesting

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say angry, funny, serious, famous and interesting.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 133: I can say angry, funny, serious, famous and interesting.

133.1 böse — angry; bad

Before the new one: say the German for nice, kind, then the German for friendly.

You'll want to know: böse

böse — "angry; bad".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

böse ← Old High German *bōsi* ← Proto-Germanic **bausijaz*, "puffed up, arrogant, bad" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: böse*
- *Say it: böse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *böse*
- *Recall:* say the German for nice, kind, then the German for friendly, then say *böse* again

Before you move on

What does böse mean? ("Angry; bad".) Say it once more.

133.2 lustig — funny

Before the new one: say the German for friendly, then the German for angry; bad.

You'll want to know: lustig

lustig — "funny".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lustig ← Old High German *lustīg*: the word for "pleasure", Old High German *lust*, English *lust*, + *-ig* (EtymDB 2.1). Funny is what gives pleasure.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lustig*
- *Say it: lustig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lustig*
- *Recall:* say the German for friendly, then the German for angry; bad, then say *lustig* again

Before you move on

What does lustig mean? (“Funny”.) Say it once more.

133.3 ernst — serious

Before the new one: say the German for angry; bad, then the German for funny.

You’ll want to know: ernst

ernst — “serious”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ernst ← Old High German *ernust*, “vigour, strife” ← Proto-Germanic **ernustuz* — inherited, the same word as English *earnest*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ernst*
- *Say it: ernst*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ernst*
- *Recall:* say the German for angry; bad, then the German for funny, then say *ernst* again

Before you move on

What does ernst mean? (“Serious”.) Say it once more.

133.4 berühmt — famous

Before the new one: say the German for funny, then the German for serious.

You'll want to know: berühmt

berühmt — "famous".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

berühmt is "praised": the past participle of a verb built on the word for "fame", Old High German *ruom* ← Proto-Germanic **hrōmiz* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: berühmt*
- *Say it: berühmt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *berühmt*
- *Recall:* say the German for funny, then the German for serious, then say *berühmt* again

Before you move on

What does berühmt mean? ("Famous".) Say it once more.

133.5 interessant — interesting

Before the new one: say the German for serious, then the German for famous.

You'll want to know: interessant

interessant — "interesting".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

interessant ← French *intéressant*, "interesting" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, from Latin *interesse*, "to be between, to matter".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: interessant*
- *Say it: interessant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *interessant*
- *Recall:* say the German for serious, then the German for famous, then say *interessant* again

Before you move on

What does interessant mean? ("Interesting".) Say it once more.

Chapter 134

Boring, Difficult, Finished, Ready, Safe

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say boring, difficult, finished, ready and safe.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 134: I can say boring, difficult, finished, ready and safe.*

134.1 langweilig — boring

> Before the new one: say the German for famous, then the German for interesting.

You'll want to know: langweilig

langweilig — "boring".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

langweilig is built from the word for "long" + the word for "a while", Old High German *wīla*, English *while* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-ig*: when time feels long.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: langweilig*
- *Say it: langweilig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *langweilig*
- *Recall:* say the German for famous, then the German for interesting, then say *langweilig* again

Before you move on

What does langweilig mean? ("Boring".) Say it once more.

134.2 schwierig — difficult

Before the new one: say the German for interesting, then the German for boring.

You'll want to know: schwierig

schwierig — "difficult".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schwierig ← Middle High German *swiric*, "full of sores": *swër*, "ulcer" (compare *Geschwür*, "abscess"), + *-ic*. What was full of sores became troublesome, then difficult.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schwierig*
- *Say it: schwierig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schwierig*
- *Recall:* say the German for interesting, then the German for boring, then say *schwierig* again

Before you move on

What does schwierig mean? (“Difficult”.) Say it once more.

134.3 fertig — finished, ready

Before the new one: say the German for boring, then the German for difficult.

You’ll want to know: fertig

fertig — “finished, ready”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fertig ← Old High German *fartīg*, “ready for the journey” (EtymDB 2.1), built on the word for “a journey”, from *fahren*. Ready to go became finished.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fertig*
- *Say it: fertig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fertig*
- *Recall:* say the German for boring, then the German for difficult, then say *fertig* again

Before you move on

What does fertig mean? (“Finished, ready”.) Say it once more.

134.4 bereit — ready, willing

Before the new one: say the German for difficult, then the German for finished.

You'll want to know: bereit

bereit — "ready, willing".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bereit ← Old High German *bireiti* — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *ready* and Dutch *gereed*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bereit*
- *Say it:* *bereit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bereit*
- *Recall:* say the German for difficult, then the German for finished, then say *bereit* again

Before you move on

What does bereit mean? ("Ready, willing".) Say it once more.

134.5 sicher — safe; sure

Before the new one: say the German for finished, then the German for ready.

You'll want to know: sicher

sicher — "safe; sure".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sicher is an early West Germanic loan (Old High German *sihhur*, Old English *sicor*) from Latin *sēcūrus*, "free from care" (EtymDB 2.1). English *secure* is a later loan of the same Latin word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sicher*
- *Say it: sicher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sicher*
- *Recall:* say the German for finished, then the German for ready, then say *sicher* again

Before you move on

What does sicher mean? ("Safe; sure".) Say it once more.

Chapter 135

Dangerous, Wet, Dry, Cool, Soft

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say dangerous, wet, dry, cool and soft.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 135: I can say dangerous, wet, dry, cool and soft.*

135.1 gefährlich — dangerous

Before the new one: say the German for ready, then the German for safe; sure.

Say *gegangen*, with ge- and -en. Then say *es regnet*.

You'll want to know: gefährlich

gefährlich — "dangerous".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gefährlich is the word for "danger" + *-lich*. That word ← Middle High German *gevāre*, "ambush, deceit", a cousin of English *fear*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gefährlich*
- *Say it: gefährlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gefährlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for ready, then the German for safe; sure, then say *gefährlich* again

Before you move on

What does gefährlich mean? (“Dangerous”.) Say it once more.

135.2 nass — wet

Before the new one: say the German for safe; sure, then the German for dangerous.

You’ll want to know: nass

nass — “wet”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nass ← Old High German *naz* ← Proto-Germanic **nataz*, “wet” — inherited; Dutch *nat* is the same word. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nass*
- *Say it: nass*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nass*
- *Recall:* say the German for safe; sure, then the German for dangerous, then say *nass* again

Before you move on

What does nass mean? (“Wet”.) Say it once more.

135.3 trocken — dry

Before the new one: say the German for dangerous, then the German for wet.

You’ll want to know: trocken

trocken — “dry”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

trocken ← Middle High German *trucken* — inherited. EtymDB 2.1 lists Old English *ġedrycnan*, “to dry up”, beside it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: trocken*
- *Say it: trocken*, once more
- *Say it:* say *trocken*
- *Recall:* say the German for dangerous, then the German for wet, then say *trocken* again

Before you move on

What does trocken mean? (“Dry”.) Say it once more.

135.4 kühl — cool

Before the new one: say the German for wet, then the German for dry.

You'll want to know: kühl

kühl — "cool".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

kühl ← Old High German *kuoli* — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *cool* and Dutch *koel*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kühl*
- *Say it: kühl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kühl*
- *Recall:* say the German for wet, then the German for dry, then say *kühl* again

Before you move on

What does kühl mean? ("Cool".) Say it once more.

135.5 weich — soft

Before the new one: say the German for dry, then the German for cool.

You'll want to know: weich

weich — "soft".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

weich ← Middle High German *weich* — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *weak*, Old English *wāc*, "pliant". Soft is what bends.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: weich*
- *Say it: weich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *weich*
- *Recall:* say the German for dry, then the German for cool, then say *weich* again

Before you move on

What does weich mean? ("Soft".) Say it once more.

Chapter 136

To want, Wish, To hope, To order, Rather

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to want, a wish, to hope, to order and rather.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 136: I can say to want, a wish, to hope, to order and rather.*

136.1 wollen — to want

Before the new one: say the German for cool, then the German for soft.

You'll want to know: wollen

wollen — "to want".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wollen goes back to Old High German *wellen* ← Proto-Germanic **wiljanǫ*, "to want" — inherited, the same verb as English *will*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: wollen*
- *Say it: wollen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *wollen*
- *Recall:* say the German for cool, then the German for soft, then say *wollen* again

Before you move on

What does wollen mean? ("To want".) Say it once more.

136.2 der Wunsch — a wish

Before the new one: say the German for soft, then the German for to want.

You'll want to know: der Wunsch

der Wunsch — "a wish".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wunsch ← Old High German *wunsc* ← Proto-Germanic **wunskō*, "wish, desire" — inherited, the same word as English *wish*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Wunsch*
- *Say it: der Wunsch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Wunsch*
- *Recall:* say the German for soft, then the German for to want, then say *der Wunsch* again

Before you move on

What does der Wunsch mean? (“A wish”.) Say it once more.

136.3 hoffen — to hope

Before the new one: say the German for to want, then the German for a wish.

You’ll want to know: hoffen

hoffen — “to hope”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hoffen ← Middle High German *hoffen*, borrowed from Low German; EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *hope* and Dutch *hopen*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hoffen*
- *Say it: hoffen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hoffen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to want, then the German for a wish, then say *hoffen* again

Before you move on

What does hoffen mean? (“To hope”.) Say it once more.

136.4 bestellen — to order (food, a taxi)

Before the new one: say the German for a wish, then the German for to hope.

You'll want to know: bestellen

bestellen — "to order (food, a taxi)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bestellen is *be-* + the verb "to put, to place", Old High German *stellen* ← Proto-Germanic **stallijanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1): to arrange for something to be put in place.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bestellen*
- *Say it:* *bestellen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bestellen*
- *Recall:* say the German for a wish, then the German for to hope, then say *bestellen* again

Before you move on

What does bestellen mean? ("To order (food, a taxi)".) Say it once more.

136.5 lieber — rather, preferably

Before the new one: say the German for to hope, then the German for to order.

You'll want to know: lieber

lieber — "rather, preferably".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lieber is the comparative of the word for "dear", Old High German *liob* ← Proto-Germanic **leubaz* (EtymDB 2.1): "more dear". English

lief, as in "I'd as lief", is the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lieber*
- *Say it: lieber*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lieber*
- *Recall:* say the German for to hope, then the German for to order, then say *lieber* again

Before you move on

What does lieber mean? ("Rather, preferably".) Say it once more.

Chapter 137

Weekend, Date, Century, Never, Often

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say the weekend, a date, a century, never and often.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 137: I can say the weekend, a date, a century, never and often.

137.1 das Wochenende — the weekend

Before the new one: say the German for to order, then the German for rather.

The weekend starts on Saturday: say *Sonnabend*, the northern word for it.

You'll want to know: das Wochenende

das Wochenende — "the weekend".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wochenende is the word for "week", Old High German *wohha*, + *Ende*, Proto-Germanic **andijaz*, English *end* (EtymDB 2.1): built after English *weekend*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Wochenende*
- *Say it: das Wochenende*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Wochenende*
- *Recall:* say the German for to order, then the German for rather, then say *das Wochenende* again

Before you move on

What does das Wochenende mean? ("The weekend".) Say it once more.

137.2 das Datum — a date

Before the new one: say the German for rather, then the German for the weekend.

You'll want to know: das Datum

das Datum — "a date".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Datum ← Latin *datum*, "given", from *datus* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: Latin letters ended *datum …*, "given on …", followed by the day.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Datum*
- *Say it: das Datum*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Datum*
- *Recall:* say the German for rather, then the German for the weekend, then say *das Datum* again

Before you move on

What does das Datum mean? (“A date”.) Say it once more.

137.3 das Jahrhundert — a century

Before the new one: say the German for the weekend, then the German for a date.

You’ll want to know: das Jahrhundert

das Jahrhundert — “a century”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Jahrhundert is *Jahr*, “year”, + *hundert*, “hundred”: a hundred years. Both are inherited; *Jahr* ← Proto-Germanic **jērą*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Jahrhundert*
- *Say it: das Jahrhundert*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Jahrhundert*
- *Recall:* say the German for the weekend, then the German for a date, then say *das Jahrhundert* again

Before you move on

What does das Jahrhundert mean? ("A century".) Say it once more.

137.4 nie — never

Before the new one: say the German for a date, then the German for a century.

You'll want to know: nie

nie — "never".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nie ← Old High German *nio*, "never" (EtymDB 2.1): the negative *ni*, "not", fused with *io*, "ever": *nio* is "not ever".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nie*
- *Say it: nie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nie*
- *Recall:* say the German for a date, then the German for a century, then say *nie* again

Before you move on

What does nie mean? ("Never".) Say it once more.

137.5 oft — often

Before the new one: say the German for a century, then the German for never.

You'll want to know: oft

oft — "often".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

oft ← Middle High German *ofte* — inherited, the same word as English *oft* and *often*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: oft*
- *Say it: oft*, once more
- *Say it:* say *oft*
- *Recall:* say the German for a century, then the German for never, then say *oft* again

Before you move on

What does oft mean? ("Often".) Say it once more.

Chapter 138

Sixty, Seventy, Eighty, Ninety, Million

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say sixty, seventy, eighty, ninety and a million.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 138: I can say sixty, seventy, eighty, ninety and a million.

138.1 sechzig — sixty

Before the new one: say the German for never, then the German for often.

You'll want to know: sechzig

sechzig — "sixty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sechzig ← Old High German *sehszug* ← Proto-Germanic **sehs tigiwiz*, "six tens" — the same build as English *sixty*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sechzig*
- *Say it: sechzig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sechzig*
- *Recall:* say the German for never, then the German for often, then say *sechzig* again

Before you move on

What does sechzig mean? (“Sixty”.) Say it once more.

138.2 siebzig — seventy

Before the new one: say the German for often, then the German for sixty.

You’ll want to know: siebzig

siebzig — “seventy”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

siebzig is *sieben*, “seven”, + *-zig*, “tens”, clipped as in *siebzehn* — the same build as English *seventy*. EtymDB 2.1 has the German word but not its parts.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: siebzig*
- *Say it: siebzig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *siebzig*
- *Recall:* say the German for often, then the German for sixty, then say *siebzig* again

Before you move on

What does siebzig mean? ("Seventy".) Say it once more.

138.3 achtzig — eighty

Before the new one: say the German for sixty, then the German for seventy.

You'll want to know: achtzig

achtzig — "eighty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

achtzig is *acht*, "eight", + *-zig*, "tens" — the same build as English *eighty*. EtymDB 2.1 has the German word but not its parts.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: achtzig*
- *Say it: achtzig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *achtzig*
- *Recall:* say the German for sixty, then the German for seventy, then say *achtzig* again

Before you move on

What does achtzig mean? ("Eighty".) Say it once more.

138.4 neunzig — ninety

Before the new one: say the German for seventy, then the German for eighty.

You'll want to know: neunzig

neunzig — "ninety".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

neunzig is *neun*, "nine", + *-zig*, "tens" — the same build as English *ninety*. EtymDB 2.1 has the German word but not its parts.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: neunzig*
- *Say it: neunzig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *neunzig*
- *Recall:* say the German for seventy, then the German for eighty, then say *neunzig* again

Before you move on

What does neunzig mean? ("Ninety".) Say it once more.

138.5 die Million — a million

Before the new one: say the German for eighty, then the German for ninety.

You'll want to know: die Million

die Million — "a million".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Million ← Italian *milione*, "a great thousand", from Latin *mīlle*, "thousand" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed through French.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Million*
- *Say it: die Million*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Million*
- *Recall:* say the German for eighty, then the German for ninety, then say *die Million* again

Before you move on

What does die Million mean? ("A million".) Say it once more.

Chapter 139

To begin, To visit, To answer, To lay, To put

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to begin, to visit, to answer, to lay and to put.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 139: I can say to begin, to visit, to answer, to lay and to put.*

139.1 beginnen — to begin

> Before the new one: say the German for ninety, then the German for a million.

You'll want to know: beginnen

beginnen — "to begin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

beginnen ← Old High German *biginnan* ← Proto-Germanic **biginnaną*, "to begin" — inherited, the same verb as English *begin*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *beginnen*
- *Say it:* *beginnen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *beginnen*
- *Recall:* say the German for ninety, then the German for a million, then say *beginnen* again

Before you move on

What does beginnen mean? ("To begin".) Say it once more.

139.2 besuchen — to visit

Before the new one: say the German for a million, then the German for to begin.

You'll want to know: besuchen

besuchen — "to visit".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

besuchen is *be-* + *suchen*, "to seek": to seek someone out. EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *beseech* and Dutch *bezoeken*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *besuchen*
- *Say it:* *besuchen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *besuchen*
- *Recall:* say the German for a million, then the German for to begin, then say *besuchen* again

Before you move on

What does besuchen mean? ("To visit".) Say it once more.

139.3 antworten — to answer

Before the new one: say the German for to begin, then the German for to visit.

You'll want to know: antworten

antworten — "to answer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

antworten is the verb made from *Antwort* ← Old High German *antwurti*, "counter-word" (EtymDB 2.1): to give a word back.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: antworten*
- *Say it: antworten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *antworten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to begin, then the German for to visit, then say *antworten* again

Before you move on

What does antworten mean? ("To answer".) Say it once more.

139.4 legen — to lay, to put (flat)

Before the new one: say the German for to visit, then the German for to answer.

You'll want to know: legen

legen — "to lay, to put (flat)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

legen ← Old High German *leggen* ← Proto-Germanic **lagjanǫ*, "to lay" — inherited, the same verb as English *lay*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *legen*
- *Say it:* *legen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *legen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to visit, then the German for to answer, then say *legen* again

Before you move on

What does legen mean? ("To lay, to put (flat)".) Say it once more.

139.5 stellen — to put (upright)

Before the new one: say the German for to answer, then the German for to lay.

You'll want to know: stellen

stellen — "to put (upright)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

stellen ← Old High German *stellen* ← Proto-Germanic **stallijanǫ*, "to put, to position" — inherited, built on the word for "a place, a stall", English *stall*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stellen*
- *Say it: stellen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stellen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to answer, then the German for to lay, then say *stellen* again

Before you move on

What does stellen mean? ("To put (upright)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 140

To lie, To get dressed, To tell, To feel, To fall

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to lie, to get dressed, to tell, to feel and to fall.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 140: I can say to lie, to get dressed, to tell, to feel and to fall.*

140.1 liegen — to lie (be lying)

Before the new one: say the German for to lay, then the German for to put.

You'll want to know: liegen

liegen — "to lie (be lying)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

liegen ← Old High German *ligen* — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *lie*, "to lie down", Dutch *liggen* and Gothic *ligan*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: liegen*
- *Say it: liegen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *liegen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to lay, then the German for to put, then say *liegen* again

Before you move on

What does liegen mean? ("To lie (be lying)".) Say it once more.

140.2 sich anziehen — to get dressed

Before the new one: say the German for to put, then the German for to lie.

You'll want to know: sich anziehen

sich anziehen — "to get dressed".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

anziehen is *an-*, "on", + the verb "to pull", Old High German *ziohan* ← Proto-Germanic **teuhanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1): to pull your clothes on.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sich anziehen*
- *Say it: sich anziehen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sich anziehen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to put, then the German for to lie, then say *sich anziehen* again

Before you move on

What does sich anziehen mean? ("To get dressed".) Say it once more.

140.3 erzählen — to tell (a story)

Before the new one: say the German for to lie, then the German for to get dressed.

You'll want to know: erzählen

erzählen — "to tell (a story)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

erzählen is *er-* + *zählen*, "to count" ← Old High German *zellen* ← Proto-Germanic **taljanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1). A story is told out, item by item — English *tell* has both senses too.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: erzählen*
- *Say it: erzählen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *erzählen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to lie, then the German for to get dressed, then say *erzählen* again

Before you move on

What does erzählen mean? ("To tell (a story)".) Say it once more.

140.4 fühlen — to feel

Before the new one: say the German for to get dressed, then the German for to tell.

You'll want to know: fühlen

fühlen — "to feel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fühlen ← Old High German *fuolen* ← Proto-Germanic **fōlijanǫ*, "to feel" — inherited, the same verb as English *feel*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fühlen*
- *Say it: fühlen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fühlen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to get dressed, then the German for to tell, then say *fühlen* again

Before you move on

What does fühlen mean? ("To feel".) Say it once more.

140.5 fallen — to fall

Before the new one: say the German for to tell, then the German for to feel.

You'll want to know: fallen

fallen — "to fall".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fallen ← Old High German *fallan* ← Proto-Germanic **fallanǫ* — inherited, the same verb as English *fall*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fallen*
- *Say it: fallen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fallen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to tell, then the German for to feel, then say *fallen* again

Before you move on

What does fallen mean? ("To fall".) Say it once more.

Chapter 141

To pay, To rent, To pack, To repair, To start

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to pay, to rent, to pack, to repair and to start.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 141: I can say to pay, to rent, to pack, to repair and to start.

141.1 zahlen — to pay

Before the new one: say the German for to feel, then the German for to fall.

You'll want to know: zahlen

zahlen — "to pay".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

zahlen is the verb made from the word for "number", Old High German *zala* ← Proto-Germanic **talō* (EtymDB 2.1): paying is counting out. English *tale* shares the root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zahlen*
- *Say it: zahlen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zahlen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to feel, then the German for to fall, then say *zahlen* again

Before you move on

What does zahlen mean? ("To pay".) Say it once more.

141.2 mieten — to rent

Before the new one: say the German for to fall, then the German for to pay.

You'll want to know: mieten

mieten — "to rent".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mieten is the verb made from the word for "rent", Old High German *miata*, "payment" ← Proto-Germanic **mēzdō* (EtymDB 2.1). English *meed*, "reward", is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mieten*
- *Say it: mieten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mieten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to fall, then the German for to pay, then say *mieten* again

Before you move on

What does mieten mean? ("To rent".) Say it once more.

141.3 packen — to pack

Before the new one: say the German for to pay, then the German for to rent.

You'll want to know: packen

packen — "to pack".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

packen ← Middle Low German *packen*, "to pack" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed from Low German, the language of the Hanseatic traders. English *pack* is the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: packen*
- *Say it: packen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *packen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to pay, then the German for to rent, then say *packen* again

Before you move on

What does packen mean? ("To pack".) Say it once more.

141.4 reparieren — to repair

Before the new one: say the German for to rent, then the German for to pack.

You'll want to know: reparieren

reparieren — "to repair".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

reparieren ← Latin *reparāre*, "to renew, to repair" (EtymDB 2.1 has the Latin verb) — borrowed, with the German ending *-ieren*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: reparieren*
- *Say it: reparieren*, once more
- *Say it:* say *reparieren*
- *Recall:* say the German for to rent, then the German for to pack, then say *reparieren* again

Before you move on

What does reparieren mean? ("To repair".) Say it once more.

141.5 anfangen — to start

Before the new one: say the German for to pack, then the German for to repair.

You'll want to know: anfangen

anfangen — "to start".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

anfangen ← Middle High German *anvāhen*, "to take hold": *an-* + *vāhen*, "to seize, to catch" (EtymDB 2.1). To start is to take hold of a task.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: anfangen*
- *Say it: anfangen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *anfangen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to pack, then the German for to repair, then say *anfangen* again

Before you move on

What does anfangen mean? ("To start".) Say it once more.

141.6 Wanting, time and numbers — a first pass

Say the words for to repair and to start.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- angry; bad, funny, serious, famous, interesting
- boring, difficult, finished, ready, safe; sure
- dangerous, wet, dry, cool, soft
- to want, a wish, to hope, to order, rather

Before you move on

Angry; bad? (**böse**.) Funny? (**lustig**.) Serious? (**ernst**.) Famous? (**berühmt**.) Interesting? (**interessant**.) Boring? (**langweilig**.) Difficult? (**schwierig**.) Finished? (**fertig**.) Ready? (**bereit**.) Safe; sure? (**sicher**.) Dangerous? (**gefährlich**.) Wet? (**nass**.) Dry? (**trocken**.) Cool? (**kühl**.) Soft? (**weich**.) To want? (**wollen**.) A

wish? (**der Wunsch**.) To hope? (**hoffen**.) To order? (**bestellen**.) Rather? (**lieber**.)

141.7 Verbs — a second pass

Say the words for the weekend and a date.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the weekend, a date, a century, never, often
- sixty, seventy, eighty, ninety, a million
- to begin, to visit, to answer, to lay, to put
- to lie, to get dressed, to tell, to feel, to fall
- to pay, to rent, to pack, to repair, to start

Before you move on

The weekend? (**das Wochenende**.) A date? (**das Datum**.) A century? (**das Jahrhundert**.) Never? (**nie**.) Often? (**oft**.) Sixty? (**sechzig**.) Seventy? (**siebzig**.) Eighty? (**achtzig**.) Ninety? (**neunzig**.) A million? (**die Million**.) To begin? (**beginnen**.) To visit? (**besuchen**.) To answer? (**antworten**.) To lay? (**legen**.) To put? (**stellen**.) To lie? (**liegen**.) To get dressed? (**sich anziehen**.) To tell? (**erzählen**.) To feel? (**fühlen**.) To fall? (**fallen**.) To pay? (**zahlen**.) To rent? (**mieten**.) To pack? (**packen**.) To repair? (**reparieren**.) To start? (**anfangen**.)

Chapter 142

The Future, Next Week, the Day after Tomorrow, Next Year, To Plan

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say what will happen, and when: next week, the day after tomorrow, next year.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 142: I can say what will happen, and when: next week, the day after tomorrow, next year.

142.1 die Zukunft — the future

Before the new one: say the German for to repair, then the German for to start.

You'll want to know: die Zukunft

die Zukunft — "the future". German builds the future with **werden** and an infinitive at the very end: **Ich werde Deutsch lernen.** — "I will learn German."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Zukunft ← Middle High German *zuokunft* ← Old High German *zuochumft*: *zu-*, "to", + a noun built on *kommen*, "to come" (EtymDB 2.1). The future is what is coming.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Zukunft*
- *Say it: die Zukunft*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Zukunft*
- *Recall:* say the German for to repair, then the German for to start, then say *die Zukunft* again

Before you move on

What does die Zukunft mean? ("The future".) Say it once more.

142.2 nächste Woche — next week

Before the new one: say the German for to start, then the German for the future.

You'll want to know: nächste Woche

nächste Woche — "next week". Put the time first and the verb stays second: **Nächste Woche werde ich Deutsch lernen.** *Werde* comes before *ich*, and *lernen* waits at the end.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nächste Woche is "nearest" + *Woche*, "week". *Woche* ← Old High German *wohha* ← Proto-Germanic **wikōn*, "turn, succession" (EtymDB 2.1), the same word as English *week*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nächste Woche*
- *Say it: nächste Woche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nächste Woche*
- *Recall:* say the German for to start, then the German for the future, then say *nächste Woche* again

Before you move on

What does nächste Woche mean? ("Next week".) Say it once more.

142.3 übermorgen — the day after tomorrow

Before the new one: say the German for the future, then the German for next week.

You'll want to know: übermorgen

übermorgen — "the day after tomorrow". When a time word already points ahead, spoken German keeps the present tense: **Übermorgen fahre ich.** — "I am going the day after tomorrow."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

übermorgen is the word for "over, beyond" + *morgen*, "tomorrow": the day beyond tomorrow. EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside Dutch *overmorgen*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: übermorgen*
- *Say it: übermorgen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *übermorgen*

- *Recall:* say the German for the future, then the German for next week, then say *übermorgen* again

Before you move on

What does übermorgen mean? ("The day after tomorrow".) Say it once more.

142.4 nächstes Jahr — next year

Before the new one: say the German for next week, then the German for the day after tomorrow.

You'll want to know: nächstes Jahr

nächstes Jahr — "next year". *Werden* changes with the person: *ich werde*, *du wirst*, *er wird*. **Nächstes Jahr wirst du Deutsch lernen.**

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nächstes Jahr is "nearest" + *Jahr*, "year" ← Old High German *jār* ← Proto-Germanic **jērą*, English *year*. (EtymDB 2.1) *nächst-* is the superlative of the word for "near".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nächstes Jahr*
- *Say it: nächstes Jahr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nächstes Jahr*
- *Recall:* say the German for next week, then the German for the day after tomorrow, then say *nächstes Jahr* again

Before you move on

What does nächstes Jahr mean? ("Next year".) Say it once more.

142.5 vorhaben — to plan, to intend

Before the new one: say the German for the day after tomorrow, then the German for next year.

You'll want to know: vorhaben

vorhaben — "to plan, to intend". It splits like the other separable verbs: **Was hast du vor?** — "What are you planning?"

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vorhaben is the word for "before, in front" + *haben*, "to have": to have a plan in front of you. *haben* is the same verb as English *have*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vorhaben*
- *Say it: vorhaben*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vorhaben*
- *Recall:* say the German for the day after tomorrow, then the German for next year, then say *vorhaben* again

Before you move on

What does vorhaben mean? ("To plan, to intend".) Say it once more.

Chapter 143

The Rent, an Advert, an Appointment, Opening Hours, a Receipt

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can read an advert, an appointment, opening hours and a receipt, and act on what they say.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 143: I can read an advert, an appointment, opening hours and a receipt, and act on what they say.*

143.1 die Miete — the rent

> Before the new one: say the German for next year, then the German for to plan.

You'll want to know: die Miete

die Miete — "the rent". The noun behind *mieten*: **Die Miete ist hoch.** — "The rent is high."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Miete ← Old High German *miata*, "payment" ← Proto-Germanic **mēzdō* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) English *meed*, "reward", is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Miete*
- *Say it: die Miete*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Miete*
- *Recall:* say the German for next year, then the German for to plan, then say *die Miete* again

Before you move on

What does die Miete mean? ("The rent".) Say it once more.

143.2 die Anzeige — an advert

Before the new one: say the German for to plan, then the German for the rent.

You'll want to know: die Anzeige

die Anzeige — "an advert".

Read it: the advert

The advert says **Zimmer frei. Miete: 400 Euro im Monat.** A room is free, at 400 euros a month.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Anzeige is the noun of a verb built from *an-*, "at, to", + *zeigen*, "to show" ← Old High German *zeigōn* (EtymDB 2.1): an announcement shown to the public.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Anzeige*
- *Say it: die Anzeige*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Anzeige*
- *Recall:* say the German for to plan, then the German for the rent, then say *die Anzeige* again

Before you move on

What does die Anzeige mean? ("An advert".) Say it once more.

143.3 der Termin — an appointment

Before the new one: say the German for the rent, then the German for an advert.

You'll want to know: der Termin

der Termin — "an appointment".

Read it: the message

The message says **Ihr Termin: Montag, zehn Uhr.** Your appointment is on Monday at ten: be there before ten.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Termin ← Latin *terminus*, "boundary, limit, end" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: a fixed point in time. English *term* shares it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Termin*
- *Say it: der Termin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Termin*

- *Recall:* say the German for the rent, then the German for an advert, then say *der Termin* again

Before you move on

What does der Termin mean? ("An appointment".) Say it once more.

143.4 die Öffnungszeiten — opening hours

Before the new one: say the German for an advert, then the German for an appointment.

You'll want to know: die Öffnungszeiten

die Öffnungszeiten — "opening hours".

Read it: the door

The door says **Montag bis Freitag, neun bis achtzehn Uhr.** Open on weekdays from nine to six: not on Saturday.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Öffnungszeiten is the noun of "to open", Old High German *offanōn*, English *open*, + *Zeit* in the plural (EtymDB 2.1): opening times.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Öffnungszeiten*
- *Say it: die Öffnungszeiten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Öffnungszeiten*
- *Recall:* say the German for an advert, then the German for an appointment, then say *die Öffnungszeiten* again

Before you move on

What does die Öffnungszeiten mean? (“Opening hours”.) Say it once more.

143.5 die Quittung — a receipt

Before the new one: say the German for an appointment, then the German for opening hours.

You’ll want to know: die Quittung

die Quittung — “a receipt”.

Read it: the receipt

The receipt says **Quittung: Miete, 400 Euro.** The rent is paid: keep it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Quittung is built on *quitt*, “settled, free of debt”, which EtymDB 2.1 lists beside French *quitte* and English *quit*; they go back to Latin *quiētus*, “at rest”. A receipt shows you are quit.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Quittung*
- *Say it: die Quittung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Quittung*
- *Recall:* say the German for an appointment, then the German for opening hours, then say *die Quittung* again

Before you move on

What does die Quittung mean? (“A receipt”.) Say it once more.

143.6 The future — a first pass

Say the words for opening hours and a receipt.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the future, next week, the day after tomorrow, next year, to plan

Before you move on

The future? (**die Zukunft**.) Next week? (**nächste Woche**.) The day after tomorrow? (**übermorgen**.) Next year? (**nächstes Jahr**.) To plan? (**vorhaben**.)

143.7 Reading notices — a second pass

Say the words for the rent and an advert.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the rent, an advert, an appointment, opening hours, a receipt

Before you move on

The rent? (**die Miete**.) An advert? (**die Anzeige**.) An appointment? (**der Termin**.) Opening hours? (**die Öffnungszeiten**.) A receipt? (**die Quittung**.)

Chapter 144

To change, To phone, To stop, To go out, To look

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to change, to phone, to stop, to go out and to look.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 144: I can say to change, to phone, to stop, to go out and to look.

144.1 ändern — to change

Before the new one: say the German for opening hours, then the German for a receipt.

You'll want to know: ändern

ändern — "to change".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ändern ← Middle High German *endern* (EtymDB 2.1), from Old High German *antarōn*, "to make other", built on the word for "other", a cousin of English *other*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ändern*
- *Say it:* *ändern*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ändern*
- *Recall:* say the German for opening hours, then the German for a receipt, then say *ändern* again

Before you move on

What does ändern mean? (“To change”.) Say it once more.

144.2 anrufen — to phone

Before the new one: say the German for a receipt, then the German for to change.

You’ll want to know: anrufen

anrufen — “to phone”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

anrufen is *an-*, “at, to”, + *rufen*, “to call” (EtymDB 2.1 links the two): to call someone up.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *anrufen*
- *Say it:* *anrufen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *anrufen*
- *Recall:* say the German for a receipt, then the German for to change, then say *anrufen* again

Before you move on

What does anrufen mean? ("To phone".) Say it once more.

144.3 aufhören — to stop

Before the new one: say the German for to change, then the German for to phone.

You'll want to know: aufhören

aufhören — "to stop".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aufhören ← Middle High German *ūfhœren* (EtymDB 2.1): *auf* + *hören*, "to hear". On the usual account, to stop was first to look up and listen.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aufhören*
- *Say it: aufhören*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aufhören*
- *Recall:* say the German for to change, then the German for to phone, then say *aufhören* again

Before you move on

What does aufhören mean? ("To stop".) Say it once more.

144.4 ausgehen — to go out

Before the new one: say the German for to phone, then the German for to stop.

You'll want to know: ausgehen

ausgehen — "to go out".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ausgehen is *aus-*, "out", + *gehen*, "to go" (EtymDB 2.1). *aus-* is the same word as English *out*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ausgehen*
- *Say it:* *ausgehen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ausgehen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to phone, then the German for to stop, then say *ausgehen* again

Before you move on

What does ausgehen mean? ("To go out".) Say it once more.

144.5 aussehen — to look (like)

Before the new one: say the German for to stop, then the German for to go out.

You'll want to know: aussehen

aussehen — "to look (like)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aussehen ← Middle High German *ūzsehen* (EtymDB 2.1): *aus-*, "out", + *sehen*, "to see". How a thing looks is how it shows outward.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *aussehen*
- *Say it:* *aussehen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aussehen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to stop, then the German for to go out, then say *aussehen* again

Before you move on

What does aussehen mean? ("To look (like)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 145

To use, To go shopping, To invite, To recommend, To decide

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to use, to go shopping, to invite, to recommend and to decide.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 145: I can say to use, to go shopping, to invite, to recommend and to decide.

145.1 benutzen — to use

Before the new one: say the German for to go out, then the German for to look.

You'll want to know: benutzen

benutzen — "to use".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

benutzen is *be-* + the verb "to use, to profit from", Old High German *nuzzōn* ← Proto-Germanic **nutōną* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: benutzen*
- *Say it: benutzen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *benutzen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to go out, then the German for to look, then say *benutzen* again

Before you move on

What does benutzen mean? (“To use”.) Say it once more.

145.2 einkaufen — to go shopping

Before the new one: say the German for to look, then the German for to use.

You’ll want to know: einkaufen

einkaufen — “to go shopping”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

einkaufen is *ein-*, “in”, + *kaufen*, “to buy”: to buy in supplies. *kaufen* goes back to Latin *caupō*, “tradesman”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: einkaufen*
- *Say it: einkaufen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *einkaufen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to look, then the German for to use, then say *einkaufen* again

Before you move on

What does einkaufen mean? ("To go shopping".) Say it once more.

145.3 einladen — to invite

Before the new one: say the German for to use, then the German for to go shopping.

You'll want to know: einladen

einladen — "to invite".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

einladen ← Old High German *inladōn* (EtymDB 2.1): *ein-*, "in", + an old verb meaning "to call, to summon". It is a different word from *Laden*, "shop".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: einladen*
- *Say it: einladen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *einladen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to use, then the German for to go shopping, then say *einladen* again

Before you move on

What does einladen mean? ("To invite".) Say it once more.

145.4 empfehlen — to recommend

Before the new one: say the German for to go shopping, then the German for to invite.

You'll want to know: empfehlen

empfehlen — "to recommend".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

empfehlen ← Middle High German *enpfelhen*, "to entrust to someone" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, built from *ent-* and an old verb for "to hand over". To recommend is to entrust.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: empfehlen*
- *Say it: empfehlen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *empfehlen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to go shopping, then the German for to invite, then say *empfehlen* again

Before you move on

What does empfehlen mean? ("To recommend".) Say it once more.

145.5 entscheiden — to decide

Before the new one: say the German for to invite, then the German for to recommend.

You'll want to know: entscheiden

entscheiden — "to decide".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

entscheiden is *ent-* + the verb "to separate, to divide", Old High German *sceidan* ← Proto-Germanic **skaiþaną* (EtymDB 2.1): to decide is to cut between choices.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: entscheiden*
- *Say it: entscheiden*, once more
- *Say it:* say *entscheiden*
- *Recall:* say the German for to invite, then the German for to recommend, then say *entscheiden* again

Before you move on

What does entscheiden mean? ("To decide".) Say it once more.

Chapter 146

To explain, To be missing, To celebrate, To fill, To please

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to explain, to be missing, to celebrate, to fill and to please.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 146: I can say to explain, to be missing, to celebrate, to fill and to please.

146.1 erklären — to explain

Before the new one: say the German for to recommend, then the German for to decide.

You'll want to know: erklären

erklären — "to explain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

erklären is *er-* + the verb "to make clear", built on the word for "clear", Middle High German *klār* ← Latin *clārus* (EtymDB 2.1). To explain is to make clear.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: erklären*
- *Say it: erklären*, once more
- *Say it:* say *erklären*
- *Recall:* say the German for to recommend, then the German for to decide, then say *erklären* again

Before you move on

What does erklären mean? (“To explain”.) Say it once more.

146.2 fehlen — to be missing

Before the new one: say the German for to decide, then the German for to explain.

You’ll want to know: fehlen

fehlen — “to be missing”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fehlen ← Middle High German *vælen*, from Old French *faillir*, “to fail” (EtymDB 2.1 traces *faillir* to Vulgar Latin *fallīre*) — borrowed, like English *fail*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fehlen*
- *Say it: fehlen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fehlen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to decide, then the German for to explain, then say *fehlen* again

Before you move on

What does fehlen mean? ("To be missing".) Say it once more.

146.3 feiern — to celebrate

Before the new one: say the German for to explain, then the German for to be missing.

You'll want to know: feiern

feiern — "to celebrate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

feiern ← Middle High German *vīren* ← Old High German *fīrōn*, from Latin *fēriae*, "holidays" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed. English *fair*, a market day, shares the Latin word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: feiern*
- *Say it: feiern*, once more
- *Say it:* say *feiern*
- *Recall:* say the German for to explain, then the German for to be missing, then say *feiern* again

Before you move on

What does feiern mean? ("To celebrate".) Say it once more.

146.4 füllen — to fill

Before the new one: say the German for to be missing, then the German for to celebrate.

You'll want to know: füllen

füllen — "to fill".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

füllen ← Old High German *fullen* ← Proto-Germanic **fullijanǫ*, "to make full" — inherited, the same verb as English *fill*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: füllen*
- *Say it: füllen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *füllen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to be missing, then the German for to celebrate, then say *füllen* again

Before you move on

What does füllen mean? ("To fill".) Say it once more.

146.5 gefallen — to please, to be liked

Before the new one: say the German for to celebrate, then the German for to fill.

You'll want to know: gefallen

gefallen — "to please, to be liked".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gefallen ← Middle High German *gevallen* ← Old High German *gifallan* (EtymDB 2.1): *ge-* + *fallen*. What falls your way pleases you.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gefallen*
- *Say it: gefallen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gefallen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to celebrate, then the German for to fill, then say *gefallen* again

Before you move on

What does gefallen mean? ("To please, to be liked".) Say it once more.

Chapter 147

To win, To hang, To marry, To know, To ring

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to win, to hang, to marry, to know and to ring.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 147: I can say to win, to hang, to marry, to know and to ring.

147.1 gewinnen — to win

Before the new one: say the German for to fill, then the German for to please.

You'll want to know: gewinnen

gewinnen — "to win".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gewinnen ← Middle High German *gewinnen* — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists Old English *ġewinnan*, "to conquer, to gain", and Dutch *winnen* beside it. English *win* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gewinnen*
- *Say it: gewinnen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gewinnen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to fill, then the German for to please, then say *gewinnen* again

Before you move on

What does gewinnen mean? ("To win".) Say it once more.

147.2 hängen — to hang

Before the new one: say the German for to please, then the German for to win.

You'll want to know: hängen

hängen — "to hang".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hängen ← Old High German *hengen* ← Proto-Germanic **hangijanǫ*, "to make hang" — inherited, the same verb as English *hang*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hängen*
- *Say it: hängen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hängen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to please, then the German for to win, then say *hängen* again

Before you move on

What does hängen mean? ("To hang".) Say it once more.

147.3 heiraten — to marry

Before the new one: say the German for to win, then the German for to hang.

You'll want to know: heiraten

heiraten — "to marry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

heiraten ← Middle High German *hīrāten*, from *hīrāt* ← Old High German *hīrāt*, "marriage" (EtymDB 2.1): a word for "household" + *rāt*, "arrangement". Old English *hīred*, "household", is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: heiraten*
- *Say it: heiraten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *heiraten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to win, then the German for to hang, then say *heiraten* again

Before you move on

What does heiraten mean? ("To marry".) Say it once more.

147.4 kennen — to know (a person or place)

Before the new one: say the German for to hang, then the German for to marry.

You'll want to know: kennen

kennen — "to know (a person or place)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

kennen ← Old High German *kennan* ← Proto-Germanic **kannijanǫ*, "to make known" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) English *ken*, "range of knowledge", is the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kennen*
- *Say it: kennen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kennen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to hang, then the German for to marry, then say *kennen* again

Before you move on

What does kennen mean? ("To know (a person or place)".) Say it once more.

147.5 klingeln — to ring

Before the new one: say the German for to marry, then the German for to know.

You'll want to know: klingeln

klingeln — "to ring".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

klingeln is built on the verb "to sound", Old High German *klingan* ← Proto-Germanic **klinganǫ* (EtymDB 2.1), with *-eln*, an ending for

small repeated actions.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: klingeln*
- *Say it: klingeln*, once more
- *Say it:* say *klingeln*
- *Recall:* say the German for to marry, then the German for to know, then say *klingeln* again

Before you move on

What does klingeln mean? ("To ring".) Say it once more.

Chapter 148

To cost, To lend, To love, To bring along, To take along

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to cost, to lend, to love, to bring along and to take along.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 148: I can say to cost, to lend, to love, to bring along and to take along.*

148.1 kosten — to cost

> Before the new one: say the German for to know, then the German for to ring.

You'll want to know: kosten

kosten — "to cost".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

kosten, "to cost", ← Middle High German *kosten*, from Old French *coster* ← Latin *cōnstāre*, "to stand at, to cost" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *cost*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kosten*
- *Say it: kosten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kosten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to know, then the German for to ring, then say *kosten* again

Before you move on

What does kosten mean? ("To cost".) Say it once more.

148.2 leihen — to lend, to borrow

Before the new one: say the German for to ring, then the German for to cost.

You'll want to know: leihen

leihen — "to lend, to borrow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

leihen ← Old High German *līhan* ← Proto-Germanic **līhwanǫ*, "to lend" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) English *loan* and *lend* come from the same root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: leihen*
- *Say it: leihen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *leihen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to ring, then the German for to cost, then say *leihen* again

Before you move on

What does leihen mean? (“To lend, to borrow”.) Say it once more.

148.3 lieben — to love

Before the new one: say the German for to cost, then the German for to lend.

You’ll want to know: lieben

lieben — “to love”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lieben is the verb of the word for “dear”, Old High German *liob* ← Proto-Germanic **leubaz* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) English *lief* is the same word, and *love* shares the root.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lieben*
- *Say it: lieben*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lieben*
- *Recall:* say the German for to cost, then the German for to lend, then say *lieben* again

Before you move on

What does lieben mean? (“To love”.) Say it once more.

148.4 mitbringen — to bring along

Before the new one: say the German for to lend, then the German for to love.

You'll want to know: mitbringen

mitbringen — "to bring along".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mitbringen is *mit*, "with", + *bringen*, "to bring" ← Proto-Germanic **bringanǫ*, English *bring* (EtymDB 2.1): to bring along.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mitbringen*
- *Say it: mitbringen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mitbringen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to lend, then the German for to love, then say *mitbringen* again

Before you move on

What does mitbringen mean? ("To bring along".) Say it once more.

148.5 mitnehmen — to take along

Before the new one: say the German for to love, then the German for to bring along.

You'll want to know: mitnehmen

mitnehmen — "to take along".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mitnehmen is *mit*, "with", + *nehmen*, "to take" ← Old High German *neman* ← Proto-Germanic **nemanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1): to take along.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mitnehmen*
- *Say it: mitnehmen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mitnehmen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to love, then the German for to bring along, then say *mitnehmen* again

Before you move on

What does mitnehmen mean? ("To take along".) Say it once more.

Chapter 149

To name, To smell, To collect, To give, To shout

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to name, to smell, to collect, to give and to shout.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 149: I can say to name, to smell, to collect, to give and to shout.*

149.1 nennen — to name, to call

> Before the new one: say the German for to bring along, then the German for to take along.

You'll want to know: nennen

nennen — "to name, to call".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nennen ← Old High German *nemnen* ← Proto-Germanic **namnijanǫ*, built on **namô*, "name" (EtymDB 2.1) — the verb of the word English keeps as *name*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nennen*
- *Say it:* *nennen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nennen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to bring along, then the German for to take along, then say *nennen* again

Before you move on

What does nennen mean? (“To name, to call”.) Say it once more.

149.2 riechen — to smell

Before the new one: say the German for to take along, then the German for to name.

You’ll want to know: riechen

riechen — “to smell”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

riechen goes back to Old High German *riohhan*, “to give off smoke” ← Proto-Germanic **reukanǫ* — inherited, the same verb as English *reek*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *riechen*
- *Say it:* *riechen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *riechen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to take along, then the German for to name, then say *riechen* again

Before you move on

What does riechen mean? (“To smell”.) Say it once more.

149.3 sammeln — to collect

Before the new one: say the German for to name, then the German for to smell.

You’ll want to know: sammeln

sammeln — “to collect”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sammeln ← Middle High German *sameln* (EtymDB 2.1), built on an old word for “together”, a cousin of English *same*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sammeln*
- *Say it: sammeln*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sammeln*
- *Recall:* say the German for to name, then the German for to smell, then say *sammeln* again

Before you move on

What does sammeln mean? (“To collect”.) Say it once more.

149.4 schenken — to give (as a present)

Before the new one: say the German for to smell, then the German for to collect.

You'll want to know: schenken

schenken — "to give (as a present)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schenken ← Old High German *scenken*, "to pour, to give someone drink" ← Proto-Germanic **skankijanǫ* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) Giving began as pouring for a guest.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schenken*
- *Say it: schenken*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schenken*
- *Recall:* say the German for to smell, then the German for to collect, then say *schenken* again

Before you move on

What does schenken mean? ("To give (as a present)".) Say it once more.

149.5 schreien — to shout, to scream

Before the new one: say the German for to collect, then the German for to give.

You'll want to know: schreien

schreien — "to shout, to scream".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schreien ← Old High German *scrīan* ← Proto-Germanic **skrīhanǫ*, "to cry out" — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists English *scream* beside it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schreien*
- *Say it: schreien*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schreien*
- *Recall:* say the German for to collect, then the German for to give, then say *schreien* again

Before you move on

What does schreien mean? ("To shout, to scream".) Say it once more.

Chapter 150

To save, To jump, To die, To disturb, To argue

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to save, to jump, to die, to disturb and to argue.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 150: I can say to save, to jump, to die, to disturb and to argue.

150.1 sparen — to save (money)

Before the new one: say the German for to give, then the German for to shout.

You'll want to know: sparen

sparen — "to save (money)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sparen is inherited, from Old High German *sparēn*. EtymDB 2.1 lists English *spare* beside Dutch *sparen* and Swedish *spara*: one Germanic verb.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sparen*
- *Say it: sparen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sparen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to give, then the German for to shout, then say *sparen* again

Before you move on

What does sparen mean? ("To save (money)".) Say it once more.

150.2 springen — to jump

Before the new one: say the German for to shout, then the German for to save.

You'll want to know: springen

springen — "to jump".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

springen ← Old High German *springan* ← Proto-Germanic **springanǫ* — inherited, the same verb as English *spring*, "to leap". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: springen*
- *Say it: springen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *springen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to shout, then the German for to save, then say *springen* again

Before you move on

What does springen mean? (“To jump”.) Say it once more.

150.3 sterben — to die

Before the new one: say the German for to save, then the German for to jump.

You’ll want to know: sterben

sterben — “to die”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sterben ← Old High German *sterban* ← Proto-Germanic **sterbanǫ*, “to become stiff, to die” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) English *starve* is the same verb, narrowed to dying of hunger.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sterben*
- *Say it: sterben*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sterben*
- *Recall:* say the German for to save, then the German for to jump, then say *sterben* again

Before you move on

What does sterben mean? (“To die”.) Say it once more.

150.4 stören — to disturb

Before the new one: say the German for to jump, then the German for to die.

You'll want to know: stören

stören — "to disturb".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

stören ← Middle High German *stœren* ← Old High German *stōren*, "to scatter, to destroy" — inherited. EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *stir* and Dutch *storen*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stören*
- *Say it: stören*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stören*
- *Recall:* say the German for to jump, then the German for to die, then say *stören* again

Before you move on

What does stören mean? ("To disturb".) Say it once more.

150.5 streiten — to argue

Before the new one: say the German for to die, then the German for to disturb.

You'll want to know: streiten

streiten — "to argue".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

streiten ← Old High German *strītan*, "to fight" ← Proto-Germanic **strīdanǫ* — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists English *stride* beside it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: streiten*
- *Say it: streiten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *streiten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to die, then the German for to disturb, then say *streiten* again

Before you move on

What does streiten mean? ("To argue".) Say it once more.

Chapter 151

To meet, To dream, To practise, To think over, To move

Modes: **voice** (4) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to meet, to dream, to practise, to think over and to move.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 151: I can say to meet, to dream, to practise, to think over and to move.*

151.1 treffen — to meet

> Before the new one: say the German for to disturb, then the German for to argue.

You'll want to know: treffen

treffen — "to meet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

treffen ← Old High German *treffan*, "to hit" ← Proto-Germanic **drepanǫ* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) To meet is to hit upon someone.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: treffen*
- *Say it: treffen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *treffen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to disturb, then the German for to argue, then say *treffen* again

Before you move on

What does treffen mean? ("To meet".) Say it once more.

151.2 träumen — to dream

Before the new one: say the German for to argue, then the German for to meet.

You'll want to know: träumen

träumen — "to dream".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

träumen ← Old High German *troumen*, the verb of the word for "a dream", Proto-Germanic **draumaz* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, the same word as English *dream*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: träumen*
- *Say it: träumen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *träumen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to argue, then the German for to meet, then say *träumen* again

Before you move on

What does träumen mean? ("To dream".) Say it once more.

151.3 üben — to practise

Before the new one: say the German for to meet, then the German for to dream.

You'll want to know: üben

üben — "to practise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

üben ← Middle High German *üeben*, "to practise, to carry out" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, from Old High German *uoben*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: üben*
- *Say it: üben*, once more
- *Say it:* say *üben*
- *Recall:* say the German for to meet, then the German for to dream, then say *üben* again

Before you move on

What does üben mean? ("To practise".) Say it once more.

151.4 überlegen — to think over

Before the new one: say the German for to dream, then the German for to practise.

You'll want to know: überlegen

überlegen — "to think over".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

überlegen is the word for "over" + *legen*, "to lay" ← Proto-Germanic **lagjanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1): to lay a thing over and look at it from the other side.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: überlegen*
- *Say it: überlegen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *überlegen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to dream, then the German for to practise, then say *überlegen* again

Before you move on

What does überlegen mean? ("To think over".) Say it once more.

151.5 umziehen — to move (house)

Before the new one: say the German for to practise, then the German for to think over.

You'll want to know: umziehen

umziehen — "to move (house)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

umziehen is *um-*, "around, over", + the verb "to pull, to move", Old High German *ziohan* ← Proto-Germanic **teuhanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1): to move from one house to another.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: umziehen*
- *Say it: umziehen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *umziehen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to practise, then the German for to think over, then say *umziehen* again

Before you move on

What does umziehen mean? ("To move (house)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 152

To sign, To earn, To sell, To promise, To introduce

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to sign, to earn, to sell, to promise and to introduce.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 152: I can say to sign, to earn, to sell, to promise and to introduce.*

152.1 unterschreiben — to sign

Before the new one: say the German for to think over, then the German for to move.

You'll want to know: unterschreiben

unterschreiben — "to sign".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

unterschreiben ← Middle High German *underschrīben* (EtymDB 2.1): the word for "under" + *schreiben*, "to write". You sign underneath. *schreiben* comes from Latin *scrībere*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: unterschreiben*
- *Say it: unterschreiben*, once more
- *Say it:* say *unterschreiben*
- *Recall:* say the German for to think over, then the German for to move, then say *unterschreiben* again

Before you move on

What does unterschreiben mean? ("To sign".) Say it once more.

152.2 verdienen — to earn

Before the new one: say the German for to move, then the German for to sign.

You'll want to know: verdienen

verdienen — "to earn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

verdienen ← Middle High German *verdienen* (EtymDB 2.1): *ver-* + the verb "to serve", Old High German *dionōn*. What you earn is what your service brings in.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: verdienen*
- *Say it: verdienen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *verdienen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to move, then the German for to sign, then say *verdienen* again

Before you move on

What does verdienen mean? ("To earn".) Say it once more.

152.3 verkaufen — to sell

Before the new one: say the German for to sign, then the German for to earn.

You'll want to know: verkaufen

verkaufen — "to sell".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

verkaufen is *ver-*, "away", + *kaufen*, "to buy": what you sell goes away from you. EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside Dutch *verkopen*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: verkaufen*
- *Say it: verkaufen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *verkaufen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to sign, then the German for to earn, then say *verkaufen* again

Before you move on

What does verkaufen mean? ("To sell".) Say it once more.

152.4 versprechen — to promise

Before the new one: say the German for to earn, then the German for to sell.

You'll want to know: versprechen

versprechen — "to promise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

versprechen ← Middle High German *versprechen*, "to guarantee" ← Old High German *firsprehhan* (EtymDB 2.1): *ver-* + the verb "to speak", the same verb as English *speak*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *versprechen*
- *Say it:* *versprechen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *versprechen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to earn, then the German for to sell, then say *versprechen* again

Before you move on

What does versprechen mean? ("To promise".) Say it once more.

152.5 vorstellen — to introduce

Before the new one: say the German for to sell, then the German for to promise.

You'll want to know: vorstellen

vorstellen — "to introduce".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vorstellen is the word for "before, in front" + *stellen*, "to put" ← Proto-Germanic **stallijanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1): to put someone in front of others.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vorstellen*
- *Say it: vorstellen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vorstellen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to sell, then the German for to promise, then say *vorstellen* again

Before you move on

What does vorstellen mean? ("To introduce".) Say it once more.

152.6 Words from chapters 144-147 — a first pass

Say the words for to promise and to introduce.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to change, to phone, to stop, to go out, to look
- to use, to go shopping, to invite, to recommend, to decide
- to explain, to be missing, to celebrate, to fill, to please
- to win, to hang, to marry, to know, to ring

Before you move on

To change? (**ändern**.) To phone? (**anrufen**.) To stop? (**aufhören**.) To go out? (**ausgehen**.) To look? (**aussehen**.) To use? (**benutzen**.) To go shopping? (**einkaufen**.) To invite? (**einladen**.) To recommend? (**empfehlen**.) To decide? (**entscheiden**.) To explain? (**erklären**.) To be missing? (**fehlen**.)

To celebrate? (**feiern**.) To fill? (**füllen**.) To please? (**gefallen**.) To win? (**gewinnen**.) To hang? (**hängen**.) To marry? (**heiraten**.) To know? (**kennen**.) To ring? (**klingeln**.)

152.7 Words from chapters 148-152 — a second pass

Say the words for to cost and to lend.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to cost, to lend, to love, to bring along, to take along
- to name, to smell, to collect, to give, to shout
- to save, to jump, to die, to disturb, to argue
- to meet, to dream, to practise, to think over, to move
- to sign, to earn, to sell, to promise, to introduce

Before you move on

To cost? (**kosten**.) To lend? (**leihen**.) To love? (**lieben**.) To bring along? (**mitbringen**.) To take along? (**mitnehmen**.) To name? (**nennen**.) To smell? (**riechen**.) To collect? (**sammeln**.) To give? (**schenken**.) To shout? (**schreien**.) To save? (**sparen**.) To jump? (**springen**.) To die? (**sterben**.) To disturb? (**stören**.) To argue? (**streiten**.) To meet? (**treffen**.) To dream? (**träumen**.) To practise? (**üben**.) To think over? (**überlegen**.) To move? (**umziehen**.) To sign? (**unterschreiben**.) To earn? (**verdienen**.) To sell? (**verkaufen**.) To promise? (**versprechen**.) To introduce? (**vorstellen**.)

Chapter 153

To hike, To change, To throw, To repeat, To pull

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to hike, to change, to throw, to repeat and to pull.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 153: I can say to hike, to change, to throw, to repeat and to pull.*

153.1 wandern — to hike

> Before the new one: say the German for to promise, then the German for to introduce.

You'll want to know: wandern

wandern — "to hike".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wandern ← Old High German *wantarōn* ← Proto-Germanic **wandrōną* — inherited, the same verb as English *wander*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *wandern*
- *Say it:* *wandern*, once more
- *Say it:* say *wandern*
- *Recall:* say the German for to promise, then the German for to introduce, then say *wandern* again

Before you move on

What does wandern mean? ("To hike".) Say it once more.

153.2 wechseln — to change (money), to switch

Before the new one: say the German for to introduce, then the German for to hike.

You'll want to know: wechseln

wechseln — "to change (money), to switch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wechseln ← Old High German *wehsalōn* ← Proto-Germanic **wihslōną*, "to change" — inherited; Dutch *wisselen* is the same verb. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *wechseln*
- *Say it:* *wechseln*, once more
- *Say it:* say *wechseln*
- *Recall:* say the German for to introduce, then the German for to hike, then say *wechseln* again

Before you move on

What does wechseln mean? (“To change (money), to switch”.) Say it once more.

153.3 werfen — to throw

Before the new one: say the German for to hike, then the German for to change.

You’ll want to know: werfen

werfen — “to throw”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

werfen ← Old High German *werfan* ← Proto-Germanic **werpanǫ*, “to throw, to turn” — inherited, the same verb as English *warp*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *werfen*
- *Say it:* *werfen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *werfen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to hike, then the German for to change, then say *werfen* again

Before you move on

What does werfen mean? (“To throw”.) Say it once more.

153.4 wiederholen — to repeat

Before the new one: say the German for to change, then the German for to throw.

You'll want to know: wiederholen

wiederholen — "to repeat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wiederholen is *wieder* + *holen*, "to fetch": to fetch something back. *holen* ← Middle High German *holen*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: wiederholen*
- *Say it: wiederholen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *wiederholen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to change, then the German for to throw, then say *wiederholen* again

Before you move on

What does wiederholen mean? ("To repeat".) Say it once more.

153.5 ziehen — to pull

Before the new one: say the German for to throw, then the German for to repeat.

You'll want to know: ziehen

ziehen — "to pull".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ziehen ← Old High German *ziohan* ← Proto-Germanic **teuhanq*, "to draw, to pull" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) English *tug* and *tow* come from the same root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ziehen*
- *Say it:* *ziehen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ziehen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to throw, then the German for to repeat, then say *ziehen* again

Before you move on

What does ziehen mean? ("To pull".) Say it once more.

Chapter 154

A workplace, A company, A colleague, A colleague, A job

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a workplace, a company, a colleague, a colleague and a job.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 154: I can say a workplace, a company, a colleague, a colleague and a job.*

154.1 der Arbeitsplatz — a workplace

Before the new one: say the German for to repeat, then the German for to pull.

You'll want to know: der Arbeitsplatz

der Arbeitsplatz — "a workplace".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Arbeitsplatz is *Arbeit* + the linking *-s-* + *Platz*, "place" (EtymDB 2.1): a place of work.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Arbeitsplatz*
- *Say it: der Arbeitsplatz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Arbeitsplatz*
- *Recall:* say the German for to repeat, then the German for to pull, then say *der Arbeitsplatz* again

Before you move on

What does der Arbeitsplatz mean? ("A workplace".) Say it once more.

154.2 die Firma — a company

Before the new one: say the German for to pull, then the German for a workplace.

You'll want to know: die Firma

die Firma — "a company".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Firma ← Italian *firma*, "signature" ← Latin *firmāre*, "to confirm" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: a firm is the name it signs with. English *firm* is the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Firma*
- *Say it: die Firma*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Firma*

- *Recall:* say the German for to pull, then the German for a workplace, then say *die Firma* again

Before you move on

What does die Firma mean? (“A company”.) Say it once more.

154.3 die Kollegin — a colleague (woman)

Before the new one: say the German for a workplace, then the German for a company.

You’ll want to know: die Kollegin

die Kollegin — “a colleague (woman)”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kollegin is the word for “colleague” + *-in*, the ending that names a woman. That word ← Latin *collēga*, “partner in office” (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Kollegin*
- *Say it: die Kollegin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Kollegin*
- *Recall:* say the German for a workplace, then the German for a company, then say *die Kollegin* again

Before you move on

What does die Kollegin mean? (“A colleague (woman)”.) Say it once more.

154.4 der Kollege — a colleague (man)

Before the new one: say the German for a company, then the German for a colleague.

You'll want to know: der Kollege

der Kollege — "a colleague (man)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kollege ← Latin *collēga*, "partner in office", from *com-*, "with", and *lēgāre*, "to delegate" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *colleague*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Kollege*
- *Say it: der Kollege*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Kollege*
- *Recall:* say the German for a company, then the German for a colleague, then say *der Kollege* again

Before you move on

What does der Kollege mean? ("A colleague (man)".) Say it once more.

154.5 die Stelle — a job, a position

Before the new one: say the German for a colleague, then the German for a colleague.

You'll want to know: die Stelle

die Stelle — "a job, a position".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Stelle, "a place", is the noun beside *stellen*, "to put" ← Proto-Germanic **stallijanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1). A job is a place you are put in.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *die Stelle*
- *Say it:* *die Stelle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Stelle*
- *Recall:* say the German for a colleague, then the German for a colleague, then say *die Stelle* again

Before you move on

What does die Stelle mean? ("A job, a position".) Say it once more.

Chapter 155

A salary, An identity card, A visa, A traffic jam, An accident

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a salary, an identity card, a visa, a traffic jam and an accident.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 155: I can say a salary, an identity card, a visa, a traffic jam and an accident.

155.1 das Gehalt — a salary

Before the new one: say the German for a colleague, then the German for a job.

You'll want to know: das Gehalt

das Gehalt — "a salary".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gehalt is *ge-* + the stem of the verb "to hold", Old High German *haltan*, English *hold* (EtymDB 2.1): first "what is held, the content", then a salary.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Gehalt*
- *Say it: das Gehalt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Gehalt*
- *Recall:* say the German for a colleague, then the German for a job, then say *das Gehalt* again

Before you move on

What does das Gehalt mean? ("A salary".) Say it once more.

155.2 der Ausweis — an identity card

Before the new one: say the German for a job, then the German for a salary.

You'll want to know: der Ausweis

der Ausweis — "an identity card".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ausweis comes from the verb "to prove who you are": *aus-*, "out", + an old verb meaning "to show the way", a cousin of English *wise*. An identity card shows who you are.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Ausweis*
- *Say it: der Ausweis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Ausweis*
- *Recall:* say the German for a job, then the German for a salary, then say *der Ausweis* again

Before you move on

What does der Ausweis mean? ("An identity card".) Say it once more.

155.3 das Visum — a visa

Before the new one: say the German for a salary, then the German for an identity card.

You'll want to know: das Visum

das Visum — "a visa".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Visum ← Latin *vīsum*, "seen" (EtymDB 2.1), from *vidēre*, "to see" — borrowed: a visa is a passport that has been seen and approved.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Visum*
- *Say it: das Visum*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Visum*
- *Recall:* say the German for a salary, then the German for an identity card, then say *das Visum* again

Before you move on

What does das Visum mean? ("A visa".) Say it once more.

155.4 der Stau — a traffic jam

Before the new one: say the German for an identity card, then the German for a visa.

You'll want to know: der Stau

der Stau — "a traffic jam".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Stau comes from the verb "to dam up, to hold back", Middle High German *stouwen* ← Old High German *stouwōn* (EtymDB 2.1). English *stow* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Stau*
- *Say it: der Stau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Stau*
- *Recall:* say the German for an identity card, then the German for a visa, then say *der Stau* again

Before you move on

What does der Stau mean? ("A traffic jam".) Say it once more.

155.5 der Unfall — an accident

Before the new one: say the German for a visa, then the German for a traffic jam.

You'll want to know: der Unfall

der Unfall — "an accident".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Unfall ← Middle High German *unval*, "mishap" (EtymDB 2.1): *un-*, "ill, bad", + the noun of *fallen*. An accident is a bad fall.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Unfall*
- *Say it: der Unfall*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Unfall*
- *Recall:* say the German for a visa, then the German for a traffic jam, then say *der Unfall* again

Before you move on

What does der Unfall mean? ("An accident".) Say it once more.

Chapter 156

A prescription, A pain, A cold, A cough, The flu

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a prescription, a pain, a cold, a cough and the flu.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 156: I can say a prescription, a pain, a cold, a cough and the flu.*

156.1 das Rezept — a prescription, a recipe

Before the new one: say the German for a traffic jam, then the German for an accident.

You'll want to know: das Rezept

das Rezept — "a prescription, a recipe".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Rezept ← Latin *receptum*, "(what is) received" (EtymDB 2.1), from *recipere*, "to take" — borrowed. Doctors' prescriptions began *recipe*, "take!".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Rezept*
- *Say it: das Rezept*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Rezept*
- *Recall:* say the German for a traffic jam, then the German for an accident, then say *das Rezept* again

Before you move on

What does das Rezept mean? ("A prescription, a recipe".) Say it once more.

156.2 der Schmerz — a pain

Before the new one: say the German for an accident, then the German for a prescription.

You'll want to know: der Schmerz

der Schmerz — "a pain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schmerz ← Middle High German *smërze* — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *smart*, "a sharp pain", and Dutch *smart*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Schmerz*
- *Say it: der Schmerz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Schmerz*
- *Recall:* say the German for an accident, then the German for a prescription, then say *der Schmerz* again

Before you move on

What does der Schmerz mean? ("A pain".) Say it once more.

156.3 die Erkältung — a cold

Before the new one: say the German for a prescription, then the German for a pain.

You'll want to know: die Erkältung

die Erkältung — "a cold".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Erkältung is the noun of the verb "to catch a chill", Middle High German *erkelten* (EtymDB 2.1): *er-* + the word for "cold", Old High German *kalt*, English *cold*, + *-ung*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Erkältung*
- *Say it: die Erkältung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Erkältung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a prescription, then the German for a pain, then say *die Erkältung* again

Before you move on

What does die Erkältung mean? ("A cold".) Say it once more.

156.4 der Husten — a cough

Before the new one: say the German for a pain, then the German for a cold.

You'll want to know: der Husten

der Husten — "a cough".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Husten ← Old High German *huosto* ← Proto-Germanic **hwōstô*, "cough" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) Old English *hwōsta* was the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Husten*
- *Say it: der Husten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Husten*
- *Recall:* say the German for a pain, then the German for a cold, then say *der Husten* again

Before you move on

What does der Husten mean? ("A cough".) Say it once more.

156.5 die Grippe — the flu

Before the new one: say the German for a cold, then the German for a cough.

You'll want to know: die Grippe

die Grippe — "the flu".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Grippe ← French *grippe*, "flu, a seizing", from Frankish **grīpan*, "to seize" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed from French, which took it from Germanic. English *grip* shares the root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Grippe*
- *Say it: die Grippe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Grippe*
- *Recall:* say the German for a cold, then the German for a cough, then say *die Grippe* again

Before you move on

What does die Grippe mean? ("The flu".) Say it once more.

Chapter 157

A tablet, Insurance, A bank account, A credit card, A price

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a tablet, insurance, a bank account, a credit card and a price.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 157: I can say a tablet, insurance, a bank account, a credit card and a price.*

157.1 die Tablette — a tablet

Before the new one: say the German for a cough, then the German for the flu.

You'll want to know: die Tablette

die Tablette — "a tablet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Tablette ← French *tablette*, "a little tablet" (EtymDB 2.1), a diminutive of the word that goes back to Latin *tabula*, "board" — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Tablette*
- *Say it: die Tablette*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Tablette*
- *Recall:* say the German for a cough, then the German for the flu, then say *die Tablette* again

Before you move on

What does die Tablette mean? ("A tablet".) Say it once more.

157.2 die Versicherung — insurance

Before the new one: say the German for the flu, then the German for a tablet.

You'll want to know: die Versicherung

die Versicherung — "insurance".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Versicherung is the noun of the verb "to insure" (EtymDB 2.1), built from *ver-* + *sicher*, "safe", which goes back to Latin *sēcūrus*: insurance makes you safe.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Versicherung*
- *Say it: die Versicherung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Versicherung*
- *Recall:* say the German for the flu, then the German for a tablet, then say *die Versicherung* again

Before you move on

What does die Versicherung mean? ("Insurance".) Say it once more.

157.3 das Konto — a bank account

Before the new one: say the German for a tablet, then the German for insurance.

You'll want to know: das Konto

das Konto — "a bank account".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Konto ← Italian *conto*, "calculation, account" (EtymDB 2.1), from Latin *computāre*, "to reckon" — borrowed. English *count* and *account* share the word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Konto*
- *Say it: das Konto*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Konto*
- *Recall:* say the German for a tablet, then the German for insurance, then say *das Konto* again

Before you move on

What does das Konto mean? ("A bank account".) Say it once more.

157.4 die Kreditkarte — a credit card

Before the new one: say the German for insurance, then the German for a bank account.

You'll want to know: die Kreditkarte

die Kreditkarte — "a credit card".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kreditkarte is *Kredit*, "credit" ← French *crédit* ← Latin *crēditum*, "a loan, a thing trusted", + *Karte*, "card" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Kreditkarte*
- *Say it: die Kreditkarte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Kreditkarte*
- *Recall:* say the German for insurance, then the German for a bank account, then say *die Kreditkarte* again

Before you move on

What does die Kreditkarte mean? ("A credit card".) Say it once more.

157.5 der Preis — a price, a prize

Before the new one: say the German for a bank account, then the German for a credit card.

You'll want to know: der Preis

der Preis — "a price, a prize".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Preis ← Middle High German *prīs*, from Old French *pris* ← Latin *pretium*, "worth, price, reward" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed. English *price*, *prize* and *praise* share it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Preis*
- *Say it: der Preis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Preis*
- *Recall:* say the German for a bank account, then the German for a credit card, then say *der Preis* again

Before you move on

What does der Preis mean? ("A price, a prize".) Say it once more.

Chapter 158

An offer, A bill, A bag, A parcel, A stamp

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an offer, a bill, a bag, a parcel and a stamp.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 158: I can say an offer, a bill, a bag, a parcel and a stamp.

158.1 das Angebot — an offer

Before the new one: say the German for a credit card, then the German for a price.

You'll want to know: das Angebot

das Angebot — "an offer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Angebot is the noun of the verb "to offer": *an-* + a verb meaning "to offer, to bid", which EtymDB 2.1 lists beside English *bid* and Dutch *bieden*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Angebot*
- *Say it: das Angebot*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Angebot*
- *Recall:* say the German for a credit card, then the German for a price, then say *das Angebot* again

Before you move on

What does das Angebot mean? (“An offer”.) Say it once more.

158.2 die Rechnung — a bill

Before the new one: say the German for a price, then the German for an offer.

You’ll want to know: die Rechnung

die Rechnung — “a bill”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Rechnung is the verb “to reckon”, Old High German *rehhanōn* ← Proto-Germanic **rekanōną*, + *-ung* — EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *reckoning*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Rechnung*
- *Say it: die Rechnung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Rechnung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a price, then the German for an offer, then say *die Rechnung* again

Before you move on

What does die Rechnung mean? ("A bill".) Say it once more.

158.3 die Tüte — a bag (paper or plastic)

Before the new one: say the German for an offer, then the German for a bill.

You'll want to know: die Tüte

die Tüte — "a bag (paper or plastic)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Tüte ← Middle Low German *tūte* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed from Low German; EtymDB lists Dutch *tuit*, "spout", beside it. A paper bag was rolled into a cone.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Tüte*
- *Say it: die Tüte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Tüte*
- *Recall:* say the German for an offer, then the German for a bill, then say *die Tüte* again

Before you move on

What does die Tüte mean? ("A bag (paper or plastic)".) Say it once more.

158.4 das Paket — a parcel

Before the new one: say the German for a bill, then the German for a bag.

You'll want to know: das Paket

das Paket — "a parcel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Paket ← French *paquet*, "packet", from Dutch *pak*, "bundle" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed. English *packet* is the same French word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Paket*
- *Say it: das Paket*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Paket*
- *Recall:* say the German for a bill, then the German for a bag, then say *das Paket* again

Before you move on

What does das Paket mean? ("A parcel".) Say it once more.

158.5 die Briefmarke — a stamp

Before the new one: say the German for a bag, then the German for a parcel.

You'll want to know: die Briefmarke

die Briefmarke — "a stamp".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Briefmarke is the word for "letter" + *Marke*, "token, mark" ← French *marque* (EtymDB 2.1): a token stuck on a letter.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Briefmarke*
- *Say it: die Briefmarke*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Briefmarke*
- *Recall:* say the German for a bag, then the German for a parcel, then say *die Briefmarke* again

Before you move on

What does die Briefmarke mean? ("A stamp".) Say it once more.

Chapter 159

An address, A phone number, The internet, An email, A message

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an address, a phone number, the internet, an email and a message.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 159: I can say an address, a phone number, the internet, an email and a message.*

159.1 die Adresse — an address

> Before the new one: say the German for a parcel, then the German for a stamp.

You'll want to know: die Adresse

die Adresse — "an address".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Adresse ← French *adresse* (EtymDB 2.1), from *adresser*, "to direct" — borrowed, like English *address*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Adresse*
- *Say it: die Adresse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Adresse*
- *Recall:* say the German for a parcel, then the German for a stamp, then say *die Adresse* again

Before you move on

What does die Adresse mean? ("An address".) Say it once more.

159.2 die Telefonnummer — a phone number

Before the new one: say the German for a stamp, then the German for an address.

You'll want to know: die Telefonnummer

die Telefonnummer — "a phone number".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Telefonnummer is *Telefon* + the word for "number", which came from Italian *numero* ← Latin *numerus*, "number". EtymDB 2.1 has the Latin word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Telefonnummer*
- *Say it: die Telefonnummer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Telefonnummer*
- *Recall:* say the German for a stamp, then the German for an address, then say *die Telefonnummer* again

Before you move on

What does die Telefonnummer mean? (“A phone number”.) Say it once more.

159.3 das Internet — the internet

Before the new one: say the German for an address, then the German for a phone number.

You’ll want to know: das Internet

das Internet — “the internet”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Internet ← English *Internet* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, built from Latin *inter*, “between”, and English *net*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Internet*
- *Say it: das Internet*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Internet*
- *Recall:* say the German for an address, then the German for a phone number, then say *das Internet* again

Before you move on

What does das Internet mean? (“The internet”.) Say it once more.

159.4 die E-Mail — an email

Before the new one: say the German for a phone number, then the German for the internet.

You'll want to know: die E-Mail

die E-Mail — "an email".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

E-Mail ← English *e-mail*, short for "electronic mail" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die E-Mail*
- *Say it: die E-Mail*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die E-Mail*
- *Recall:* say the German for a phone number, then the German for the internet, then say *die E-Mail* again

Before you move on

What does die E-Mail mean? ("An email".) Say it once more.

159.5 die Nachricht — a message, the news

Before the new one: say the German for the internet, then the German for an email.

You'll want to know: die Nachricht

die Nachricht — "a message, the news".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Nachricht is the word for "after" + a noun from the verb "to direct, to set right", Old High German *rihten* (EtymDB 2.1): first an instruction to go by, then news.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Nachricht*
- *Say it: die Nachricht*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Nachricht*
- *Recall:* say the German for the internet, then the German for an email, then say *die Nachricht* again

Before you move on

What does die Nachricht mean? ("A message, the news".) Say it once more.

Chapter 160

A university, A course, A task, A dictionary, A mistake

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a university, a course, a task, a dictionary and a mistake.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 160: I can say a university, a course, a task, a dictionary and a mistake.*

160.1 die Universität — a university

> Before the new one: say the German for an email, then the German for a message.

You'll want to know: die Universität

die Universität — "a university".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Universität ← Latin *ūniversitās*, "the whole, a community", in the Middle Ages a guild of teachers and students (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Universität*
- *Say it: die Universität*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Universität*
- *Recall:* say the German for an email, then the German for a message, then say *die Universität* again

Before you move on

What does die Universität mean? ("A university".) Say it once more.

160.2 der Kurs — a course

Before the new one: say the German for a message, then the German for a university.

You'll want to know: der Kurs

der Kurs — "a course".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kurs ← Latin *cursus*, "a running, a course", from *currere*, "to run" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *course*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Kurs*
- *Say it: der Kurs*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Kurs*
- *Recall:* say the German for a message, then the German for a university, then say *der Kurs* again

Before you move on

What does der Kurs mean? ("A course".) Say it once more.

160.3 die Aufgabe — a task, an exercise

Before the new one: say the German for a university, then the German for a course.

You'll want to know: die Aufgabe

die Aufgabe — "a task, an exercise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Aufgabe ← Middle High German *ūfgābe* (EtymDB 2.1): *auf* + the word for "gift", from the verb "to give". A task is something given to you.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Aufgabe*
- *Say it: die Aufgabe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Aufgabe*
- *Recall:* say the German for a university, then the German for a course, then say *die Aufgabe* again

Before you move on

What does die Aufgabe mean? ("A task, an exercise".) Say it once more.

160.4 das Wörterbuch — a dictionary

Before the new one: say the German for a course, then the German for a task.

You'll want to know: das Wörterbuch

das Wörterbuch — "a dictionary".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wörterbuch is *Wörter*, the plural of *Wort*, + the word for "book", Old High German *buoh* (EtymDB 2.1): a book of words, like Dutch *woordenboek*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Wörterbuch*
- *Say it: das Wörterbuch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Wörterbuch*
- *Recall:* say the German for a course, then the German for a task, then say *das Wörterbuch* again

Before you move on

What does das Wörterbuch mean? ("A dictionary".) Say it once more.

160.5 der Fehler — a mistake

Before the new one: say the German for a task, then the German for a dictionary.

You'll want to know: der Fehler

der Fehler — "a mistake".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Fehler is *fehlen* + *-er*: where something fails. *fehlen* came from Old French *faillir*, “to fail” (EtymDB 2.1).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *der Fehler*
- *Say it:* *der Fehler*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Fehler*
- *Recall:* say the German for a task, then the German for a dictionary, then say *der Fehler* again

Before you move on

What does der Fehler mean? (“A mistake”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 161

A house, A bedroom, A living room, A balcony, A cellar

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a house, a bedroom, a living room, a balcony and a cellar.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 161: I can say a house, a bedroom, a living room, a balcony and a cellar.*

161.1 das Haus — a house

> Before the new one: say the German for a dictionary, then the German for a mistake.

You'll want to know: das Haus

das Haus — "a house".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Haus ← Old High German *hūs* ← Proto-Germanic **hūsą*, "dwelling" — inherited, the same word as English *house*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Haus*
- *Say it: das Haus*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Haus*
- *Recall:* say the German for a dictionary, then the German for a mistake, then say *das Haus* again

Before you move on

What does das Haus mean? ("A house".) Say it once more.

161.2 das Schlafzimmer — a bedroom

Before the new one: say the German for a mistake, then the German for a house.

You'll want to know: das Schlafzimmer

das Schlafzimmer — "a bedroom".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schlafzimmer is the stem of *schlafen*, "to sleep", + *Zimmer*, "room", which first meant "timber" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Schlafzimmer*
- *Say it: das Schlafzimmer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Schlafzimmer*
- *Recall:* say the German for a mistake, then the German for a house, then say *das Schlafzimmer* again

Before you move on

What does das Schlafzimmer mean? (“A bedroom”.) Say it once more.

161.3 das Wohnzimmer — a living room

Before the new one: say the German for a house, then the German for a bedroom.

You’ll want to know: das Wohnzimmer

das Wohnzimmer — “a living room”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wohnzimmer is *wohnen*, “to live”, + *Zimmer*, “room” (EtymDB 2.1): the room you live in.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Wohnzimmer*
- *Say it: das Wohnzimmer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Wohnzimmer*
- *Recall:* say the German for a house, then the German for a bedroom, then say *das Wohnzimmer* again

Before you move on

What does das Wohnzimmer mean? (“A living room”.) Say it once more.

161.4 der Balkon — a balcony

Before the new one: say the German for a bedroom, then the German for a living room.

You'll want to know: der Balkon

der Balkon — "a balcony".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Balkon ← French *balcon* ← Italian *balcone*, from a Lombardic word for "beam" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *balcony*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Balkon*
- *Say it: der Balkon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Balkon*
- *Recall:* say the German for a bedroom, then the German for a living room, then say *der Balkon* again

Before you move on

What does der Balkon mean? ("A balcony".) Say it once more.

161.5 der Keller — a cellar

Before the new one: say the German for a living room, then the German for a balcony.

You'll want to know: der Keller

der Keller — "a cellar".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Keller ← Old High German *kellari* ← Late Latin *cellārium*, "storeroom", from *cella*, "room" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *cellar*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Keller*
- *Say it: der Keller*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Keller*
- *Recall:* say the German for a living room, then the German for a balcony, then say *der Keller* again

Before you move on

What does der Keller mean? ("A cellar".) Say it once more.

161.6 Words from chapters 153-156 — a first pass

Say the words for a balcony and a cellar.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to hike, to change, to throw, to repeat, to pull
- a workplace, a company, a colleague, a colleague, a job
- a salary, an identity card, a visa, a traffic jam, an accident
- a prescription, a pain, a cold, a cough, the flu

Before you move on

To hike? (**wandern**.) To change? (**wechseln**.) To throw? (**werfen**.) To repeat? (**wiederholen**.) To pull? (**ziehen**.) A workplace? (**der Arbeitsplatz**.) A company? (**die Firma**.) A colleague? (**die Kollegin**.) A colleague? (**der Kollege**.) A job? (**die Stelle**.) A salary? (**das Gehalt**.) An identity card? (**der Ausweis**.) A visa? (**das Visum**.) A traffic jam? (**der Stau**.) An accident? (**der Unfall**.) A prescription? (**das Rezept**.) A pain? (**der Schmerz**.) A cold? (**die Erkältung**.) A cough? (**der Husten**.) The flu? (**die Grippe**.)

161.7 Words from chapters 157-161 — a second pass

Say the words for a tablet and insurance.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a tablet, insurance, a bank account, a credit card, a price
- an offer, a bill, a bag, a parcel, a stamp
- an address, a phone number, the internet, an email, a message
- a university, a course, a task, a dictionary, a mistake
- a house, a bedroom, a living room, a balcony, a cellar

Before you move on

A tablet? (**die Tablette**.) Insurance? (**die Versicherung**.) A bank account? (**das Konto**.) A credit card? (**die Kreditkarte**.) A price? (**der Preis**.) An offer? (**das Angebot**.) A bill? (**die Rechnung**.) A bag? (**die Tüte**.) A parcel? (**das Paket**.) A stamp? (**die Briefmarke**.) An address? (**die Adresse**.) A phone number? (**die Telefonnummer**.) The internet? (**das Internet**.) An email? (**die E-Mail**.) A message? (**die Nachricht**.) A university? (**die Universität**.) A course? (**der Kurs**.) A task?

(**die Aufgabe**.) A dictionary? (**das Wörterbuch**.) A mistake? (**der Fehler**.) A house? (**das Haus**.) A bedroom? (**das Schlafzimmer**.) A living room? (**das Wohnzimmer**.) A balcony? (**der Balkon**.) A cellar? (**der Keller**.)

Chapter 162

A sofa, A radio, The weather, The wind, A thunderstorm

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a sofa, a radio, the weather, the wind and a thunderstorm.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 162: I can say a sofa, a radio, the weather, the wind and a thunderstorm.

162.1 das Sofa — a sofa

Before the new one: say the German for a balcony, then the German for a cellar.

You'll want to know: das Sofa

das Sofa — "a sofa".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Sofa came in from French *sofa*, which EtymDB 2.1 traces to Arabic *ṣuffa*, "a long raised bench" — borrowed, like English *sofa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Sofa*
- *Say it: das Sofa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Sofa*
- *Recall:* say the German for a balcony, then the German for a cellar, then say *das Sofa* again

Before you move on

What does das Sofa mean? ("A sofa".) Say it once more.

162.2 das Radio — a radio

Before the new one: say the German for a cellar, then the German for a sofa.

You'll want to know: das Radio

das Radio — "a radio".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Radio ← English *radio* (EtymDB 2.1), short for *radiotelegraphy* and built on Latin *radius*, "ray, spoke" — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Radio*
- *Say it: das Radio*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Radio*
- *Recall:* say the German for a cellar, then the German for a sofa, then say *das Radio* again

Before you move on

What does das Radio mean? (“A radio”.) Say it once more.

162.3 das Wetter — the weather

Before the new one: say the German for a sofa, then the German for a radio.

You’ll want to know: das Wetter

das Wetter — “the weather”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wetter ← Old High German *wetar* ← Proto-Germanic **wedrą* — inherited, the same word as English *weather*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Wetter*
- *Say it: das Wetter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Wetter*
- *Recall:* say the German for a sofa, then the German for a radio, then say *das Wetter* again

Before you move on

What does das Wetter mean? (“The weather”.) Say it once more.

162.4 der Wind — the wind

Before the new one: say the German for a radio, then the German for the weather.

You'll want to know: der Wind

der Wind — "the wind".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wind ← Old High German *wint* ← Proto-Germanic **windaz* — inherited, the same word as English *wind*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Wind*
- *Say it: der Wind*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Wind*
- *Recall:* say the German for a radio, then the German for the weather, then say *der Wind* again

Before you move on

What does der Wind mean? ("The wind".) Say it once more.

162.5 das Gewitter — a thunderstorm

Before the new one: say the German for the weather, then the German for the wind.

You'll want to know: das Gewitter

das Gewitter — "a thunderstorm".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gewitter ← Old High German *giwitiri*: *ge-*, the gathering prefix, + *Wetter*, "weather" (EtymDB 2.1 has *giwitiri*). A thunderstorm is weather all at once.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Gewitter*
- *Say it: das Gewitter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Gewitter*
- *Recall:* say the German for the weather, then the German for the wind, then say *das Gewitter* again

Before you move on

What does das Gewitter mean? ("A thunderstorm".) Say it once more.

Chapter 163

The temperature, A birthday, A wedding, A party, An invitation

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say the temperature, a birthday, a wedding, a party and an invitation.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 163: I can say the temperature, a birthday, a wedding, a party and an invitation.

163.1 die Temperatur — the temperature

Before the new one: say the German for the wind, then the German for a thunderstorm.

You'll want to know: die Temperatur

die Temperatur — "the temperature".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Temperatur ← Latin *temperātūra*, "due measure, mixture", from *temperāre*, "to mix in proportion" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Temperatur*
- *Say it: die Temperatur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Temperatur*
- *Recall:* say the German for the wind, then the German for a thunderstorm, then say *die Temperatur* again

Before you move on

What does die Temperatur mean? ("The temperature".) Say it once more.

163.2 der Geburtstag — a birthday

Before the new one: say the German for a thunderstorm, then the German for the temperature.

You'll want to know: der Geburtstag

der Geburtstag — "a birthday".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Geburtstag is the word for "birth", Old High German *giburt*, + *-s-* + *Tag* (EtymDB 2.1): the day of your birth. English *birth* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Geburtstag*
- *Say it: der Geburtstag*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Geburtstag*
- *Recall:* say the German for a thunderstorm, then the German for the temperature, then say *der Geburtstag* again

Before you move on

What does der Geburtstag mean? ("A birthday".) Say it once more.

163.3 die Hochzeit — a wedding

Before the new one: say the German for the temperature, then the German for a birthday.

You'll want to know: die Hochzeit

die Hochzeit — "a wedding".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Hochzeit ← Middle High German *hōchzīt*, "high time, festival" (EtymDB 2.1): *hoch* + *Zeit*. The great feast of a life became the wedding.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Hochzeit*
- *Say it: die Hochzeit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Hochzeit*
- *Recall:* say the German for the temperature, then the German for a birthday, then say *die Hochzeit* again

Before you move on

What does die Hochzeit mean? ("A wedding".) Say it once more.

163.4 die Party — a party

Before the new one: say the German for a birthday, then the German for a wedding.

You'll want to know: die Party

die Party — "a party".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Party ← English *party*, from Old French *partie*, "a part, a side" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Party*
- *Say it: die Party*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Party*
- *Recall:* say the German for a birthday, then the German for a wedding, then say *die Party* again

Before you move on

What does die Party mean? ("A party".) Say it once more.

163.5 die Einladung — an invitation

Before the new one: say the German for a wedding, then the German for a party.

You'll want to know: die Einladung

die Einladung — "an invitation".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Einladung is *einladen*, "to invite" ← Old High German *inladōn* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-ung*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Einladung*
- *Say it: die Einladung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Einladung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a wedding, then the German for a party, then say *die Einladung* again

Before you move on

What does die Einladung mean? ("An invitation".) Say it once more.

Chapter 164

A neighbour, A cousin, A granddaughter, A baby, A human being

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a neighbour, a cousin, a granddaughter, a baby and a human being.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 164: I can say a neighbour, a cousin, a granddaughter, a baby and a human being.

164.1 die Nachbarin — a neighbour (woman)

Before the new one: say the German for a party, then the German for an invitation.

You'll want to know: die Nachbarin

die Nachbarin — "a neighbour (woman)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Nachbarin is *Nachbar* + *-in*, the ending that names a woman. *Nachbar* ← Middle High German *nāchbūre*, "the one who dwells near". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Nachbarin*
- *Say it: die Nachbarin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Nachbarin*
- *Recall:* say the German for a party, then the German for an invitation, then say *die Nachbarin* again

Before you move on

What does die Nachbarin mean? ("A neighbour (woman)".) Say it once more.

164.2 die Cousine — a cousin (woman)

Before the new one: say the German for an invitation, then the German for a neighbour.

You'll want to know: die Cousine

die Cousine — "a cousin (woman)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Cousine ← French *cousine* ← Latin *cōnsōbrīna*, a cousin on the mother's side (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *cousin*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Cousine*
- *Say it: die Cousine*, once more

- *Say it:* say *die Cousine*
- *Recall:* say the German for an invitation, then the German for a neighbour, then say *die Cousine* again

Before you move on

What does die Cousine mean? (“A cousin (woman)”.) Say it once more.

164.3 die Enkelin — a granddaughter

Before the new one: say the German for a neighbour, then the German for a cousin.

You’ll want to know: die Enkelin

die Enkelin — “a granddaughter”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Enkelin is *Enkel* + *-in*, the ending that names a woman or girl. *Enkel* ← Old High German *eniklīn*, “little grandfather”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Enkelin*
- *Say it: die Enkelin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Enkelin*
- *Recall:* say the German for a neighbour, then the German for a cousin, then say *die Enkelin* again

Before you move on

What does die Enkelin mean? (“A granddaughter”.) Say it once more.

164.4 das Baby — a baby

Before the new one: say the German for a cousin, then the German for a granddaughter.

You'll want to know: das Baby

das Baby — "a baby".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Baby ← English *baby* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Baby*
- *Say it: das Baby*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Baby*
- *Recall:* say the German for a cousin, then the German for a granddaughter, then say *das Baby* again

Before you move on

What does das Baby mean? ("A baby".) Say it once more.

164.5 der Mensch — a human being

Before the new one: say the German for a granddaughter, then the German for a baby.

You'll want to know: der Mensch

der Mensch — "a human being".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mensch ← Middle High German *mensche* (EtymDB 2.1), from Old High German *mennisco*, "human", built on *man*, "person" ← Proto-Germanic **mann-* + *-isk*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Mensch*
- *Say it: der Mensch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Mensch*
- *Recall:* say the German for a granddaughter, then the German for a baby, then say *der Mensch* again

Before you move on

What does der Mensch mean? ("A human being".) Say it once more.

Chapter 165

People, Luck, Fun, Desire, An opinion

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say people, luck, fun, desire and an opinion.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 165: I can say people, luck, fun, desire and an opinion.*

165.1 die Leute — people

> Before the new one: say the German for a baby, then the German for a human being.

You'll want to know: die Leute

die Leute — "people".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Leute ← Middle High German *liute* ← Old High German *liuti*, "people" ← Proto-Germanic **liudiz* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Leute*
- *Say it: die Leute*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Leute*
- *Recall:* say the German for a baby, then the German for a human being, then say *die Leute* again

Before you move on

What does die Leute mean? ("People".) Say it once more.

165.2 das Glück — luck, happiness

Before the new one: say the German for a human being, then the German for people.

You'll want to know: das Glück

das Glück — "luck, happiness".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Glück ← Middle High German *gelücke*, "luck" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited. English *luck* is the same word, taken from Low German or Dutch; where *gelücke* came from is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Glück*
- *Say it: das Glück*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Glück*
- *Recall:* say the German for a human being, then the German for people, then say *das Glück* again

Before you move on

What does das Glück mean? ("Luck, happiness".) Say it once more.

165.3 der Spaß — fun

Before the new one: say the German for people, then the German for luck.

You'll want to know: der Spaß

der Spaß — "fun".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Spaß ← Italian *spasso*, "pastime, amusement" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Spaß*
- *Say it: der Spaß*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Spaß*
- *Recall:* say the German for people, then the German for luck, then say *der Spaß* again

Before you move on

What does der Spaß mean? ("Fun".) Say it once more.

165.4 die Lust — desire (Lust haben: to feel like)

Before the new one: say the German for luck, then the German for fun.

You'll want to know: die Lust

die Lust — "desire (Lust haben: to feel like)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Lust ← Old High German *lust* ← Proto-Germanic **lustuz*, "pleasure, desire" — inherited, the same word as English *lust*, which narrowed its meaning. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Lust*
- *Say it: die Lust*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Lust*
- *Recall:* say the German for luck, then the German for fun, then say *die Lust* again

Before you move on

What does die Lust mean? ("Desire (Lust haben: to feel like)".) Say it once more.

165.5 die Meinung — an opinion

Before the new one: say the German for fun, then the German for desire.

You'll want to know: die Meinung

die Meinung — "an opinion".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Meinung is the verb "to think, to mean", Old High German *meinen* ← Proto-Germanic **mainijanǫ*, + *-ung* (EtymDB 2.1). The verb is the

same as English *mean*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Meinung*
- *Say it: die Meinung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Meinung*
- *Recall:* say the German for fun, then the German for desire, then say *die Meinung* again

Before you move on

What does die Meinung mean? ("An opinion".) Say it once more.

Chapter 166

A reason, A solution, Experience, A possibility, The afternoon

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a reason, a solution, experience, a possibility and the afternoon.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 166: I can say a reason, a solution, experience, a possibility and the afternoon.

166.1 der Grund — a reason

Before the new one: say the German for desire, then the German for an opinion.

You'll want to know: der Grund

der Grund — "a reason".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Grund ← Old High German *grunt* ← Proto-Germanic **grunduz* — inherited, the same word as English *ground*. (EtymDB 2.1) A reason is the ground something stands on.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Grund*
- *Say it: der Grund*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Grund*
- *Recall:* say the German for desire, then the German for an opinion, then say *der Grund* again

Before you move on

What does der Grund mean? ("A reason".) Say it once more.

166.2 die Lösung — a solution

Before the new one: say the German for an opinion, then the German for a reason.

You'll want to know: die Lösung

die Lösung — "a solution".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Lösung is the verb "to loosen, to release", Old High German *lōsen* ← Proto-Germanic **lausijanǫ*, built on **lausaz*, "loose" (EtymDB 2.1), + *-ung*. A solution unties a knot.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Lösung*
- *Say it: die Lösung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Lösung*
- *Recall:* say the German for an opinion, then the German for a reason, then say *die Lösung* again

Before you move on

What does die Lösung mean? ("A solution".) Say it once more.

166.3 die Erfahrung — experience

Before the new one: say the German for a reason, then the German for a solution.

You'll want to know: die Erfahrung

die Erfahrung — "experience".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Erfahrung is the noun of the verb "to experience", Old High German *irfaran*, "to travel through, to explore" (EtymDB 2.1): *er-* + *fahren*. Experience is what you learn on the road.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Erfahrung*
- *Say it: die Erfahrung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Erfahrung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a reason, then the German for a solution, then say *die Erfahrung* again

Before you move on

What does die Erfahrung mean? ("Experience".) Say it once more.

166.4 die Möglichkeit — a possibility

Before the new one: say the German for a solution, then the German for experience.

You'll want to know: die Möglichkeit

die Möglichkeit — "a possibility".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Möglichkeit is the word for "possible" + *-keit*, the ending that makes a noun. "Possible" is built on *mögen*, "to be able", which EtymDB 2.1 traces to Proto-Germanic **magang*, the verb behind English *may*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Möglichkeit*
- *Say it: die Möglichkeit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Möglichkeit*
- *Recall:* say the German for a solution, then the German for experience, then say *die Möglichkeit* again

Before you move on

What does die Möglichkeit mean? ("A possibility".) Say it once more.

166.5 der Nachmittag — the afternoon

Before the new one: say the German for experience, then the German for a possibility.

You'll want to know: der Nachmittag

der Nachmittag — "the afternoon".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Nachmittag is the word for "after" + *Mittag*, "noon": after noon, built the same way as English *afternoon*. *Mittag* is built from *Mitte*,

"middle", inherited from Proto-Germanic **midją* (EtymDB 2.1), and *Tag*, "day".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Nachmittag*
- *Say it: der Nachmittag*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Nachmittag*
- *Recall:* say the German for experience, then the German for a possibility, then say *der Nachmittag* again

Before you move on

What does der Nachmittag mean? ("The afternoon".) Say it once more.

Chapter 167

Comfortable, Unfriendly, Polite, Exciting, Possible

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say comfortable, unfriendly, polite, exciting and possible.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 167: I can say comfortable, unfriendly, polite, exciting and possible.

167.1 bequem — comfortable

Before the new one: say the German for a possibility, then the German for the afternoon.

You'll want to know: bequem

bequem — "comfortable".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bequem ← Middle High German *bequæme*, "fitting, suitable" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, built on the root of *kommen*: what comes in handy.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bequem*
- *Say it: bequem*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bequem*
- *Recall:* say the German for a possibility, then the German for the afternoon, then say *bequem* again

Before you move on

What does bequem mean? ("Comfortable".) Say it once more.

167.2 unfreundlich — unfriendly

Before the new one: say the German for the afternoon, then the German for comfortable.

You'll want to know: unfreundlich

unfreundlich — "unfriendly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

unfreundlich is *un-*, "not", + *freundlich* (EtymDB 2.1), which is built on *Freund*, "friend".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: unfreundlich*
- *Say it: unfreundlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *unfreundlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for the afternoon, then the German for comfortable, then say *unfreundlich* again

Before you move on

What does unfreundlich mean? ("Unfriendly".) Say it once more.

167.3 höflich — polite

Before the new one: say the German for comfortable, then the German for unfriendly.

You'll want to know: höflich

höflich — "polite".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

höflich ← Middle High German *hovelich*, "in keeping with the customs of the court": the word for "court" + *-lich* (EtymDB 2.1). English *courteous* is built on *court* the same way.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: höflich*
- *Say it: höflich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *höflich*
- *Recall:* say the German for comfortable, then the German for unfriendly, then say *höflich* again

Before you move on

What does höflich mean? ("Polite".) Say it once more.

167.4 spannend — exciting

Before the new one: say the German for unfriendly, then the German for polite.

You'll want to know: spannend

spannend — "exciting".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

spannend is the present participle of the verb "to stretch, to tighten", Old High German *spannan* ← Proto-Germanic **spannanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1): what keeps you tense. English *span* shares the root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *spannend*
- *Say it:* *spannend*, once more
- *Say it:* say *spannend*
- *Recall:* say the German for unfriendly, then the German for polite, then say *spannend* again

Before you move on

What does spannend mean? ("Exciting".) Say it once more.

167.5 möglich — possible

Before the new one: say the German for polite, then the German for exciting.

You'll want to know: möglich

möglich — "possible".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

möglich is the stem of *mögen*, "to be able", + *-lich*: what can be. EtymDB 2.1 traces *mögen* to Old High German *mugan* ← Proto-Germanic **maganǫ*, the verb behind English *may*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: möglich*
- *Say it: möglich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *möglich*
- *Recall:* say the German for polite, then the German for exciting, then say *möglich* again

Before you move on

What does möglich mean? ("Possible".) Say it once more.

167.6 Words from chapters 162-164 — a first pass

Say the words for exciting and possible.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a sofa, a radio, the weather, the wind, a thunderstorm
- the temperature, a birthday, a wedding, a party, an invitation
- a neighbour, a cousin, a granddaughter, a baby, a human being

Before you move on

A sofa? (**das Sofa**.) A radio? (**das Radio**.) The weather? (**das Wetter**.) The wind? (**der Wind**.) A thunderstorm? (**das Gewitter**.) The temperature? (**die Temperatur**.) A birthday? (**der Geburtstag**.) A wedding? (**die Hochzeit**.) A party? (**die Party**.) An invitation? (**die Einladung**.) A neighbour? (**die Nachbarin**.) A cousin? (**die Cousine**.) A granddaughter? (**die Enkelin**.) A baby? (**das Baby**.) A human being? (**der Mensch**.)

167.7 Words from chapters 165-167 — a second pass

Say the words for people and luck.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- people, luck, fun, desire, an opinion
- a reason, a solution, experience, a possibility, the afternoon
- comfortable, unfriendly, polite, exciting, possible

Before you move on

People? (**die Leute**.) Luck? (**das Glück**.) Fun? (**der Spaß**.) Desire? (**die Lust**.) An opinion? (**die Meinung**.) A reason? (**der Grund**.) A solution? (**die Lösung**.) Experience? (**die Erfahrung**.) A possibility? (**die Möglichkeit**.) The afternoon? (**der Nachmittag**.) Comfortable? (**bequem**.) Unfriendly? (**unfreundlich**.) Polite? (**höflich**.) Exciting? (**spannend**.) Possible? (**möglich**.)

Chapter 168

Impossible, Bright, Dark, Full, Old-fashioned

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say impossible, bright, dark, full and old-fashioned.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 168: I can say impossible, bright, dark, full and old-fashioned.

168.1 unmöglich — impossible

Before the new one: say the German for exciting, then the German for possible.

You'll want to know: unmöglich

unmöglich — "impossible".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

unmöglich is *un-*, "not", + *möglich*, "possible", which is built on *mögen*, the verb behind English *may*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: unmöglich*
- *Say it: unmöglich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *unmöglich*
- *Recall:* say the German for exciting, then the German for possible, then say *unmöglich* again

Before you move on

What does unmöglich mean? ("Impossible".) Say it once more.

168.2 hell — bright, light

Before the new one: say the German for possible, then the German for impossible.

You'll want to know: hell

hell — "bright, light".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hell ← Middle High German *hel*, "ringing, clear-sounding" — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists Dutch *hel* beside it. A word for a clear sound came to mean a clear light.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hell*
- *Say it: hell*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hell*
- *Recall:* say the German for possible, then the German for impossible, then say *hell* again

Before you move on

What does hell mean? ("Bright, light".) Say it once more.

168.3 dunkel — dark

Before the new one: say the German for impossible, then the German for bright.

You'll want to know: dunkel

dunkel — "dark".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dunkel ← Middle High German *tunkel* ← Old High German *tunkal*, "dark" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dunkel*
- *Say it: dunkel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dunkel*
- *Recall:* say the German for impossible, then the German for bright, then say *dunkel* again

Before you move on

What does dunkel mean? ("Dark".) Say it once more.

168.4 voll — full

Before the new one: say the German for bright, then the German for dark.

You'll want to know: voll

voll — "full".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

voll ← Middle High German *vol* ← Old High German *fol*, "full" — inherited, the same word as English *full*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: voll*
- *Say it: voll*, once more
- *Say it:* say *voll*
- *Recall:* say the German for bright, then the German for dark, then say *voll* again

Before you move on

What does voll mean? ("Full".) Say it once more.

168.5 altmodisch — old-fashioned

Before the new one: say the German for dark, then the German for full.

You'll want to know: altmodisch

altmodisch — "old-fashioned".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

altmodisch is *alt*, "old", + the word for "fashion", from French *mode* ← Latin *modus*, "manner", + *-isch*: in the old manner.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: altmodisch*
- *Say it: altmodisch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *altmodisch*
- *Recall:* say the German for dark, then the German for full, then say *altmodisch* again

Before you move on

What does altmodisch mean? ("Old-fashioned".) Say it once more.

Chapter 169

Well known, Foreign, Nervous, Proud, Angry

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say well known, foreign, nervous, proud and angry.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 169: I can say well known, foreign, nervous, proud and angry.

169.1 bekannt — well known

Before the new one: say the German for full, then the German for old-fashioned.

You'll want to know: bekannt

bekannt — "well known".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bekannt is a past participle built on *kennen*, "to know" ← Old High German *kennan* ← Proto-Germanic **kannijanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1): known.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bekannt*
- *Say it: bekannt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bekannt*
- *Recall:* say the German for full, then the German for old-fashioned, then say *bekannt* again

Before you move on

What does bekannt mean? (“Well known”.) Say it once more.

169.2 fremd — foreign, strange

Before the new one: say the German for old-fashioned, then the German for well known.

You’ll want to know: fremd

fremd — “foreign, strange”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fremd ← Middle High German *vremde*, from Old High German *framadi*, “away from here” — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists the old English *fremd*, “strange”, and Dutch *vreemd* beside it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fremd*
- *Say it: fremd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fremd*
- *Recall:* say the German for old-fashioned, then the German for well known, then say *fremd* again

Before you move on

What does fremd mean? ("Foreign, strange".) Say it once more.

169.3 nervös — nervous

Before the new one: say the German for well known, then the German for foreign.

You'll want to know: nervös

nervös — "nervous".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nervös ← Latin *nervōsus*, "sinewy, vigorous", from *nervus*, "sinew, nerve" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed through French, like English *nervous*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nervös*
- *Say it: nervös*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nervös*
- *Recall:* say the German for well known, then the German for foreign, then say *nervös* again

Before you move on

What does nervös mean? ("Nervous".) Say it once more.

169.4 stolz — proud

Before the new one: say the German for foreign, then the German for nervous.

You'll want to know: stolz

stolz — "proud".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

stolz ← Middle High German *stolz* ← Old High German *stolz*, "proud" (EtymDB 2.1). Where the Old High German word came from is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stolz*
- *Say it: stolz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stolz*
- *Recall:* say the German for foreign, then the German for nervous, then say *stolz* again

Before you move on

What does stolz mean? ("Proud".) Say it once more.

169.5 wütend — angry

Before the new one: say the German for nervous, then the German for proud.

You'll want to know: wütend

wütend — "angry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wütend is the present participle of the verb "to rage", built on the word for "fury", Old High German *wuot* ← Proto-Germanic **wōdaz*, "mad" (EtymDB 2.1). The god's name *Wodan* shares the root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: wütend*
- *Say it: wütend*, once more
- *Say it:* say *wütend*
- *Recall:* say the German for nervous, then the German for proud, then say *wütend* again

Before you move on

What does wütend mean? ("Angry".) Say it once more.

Chapter 170

Rarely, Mostly, Right away, Finally, Still

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say rarely, mostly, right away, finally and still.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 170: I can say rarely, mostly, right away, finally and still.

170.1 selten — rarely

Before the new one: say the German for proud, then the German for angry.

You'll want to know: selten

selten — "rarely".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

selten ← Middle High German *selten* — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *seldom* and Dutch *zelden*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: selten*
- *Say it: selten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *selten*
- *Recall:* say the German for proud, then the German for angry, then say *selten* again

Before you move on

What does selten mean? ("Rarely".) Say it once more.

170.2 meistens — mostly, usually

Before the new one: say the German for angry, then the German for rarely.

You'll want to know: meistens

meistens — "mostly, usually".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

meistens is the word for "most", Old High German *meist* ← Proto-Germanic **maistaz*, + the adverb ending *-ens* (EtymDB 2.1). It is the same word as English *most*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: meistens*
- *Say it: meistens*, once more
- *Say it:* say *meistens*
- *Recall:* say the German for angry, then the German for rarely, then say *meistens* again

Before you move on

What does meistens mean? (“Mostly, usually”.) Say it once more.

170.3 gleich — right away, in a moment

Before the new one: say the German for rarely, then the German for mostly.

You’ll want to know: gleich

gleich — “right away, in a moment”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gleich ← Old High German *gilīh*, “alike” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *gi-*, “together”, + an old word for “body, shape”, the same build as English *alike*. “Right away” means “at the same moment”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gleich*
- *Say it: gleich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gleich*
- *Recall:* say the German for rarely, then the German for mostly, then say *gleich* again

Before you move on

What does gleich mean? (“Right away, in a moment”.) Say it once more.

170.4 endlich — finally

Before the new one: say the German for mostly, then the German for right away.

You'll want to know: endlich

endlich — "finally".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

endlich ← Middle High German *endelīch*, "final" (EtymDB 2.1): *Ende* + *-lich*. Finally is at the end.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *endlich*
- *Say it:* *endlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *endlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for mostly, then the German for right away, then say *endlich* again

Before you move on

What does endlich mean? ("Finally".) Say it once more.

170.5 noch — still, yet

Before the new one: say the German for right away, then the German for finally.

You'll want to know: noch

noch — "still, yet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

noch ← Middle High German *noch* ← Old High German *noh* (EtymDB 2.1 has the Middle High German) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: noch*
- *Say it: noch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *noch*
- *Recall:* say the German for right away, then the German for finally, then say *noch* again

Before you move on

What does noch mean? ("Still, yet".) Say it once more.

Chapter 171

Only, First, Afterwards, Before, Later

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say only, first, afterwards, before and later.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 171: I can say only, first, afterwards, before and later.

171.1 erst — only (so far), not until

Before the new one: say the German for finally, then the German for still.

You'll want to know: erst

erst — "only (so far), not until".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

erst ← Old High German *ērist*, "first" ← Proto-Germanic **airistaz*, "earliest" — inherited, the same word as old English *erst*, "formerly". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: erst*
- *Say it: erst*, once more
- *Say it:* say *erst*
- *Recall:* say the German for finally, then the German for still, then say *erst* again

Before you move on

What does erst mean? ("Only (so far), not until".) Say it once more.

171.2 zuerst — first

Before the new one: say the German for still, then the German for only.

You'll want to know: zuerst

zuerst — "first".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

zuerst is *zu-*, "at", + *erst*, "first" ← Proto-Germanic **airistaz* (EtymDB 2.1): at first.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuerst*
- *Say it: zuerst*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zuerst*
- *Recall:* say the German for still, then the German for only, then say *zuerst* again

Before you move on

What does zuerst mean? (“First”.) Say it once more.

171.3 danach — afterwards

Before the new one: say the German for only, then the German for first.

You’ll want to know: danach

danach — “afterwards”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

danach is the word for “there, that” + the word for “after”: after that. EtymDB 2.1 has the compound but not its parts; both are inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: danach*
- *Say it: danach*, once more
- *Say it:* say *danach*
- *Recall:* say the German for only, then the German for first, then say *danach* again

Before you move on

What does danach mean? (“Afterwards”.) Say it once more.

171.4 vorher — before, beforehand

Before the new one: say the German for first, then the German for afterwards.

You'll want to know: vorher

vorher — "before, beforehand".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vorher is the word for "before" + *her*, "hither", Old High German *hera* (EtymDB 2.1): before the time you are looking from.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vorher*
- *Say it: vorher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vorher*
- *Recall:* say the German for first, then the German for afterwards, then say *vorher* again

Before you move on

What does vorher mean? ("Before, beforehand".) Say it once more.

171.5 nachher — later, afterwards

Before the new one: say the German for afterwards, then the German for before.

You'll want to know: nachher

nachher — "later, afterwards".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nachher is the word for "after" + *her*, "hither", Old High German *hera* (EtymDB 2.1): after the time you are looking from.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nachher*
- *Say it: nachher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nachher*
- *Recall:* say the German for afterwards, then the German for before, then say *nachher* again

Before you move on

What does nachher mean? ("Later, afterwards".) Say it once more.

Chapter 172

Unfortunately, Perhaps, Probably, Of course, Exactly

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say unfortunately, perhaps, probably, of course and exactly.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 172: I can say unfortunately, perhaps, probably, of course and exactly.

172.1 leider — unfortunately

Before the new one: say the German for before, then the German for later.

You'll want to know: leider

leider — "unfortunately".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

leider ← Old High German *leidir* (EtymDB 2.1), a form of the word for "sorrow, harm", which EtymDB lists beside English *loath*: "sadly".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: leider*
- *Say it: leider*, once more
- *Say it:* say *leider*
- *Recall:* say the German for before, then the German for later, then say *leider* again

Before you move on

What does leider mean? ("Unfortunately".) Say it once more.

172.2 vielleicht — perhaps

Before the new one: say the German for later, then the German for unfortunately.

You'll want to know: vielleicht

vielleicht — "perhaps".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vielleicht ← Middle High German *vil līhte*, "very easily" (EtymDB 2.1): *viel* + *leicht*. What could very easily happen is what perhaps will.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vielleicht*
- *Say it: vielleicht*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vielleicht*
- *Recall:* say the German for later, then the German for unfortunately, then say *vielleicht* again

Before you move on

What does vielleicht mean? (“Perhaps”.) Say it once more.

172.3 wahrscheinlich — probably

Before the new one: say the German for unfortunately, then the German for perhaps.

You’ll want to know: wahrscheinlich

wahrscheinlich — “probably”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wahrscheinlich is the word for “true”, Old High German *wār*, + the word for “appearance, shine”, English *shine* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-lich*: “true-seeming”, a copy of Latin *vērisimilis*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: wahrscheinlich*
- *Say it: wahrscheinlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *wahrscheinlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for unfortunately, then the German for perhaps, then say *wahrscheinlich* again

Before you move on

What does wahrscheinlich mean? (“Probably”.) Say it once more.

172.4 natürlich — of course

Before the new one: say the German for perhaps, then the German for probably.

You'll want to know: natürlich

natürlich — "of course".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

natürlich ← Middle High German *natiurlich* ← Old High German *natūrlīh* (EtymDB 2.1): the word for "nature", from Latin *nātūra*, + *-lich*. Of course is "as nature goes".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: natürlich*
- *Say it: natürlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *natürlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for perhaps, then the German for probably, then say *natürlich* again

Before you move on

What does natürlich mean? ("Of course".) Say it once more.

172.5 genau — exactly

Before the new one: say the German for probably, then the German for of course.

You'll want to know: genau

genau — "exactly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

genau ← Middle High German *genouwe*, "close, careful" — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists Dutch *nauw*, "narrow, close", beside it. Exact is close to the mark.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: genau*
- *Say it: genau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *genau*
- *Recall:* say the German for probably, then the German for of course, then say *genau* again

Before you move on

What does genau mean? ("Exactly".) Say it once more.

Chapter 173

Quite, Especially, About, Together, Alone

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say quite, especially, about, together and alone.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 173: I can say quite, especially, about, together and alone.

173.1 ziemlich — quite, fairly

Before the new one: say the German for of course, then the German for exactly.

You'll want to know: ziemlich

ziemlich — "quite, fairly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ziemlich ← Old High German *zimilīh*, "befitting, proper" (EtymDB 2.1), from a verb meaning "to suit". What was proper came to mean "fairly, quite".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ziemlich*
- *Say it: ziemlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ziemlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for of course, then the German for exactly, then say *ziemlich* again

Before you move on

What does ziemlich mean? ("Quite, fairly".) Say it once more.

173.2 besonders — especially

Before the new one: say the German for exactly, then the German for quite.

You'll want to know: besonders

besonders — "especially".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

besonders is built on the word for "apart, special" ← Proto-Germanic **sundraz*, "isolated, alone" (EtymDB 2.1), with *be-* and an adverb *-s*: set apart, especially. English *asunder* shares the root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: besonders*
- *Say it: besonders*, once more
- *Say it:* say *besonders*
- *Recall:* say the German for exactly, then the German for quite, then say *besonders* again

Before you move on

What does besonders mean? ("Especially".) Say it once more.

173.3 ungefähr — about, roughly

Before the new one: say the German for quite, then the German for especially.

You'll want to know: ungefähr

ungefähr — "about, roughly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ungefähr ← Middle High German *āne gevære*, "without intent to deceive" (EtymDB 2.1): a figure given honestly but roughly. The *un-* replaced the old word for "without".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ungefähr*
- *Say it: ungefähr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ungefähr*
- *Recall:* say the German for quite, then the German for especially, then say *ungefähr* again

Before you move on

What does ungefähr mean? ("About, roughly".) Say it once more.

173.4 zusammen — together

Before the new one: say the German for especially, then the German for about.

You'll want to know: zusammen

zusammen — "together".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

zusammen ← Middle High German *zesamene* ← Old High German *zisamane*, "together" (EtymDB 2.1): *zu-*, "to", + an old word for "together", a cousin of English *same*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zusammen*
- *Say it: zusammen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zusammen*
- *Recall:* say the German for especially, then the German for about, then say *zusammen* again

Before you move on

What does zusammen mean? ("Together".) Say it once more.

173.5 allein — alone

Before the new one: say the German for about, then the German for together.

You'll want to know: allein

allein — "alone".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

allein ← Middle High German *al-ein*, "all one" — the same build as English *alone*, "all one". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: allein*
- *Say it: allein*, once more
- *Say it:* say *allein*
- *Recall:* say the German for about, then the German for together, then say *allein* again

Before you move on

What does allein mean? ("Alone".) Say it once more.

173.6 Words from chapters 168-170 — a first pass

Say the words for together and alone.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- impossible, bright, dark, full, old-fashioned
- well known, foreign, nervous, proud, angry
- rarely, mostly, right away, finally, still

Before you move on

Impossible? (**unmöglich**.) Bright? (**hell**.) Dark? (**dunkel**.) Full? (**voll**.) Old-fashioned? (**altmodisch**.) Well known? (**bekannt**.) Foreign? (**fremd**.) Nervous? (**nervös**.) Proud? (**stolz**.) Angry? (**wütend**.) Rarely? (**selten**.) Mostly? (**meistens**.) Right away? (**gleich**.) Finally? (**endlich**.) Still? (**noch**.)

173.7 Words from chapters 171-173 — a second pass

Say the words for only and first.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- only, first, afterwards, before, later
- unfortunately, perhaps, probably, of course, exactly
- quite, especially, about, together, alone

Before you move on

Only? (**erst**.) First? (**zuerst**.) Afterwards? (**danach**.) Before? (**vorher**.) Later? (**nachher**.) Unfortunately? (**leider**.) Perhaps? (**vielleicht**.) Probably? (**wahrscheinlich**.) Of course? (**natürlich**.) Exactly? (**genau**.) Quite? (**ziemlich**.) Especially? (**besonders**.) About? (**ungefähr**.) Together? (**zusammen**.) Alone? (**allein**.)

Chapter 174

To pick up, To depart, To arrive, To take off, To tidy up

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to pick up, to depart, to arrive, to take off and to tidy up.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 174: I can say to pick up, to depart, to arrive, to take off and to tidy up.*

174.1 abholen — to pick up, to collect

Before the new one: say the German for together, then the German for alone.

You'll want to know: abholen

abholen — "to pick up, to collect".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

abholen is *ab-*, "off, away", + *holen*, "to fetch" ← Middle High German *holen* (EtymDB 2.1): to collect and take away.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: abholen*
- *Say it: abholen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *abholen*
- *Recall:* say the German for together, then the German for alone, then say *abholen* again

Before you move on

What does abholen mean? ("To pick up, to collect".) Say it once more.

174.2 abfahren — to depart

Before the new one: say the German for alone, then the German for to pick up.

You'll want to know: abfahren

abfahren — "to depart".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

abfahren is *ab-*, "off, away", + *fahren*, "to travel", which EtymDB 2.1 lists beside English *fare*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: abfahren*
- *Say it: abfahren*, once more
- *Say it:* say *abfahren*
- *Recall:* say the German for alone, then the German for to pick up, then say *abfahren* again

Before you move on

What does abfahren mean? (“To depart”.) Say it once more.

174.3 ankommen — to arrive

Before the new one: say the German for to pick up, then the German for to depart.

You’ll want to know: ankommen

ankommen — “to arrive”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ankommen is *an-*, “at”, + *kommen*, “to come” ← Old High German *kweman* (EtymDB 2.1). EtymDB lists Dutch *aankomen* beside it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ankommen*
- *Say it: ankommen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ankommen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to pick up, then the German for to depart, then say *ankommen* again

Before you move on

What does ankommen mean? (“To arrive”.) Say it once more.

174.4 ausziehen — to take off (clothes), to move out

Before the new one: say the German for to depart, then the German for to arrive.

You'll want to know: ausziehen

ausziehen — "to take off (clothes), to move out".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ausziehen is *aus-*, "out", + *ziehen*, "to pull" ← Proto-Germanic **teuhanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1): to pull off, or to pull out of a house.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ausziehen*
- *Say it: ausziehen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ausziehen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to depart, then the German for to arrive, then say *ausziehen* again

Before you move on

What does ausziehen mean? ("To take off (clothes), to move out".) Say it once more.

174.5 aufräumen — to tidy up

Before the new one: say the German for to arrive, then the German for to take off.

You'll want to know: aufräumen

aufräumen — "to tidy up".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aufräumen is *auf* + the verb "to make room", Old High German *rūmen* ← Proto-Germanic **rūmijanǫ*, built on **rūmaz*, "roomy" (EtymDB 2.1). English *room* shares the root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aufräumen*
- *Say it: aufräumen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aufräumen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to arrive, then the German for to take off, then say *aufräumen* again

Before you move on

What does aufräumen mean? ("To tidy up".) Say it once more.

Chapter 175

To fill in, To rest, To bake, To bathe, To build

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to fill in, to rest, to bake, to bathe and to build.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 175: I can say to fill in, to rest, to bake, to bathe and to build.*

175.1 ausfüllen — to fill in (a form)

> Before the new one: say the German for to take off, then the German for to tidy up.

You'll want to know: ausfüllen

ausfüllen — "to fill in (a form)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ausfüllen is *aus-*, "out", + *füllen*, "to fill", the same verb as English *fill* (EtymDB 2.1): to fill out a form.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ausfüllen*
- *Say it: ausfüllen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ausfüllen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to take off, then the German for to tidy up, then say *ausfüllen* again

Before you move on

What does ausfüllen mean? ("To fill in (a form)".) Say it once more.

175.2 ausruhen — to rest (sich ausruhen)

Before the new one: say the German for to tidy up, then the German for to fill in.

You'll want to know: ausruhen

ausruhen — "to rest (sich ausruhen)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ausruhen is *aus-*, "out, fully", + the verb "to rest", built on the noun for "rest", Old High German *ruowa* ← Proto-Germanic **rōwō* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ausruhen*
- *Say it: ausruhen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ausruhen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to tidy up, then the German for to fill in, then say *ausruhen* again

Before you move on

What does ausruhen mean? ("To rest (sich ausruhen)".) Say it once more.

175.3 backen — to bake

Before the new one: say the German for to fill in, then the German for to rest.

You'll want to know: backen

backen — "to bake".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

backen ← Middle High German *backen* ← Old High German *backan* — inherited, the same verb as English *bake*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *backen*
- *Say it:* *backen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *backen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to fill in, then the German for to rest, then say *backen* again

Before you move on

What does backen mean? ("To bake".) Say it once more.

175.4 baden — to bathe

Before the new one: say the German for to rest, then the German for to bake.

You'll want to know: baden

baden — "to bathe".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

baden ← Old High German *badōn* ← Proto-Germanic **baþōnǫ*, "to bathe" — inherited, the verb beside *Bad*, the same as English *bathe*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: baden*
- *Say it: baden*, once more
- *Say it:* say *baden*
- *Recall:* say the German for to rest, then the German for to bake, then say *baden* again

Before you move on

What does baden mean? ("To bathe".) Say it once more.

175.5 bauen — to build

Before the new one: say the German for to bake, then the German for to bathe.

You'll want to know: bauen

bauen — "to build".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bauen ← Middle High German *būwen* ← Old High German *būan*, "to dwell, to farm" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, the verb beside *Bauer*. Old English *būan* meant "to dwell".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bauen*
- *Say it: bauen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bauen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to bake, then the German for to bathe, then say *bauen* again

Before you move on

What does bauen mean? ("To build".) Say it once more.

Chapter 176

To mean, To hurry, To keep, To describe, To enter

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to mean, to hurry, to keep, to describe and to enter.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 176: I can say to mean, to hurry, to keep, to describe and to enter.*

176.1 bedeuten — to mean

Before the new one: say the German for to bathe, then the German for to build.

You'll want to know: bedeuten

bedeuten — "to mean".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bedeuten is *be-* + the verb "to interpret", Old High German *diuten*, "to make plain to the people" (EtymDB 2.1). It shares its root with *Deutsch*, "of the people".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bedeuten*
- *Say it:* *bedeuten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bedeuten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to bathe, then the German for to build, then say *bedeuten* again

Before you move on

What does bedeuten mean? (“To mean”.) Say it once more.

176.2 beeilen — to hurry (sich beeilen)

Before the new one: say the German for to build, then the German for to mean.

You’ll want to know: beeilen

beeilen — “to hurry (sich beeilen)”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

beeilen is *be-* + the verb “to hurry”, Middle High German *īlen* ← Old High German *īlen* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *beeilen*
- *Say it:* *beeilen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *beeilen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to build, then the German for to mean, then say *beeilen* again

Before you move on

What does beeilen mean? ("To hurry (sich beeilen)".) Say it once more.

176.3 behalten — to keep

Before the new one: say the German for to mean, then the German for to hurry.

You'll want to know: behalten

behalten — "to keep".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

behalten ← Old High German *bihaltan*: *be-* + the verb "to hold" — the same build as English *behold*, which EtymDB 2.1 lists beside it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: behalten*
- *Say it: behalten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *behalten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to mean, then the German for to hurry, then say *behalten* again

Before you move on

What does behalten mean? ("To keep".) Say it once more.

176.4 beschreiben — to describe

Before the new one: say the German for to hurry, then the German for to keep.

You'll want to know: beschreiben

beschreiben — "to describe".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

beschreiben is *be-* + *schreiben*, "to write": to write something down in full. *schreiben* comes from Latin *scrībere*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: beschreiben*
- *Say it: beschreiben*, once more
- *Say it:* say *beschreiben*
- *Recall:* say the German for to hurry, then the German for to keep, then say *beschreiben* again

Before you move on

What does beschreiben mean? ("To describe".) Say it once more.

176.5 betreten — to enter, to step on

Before the new one: say the German for to keep, then the German for to describe.

You'll want to know: betreten

betreten — "to enter, to step on".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

betreten is *be-* + the verb "to step", Old High German *tretan*, which EtymDB 2.1 lists beside English *tread*: to step onto or into.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *betreten*
- *Say it:* *betreten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *betreten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to keep, then the German for to describe, then say *betreten* again

Before you move on

What does betreten mean? ("To enter, to step on".) Say it once more.

Chapter 177

To apply, To bend, To fry, To spell, To print

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to apply, to bend, to fry, to spell and to print.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 177: I can say to apply, to bend, to fry, to spell and to print.*

177.1 bewerben — to apply (sich bewerben)

Before the new one: say the German for to describe, then the German for to enter.

You'll want to know: bewerben

bewerben — "to apply (sich bewerben)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bewerben is *be-* + the verb "to recruit, to woo", Old High German *werban* ← Proto-Germanic **hwerbanǫ*, "to turn" (EtymDB 2.1). To apply is to court a post.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bewerben*
- *Say it: bewerben*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bewerben*
- *Recall:* say the German for to describe, then the German for to enter, then say *bewerben* again

Before you move on

What does bewerben mean? ("To apply (sich bewerben)".) Say it once more.

177.2 biegen — to bend, to turn

Before the new one: say the German for to enter, then the German for to apply.

You'll want to know: biegen

biegen — "to bend, to turn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

biegen ← Middle High German *biegen* ← Old High German *biogan* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, a cousin of English *bow*, "to bend".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: biegen*
- *Say it: biegen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *biegen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to enter, then the German for to apply, then say *biegen* again

Before you move on

What does biegen mean? (“To bend, to turn”.) Say it once more.

177.3 braten — to fry, to roast

Before the new one: say the German for to apply, then the German for to bend.

You’ll want to know: braten

braten — “to fry, to roast”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

braten ← Middle High German *brāten* ← Old High German *brātan*, “to roast” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: braten*
- *Say it: braten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *braten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to apply, then the German for to bend, then say *braten* again

Before you move on

What does braten mean? (“To fry, to roast”.) Say it once more.

177.4 buchstabieren — to spell

Before the new one: say the German for to bend, then the German for to fry.

You'll want to know: buchstabieren

buchstabieren — "to spell".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

buchstabieren is built on the word for "a letter of the alphabet", literally "beech staff", + the ending *-ieren*. The beech staff is traditionally explained by the beech staves runes were carved on, though this is disputed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: buchstabieren*
- *Say it: buchstabieren*, once more
- *Say it:* say *buchstabieren*
- *Recall:* say the German for to bend, then the German for to fry, then say *buchstabieren* again

Before you move on

What does buchstabieren mean? ("To spell".) Say it once more.

177.5 drucken — to print

Before the new one: say the German for to fry, then the German for to spell.

You'll want to know: drucken

drucken — "to print".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

drucken ← Proto-Germanic **þrukjanǫ*, "to press" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited; printing is pressing. Dutch *drukken* is the same verb.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: drucken*
- *Say it: drucken*, once more
- *Say it:* say *drucken*
- *Recall:* say the German for to fry, then the German for to spell, then say *drucken* again

Before you move on

What does drucken mean? ("To print".) Say it once more.

Chapter 178

To shower, To fall asleep, To get on, To get off, To change

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to shower, to fall asleep, to get on, to get off and to change.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 178: I can say to shower, to fall asleep, to get on, to get off and to change.*

178.1 duschen — to shower

Before the new one: say the German for to spell, then the German for to print.

You'll want to know: duschen

duschen — "to shower".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

duschen is the verb made from *Dusche* ← French *douche* ← Italian *doccia*, "water pipe" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: duschen*
- *Say it: duschen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *duschen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to spell, then the German for to print, then say *duschen* again

Before you move on

What does duschen mean? ("To shower".) Say it once more.

178.2 einschlafen — to fall asleep

Before the new one: say the German for to print, then the German for to shower.

You'll want to know: einschlafen

einschlafen — "to fall asleep".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

einschlafen is *ein-*, "into", + *schlafen*, "to sleep" ← Proto-Germanic **slēpanǫ*, English *sleep* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: einschlafen*
- *Say it: einschlafen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *einschlafen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to print, then the German for to shower, then say *einschlafen* again

Before you move on

What does einschlafen mean? (“To fall asleep”.) Say it once more.

178.3 einsteigen — to get on (a vehicle)

Before the new one: say the German for to shower, then the German for to fall asleep.

You’ll want to know: einsteigen

einsteigen — “to get on (a vehicle)”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

einsteigen is *ein-*, “in”, + the verb “to climb”, Old High German *stīgan* (EtymDB 2.1): to climb into a vehicle. English *stile* and *stirrup* share the root.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: einsteigen*
- *Say it: einsteigen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *einsteigen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to shower, then the German for to fall asleep, then say *einsteigen* again

Before you move on

What does einsteigen mean? (“To get on (a vehicle)”.) Say it once more.

178.4 aussteigen — to get off (a vehicle)

Before the new one: say the German for to fall asleep, then the German for to get on.

You'll want to know: aussteigen

aussteigen — "to get off (a vehicle)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aussteigen is *aus-*, "out", + the verb "to climb", Old High German *stīgan* (EtymDB 2.1): to climb out of a vehicle.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *aussteigen*
- *Say it:* *aussteigen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aussteigen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to fall asleep, then the German for to get on, then say *aussteigen* again

Before you move on

What does aussteigen mean? ("To get off (a vehicle)".) Say it once more.

178.5 umsteigen — to change (trains or buses)

Before the new one: say the German for to get on, then the German for to get off.

You'll want to know: umsteigen

umsteigen — "to change (trains or buses)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

umsteigen is *um-*, "over, around", + the verb "to climb", Old High German *stīgan* (EtymDB 2.1): to climb over into another train.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *umsteigen*
- *Say it:* *umsteigen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *umsteigen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to get on, then the German for to get off, then say *umsteigen* again

Before you move on

What does umsteigen mean? ("To change (trains or buses)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 179

To receive, To remind, To allow, To feed, To reach

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to receive, to remind, to allow, to feed and to reach.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 179: I can say to receive, to remind, to allow, to feed and to reach.*

179.1 empfangen — to receive, to welcome

Before the new one: say the German for to get off, then the German for to change.

You'll want to know: empfangen

empfangen — "to receive, to welcome".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

empfangen ← Middle High German *enphāhen* ← Old High German *intfāhan* (EtymDB 2.1): *ent-* + the verb "to catch, to take". Dutch *ontvangen* is the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: empfangen*
- *Say it: empfangen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *empfangen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to get off, then the German for to change, then say *empfangen* again

Before you move on

What does empfangen mean? ("To receive, to welcome".) Say it once more.

179.2 erinnern — to remind (sich erinnern: to remember)

Before the new one: say the German for to change, then the German for to receive.

You'll want to know: erinnern

erinnern — "to remind (sich erinnern: to remember)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

erinnern is *er-* + the word for "inner, inside" + a verb ending: to bring something inside the mind. EtymDB 2.1 has the word but not its parts; the build is plain to see.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: erinnern*
- *Say it: erinnern*, once more
- *Say it:* say *erinnern*

- *Recall:* say the German for to change, then the German for to receive, then say *erinnern* again

Before you move on

What does erinnern mean? ("To remind (sich erinnern: to remember)".) Say it once more.

179.3 erlauben — to allow

Before the new one: say the German for to receive, then the German for to remind.

You'll want to know: erlauben

erlauben — "to allow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

erlauben ← Middle High German *erlouben* ← Old High German *irlouben* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, from the root of English *leave*, "permission". EtymDB lists Old English *ālyfan*, "to allow", beside it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: erlauben*
- *Say it: erlauben*, once more
- *Say it:* say *erlauben*
- *Recall:* say the German for to receive, then the German for to remind, then say *erlauben* again

Before you move on

What does erlauben mean? ("To allow".) Say it once more.

179.4 ernähren — to feed, to nourish

Before the new one: say the German for to remind, then the German for to allow.

You'll want to know: ernähren

ernähren — "to feed, to nourish".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ernähren is *er-* + the verb "to feed, to nourish", which grew out of Old High German *nerien*, "to save, to keep alive" ← Proto-Germanic **nazjanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ernähren*
- *Say it:* *ernähren*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ernähren*
- *Recall:* say the German for to remind, then the German for to allow, then say *ernähren* again

Before you move on

What does ernähren mean? ("To feed, to nourish".) Say it once more.

179.5 erreichen — to reach

Before the new one: say the German for to allow, then the German for to feed.

You'll want to know: erreichen

erreichen — "to reach".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

erreichen is *er-* + the verb "to reach", Old High German *reihhen* ← Proto-Germanic **raikijanǫ*, the same verb as English *reach*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *erreichen*
- *Say it:* *erreichen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *erreichen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to allow, then the German for to feed, then say *erreichen* again

Before you move on

What does erreichen mean? ("To reach".) Say it once more.

Chapter 180

To expect, To catch, To watch television, To hold on to, To whisper

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to expect, to catch, to watch television, to hold on to and to whisper.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 180: I can say to expect, to catch, to watch television, to hold on to and to whisper.

180.1 erwarten — to expect

Before the new one: say the German for to feed, then the German for to reach.

You'll want to know: erwarten

erwarten — "to expect".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

erwarten is *er-* + *warten*, "to wait", which first meant "to watch" ← Proto-Germanic **wardānǫ* (EtymDB 2.1): to watch out for something.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: erwarten*
- *Say it: erwarten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *erwarten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to feed, then the German for to reach, then say *erwarten* again

Before you move on

What does erwarten mean? ("To expect".) Say it once more.

180.2 fangen — to catch

Before the new one: say the German for to reach, then the German for to expect.

You'll want to know: fangen

fangen — "to catch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fangen ← Middle High German *vāhen* ← Old High German *fāhan* ← Proto-Germanic **fanhanǫ* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) English *fang*, the seizing tooth, is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fangen*
- *Say it: fangen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fangen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to reach, then the German for to expect, then say *fangen* again

Before you move on

What does fangen mean? ("To catch".) Say it once more.

180.3 fernsehen — to watch television

Before the new one: say the German for to expect, then the German for to catch.

You'll want to know: fernsehen

fernsehen — "to watch television".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fernsehen is the word for "far" + *sehen*, "to see" (EtymDB 2.1): a piece-by-piece copy of *television*, Greek *tēle*, "far", + Latin *vīsiō*, "seeing".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fernsehen*
- *Say it: fernsehen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fernsehen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to expect, then the German for to catch, then say *fernsehen* again

Before you move on

What does fernsehen mean? ("To watch television".) Say it once more.

180.4 festhalten — to hold on to

Before the new one: say the German for to catch, then the German for to watch television.

You'll want to know: festhalten

festhalten — "to hold on to".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

festhalten is the word for "firm" + the verb "to hold", Old High German *haltan*, English *hold* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: festhalten*
- *Say it: festhalten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *festhalten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to catch, then the German for to watch television, then say *festhalten* again

Before you move on

What does festhalten mean? ("To hold on to".) Say it once more.

180.5 flüstern — to whisper

Before the new one: say the German for to watch television, then the German for to hold on to.

You'll want to know: flüstern

flüstern — "to whisper".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

flüstern is a sound-word, shaped to imitate whispering, as English *whisper* is. EtymDB 2.1 lists Dutch *fluisteren* beside it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: flüstern*
- *Say it: flüstern*, once more
- *Say it:* say *flüstern*
- *Recall:* say the German for to watch television, then the German for to hold on to, then say *flüstern* again

Before you move on

What does flüstern mean? ("To whisper".) Say it once more.

Chapter 181

To photograph, To have breakfast, To pour, To greet, To inform

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to photograph, to have breakfast, to pour, to greet and to inform.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 181: I can say to photograph, to have breakfast, to pour, to greet and to inform.*

181.1 fotografieren — to photograph

Before the new one: say the German for to hold on to, then the German for to whisper.

You'll want to know: fotografieren

fotografieren — "to photograph".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fotografieren is the verb of the word for "photography", a modern coinage from Greek *phōs*, "light", and *gráphein*, "to write", + the ending *-ieren*. See *Foto*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fotografieren*
- *Say it: fotografieren*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fotografieren*
- *Recall:* say the German for to hold on to, then the German for to whisper, then say *fotografieren* again

Before you move on

What does fotografieren mean? ("To photograph".) Say it once more.

181.2 frühstücken — to have breakfast

Before the new one: say the German for to whisper, then the German for to photograph.

You'll want to know: frühstücken

frühstücken — "to have breakfast".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

frühstücken is the verb made from *Frühstück*: *früh*, "early", + the word for "a piece" (EtymDB 2.1) — to eat the early bite.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: frühstücken*
- *Say it: frühstücken*, once more
- *Say it:* say *frühstücken*
- *Recall:* say the German for to whisper, then the German for to photograph, then say *frühstücken* again

Before you move on

What does frühstücken mean? ("To have breakfast".) Say it once more.

181.3 gießen — to pour, to water

Before the new one: say the German for to photograph, then the German for to have breakfast.

You'll want to know: gießen

gießen — "to pour, to water".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gießen ← Middle High German *giezen* ← Old High German *giozan*, "to pour" (EtymDB 2.1), from Proto-Germanic **geutaną* — inherited. English *ingot*, poured metal, shares the root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gießen*
- *Say it: gießen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gießen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to photograph, then the German for to have breakfast, then say *gießen* again

Before you move on

What does gießen mean? ("To pour, to water".) Say it once more.

181.4 grüßen — to greet

Before the new one: say the German for to have breakfast, then the German for to pour.

You'll want to know: grüßen

grüßen — "to greet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grüßen ← Old High German *gruozen* — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *greet* and Dutch *groeten*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: grüßen*
- *Say it: grüßen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *grüßen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to have breakfast, then the German for to pour, then say *grüßen* again

Before you move on

What does grüßen mean? ("To greet".) Say it once more.

181.5 informieren — to inform

Before the new one: say the German for to pour, then the German for to greet.

You'll want to know: informieren

informieren — "to inform".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

informieren ← Latin *īnfōrmāre*, "to give shape to, to instruct", from *in-* and *fōrma*, "shape" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, with the German ending *-ieren*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: informieren*
- *Say it: informieren*, once more
- *Say it:* say *informieren*
- *Recall:* say the German for to pour, then the German for to greet, then say *informieren* again

Before you move on

What does informieren mean? ("To inform".) Say it once more.

Chapter 182

To fight, To climb, To take care, To land, To smile

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to fight, to climb, to take care, to land and to smile.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 182: I can say to fight, to climb, to take care, to land and to smile.*

182.1 kämpfen — to fight

> Before the new one: say the German for to greet, then the German for to inform.

You'll want to know: kämpfen

kämpfen — "to fight".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

kämpfen ← Old High German *kempfan*, the verb of the word for "fight", Old High German *kampf* ← Latin *campus*, "field, the field of battle" (EtymDB 2.1) — an early loan.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kämpfen*
- *Say it: kämpfen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kämpfen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to greet, then the German for to inform, then say *kämpfen* again

Before you move on

What does kämpfen mean? ("To fight".) Say it once more.

182.2 klettern — to climb

Before the new one: say the German for to inform, then the German for to fight.

You'll want to know: klettern

klettern — "to climb".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

klettern is of uncertain origin. One account ties it to the word for "a burr", Old High German *kletta* (EtymDB 2.1), as if climbing were clinging; EtymDB has no source for *klettern* itself.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: klettern*
- *Say it: klettern*, once more
- *Say it:* say *klettern*
- *Recall:* say the German for to inform, then the German for to fight, then say *klettern* again

Before you move on

What does klettern mean? ("To climb".) Say it once more.

182.3 kümmern — to take care (sich kümmern um)

Before the new one: say the German for to fight, then the German for to climb.

You'll want to know: kümmern

kümmern — "to take care (sich kümmern um)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

kümmern ← Middle High German *kumbern*, "to burden, to trouble" (EtymDB 2.1), from the word for "grief, burden", which EtymDB lists beside English *encumbrance*. To take care is to take the burden on.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kümmern*
- *Say it: kümmern*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kümmern*
- *Recall:* say the German for to fight, then the German for to climb, then say *kümmern* again

Before you move on

What does kümmern mean? ("To take care (sich kümmern um)".) Say it once more.

182.4 landen — to land

Before the new one: say the German for to climb, then the German for to take care.

You'll want to know: landen

landen — "to land".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

landen was borrowed from Middle Low German *landen* (EtymDB 2.1), the verb of the word for "land", Proto-Germanic **landą*, the same as English *land*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *landen*
- *Say it:* *landen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *landen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to climb, then the German for to take care, then say *landen* again

Before you move on

What does landen mean? ("To land".) Say it once more.

182.5 lächeln — to smile

Before the new one: say the German for to take care, then the German for to land.

You'll want to know: lächeln

lächeln — "to smile".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lächeln is *lachen*, "to laugh", with the ending *-eln*, which makes an action small: a little laugh. *lachen* ← Proto-Germanic **hlahjanǫ*, English *laugh*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lächeln*
- *Say it: lächeln*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lächeln*
- *Recall:* say the German for to take care, then the German for to land, then say *lächeln* again

Before you move on

What does lächeln mean? ("To smile".) Say it once more.

182.6 Words from chapters 174-177 — a first pass

Say the words for to land and to smile.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to pick up, to depart, to arrive, to take off, to tidy up
- to fill in, to rest, to bake, to bathe, to build
- to mean, to hurry, to keep, to describe, to enter
- to apply, to bend, to fry, to spell, to print

Before you move on

To pick up? (**abholen**.) To depart? (**abfahren**.) To arrive? (**ankommen**.) To take off? (**ausziehen**.) To tidy up? (**aufräumen**.) To fill in? (**ausfüllen**.) To rest? (**ausruhen**.) To bake? (**backen**.) To bathe? (**baden**.) To build? (**bauen**.) To mean? (**bedeuten**.) To hurry? (**beeilen**.) To keep? (**behalten**.) To describe? (**beschreiben**.) To enter? (**betreten**.) To apply? (**bewerben**.) To bend? (**biegen**.) To fry? (**braten**.) To spell? (**buchstabieren**.) To print? (**drucken**.)

182.7 Words from chapters 178-182 — a second pass

Say the words for to shower and to fall asleep.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to shower, to fall asleep, to get on, to get off, to change
- to receive, to remind, to allow, to feed, to reach
- to expect, to catch, to watch television, to hold on to, to whisper
- to photograph, to have breakfast, to pour, to greet, to inform
- to fight, to climb, to take care, to land, to smile

Before you move on

To shower? (**duschen**.) To fall asleep? (**einschlafen**.) To get on? (**einsteigen**.) To get off? (**aussteigen**.) To change? (**umsteigen**.) To receive? (**empfangen**.) To remind? (**erinnern**.) To allow? (**erlauben**.) To feed? (**ernähren**.) To reach? (**erreichen**.) To expect? (**erwarten**.) To catch? (**fangen**.) To watch television? (**fernsehen**.) To hold on to? (**festhalten**.) To whisper? (**flüstern**.) To photograph? (**fotografieren**.) To have breakfast? (**frühstücken**.) To pour? (**gießen**.) To greet? (**grüßen**.) To inform? (**informieren**.) To fight? (**kämpfen**.) To climb?

(**klettern**.) To take care? (**kümmern**.) To land? (**landen**.) To smile? (**lächeln**.)

Chapter 183

To suffer, To measure, To mix, To sew, To sneeze

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to suffer, to measure, to mix, to sew and to sneeze.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 183: I can say to suffer, to measure, to mix, to sew and to sneeze.

183.1 leiden — to suffer

Before the new one: say the German for to land, then the German for to smile.

You'll want to know: leiden

leiden — "to suffer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

leiden ← Middle High German *līden* ← Old High German *līdan*, "to go, to undergo" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited. To suffer is to go through something. Dutch *lijden* is the same verb.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: leiden*
- *Say it: leiden*, once more
- *Say it:* say *leiden*
- *Recall:* say the German for to land, then the German for to smile, then say *leiden* again

Before you move on

What does leiden mean? ("To suffer".) Say it once more.

183.2 messen — to measure

Before the new one: say the German for to smile, then the German for to suffer.

You'll want to know: messen

messen — "to measure".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

messen ← Old High German *mezzen* ← Proto-Germanic **metanǫ*, "to measure" — inherited, the same verb as English *mete*, as in "mete out". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: messen*
- *Say it: messen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *messen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to smile, then the German for to suffer, then say *messen* again

Before you move on

What does messen mean? ("To measure".) Say it once more.

183.3 mischen — to mix

Before the new one: say the German for to suffer, then the German for to measure.

You'll want to know: mischen

mischen — "to mix".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mischen ← Old High German *miskan*, from Latin *miscēre*, "to mix" — an early loan. EtymDB 2.1 has the Latin verb.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mischen*
- *Say it: mischen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mischen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to suffer, then the German for to measure, then say *mischen* again

Before you move on

What does mischen mean? ("To mix".) Say it once more.

183.4 nähen — to sew

Before the new one: say the German for to measure, then the German for to mix.

You'll want to know: nähen

nähen — "to sew".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nähen ← Old High German *nājen* ← Proto-Germanic **nēaną*, "to sew, to stitch" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The German word for "needle" comes from the same root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nähen*
- *Say it: nähen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nähen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to measure, then the German for to mix, then say *nähen* again

Before you move on

What does nähen mean? ("To sew".) Say it once more.

183.5 niesen — to sneeze

Before the new one: say the German for to mix, then the German for to sew.

You'll want to know: niesen

niesen — "to sneeze".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

niesen ← Old High German *niosan* ← Proto-Germanic **hneusaną*, "to sneeze" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) Dutch *niezen* is the same verb.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: niesen*
- *Say it: niesen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *niesen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to mix, then the German for to sew, then say *niesen* again

Before you move on

What does niesen mean? ("To sneeze".) Say it once more.

Chapter 184

To park, To look after, To pick, To test, To clean

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to park, to look after, to pick, to test and to clean.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 184: I can say to park, to look after, to pick, to test and to clean.*

184.1 parken — to park

> Before the new one: say the German for to sew, then the German for to sneeze.

You'll want to know: parken

parken — "to park".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

parken is taken from English *to park*, built on *park*, which came from Old French *parc*, "enclosure" (EtymDB 2.1). A car park is an enclosure.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: parken*
- *Say it: parken*, once more
- *Say it:* say *parken*
- *Recall:* say the German for to sew, then the German for to sneeze, then say *parken* again

Before you move on

What does parken mean? ("To park".) Say it once more.

184.2 pflegen — to look after, to nurse

Before the new one: say the German for to sneeze, then the German for to park.

You'll want to know: pflegen

pflegen — "to look after, to nurse".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pflegen ← Middle High German *phlëgen* ← Old High German *plegan*, "to look after, to be responsible for" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited. English *plight*, a pledge, is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pflegen*
- *Say it: pflegen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pflegen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to sneeze, then the German for to park, then say *pflegen* again

Before you move on

What does pflegen mean? ("To look after, to nurse".) Say it once more.

184.3 pflücken — to pick (flowers, fruit)

Before the new one: say the German for to park, then the German for to look after.

You'll want to know: pflücken

pflücken — "to pick (flowers, fruit)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pflücken ← Middle High German *pflocken* — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *pluck* and Dutch *plukken*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pflücken*
- *Say it: pflücken*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pflücken*
- *Recall:* say the German for to park, then the German for to look after, then say *pflücken* again

Before you move on

What does pflücken mean? ("To pick (flowers, fruit)".) Say it once more.

184.4 prüfen — to test, to check

Before the new one: say the German for to look after, then the German for to pick.

You'll want to know: prüfen

prüfen — "to test, to check".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prüfen ← Middle High German *brüeven* (EtymDB 2.1), from Old French *prover* ← Latin *probāre*, "to test" — borrowed, like English *prove*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prüfen*
- *Say it: prüfen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prüfen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to look after, then the German for to pick, then say *prüfen* again

Before you move on

What does prüfen mean? ("To test, to check".) Say it once more.

184.5 reinigen — to clean

Before the new one: say the German for to pick, then the German for to test.

You'll want to know: reinigen

reinigen — "to clean".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

reinigen is the word for "pure, clean", Old High German *reini* ← Proto-Germanic **hrainiz* (EtymDB 2.1), + the verb ending *-igen*: to make clean.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: reinigen*
- *Say it: reinigen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *reinigen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to pick, then the German for to test, then say *reinigen* again

Before you move on

What does reinigen mean? ("To clean".) Say it once more.

Chapter 185

To rescue, To row, To push, To hit, To taste

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to rescue, to row, to push, to hit and to taste.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 185: I can say to rescue, to row, to push, to hit and to taste.*

185.1 retten — to rescue

> Before the new one: say the German for to test, then the German for to clean.

You'll want to know: retten

retten — "to rescue".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

retten ← Middle High German *retten* ← Old High German *retten* — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *rid* and Dutch *redden*. To rescue is to rid someone of danger.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: retten*
- *Say it: retten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *retten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to test, then the German for to clean, then say *retten* again

Before you move on

What does retten mean? (“To rescue”.) Say it once more.

185.2 rudern — to row

Before the new one: say the German for to clean, then the German for to rescue.

You’ll want to know: rudern

rudern — “to row”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rudern ← Old High German *ruoderōn*, the verb of the word for “oar”, Old High German *ruodar* ← Proto-Germanic **rōþrą* — the same word as English *rudder*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rudern*
- *Say it: rudern*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rudern*
- *Recall:* say the German for to clean, then the German for to rescue, then say *rudern* again

Before you move on

What does rudern mean? ("To row".) Say it once more.

185.3 schieben — to push

Before the new one: say the German for to rescue, then the German for to row.

You'll want to know: schieben

schieben — "to push".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schieben ← Middle High German *schieben* ← Old High German *skioban* — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *shove* and Dutch *schuiven*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schieben*
- *Say it: schieben*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schieben*
- *Recall:* say the German for to rescue, then the German for to row, then say *schieben* again

Before you move on

What does schieben mean? ("To push".) Say it once more.

185.4 schlagen — to hit, to beat

Before the new one: say the German for to row, then the German for to push.

You'll want to know: schlagen

schlagen — "to hit, to beat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schlagen goes back to Old High German *slahan* ← Proto-Germanic **slahanǫ*, "to strike, to fight" — inherited. EtymDB 2.1 has the Proto-Germanic verb; English *slay* and *slaughter* share it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schlagen*
- *Say it: schlagen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schlagen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to row, then the German for to push, then say *schlagen* again

Before you move on

What does schlagen mean? ("To hit, to beat".) Say it once more.

185.5 schmecken — to taste

Before the new one: say the German for to push, then the German for to hit.

You'll want to know: schmecken

schmecken — "to taste".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schmecken ← Proto-Germanic **smakkijanǫ*, "to taste" — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists English *smack*, "a taste, a hint", beside it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schmecken*
- *Say it: schmecken*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schmecken*
- *Recall:* say the German for to push, then the German for to hit, then say *schmecken* again

Before you move on

What does schmecken mean? ("To taste".) Say it once more.

Chapter 186

To snow, To protect, To sail, To send, To stroll

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to snow, to protect, to sail, to send and to stroll.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 186: I can say to snow, to protect, to sail, to send and to stroll.

186.1 schneien — to snow

Before the new one: say the German for to hit, then the German for to taste.

You'll want to know: schneien

schneien — "to snow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schneien ← Old High German *snīwan* ← Proto-Germanic **snīwanǫ*, "to snow" — inherited, from the same root as English *snow*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schneien*
- *Say it: schneien*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schneien*
- *Recall:* say the German for to hit, then the German for to taste, then say *schneien* again

Before you move on

What does schneien mean? ("To snow".) Say it once more.

186.2 schützen — to protect

Before the new one: say the German for to taste, then the German for to snow.

You'll want to know: schützen

schützen — "to protect".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schützen is the verb of the word for "protection", Middle High German *schuz* (EtymDB 2.1): first "to dam up water", then "to shield".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schützen*
- *Say it: schützen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schützen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to taste, then the German for to snow, then say *schützen* again

Before you move on

What does schützen mean? (“To protect”.) Say it once more.

186.3 segeln — to sail

Before the new one: say the German for to snow, then the German for to protect.

You’ll want to know: segeln

segeln — “to sail”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

segeln is the verb of the word for “a sail”, Old High German *segal* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Proto-Germanic **seglą* — the same word as English *sail*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: segeln*
- *Say it: segeln*, once more
- *Say it:* say *segeln*
- *Recall:* say the German for to snow, then the German for to protect, then say *segeln* again

Before you move on

What does segeln mean? (“To sail”.) Say it once more.

186.4 senden — to send, to broadcast

Before the new one: say the German for to protect, then the German for to sail.

You'll want to know: senden

senden — "to send, to broadcast".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

senden ← Middle High German *senden* ← Old High German *senten* — inherited, the same verb as English *send* and Gothic *sandjan*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *senden*
- *Say it:* *senden*, once more
- *Say it:* say *senden*
- *Recall:* say the German for to protect, then the German for to sail, then say *senden* again

Before you move on

What does senden mean? ("To send, to broadcast".) Say it once more.

186.5 spazieren — to stroll (spazieren gehen)

Before the new one: say the German for to sail, then the German for to send.

You'll want to know: spazieren

spazieren — "to stroll (spazieren gehen)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

spazieren ← Italian *spaziare*, "to roam" ← Latin *spatiārī*, "to walk about", from *spatium*, "space" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: spazieren*
- *Say it: spazieren*, once more
- *Say it:* say *spazieren*
- *Recall:* say the German for to sail, then the German for to send, then say *spazieren* again

Before you move on

What does spazieren mean? ("To stroll (spazieren gehen)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 187

To rinse, To start, To put, To steal, To climb

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to rinse, to start, to put, to steal and to climb.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 187: I can say to rinse, to start, to put, to steal and to climb.

187.1 spülen — to rinse, to wash up

Before the new one: say the German for to send, then the German for to stroll.

You'll want to know: spülen

spülen — "to rinse, to wash up".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

spülen ← Middle High German *spüelen* ← Old High German *spuolen*, "to rinse" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *spülen*
- *Say it:* *spülen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *spülen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to send, then the German for to stroll, then say *spülen* again

Before you move on

What does spülen mean? ("To rinse, to wash up".) Say it once more.

187.2 starten — to start, to take off

Before the new one: say the German for to stroll, then the German for to rinse.

You'll want to know: starten

starten — "to start, to take off".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

starten is taken from English *start*, which EtymDB 2.1 traces to Old English *styrtan*, "to leap up".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *starten*
- *Say it:* *starten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *starten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to stroll, then the German for to rinse, then say *starten* again

Before you move on

What does starten mean? ("To start, to take off".) Say it once more.

187.3 stecken — to put, to stick

Before the new one: say the German for to rinse, then the German for to start.

You'll want to know: stecken

stecken — "to put, to stick".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

stecken ← Old High German *steckōn* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, from the same root as the verb "to prick, to stick", Proto-Germanic **stikanǫ*, English *stick*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stecken*
- *Say it: stecken*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stecken*
- *Recall:* say the German for to rinse, then the German for to start, then say *stecken* again

Before you move on

What does stecken mean? ("To put, to stick".) Say it once more.

187.4 stehlen — to steal

Before the new one: say the German for to start, then the German for to put.

You'll want to know: stehlen

stehlen — "to steal".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

stehlen ← Old High German *stelan* ← Proto-Germanic **stelanǫ* — inherited, the same verb as English *steal*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stehlen*
- *Say it: stehlen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stehlen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to start, then the German for to put, then say *stehlen* again

Before you move on

What does stehlen mean? ("To steal".) Say it once more.

187.5 steigen — to climb, to rise

Before the new one: say the German for to put, then the German for to steal.

You'll want to know: steigen

steigen — "to climb, to rise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

steigen ← Middle High German *stīgen* ← Old High German *stīgan*, "to climb" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) English *stile* and *stirrup*, a climbing rope, share the root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: steigen*
- *Say it: steigen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *steigen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to put, then the German for to steal, then say *steigen* again

Before you move on

What does steigen mean? ("To climb, to rise".) Say it once more.

Chapter 188

To paint, To share, To talk on the phone, To separate, To cross

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to paint, to share, to talk on the phone, to separate and to cross.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 188: I can say to paint, to share, to talk on the phone, to separate and to cross.*

188.1 streichen — to paint, to spread

> Before the new one: say the German for to steal, then the German for to climb.

You'll want to know: streichen

streichen — "to paint, to spread".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

streichen ← Middle High German *strīchen* ← Old High German *strīhhan*, "to stroke, to smooth, to spread" — inherited, the same verb as English *strike*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: streichen*
- *Say it: streichen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *streichen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to steal, then the German for to climb, then say *streichen* again

Before you move on

What does streichen mean? ("To paint, to spread".) Say it once more.

188.2 teilen — to share, to divide

Before the new one: say the German for to climb, then the German for to paint.

You'll want to know: teilen

teilen — "to share, to divide".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

teilen ← Old High German *teilen* ← Proto-Germanic **dailijanǫ*, "to divide, to deal out" — inherited, the same verb as English *deal*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: teilen*
- *Say it: teilen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *teilen*

- *Recall:* say the German for to climb, then the German for to paint, then say *teilen* again

Before you move on

What does teilen mean? ("To share, to divide".) Say it once more.

188.3 telefonieren — to talk on the phone

Before the new one: say the German for to paint, then the German for to share.

You'll want to know: telefonieren

telefonieren — "to talk on the phone".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

telefonieren is *Telefon* + the verb ending *-ieren*. *Telefon* is a modern coinage from Greek *tēle*, "far", and *phōnē*, "sound".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: telefonieren*
- *Say it: telefonieren*, once more
- *Say it:* say *telefonieren*
- *Recall:* say the German for to paint, then the German for to share, then say *telefonieren* again

Before you move on

What does telefonieren mean? ("To talk on the phone".) Say it once more.

188.4 trennen — to separate

Before the new one: say the German for to share, then the German for to talk on the phone.

You'll want to know: trennen

trennen — "to separate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

trennen ← Middle High German *trennen* ← Old High German *trennen*, "to split, to separate" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: trennen*
- *Say it: trennen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *trennen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to share, then the German for to talk on the phone, then say *trennen* again

Before you move on

What does trennen mean? ("To separate".) Say it once more.

188.5 überqueren — to cross

Before the new one: say the German for to talk on the phone, then the German for to separate.

You'll want to know: überqueren

überqueren — "to cross".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

überqueren is the word for "over" + a verb built on the word for "across" (EtymDB 2.1 links the two). That word, Middle High German *twer*, is a cousin of English *thwart*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *überqueren*
- *Say it:* *überqueren*, once more
- *Say it:* say *überqueren*
- *Recall:* say the German for to talk on the phone, then the German for to separate, then say *überqueren* again

Before you move on

What does überqueren mean? ("To cross".) Say it once more.

Chapter 189

To translate, To hug, To arrange, To forbid, To connect

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to translate, to hug, to arrange, to forbid and to connect.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 189: I can say to translate, to hug, to arrange, to forbid and to connect.*

189.1 übersetzen — to translate

Before the new one: say the German for to separate, then the German for to cross.

You'll want to know: übersetzen

übersetzen — "to translate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

übersetzen is the word for "over" + the verb "to set", Old High German *sezzen*, English *set* (EtymDB 2.1): to set words over into another language, a copy of Latin *trādūcere*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *übersetzen*
- *Say it:* *übersetzen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *übersetzen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to separate, then the German for to cross, then say *übersetzen* again

Before you move on

What does übersetzen mean? ("To translate".) Say it once more.

189.2 umarmen — to hug

Before the new one: say the German for to cross, then the German for to translate.

You'll want to know: umarmen

umarmen — "to hug".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

umarmen is *um-*, "around", + *Arm* + a verb ending: to put your arms around someone. *Arm* ← Proto-Germanic **armaz*, English *arm*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *umarmen*
- *Say it:* *umarmen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *umarmen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to cross, then the German for to translate, then say *umarmen* again

Before you move on

What does umarmen mean? ("To hug".) Say it once more.

189.3 verabreden — to arrange (sich verabreden: to make a date)

Before the new one: say the German for to translate, then the German for to hug.

You'll want to know: verabreden

verabreden — "to arrange (sich verabreden: to make a date)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

verabreden is *ver-* + *ab-* + the verb "to speak", Old High German *redōn* (EtymDB 2.1): to settle something by talking it over.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: verabreden*
- *Say it: verabreden*, once more
- *Say it:* say *verabreden*
- *Recall:* say the German for to translate, then the German for to hug, then say *verabreden* again

Before you move on

What does verabreden mean? ("To arrange (sich verabreden: to make a date)".) Say it once more.

189.4 verbieten — to forbid

Before the new one: say the German for to hug, then the German for to arrange.

You'll want to know: verbieten

verbieten — "to forbid".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

verbieten is *ver-* + an old verb meaning "to bid, to command" — the same build as English *forbid*, which EtymDB 2.1 lists beside it with Gothic *faurbiudan*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: verbieten*
- *Say it: verbieten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *verbieten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to hug, then the German for to arrange, then say *verbieten* again

Before you move on

What does verbieten mean? ("To forbid".) Say it once more.

189.5 verbinden — to connect, to bandage

Before the new one: say the German for to arrange, then the German for to forbid.

You'll want to know: verbinden

verbinden — "to connect, to bandage".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

verbinden is *ver-* + the verb "to bind", Old High German *bintan* (EtymDB 2.1), the same verb as English *bind*: to tie together, or to bind a wound.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *verbinden*
- *Say it:* *verbinden*, once more
- *Say it:* say *verbinden*
- *Recall:* say the German for to arrange, then the German for to forbid, then say *verbinden* again

Before you move on

What does verbinden mean? ("To connect, to bandage".) Say it once more.

Chapter 190

To compare, To injure, To miss, To postpone, To use

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to compare, to injure, to miss, to postpone and to use.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 190: I can say to compare, to injure, to miss, to postpone and to use.*

190.1 vergleichen — to compare

Before the new one: say the German for to forbid, then the German for to connect.

You'll want to know: vergleichen

vergleichen — "to compare".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vergleichen is *ver-* + *gleich*, "alike", + *-en* (EtymDB 2.1): to set things side by side to see how alike they are.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vergleichen*
- *Say it: vergleichen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vergleichen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to forbid, then the German for to connect, then say *vergleichen* again

Before you move on

What does vergleichen mean? ("To compare".) Say it once more.

190.2 verletzen — to injure

Before the new one: say the German for to connect, then the German for to compare.

You'll want to know: verletzen

verletzen — "to injure".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

verletzen ← Middle High German *verletzen*, "to injure" (EtymDB 2.1): *ver-* + an old verb "to hinder, to harm", built on the root of English *late*, "slow".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: verletzen*
- *Say it: verletzen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *verletzen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to connect, then the German for to compare, then say *verletzen* again

Before you move on

What does verletzen mean? ("To injure".) Say it once more.

190.3 verpassen — to miss (a train, a chance)

Before the new one: say the German for to compare, then the German for to injure.

You'll want to know: verpassen

verpassen — "to miss (a train, a chance)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

verpassen is *ver-* + the verb "to fit, to pass", from Dutch *passen* ← French *passer*, "to pass" (EtymDB 2.1): to let something pass you by.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: verpassen*
- *Say it: verpassen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *verpassen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to compare, then the German for to injure, then say *verpassen* again

Before you move on

What does verpassen mean? ("To miss (a train, a chance)".) Say it once more.

190.4 verschieben — to postpone

Before the new one: say the German for to injure, then the German for to miss.

You'll want to know: verschieben

verschieben — "to postpone".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

verschieben is *ver-* + *schieben*, "to push", the same verb as English *shove* (EtymDB 2.1): to push something to another place or time.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: verschieben*
- *Say it: verschieben*, once more
- *Say it:* say *verschieben*
- *Recall:* say the German for to injure, then the German for to miss, then say *verschieben* again

Before you move on

What does verschieben mean? ("To postpone".) Say it once more.

190.5 verwenden — to use

Before the new one: say the German for to miss, then the German for to postpone.

You'll want to know: verwenden

verwenden — "to use".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

verwenden is *ver-* + the verb "to turn", Old High German *wenten* ← Proto-Germanic **wandijanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1), the same verb as English *wend*: to turn something to a use.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *verwenden*
- *Say it:* *verwenden*, once more
- *Say it:* say *verwenden*
- *Recall:* say the German for to miss, then the German for to postpone, then say *verwenden* again

Before you move on

What does verwenden mean? ("To use".) Say it once more.

Chapter 191

To prepare, To choose, To wake, To weigh, To draw

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to prepare, to choose, to wake, to weigh and to draw.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 191: I can say to prepare, to choose, to wake, to weigh and to draw.*

191.1 vorbereiten — to prepare

Before the new one: say the German for to postpone, then the German for to use.

You'll want to know: vorbereiten

vorbereiten — "to prepare".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vorbereiten is the word for "before" + a verb built on *bereit*, "ready", which EtymDB 2.1 lists beside English *ready*: to make ready beforehand.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vorbereiten*
- *Say it: vorbereiten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vorbereiten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to postpone, then the German for to use, then say *vorbereiten* again

Before you move on

What does vorbereiten mean? ("To prepare".) Say it once more.

191.2 wählen — to choose, to vote, to dial

Before the new one: say the German for to use, then the German for to prepare.

You'll want to know: wählen

wählen — "to choose, to vote, to dial".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wählen ← Old High German *wellen* ← Proto-Germanic **waljanǫ*, "to choose, to select" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) It shares its root with *wollen*, "to want".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: wählen*
- *Say it: wählen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *wählen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to use, then the German for to prepare, then say *wählen* again

Before you move on

What does wählen mean? (“To choose, to vote, to dial”.) Say it once more.

191.3 wecken — to wake (someone)

Before the new one: say the German for to prepare, then the German for to choose.

You’ll want to know: wecken

wecken — “to wake (someone)”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wecken ← Old High German *wecchen* ← Proto-Germanic **wakjanǫ*, “to wake up” — inherited, a cousin of English *wake*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *wecken*
- *Say it:* *wecken*, once more
- *Say it:* say *wecken*
- *Recall:* say the German for to prepare, then the German for to choose, then say *wecken* again

Before you move on

What does wecken mean? (“To wake (someone)”.) Say it once more.

191.4 wiegen — to weigh

Before the new one: say the German for to choose, then the German for to wake.

You'll want to know: wiegen

wiegen — "to weigh".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wiegen ← Middle High German *wegen* ← Old High German *wegan*, "to move, to weigh" — inherited, the same verb as English *weigh*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *wiegen*
- *Say it:* *wiegen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *wiegen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to choose, then the German for to wake, then say *wiegen* again

Before you move on

What does wiegen mean? ("To weigh".) Say it once more.

191.5 zeichnen — to draw

Before the new one: say the German for to wake, then the German for to weigh.

You'll want to know: zeichnen

zeichnen — "to draw".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

zeichnen is the verb of the word for "a sign", Old High German *zeihhan* ← Proto-Germanic **taiknǫ*, the same word as English *token*. (EtymDB 2.1) To draw is to make signs.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zeichnen*
- *Say it: zeichnen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zeichnen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to wake, then the German for to weigh, then say *zeichnen* again

Before you move on

What does zeichnen mean? ("To draw".) Say it once more.

191.6 Words from chapters 183-186 — a first pass

Say the words for to weigh and to draw.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to suffer, to measure, to mix, to sew, to sneeze
- to park, to look after, to pick, to test, to clean
- to rescue, to row, to push, to hit, to taste
- to snow, to protect, to sail, to send, to stroll

Before you move on

To suffer? (**leiden**.) To measure? (**messen**.) To mix? (**mischen**.) To sew? (**nähen**.) To sneeze? (**niesen**.) To park? (**parken**.) To look after? (**pflegen**.) To pick? (**pflücken**.) To test? (**prüfen**.) To clean? (**reinigen**.) To rescue? (**retten**.) To row? (**rudern**.) To push? (**schieben**.) To hit? (**schlagen**.) To taste? (**schmecken**.)

To snow? (**schneien**.) To protect? (**schützen**.) To sail? (**segeln**.) To send? (**senden**.) To stroll? (**spazieren**.)

191.7 Words from chapters 187-191 — a second pass

Say the words for to rinse and to start.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to rinse, to start, to put, to steal, to climb
- to paint, to share, to talk on the phone, to separate, to cross
- to translate, to hug, to arrange, to forbid, to connect
- to compare, to injure, to miss, to postpone, to use
- to prepare, to choose, to wake, to weigh, to draw

Before you move on

To rinse? (**spülen**.) To start? (**starten**.) To put? (**stecken**.) To steal? (**stehlen**.) To climb? (**steigen**.) To paint? (**streichen**.) To share? (**teilen**.) To talk on the phone? (**telefonieren**.) To separate? (**trennen**.) To cross? (**überqueren**.) To translate? (**übersetzen**.) To hug? (**umarmen**.) To arrange? (**verabreden**.) To forbid? (**verbieten**.) To connect? (**verbinden**.) To compare? (**vergleichen**.) To injure? (**verletzen**.) To miss? (**verpassen**.) To postpone? (**verschieben**.) To use? (**verwenden**.) To prepare? (**vorbereiten**.) To choose? (**wählen**.) To wake? (**wecken**.) To weigh? (**wiegen**.) To draw? (**zeichnen**.)

Chapter 192

A departure, An arrival, A take-off, A delay, A platform

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a departure, an arrival, a take-off, a delay and a platform.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 192: I can say a departure, an arrival, a take-off, a delay and a platform.*

192.1 die Abfahrt — a departure

> Before the new one: say the German for to weigh, then the German for to draw.

You'll want to know: die Abfahrt

die Abfahrt — "a departure".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Abfahrt is *ab-*, "off", + the word for "a journey", Old High German *vart* ← Proto-Germanic **fardiz* (EtymDB 2.1), from *fahren*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Abfahrt*
- *Say it: die Abfahrt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Abfahrt*
- *Recall:* say the German for to weigh, then the German for to draw, then say *die Abfahrt* again

Before you move on

What does die Abfahrt mean? ("A departure".) Say it once more.

192.2 die Ankunft — an arrival

Before the new one: say the German for to draw, then the German for a departure.

You'll want to know: die Ankunft

die Ankunft — "an arrival".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ankunft is *an-*, "at", + an old noun for "a coming", built on *kommen* (EtymDB 2.1). An arrival is a coming-at.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Ankunft*
- *Say it: die Ankunft*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Ankunft*
- *Recall:* say the German for to draw, then the German for a departure, then say *die Ankunft* again

Before you move on

What does die Ankunft mean? ("An arrival".) Say it once more.

192.3 der Abflug — a take-off, a departure (by air)

Before the new one: say the German for a departure, then the German for an arrival.

You'll want to know: der Abflug

der Abflug — "a take-off, a departure (by air)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Abflug is *ab-*, "off", + the word for "flight", Old High German *flug* ← Proto-Germanic **flugiz*, from *fliegen* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Abflug*
- *Say it: der Abflug*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Abflug*
- *Recall:* say the German for a departure, then the German for an arrival, then say *der Abflug* again

Before you move on

What does der Abflug mean? ("A take-off, a departure (by air)".) Say it once more.

192.4 die Verspätung — a delay

Before the new one: say the German for an arrival, then the German for a take-off.

You'll want to know: die Verspätung

die Verspätung — "a delay".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Verspätung is *ver-* + *spät*, "late", + *-ung*: being made late. *spät* ← Old High German *spāti*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Verspätung*
- *Say it: die Verspätung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Verspätung*
- *Recall:* say the German for an arrival, then the German for a take-off, then say *die Verspätung* again

Before you move on

What does die Verspätung mean? ("A delay".) Say it once more.

192.5 das Gleis — a platform, a track

Before the new one: say the German for a take-off, then the German for a delay.

You'll want to know: das Gleis

das Gleis — "a platform, a track".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gleis is worn down from Middle High German *geleise*, "rut, track": *ge-* + an old word for "a track", the ruts carts cut into a road. EtymDB 2.1 has no source for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Gleis*
- *Say it: das Gleis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Gleis*
- *Recall:* say the German for a take-off, then the German for a delay, then say *das Gleis* again

Before you move on

What does das Gleis mean? ("A platform, a track".) Say it once more.

Chapter 193

A timetable, A return journey, Accommodation, A youth hostel, Luggage

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a timetable, a return journey, accommodation, a youth hostel and luggage.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 193: I can say a timetable, a return journey, accommodation, a youth hostel and luggage.*

193.1 der Fahrplan — a timetable

Before the new one: say the German for a delay, then the German for a platform.

You'll want to know: der Fahrplan

der Fahrplan — "a timetable".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Fahrplan is *fahren* + *Plan*, "plan" ← French *plan*, from Latin *plānus*, "flat" (EtymDB 2.1): a plan of journeys.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Fahrplan*
- *Say it: der Fahrplan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Fahrplan*
- *Recall:* say the German for a delay, then the German for a platform, then say *der Fahrplan* again

Before you move on

What does der Fahrplan mean? ("A timetable".) Say it once more.

193.2 die Rückfahrt — a return journey

Before the new one: say the German for a platform, then the German for a timetable.

You'll want to know: die Rückfahrt

die Rückfahrt — "a return journey".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Rückfahrt is the word for "back" (as in *Rücken*) + the word for "a journey", Old High German *vart* ← Proto-Germanic **fardiz* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Rückfahrt*
- *Say it: die Rückfahrt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Rückfahrt*
- *Recall:* say the German for a platform, then the German for a timetable, then say *die Rückfahrt* again

Before you move on

What does die Rückfahrt mean? (“A return journey”.) Say it once more.

193.3 die Unterkunft — accommodation

Before the new one: say the German for a timetable, then the German for a return journey.

You’ll want to know: die Unterkunft

die Unterkunft — “accommodation”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Unterkunft is the word for “under” + an old noun for “a coming”, built on *kommen* (EtymDB 2.1): a place you come under, a shelter.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Unterkunft*
- *Say it: die Unterkunft*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Unterkunft*
- *Recall:* say the German for a timetable, then the German for a return journey, then say *die Unterkunft* again

Before you move on

What does die Unterkunft mean? (“Accommodation”.) Say it once more.

193.4 die Jugendherberge — a youth hostel

Before the new one: say the German for a return journey, then the German for accommodation.

You'll want to know: die Jugendherberge

die Jugendherberge — "a youth hostel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Jugendherberge is the word for "youth" + *Herberge*, "inn" ← Old High German *heriberga*, "shelter for an army" (EtymDB 2.1). English *harbour* and French *auberge* are cousins.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Jugendherberge*
- *Say it: die Jugendherberge*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Jugendherberge*
- *Recall:* say the German for a return journey, then the German for accommodation, then say *die Jugendherberge* again

Before you move on

What does die Jugendherberge mean? ("A youth hostel".) Say it once more.

193.5 das Gepäck — luggage

Before the new one: say the German for accommodation, then the German for a youth hostel.

You'll want to know: das Gepäck

das Gepäck — "luggage".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gepäck is *ge-*, the gathering prefix, + the word for "a pack" (EtymDB 2.1 has the word), the same word as English *pack*: everything packed together.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Gepäck*
- *Say it: das Gepäck*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Gepäck*
- *Recall:* say the German for accommodation, then the German for a youth hostel, then say *das Gepäck* again

Before you move on

What does das Gepäck mean? ("Luggage".) Say it once more.

Chapter 194

A rucksack, A sight, A city map, A round trip, A market square

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a rucksack, a sight, a city map, a round trip and a market square.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 194: I can say a rucksack, a sight, a city map, a round trip and a market square.

194.1 der Rucksack — a rucksack

Before the new one: say the German for a youth hostel, then the German for luggage.

You'll want to know: der Rucksack

der Rucksack — "a rucksack".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Rucksack is an Alpine dialect form of the word for "back" + the word for "sack", Old High German *sac* (EtymDB 2.1). English borrowed *rucksack* from German.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Rucksack*
- *Say it: der Rucksack*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Rucksack*
- *Recall:* say the German for a youth hostel, then the German for luggage, then say *der Rucksack* again

Before you move on

What does der Rucksack mean? ("A rucksack".) Say it once more.

194.2 die Sehenswürdigkeit — a sight (worth seeing)

Before the new one: say the German for luggage, then the German for a rucksack.

You'll want to know: die Sehenswürdigkeit

die Sehenswürdigkeit — "a sight (worth seeing)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Sehenswürdigkeit is *sehen*, "to see", + the word for "worthy", which EtymDB 2.1 lists beside English *worthy*, + *-keit*: a thing worth seeing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Sehenswürdigkeit*
- *Say it: die Sehenswürdigkeit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Sehenswürdigkeit*
- *Recall:* say the German for luggage, then the German for a rucksack, then say *die Sehenswürdigkeit* again

Before you move on

What does die Sehenswürdigkeit mean? ("A sight (worth seeing)".) Say it once more.

194.3 der Stadtplan — a city map

Before the new one: say the German for a rucksack, then the German for a sight.

You'll want to know: der Stadtplan

der Stadtplan — "a city map".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Stadtplan is the word for "town, city" + *Plan*, "plan" ← French *plan* (EtymDB 2.1): a plan of the town.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Stadtplan*
- *Say it: der Stadtplan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Stadtplan*
- *Recall:* say the German for a rucksack, then the German for a sight, then say *der Stadtplan* again

Before you move on

What does der Stadtplan mean? ("A city map".) Say it once more.

194.4 die Rundfahrt — a round trip, a tour

Before the new one: say the German for a sight, then the German for a city map.

You'll want to know: die Rundfahrt

die Rundfahrt — "a round trip, a tour".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Rundfahrt is *rund*, "round", + the word for "a journey", Old High German *vart* (EtymDB 2.1): a trip that comes round to its start.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Rundfahrt*
- *Say it: die Rundfahrt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Rundfahrt*
- *Recall:* say the German for a sight, then the German for a city map, then say *die Rundfahrt* again

Before you move on

What does die Rundfahrt mean? ("A round trip, a tour".) Say it once more.

194.5 der Marktplatz — a market square

Before the new one: say the German for a city map, then the German for a round trip.

You'll want to know: der Marktplatz

der Marktplatz — "a market square".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Marktplatz is *Markt* + *Platz* (EtymDB 2.1): both came from Latin, *mercātus* and *platēa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Marktplatz*
- *Say it: der Marktplatz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Marktplatz*
- *Recall:* say the German for a city map, then the German for a round trip, then say *der Marktplatz* again

Before you move on

What does der Marktplatz mean? ("A market square".) Say it once more.

Chapter 195

A pedestrian zone, A cathedral, A monument, A tower, A castle

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a pedestrian zone, a cathedral, a monument, a tower and a castle.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 195: I can say a pedestrian zone, a cathedral, a monument, a tower and a castle.*

195.1 die Fußgängerzone — a pedestrian zone

> Before the new one: say the German for a round trip, then the German for a market square.

You'll want to know: die Fußgängerzone

die Fußgängerzone — "a pedestrian zone".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Fußgängerzone is *Fuß* + a noun built on *gehen*, "to go", + *Zone*, "zone", which came through Latin from Greek *zṓnē*, "belt": a belt of town for people on foot.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Fußgängerzone*
- *Say it: die Fußgängerzone*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Fußgängerzone*
- *Recall:* say the German for a round trip, then the German for a market square, then say *die Fußgängerzone* again

Before you move on

What does die Fußgängerzone mean? ("A pedestrian zone".) Say it once more.

195.2 der Dom — a cathedral

Before the new one: say the German for a market square, then the German for a pedestrian zone.

You'll want to know: der Dom

der Dom — "a cathedral".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Dom ← Middle High German *tuom* ← Medieval Latin *domus* (*episcopalis*), "the (bishop's) house" — borrowed. The modern form was reshaped after French *dôme* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Dom*
- *Say it: der Dom*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Dom*

- *Recall:* say the German for a market square, then the German for a pedestrian zone, then say *der Dom* again

Before you move on

What does der Dom mean? ("A cathedral".) Say it once more.

195.3 das Denkmal — a monument

Before the new one: say the German for a pedestrian zone, then the German for a cathedral.

You'll want to know: das Denkmal

das Denkmal — "a monument".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Denkmal is *denken*, "to think, to remember", + the old word for "a mark", Old High German *māl* (EtymDB 2.1): a mark to remember by, copying Greek *mnēmósynon*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Denkmal*
- *Say it: das Denkmal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Denkmal*
- *Recall:* say the German for a pedestrian zone, then the German for a cathedral, then say *das Denkmal* again

Before you move on

What does das Denkmal mean? ("A monument".) Say it once more.

195.4 der Turm — a tower

Before the new one: say the German for a cathedral, then the German for a monument.

You'll want to know: der Turm

der Turm — "a tower".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Turm ← Middle High German *turn* ← Old French *torn*, *tor* ← Latin *turris*, "tower" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *tower*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Turm*
- *Say it: der Turm*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Turm*
- *Recall:* say the German for a cathedral, then the German for a monument, then say *der Turm* again

Before you move on

What does der Turm mean? ("A tower".) Say it once more.

195.5 die Burg — a castle

Before the new one: say the German for a monument, then the German for a tower.

You'll want to know: die Burg

die Burg — "a castle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Burg ← Old High German *burg* ← Proto-Germanic **burgz*, "stronghold" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) English *borough* and the *-bury* of place names are the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Burg*
- *Say it: die Burg*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Burg*
- *Recall:* say the German for a monument, then the German for a tower, then say *die Burg* again

Before you move on

What does die Burg mean? ("A castle".) Say it once more.

Chapter 196

A harbour, A bank, A beach, A meadow, A valley

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a harbour, a bank, a beach, a meadow and a valley.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 196: I can say a harbour, a bank, a beach, a meadow and a valley.

196.1 der Hafen — a harbour

Before the new one: say the German for a tower, then the German for a castle.

You'll want to know: der Hafen

der Hafen — "a harbour".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Hafen was borrowed into standard German from Middle Low German *havene*; EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *haven* and Dutch *haven*: one Germanic word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Hafen*
- *Say it: der Hafen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Hafen*
- *Recall:* say the German for a tower, then the German for a castle, then say *der Hafen* again

Before you move on

What does der Hafen mean? (“A harbour”.) Say it once more.

196.2 das Ufer — a bank, a shore

Before the new one: say the German for a castle, then the German for a harbour.

You’ll want to know: das Ufer

das Ufer — “a bank, a shore”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ufer ← Middle High German *uover* — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists Dutch *oever* and an old English *over*, “shore”, beside it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Ufer*
- *Say it: das Ufer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Ufer*
- *Recall:* say the German for a castle, then the German for a harbour, then say *das Ufer* again

Before you move on

What does das Ufer mean? (“A bank, a shore”.) Say it once more.

196.3 der Strand — a beach

Before the new one: say the German for a harbour, then the German for a bank.

You’ll want to know: der Strand

der Strand — “a beach”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Strand ← Middle High German *strant*, borrowed from Low German — the same word as English *strand*, “shore”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Strand*
- *Say it: der Strand*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Strand*
- *Recall:* say the German for a harbour, then the German for a bank, then say *der Strand* again

Before you move on

What does der Strand mean? (“A beach”.) Say it once more.

196.4 die Wiese — a meadow

Before the new one: say the German for a bank, then the German for a beach.

You'll want to know: die Wiese

die Wiese — "a meadow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wiese ← Middle High German *wise* ← Old High German *wisa*, "meadow" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Wiese*
- *Say it: die Wiese*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Wiese*
- *Recall:* say the German for a bank, then the German for a beach, then say *die Wiese* again

Before you move on

What does die Wiese mean? ("A meadow".) Say it once more.

196.5 das Tal — a valley

Before the new one: say the German for a beach, then the German for a meadow.

You'll want to know: das Tal

das Tal — "a valley".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Tal ← Middle High German *tal* ← Old High German *tal* — inherited, the same word as English *dale*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Tal*
- *Say it: das Tal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Tal*
- *Recall:* say the German for a beach, then the German for a meadow, then say *das Tal* again

Before you move on

What does das Tal mean? ("A valley".) Say it once more.

Chapter 197

A coast, Fog, Heat, Cold, Lightning

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a coast, fog, heat, cold and lightning.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 197: I can say a coast, fog, heat, cold and lightning.

197.1 die Küste — a coast

Before the new one: say the German for a meadow, then the German for a valley.

You'll want to know: die Küste

die Küste — "a coast".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Küste came through Low German and Dutch from Old French *coste*, "side, coast", ← Latin *costa*, "rib, side" — borrowed, like English *coast*. EtymDB 2.1 has no row for the German word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Küste*
- *Say it: die Küste*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Küste*
- *Recall:* say the German for a meadow, then the German for a valley, then say *die Küste* again

Before you move on

What does die Küste mean? ("A coast".) Say it once more.

197.2 der Nebel — fog

Before the new one: say the German for a valley, then the German for a coast.

You'll want to know: der Nebel

der Nebel — "fog".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Nebel ← Old High German *nebul*, "cloud, fog" ← Proto-Germanic **nebulaz* — inherited, a cousin of Latin *nebula*, "mist". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Nebel*
- *Say it: der Nebel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Nebel*
- *Recall:* say the German for a valley, then the German for a coast, then say *der Nebel* again

Before you move on

What does der Nebel mean? (“Fog”.) Say it once more.

197.3 die Hitze — heat

Before the new one: say the German for a coast, then the German for fog.

You’ll want to know: die Hitze

die Hitze — “heat”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Hitze ← Middle High German *hitze* ← Old High German *hizza* — inherited, a cousin of English *heat*; Dutch *hitte* is the same word. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Hitze*
- *Say it: die Hitze*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Hitze*
- *Recall:* say the German for a coast, then the German for fog, then say *die Hitze* again

Before you move on

What does die Hitze mean? (“Heat”.) Say it once more.

197.4 die Kälte — cold

Before the new one: say the German for fog, then the German for heat.

You'll want to know: die Kälte

die Kälte — "cold".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kälte ← Middle High German *kelte* ← Old High German *kaltī*, the noun of the word for "cold" ← Proto-Germanic **kaldaz*, English *cold*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Kälte*
- *Say it: die Kälte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Kälte*
- *Recall:* say the German for fog, then the German for heat, then say *die Kälte* again

Before you move on

What does die Kälte mean? ("Cold".) Say it once more.

197.5 der Blitz — lightning

Before the new one: say the German for heat, then the German for cold.

You'll want to know: der Blitz

der Blitz — "lightning".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Blitz ← Middle High German *blitze*, "lightning", from Old High German *blecchazzen*, "to flash" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited. English borrowed *blitz* from German.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Blitz*
- *Say it: der Blitz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Blitz*
- *Recall:* say the German for heat, then the German for cold, then say *der Blitz* again

Before you move on

What does der Blitz mean? ("Lightning".) Say it once more.

Chapter 198

An animal, A hare, A fly, A butterfly, A plant

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an animal, a hare, a fly, a butterfly and a plant.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 198: I can say an animal, a hare, a fly, a butterfly and a plant.

198.1 das Tier — an animal

Before the new one: say the German for cold, then the German for lightning.

You'll want to know: das Tier

das Tier — "an animal".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Tier ← Old High German *tior* ← Proto-Germanic **deuzą*, "animal" — inherited, the same word as English *deer*, which narrowed to one kind of animal. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Tier*
- *Say it: das Tier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Tier*
- *Recall:* say the German for cold, then the German for lightning, then say *das Tier* again

Before you move on

What does das Tier mean? ("An animal".) Say it once more.

198.2 der Hase — a hare

Before the new one: say the German for lightning, then the German for an animal.

You'll want to know: der Hase

der Hase — "a hare".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Hase ← Middle High German *hase* ← Old High German *haso* — inherited. EtymDB 2.1 traces English *hare* to Proto-Germanic **hasô*: the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Hase*
- *Say it: der Hase*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Hase*
- *Recall:* say the German for lightning, then the German for an animal, then say *der Hase* again

Before you move on

What does der Hase mean? (“A hare”.) Say it once more.

198.3 die Fliege — a fly

Before the new one: say the German for an animal, then the German for a hare.

You’ll want to know: die Fliege

die Fliege — “a fly”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Fliege ← Middle High German *vliege* (EtymDB 2.1), named from *fliegen*, “to fly” — as English *fly* names the insect after flying.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Fliege*
- *Say it: die Fliege*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Fliege*
- *Recall:* say the German for an animal, then the German for a hare, then say *die Fliege* again

Before you move on

What does die Fliege mean? (“A fly”.) Say it once more.

198.4 der Schmetterling — a butterfly

Before the new one: say the German for a hare, then the German for a fly.

You'll want to know: der Schmetterling

der Schmetterling — "a butterfly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schmetterling is built on an East Central German word for "cream", taken from Czech *smetana* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-ling*: butterflies were said to be drawn to milk and cream.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Schmetterling*
- *Say it: der Schmetterling*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Schmetterling*
- *Recall:* say the German for a hare, then the German for a fly, then say *der Schmetterling* again

Before you move on

What does der Schmetterling mean? ("A butterfly".) Say it once more.

198.5 die Pflanze — a plant

Before the new one: say the German for a fly, then the German for a butterfly.

You'll want to know: die Pflanze

die Pflanze — "a plant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Pflanze ← Old High German *pflanza* ← Latin *planta*, "shoot, cutting" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed so early that its *p* shifted to *pf*. English *plant* is the same Latin word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Pflanze*
- *Say it: die Pflanze*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Pflanze*
- *Recall:* say the German for a fly, then the German for a butterfly, then say *die Pflanze* again

Before you move on

What does die Pflanze mean? ("A plant".) Say it once more.

Chapter 199

Grass, A fruit, A carrot, A chicken, A gateau

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say grass, a fruit, a carrot, a chicken and a gateau.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 199: I can say grass, a fruit, a carrot, a chicken and a gateau.*

199.1 das Gras — grass

Before the new one: say the German for a butterfly, then the German for a plant.

You'll want to know: das Gras

das Gras — "grass".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gras ← Middle High German *gras* ← Old High German *gras* — inherited, the same word as English *grass*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Gras*
- *Say it: das Gras*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Gras*
- *Recall:* say the German for a butterfly, then the German for a plant, then say *das Gras* again

Before you move on

What does das Gras mean? ("Grass".) Say it once more.

199.2 die Frucht — a fruit

Before the new one: say the German for a plant, then the German for grass.

You'll want to know: die Frucht

die Frucht — "a fruit".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Frucht ← Middle High German *vruht* ← Old High German *fruht* (EtymDB 2.1), from Latin *frūctus*, "produce, enjoyment" — borrowed, like English *fruit*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Frucht*
- *Say it: die Frucht*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Frucht*
- *Recall:* say the German for a plant, then the German for grass, then say *die Frucht* again

Before you move on

What does die Frucht mean? ("A fruit".) Say it once more.

199.3 die Karotte — a carrot

Before the new one: say the German for grass, then the German for a fruit.

You'll want to know: die Karotte

die Karotte — "a carrot".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Karotte ← French *carotte* ← Latin *carōta*, "carrot" (EtymDB 2.1), from Greek — borrowed, like English *carrot*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Karotte*
- *Say it: die Karotte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Karotte*
- *Recall:* say the German for grass, then the German for a fruit, then say *die Karotte* again

Before you move on

What does die Karotte mean? ("A carrot".) Say it once more.

199.4 das Hähnchen — a chicken (to eat)

Before the new one: say the German for a fruit, then the German for a carrot.

You'll want to know: das Hähnchen

das Hähnchen — "a chicken (to eat)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Hähnchen is the word for "cock, rooster", Old High German *hano* ← Proto-Germanic **hanô* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-chen*, "little". The same root gives English *hen*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Hähnchen*
- *Say it: das Hähnchen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Hähnchen*
- *Recall:* say the German for a fruit, then the German for a carrot, then say *das Hähnchen* again

Before you move on

What does das Hähnchen mean? ("A chicken (to eat)".) Say it once more.

199.5 die Torte — a gateau, a layer cake

Before the new one: say the German for a carrot, then the German for a chicken.

You'll want to know: die Torte

die Torte — "a gateau, a layer cake".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Torte ← Italian *torta*, "cake" ← Late Latin *torta*, "a kind of round bread" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed; English took *torte* from German.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Torte*
- *Say it: die Torte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Torte*
- *Recall:* say the German for a carrot, then the German for a chicken, then say *die Torte* again

Before you move on

What does die Torte mean? ("A gateau, a layer cake".) Say it once more.

Chapter 200

A menu, An order, A tip, A waitress, Cutlery

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a menu, an order, a tip, a waitress and cutlery.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 200: I can say a menu, an order, a tip, a waitress and cutlery.

200.1 die Speisekarte — a menu

Before the new one: say the German for a chicken, then the German for a gateau.

You'll want to know: die Speisekarte

die Speisekarte — "a menu".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Speisekarte is the word for "food, a dish" (itself from Medieval Latin *spēsa*, "provisions") + *Karte*, "card", from Latin *charta* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Speisekarte*
- *Say it: die Speisekarte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Speisekarte*
- *Recall:* say the German for a chicken, then the German for a gateau, then say *die Speisekarte* again

Before you move on

What does die Speisekarte mean? ("A menu".) Say it once more.

200.2 die Bestellung — an order

Before the new one: say the German for a gateau, then the German for a menu.

You'll want to know: die Bestellung

die Bestellung — "an order".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bestellung is *bestellen*, "to order", + *-ung*. *bestellen* is *be-* + the verb "to put, to place", Proto-Germanic **stallijanǫ*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Bestellung*
- *Say it: die Bestellung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Bestellung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a gateau, then the German for a menu, then say *die Bestellung* again

Before you move on

What does die Bestellung mean? (“An order”.) Say it once more.

200.3 das Trinkgeld — a tip

Before the new one: say the German for a menu, then the German for an order.

You’ll want to know: das Trinkgeld

das Trinkgeld — “a tip”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Trinkgeld is the stem of the verb “to drink”, Old High German *trinkan* ← Proto-Germanic **drinkanǫ*, English *drink*, + *Geld*, “money” (EtymDB 2.1): money for a drink.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Trinkgeld*
- *Say it: das Trinkgeld*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Trinkgeld*
- *Recall:* say the German for a menu, then the German for an order, then say *das Trinkgeld* again

Before you move on

What does das Trinkgeld mean? (“A tip”.) Say it once more.

200.4 die Kellnerin — a waitress

Before the new one: say the German for an order, then the German for a tip.

You'll want to know: die Kellnerin

die Kellnerin — "a waitress".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kellnerin ← Middle High German *këlnærinne* (EtymDB 2.1): *Kellner* + *-in*. *Kellner* goes back to Medieval Latin *cellenārius*, "cellar master".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Kellnerin*
- *Say it: die Kellnerin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Kellnerin*
- *Recall:* say the German for an order, then the German for a tip, then say *die Kellnerin* again

Before you move on

What does die Kellnerin mean? ("A waitress".) Say it once more.

200.5 das Besteck — cutlery

Before the new one: say the German for a tip, then the German for a waitress.

You'll want to know: das Besteck

das Besteck — "cutlery".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Besteck comes from the verb "to stick in, to fit with" (EtymDB 2.1): a case with knives and forks stuck into it, then the cutlery itself.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Besteck*
- *Say it: das Besteck*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Besteck*
- *Recall:* say the German for a tip, then the German for a waitress, then say *das Besteck* again

Before you move on

What does das Besteck mean? ("Cutlery".) Say it once more.

200.6 Words from chapters 192-195 — a first pass

Say the words for a waitress and cutlery.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a departure, an arrival, a take-off, a delay, a platform
- a timetable, a return journey, accommodation, a youth hostel, luggage
- a rucksack, a sight, a city map, a round trip, a market square
- a pedestrian zone, a cathedral, a monument, a tower, a castle

Before you move on

A departure? (**die Abfahrt**.) An arrival? (**die Ankunft**.) A take-off? (**der Abflug**.) A delay? (**die Verspätung**.) A platform? (**das Gleis**.) A timetable? (**der Fahrplan**.) A return journey? (**die Rückfahrt**.) Accommodation? (**die Unterkunft**.) A youth

hostel? (**die Jugendherberge**.) Luggage? (**das Gepäck**.) A rucksack? (**der Rucksack**.) A sight? (**die Sehenswürdigkeit**.) A city map? (**der Stadtplan**.) A round trip? (**die Rundfahrt**.) A market square? (**der Marktplatz**.) A pedestrian zone? (**die Fußgängerzone**.) A cathedral? (**der Dom**.) A monument? (**das Denkmal**.) A tower? (**der Turm**.) A castle? (**die Burg**.)

200.7 Words from chapters 196-200 — a second pass

Say the words for a harbour and a bank.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a harbour, a bank, a beach, a meadow, a valley
- a coast, fog, heat, cold, lightning
- an animal, a hare, a fly, a butterfly, a plant
- grass, a fruit, a carrot, a chicken, a gateau
- a menu, an order, a tip, a waitress, cutlery

Before you move on

A harbour? (**der Hafen**.) A bank? (**das Ufer**.) A beach? (**der Strand**.) A meadow? (**die Wiese**.) A valley? (**das Tal**.) A coast? (**die Küste**.) Fog? (**der Nebel**.) Heat? (**die Hitze**.) Cold? (**die Kälte**.) Lightning? (**der Blitz**.) An animal? (**das Tier**.) A hare? (**der Hase**.) A fly? (**die Fliege**.) A butterfly? (**der Schmetterling**.) A plant? (**die Pflanze**.) Grass? (**das Gras**.) A fruit? (**die Frucht**.) A carrot? (**die Karotte**.) A chicken? (**das Hähnchen**.) A gateau? (**die Torte**.) A menu? (**die Speisekarte**.) An order? (**die Bestellung**.) A tip? (**das Trinkgeld**.) A waitress? (**die Kellnerin**.) Cutlery? (**das Besteck**.)

Chapter 201

A tin, A pot, A frying pan, An oven, A dishwasher

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a tin, a pot, a frying pan, an oven and a dishwasher.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 201: I can say a tin, a pot, a frying pan, an oven and a dishwasher.

201.1 die Dose — a tin, a can

Before the new one: say the German for a waitress, then the German for cutlery.

You'll want to know: die Dose

die Dose — "a tin, a can".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Dose was borrowed into standard German from Low German *dose*, "box, case". Its origin is uncertain; EtymDB 2.1 has the word but no source for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Dose*
- *Say it: die Dose*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Dose*
- *Recall:* say the German for a waitress, then the German for cutlery, then say *die Dose* again

Before you move on

What does die Dose mean? ("A tin, a can".) Say it once more.

201.2 der Topf — a pot

Before the new one: say the German for cutlery, then the German for a tin.

You'll want to know: der Topf

der Topf — "a pot".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Topf ← Middle High German *topf* (EtymDB 2.1), a central German word of uncertain origin; Dutch *dop*, "little cup", may be related.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Topf*
- *Say it: der Topf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Topf*
- *Recall:* say the German for cutlery, then the German for a tin, then say *der Topf* again

Before you move on

What does der Topf mean? ("A pot".) Say it once more.

201.3 die Pfanne — a frying pan

Before the new one: say the German for a tin, then the German for a pot.

You'll want to know: die Pfanne

die Pfanne — "a frying pan".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Pfanne ← Middle High German *pfanne* ← Old High German *phanna* (EtymDB 2.1), from Latin *patina*, "pan, dish" — an early loan whose *p* shifted to *pf*. English *pan* is the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Pfanne*
- *Say it: die Pfanne*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Pfanne*
- *Recall:* say the German for a tin, then the German for a pot, then say *die Pfanne* again

Before you move on

What does die Pfanne mean? ("A frying pan".) Say it once more.

201.4 der Ofen — an oven

Before the new one: say the German for a pot, then the German for a frying pan.

You'll want to know: der Ofen

der Ofen — "an oven".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ofen ← Proto-Germanic **uhnaz*, "oven" — inherited, the same word as English *oven*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Ofen*
- *Say it: der Ofen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Ofen*
- *Recall:* say the German for a pot, then the German for a frying pan, then say *der Ofen* again

Before you move on

What does der Ofen mean? ("An oven".) Say it once more.

201.5 die Spülmaschine — a dishwasher

Before the new one: say the German for a frying pan, then the German for an oven.

You'll want to know: die Spülmaschine

die Spülmaschine — "a dishwasher".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Spülmaschine is *spülen*, "to rinse", + the word for "machine" ← French *machine* ← Latin *māchina* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Spülmaschine*
- *Say it: die Spülmaschine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Spülmaschine*
- *Recall:* say the German for a frying pan, then the German for an oven, then say *die Spülmaschine* again

Before you move on

What does die Spülmaschine mean? ("A dishwasher".) Say it once more.

Chapter 202

A vacuum cleaner, An iron, Shampoo, A brush, A suit

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a vacuum cleaner, an iron, shampoo, a brush and a suit.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 202: I can say a vacuum cleaner, an iron, shampoo, a brush and a suit.*

202.1 der Staubsauger — a vacuum cleaner

> Before the new one: say the German for an oven, then the German for a dishwasher.

You'll want to know: der Staubsauger

der Staubsauger — "a vacuum cleaner".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Staubsauger is the word for "dust", Old High German *stoup*, + a noun from the verb "to suck", Old High German *sūgan* ← Proto-Germanic **sūganą*, English *suck* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Staubsauger*
- *Say it: der Staubsauger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Staubsauger*
- *Recall:* say the German for an oven, then the German for a dishwasher, then say *der Staubsauger* again

Before you move on

What does der Staubsauger mean? ("A vacuum cleaner".) Say it once more.

202.2 das Bügeleisen — an iron

Before the new one: say the German for a dishwasher, then the German for a vacuum cleaner.

You'll want to know: das Bügeleisen

das Bügeleisen — "an iron".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bügeleisen is the verb "to iron, to smooth" + the word for "iron", Old High German *īsarn* ← Proto-Germanic **īsarną*, the same word as English *iron* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Bügeleisen*
- *Say it: das Bügeleisen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Bügeleisen*

- *Recall:* say the German for a dishwasher, then the German for a vacuum cleaner, then say *das Bügeleisen* again

Before you move on

What does das Bügeleisen mean? ("An iron".) Say it once more.

202.3 das Shampoo — shampoo

Before the new one: say the German for a vacuum cleaner, then the German for an iron.

You'll want to know: das Shampoo

das Shampoo — "shampoo".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Shampoo ← English *shampoo* ← Hindi *chāmpo*, "press!, knead!" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: it first meant a massage.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Shampoo*
- *Say it: das Shampoo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Shampoo*
- *Recall:* say the German for a vacuum cleaner, then the German for an iron, then say *das Shampoo* again

Before you move on

What does das Shampoo mean? ("Shampoo".) Say it once more.

202.4 die Bürste — a brush

Before the new one: say the German for an iron, then the German for shampoo.

You'll want to know: die Bürste

die Bürste — "a brush".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bürste ← Old High German *bursta*, "bristles" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited. English *bristle* comes from the same root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Bürste*
- *Say it: die Bürste*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Bürste*
- *Recall:* say the German for an iron, then the German for shampoo, then say *die Bürste* again

Before you move on

What does die Bürste mean? ("A brush".) Say it once more.

202.5 der Anzug — a suit

Before the new one: say the German for shampoo, then the German for a brush.

You'll want to know: der Anzug

der Anzug — "a suit".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Anzug is *an-*, "on", + *Zug*, "a pull", from the verb "to pull" (EtymDB 2.1): what you pull on, a suit.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Anzug*
- *Say it: der Anzug*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Anzug*
- *Recall:* say the German for shampoo, then the German for a brush, then say *der Anzug* again

Before you move on

What does der Anzug mean? ("A suit".) Say it once more.

Chapter 203

A purse, A size, Material, Wool, Silk

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a purse, a size, material, wool and silk.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 203: I can say a purse, a size, material, wool and silk.

203.1 das Portemonnaie — a purse, a wallet

Before the new one: say the German for a brush, then the German for a suit.

You'll want to know: das Portemonnaie

das Portemonnaie — "a purse, a wallet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Portemonnaie ← French *porte-monnaie*, "carry-money" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Portemonnaie*
- *Say it: das Portemonnaie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Portemonnaie*
- *Recall:* say the German for a brush, then the German for a suit, then say *das Portemonnaie* again

Before you move on

What does das Portemonnaie mean? ("A purse, a wallet".) Say it once more.

203.2 die Größe — a size

Before the new one: say the German for a suit, then the German for a purse.

You'll want to know: die Größe

die Größe — "a size".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Größe ← Old High German *grōzī* ← Proto-Germanic **grautīz*, "greatness, size" — inherited, the noun of the word for "big, great", a cousin of English *great*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Größe*
- *Say it: die Größe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Größe*

- *Recall:* say the German for a suit, then the German for a purse, then say *die Größe* again

Before you move on

What does die Größe mean? (“A size”.) Say it once more.

203.3 der Stoff — material, fabric

Before the new one: say the German for a purse, then the German for a size.

You’ll want to know: der Stoff

der Stoff — “material, fabric”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Stoff came in from Old French *estoffe*, “material”; EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *stuff*, the same French word.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Stoff*
- *Say it: der Stoff*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Stoff*
- *Recall:* say the German for a purse, then the German for a size, then say *der Stoff* again

Before you move on

What does der Stoff mean? (“Material, fabric”.) Say it once more.

203.4 die Wolle — wool

Before the new one: say the German for a size, then the German for material.

You'll want to know: die Wolle

die Wolle — "wool".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wolle ← Old High German *wolla* — inherited, the same word as English *wool*. EtymDB 2.1 has the German word but not its source.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Wolle*
- *Say it: die Wolle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Wolle*
- *Recall:* say the German for a size, then the German for material, then say *die Wolle* again

Before you move on

What does die Wolle mean? ("Wool".) Say it once more.

203.5 die Seide — silk

Before the new one: say the German for material, then the German for wool.

You'll want to know: die Seide

die Seide — "silk".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Seide ← Middle High German *sīde* ← Old High German *sīda*, “silk” (EtymDB 2.1), from Medieval Latin *sēta*, “bristle, silk” — borrowed.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *die Seide*
- *Say it:* *die Seide*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Seide*
- *Recall:* say the German for material, then the German for wool, then say *die Seide* again

Before you move on

What does die Seide mean? (“Silk”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 204

Leather, Wood, Metal, Plastic, The body

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say leather, wood, metal, plastic and the body.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 204: I can say leather, wood, metal, plastic and the body.

204.1 das Leder — leather

Before the new one: say the German for wool, then the German for silk.

You'll want to know: das Leder

das Leder — "leather".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Leder ← Old High German *ledar* ← Proto-Germanic **leþrą* — inherited, the same word as English *leather*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Leder*
- *Say it: das Leder*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Leder*
- *Recall:* say the German for wool, then the German for silk, then say *das Leder* again

Before you move on

What does das Leder mean? ("Leather".) Say it once more.

204.2 das Holz — wood

Before the new one: say the German for silk, then the German for leather.

You'll want to know: das Holz

das Holz — "wood".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Holz ← Middle High German *holz* ← Old High German *holz*, "wood" — inherited, the same word as English *holt*, "a small wood". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Holz*
- *Say it: das Holz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Holz*
- *Recall:* say the German for silk, then the German for leather, then say *das Holz* again

Before you move on

What does das Holz mean? (“Wood”.) Say it once more.

204.3 das Metall — metal

Before the new one: say the German for leather, then the German for wood.

You’ll want to know: das Metall

das Metall — “metal”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Metall ← Latin *metallum* ← Greek *métallon*, “mine, metal” — borrowed, like English *metal*. EtymDB 2.1 has the German word but not its source.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Metall*
- *Say it: das Metall*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Metall*
- *Recall:* say the German for leather, then the German for wood, then say *das Metall* again

Before you move on

What does das Metall mean? (“Metal”.) Say it once more.

204.4 der Kunststoff — plastic

Before the new one: say the German for wood, then the German for metal.

You'll want to know: der Kunststoff

der Kunststoff — "plastic".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kunststoff is the word for "art, skill" + *Stoff*, "material": material made by skill, not found in nature. *Kunst* is built on *können*, "to be able", inherited from Proto-Germanic **kunnanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Kunststoff*
- *Say it: der Kunststoff*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Kunststoff*
- *Recall:* say the German for wood, then the German for metal, then say *der Kunststoff* again

Before you move on

What does der Kunststoff mean? ("Plastic".) Say it once more.

204.5 der Körper — the body

Before the new one: say the German for metal, then the German for plastic.

You'll want to know: der Körper

der Körper — "the body".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Körper ← Middle High German *korper*, from Latin *corpus*, "body" (EtymDB 2.1 has the Latin word) — borrowed. English *corpse* and *corps* share it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Körper*
- *Say it: der Körper*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Körper*
- *Recall:* say the German for metal, then the German for plastic, then say *der Körper* again

Before you move on

What does der Körper mean? ("The body".) Say it once more.

Chapter 205

A bone, A dentist, Surgery hours, An examination, An injury

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a bone, a dentist, surgery hours, an examination and an injury.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 205: I can say a bone, a dentist, surgery hours, an examination and an injury.

205.1 der Knochen — a bone

Before the new one: say the German for plastic, then the German for the body.

You'll want to know: der Knochen

der Knochen — "a bone".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Knochen ← Middle High German *knoche*, "bone, knot" ← Old High German *knohha* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited. English *knuckle* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Knochen*
- *Say it: der Knochen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Knochen*
- *Recall:* say the German for plastic, then the German for the body, then say *der Knochen* again

Before you move on

What does der Knochen mean? ("A bone".) Say it once more.

205.2 der Zahnarzt — a dentist

Before the new one: say the German for the body, then the German for a bone.

You'll want to know: der Zahnarzt

der Zahnarzt — "a dentist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Zahnarzt is *Zahn*, "tooth", + *Arzt*, "doctor" (EtymDB 2.1). *Arzt* goes back to Late Latin *archiāter*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Zahnarzt*
- *Say it: der Zahnarzt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Zahnarzt*
- *Recall:* say the German for the body, then the German for a bone, then say *der Zahnarzt* again

Before you move on

What does der Zahnarzt mean? (“A dentist”.) Say it once more.

205.3 die Sprechstunde — surgery hours, office hours

Before the new one: say the German for a bone, then the German for a dentist.

You’ll want to know: die Sprechstunde

die Sprechstunde — “surgery hours, office hours”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Sprechstunde is the verb “to speak”, Old High German *sprehhan*, English *speak*, + *Stunde*, “hour” (EtymDB 2.1): the hour when you can speak to the doctor.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Sprechstunde*
- *Say it: die Sprechstunde*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Sprechstunde*
- *Recall:* say the German for a bone, then the German for a dentist, then say *die Sprechstunde* again

Before you move on

What does die Sprechstunde mean? (“Surgery hours, office hours”.) Say it once more.

205.4 die Untersuchung — an examination

Before the new one: say the German for a dentist, then the German for surgery hours.

You'll want to know: die Untersuchung

die Untersuchung — "an examination".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Untersuchung is the noun of a verb built from the word for "under" + *suchen*, "to seek" (EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside Dutch *onderzoeken*): a search beneath the surface.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Untersuchung*
- *Say it: die Untersuchung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Untersuchung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a dentist, then the German for surgery hours, then say *die Untersuchung* again

Before you move on

What does die Untersuchung mean? ("An examination".) Say it once more.

205.5 die Verletzung — an injury

Before the new one: say the German for surgery hours, then the German for an examination.

You'll want to know: die Verletzung

die Verletzung — "an injury".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Verletzung is *verletzen*, "to injure" ← Middle High German *verletzen* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-ung*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Verletzung*
- *Say it: die Verletzung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Verletzung*
- *Recall:* say the German for surgery hours, then the German for an examination, then say *die Verletzung* again

Before you move on

What does die Verletzung mean? ("An injury".) Say it once more.

205.6 Words from chapters 201-202 — a first pass

Say the words for an examination and an injury.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a tin, a pot, a frying pan, an oven, a dishwasher
- a vacuum cleaner, an iron, shampoo, a brush, a suit

Before you move on

A tin? (**die Dose**.) A pot? (**der Topf**.) A frying pan? (**die Pfanne**.) An oven? (**der Ofen**.) A dishwasher? (**die Spülmaschine**.) A vacuum cleaner? (**der Staubsauger**.) An iron? (**das Bügeleisen**.) Shampoo? (**das Shampoo**.) A brush?

(**die Bürste**.) A suit? (**der Anzug**.)

205.7 Words from chapters 203-205 — a second pass

Say the words for a purse and a size.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a purse, a size, material, wool, silk
- leather, wood, metal, plastic, the body
- a bone, a dentist, surgery hours, an examination, an injury

Before you move on

A purse? (**das Portemonnaie**.) A size? (**die Größe**.) Material? (**der Stoff**.) Wool? (**die Wolle**.) Silk? (**die Seide**.) Leather? (**das Leder**.) Wood? (**das Holz**.) Metal? (**das Metall**.) Plastic? (**der Kunststoff**.) The body? (**der Körper**.) A bone? (**der Knochen**.) A dentist? (**der Zahnarzt**.) Surgery hours? (**die Sprechstunde**.) An examination? (**die Untersuchung**.) An injury? (**die Verletzung**.)

Chapter 206

A wound, A plaster, An ointment, An injection, An emergency

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a wound, a plaster, an ointment, an injection and an emergency.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 206: I can say a wound, a plaster, an ointment, an injection and an emergency.

206.1 die Wunde — a wound

Before the new one: say the German for an examination, then the German for an injury.

You'll want to know: die Wunde

die Wunde — "a wound".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wunde ← Middle High German *wunde* ← Old High German *wunta* — inherited, the same word as English *wound*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Wunde*
- *Say it: die Wunde*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Wunde*
- *Recall:* say the German for an examination, then the German for an injury, then say *die Wunde* again

Before you move on

What does die Wunde mean? ("A wound".) Say it once more.

206.2 das Pflaster — a plaster

Before the new one: say the German for an injury, then the German for a wound.

You'll want to know: das Pflaster

das Pflaster — "a plaster".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Pflaster ← Old High German *pflastar* ← Latin *emplastrum*, "a salve spread on" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *plaster*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Pflaster*
- *Say it: das Pflaster*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Pflaster*
- *Recall:* say the German for an injury, then the German for a wound, then say *das Pflaster* again

Before you move on

What does das Pflaster mean? ("A plaster".) Say it once more.

206.3 die Salbe — an ointment

Before the new one: say the German for a wound, then the German for a plaster.

You'll want to know: die Salbe

die Salbe — "an ointment".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Salbe ← Middle High German *salbe* ← Old High German *salba* — inherited, the same word as English *salve*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Salbe*
- *Say it: die Salbe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Salbe*
- *Recall:* say the German for a wound, then the German for a plaster, then say *die Salbe* again

Before you move on

What does die Salbe mean? ("An ointment".) Say it once more.

206.4 die Spritze — an injection

Before the new one: say the German for a plaster, then the German for an ointment.

You'll want to know: die Spritze

die Spritze — "an injection".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Spritze comes from the verb "to squirt, to spray" (EtymDB 2.1), shaped to sound like a spurt of liquid.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Spritze*
- *Say it: die Spritze*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Spritze*
- *Recall:* say the German for a plaster, then the German for an ointment, then say *die Spritze* again

Before you move on

What does die Spritze mean? ("An injection".) Say it once more.

206.5 der Notfall — an emergency

Before the new one: say the German for an ointment, then the German for an injection.

You'll want to know: der Notfall

der Notfall — "an emergency".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Notfall is the word for "need, distress", Middle High German *nōt*, a cousin of English *need* (EtymDB 2.1), + the word for "case, fall": a case of distress.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Notfall*
- *Say it: der Notfall*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Notfall*
- *Recall:* say the German for an ointment, then the German for an injection, then say *der Notfall* again

Before you move on

What does der Notfall mean? ("An emergency".) Say it once more.

Chapter 207

An ambulance, The fire brigade, A thief, A theft, A court

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an ambulance, the fire brigade, a thief, a theft and a court.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 207: I can say an ambulance, the fire brigade, a thief, a theft and a court.*

207.1 der Krankenwagen — an ambulance

> Before the new one: say the German for an injection, then the German for an emergency.

You'll want to know: der Krankenwagen

der Krankenwagen — "an ambulance".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Krankenwagen ← *krank* + *-n-* + the word for "vehicle", Middle High German *wagen* ← Proto-Germanic **wagnaz*, English *wagon* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Krankenwagen*
- *Say it: der Krankenwagen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Krankenwagen*
- *Recall:* say the German for an injection, then the German for an emergency, then say *der Krankenwagen* again

Before you move on

What does der Krankenwagen mean? ("An ambulance".) Say it once more.

207.2 die Feuerwehr — the fire brigade

Before the new one: say the German for an emergency, then the German for an ambulance.

You'll want to know: die Feuerwehr

die Feuerwehr — "the fire brigade".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Feuerwehr is *Feuer*, "fire", + the word for "defence", Old High German *werī* ← Proto-Germanic **warīniz* (EtymDB 2.1): the defence against fire. English *weir* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Feuerwehr*
- *Say it: die Feuerwehr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Feuerwehr*

- *Recall:* say the German for an emergency, then the German for an ambulance, then say *die Feuerwehr* again

Before you move on

What does die Feuerwehr mean? ("The fire brigade".) Say it once more.

207.3 der Dieb — a thief

Before the new one: say the German for an ambulance, then the German for the fire brigade.

You'll want to know: der Dieb

der Dieb — "a thief".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Dieb ← Middle High German *diep* ← Old High German *diob* — inherited, the same word as English *thief* and Gothic *þiufs*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Dieb*
- *Say it: der Dieb*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Dieb*
- *Recall:* say the German for an ambulance, then the German for the fire brigade, then say *der Dieb* again

Before you move on

What does der Dieb mean? ("A thief".) Say it once more.

207.4 der Diebstahl — a theft

Before the new one: say the German for the fire brigade, then the German for a thief.

You'll want to know: der Diebstahl

der Diebstahl — "a theft".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Diebstahl is *Dieb*, "thief", + an old noun from *stehlen*, "to steal": a thief's stealing. *Dieb* ← Proto-Germanic **þeubaz* (EtymDB 2.1), the same word as English *thief*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Diebstahl*
- *Say it: der Diebstahl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Diebstahl*
- *Recall:* say the German for the fire brigade, then the German for a thief, then say *der Diebstahl* again

Before you move on

What does der Diebstahl mean? ("A theft".) Say it once more.

207.5 das Gericht — a court, a dish

Before the new one: say the German for a thief, then the German for a theft.

You'll want to know: das Gericht

das Gericht — "a court, a dish".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gericht is *ge-* + the verb "to set right, to make ready", Old High German *rihten* (EtymDB 2.1): a court sets things right; a dish is something made ready.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Gericht*
- *Say it: das Gericht*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Gericht*
- *Recall:* say the German for a thief, then the German for a theft, then say *das Gericht* again

Before you move on

What does das Gericht mean? ("A court, a dish".) Say it once more.

Chapter 208

A law, A punishment, The government, A state, The population

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a law, a punishment, the government, a state and the population.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 208: I can say a law, a punishment, the government, a state and the population.

208.1 das Gesetz — a law

Before the new one: say the German for a theft, then the German for a court.

You'll want to know: das Gesetz

das Gesetz — "a law".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gesetz is *ge-* + the verb "to set", Old High German *sezzen*, English *set* (EtymDB 2.1): a law is what has been set down.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Gesetz*
- *Say it: das Gesetz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Gesetz*
- *Recall:* say the German for a theft, then the German for a court, then say *das Gesetz* again

Before you move on

What does das Gesetz mean? ("A law".) Say it once more.

208.2 die Strafe — a punishment, a fine

Before the new one: say the German for a court, then the German for a law.

You'll want to know: die Strafe

die Strafe — "a punishment, a fine".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Strafe ← Middle High German *strāfe*, "rebuke, punishment" (EtymDB 2.1). Its earlier origin is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Strafe*
- *Say it: die Strafe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Strafe*
- *Recall:* say the German for a court, then the German for a law, then say *die Strafe* again

Before you move on

What does die Strafe mean? (“A punishment, a fine”.) Say it once more.

208.3 die Regierung — the government

Before the new one: say the German for a law, then the German for a punishment.

You’ll want to know: die Regierung

die Regierung — “the government”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Regierung is the verb “to govern”, Middle High German *regieren* (EtymDB 2.1), from Old French *reger* ← Latin *regere*, “to rule”, + *-ung*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Regierung*
- *Say it: die Regierung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Regierung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a law, then the German for a punishment, then say *die Regierung* again

Before you move on

What does die Regierung mean? (“The government”.) Say it once more.

208.4 der Staat — a state

Before the new one: say the German for a punishment, then the German for the government.

You'll want to know: der Staat

der Staat — "a state".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Staat ← Middle Low German *stāt* ← Middle Dutch *staet*, "state, country" (EtymDB 2.1), from Latin *status*, "condition, standing" — borrowed, like English *state*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Staat*
- *Say it: der Staat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Staat*
- *Recall:* say the German for a punishment, then the German for the government, then say *der Staat* again

Before you move on

What does der Staat mean? ("A state".) Say it once more.

208.5 die Bevölkerung — the population

Before the new one: say the German for the government, then the German for a state.

You'll want to know: die Bevölkerung

die Bevölkerung — "the population".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bevölkerung is *be-* + the word for "a people", Old High German *folc* ← Proto-Germanic **fulką*, English *folk* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-ung*: the people who fill a land.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Bevölkerung*
- *Say it: die Bevölkerung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Bevölkerung*
- *Recall:* say the German for the government, then the German for a state, then say *die Bevölkerung* again

Before you move on

What does die Bevölkerung mean? ("The population".) Say it once more.

Chapter 209

A citizen, An election, A party, Politics, The economy

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a citizen, an election, a party, politics and the economy.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 209: I can say a citizen, an election, a party, politics and the economy.

209.1 der Bürger — a citizen

Before the new one: say the German for a state, then the German for the population.

You'll want to know: der Bürger

der Bürger — "a citizen".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bürger ← Middle High German *burgære*: *Burg* + *-er* — the one who lives in the walled town. English *burgher* and *borough* are cousins.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Bürger*
- *Say it: der Bürger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Bürger*
- *Recall:* say the German for a state, then the German for the population, then say *der Bürger* again

Before you move on

What does der Bürger mean? ("A citizen".) Say it once more.

209.2 die Wahl — an election, a choice

Before the new one: say the German for the population, then the German for a citizen.

You'll want to know: die Wahl

die Wahl — "an election, a choice".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wahl ← Old High German *wala*, "choice" ← Proto-Germanic **walō* — inherited, the noun beside *wählen*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Wahl*
- *Say it: die Wahl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Wahl*
- *Recall:* say the German for the population, then the German for a citizen, then say *die Wahl* again

Before you move on

What does die Wahl mean? (“An election, a choice”.) Say it once more.

209.3 die Partei — a party (political)

Before the new one: say the German for a citizen, then the German for an election.

You’ll want to know: die Partei

die Partei — “a party (political)”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Partei ← Middle High German *partīe*, from French *partie*, “a part, a side” (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *party*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Partei*
- *Say it: die Partei*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Partei*
- *Recall:* say the German for a citizen, then the German for an election, then say *die Partei* again

Before you move on

What does die Partei mean? (“A party (political)”.) Say it once more.

209.4 die Politik — politics

Before the new one: say the German for an election, then the German for a party.

You'll want to know: die Politik

die Politik — "politics".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Politik ← French *politique* ← Latin *politicus* (EtymDB 2.1), from Greek *politikós*, "of the city" — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Politik*
- *Say it: die Politik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Politik*
- *Recall:* say the German for an election, then the German for a party, then say *die Politik* again

Before you move on

What does die Politik mean? ("Politics".) Say it once more.

209.5 die Wirtschaft — the economy

Before the new one: say the German for a party, then the German for politics.

You'll want to know: die Wirtschaft

die Wirtschaft — "the economy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wirtschaft is the word for "host, landlord", Old High German *wirt* ← Proto-Germanic **werduz*, + *-schaft* (EtymDB 2.1): first running a household or an inn, then the whole economy.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Wirtschaft*
- *Say it: die Wirtschaft*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Wirtschaft*
- *Recall:* say the German for a party, then the German for politics, then say *die Wirtschaft* again

Before you move on

What does die Wirtschaft mean? ("The economy".) Say it once more.

Chapter 210

Industry, A workshop, A shop, A butcher's, A department store

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say industry, a workshop, a shop, a butcher's and a department store.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 210: I can say industry, a workshop, a shop, a butcher's and a department store.

210.1 die Industrie — industry

Before the new one: say the German for politics, then the German for the economy.

You'll want to know: die Industrie

die Industrie — "industry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Industrie ← French *industrie* ← Latin *industria*, "diligence, activity" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *industry*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Industrie*
- *Say it: die Industrie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Industrie*
- *Recall:* say the German for politics, then the German for the economy, then say *die Industrie* again

Before you move on

What does die Industrie mean? ("Industry".) Say it once more.

210.2 die Werkstatt — a workshop, a garage

Before the new one: say the German for the economy, then the German for industry.

You'll want to know: die Werkstatt

die Werkstatt — "a workshop, a garage".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Werkstatt is the word for "work", Old High German *werc* ← Proto-Germanic **werką*, English *work* (EtymDB 2.1), + an old word for "place", English *stead*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Werkstatt*
- *Say it: die Werkstatt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Werkstatt*
- *Recall:* say the German for the economy, then the German for industry, then say *die Werkstatt* again

Before you move on

What does die Werkstatt mean? (“A workshop, a garage”.) Say it once more.

210.3 das Geschäft — a shop, a business

Before the new one: say the German for industry, then the German for a workshop.

You’ll want to know: das Geschäft

das Geschäft — “a shop, a business”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Geschäft ← Middle High German *gescheft* ← Old High German *giscaft*, “creation, affair” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, from the verb “to make, to create”, English *shape*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Geschäft*
- *Say it: das Geschäft*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Geschäft*
- *Recall:* say the German for industry, then the German for a workshop, then say *das Geschäft* again

Before you move on

What does das Geschäft mean? (“A shop, a business”.) Say it once more.

210.4 die Metzgerei — a butcher's

Before the new one: say the German for a workshop, then the German for a shop.

You'll want to know: die Metzgerei

die Metzgerei — "a butcher's".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Metzgerei is the southern word for "butcher", Middle High German *metziger* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-ei*, the ending for a trade's workplace. Where *metziger* came from is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Metzgerei*
- *Say it: die Metzgerei*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Metzgerei*
- *Recall:* say the German for a workshop, then the German for a shop, then say *die Metzgerei* again

Before you move on

What does die Metzgerei mean? ("A butcher's".) Say it once more.

210.5 das Kaufhaus — a department store

Before the new one: say the German for a shop, then the German for a butcher's.

You'll want to know: das Kaufhaus

das Kaufhaus — "a department store".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kaufhaus is the stem of *kaufen*, "to buy", + *Haus*, "house" (EtymDB 2.1): a house for buying.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Kaufhaus*
- *Say it: das Kaufhaus*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Kaufhaus*
- *Recall:* say the German for a shop, then the German for a butcher's, then say *das Kaufhaus* again

Before you move on

What does das Kaufhaus mean? ("A department store".) Say it once more.

210.6 Words from chapters 206-207 — a first pass

Say the words for a butcher's and a department store.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a wound, a plaster, an ointment, an injection, an emergency
- an ambulance, the fire brigade, a thief, a theft, a court

Before you move on

A wound? (**die Wunde**.) A plaster? (**das Pflaster**.) An ointment? (**die Salbe**.) An injection? (**die Spritze**.) An emergency? (**der Notfall**.) An ambulance? (**der Krankenwagen**.) The fire

brigade? (**die Feuerwehr**.) A thief? (**der Dieb**.) A theft? (**der Diebstahl**.) A court? (**das Gericht**.)

210.7 Words from chapters 208-210 — a second pass

Say the words for a law and a punishment.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a law, a punishment, the government, a state, the population
- a citizen, an election, a party, politics, the economy
- industry, a workshop, a shop, a butcher's, a department store

Before you move on

A law? (**das Gesetz**.) A punishment? (**die Strafe**.) The government? (**die Regierung**.) A state? (**der Staat**.) The population? (**die Bevölkerung**.) A citizen? (**der Bürger**.) An election? (**die Wahl**.) A party? (**die Partei**.) Politics? (**die Politik**.) The economy? (**die Wirtschaft**.) Industry? (**die Industrie**.) A workshop? (**die Werkstatt**.) A shop? (**das Geschäft**.) A butcher's? (**die Metzgerei**.) A department store? (**das Kaufhaus**.)

Chapter 211

Anxious, Tiring, Excited, Excellent, Working

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say anxious, tiring, excited, excellent and working.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 211: I can say anxious, tiring, excited, excellent and working.

211.1 ängstlich — anxious, timid

Before the new one: say the German for a butcher's, then the German for a department store.

You'll want to know: ängstlich

ängstlich — "anxious, timid".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ängstlich is *Angst*, "fear", + *-lich*: fearful. *Angst* ← Proto-Germanic **angustiz*, from a word for "narrow". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ängstlich*
- *Say it: ängstlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ängstlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for a butcher's, then the German for a department store, then say *ängstlich* again

Before you move on

What does ängstlich mean? ("Anxious, timid".) Say it once more.

211.2 anstrengend — tiring, demanding

Before the new one: say the German for a department store, then the German for anxious.

You'll want to know: anstrengend

anstrengend — "tiring, demanding".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

anstrengend is the present participle of the verb "to strain", built on the word for "tight, strict", Old High German *strengi*, which EtymDB 2.1 lists beside English *strong*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: anstrengend*
- *Say it: anstrengend*, once more
- *Say it:* say *anstrengend*
- *Recall:* say the German for a department store, then the German for anxious, then say *anstrengend* again

Before you move on

What does anstrengend mean? ("Tiring, demanding".) Say it once more.

211.3 aufgeregt — excited, nervous

Before the new one: say the German for anxious, then the German for tiring.

You'll want to know: aufgeregt

aufgeregt — "excited, nervous".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aufgeregt is the past participle of *auf* + an old verb meaning "to stir, to move": stirred up. *Auf* ← Proto-Germanic **upp* (EtymDB 2.1), the same word as English *up*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *aufgeregt*
- *Say it:* *aufgeregt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aufgeregt*
- *Recall:* say the German for anxious, then the German for tiring, then say *aufgeregt* again

Before you move on

What does aufgeregt mean? ("Excited, nervous".) Say it once more.

211.4 ausgezeichnet — excellent

Before the new one: say the German for tiring, then the German for excited.

You'll want to know: ausgezeichnet

ausgezeichnet — "excellent".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ausgezeichnet is the past participle of *aus-* + *zeichnen*, "to mark": marked out from the rest. *zeichnen* is built on the word for "sign", English *token*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ausgezeichnet*
- *Say it: ausgezeichnet*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ausgezeichnet*
- *Recall:* say the German for tiring, then the German for excited, then say *ausgezeichnet* again

Before you move on

What does ausgezeichnet mean? ("Excellent".) Say it once more.

211.5 berufstätig — working, employed

Before the new one: say the German for excited, then the German for excellent.

You'll want to know: berufstätig

berufstätig — "working, employed".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

berufstätig is *Beruf*, "profession", + *-s-* + the word for "active", built on the word for "a deed", Old High German *tāt*, English *deed* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: berufstätig*
- *Say it: berufstätig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *berufstätig*
- *Recall:* say the German for excited, then the German for excellent, then say *berufstätig* again

Before you move on

What does berufstätig mean? ("Working, employed".) Say it once more.

Chapter 212

Cloudy, Blond, Honest, Urgent, Lonely

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say cloudy, blond, honest, urgent and lonely.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 212: I can say cloudy, blond, honest, urgent and lonely.*

212.1 bewölkt — cloudy

> Before the new one: say the German for excellent, then the German for working.

You'll want to know: bewölkt

bewölkt — "cloudy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bewölkt is *be-* + *Wolke*, "cloud", as a participle: covered with cloud. *Wolke* ← Proto-Germanic **wulkaną*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bewölkt*
- *Say it: bewölkt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bewölkt*
- *Recall:* say the German for excellent, then the German for working, then say *bewölkt* again

Before you move on

What does bewölkt mean? ("Cloudy".) Say it once more.

212.2 blond — blond

Before the new one: say the German for working, then the German for cloudy.

You'll want to know: blond

blond — "blond".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

blond ← French *blond*, probably from a Germanic word — borrowed, like English *blond*. EtymDB 2.1 has the German word but not its source.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: blond*
- *Say it: blond*, once more
- *Say it:* say *blond*
- *Recall:* say the German for working, then the German for cloudy, then say *blond* again

Before you move on

What does blond mean? ("Blond".) Say it once more.

212.3 ehrlich — honest

Before the new one: say the German for cloudy, then the German for blond.

You'll want to know: ehrlich

ehrlich — "honest".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ehrlich is the word for "honour", Old High German *ēra* ← Proto-Germanic **aizō*, "respect" (EtymDB 2.1), + *-lich*: honourable, then honest.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ehrlich*
- *Say it: ehrlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ehrlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for cloudy, then the German for blond, then say *ehrlich* again

Before you move on

What does ehrlich mean? ("Honest".) Say it once more.

212.4 eilig — urgent, in a hurry

Before the new one: say the German for blond, then the German for honest.

You'll want to know: eilig

eilig — "urgent, in a hurry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

eilig is the word for "haste", Old High German *īla* ← Proto-Germanic **īlō* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-ig*: in haste.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: eilig*
- *Say it: eilig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eilig*
- *Recall:* say the German for blond, then the German for honest, then say *eilig* again

Before you move on

What does eilig mean? ("Urgent, in a hurry".) Say it once more.

212.5 einsam — lonely

Before the new one: say the German for honest, then the German for urgent.

You'll want to know: einsam

einsam — "lonely".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

einsam is *ein*, "one", + *-sam*, the same ending as in English *lonesome*: being on one's own. *ein* ← Proto-Germanic **ainaz*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *einsam*
- *Say it:* *einsam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *einsam*
- *Recall:* say the German for honest, then the German for urgent, then say *einsam* again

Before you move on

What does einsam mean? ("Lonely".) Say it once more.

Chapter 213

Jealous, Successful, Having a cold, Fantastic, Damp

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say jealous, successful, having a cold, fantastic and damp.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 213: I can say jealous, successful, having a cold, fantastic and damp.

213.1 eifersüchtig — jealous

Before the new one: say the German for urgent, then the German for lonely.

You'll want to know: eifersüchtig

eifersüchtig — "jealous".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

eifersüchtig is the word for "zeal" + the word for "sickness, craving", Old High German *suht* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-ig*: sick with zeal, jealous. English *sick* is a cousin of that word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: eifersüchtig*
- *Say it: eifersüchtig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eifersüchtig*
- *Recall:* say the German for urgent, then the German for lonely, then say *eifersüchtig* again

Before you move on

What does eifersüchtig mean? ("Jealous".) Say it once more.

213.2 erfolgreich — successful

Before the new one: say the German for lonely, then the German for jealous.

You'll want to know: erfolgreich

erfolgreich — "successful".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

erfolgreich is the word for "success", from a verb "to follow, to result", + *reich*, "rich" (EtymDB 2.1): rich in success. The "follow" verb is the same as English *follow*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: erfolgreich*
- *Say it: erfolgreich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *erfolgreich*
- *Recall:* say the German for lonely, then the German for jealous, then say *erfolgreich* again

Before you move on

What does erfolgreich mean? ("Successful".) Say it once more.

213.3 erkältet — having a cold

Before the new one: say the German for jealous, then the German for successful.

You'll want to know: erkältet

erkältet — "having a cold".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

erkältet is the past participle beside *Erkältung*: *er-* + the word for "cold", English *cold*: chilled. (EtymDB 2.1 has Middle High German *erkelten*.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: erkältet*
- *Say it: erkältet*, once more
- *Say it:* say *erkältet*
- *Recall:* say the German for jealous, then the German for successful, then say *erkältet* again

Before you move on

What does erkältet mean? ("Having a cold".) Say it once more.

213.4 fantastisch — fantastic

Before the new one: say the German for successful, then the German for having a cold.

You'll want to know: fantastisch

fantastisch — "fantastic".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fantastisch ← Latin *phantasticus* ← Greek *phantastikós*, "able to imagine, imaginary" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fantastisch*
- *Say it: fantastisch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fantastisch*
- *Recall:* say the German for successful, then the German for having a cold, then say *fantastisch* again

Before you move on

What does fantastisch mean? ("Fantastic".) Say it once more.

213.5 feucht — damp

Before the new one: say the German for having a cold, then the German for fantastic.

You'll want to know: feucht

feucht — "damp".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

feucht ← Old High German *fūht* ← Proto-Germanic **funhtijaz*, "humid, damp" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: feucht*
- *Say it: feucht*, once more
- *Say it:* say *feucht*
- *Recall:* say the German for having a cold, then the German for fantastic, then say *feucht* again

Before you move on

What does feucht mean? ("Damp".) Say it once more.

Chapter 214

Cheerful, Terrible, Patient, Stingy, Cosy

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say cheerful, terrible, patient, stingy and cosy.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 214: I can say cheerful, terrible, patient, stingy and cosy.

214.1 fröhlich — cheerful

Before the new one: say the German for fantastic, then the German for damp.

You'll want to know: fröhlich

fröhlich — "cheerful".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fröhlich is the word for "glad", Middle High German *vrō* ← Old High German *frō* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-lich*: merry. English *frolic* came from the Dutch cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fröhlich*
- *Say it: fröhlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fröhlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for fantastic, then the German for damp, then say *fröhlich* again

Before you move on

What does fröhlich mean? ("Cheerful".) Say it once more.

214.2 furchtbar — terrible

Before the new one: say the German for damp, then the German for cheerful.

You'll want to know: furchtbar

furchtbar — "terrible".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

furchtbar is the word for "fear", Middle High German *vorht* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-bar*: causing fear. English *fright* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: furchtbar*
- *Say it: furchtbar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *furchtbar*
- *Recall:* say the German for damp, then the German for cheerful, then say *furchtbar* again

Before you move on

What does furchtbar mean? ("Terrible".) Say it once more.

214.3 geduldig — patient

Before the new one: say the German for cheerful, then the German for terrible.

You'll want to know: geduldig

geduldig — "patient".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

geduldig ← Middle High German *gedultic* (EtymDB 2.1): the word for "patience", from a verb "to endure", + *-ig*. EtymDB lists Old English *geþyldig*, "patient", beside it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: geduldig*
- *Say it: geduldig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *geduldig*
- *Recall:* say the German for cheerful, then the German for terrible, then say *geduldig* again

Before you move on

What does geduldig mean? ("Patient".) Say it once more.

214.4 geizig — stingy

Before the new one: say the German for terrible, then the German for patient.

You'll want to know: geizig

geizig — "stingy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

geizig is the word for "avarice" + *-ig*. It goes back to Middle High German *gītesen*, "to be greedy" (EtymDB 2.1), and EtymDB lists Old English *ġītsian*, "to covet", beside it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: geizig*
- *Say it: geizig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *geizig*
- *Recall:* say the German for terrible, then the German for patient, then say *geizig* again

Before you move on

What does geizig mean? ("Stingy".) Say it once more.

214.5 gemütlich — cosy

Before the new one: say the German for patient, then the German for stingy.

You'll want to know: gemütlich

gemütlich — "cosy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gemütlich ← Middle High German *gemüetlich*: the word for "mind, heart", Old High German *gimuati*, + *-lich* (EtymDB 2.1). Cosy is what suits your mood; English *mood* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gemütlich*
- *Say it: gemütlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gemütlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for patient, then the German for stingy, then say *gemütlich* again

Before you move on

What does gemütlich mean? ("Cosy".) Say it once more.

Chapter 215

Fair, Divorced, At the same time, Generous, Good value

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say fair, divorced, at the same time, generous and good value.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 215: I can say fair, divorced, at the same time, generous and good value.

215.1 gerecht — fair, even-handed

Before the new one: say the German for stingy, then the German for cosy.

You'll want to know: gerecht

gerecht — "fair, even-handed".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gerecht ← Middle High German *gereht* ← Old High German *gireht* — inherited, built on the word for "right", Proto-Germanic **rehtaz*, English *right*. EtymDB 2.1 lists Gothic *garaihts*, "righteous", beside it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gerecht*
- *Say it: gerecht*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gerecht*
- *Recall:* say the German for stingy, then the German for cosy, then say *gerecht* again

Before you move on

What does gerecht mean? (“Fair, even-handed”.) Say it once more.

215.2 geschieden — divorced

Before the new one: say the German for cosy, then the German for fair.

You’ll want to know: geschieden

geschieden — “divorced”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

geschieden is the past participle of the verb “to separate, to part”, Old High German *sceidan* ← Proto-Germanic **skaiþaną* (EtymDB 2.1): separated.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: geschieden*
- *Say it: geschieden*, once more
- *Say it:* say *geschieden*
- *Recall:* say the German for cosy, then the German for fair, then say *geschieden* again

Before you move on

What does geschieden mean? ("Divorced".) Say it once more.

215.3 gleichzeitig — at the same time

Before the new one: say the German for fair, then the German for divorced.

You'll want to know: gleichzeitig

gleichzeitig — "at the same time".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gleichzeitig is *gleich*, "same", + *Zeit*, "time", + *-ig*: at the same time. Both are inherited; *Zeit* ← Proto-Germanic **tīdiz*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gleichzeitig*
- *Say it: gleichzeitig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gleichzeitig*
- *Recall:* say the German for fair, then the German for divorced, then say *gleichzeitig* again

Before you move on

What does gleichzeitig mean? ("At the same time".) Say it once more.

215.4 großzügig — generous

Before the new one: say the German for divorced, then the German for at the same time.

You'll want to know: großzügig

großzügig — "generous".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

großzügig is the word for "great" + *Zug*, here "a trait", + *-ig*: of great traits, generous. The word for "great" ← Old High German *grōz* ← Proto-Germanic **grautaz*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: großzügig*
- *Say it: großzügig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *großzügig*
- *Recall:* say the German for divorced, then the German for at the same time, then say *großzügig* again

Before you move on

What does großzügig mean? ("Generous".) Say it once more.

215.5 günstig — good value, favourable

Before the new one: say the German for at the same time, then the German for generous.

You'll want to know: günstig

günstig — "good value, favourable".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

günstig is built on the word for "favour", Middle High German *gunst*, from the verb "to grant, not to begrudge" — inherited. Good value is a favourable price. EtymDB 2.1 has no source for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: günstig*
- *Say it: günstig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *günstig*
- *Recall:* say the German for at the same time, then the German for generous, then say *günstig* again

Before you move on

What does günstig mean? ("Good value, favourable".) Say it once more.

Chapter 216

Thorough, Frequent, Wonderful, Helpful, Intelligent

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say thorough, frequent, wonderful, helpful and intelligent.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 216: I can say thorough, frequent, wonderful, helpful and intelligent.

216.1 gründlich — thorough

Before the new one: say the German for generous, then the German for good value.

You'll want to know: gründlich

gründlich — "thorough".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gründlich is *Grund*, "ground, bottom", + *-lich*: going down to the bottom. *Grund* is the same word as English *ground*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gründlich*
- *Say it: gründlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gründlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for generous, then the German for good value, then say *gründlich* again

Before you move on

What does gründlich mean? ("Thorough".) Say it once more.

216.2 häufig — frequent

Before the new one: say the German for good value, then the German for thorough.

You'll want to know: häufig

häufig — "frequent".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

häufig is the word for "a heap" + *-ig*: coming in heaps, so frequent. The heap word is a cousin of English *heap*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: häufig*
- *Say it: häufig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *häufig*
- *Recall:* say the German for good value, then the German for thorough, then say *häufig* again

Before you move on

What does häufig mean? (“Frequent”.) Say it once more.

216.3 herrlich — wonderful

Before the new one: say the German for thorough, then the German for frequent.

You’ll want to know: herrlich

herrlich — “wonderful”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

herrlich ← Middle High German *hērlich* ← Old High German *hērlīh*, “noble, splendid” (EtymDB 2.1), from *hēr*, “venerable”, first “grey-haired”. English *hoar* is a cousin.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: herrlich*
- *Say it: herrlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *herrlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for thorough, then the German for frequent, then say *herrlich* again

Before you move on

What does herrlich mean? (“Wonderful”.) Say it once more.

216.4 hilfsbereit — helpful

Before the new one: say the German for frequent, then the German for wonderful.

You'll want to know: hilfsbereit

hilfsbereit — "helpful".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hilfsbereit is the word for "help", Old High German *helfa*, English *help*, + *-s-* + *bereit*, "ready" (EtymDB 2.1): ready to help.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hilfsbereit*
- *Say it: hilfsbereit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hilfsbereit*
- *Recall:* say the German for frequent, then the German for wonderful, then say *hilfsbereit* again

Before you move on

What does hilfsbereit mean? ("Helpful".) Say it once more.

216.5 intelligent — intelligent

Before the new one: say the German for wonderful, then the German for helpful.

You'll want to know: intelligent

intelligent — "intelligent".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

intelligent ← Latin *intelligēns*, "discerning, understanding" (EtymDB 2.1), from *intellegere*, "to choose between, to understand" — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: intelligent*
- *Say it: intelligent*, once more
- *Say it:* say *intelligent*
- *Recall:* say the German for wonderful, then the German for helpful, then say *intelligent* again

Before you move on

What does intelligent mean? ("Intelligent".) Say it once more.

Chapter 217

Broken, Clever, Free of charge, Strong, Single

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say broken, clever, free of charge, strong and single.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 217: I can say broken, clever, free of charge, strong and single.*

217.1 kaputt — broken

> Before the new one: say the German for helpful, then the German for intelligent.

You'll want to know: kaputt

kaputt — "broken".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

kaputt ← French *capot*, said of a card player who has won no trick (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: the loser was done for. English *kaput* came from German.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaputt*
- *Say it: kaputt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaputt*
- *Recall:* say the German for helpful, then the German for intelligent, then say *kaputt* again

Before you move on

What does kaputt mean? (“Broken”.) Say it once more.

217.2 klug — clever

Before the new one: say the German for intelligent, then the German for broken.

You’ll want to know: klug

klug — “clever”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

klug ← Middle High German *kluoc*, “clever, fine” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited; EtymDB lists Old Norse *klókr*, “clever”, beside it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: klug*
- *Say it: klug*, once more
- *Say it:* say *klug*
- *Recall:* say the German for intelligent, then the German for broken, then say *klug* again

Before you move on

What does klug mean? ("Clever".) Say it once more.

217.3 kostenlos — free of charge

Before the new one: say the German for broken, then the German for clever.

You'll want to know: kostenlos

kostenlos — "free of charge".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

kostenlos is the word for "costs", from *kosten*, + *-los*, "without", the same ending as English *-less*: without cost. EtymDB 2.1 lists English *costless* beside it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kostenlos*
- *Say it: kostenlos*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kostenlos*
- *Recall:* say the German for broken, then the German for clever, then say *kostenlos* again

Before you move on

What does kostenlos mean? ("Free of charge".) Say it once more.

217.4 kräftig — strong, hearty

Before the new one: say the German for clever, then the German for free of charge.

You'll want to know: kräftig

kräftig — "strong, hearty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

kräftig is the word for "strength", Old High German *kraft* ← Proto-Germanic **kraftaz* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-ig*. English *craft*, first "strength, skill", is the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kräftig*
- *Say it: kräftig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kräftig*
- *Recall:* say the German for clever, then the German for free of charge, then say *kräftig* again

Before you move on

What does kräftig mean? ("Strong, hearty".) Say it once more.

217.5 ledig — single (unmarried)

Before the new one: say the German for free of charge, then the German for strong.

You'll want to know: ledig

ledig — "single (unmarried)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ledig ← Old High German *lidig*, "free" ← Proto-Germanic **liþugaz*, "flexible, free, unoccupied" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) Single is free of ties.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ledig*
- *Say it:* *ledig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ledig*
- *Recall:* say the German for free of charge, then the German for strong, then say *ledig* again

Before you move on

What does ledig mean? ("Single (unmarried)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 218

Tasty, Kind, Relaxed, Thin, Brave

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say tasty, kind, relaxed, thin and brave.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 218: I can say tasty, kind, relaxed, thin and brave.*

218.1 lecker — tasty

Before the new one: say the German for strong, then the German for single.

You'll want to know: lecker

lecker — "tasty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lecker ← Middle High German *lecker* (EtymDB 2.1), from the verb "to lick", Old High German *lecchōn*, English *lick*: food worth licking your lips for.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lecker*
- *Say it: lecker*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lecker*
- *Recall:* say the German for strong, then the German for single, then say *lecker* again

Before you move on

What does lecker mean? ("Tasty".) Say it once more.

218.2 lieb — kind, dear

Before the new one: say the German for single, then the German for tasty.

You'll want to know: lieb

lieb — "kind, dear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lieb ← Middle High German *liep* ← Old High German *liob* ← Proto-Germanic **leubaz*, "dear" — inherited, the same word as English *lief*. (EtymDB 2.1) English *love* shares the root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lieb*
- *Say it: lieb*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lieb*
- *Recall:* say the German for single, then the German for tasty, then say *lieb* again

Before you move on

What does lieb mean? (“Kind, dear”.) Say it once more.

218.3 locker — relaxed, loose

Before the new one: say the German for tasty, then the German for kind.

You’ll want to know: locker

locker — “relaxed, loose”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

locker, “loose”, was borrowed into standard German from Low German. Its origin is uncertain; EtymDB 2.1 has the word but no source for it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: locker*
- *Say it: locker*, once more
- *Say it:* say *locker*
- *Recall:* say the German for tasty, then the German for kind, then say *locker* again

Before you move on

What does locker mean? (“Relaxed, loose”.) Say it once more.

218.4 mager — thin, lean

Before the new one: say the German for kind, then the German for relaxed.

You'll want to know: mager

mager — "thin, lean".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mager ← Old High German *magar*, "thin" ← Proto-Germanic **magraz* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) Dutch *mager* is the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mager*
- *Say it: mager*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mager*
- *Recall:* say the German for kind, then the German for relaxed, then say *mager* again

Before you move on

What does mager mean? ("Thin, lean".) Say it once more.

218.5 mutig — brave

Before the new one: say the German for relaxed, then the German for thin.

You'll want to know: mutig

mutig — "brave".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mutig ← Middle High German *muotic* ← Old High German *muotag* (EtymDB 2.1): the word for "courage, spirit" + *-ig*. That word, Old High German *muot*, is the same as English *mood*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mutig*
- *Say it: mutig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mutig*
- *Recall:* say the German for relaxed, then the German for thin, then say *mutig* again

Before you move on

What does mutig mean? ("Brave".) Say it once more.

Chapter 219

Curious, Useful, Public, Tidy, Personal

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say curious, useful, public, tidy and personal.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 219: I can say curious, useful, public, tidy and personal.

219.1 neugierig — curious

Before the new one: say the German for thin, then the German for brave.

You'll want to know: neugierig

neugierig — "curious".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

neugierig is the word for "new", Old High German *niuwi*, English *new*, + the word for "greed, craving" + *-ig* (EtymDB 2.1): greedy for new things.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: neugierig*
- *Say it: neugierig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *neugierig*
- *Recall:* say the German for thin, then the German for brave, then say *neugierig* again

Before you move on

What does neugierig mean? ("Curious".) Say it once more.

219.2 nützlich — useful

Before the new one: say the German for brave, then the German for curious.

You'll want to know: nützlich

nützlich — "useful".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nützlich ← Middle High German *nützelich* (EtymDB 2.1): the word for "use, benefit", from Old High German *nuzzōn*, "to use", + *-lich*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nützlich*
- *Say it: nützlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nützlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for brave, then the German for curious, then say *nützlich* again

Before you move on

What does nützlich mean? ("Useful".) Say it once more.

219.3 öffentlich — public

Before the new one: say the German for curious, then the German for useful.

You'll want to know: öffentlich

öffentlich — "public".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

öffentlich is built on the word for "open", Old High German *offan*, English *open* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-lich*: in the open, public.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: öffentlich*
- *Say it: öffentlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *öffentlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for curious, then the German for useful, then say *öffentlich* again

Before you move on

What does öffentlich mean? ("Public".) Say it once more.

219.4 ordentlich — tidy, proper

Before the new one: say the German for useful, then the German for public.

You'll want to know: ordentlich

ordentlich — "tidy, proper".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ordentlich ← Middle High German *ordenlich* (EtymDB 2.1), from the word for "order, rank", which came from Latin *ōrdō*, + *-lich*: in good order.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ordentlich*
- *Say it: ordentlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ordentlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for useful, then the German for public, then say *ordentlich* again

Before you move on

What does ordentlich mean? ("Tidy, proper".) Say it once more.

219.5 persönlich — personal

Before the new one: say the German for public, then the German for tidy.

You'll want to know: persönlich

persönlich — "personal".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

persönlich ← Middle High German *persōnlich* (EtymDB 2.1): the word for "person", from Latin *persōna*, + *-lich*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: persönlich*
- *Say it: persönlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *persönlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for public, then the German for tidy, then say *persönlich* again

Before you move on

What does persönlich mean? ("Personal".) Say it once more.

219.6 Words from chapters 211-214 — a first pass

Say the words for tidy and personal.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- anxious, tiring, excited, excellent, working
- cloudy, blond, honest, urgent, lonely
- jealous, successful, having a cold, fantastic, damp
- cheerful, terrible, patient, stingy, cosy

Before you move on

Anxious? (**ängstlich**.) Tiring? (**anstrengend**.) Excited? (**aufgeregt**.) Excellent? (**ausgezeichnet**.) Working? (**berufstätig**.) Cloudy? (**bewölkt**.) Blond? (**blond**.) Honest? (**ehrlich**.) Urgent? (**eilig**.) Lonely? (**einsam**.) Jealous? (**eifersüchtig**.) Successful? (**erfolgreich**.) Having a cold?

(**erkältet**.) Fantastic? (**fantastisch**.) Damp? (**feucht**.) Cheerful? (**fröhlich**.) Terrible? (**furchtbar**.) Patient? (**geduldig**.) Stingy? (**geizig**.) Cosy? (**gemütlich**.)

219.7 Words from chapters 215-219 — a second pass

Say the words for fair and divorced.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- fair, divorced, at the same time, generous, good value
- thorough, frequent, wonderful, helpful, intelligent
- broken, clever, free of charge, strong, single
- tasty, kind, relaxed, thin, brave
- curious, useful, public, tidy, personal

Before you move on

Fair? (**gerecht**.) Divorced? (**geschieden**.) At the same time? (**gleichzeitig**.) Generous? (**großzügig**.) Good value? (**günstig**.) Thorough? (**gründlich**.) Frequent? (**häufig**.) Wonderful? (**herrlich**.) Helpful? (**hilfsbereit**.) Intelligent? (**intelligent**.) Broken? (**kaputt**.) Clever? (**klug**.) Free of charge? (**kostenlos**.) Strong? (**kräftig**.) Single? (**ledig**.) Tasty? (**lecker**.) Kind? (**lieb**.) Relaxed? (**locker**.) Thin? (**mager**.) Brave? (**mutig**.) Curious? (**neugierig**.) Useful? (**nützlich**.) Public? (**öffentlich**.) Tidy? (**ordentlich**.) Personal? (**persönlich**.)

Chapter 220

Punctual, Rainy, Raw, Salty, Sour

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say punctual, rainy, raw, salty and sour.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 220: I can say punctual, rainy, raw, salty and sour.*

220.1 pünktlich — punctual

Before the new one: say the German for tidy, proper, then the German for personal.

You'll want to know: pünktlich

pünktlich — "punctual".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pünktlich is the word for "point", from Latin *pūnctum*, "a prick, a point" (EtymDB 2.1), + *-lich*: on the dot.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pünktlich*
- *Say it: pünktlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pünktlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for tidy, proper, then the German for personal, then say *pünktlich* again

Before you move on

What does pünktlich mean? ("Punctual".) Say it once more.

220.2 regnerisch — rainy

Before the new one: say the German for personal, then the German for punctual.

You'll want to know: regnerisch

regnerisch — "rainy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

regnerisch is built on *Regen*, "rain", + *-isch*. *Regen* ← Proto-Germanic **regnaz*, English *rain*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: regnerisch*
- *Say it: regnerisch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *regnerisch*
- *Recall:* say the German for personal, then the German for punctual, then say *regnerisch* again

Before you move on

What does regnerisch mean? ("Rainy".) Say it once more.

220.3 roh — raw

Before the new one: say the German for punctual, then the German for rainy.

You'll want to know: roh

roh — "raw".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

roh ← Middle High German *rō* ← Old High German *rāo* — inherited, the same word as English *raw*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: roh*
- *Say it: roh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *roh*
- *Recall:* say the German for punctual, then the German for rainy, then say *roh* again

Before you move on

What does roh mean? ("Raw".) Say it once more.

220.4 salzig — salty

Before the new one: say the German for rainy, then the German for raw.

You'll want to know: salzig

salzig — "salty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

salzig is *Salz*, "salt", + *-ig*, built like English *salty*. *Salz* ← Proto-Germanic **saltą*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: salzig*
- *Say it: salzig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *salzig*
- *Recall:* say the German for rainy, then the German for raw, then say *salzig* again

Before you move on

What does salzig mean? ("Salty".) Say it once more.

220.5 sauer — sour, annoyed

Before the new one: say the German for raw, then the German for salty.

You'll want to know: sauer

sauer — "sour, annoyed".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sauer ← Middle High German *sūr* ← Old High German *sūr* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, the same word as English *sour*. "Annoyed" is a soured mood.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sauer*
- *Say it: sauer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sauer*
- *Recall:* say the German for raw, then the German for salty, then say *sauer* again

Before you move on

What does sauer mean? ("Sour, annoyed".) Say it once more.

Chapter 221

Slim, Dreadful, Shy, Independent, Sunny

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say slim, dreadful, shy, independent and sunny.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 221: I can say slim, dreadful, shy, independent and sunny.

221.1 schlank — slim

Before the new one: say the German for salty, then the German for sour.

You'll want to know: schlank

schlank — "slim".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schlank first meant "flexible, thin" and was borrowed from Low German. Its origin is uncertain; EtymDB 2.1 has the word but no source for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schlank*
- *Say it: schlank*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schlank*
- *Recall:* say the German for salty, then the German for sour, then say *schlank* again

Before you move on

What does schlank mean? ("Slim".) Say it once more.

221.2 schrecklich — dreadful

Before the new one: say the German for sour, then the German for slim.

You'll want to know: schrecklich

schrecklich — "dreadful".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schrecklich is the word for "fright" + *-lich*. It comes from the verb Old High German *skreckōn*, "to jump up in fright" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schrecklich*
- *Say it: schrecklich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schrecklich*
- *Recall:* say the German for sour, then the German for slim, then say *schrecklich* again

Before you move on

What does schrecklich mean? ("Dreadful".) Say it once more.

221.3 schüchtern — shy

Before the new one: say the German for slim, then the German for dreadful.

You'll want to know: schüchtern

schüchtern — "shy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

schüchtern was borrowed into standard German from Middle Low German *schüchter*, "shy, easily scared" (EtymDB 2.1). It is related to English *shy*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schüchtern*
- *Say it: schüchtern*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schüchtern*
- *Recall:* say the German for slim, then the German for dreadful, then say *schüchtern* again

Before you move on

What does schüchtern mean? ("Shy".) Say it once more.

221.4 selbstständig — independent, self-employed

Before the new one: say the German for dreadful, then the German for shy.

You'll want to know: selbstständig

selbstständig — "independent, self-employed".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

selbstständig is the word for "self", which EtymDB 2.1 lists beside English *self*, + a word built on the verb "to stand", Old High German *stān*: standing on one's own.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: selbstständig*
- *Say it: selbstständig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *selbstständig*
- *Recall:* say the German for dreadful, then the German for shy, then say *selbstständig* again

Before you move on

What does selbstständig mean? ("Independent, self-employed".)
Say it once more.

221.5 sonnig — sunny

Before the new one: say the German for shy, then the German for independent.

You'll want to know: sonnig

sonnig — "sunny".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sonnig ← Middle High German *sunnec*: *Sonne* + *-ig* — the same build as English *sunny*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sonnig*
- *Say it: sonnig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sonnig*
- *Recall:* say the German for shy, then the German for independent, then say *sonnig* again

Before you move on

What does sonnig mean? ("Sunny".) Say it once more.

Chapter 222

Thrifty, Sporty, Strict, Likeable, Dead

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say thrifty, sporty, strict, likeable and dead.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 222: I can say thrifty, sporty, strict, likeable and dead.*

222.1 sparsam — thrifty

> Before the new one: say the German for independent, then the German for sunny.

You'll want to know: sparsam

sparsam — "thrifty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sparsam is *sparen*, "to save", + *-sam*, a cousin of English *-some*: given to saving.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sparsam*
- *Say it:* *sparsam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sparsam*
- *Recall:* say the German for independent, then the German for sunny, then say *sparsam* again

Before you move on

What does sparsam mean? ("Thrifty".) Say it once more.

222.2 sportlich — sporty

Before the new one: say the German for sunny, then the German for thrifty.

You'll want to know: sportlich

sportlich — "sporty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sportlich is *Sport* + *-lich*. *Sport* ← English *sport* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sportlich*
- *Say it:* *sportlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sportlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for sunny, then the German for thrifty, then say *sportlich* again

Before you move on

What does sportlich mean? (“Sporty”.) Say it once more.

222.3 streng — strict

Before the new one: say the German for thrifty, then the German for sporty.

You’ll want to know: streng

streng — “strict”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

streng ← Middle High German *strenge* ← Old High German *strengi*, “strong” — inherited, the same word as English *strong*. (EtymDB 2.1) Strict is strong in rule.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: streng*
- *Say it: streng*, once more
- *Say it:* say *streng*
- *Recall:* say the German for thrifty, then the German for sporty, then say *streng* again

Before you move on

What does streng mean? (“Strict”.) Say it once more.

222.4 sympathisch — likeable

Before the new one: say the German for sporty, then the German for strict.

You'll want to know: sympathisch

sympathisch — "likeable".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sympathisch ← French *sympathique*, "likeable" (EtymDB 2.1), from Greek *sympátheia*, "feeling with" — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sympathisch*
- *Say it: sympathisch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sympathisch*
- *Recall:* say the German for sporty, then the German for strict, then say *sympathisch* again

Before you move on

What does sympathisch mean? ("Likeable".) Say it once more.

222.5 tot — dead

Before the new one: say the German for strict, then the German for likeable.

You'll want to know: tot

tot — "dead".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tot ← Old High German *tōt* ← Proto-Germanic **daudaz*, "dead" — inherited, the same word as English *dead*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tot*
- *Say it: tot*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tot*
- *Recall:* say the German for strict, then the German for likeable, then say *tot* again

Before you move on

What does tot mean? ("Dead".) Say it once more.

Chapter 223

Faithful, Typical, Impatient, Unhappy, Married

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say faithful, typical, impatient, unhappy and married.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 223: I can say faithful, typical, impatient, unhappy and married.*

223.1 treu — faithful, loyal

> Before the new one: say the German for likeable, then the German for dead.

You'll want to know: treu

treu — "faithful, loyal".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

treu ← Middle High German *triuwe* ← Old High German *triuwi*, "true, faithful" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, the same word as English *true*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: treu*
- *Say it: treu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *treu*
- *Recall:* say the German for likeable, then the German for dead, then say *treu* again

Before you move on

What does treu mean? ("Faithful, loyal".) Say it once more.

223.2 typisch — typical

Before the new one: say the German for dead, then the German for faithful.

You'll want to know: typisch

typisch — "typical".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

typisch is the word for "type" ← Latin *typus* ← Greek *týpos*, "a blow, an impression" (EtymDB 2.1), + *-isch*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: typisch*
- *Say it: typisch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *typisch*
- *Recall:* say the German for dead, then the German for faithful, then say *typisch* again

Before you move on

What does typisch mean? (“Typical”.) Say it once more.

223.3 ungeduldig — impatient

Before the new one: say the German for faithful, then the German for typical.

You’ll want to know: ungeduldig

ungeduldig — “impatient”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ungeduldig is *un-*, “not”, + *geduldig* ← Middle High German *gedultic*, “patient” (EtymDB 2.1).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ungeduldig*
- *Say it: ungeduldig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ungeduldig*
- *Recall:* say the German for faithful, then the German for typical, then say *ungeduldig* again

Before you move on

What does ungeduldig mean? (“Impatient”.) Say it once more.

223.4 unglücklich — unhappy

Before the new one: say the German for typical, then the German for impatient.

You'll want to know: unglücklich

unglücklich — "unhappy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

unglücklich is *un-*, "not", + *glücklich*, "happy". Middle High German *unglück*, "misfortune", is the noun beside it (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: unglücklich*
- *Say it: unglücklich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *unglücklich*
- *Recall:* say the German for typical, then the German for impatient, then say *unglücklich* again

Before you move on

What does unglücklich mean? ("Unhappy".) Say it once more.

223.5 verheiratet — married

Before the new one: say the German for impatient, then the German for unhappy.

You'll want to know: verheiratet

verheiratet — "married".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

verheiratet is the past participle of a verb built from *ver-* + *heiraten*, "to marry", which goes back to Old High German *hīrāt*, "marriage" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: verheiratet*
- *Say it: verheiratet*, once more
- *Say it:* say *verheiratet*
- *Recall:* say the German for impatient, then the German for unhappy, then say *verheiratet* again

Before you move on

What does verheiratet mean? ("Married".) Say it once more.

Chapter 224

In love, Different, Careful, Windy, Funny

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say in love, different, careful, windy and funny.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 224: I can say in love, different, careful, windy and funny.

224.1 verliebt — in love

Before the new one: say the German for unhappy, then the German for married.

You'll want to know: verliebt

verliebt — "in love".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

verliebt is the participle of *ver-* + *lieben*, "to love": fallen in love. *lieben* is built on Proto-Germanic **leubaz*, "dear". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: verliebt*
- *Say it: verliebt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *verliebt*
- *Recall:* say the German for unhappy, then the German for married, then say *verliebt* again

Before you move on

What does verliebt mean? ("In love".) Say it once more.

224.2 verschieden — different, various

Before the new one: say the German for married, then the German for in love.

You'll want to know: verschieden

verschieden — "different, various".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

verschieden is the participle of *ver-* + the verb "to separate", Old High German *sceidan* (EtymDB 2.1): things set apart are different.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: verschieden*
- *Say it: verschieden*, once more
- *Say it:* say *verschieden*
- *Recall:* say the German for married, then the German for in love, then say *verschieden* again

Before you move on

What does verschieden mean? ("Different, various".) Say it once more.

224.3 vorsichtig — careful

Before the new one: say the German for in love, then the German for different.

You'll want to know: vorsichtig

vorsichtig — "careful".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vorsichtig is the word for "before" + the word for "sight", from *sehen*, + *-ig*: looking ahead. EtymDB 2.1 lists Dutch *voorzichtig* beside it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vorsichtig*
- *Say it: vorsichtig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vorsichtig*
- *Recall:* say the German for in love, then the German for different, then say *vorsichtig* again

Before you move on

What does vorsichtig mean? ("Careful".) Say it once more.

224.4 windig — windy

Before the new one: say the German for different, then the German for careful.

You'll want to know: windig

windig — "windy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

windig ← Middle High German *windic*: *Wind* + *-ig* — the same build as English *windy*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: windig*
- *Say it: windig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *windig*
- *Recall:* say the German for different, then the German for careful, then say *windig* again

Before you move on

What does windig mean? ("Windy".) Say it once more.

224.5 witzig — funny, witty

Before the new one: say the German for careful, then the German for windy.

You'll want to know: witzig

witzig — "funny, witty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

witzig is the word for "joke", Old High German *wizzi*, "knowledge, understanding" ← Proto-Germanic **witjǫ*, English *wit* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-ig*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: witzig*
- *Say it: witzig*, once more
- *Say it:* say *witzig*
- *Recall:* say the German for careful, then the German for windy, then say *witzig* again

Before you move on

What does witzig mean? ("Funny, witty".) Say it once more.

Chapter 225

An adventure, An idea, Everyday life, Training, An exhibition

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an adventure, an idea, everyday life, training and an exhibition.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 225: I can say an adventure, an idea, everyday life, training and an exhibition.*

225.1 das Abenteuer — an adventure

> Before the new one: say the German for windy, then the German for funny.

You'll want to know: das Abenteuer

das Abenteuer — "an adventure".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Abenteuer ← Middle High German *āventiure* (EtymDB 2.1), from Old French *aventure*, "what comes to you", ← Latin *advenīre*, "to arrive" — borrowed and reshaped.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Abenteuer*
- *Say it: das Abenteuer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Abenteuer*
- *Recall:* say the German for windy, then the German for funny, then say *das Abenteuer* again

Before you move on

What does das Abenteuer mean? ("An adventure".) Say it once more.

225.2 die Ahnung — an idea, a notion (keine Ahnung: no idea)

Before the new one: say the German for funny, then the German for an adventure.

You'll want to know: die Ahnung

die Ahnung — "an idea, a notion (keine Ahnung: no idea)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ahnung is the verb "to sense, to suspect", Middle High German *anen* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-ung*: a hunch. Its earlier origin is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Ahnung*
- *Say it: die Ahnung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Ahnung*

- *Recall:* say the German for funny, then the German for an adventure, then say *die Ahnung* again

Before you move on

What does die Ahnung mean? ("An idea, a notion (keine Ahnung: no idea)".) Say it once more.

225.3 der Alltag — everyday life

Before the new one: say the German for an adventure, then the German for an idea.

You'll want to know: der Alltag

der Alltag — "everyday life".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Alltag ← Middle High German *altac* (EtymDB 2.1): the word for "all" + *Tag*: the everyday.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Alltag*
- *Say it: der Alltag*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Alltag*
- *Recall:* say the German for an adventure, then the German for an idea, then say *der Alltag* again

Before you move on

What does der Alltag mean? ("Everyday life".) Say it once more.

225.4 die Ausbildung — training, an apprenticeship

Before the new one: say the German for an idea, then the German for everyday life.

You'll want to know: die Ausbildung

die Ausbildung — "training, an apprenticeship".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ausbildung is *aus-* + the word for "forming, education", Old High German *bildunga* (EtymDB 2.1), from the verb built on *Bild*: shaping someone out.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Ausbildung*
- *Say it: die Ausbildung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Ausbildung*
- *Recall:* say the German for an idea, then the German for everyday life, then say *die Ausbildung* again

Before you move on

What does die Ausbildung mean? ("Training, an apprenticeship".) Say it once more.

225.5 die Ausstellung — an exhibition

Before the new one: say the German for everyday life, then the German for training.

You'll want to know: die Ausstellung

die Ausstellung — "an exhibition".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ausstellung is *aus-*, "out", + *stellen*, "to put", + *-ung* (EtymDB 2.1): things put out on show.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Ausstellung*
- *Say it: die Ausstellung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Ausstellung*
- *Recall:* say the German for everyday life, then the German for training, then say *die Ausstellung* again

Before you move on

What does die Ausstellung mean? ("An exhibition".) Say it once more.

Chapter 226

Pronunciation, A meaning, A greeting, A description, A visit

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say pronunciation, a meaning, a greeting, a description and a visit.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 226: I can say pronunciation, a meaning, a greeting, a description and a visit.*

226.1 die Aussprache — pronunciation

Before the new one: say the German for training, then the German for an exhibition.

You'll want to know: die Aussprache

die Aussprache — "pronunciation".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Aussprache is *aus-*, "out", + *Sprache*, "speech" ← Proto-Germanic **sprēkijō* (EtymDB 2.1): how a word is spoken out.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Aussprache*
- *Say it: die Aussprache*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Aussprache*
- *Recall:* say the German for training, then the German for an exhibition, then say *die Aussprache* again

Before you move on

What does die Aussprache mean? ("Pronunciation".) Say it once more.

226.2 die Bedeutung — a meaning

Before the new one: say the German for an exhibition, then the German for pronunciation.

You'll want to know: die Bedeutung

die Bedeutung — "a meaning".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bedeutung is *bedeuten*, "to mean", + *-ung* (EtymDB 2.1). *bedeuten* shares its root with *Deutsch*, "of the people".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Bedeutung*
- *Say it: die Bedeutung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Bedeutung*
- *Recall:* say the German for an exhibition, then the German for pronunciation, then say *die Bedeutung* again

Before you move on

What does die Bedeutung mean? ("A meaning".) Say it once more.

226.3 die Begrüßung — a greeting, a welcome

Before the new one: say the German for pronunciation, then the German for a meaning.

You'll want to know: die Begrüßung

die Begrüßung — "a greeting, a welcome".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Begrüßung is *be-* + *grüßen*, "to greet", + *-ung*. *grüßen* is the same verb as English *greet*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Begrüßung*
- *Say it: die Begrüßung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Begrüßung*
- *Recall:* say the German for pronunciation, then the German for a meaning, then say *die Begrüßung* again

Before you move on

What does die Begrüßung mean? ("A greeting, a welcome".) Say it once more.

226.4 die Beschreibung — a description

Before the new one: say the German for a meaning, then the German for a greeting.

You'll want to know: die Beschreibung

die Beschreibung — "a description".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Beschreibung is *beschreiben*, "to describe", + *-ung* (EtymDB 2.1). *schreiben* comes from Latin *scrībere*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Beschreibung*
- *Say it: die Beschreibung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Beschreibung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a meaning, then the German for a greeting, then say *die Beschreibung* again

Before you move on

What does die Beschreibung mean? ("A description".) Say it once more.

226.5 der Besuch — a visit

Before the new one: say the German for a greeting, then the German for a description.

You'll want to know: der Besuch

der Besuch — "a visit".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Besuch is the noun of *besuchen*, "to visit", which is *be-* + *suchen*, "to seek" (EtymDB 2.1): a seeking out.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Besuch*
- *Say it: der Besuch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Besuch*
- *Recall:* say the German for a greeting, then the German for a description, then say *der Besuch* again

Before you move on

What does der Besuch mean? ("A visit".) Say it once more.

Chapter 227

An application, A relationship, An impression, Admission, An admission ticket

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an application, a relationship, an impression, admission and an admission ticket.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 227: I can say an application, a relationship, an impression, admission and an admission ticket.

227.1 die Bewerbung — an application

Before the new one: say the German for a description, then the German for a visit.

You'll want to know: die Bewerbung

die Bewerbung — "an application".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Bewerbung is *bewerben*, "to apply", + *-ung*. The verb is built on Old High German *werban* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Bewerbung*
- *Say it: die Bewerbung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Bewerbung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a description, then the German for a visit, then say *die Bewerbung* again

Before you move on

What does die Bewerbung mean? ("An application".) Say it once more.

227.2 die Beziehung — a relationship

Before the new one: say the German for a visit, then the German for an application.

You'll want to know: die Beziehung

die Beziehung — "a relationship".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Beziehung is *be-* + *ziehen*, "to pull, to draw", + *-ung* (EtymDB 2.1): what draws two people or things together.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Beziehung*
- *Say it: die Beziehung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Beziehung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a visit, then the German for an application, then say *die Beziehung* again

Before you move on

What does die Beziehung mean? (“A relationship”.) Say it once more.

227.3 der Eindruck — an impression

Before the new one: say the German for an application, then the German for a relationship.

You’ll want to know: der Eindruck

der Eindruck — “an impression”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Eindruck ← Middle High German *īndruc* (EtymDB 2.1): *ein-*, “in”, + the word for “a press, a pressing”: what is pressed into the mind, after Latin *impressiō*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Eindruck*
- *Say it: der Eindruck*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Eindruck*
- *Recall:* say the German for an application, then the German for a relationship, then say *der Eindruck* again

Before you move on

What does der Eindruck mean? (“An impression”.) Say it once more.

227.4 der Eintritt — admission, entry

Before the new one: say the German for a relationship, then the German for an impression.

You'll want to know: der Eintritt

der Eintritt — "admission, entry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Eintritt comes from the verb "to step in" (EtymDB 2.1): *ein-*, "in", + the word for "a step", from Old High German *tretan*, English *tread*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Eintritt*
- *Say it: der Eintritt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Eintritt*
- *Recall:* say the German for a relationship, then the German for an impression, then say *der Eintritt* again

Before you move on

What does der Eintritt mean? ("Admission, entry".) Say it once more.

227.5 die Eintrittskarte — an admission ticket

Before the new one: say the German for an impression, then the German for admission.

You'll want to know: die Eintrittskarte

die Eintrittskarte — "an admission ticket".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Eintrittskarte is *Eintritt*, "entry", + *-s-* + *Karte*, "card": a card that lets you step in. *Karte* goes back to Latin *charta*, "paper", itself from Greek (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Eintrittskarte*
- *Say it: die Eintrittskarte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Eintrittskarte*
- *Recall:* say the German for an impression, then the German for admission, then say *die Eintrittskarte* again

Before you move on

What does die Eintrittskarte mean? ("An admission ticket".) Say it once more.

Chapter 228

A decision, A memory, Permission, A result, An explanation

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a decision, a memory, permission, a result and an explanation.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 228: I can say a decision, a memory, permission, a result and an explanation.*

228.1 die Entscheidung — a decision

> Before the new one: say the German for admission, then the German for an admission ticket.

You'll want to know: die Entscheidung

die Entscheidung — "a decision".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Entscheidung is *entscheiden*, "to decide", + *-ung*. The verb is *ent-* + Old High German *sceidan*, "to separate". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Entscheidung*
- *Say it: die Entscheidung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Entscheidung*
- *Recall:* say the German for admission, then the German for an admission ticket, then say *die Entscheidung* again

Before you move on

What does die Entscheidung mean? ("A decision".) Say it once more.

228.2 die Erinnerung — a memory, a reminder

Before the new one: say the German for an admission ticket, then the German for a decision.

You'll want to know: die Erinnerung

die Erinnerung — "a memory, a reminder".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Erinnerung is *erinnern*, "to remind", + *-ung*: what is brought back inside the mind. *Erinnern* is built on *inner*, "inside", which EtymDB 2.1 traces to Old High German *innar*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Erinnerung*
- *Say it: die Erinnerung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Erinnerung*

- *Recall:* say the German for an admission ticket, then the German for a decision, then say *die Erinnerung* again

Before you move on

What does die Erinnerung mean? ("A memory, a reminder".) Say it once more.

228.3 die Erlaubnis — permission

Before the new one: say the German for a decision, then the German for a memory.

You'll want to know: die Erlaubnis

die Erlaubnis — "permission".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Erlaubnis is *erlauben*, "to allow", + *-nis*, an ending that makes a noun. *erlauben* ← Old High German *irlouben*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Erlaubnis*
- *Say it: die Erlaubnis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Erlaubnis*
- *Recall:* say the German for a decision, then the German for a memory, then say *die Erlaubnis* again

Before you move on

What does die Erlaubnis mean? ("Permission".) Say it once more.

228.4 das Ergebnis — a result

Before the new one: say the German for a memory, then the German for permission.

You'll want to know: das Ergebnis

das Ergebnis — "a result".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ergebnis comes from the verb "to yield, to result" (EtymDB 2.1): *er-* + the verb "to give", English *give*, + *-nis*. A result is what a thing gives out.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Ergebnis*
- *Say it: das Ergebnis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Ergebnis*
- *Recall:* say the German for a memory, then the German for permission, then say *das Ergebnis* again

Before you move on

What does das Ergebnis mean? ("A result".) Say it once more.

228.5 die Erklärung — an explanation

Before the new one: say the German for permission, then the German for a result.

You'll want to know: die Erklärung

die Erklärung — "an explanation".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Erklärung is *erklären*, "to explain", + *-ung* (EtymDB 2.1). The verb is built on the word for "clear", from Latin *clārus*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Erklärung*
- *Say it: die Erklärung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Erklärung*
- *Recall:* say the German for permission, then the German for a result, then say *die Erklärung* again

Before you move on

What does die Erklärung mean? ("An explanation".) Say it once more.

228.6 Words from chapters 220-223 — a first pass

Say the words for a result and an explanation.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- punctual, rainy, raw, salty, sour
- slim, dreadful, shy, independent, sunny
- thrifty, sporty, strict, likeable, dead
- faithful, typical, impatient, unhappy, married

Before you move on

Punctual? (**pünktlich**.) Rainy? (**regnerisch**.) Raw? (**roh**.) Salty? (**salzig**.) Sour? (**sauer**.) Slim? (**schlank**.) Dreadful? (**schrecklich**.) Shy? (**schüchtern**.) Independent? (**selbstständig**.) Sunny? (**sonnig**.) Thrifty? (**sparsam**.) Sporty? (**sportlich**.) Strict? (**streng**.) Likeable? (**sympathisch**.) Dead? (**tot**.) Faithful? (**treu**.) Typical? (**typisch**.) Impatient? (**ungeduldig**.) Unhappy? (**unglücklich**.) Married? (**verheiratet**.)

228.7 Words from chapters 224-228 — a second pass

Say the words for in love and different.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- in love, different, careful, windy, funny
- an adventure, an idea, everyday life, training, an exhibition
- pronunciation, a meaning, a greeting, a description, a visit
- an application, a relationship, an impression, admission, an admission ticket
- a decision, a memory, permission, a result, an explanation

Before you move on

In love? (**verliebt**.) Different? (**verschieden**.) Careful? (**vorsichtig**.) Windy? (**windig**.) Funny? (**witzig**.) An adventure? (**das Abenteuer**.) An idea? (**die Ahnung**.) Everyday life? (**der Alltag**.) Training? (**die Ausbildung**.) An exhibition? (**die Ausstellung**.) Pronunciation? (**die Aussprache**.) A meaning? (**die Bedeutung**.) A greeting? (**die Begrüßung**.) A description? (**die Beschreibung**.) A visit? (**der Besuch**.) An application? (**die Bewerbung**.) A relationship? (**die Beziehung**.) An impression? (**der Eindruck**.) Admission? (**der Eintritt**.) An

admission ticket? (**die Eintrittskarte**.) A decision? (**die Entscheidung**.) A memory? (**die Erinnerung**.) Permission? (**die Erlaubnis**.) A result? (**das Ergebnis**.) An explanation? (**die Erklärung**.)

Chapter 229

An experience, A guided tour, A fee, A feeling, An area

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an experience, a guided tour, a fee, a feeling and an area.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 229: I can say an experience, a guided tour, a fee, a feeling and an area.

229.1 das Erlebnis — an experience (something lived)

Before the new one: say the German for a result, then the German for an explanation.

You'll want to know: das Erlebnis

das Erlebnis — "an experience (something lived)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Erlebnis is *er-* + *leben*, "to live", + *-nis*: something lived through. *leben* ← Proto-Germanic **libjanǫ*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Erlebnis*
- *Say it: das Erlebnis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Erlebnis*
- *Recall:* say the German for a result, then the German for an explanation, then say *das Erlebnis* again

Before you move on

What does das Erlebnis mean? ("An experience (something lived)".) Say it once more.

229.2 die Führung — a guided tour, leadership

Before the new one: say the German for an explanation, then the German for an experience.

You'll want to know: die Führung

die Führung — "a guided tour, leadership".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Führung is the verb "to lead" + *-ung*. That verb first meant "to make go", built on *fahren*: a guide makes you travel. EtymDB 2.1 has the verb but not its source.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Führung*
- *Say it: die Führung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Führung*

- *Recall:* say the German for an explanation, then the German for an experience, then say *die Führung* again

Before you move on

What does die Führung mean? ("A guided tour, leadership".) Say it once more.

229.3 die Gebühr — a fee

Before the new one: say the German for an experience, then the German for a guided tour.

You'll want to know: die Gebühr

die Gebühr — "a fee".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gebühr comes from Middle High German *gebür*, "what is due", from an old verb meaning "to befall, to be fitting". EtymDB 2.1 has no source for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Gebühr*
- *Say it: die Gebühr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Gebühr*
- *Recall:* say the German for an experience, then the German for a guided tour, then say *die Gebühr* again

Before you move on

What does die Gebühr mean? ("A fee".) Say it once more.

229.4 das Gefühl — a feeling

Before the new one: say the German for a guided tour, then the German for a fee.

You'll want to know: das Gefühl

das Gefühl — "a feeling".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gefühl is *ge-* + *fühlen*, "to feel": a feeling. EtymDB 2.1 lists English *feel* beside it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Gefühl*
- *Say it: das Gefühl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Gefühl*
- *Recall:* say the German for a guided tour, then the German for a fee, then say *das Gefühl* again

Before you move on

What does das Gefühl mean? ("A feeling".) Say it once more.

229.5 die Gegend — an area, a region

Before the new one: say the German for a fee, then the German for a feeling.

You'll want to know: die Gegend

die Gegend — "an area, a region".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gegend ← Middle High German *gegende* (EtymDB 2.1), built on the word for "towards, against": the land that lies before you, a copy of Medieval Latin *contrāta*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *die Gegend*
- *Say it:* *die Gegend*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Gegend*
- *Recall:* say the German for a fee, then the German for a feeling, then say *die Gegend* again

Before you move on

What does die Gegend mean? ("An area, a region".) Say it once more.

Chapter 230

The opposite, A story, A conversation, Weight, A habit

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say the opposite, a story, a conversation, weight and a habit.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 230: I can say the opposite, a story, a conversation, weight and a habit.*

230.1 das Gegenteil — the opposite

> Before the new one: say the German for a feeling, then the German for an area.

You'll want to know: das Gegenteil

das Gegenteil — "the opposite".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gegenteil is the word for "against" + the word for "part", Old High German *teil* ← Proto-Germanic **dailą*, English *deal* (EtymDB 2.1): the opposite part.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Gegenteil*
- *Say it: das Gegenteil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Gegenteil*
- *Recall:* say the German for a feeling, then the German for an area, then say *das Gegenteil* again

Before you move on

What does das Gegenteil mean? ("The opposite".) Say it once more.

230.2 die Geschichte — a story, history

Before the new one: say the German for an area, then the German for the opposite.

You'll want to know: die Geschichte

die Geschichte — "a story, history".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Geschichte ← Middle High German *geschicht* ← Old High German *gisciht*, "event" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, from the verb "to happen". A story is what happened, told.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Geschichte*
- *Say it: die Geschichte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Geschichte*
- *Recall:* say the German for an area, then the German for the opposite, then say *die Geschichte* again

Before you move on

What does die Geschichte mean? ("A story, history".) Say it once more.

230.3 das Gespräch — a conversation

Before the new one: say the German for the opposite, then the German for a story.

You'll want to know: das Gespräch

das Gespräch — "a conversation".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gespräch ← Middle High German *gespræche* ← Old High German *gisprāhhi* (EtymDB 2.1): *ge-*, "together", + the root of *Sprache*. A conversation is speech together.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Gespräch*
- *Say it: das Gespräch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Gespräch*
- *Recall:* say the German for the opposite, then the German for a story, then say *das Gespräch* again

Before you move on

What does das Gespräch mean? ("A conversation".) Say it once more.

230.4 das Gewicht — weight

Before the new one: say the German for a story, then the German for a conversation.

You'll want to know: das Gewicht

das Gewicht — "weight".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gewicht is *ge-* + the root of *wiegen*, "to weigh" — EtymDB 2.1 lists it beside English *weight* and Dutch *gewicht*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Gewicht*
- *Say it: das Gewicht*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Gewicht*
- *Recall:* say the German for a story, then the German for a conversation, then say *das Gewicht* again

Before you move on

What does das Gewicht mean? ("Weight".) Say it once more.

230.5 die Gewohnheit — a habit

Before the new one: say the German for a conversation, then the German for weight.

You'll want to know: die Gewohnheit

die Gewohnheit — "a habit".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Gewohnheit is *gewohnt*, "accustomed", + *-heit*: what you are accustomed to. *gewohnt* is built on *wohnen*, first "to be accustomed, to stay".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Gewohnheit*
- *Say it: die Gewohnheit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Gewohnheit*
- *Recall:* say the German for a conversation, then the German for weight, then say *die Gewohnheit* again

Before you move on

What does die Gewohnheit mean? ("A habit".) Say it once more.

Chapter 231

A hobby, Hope, Humour, An interest, Youth

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a hobby, hope, humour, an interest and youth.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 231: I can say a hobby, hope, humour, an interest and youth.

231.1 das Hobby — a hobby

Before the new one: say the German for weight, then the German for a habit.

You'll want to know: das Hobby

das Hobby — "a hobby".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Hobby ← English *hobby* (EtymDB 2.1), short for *hobby-horse* — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Hobby*
- *Say it: das Hobby*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Hobby*
- *Recall:* say the German for weight, then the German for a habit, then say *das Hobby* again

Before you move on

What does das Hobby mean? ("A hobby".) Say it once more.

231.2 die Hoffnung — hope

Before the new one: say the German for a habit, then the German for a hobby.

You'll want to know: die Hoffnung

die Hoffnung — "hope".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Hoffnung is *hoffen*, "to hope", + *-ung* (EtymDB 2.1). *hoffen* is the same verb as English *hope*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Hoffnung*
- *Say it: die Hoffnung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Hoffnung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a habit, then the German for a hobby, then say *die Hoffnung* again

Before you move on

What does die Hoffnung mean? (“Hope”.) Say it once more.

231.3 der Humor — humour

Before the new one: say the German for a hobby, then the German for hope.

You’ll want to know: der Humor

der Humor — “humour”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Humor ← Latin *(h)ūmor*, “moisture, fluid” (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: the body’s fluids, the humours, were thought to set your temper.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Humor*
- *Say it: der Humor*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Humor*
- *Recall:* say the German for a hobby, then the German for hope, then say *der Humor* again

Before you move on

What does der Humor mean? (“Humour”.) Say it once more.

231.4 das Interesse — an interest

Before the new one: say the German for hope, then the German for humour.

You'll want to know: das Interesse

das Interesse — "an interest".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Interesse ← Medieval Latin *interesse*, "what matters, compensation", from Latin *interesse*, "to be between" — borrowed. See *interessant*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Interesse*
- *Say it: das Interesse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Interesse*
- *Recall:* say the German for hope, then the German for humour, then say *das Interesse* again

Before you move on

What does das Interesse mean? ("An interest".) Say it once more.

231.5 die Jugend — youth

Before the new one: say the German for humour, then the German for an interest.

You'll want to know: die Jugend

die Jugend — "youth".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Jugend ← Old High German *jugund* ← Proto-Germanic **jugunþiz*, "youth" — inherited, the same word as English *youth*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Jugend*
- *Say it: die Jugend*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Jugend*
- *Recall:* say the German for humour, then the German for an interest, then say *die Jugend* again

Before you move on

What does die Jugend mean? ("Youth".) Say it once more.

Chapter 232

Childhood, Knowledge, Culture, Art, A landscape

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say childhood, knowledge, culture, art and a landscape.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 232: I can say childhood, knowledge, culture, art and a landscape.

232.1 die Kindheit — childhood

Before the new one: say the German for an interest, then the German for youth.

You'll want to know: die Kindheit

die Kindheit — "childhood".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kindheit ← Middle High German *kintheit* ← Old High German *kindheit* (EtymDB 2.1): the word for "child" + *-heit*, the same ending as English *-hood*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Kindheit*
- *Say it: die Kindheit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Kindheit*
- *Recall:* say the German for an interest, then the German for youth, then say *die Kindheit* again

Before you move on

What does die Kindheit mean? ("Childhood".) Say it once more.

232.2 die Kenntnis — knowledge (of something)

Before the new one: say the German for youth, then the German for childhood.

You'll want to know: die Kenntnis

die Kenntnis — "knowledge (of something)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kenntnis is *kennen*, "to know", + *-nis*, an ending that makes a noun (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Kenntnis*
- *Say it: die Kenntnis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Kenntnis*
- *Recall:* say the German for youth, then the German for childhood, then say *die Kenntnis* again

Before you move on

What does die Kenntnis mean? (“Knowledge (of something)”.) Say it once more.

232.3 die Kultur — culture

Before the new one: say the German for childhood, then the German for knowledge.

You’ll want to know: die Kultur

die Kultur — “culture”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kultur ← Latin *cultūra*, “tilling, cultivation”, from *colere*, “to till” (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: culture began in the field.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Kultur*
- *Say it: die Kultur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Kultur*
- *Recall:* say the German for childhood, then the German for knowledge, then say *die Kultur* again

Before you move on

What does die Kultur mean? (“Culture”.) Say it once more.

232.4 die Kunst — art

Before the new one: say the German for knowledge, then the German for culture.

You'll want to know: die Kunst

die Kunst — "art".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Kunst ← Old High German *kunst*, "knowledge, skill" — inherited, built on *können*, "to be able", Old High German *kunnan* (EtymDB 2.1). Art was first skill.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Kunst*
- *Say it: die Kunst*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Kunst*
- *Recall:* say the German for knowledge, then the German for culture, then say *die Kunst* again

Before you move on

What does die Kunst mean? ("Art".) Say it once more.

232.5 die Landschaft — a landscape

Before the new one: say the German for culture, then the German for art.

You'll want to know: die Landschaft

die Landschaft — "a landscape".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Landschaft ← Middle High German *lantschaft* ← Old High German *lantskaf* (EtymDB 2.1): the word for "land" + *-schaft*. English *landscape* came from its Dutch cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Landschaft*
- *Say it: die Landschaft*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Landschaft*
- *Recall:* say the German for culture, then the German for art, then say *die Landschaft* again

Before you move on

What does die Landschaft mean? ("A landscape".) Say it once more.

Chapter 233

Noise, A mood, A CV, An achievement, A lesson

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say noise, a mood, a CV, an achievement and a lesson.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 233: I can say noise, a mood, a CV, an achievement and a lesson.*

233.1 der Lärm — noise

Before the new one: say the German for art, then the German for a landscape.

You'll want to know: der Lärm

der Lärm — "noise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Lärm ← Italian *allarme*, "to arms!" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, and its first syllable dropped. English *alarm* is the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Lärm*
- *Say it: der Lärm*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Lärm*
- *Recall:* say the German for art, then the German for a landscape, then say *der Lärm* again

Before you move on

What does der Lärm mean? ("Noise".) Say it once more.

233.2 die Laune — a mood

Before the new one: say the German for a landscape, then the German for noise.

You'll want to know: die Laune

die Laune — "a mood".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Laune ← Middle High German *lūne*, from Latin *lūna*, "moon" (EtymDB 2.1 has the Latin word) — borrowed: moods were thought to change with the moon.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Laune*
- *Say it: die Laune*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Laune*
- *Recall:* say the German for a landscape, then the German for noise, then say *die Laune* again

Before you move on

What does die Laune mean? ("A mood".) Say it once more.

233.3 der Lebenslauf — a CV

Before the new one: say the German for noise, then the German for a mood.

You'll want to know: der Lebenslauf

der Lebenslauf — "a CV".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Lebenslauf is the noun of *leben*, "to live", + *-s-* + the noun of *laufen*, "to run": the run of a life, a copy of Latin *curriculum vītae*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Lebenslauf*
- *Say it: der Lebenslauf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Lebenslauf*
- *Recall:* say the German for noise, then the German for a mood, then say *der Lebenslauf* again

Before you move on

What does der Lebenslauf mean? ("A CV".) Say it once more.

233.4 die Leistung — an achievement, performance

Before the new one: say the German for a mood, then the German for a CV.

You'll want to know: die Leistung

die Leistung — "an achievement, performance".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Leistung is the verb "to carry out, to achieve", Old High German *leisten* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-ung*. The verb first meant "to follow a track", like the shoemaker's *last*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Leistung*
- *Say it: die Leistung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Leistung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a mood, then the German for a CV, then say *die Leistung* again

Before you move on

What does die Leistung mean? ("An achievement, performance".) Say it once more.

233.5 die Lektion — a lesson (in a textbook)

Before the new one: say the German for a CV, then the German for an achievement.

You'll want to know: die Lektion

die Lektion — "a lesson (in a textbook)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Lektion ← Latin *lēctiō*, "a reading" (EtymDB 2.1 has the Latin word) — borrowed. English *lesson* is the same Latin word through French.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Lektion*
- *Say it: die Lektion*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Lektion*
- *Recall:* say the German for a CV, then the German for an achievement, then say *die Lektion* again

Before you move on

What does die Lektion mean? ("A lesson (in a textbook)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 234

A wage, A team, A majority, Fashion, Courage

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a wage, a team, a majority, fashion and courage.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 234: I can say a wage, a team, a majority, fashion and courage.

234.1 der Lohn — a wage

Before the new one: say the German for an achievement, then the German for a lesson.

You'll want to know: der Lohn

der Lohn — "a wage".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Lohn ← Old High German *lōn* ← Proto-Germanic **launą*, "reward" — inherited; Old English *lēan*, "reward", was the same word. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Lohn*
- *Say it: der Lohn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Lohn*
- *Recall:* say the German for an achievement, then the German for a lesson, then say *der Lohn* again

Before you move on

What does der Lohn mean? ("A wage".) Say it once more.

234.2 die Mannschaft — a team

Before the new one: say the German for a lesson, then the German for a wage.

You'll want to know: die Mannschaft

die Mannschaft — "a team".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mannschaft is the word for "man", Old High German *man* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-schaft*: a body of men, a crew, then a team.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Mannschaft*
- *Say it: die Mannschaft*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Mannschaft*
- *Recall:* say the German for a lesson, then the German for a wage, then say *die Mannschaft* again

Before you move on

What does die Mannschaft mean? ("A team".) Say it once more.

234.3 die Mehrheit — a majority

Before the new one: say the German for a wage, then the German for a team.

You'll want to know: die Mehrheit

die Mehrheit — "a majority".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mehrheit is the word for "more" + *-heit*: the greater part. EtymDB 2.1 lists the "more" word beside English *more*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Mehrheit*
- *Say it: die Mehrheit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Mehrheit*
- *Recall:* say the German for a wage, then the German for a team, then say *die Mehrheit* again

Before you move on

What does die Mehrheit mean? ("A majority".) Say it once more.

234.4 die Mode — fashion

Before the new one: say the German for a team, then the German for a majority.

You'll want to know: die Mode

die Mode — "fashion".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mode ← French *mode*, "fashion, manner" ← Latin *modus*, "measure, manner" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Mode*
- *Say it: die Mode*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Mode*
- *Recall:* say the German for a team, then the German for a majority, then say *die Mode* again

Before you move on

What does die Mode mean? ("Fashion".) Say it once more.

234.5 der Mut — courage

Before the new one: say the German for a majority, then the German for fashion.

You'll want to know: der Mut

der Mut — "courage".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Mut ← Middle High German *muot* ← Old High German *muot*, "spirit, heart" — inherited, the same word as English *mood*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Mut*
- *Say it: der Mut*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Mut*
- *Recall:* say the German for a majority, then the German for fashion, then say *der Mut* again

Before you move on

What does der Mut mean? ("Courage".) Say it once more.

Chapter 235

A piece of news, A number, The public, Order, A couple

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a piece of news, a number, the public, order and a couple.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 235: I can say a piece of news, a number, the public, order and a couple.

235.1 die Neuigkeit — a piece of news

Before the new one: say the German for fashion, then the German for courage.

You'll want to know: die Neuigkeit

die Neuigkeit — "a piece of news".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Neuigkeit is the word for "new", Old High German *niuwi*, English *new* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-igkeit*: a new thing, a piece of news.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Neuigkeit*
- *Say it: die Neuigkeit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Neuigkeit*
- *Recall:* say the German for fashion, then the German for courage, then say *die Neuigkeit* again

Before you move on

What does die Neuigkeit mean? ("A piece of news".) Say it once more.

235.2 die Nummer — a number

Before the new one: say the German for courage, then the German for a piece of news.

You'll want to know: die Nummer

die Nummer — "a number".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Nummer ← Italian *numero* ← Latin *numerus*, "number" — borrowed, like English *number*. EtymDB 2.1 has the Latin word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Nummer*
- *Say it: die Nummer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Nummer*
- *Recall:* say the German for courage, then the German for a piece of news, then say *die Nummer* again

Before you move on

What does die Nummer mean? ("A number".) Say it once more.

235.3 die Öffentlichkeit — the public

Before the new one: say the German for a piece of news, then the German for a number.

You'll want to know: die Öffentlichkeit

die Öffentlichkeit — "the public".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Öffentlichkeit is *öffentlich*, "public", + *-keit*. *öffentlich* is built on the word for "open", English *open*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Öffentlichkeit*
- *Say it: die Öffentlichkeit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Öffentlichkeit*
- *Recall:* say the German for a piece of news, then the German for a number, then say *die Öffentlichkeit* again

Before you move on

What does die Öffentlichkeit mean? ("The public".) Say it once more.

235.4 die Ordnung — order, tidiness

Before the new one: say the German for a number, then the German for the public.

You'll want to know: die Ordnung

die Ordnung — "order, tidiness".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ordnung ← Middle High German *ordenunge* ← Old High German *ordinunga* (EtymDB 2.1), from *ordinōn*, "to put in order", taken from Latin *ōrdināre*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Ordnung*
- *Say it: die Ordnung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Ordnung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a number, then the German for the public, then say *die Ordnung* again

Before you move on

What does die Ordnung mean? ("Order, tidiness".) Say it once more.

235.5 das Paar — a couple, a pair

Before the new one: say the German for the public, then the German for order.

You'll want to know: das Paar

das Paar — "a couple, a pair".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Paar ← Middle High German *par* ← Latin *pār*, "equal" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *pair*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Paar*
- *Say it: das Paar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Paar*
- *Recall:* say the German for the public, then the German for order, then say *das Paar* again

Before you move on

What does das Paar mean? ("A couple, a pair".) Say it once more.

Chapter 236

A duty, Quality, A speech, A row, Religion

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a duty, quality, a speech, a row and religion.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 236: I can say a duty, quality, a speech, a row and religion.

236.1 die Pflicht — a duty

Before the new one: say the German for order, then the German for a couple.

You'll want to know: die Pflicht

die Pflicht — "a duty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Pflicht ← Old High German *pfliht* ← Proto-Germanic **plihtiz* — inherited, the same word as English *plight*, as in "plight one's troth". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Pflicht*
- *Say it: die Pflicht*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Pflicht*
- *Recall:* say the German for order, then the German for a couple, then say *die Pflicht* again

Before you move on

What does die Pflicht mean? ("A duty".) Say it once more.

236.2 die Qualität — quality

Before the new one: say the German for a couple, then the German for a duty.

You'll want to know: die Qualität

die Qualität — "quality".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Qualität ← Latin *quālitās*, "what kind something is", from *quālis*, "of what kind" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *quality*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Qualität*
- *Say it: die Qualität*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Qualität*
- *Recall:* say the German for a couple, then the German for a duty, then say *die Qualität* again

Before you move on

What does die Qualität mean? ("Quality".) Say it once more.

236.3 die Rede — a speech

Before the new one: say the German for a duty, then the German for quality.

You'll want to know: die Rede

die Rede — "a speech".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Rede ← Middle High German *rede* ← Old High German *redia*, "speech, account" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Rede*
- *Say it: die Rede*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Rede*
- *Recall:* say the German for a duty, then the German for quality, then say *die Rede* again

Before you move on

What does die Rede mean? ("A speech".) Say it once more.

236.4 die Reihe — a row, a turn

Before the new one: say the German for quality, then the German for a speech.

You'll want to know: die Reihe

die Reihe — "a row, a turn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Reihe ← Middle High German *rīhe*, "row, line" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited. Your turn is your place in the row.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Reihe*
- *Say it: die Reihe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Reihe*
- *Recall:* say the German for quality, then the German for a speech, then say *die Reihe* again

Before you move on

What does die Reihe mean? ("A row, a turn".) Say it once more.

236.5 die Religion — religion

Before the new one: say the German for a speech, then the German for a row.

You'll want to know: die Religion

die Religion — "religion".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Religion ← Latin *religiō*, "scruple, reverence" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed, like English *religion*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Religion*
- *Say it: die Religion*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Religion*
- *Recall:* say the German for a speech, then the German for a row, then say *die Religion* again

Before you move on

What does die Religion mean? ("Religion".) Say it once more.

Chapter 237

A role, Quiet, A thing, A shadow, A step

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a role, quiet, a thing, a shadow and a step.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 237: I can say a role, quiet, a thing, a shadow and a step.

237.1 die Rolle — a role

Before the new one: say the German for a row, then the German for religion.

You'll want to know: die Rolle

die Rolle — "a role".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Rolle ← Middle High German *rolle* ← Old French *rolle* ← Latin *rotulus*, "little wheel, scroll" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: an actor's part was written on a roll.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Rolle*
- *Say it: die Rolle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Rolle*
- *Recall:* say the German for a row, then the German for religion, then say *die Rolle* again

Before you move on

What does die Rolle mean? ("A role".) Say it once more.

237.2 die Ruhe — quiet, calm

Before the new one: say the German for religion, then the German for a role.

You'll want to know: die Ruhe

die Ruhe — "quiet, calm".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ruhe ← Middle High German *ruowe* ← Old High German *ruowa*, "peace, rest" ← Proto-Germanic **rōwō* — inherited; Old English *rōw* was the same word. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Ruhe*
- *Say it: die Ruhe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Ruhe*
- *Recall:* say the German for religion, then the German for a role, then say *die Ruhe* again

Before you move on

What does die Ruhe mean? ("Quiet, calm".) Say it once more.

237.3 die Sache — a thing, a matter

Before the new one: say the German for a role, then the German for quiet.

You'll want to know: die Sache

die Sache — "a thing, a matter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Sache ← Middle High German *sache* ← Old High German *sahha*, "a legal case" — inherited, the same word as English *sake*, as in "for your sake". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Sache*
- *Say it: die Sache*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Sache*
- *Recall:* say the German for a role, then the German for quiet, then say *die Sache* again

Before you move on

What does die Sache mean? ("A thing, a matter".) Say it once more.

237.4 der Schatten — a shadow, shade

Before the new one: say the German for quiet, then the German for a thing.

You'll want to know: der Schatten

der Schatten — "a shadow, shade".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schatten ← Middle High German *schate* ← Old High German *scato* ← Proto-Germanic **skadwaz*, "shade" — inherited, the same word as English *shade* and *shadow*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Schatten*
- *Say it: der Schatten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Schatten*
- *Recall:* say the German for quiet, then the German for a thing, then say *der Schatten* again

Before you move on

What does der Schatten mean? ("A shadow, shade".) Say it once more.

237.5 der Schritt — a step

Before the new one: say the German for a thing, then the German for a shadow.

You'll want to know: der Schritt

der Schritt — "a step".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schritt ← Middle High German *schrit* ← Old High German *scrit* (EtymDB 2.1), from the verb "to stride", Old High German *skrītan*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Schritt*
- *Say it: der Schritt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Schritt*
- *Recall:* say the German for a thing, then the German for a shadow, then say *der Schritt* again

Before you move on

What does der Schritt mean? ("A step".) Say it once more.

237.6 Words from chapters 229-232 — a first pass

Say the words for a shadow and a step.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- an experience, a guided tour, a fee, a feeling, an area
- the opposite, a story, a conversation, weight, a habit
- a hobby, hope, humour, an interest, youth
- childhood, knowledge, culture, art, a landscape

Before you move on

An experience? (**das Erlebnis**.) A guided tour? (**die Führung**.) A fee? (**die Gebühr**.) A feeling? (**das Gefühl**.) An area? (**die Gegend**.) The opposite? (**das Gegenteil**.) A story? (**die Geschichte**.) A conversation? (**das Gespräch**.) Weight? (**das Gewicht**.) A habit? (**die Gewohnheit**.) A hobby? (**das Hobby**.)

Hope? (**die Hoffnung**.) Humour? (**der Humor**.) An interest? (**das Interesse**.) Youth? (**die Jugend**.) Childhood? (**die Kindheit**.) Knowledge? (**die Kenntnis**.) Culture? (**die Kultur**.) Art? (**die Kunst**.) A landscape? (**die Landschaft**.)

237.7 Words from chapters 233-237 — a second pass

Say the words for noise and a mood.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- noise, a mood, a CV, an achievement, a lesson
- a wage, a team, a majority, fashion, courage
- a piece of news, a number, the public, order, a couple
- a duty, quality, a speech, a row, religion
- a role, quiet, a thing, a shadow, a step

Before you move on

Noise? (**der Lärm**.) A mood? (**die Laune**.) A CV? (**der Lebenslauf**.) An achievement? (**die Leistung**.) A lesson? (**die Lektion**.) A wage? (**der Lohn**.) A team? (**die Mannschaft**.) A majority? (**die Mehrheit**.) Fashion? (**die Mode**.) Courage? (**der Mut**.) A piece of news? (**die Neuigkeit**.) A number? (**die Nummer**.) The public? (**die Öffentlichkeit**.) Order? (**die Ordnung**.) A couple? (**das Paar**.) A duty? (**die Pflicht**.) Quality? (**die Qualität**.) A speech? (**die Rede**.) A row? (**die Reihe**.) Religion? (**die Religion**.) A role? (**die Rolle**.) Quiet? (**die Ruhe**.) A thing? (**die Sache**.) A shadow? (**der Schatten**.) A step? (**der Schritt**.)

Chapter 238

A difficulty, Safety, Sense, A worry, A voice

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a difficulty, safety, sense, a worry and a voice.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 238: I can say a difficulty, safety, sense, a worry and a voice.

238.1 die Schwierigkeit — a difficulty

Before the new one: say the German for a shadow, shade, then the German for a step.

You'll want to know: die Schwierigkeit

die Schwierigkeit — "a difficulty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Schwierigkeit is *schwierig*, "difficult", + *-keit*, the ending that makes a noun. *schwierig* first meant "full of sores", from Middle High German *swër*, "ulcer".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Schwierigkeit*
- *Say it: die Schwierigkeit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Schwierigkeit*
- *Recall:* say the German for a shadow, shade, then the German for a step, then say *die Schwierigkeit* again

Before you move on

What does die Schwierigkeit mean? ("A difficulty".) Say it once more.

238.2 die Sicherheit — safety, security

Before the new one: say the German for a step, then the German for a difficulty.

You'll want to know: die Sicherheit

die Sicherheit — "safety, security".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Sicherheit is *sicher*, "safe", + *-heit*. *sicher* ← Old High German *sihhur*, from Latin *sēcūrus* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Sicherheit*
- *Say it: die Sicherheit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Sicherheit*
- *Recall:* say the German for a step, then the German for a difficulty, then say *die Sicherheit* again

Before you move on

What does die Sicherheit mean? (“Safety, security”.) Say it once more.

238.3 der Sinn — sense, meaning

Before the new one: say the German for a difficulty, then the German for safety.

You’ll want to know: der Sinn

der Sinn — “sense, meaning”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Sinn ← Middle High German *sin* ← Old High German *sin*, “sense, mind” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Sinn*
- *Say it: der Sinn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Sinn*
- *Recall:* say the German for a difficulty, then the German for safety, then say *der Sinn* again

Before you move on

What does der Sinn mean? (“Sense, meaning”.) Say it once more.

238.4 die Sorge — a worry

Before the new one: say the German for safety, then the German for sense.

You'll want to know: die Sorge

die Sorge — "a worry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Sorge ← Middle High German *sorge* ← Old High German *sorga*, "care, worry" — inherited, the same word as English *sorrow*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Sorge*
- *Say it: die Sorge*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Sorge*
- *Recall:* say the German for safety, then the German for sense, then say *die Sorge* again

Before you move on

What does die Sorge mean? ("A worry".) Say it once more.

238.5 die Stimme — a voice, a vote

Before the new one: say the German for sense, then the German for a worry.

You'll want to know: die Stimme

die Stimme — "a voice, a vote".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Stimme ← Old High German *stimna* — inherited; EtymDB 2.1 lists Old English *stefn*, "voice", beside it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Stimme*
- *Say it: die Stimme*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Stimme*
- *Recall:* say the German for sense, then the German for a worry, then say *die Stimme* again

Before you move on

What does die Stimme mean? ("A voice, a vote".) Say it once more.

Chapter 239

An atmosphere, An argument, University studies, A step, A fact

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an atmosphere, an argument, university studies, a step and a fact.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 239: I can say an atmosphere, an argument, university studies, a step and a fact.

239.1 die Stimmung — an atmosphere, a mood

Before the new one: say the German for a worry, then the German for a voice.

You'll want to know: die Stimmung

die Stimmung — "an atmosphere, a mood".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Stimmung is the verb "to tune", built on *Stimme*, "voice" (EtymDB 2.1), + *-ung*: the key a room or a mood is tuned to.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Stimmung*
- *Say it: die Stimmung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Stimmung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a worry, then the German for a voice, then say *die Stimmung* again

Before you move on

What does die Stimmung mean? ("An atmosphere, a mood".) Say it once more.

239.2 der Streit — an argument

Before the new one: say the German for a voice, then the German for an atmosphere.

You'll want to know: der Streit

der Streit — "an argument".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Streit ← Middle High German *strīt* ← Old High German *strīt*, "quarrel" (EtymDB 2.1) — the noun beside *streiten*, both inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Streit*
- *Say it: der Streit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Streit*
- *Recall:* say the German for a voice, then the German for an atmosphere, then say *der Streit* again

Before you move on

What does der Streit mean? ("An argument".) Say it once more.

239.3 das Studium — university studies

Before the new one: say the German for an atmosphere, then the German for an argument.

You'll want to know: das Studium

das Studium — "university studies".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Studium ← Latin *studium*, "zeal, dedication, study" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Studium*
- *Say it: das Studium*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Studium*
- *Recall:* say the German for an atmosphere, then the German for an argument, then say *das Studium* again

Before you move on

What does das Studium mean? ("University studies".) Say it once more.

239.4 die Stufe — a step, a level

Before the new one: say the German for an argument, then the German for university studies.

You'll want to know: die Stufe

die Stufe — "a step, a level".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Stufe ← Middle High German *stuofe* ← Old High German *stuofa*, "step" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, from the same root as English *step*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Stufe*
- *Say it: die Stufe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Stufe*
- *Recall:* say the German for an argument, then the German for university studies, then say *die Stufe* again

Before you move on

What does die Stufe mean? ("A step, a level".) Say it once more.

239.5 die Tatsache — a fact

Before the new one: say the German for university studies, then the German for a step.

You'll want to know: die Tatsache

die Tatsache — "a fact".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Tatsache ← the word for "deed", Old High German *tāt*, English *deed*, + *Sache*, "matter" (EtymDB 2.1): a German copy of English *matter of fact*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Tatsache*
- *Say it: die Tatsache*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Tatsache*
- *Recall:* say the German for university studies, then the German for a step, then say *die Tatsache* again

Before you move on

What does die Tatsache mean? ("A fact".) Say it once more.

Chapter 240

A topic, A tradition, A dream, A surprise, The surroundings

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a topic, a tradition, a dream, a surprise and the surroundings.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 240: I can say a topic, a tradition, a dream, a surprise and the surroundings.*

240.1 das Thema — a topic

Before the new one: say the German for a step, then the German for a fact.

You'll want to know: das Thema

das Thema — "a topic".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Thema ← Latin *thema* ← Greek *théma*, "what is set down", from *títhēmi*, "to put" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed. English *theme* is the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Thema*
- *Say it: das Thema*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Thema*
- *Recall:* say the German for a step, then the German for a fact, then say *das Thema* again

Before you move on

What does das Thema mean? ("A topic".) Say it once more.

240.2 die Tradition — a tradition

Before the new one: say the German for a fact, then the German for a topic.

You'll want to know: die Tradition

die Tradition — "a tradition".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Tradition ← Latin *trāditiō*, "a handing over" (EtymDB 2.1 has the Latin word) — borrowed: what is handed down.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Tradition*
- *Say it: die Tradition*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Tradition*
- *Recall:* say the German for a fact, then the German for a topic, then say *die Tradition* again

Before you move on

What does die Tradition mean? (“A tradition”.) Say it once more.

240.3 der Traum — a dream

Before the new one: say the German for a topic, then the German for a tradition.

You’ll want to know: der Traum

der Traum — “a dream”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Traum ← Middle High German *troum* (EtymDB 2.1), from Proto-Germanic **draumaz* — inherited, the same word as English *dream*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Traum*
- *Say it: der Traum*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Traum*
- *Recall:* say the German for a topic, then the German for a tradition, then say *der Traum* again

Before you move on

What does der Traum mean? (“A dream”.) Say it once more.

240.4 die Überraschung — a surprise

Before the new one: say the German for a tradition, then the German for a dream.

You'll want to know: die Überraschung

die Überraschung — "a surprise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Überraschung is the noun of a verb built from the word for "over" + the word for "quick, swift" (EtymDB 2.1 links the verb to it): to come over someone quickly.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Überraschung*
- *Say it: die Überraschung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Überraschung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a tradition, then the German for a dream, then say *die Überraschung* again

Before you move on

What does die Überraschung mean? ("A surprise".) Say it once more.

240.5 die Umgebung — the surroundings

Before the new one: say the German for a dream, then the German for a surprise.

You'll want to know: die Umgebung

die Umgebung — "the surroundings".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Umgebung is the noun of a verb built from *um-*, "around", + the verb "to give", English *give*: what surrounds you. EtymDB 2.1 lists

Dutch *omgeving* beside it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Umgebung*
- *Say it: die Umgebung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Umgebung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a dream, then the German for a surprise, then say *die Umgebung* again

Before you move on

What does die Umgebung mean? ("The surroundings".) Say it once more.

Chapter 241

The environment, Lessons, A difference, A cause, Behaviour

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say the environment, lessons, a difference, a cause and behaviour.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 241: I can say the environment, lessons, a difference, a cause and behaviour.*

241.1 die Umwelt — the environment

Before the new one: say the German for a surprise, then the German for the surroundings.

You'll want to know: die Umwelt

die Umwelt — "the environment".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Umwelt is *um-*, "around", + *Welt*, "world": the world around us. *Welt* was first "the age of man". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Umwelt*
- *Say it: die Umwelt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Umwelt*
- *Recall:* say the German for a surprise, then the German for the surroundings, then say *die Umwelt* again

Before you move on

What does die Umwelt mean? ("The environment".) Say it once more.

241.2 der Unterricht — lessons, teaching

Before the new one: say the German for the surroundings, then the German for the environment.

You'll want to know: der Unterricht

der Unterricht — "lessons, teaching".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Unterricht is the noun of a verb built from the word for "under" + the verb "to direct, to set right", Old High German *rihten* (EtymDB 2.1): instruction.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Unterricht*
- *Say it: der Unterricht*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Unterricht*

- *Recall:* say the German for the surroundings, then the German for the environment, then say *der Unterricht* again

Before you move on

What does der Unterricht mean? ("Lessons, teaching".) Say it once more.

241.3 der Unterschied — a difference

Before the new one: say the German for the environment, then the German for lessons.

You'll want to know: der Unterschied

der Unterschied — "a difference".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Unterschied is the word for "under, between" + the verb "to separate", Old High German *sceidan* (EtymDB 2.1): what sets two things apart.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Unterschied*
- *Say it: der Unterschied*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Unterschied*
- *Recall:* say the German for the environment, then the German for lessons, then say *der Unterschied* again

Before you move on

What does der Unterschied mean? ("A difference".) Say it once more.

241.4 die Ursache — a cause

Before the new one: say the German for lessons, then the German for a difference.

You'll want to know: die Ursache

die Ursache — "a cause".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ursache is *ur-*, "original, first", + *Sache*, "matter" ← Old High German *sahha* (EtymDB 2.1): the first matter, the cause.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Ursache*
- *Say it: die Ursache*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Ursache*
- *Recall:* say the German for lessons, then the German for a difference, then say *die Ursache* again

Before you move on

What does die Ursache mean? ("A cause".) Say it once more.

241.5 das Verhalten — behaviour

Before the new one: say the German for a difference, then the German for a cause.

You'll want to know: das Verhalten

das Verhalten — "behaviour".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Verhalten is *ver-* + the verb "to hold", Old High German *haltan*, English *hold* (EtymDB 2.1): how you hold yourself, behaviour.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Verhalten*
- *Say it: das Verhalten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Verhalten*
- *Recall:* say the German for a difference, then the German for a cause, then say *das Verhalten* again

Before you move on

What does das Verhalten mean? ("Behaviour".) Say it once more.

Chapter 242

Traffic, Trust, A club, Caution, An advantage

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say traffic, trust, a club, caution and an advantage.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 242: I can say traffic, trust, a club, caution and an advantage.

242.1 der Verkehr — traffic

Before the new one: say the German for a cause, then the German for behaviour.

You'll want to know: der Verkehr

der Verkehr — "traffic".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Verkehr is *ver-* + the verb "to turn", Old High German *kēran* (EtymDB 2.1): turning to and fro, dealings, then traffic.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Verkehr*
- *Say it: der Verkehr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Verkehr*
- *Recall:* say the German for a cause, then the German for behaviour, then say *der Verkehr* again

Before you move on

What does der Verkehr mean? ("Traffic".) Say it once more.

242.2 das Vertrauen — trust

Before the new one: say the German for behaviour, then the German for traffic.

You'll want to know: das Vertrauen

das Vertrauen — "trust".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Vertrauen is *ver-* + the verb "to trust", Old High German *trūwēn* (EtymDB 2.1), a cousin of English *true* and *trust*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Vertrauen*
- *Say it: das Vertrauen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Vertrauen*
- *Recall:* say the German for behaviour, then the German for traffic, then say *das Vertrauen* again

Before you move on

What does das Vertrauen mean? ("Trust".) Say it once more.

242.3 der Verein — a club, an association

Before the new one: say the German for traffic, then the German for trust.

You'll want to know: der Verein

der Verein — "a club, an association".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Verein is *ver-* + *ein*, "one": people made one, a union. *ein* ← Proto-Germanic **ainaz*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Verein*
- *Say it: der Verein*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Verein*
- *Recall:* say the German for traffic, then the German for trust, then say *der Verein* again

Before you move on

What does der Verein mean? ("A club, an association".) Say it once more.

242.4 die Vorsicht — caution

Before the new one: say the German for trust, then the German for a club.

You'll want to know: die Vorsicht

die Vorsicht — "caution".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Vorsicht is the word for "before" + the word for "sight", from *sehen*: looking ahead. See *vorsichtig*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Vorsicht*
- *Say it: die Vorsicht*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Vorsicht*
- *Recall:* say the German for trust, then the German for a club, then say *die Vorsicht* again

Before you move on

What does die Vorsicht mean? ("Caution".) Say it once more.

242.5 der Vorteil — an advantage

Before the new one: say the German for a club, then the German for caution.

You'll want to know: der Vorteil

der Vorteil — "an advantage".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Vorteil is the word for "before" + the word for "part", Old High German *teil*, English *deal* (EtymDB 2.1): the share taken first. EtymDB lists English *foredeal* beside it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Vorteil*
- *Say it: der Vorteil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Vorteil*
- *Recall:* say the German for a club, then the German for caution, then say *der Vorteil* again

Before you move on

What does der Vorteil mean? ("An advantage".) Say it once more.

Chapter 243

A disadvantage, The truth, Advertising, A competition, A goal

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a disadvantage, the truth, advertising, a competition and a goal.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 243: I can say a disadvantage, the truth, advertising, a competition and a goal.*

243.1 der Nachteil — a disadvantage

> Before the new one: say the German for caution, then the German for an advantage.

You'll want to know: der Nachteil

der Nachteil — "a disadvantage".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Nachteil is the word for "after" + the word for "part", Old High German *teil* ← Proto-Germanic **dailą* (EtymDB 2.1): the share that comes last.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Nachteil*
- *Say it: der Nachteil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Nachteil*
- *Recall:* say the German for caution, then the German for an advantage, then say *der Nachteil* again

Before you move on

What does der Nachteil mean? ("A disadvantage".) Say it once more.

243.2 die Wahrheit — the truth

Before the new one: say the German for an advantage, then the German for a disadvantage.

You'll want to know: die Wahrheit

die Wahrheit — "the truth".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wahrheit ← Middle High German *wārheit* ← Old High German *wārheit* (EtymDB 2.1): the word for "true" + *-heit*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Wahrheit*
- *Say it: die Wahrheit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Wahrheit*
- *Recall:* say the German for an advantage, then the German for a disadvantage, then say *die Wahrheit* again

Before you move on

What does die Wahrheit mean? ("The truth".) Say it once more.

243.3 die Werbung — advertising

Before the new one: say the German for a disadvantage, then the German for the truth.

You'll want to know: die Werbung

die Werbung — "advertising".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Werbung is the verb "to recruit, to woo", Old High German *werban* (EtymDB 2.1), + *-ung*: wooing customers. See *bewerben*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: die Werbung*
- *Say it: die Werbung*, once more
- *Say it:* say *die Werbung*
- *Recall:* say the German for a disadvantage, then the German for the truth, then say *die Werbung* again

Before you move on

What does die Werbung mean? ("Advertising".) Say it once more.

243.4 der Wettbewerb — a competition

Before the new one: say the German for the truth, then the German for advertising.

You'll want to know: der Wettbewerb

der Wettbewerb — "a competition".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Wettbewerb is the word for "a wager", Old High German *wetti*, "pledge" (EtymDB 2.1), + the noun of *bewerben*: competing for a prize.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: der Wettbewerb*
- *Say it: der Wettbewerb*, once more
- *Say it:* say *der Wettbewerb*
- *Recall:* say the German for the truth, then the German for advertising, then say *der Wettbewerb* again

Before you move on

What does der Wettbewerb mean? ("A competition".) Say it once more.

243.5 das Ziel — a goal, a destination

Before the new one: say the German for advertising, then the German for a competition.

You'll want to know: das Ziel

das Ziel — "a goal, a destination".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Ziel ← Old High German *zil* ← Proto-Germanic **tila-*, "goal" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) English *till*, "up to", shares the root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: das Ziel*
- *Say it: das Ziel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *das Ziel*
- *Recall:* say the German for advertising, then the German for a competition, then say *das Ziel* again

Before you move on

What does das Ziel mean? ("A goal, a destination".) Say it once more.

Chapter 244

To offer, To accept, To refuse, To lock, To register

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to offer, to accept, to refuse, to lock and to register.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 244: I can say to offer, to accept, to refuse, to lock and to register.*

244.1 anbieten — to offer

> Before the new one: say the German for a competition, then the German for a goal.

You'll want to know: anbieten

anbieten — "to offer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

anbieten is *an-* + the verb "to offer, to bid", which EtymDB 2.1 lists beside English *bid* and Dutch *bieden*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: anbieten*
- *Say it: anbieten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *anbieten*
- *Recall:* say the German for a competition, then the German for a goal, then say *anbieten* again

Before you move on

What does anbieten mean? ("To offer".) Say it once more.

244.2 annehmen — to accept, to assume

Before the new one: say the German for a goal, then the German for to offer.

You'll want to know: annehmen

annehmen — "to accept, to assume".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

annehmen is *an-* + *nehmen*, "to take" ← Proto-Germanic **nemanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1): to take on, or to take as true.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: annehmen*
- *Say it: annehmen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *annehmen*
- *Recall:* say the German for a goal, then the German for to offer, then say *annehmen* again

Before you move on

What does annehmen mean? ("To accept, to assume".) Say it once more.

244.3 ablehnen — to refuse, to reject

Before the new one: say the German for to offer, then the German for to accept.

You'll want to know: ablehnen

ablehnen — "to refuse, to reject".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ablehnen is *ab-*, "away", + the verb "to lean", which EtymDB 2.1 lists beside English *lean*: to lean away from something.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ablehnen*
- *Say it: ablehnen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ablehnen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to offer, then the German for to accept, then say *ablehnen* again

Before you move on

What does ablehnen mean? ("To refuse, to reject".) Say it once more.

244.4 abschließen — to lock, to complete

Before the new one: say the German for to accept, then the German for to refuse.

You'll want to know: abschließen

abschließen — "to lock, to complete".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

abschließen is *ab-* + *schließen*, "to close, to lock" ← Old High German *sliozan* (EtymDB 2.1): to lock up, or to close a matter off.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *abschließen*
- *Say it:* *abschließen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *abschließen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to accept, then the German for to refuse, then say *abschließen* again

Before you move on

What does abschließen mean? ("To lock, to complete".) Say it once more.

244.5 anmelden — to register

Before the new one: say the German for to refuse, then the German for to lock.

You'll want to know: anmelden

anmelden — "to register".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

anmelden is *an-* + the verb "to report, to announce", Old High German *meldōn* (EtymDB 2.1): to announce yourself.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *anmelden*
- *Say it:* *anmelden*, once more
- *Say it:* say *anmelden*
- *Recall:* say the German for to refuse, then the German for to lock, then say *anmelden* again

Before you move on

What does anmelden mean? ("To register".) Say it once more.

Chapter 245

To pay attention, To spend, To pronounce, To answer, To end

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to pay attention, to spend, to pronounce, to answer and to end.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 245: I can say to pay attention, to spend, to pronounce, to answer and to end.*

245.1 aufpassen — to pay attention, to look after

> Before the new one: say the German for to lock, then the German for to register.

You'll want to know: aufpassen

aufpassen — "to pay attention, to look after".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aufpassen is *auf* + the verb "to fit, to look out", from Dutch *passen* ← French *passer* (EtymDB 2.1): to keep watch.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aufpassen*
- *Say it: aufpassen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aufpassen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to lock, then the German for to register, then say *aufpassen* again

Before you move on

What does aufpassen mean? ("To pay attention, to look after".) Say it once more.

245.2 ausgeben — to spend (money)

Before the new one: say the German for to register, then the German for to pay attention.

You'll want to know: ausgeben

ausgeben — "to spend (money)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ausgeben is *aus-*, "out", + the verb "to give", Old High German *geban* ← Proto-Germanic **gebaną*, English *give* (EtymDB 2.1): to give money out.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ausgeben*
- *Say it: ausgeben*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ausgeben*

- *Recall:* say the German for to register, then the German for to pay attention, then say *ausgeben* again

Before you move on

What does ausgeben mean? (“To spend (money)”.) Say it once more.

245.3 aussprechen — to pronounce

Before the new one: say the German for to pay attention, then the German for to spend.

You’ll want to know: aussprechen

aussprechen — “to pronounce”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aussprechen is *aus-*, “out”, + the verb “to speak”, Old High German *sprehhan* ← Proto-Germanic **sprekanǫ*, English *speak* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aussprechen*
- *Say it: aussprechen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aussprechen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to pay attention, then the German for to spend, then say *aussprechen* again

Before you move on

What does aussprechen mean? (“To pronounce”.) Say it once more.

245.4 beantworten — to answer (a question)

Before the new one: say the German for to spend, then the German for to pronounce.

You'll want to know: beantworten

beantworten — "to answer (a question)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

beantworten is *be-* + *antworten*, "to answer", built on *Antwort*, "counter-word" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *beantworten*
- *Say it:* *beantworten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *beantworten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to spend, then the German for to pronounce, then say *beantworten* again

Before you move on

What does beantworten mean? ("To answer (a question)".) Say it once more.

245.5 beenden — to end, to finish

Before the new one: say the German for to pronounce, then the German for to answer.

You'll want to know: beenden

beenden — "to end, to finish".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

beenden is *be-* + the verb built on *Ende*, "end" ← Proto-Germanic **andijaz*, English *end* (EtymDB 2.1): to bring to an end.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *beenden*
- *Say it:* *beenden*, once more
- *Say it:* say *beenden*
- *Recall:* say the German for to pronounce, then the German for to answer, then say *beenden* again

Before you move on

What does beenden mean? ("To end, to finish".) Say it once more.

Chapter 246

To accompany, To notice, To advise, To report, To visit

Modes: **voice** (6) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 4 of 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to accompany, to notice, to advise, to report and to visit.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 246: I can say to accompany, to notice, to advise, to report and to visit.

246.1 begleiten — to accompany

Before the new one: say the German for to answer, then the German for to end.

You'll want to know: begleiten

begleiten — "to accompany".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

begleiten is *be-* + an older verb "to escort", built on the verb "to lead", Old High German *leiten*, English *lead* (EtymDB 2.1). It is not the verb for "to glide".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: begleiten*
- *Say it: begleiten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *begleiten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to answer, then the German for to end, then say *begleiten* again

Before you move on

What does begleiten mean? ("To accompany".) Say it once more.

246.2 bemerken — to notice

Before the new one: say the German for to end, then the German for to accompany.

You'll want to know: bemerken

bemerken — "to notice".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bemerken is *be-* + the verb "to mark, to notice", Old High German *merchen* (EtymDB 2.1), a cousin of English *mark*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bemerken*
- *Say it: bemerken*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bemerken*
- *Recall:* say the German for to end, then the German for to accompany, then say *bemerken* again

Before you move on

What does bemerken mean? ("To notice".) Say it once more.

246.3 beraten — to advise

Before the new one: say the German for to accompany, then the German for to notice.

You'll want to know: beraten

beraten — "to advise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

beraten is *be-* + the verb "to advise", Old High German *rātan* ← Proto-Germanic **rēdanǫ* (EtymDB 2.1). English *rede*, "counsel", is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *beraten*
- *Say it:* *beraten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *beraten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to accompany, then the German for to notice, then say *beraten* again

Before you move on

What does beraten mean? ("To advise".) Say it once more.

246.4 berichten — to report

Before the new one: say the German for to notice, then the German for to advise.

You'll want to know: berichten

berichten — "to report".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

berichten ← Middle High German *berihten*, "to set in order, to instruct" (EtymDB 2.1): *be-* + the verb "to set right". A report sets the facts in order.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: berichten*
- *Say it: berichten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *berichten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to notice, then the German for to advise, then say *berichten* again

Before you move on

What does berichten mean? ("To report".) Say it once more.

246.5 besichtigen — to visit (sights)

Before the new one: say the German for to advise, then the German for to report.

You'll want to know: besichtigen

besichtigen — "to visit (sights)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

besichtigen is *be-* + the word for "sight", from *sehen*, + *-igen* (EtymDB 2.1 has the verb): to take a careful look at.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: besichtigen*
- *Say it: besichtigen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *besichtigen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to advise, then the German for to report, then say *besichtigen* again

Before you move on

What does besichtigen mean? ("To visit (sights)".) Say it once more.

246.6 Words from chapters 238-241 — a first pass

Say the words for to report and to visit.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a difficulty, safety, sense, a worry, a voice
- an atmosphere, an argument, university studies, a step, a fact
- a topic, a tradition, a dream, a surprise, the surroundings
- the environment, lessons, a difference, a cause, behaviour

Before you move on

A difficulty? (**die Schwierigkeit**.) Safety? (**die Sicherheit**.) Sense? (**der Sinn**.) A worry? (**die Sorge**.) A voice? (**die Stimme**.) An atmosphere? (**die Stimmung**.) An argument? (**der Streit**.) University studies? (**das Studium**.) A step? (**die Stufe**.) A fact? (**die Tatsache**.) A topic? (**das Thema**.) A tradition?

(**die Tradition**.) A dream? (**der Traum**.) A surprise? (**die Überraschung**.) The surroundings? (**die Umgebung**.) The environment? (**die Umwelt**.) Lessons? (**der Unterricht**.) A difference? (**der Unterschied**.) A cause? (**die Ursache**.) Behaviour? (**das Verhalten**.)

246.7 Words from chapters 242-246 — a second pass

Say the words for traffic and trust.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- traffic, trust, a club, caution, an advantage
- a disadvantage, the truth, advertising, a competition, a goal
- to offer, to accept, to refuse, to lock, to register
- to pay attention, to spend, to pronounce, to answer, to end
- to accompany, to notice, to advise, to report, to visit

Before you move on

Traffic? (**der Verkehr**.) Trust? (**das Vertrauen**.) A club? (**der Verein**.) Caution? (**die Vorsicht**.) An advantage? (**der Vorteil**.) A disadvantage? (**der Nachteil**.) The truth? (**die Wahrheit**.) Advertising? (**die Werbung**.) A competition? (**der Wettbewerb**.) A goal? (**das Ziel**.) To offer? (**anbieten**.) To accept? (**annehmen**.) To refuse? (**ablehnen**.) To lock? (**abschließen**.) To register? (**anmelden**.) To pay attention? (**aufpassen**.) To spend? (**ausgeben**.) To pronounce? (**aussprechen**.) To answer? (**beantworten**.) To end? (**beenden**.) To accompany? (**begleiten**.) To notice? (**bemerken**.) To advise? (**beraten**.) To report? (**berichten**.) To visit? (**besichtigen**.)

Chapter 247

To pass, To prove, To bloom, To discuss, To pack

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to pass, to prove, to bloom, to discuss and to pack.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 247: I can say to pass, to prove, to bloom, to discuss and to pack.

247.1 bestehen — to pass (an exam), to insist

Before the new one: say the German for to report, then the German for to visit (sights).

You'll want to know: bestehen

bestehen — "to pass (an exam), to insist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bestehen ← Middle High German *bestān* (EtymDB 2.1): *be-* + *stehen*, "to stand". To pass is to stand the test; to insist is to stand firm.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bestehen*
- *Say it: bestehen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bestehen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to report, then the German for to visit (sights), then say *bestehen* again

Before you move on

What does bestehen mean? ("To pass (an exam), to insist".) Say it once more.

247.2 beweisen — to prove

Before the new one: say the German for to visit (sights), then the German for to pass.

You'll want to know: beweisen

beweisen — "to prove".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

beweisen is *be-* + the verb "to show, to point out" (EtymDB 2.1 has *weisen*): to show that something is so. English *wise* shares the root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: beweisen*
- *Say it: beweisen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *beweisen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to visit (sights), then the German for to pass, then say *beweisen* again

Before you move on

What does beweisen mean? (“To prove”.) Say it once more.

247.3 blühen — to bloom

Before the new one: say the German for to pass, then the German for to prove.

You’ll want to know: blühen

blühen — “to bloom”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

blühen ← Middle High German *blüen* ← Old High German *bluoen* — inherited, the same verb as English *blow* in its old sense “to bloom”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: blühen*
- *Say it: blühen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *blühen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to pass, then the German for to prove, then say *blühen* again

Before you move on

What does blühen mean? (“To bloom”.) Say it once more.

247.4 diskutieren — to discuss

Before the new one: say the German for to prove, then the German for to bloom.

You'll want to know: diskutieren

diskutieren — "to discuss".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

diskutieren comes from Latin *discutere*, "to shake apart, to examine" (EtymDB 2.1 has the related *discutiō*) — borrowed, with the ending *-ieren*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: diskutieren*
- *Say it: diskutieren*, once more
- *Say it:* say *diskutieren*
- *Recall:* say the German for to prove, then the German for to bloom, then say *diskutieren* again

Before you move on

What does diskutieren mean? ("To discuss".) Say it once more.

247.5 einpacken — to pack

Before the new one: say the German for to bloom, then the German for to discuss.

You'll want to know: einpacken

einpacken — "to pack".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

einpacken is *ein-*, "in", + *packen*, "to pack", from Middle Low German *packen* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: einpacken*
- *Say it: einpacken*, once more
- *Say it:* say *einpacken*
- *Recall:* say the German for to bloom, then the German for to discuss, then say *einpacken* again

Before you move on

What does einpacken mean? ("To pack".) Say it once more.

Chapter 248

To furnish, To end, To discover, To excuse, To find out

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to furnish, to end, to discover, to excuse and to find out.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 248: I can say to furnish, to end, to discover, to excuse and to find out.*

248.1 einrichten — to furnish, to set up

> Before the new one: say the German for to discuss, then the German for to pack.

You'll want to know: einrichten

einrichten — "to furnish, to set up".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

einrichten is *ein-*, "in", + the verb "to set right, to arrange", Old High German *rihten* (EtymDB 2.1): to arrange a room, to set something up.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: einrichten*
- *Say it: einrichten*, once more
- *Say it:* say *einrichten*
- *Recall:* say the German for to discuss, then the German for to pack, then say *einrichten* again

Before you move on

What does einrichten mean? ("To furnish, to set up".) Say it once more.

248.2 enden — to end

Before the new one: say the German for to pack, then the German for to furnish.

You'll want to know: enden

enden — "to end".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enden is the verb of *Ende*, "end" ← Old High German *enti* ← Proto-Germanic **andijaz*, English *end*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: enden*
- *Say it: enden*, once more
- *Say it:* say *enden*
- *Recall:* say the German for to pack, then the German for to furnish, then say *enden* again

Before you move on

What does enden mean? (“To end”.) Say it once more.

248.3 entdecken — to discover

Before the new one: say the German for to furnish, then the German for to end.

You’ll want to know: entdecken

entdecken — “to discover”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

entdecken is *ent-*, “off, away”, + the verb “to cover”, Old High German *decchen*, built on the word for “roof”, *Dach* (EtymDB 2.1): to uncover, built like English *discover*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *entdecken*
- *Say it:* *entdecken*, once more
- *Say it:* say *entdecken*
- *Recall:* say the German for to furnish, then the German for to end, then say *entdecken* again

Before you move on

What does entdecken mean? (“To discover”.) Say it once more.

248.4 entschuldigen — to excuse (sich entschuldigen: to apologise)

Before the new one: say the German for to end, then the German for to discover.

You'll want to know: entschuldigen

entschuldigen — "to excuse (sich entschuldigen: to apologise)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

entschuldigen ← Middle High German *entschuldigen* (EtymDB 2.1): *ent-*, "free of", + the word for "guilt, debt": to free someone of guilt.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: entschuldigen*
- *Say it: entschuldigen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *entschuldigen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to end, then the German for to discover, then say *entschuldigen* again

Before you move on

What does entschuldigen mean? ("To excuse (sich entschuldigen: to apologise)".) Say it once more.

248.5 erfahren — to find out, to experience

Before the new one: say the German for to discover, then the German for to excuse.

You'll want to know: erfahren

erfahren — "to find out, to experience".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

erfahren ← Old High German *irfaran*, "to travel through, to explore" (EtymDB 2.1): *er-* + *fahren*. What you find out on the way, you have experienced.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *erfahren*
- *Say it:* *erfahren*, once more
- *Say it:* say *erfahren*
- *Recall:* say the German for to discover, then the German for to excuse, then say *erfahren* again

Before you move on

What does erfahren mean? ("To find out, to experience".) Say it once more.

Chapter 249

To complete, To get done, To appear, To produce, To demand

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to complete, to get done, to appear, to produce and to demand.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 249: I can say to complete, to get done, to appear, to produce and to demand.*

249.1 ergänzen — to complete, to add

> Before the new one: say the German for to excuse, then the German for to find out.

You'll want to know: ergänzen

ergänzen — "to complete, to add".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ergänzen is *er-* + the word for "whole", Old High German *ganz* ← Proto-Germanic **gantaz* (EtymDB 2.1): to make whole.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ergänzen*
- *Say it:* *ergänzen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ergänzen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to excuse, then the German for to find out, then say *ergänzen* again

Before you move on

What does ergänzen mean? ("To complete, to add".) Say it once more.

249.2 erledigen — to get done

Before the new one: say the German for to find out, then the German for to complete.

You'll want to know: erledigen

erledigen — "to get done".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

erledigen is *er-* + *ledig*, "free", + a verb ending: to free yourself of a task. *ledig* ← Proto-Germanic **liþugaz*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *erledigen*
- *Say it:* *erledigen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *erledigen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to find out, then the German for to complete, then say *erledigen* again

Before you move on

What does erledigen mean? (“To get done”.) Say it once more.

249.3 erscheinen — to appear

Before the new one: say the German for to complete, then the German for to get done.

You’ll want to know: erscheinen

erscheinen — “to appear”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

erscheinen is *er-* + the verb “to shine, to seem”, Old High German *skīnan*, the same verb as English *shine* (EtymDB 2.1): to come into view.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: erscheinen*
- *Say it: erscheinen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *erscheinen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to complete, then the German for to get done, then say *erscheinen* again

Before you move on

What does erscheinen mean? (“To appear”.) Say it once more.

249.4 erzeugen — to produce

Before the new one: say the German for to get done, then the German for to appear.

You'll want to know: erzeugen

erzeugen — "to produce".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

erzeugen is *er-* + the verb "to beget, to produce", Middle High German *ziugen* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: erzeugen*
- *Say it: erzeugen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *erzeugen*
- *Recall:* say the German for to get done, then the German for to appear, then say *erzeugen* again

Before you move on

What does erzeugen mean? ("To produce".) Say it once more.

249.5 fordern — to demand

Before the new one: say the German for to appear, then the German for to produce.

You'll want to know: fordern

fordern — "to demand".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fordern ← Old High German *fordarōn* (EtymDB 2.1), built on the word for "further, forward": to call for something to be brought forward. English *further* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fordern*
- *Say it: fordern*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fordern*
- *Recall:* say the German for to appear, then the German for to produce, then say *fordern* again

Before you move on

What does fordern mean? ("To demand".) Say it once more.

Chapter 250

Besides, Therefore, Nevertheless, In any case, Actually

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say besides, therefore, nevertheless, in any case and actually.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 250: I can say besides, therefore, nevertheless, in any case and actually.

250.1 außerdem — besides, moreover

Before the new one: say the German for to produce, then the German for to demand.

You'll want to know: außerdem

außerdem — "besides, moreover".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

außerdem is the word for "besides, outside", built on the word for "out", + *dem*, a form of *der*: "besides that".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: außerdem*
- *Say it: außerdem*, once more
- *Say it:* say *außerdem*
- *Recall:* say the German for to produce, then the German for to demand, then say *außerdem* again

Before you move on

What does außerdem mean? (“Besides, moreover”.) Say it once more.

250.2 deshalb — therefore

Before the new one: say the German for to demand, then the German for besides.

You’ll want to know: deshalb

deshalb — “therefore”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

deshalb is *des*, “of that”, a form of *der*, + *halb*, an old word for “side, behalf” (as in English *behalf*): on that account. *Halb* ← Proto-Germanic **halbaz* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: deshalb*
- *Say it: deshalb*, once more
- *Say it:* say *deshalb*

- *Recall:* say the German for to demand, then the German for besides, then say *deshalb* again

Before you move on

What does deshalb mean? ("Therefore".) Say it once more.

250.3 trotzdem — nevertheless

Before the new one: say the German for besides, then the German for therefore.

You'll want to know: trotzdem

trotzdem — "nevertheless".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

trotzdem is the word for "defiance", Middle High German *traz* (EtymDB 2.1), + *dem*, a form of *der*: in defiance of that.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: trotzdem*
- *Say it: trotzdem*, once more
- *Say it:* say *trotzdem*
- *Recall:* say the German for besides, then the German for therefore, then say *trotzdem* again

Before you move on

What does trotzdem mean? ("Nevertheless".) Say it once more.

250.4 jedenfalls — in any case

Before the new one: say the German for therefore, then the German for nevertheless.

You'll want to know: jedenfalls

jedenfalls — "in any case".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jedenfalls is the word for "every" + the word for "case", from *fallen*, + *-s*: in every case.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jedenfalls*
- *Say it: jedenfalls*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jedenfalls*
- *Recall:* say the German for therefore, then the German for nevertheless, then say *jedenfalls* again

Before you move on

What does jedenfalls mean? ("In any case".) Say it once more.

250.5 eigentlich — actually

Before the new one: say the German for nevertheless, then the German for in any case.

You'll want to know: eigentlich

eigentlich — "actually".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

eigentlich ← Middle High German *eigenlīche* (EtymDB 2.1): the word for "own", Old High German *eigan*, English *own*, + *-lich*: in its own nature, actually.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: eigentlich*
- *Say it: eigentlich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eigentlich*
- *Recall:* say the German for nevertheless, then the German for in any case, then say *eigentlich* again

Before you move on

What does eigentlich mean? ("Actually".) Say it once more.

Chapter 251

By the way, Anyway, At most, At least, During

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say by the way, anyway, at most, at least and during.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 251: I can say by the way, anyway, at most, at least and during.*

251.1 übrigens — by the way

Before the new one: say the German for in any case, then the German for actually.

You'll want to know: übrigens

übrigens — "by the way".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

übrigens is the word for "left over", Middle High German *überec* (EtymDB 2.1), built on the word for "over", + *-ens*: by the way, a leftover remark.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *übrigens*
- *Say it:* *übrigens*, once more
- *Say it:* say *übrigens*
- *Recall:* say the German for in any case, then the German for actually, then say *übrigens* again

Before you move on

What does übrigens mean? ("By the way".) Say it once more.

251.2 sowieso — anyway

Before the new one: say the German for actually, then the German for by the way.

You'll want to know: sowieso

sowieso — "anyway".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sowieso is *so* + *wie* + *so*: "so, however so" — whatever happens, anyway. *So* ← Proto-Germanic **swa* and *wie* ← Old High German *wio* (EtymDB 2.1), both inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sowieso*
- *Say it:* *sowieso*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sowieso*
- *Recall:* say the German for actually, then the German for by the way, then say *sowieso* again

Before you move on

What does sowieso mean? ("Anyway".) Say it once more.

251.3 höchstens — at most

Before the new one: say the German for by the way, then the German for anyway.

You'll want to know: höchstens

höchstens — "at most".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

höchstens is the superlative of *hoch*, "high", + *-ens*: at the highest, at most. *hoch* is the same word as English *high*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: höchstens*
- *Say it: höchstens*, once more
- *Say it:* say *höchstens*
- *Recall:* say the German for by the way, then the German for anyway, then say *höchstens* again

Before you move on

What does höchstens mean? ("At most".) Say it once more.

251.4 mindestens — at least

Before the new one: say the German for anyway, then the German for at most.

You'll want to know: mindestens

mindestens — "at least".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mindestens is the superlative of an old word for "less", a cousin of Latin *minus*, + *-ens*: at the least.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mindestens*
- *Say it: mindestens*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mindestens*
- *Recall:* say the German for anyway, then the German for at most, then say *mindestens* again

Before you move on

What does mindestens mean? ("At least".) Say it once more.

251.5 während — during, while

Before the new one: say the German for at most, then the German for at least.

You'll want to know: während

während — "during, while".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

während is the present participle of the verb "to last, to endure", Middle High German *wëren* (EtymDB 2.1): "lasting", so "while, during".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: während*
- *Say it: während*, once more
- *Say it:* say *während*
- *Recall:* say the German for at most, then the German for at least, then say *während* again

Before you move on

What does während mean? ("During, while".) Say it once more.

251.6 Words from chapters 247-248 — a first pass

Say the words for at least and during.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to pass, to prove, to bloom, to discuss, to pack
- to furnish, to end, to discover, to excuse, to find out

Before you move on

To pass? (**bestehen**.) To prove? (**beweisen**.) To bloom? (**blühen**.) To discuss? (**diskutieren**.) To pack? (**einpacken**.) To furnish? (**einrichten**.) To end? (**enden**.) To discover? (**entdecken**.) To excuse? (**entschuldigen**.) To find out? (**erfahren**.)

251.7 Words from chapters 249-251 — a second pass

Say the words for to complete and to get done.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to complete, to get done, to appear, to produce, to demand
- besides, therefore, nevertheless, in any case, actually
- by the way, anyway, at most, at least, during

Before you move on

To complete? (**ergänzen**.) To get done? (**erledigen**.) To appear? (**erscheinen**.) To produce? (**erzeugen**.) To demand? (**fordern**.) Besides? (**außerdem**.) Therefore? (**deshalb**.) Nevertheless? (**trotzdem**.) In any case? (**jedenfalls**.) Actually? (**eigentlich**.) By the way? (**übrigens**.) Anyway? (**sowieso**.) At most? (**höchstens**.) At least? (**mindestens**.) During? (**während**.)

Pronunciation — a reference, not a chapter

A **reference**, not a chapter. Each lesson names the sounds its word needs; this is where to look them up. German spelling is far more phonetic than French — mostly you say what you see — so this page is short.

Ids (e.g. `ch-ach`) are cited in each lesson's frontmatter `sounds:` field.

Vowels

- `vowel-a-german` — **a** = a clean open *ah* (*Tag*, *Nacht*).
- `vowel-o-german` — **o** = *oh* (*Morgen*).
- `vowel-u-german` — **u** = *oo* as in *food* (*gut* = *goot*).
- **Umlauts** shift the vowel forward: **ä** ≈ *eh*, **ö** ≈ the vowel in *fur*, **ü** = the front-rounded *ee* (same as French *u*). (Later.)
- Doubled vowels are long; a vowel before a doubled consonant is short.

Consonants that differ

- `ch-ach` — **ch** after *a/o/u* = a guttural sound at the back of the throat (Scottish *loch*): *Nacht* = *nahkht*, *Buch* = *bookh*. After *e/i* it's softer (like a strong *h* in *hue*).
- `z-ts` — **z** = *ts* (*zehn* = *tsayn*); **s** before a vowel = *z* (*sagen* = *ZAH-gen*); **ß** = a sharp *ss*.
- `h-pronounced` — **h** at the start of a word **is** pronounced (unlike Spanish/French): *hallo*, *Haus*. After a vowel it just lengthens it (*gehen*).

- `d-t-final` — German **de-voices final consonants**: a final *d* sounds like *t*, final *g* like *k*, final *b* like *p*. *Abend* = *AH-bent*, *Tag* = *tahk*.
- `r-uvular-german` — **r** = a soft guttural at the back of the throat (like French), or lightly rolled in the south. Often barely voiced at the end of a word (*Morgen* ≈ *MOR-gn*).
- **w** = English *v* (*Wasser* = *VAS-ser*); **v** = English *f* (*Vater* = *FAH-ter*); **j** = English *y* (*ja* = *yah*).

The two big habits

- **Every noun is Capitalized** — *Tag*, *Nacht*, *Morgen* — not just names. A spelling rule unique to German among these languages.
- **Final devoicing** (above): what's written *-d/-g/-b* is said *-t/-k/-p*.

The High German Consonant Shift (a decoding tool, not pronunciation)

Not about *saying* words but *recognizing* them: German pushed certain consonants forward, so English and German cousins differ predictably. Learn it and you can guess across the two languages:

- English **d** → German **t**: goo**d** → gu**t**, **d**ay → **T**ag.
- English **t** → German **s / ss / z**: wa**t**er → Wa**ss**er, **t**hat → da**s**, **t**en → **z**ehn.
- English **p** → German **pf / f**: a**pp**le → A**pf**el, shi**p** → Schi**ff**.
- English **k** → German **ch**: ma**k**e → ma**ch**en, boo**k** → Bu**ch**.

(This is a *different* shift from Grimm's Law, which is the older PIE→Germanic change shared by both English and German — see the *Nacht* lesson.)

Glossary

This glossary collects every word and phrase taught in the book. Pronunciation appears when it differs from the written form; chapter numbers show where each entry is introduced.

Abend
evening (der Abend — masculine)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

aber
but — the third joiner, and the first word in the book that sets two thoughts against each other
Introduced in Chapter 48.

abfahren
to depart
Introduced in Chapter 174.

abholen
to pick up, to collect
Introduced in Chapter 174.

ablehnen
to refuse, to reject
Introduced in Chapter 244.

abschließen
to lock, to complete
Introduced in Chapter 244.

acht
eight — the rasp you already own, on a number you already know
Introduced in Chapter 8.

achtzehn
eighteen — the digit whole again, and the -cht you have had since Nacht
Introduced in Chapter 19.

achtzig
eighty
Introduced in Chapter 138.

allein
alone
Introduced in Chapter 173.

alt
old — the adjective the German age sentence is built on
Introduced in Chapter 27.

altmodisch
old-fashioned
Introduced in Chapter 168.

anbieten
to offer
Introduced in Chapter 244.

ändern
to change
Introduced in Chapter 144.

anfangen
to start
Introduced in Chapter 141.

ängstlich
anxious, timid
Introduced in Chapter 211.

ankommen
to arrive
Introduced in Chapter 174.

anmelden
to register
Introduced in Chapter 244.

annehmen
to accept, to assume
Introduced in Chapter 244.

anrufen
to phone
Introduced in Chapter 144.

anstrengend
tiring, demanding
Introduced in Chapter 211.

antworten
to answer
Introduced in Chapter 139.

auf
on, upon — the small word the formal goodbye is built on
Introduced in Chapter 4.

auf Wiedersehen
goodbye, formally — literally "on the seeing-again"
Introduced in Chapter 4.

aufgeregt
excited, nervous
Introduced in Chapter 211.

aufhören
to stop
Introduced in Chapter 144.

aufpassen
to pay attention, to look after
Introduced in Chapter 245.

aufräumen
to tidy up
Introduced in Chapter 174.

ausfüllen
to fill in (a form)
Introduced in Chapter 175.

ausgeben
to spend (money)
Introduced in Chapter 245.

ausgehen
to go out
Introduced in Chapter 144.

ausgezeichnet
excellent
Introduced in Chapter 211.

ausruhen
to rest (sich ausruhen)
Introduced in Chapter 175.

aussehen
to look (like)
Introduced in Chapter 144.

aussprechen
to pronounce
Introduced in Chapter 245.

aussteigen
to get off (a vehicle)
Introduced in Chapter 178.

ausziehen
to take off (clothes), to move out
Introduced in Chapter 174.

außerdem
besides, moreover
Introduced in Chapter 250.

backen
to bake
Introduced in Chapter 175.

baden
to bathe
Introduced in Chapter 175.

bald
soon — and the same word as English bold
Introduced in Chapter 4.

bauen
to build
Introduced in Chapter 175.

beantworten
to answer (a question)
Introduced in Chapter 245.

bedeuten
to mean
Introduced in Chapter 176.

beeilen
to hurry (sich beeilen)
Introduced in Chapter 176.

beenden
to end, to finish
Introduced in Chapter 245.

beginnen
to begin
Introduced in Chapter 139.

begleiten
to accompany
Introduced in Chapter 246.

behalten
to keep
Introduced in Chapter 176.

bekannt
well known
Introduced in Chapter 169.

bemerken
to notice
Introduced in Chapter 246.

benutzen
to use
Introduced in Chapter 145.

bequem
comfortable
Introduced in Chapter 167.

beraten
to advise
Introduced in Chapter 246.

bereit
ready, willing
Introduced in Chapter 134.

berichten
to report
Introduced in Chapter 246.

berufstätig
working, employed
Introduced in Chapter 211.

berühmt
famous
Introduced in Chapter 133.

beschäftigt
busy
Introduced in Chapter 131.

beschreiben
to describe
Introduced in Chapter 176.

besichtigen
to visit (sights)
Introduced in Chapter 246.

besonders
especially
Introduced in Chapter 173.

bestehen
to pass (an exam), to insist
Introduced in Chapter 247.

bestellen
to order (food, a taxi)
Introduced in Chapter 136.

besuchen
to visit
Introduced in Chapter 139.

betreten
to enter, to step on
Introduced in Chapter 176.

beweisen
to prove
Introduced in Chapter 247.

bewerben
to apply (sich bewerben)
Introduced in Chapter 177.

bewölkt
cloudy
Introduced in Chapter 212.

bezahlen
to pay
Introduced in Chapter 65.

biegen
to bend, to turn
Introduced in Chapter 177.

billig
cheap
Introduced in Chapter 90.

bis
until, up to — the preposition every soft German goodbye is built from
Introduced in Chapter 4.

bis bald
see you soon — the first of the bis… family
Introduced in Chapter 4.

bis morgen
see you tomorrow — and the bis… family, complete
Introduced in Chapter 4.

bis später
see you later — the vaguest of the bis… family
Introduced in Chapter 4.

bitte
please — and also “you’re welcome,” “here you go,” and “pardon?”
Introduced in Chapter 3.

bitte
please — place the familiar courtesy word after a small request
Introduced in Chapter 32.

blank
shiny, polished, bare — a German word that is not a colour, and became one abroad
Introduced in Chapter 20.

blau
blue — the fourth colour, and the second German word the Romance languages took
Introduced in Chapter 21.

bleiben
to stay — a verb that takes sein while meaning the exact opposite of change
Introduced in Chapter 29.

blond
blond
Introduced in Chapter 212.

blühen
to bloom
Introduced in Chapter 247.

böse
angry; bad
Introduced in Chapter 133.

braten
to fry, to roast
Introduced in Chapter 177.

brauchen
to need
Introduced in Chapter 67.

braun
brown
Introduced in Chapter 93.

breit
wide
Introduced in Chapter 130.

bringen
to bring
Introduced in Chapter 66.

buchstabieren
to spell
Introduced in Chapter 177.

danach
afterwards
Introduced in Chapter 171.

danke
thank you — which is really "I think of you"
Introduced in Chapter 3.

das Abendessen
dinner
Introduced in Chapter 72.

das Abenteuer
an adventure
Introduced in Chapter 225.

das Angebot
an offer
Introduced in Chapter 158.

das Auge
eye — the third gender back on a body part, and a direct Germanic cousin of English eye
Introduced in Chapter 43.

das Auto
a car
Introduced in Chapter 96.

das Baby
a baby
Introduced in Chapter 164.

das Bad
a bath; a bathroom
Introduced in Chapter 77.

das Bein
a leg
Introduced in Chapter 56.

das Besteck
cutlery
Introduced in Chapter 200.

das Bett
a bed
Introduced in Chapter 77.

das Bier
beer
Introduced in Chapter 75.

das Bild
a picture
Introduced in Chapter 81.

das Blatt
a leaf; a sheet of paper
Introduced in Chapter 82.

das Blut
blood
Introduced in Chapter 57.

das Brot
bread — and the third article, das, which completes the set you were given in chapter one
Introduced in Chapter 17.

das Brötchen
a bread roll
Introduced in Chapter 122.

das Bügeleisen
an iron
Introduced in Chapter 202.

das Büro
an office
Introduced in Chapter 107.

das Dach
a roof
Introduced in Chapter 76.

das Datum
a date
Introduced in Chapter 137.

das Denkmal
a monument
Introduced in Chapter 195.

das Dorf
a village
Introduced in Chapter 97.

das Eis
ice; ice cream
Introduced in Chapter 85.

das Ergebnis
a result
Introduced in Chapter 228.

das Erlebnis
an experience (something lived)
Introduced in Chapter 229.

das Fahrrad
a bicycle
Introduced in Chapter 98.

das Feld
a field
Introduced in Chapter 83.

das Fenster
a window
Introduced in Chapter 76.

das Fest
a celebration, a festival
Introduced in Chapter 129.

das Feuer
fire
Introduced in Chapter 84.

das Fieber
a fever
Introduced in Chapter 59.

das Fleisch
meat
Introduced in Chapter 69.

das Flugzeug
an aeroplane
Introduced in Chapter 96.

das Foto
a photo
Introduced in Chapter 117.

das Frühstück
breakfast
Introduced in Chapter 72.

das Gefühl
a feeling
Introduced in Chapter 229.

das Gegenteil
the opposite
Introduced in Chapter 230.

das Gehalt
a salary
Introduced in Chapter 155.

das Geld
money
Introduced in Chapter 81.

das Gemüse
vegetables
Introduced in Chapter 120.

das Gepäck
luggage
Introduced in Chapter 193.

das Gericht
a court, a dish
Introduced in Chapter 207.

das Geschäft
a shop, a business
Introduced in Chapter 210.

das Geschenk
a present
Introduced in Chapter 117.

das Gesetz
a law
Introduced in Chapter 208.

das Gesicht
the face
Introduced in Chapter 57.

das Gespräch
a conversation
Introduced in Chapter 230.

das Gewicht
weight
Introduced in Chapter 230.

das Gewitter
a thunderstorm
Introduced in Chapter 162.

das Glas
a glass
Introduced in Chapter 79.

das Gleis
a platform, a track
Introduced in Chapter 192.

das Glück
luck, happiness
Introduced in Chapter 165.

das Gras
grass
Introduced in Chapter 199.

das Haar
a hair; hair
Introduced in Chapter 57.

das Hähnchen
a chicken (to eat)
Introduced in Chapter 199.

das Handtuch
a towel
Introduced in Chapter 114.

das Handy
a mobile phone
Introduced in Chapter 116.

das Haus
a house
Introduced in Chapter 161.

das Heft
an exercise book
Introduced in Chapter 80.

das Hemd
a shirt
Introduced in Chapter 98.

das Herz
heart — the last name from the *Hand* table, closing it with the same k-to-h Grimm's law swap already heard on hören and Hund
Introduced in Chapter 44.

das Hobby
a hobby
Introduced in Chapter 231.

das Holz
wood
Introduced in Chapter 204.

das Hotel
a hotel
Introduced in Chapter 104.

das Huhn
a chicken
Introduced in Chapter 69.

das Interesse
an interest
Introduced in Chapter 231.

das Internet
the internet
Introduced in Chapter 159.

Das ist mein Bruder
this is — the phrase that introduces somebody else, using a das that stands for no gender at all
Introduced in Chapter 49.

das Jahr
the year — the span the twelve months add up to, and a word German never borrowed
Introduced in Chapter 15.

das Jahrhundert
a century
Introduced in Chapter 137.

das Kaufhaus
a department store
Introduced in Chapter 210.

das Kino
a cinema
Introduced in Chapter 105.

das Kissen
a cushion, a pillow
Introduced in Chapter 113.

das Kleid
a dress
Introduced in Chapter 99.

das Knie
a knee
Introduced in Chapter 56.

das Konto
a bank account
Introduced in Chapter 157.

das Konzert
a concert
Introduced in Chapter 129.

das Krankenhaus
a hospital
Introduced in Chapter 59.

das Leder
leather
Introduced in Chapter 204.

das Lied
a song
Introduced in Chapter 103.

das Mädchen
a girl
Introduced in Chapter 62.

das Mehl
flour
Introduced in Chapter 122.

das Messer
a knife
Introduced in Chapter 79.

das Metall
metal
Introduced in Chapter 204.

das Mittagessen
lunch
Introduced in Chapter 71.

das Museum
a museum
Introduced in Chapter 104.

das Obst
fruit
Introduced in Chapter 69.

das Ohr
ear — another direct Germanic cousin of its English translation, and the sense hören already named
Introduced in Chapter 43.

das Öl
oil
Introduced in Chapter 71.

das Paar
a couple, a pair
Introduced in Chapter 235.

das Paket
a parcel
Introduced in Chapter 158.

das Papier
paper
Introduced in Chapter 80.

das Pferd
a horse
Introduced in Chapter 85.

das Pflaster
a plaster
Introduced in Chapter 206.

das Portemonnaie
a purse, a wallet
Introduced in Chapter 203.

das Radio
a radio
Introduced in Chapter 162.

das Rathaus
a town hall
Introduced in Chapter 105.

das Regal
a shelf
Introduced in Chapter 113.

das Restaurant
a restaurant
Introduced in Chapter 105.

das Rezept
a prescription, a recipe
Introduced in Chapter 156.

das Rindfleisch
beef
Introduced in Chapter 120.

das Salz
salt
Introduced in Chapter 73.

das Schaf
a sheep
Introduced in Chapter 87.

das Schlafzimmer
a bedroom
Introduced in Chapter 161.

das Schwein
a pig
Introduced in Chapter 86.

das Schwimmbad
a swimming pool
Introduced in Chapter 106.

das Shampoo
shampoo
Introduced in Chapter 202.

das Sofa
a sofa
Introduced in Chapter 162.

das Spiel
a game
Introduced in Chapter 103.

das Stadion
a stadium
Introduced in Chapter 106.

das Studium
university studies
Introduced in Chapter 239.

das Tal
a valley
Introduced in Chapter 196.

das Taxi
a taxi
Introduced in Chapter 111.

das Telefon
a telephone
Introduced in Chapter 82.

das Theater
a theatre
Introduced in Chapter 105.

das Thema
a topic
Introduced in Chapter 240.

das Tier
an animal
Introduced in Chapter 198.

das Trinkgeld
a tip
Introduced in Chapter 200.

das Ufer
a bank, a shore
Introduced in Chapter 196.

das Verhalten
behaviour
Introduced in Chapter 241.

das Vertrauen
trust
Introduced in Chapter 242.

das Visum
a visa
Introduced in Chapter 155.

das Wasser
water — a second das-word, and the w that is said as a v
Introduced in Chapter 17.

das Wetter
the weather
Introduced in Chapter 162.

das Wetter, es regnet
weather — a NATIVE Germanic word, unlike Romance's shared Latin tempus family; Wetter is the SAME word as English "weather," and regnet is the SAME word as English "rain"
Introduced in Chapter 34.

das Wochenende
the weekend
Introduced in Chapter 137.

das Wohnzimmer
a living room
Introduced in Chapter 161.

das Wort
a word
Introduced in Chapter 102.

das Wörterbuch
a dictionary
Introduced in Chapter 160.

das Ziel
a goal, a destination
Introduced in Chapter 243.

das Zimmer
a room
Introduced in Chapter 77.

dein
your — the second of the six, and the same consonant shift that turned *thou* into *du*
Introduced in Chapter 49.

denken
to think — the verb you already met hiding inside danke, and the same inherited word as English think
Introduced in Chapter 37.

denn
for, because — the reason word that leaves the sentence alone, and the same word as dann and English *then*
Introduced in Chapter 48.

der / die / das
the (masculine / feminine / neuter)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

der Abflug
a take-off, a departure (by air)
Introduced in Chapter 192.

der Affe
a monkey
Introduced in Chapter 87.

der Alltag
everyday life
Introduced in Chapter 225.

der Anwalt
a lawyer
Introduced in Chapter 125.

der Anzug
a suit
Introduced in Chapter 202.

der Apfel
an apple
Introduced in Chapter 69.

der April
April — the one month whose Roman name nobody can be sure about
Introduced in Chapter 13.

der Arbeitsplatz
a workplace
Introduced in Chapter 154.

der Arm
arm — named on the *Hand* table and now finally taught, a word Grimm's law never had to touch
Introduced in Chapter 44.

der Arzt
a doctor (a man)
Introduced in Chapter 59.

der Aufzug
a lift
Introduced in Chapter 111.

der August
August — the second and last month named for a man, and the last name the calendar ever gave
Introduced in Chapter 14.

der Ausweis
an identity card
Introduced in Chapter 155.

der Bäcker
a baker
Introduced in Chapter 125.

der Bahnhof
a railway station
Introduced in Chapter 96.

der Balkon
a balcony
Introduced in Chapter 161.

der Bauch
the belly
Introduced in Chapter 57.

der Bauer
a farmer
Introduced in Chapter 125.

der Baum
a tree
Introduced in Chapter 82.

der Berg
a mountain
Introduced in Chapter 82.

der Beruf
a job, a profession
Introduced in Chapter 127.

der Besen
a broom
Introduced in Chapter 115.

der Besuch
a visit
Introduced in Chapter 226.

der Blitz
lightning
Introduced in Chapter 197.

der Boden
the floor; the ground
Introduced in Chapter 78.

der Briefträger
a postman
Introduced in Chapter 126.

der Bruder
brother — the same word as English brother with one vowel of difference
Introduced in Chapter 16.

der Bürger
a citizen
Introduced in Chapter 209.

der Chef
a boss
Introduced in Chapter 126.

der Computer
a computer
Introduced in Chapter 112.

der Dezember
December — decem, ten, the last month and the last of the four numbered ones
Introduced in Chapter 14.

der Dieb
a thief
Introduced in Chapter 207.

der Diebstahl
a theft
Introduced in Chapter 207.

der Dom
a cathedral
Introduced in Chapter 195.

der Donner
thunder — the noun, and the god's name hiding inside it
Introduced in Chapter 10.

der Durst
thirst
Introduced in Chapter 60.

der Eindruck
an impression
Introduced in Chapter 227.

der Eintritt
admission, entry
Introduced in Chapter 227.

der Elefant
an elephant
Introduced in Chapter 88.

der Enkel
a grandson
Introduced in Chapter 63.

der Essig
vinegar
Introduced in Chapter 123.

der Fahrer
a driver
Introduced in Chapter 125.

der Fahrplan
a timetable
Introduced in Chapter 193.

der Februar
February — the one month named for a ritual rather than a person or a god
Introduced in Chapter 13.

der Fehler
a mistake
Introduced in Chapter 160.

der Fernseher
a television
Introduced in Chapter 112.

der Film
a film
Introduced in Chapter 129.

der Finger
finger — identical to its English cousin, and possibly, though not certainly, built on the word for "five"
Introduced in Chapter 44.

der Fisch
a fish
Introduced in Chapter 69.

der Flughafen
an airport
Introduced in Chapter 104.

der Freund
friend — a Germanic cousin of English friend, both frozen out of the same old verb meaning "to love"
Introduced in Chapter 42.

der Frühling
spring — früh plus -ling, "the early one", a season German named rather than borrowed
Introduced in Chapter 15.

der Fuchs
a fox
Introduced in Chapter 86.

der Fuß
foot — the fourth name from the *Hand* table, and the same p-to-f Grimm's law pattern Vater already taught
Introduced in Chapter 44.

der Fußball
football
Introduced in Chapter 129.

der Garten
a garden
Introduced in Chapter 77.

der Gast
a guest
Introduced in Chapter 63.

der Geburtstag
a birthday
Introduced in Chapter 163.

der Großvater
a grandfather
Introduced in Chapter 61.

der Grund
a reason
Introduced in Chapter 166.

der Gürtel
a belt
Introduced in Chapter 100.

der Hafen
a harbour
Introduced in Chapter 196.

der Hals
the neck; the throat
Introduced in Chapter 56.

der Hase
a hare
Introduced in Chapter 198.

der Herbst
autumn — and the word is one English still has, doing a different job
Introduced in Chapter 15.

der Herd
a cooker
Introduced in Chapter 112.

der Himmel
the sky; heaven
Introduced in Chapter 83.

der Honig
honey
Introduced in Chapter 71.

der Hügel
a hill
Introduced in Chapter 85.

der Humor
humour
Introduced in Chapter 231.

der Hunger
hunger
Introduced in Chapter 60.

der Husten
a cough
Introduced in Chapter 156.

der Ingenieur
an engineer
Introduced in Chapter 125.

der Januar
January — Janus, the god of doorways, which is what a first month is
Introduced in Chapter 13.

der Joghurt
a yoghurt
Introduced in Chapter 124.

der Juli
July — the first month in the year named after a man, and he named it himself
Introduced in Chapter 14.

der Juni
June — Juno, queen of the gods, and a j that sounds like Januar's
Introduced in Chapter 13.

der Kaffee
coffee — a loanword that crossed from Arabic to German by way of Turkish and Italian, and the first word in a new polite request
Introduced in Chapter 41.

der Kalender
a calendar
Introduced in Chapter 118.

der Kamm
a comb
Introduced in Chapter 115.

der Käse
cheese
Introduced in Chapter 73.

der Keks
a biscuit
Introduced in Chapter 122.

der Keller
a cellar
Introduced in Chapter 161.

der Kellner
a waiter
Introduced in Chapter 126.

der Knoblauch
garlic
Introduced in Chapter 122.

der Knochen
a bone
Introduced in Chapter 205.

der Koch
a cook
Introduced in Chapter 124.

der Koffer
a suitcase
Introduced in Chapter 111.

der Kollege
a colleague (man)
Introduced in Chapter 154.

der Kopf
the head — masculine, capitalised, with final pf
Introduced in Chapter 30.

der Körper
the body
Introduced in Chapter 204.

der Krankenwagen
an ambulance
Introduced in Chapter 207.

der Kuchen
a cake
Introduced in Chapter 71.

der Kühlschrank
a fridge
Introduced in Chapter 112.

der Kunde
a customer
Introduced in Chapter 126.

der Kunststoff
plastic
Introduced in Chapter 204.

der Kurs
a course
Introduced in Chapter 160.

der Laden
a shop
Introduced in Chapter 96.

der Lärm
noise
Introduced in Chapter 233.

der Lebenslauf
a CV
Introduced in Chapter 233.

der Lenz
spring, the old poetic word — worth recognising, not worth saying
Introduced in Chapter 15.

der Löffel
a spoon
Introduced in Chapter 80.

der Lohn
a wage
Introduced in Chapter 234.

der Löwe
a lion
Introduced in Chapter 87.

der Magen
the stomach
Introduced in Chapter 58.

der Mai
May — Maia, a goddess of growth, and the shortest month name German has
Introduced in Chapter 13.

der Mantel
a coat
Introduced in Chapter 119.

der Markt
a market
Introduced in Chapter 96.

der Marktplatz
a market square
Introduced in Chapter 194.

der März
March — Mars's month, and once the first month of the whole Roman year
Introduced in Chapter 13.

der Mensch
a human being
Introduced in Chapter 164.

der Mittag
noon — Mitte plus Tag, a compound you can read before you are told it
Introduced in Chapter 12.

der Monat
the month — and the word itself is the moon, before Rome supplied the names to put in it
Introduced in Chapter 13.

der Mond
the moon — the noun the first weekday is built on, and English's own word untouched
Introduced in Chapter 10.

der Mülleimer
a bin
Introduced in Chapter 115.

der Mund
mouth — the same inherited word as English mouth, with a root the standard accounts do not agree on past Proto-Germanic
Introduced in Chapter 43.

der Mut
courage
Introduced in Chapter 234.

der Nachbar
a neighbour
Introduced in Chapter 63.

der Nachmittag
the afternoon
Introduced in Chapter 166.

der Nachteil
a disadvantage
Introduced in Chapter 243.

der Nachtisch
a dessert
Introduced in Chapter 123.

der Nebel
fog
Introduced in Chapter 197.

der Norden
the north
Introduced in Chapter 108.

der Notfall
an emergency
Introduced in Chapter 206.

der November
November — novem, nine, and a word German and English spell identically
Introduced in Chapter 14.

der Ofen
an oven
Introduced in Chapter 201.

der Oktober
October — octo, eight, and German spells the Latin c as a k because German spells that sound with a k
Introduced in Chapter 14.

der Onkel
an uncle
Introduced in Chapter 62.

der Osten
the east
Introduced in Chapter 108.

der Parkplatz
a car park
Introduced in Chapter 107.

der Pfeffer
pepper
Introduced in Chapter 75.

der Pilz
a mushroom
Introduced in Chapter 120.

der Platz
a square; a seat
Introduced in Chapter 104.

der Polizist
a police officer
Introduced in Chapter 124.

der Preis
a price, a prize
Introduced in Chapter 157.

der Pullover
a jumper
Introduced in Chapter 118.

der Radiergummi
a rubber, an eraser
Introduced in Chapter 127.

der Regen
rain
Introduced in Chapter 84.

der Regenschirm
an umbrella
Introduced in Chapter 116.

der Reis
rice
Introduced in Chapter 72.

der Ring
a ring
Introduced in Chapter 117.

der Rock
a skirt
Introduced in Chapter 119.

der Rücken
the back (of the body)
Introduced in Chapter 58.

der Rucksack
a rucksack
Introduced in Chapter 194.

der Sabbat
the Sabbath — the only word in the week that is neither Germanic nor Latin
Introduced in Chapter 11.

der Saft
juice
Introduced in Chapter 74.

der Salat
a salad; lettuce
Introduced in Chapter 74.

der Satz
a sentence
Introduced in Chapter 128.

der Schal
a scarf
Introduced in Chapter 119.

der Schatten
a shadow, shade
Introduced in Chapter 237.

der Schinken
ham
Introduced in Chapter 74.

der Schmerz
a pain
Introduced in Chapter 156.

der Schmetterling
a butterfly
Introduced in Chapter 198.

der Schrank
a cupboard
Introduced in Chapter 78.

der Schritt
a step
Introduced in Chapter 237.

der Schuh
a shoe
Introduced in Chapter 99.

der Schüler
a pupil (a boy)
Introduced in Chapter 63.

der September
September — the seventh month, which is now the ninth, and the name never caught up
Introduced in Chapter 14.

der Sessel
an armchair
Introduced in Chapter 115.

der Sinn
sense, meaning
Introduced in Chapter 238.

der Sohn
a son
Introduced in Chapter 61.

der Sommer
summer — the season whose German and English names are the same word, barely disguised
Introduced in Chapter 15.

der Spaß
fun
Introduced in Chapter 165.

der Spiegel
a mirror
Introduced in Chapter 78.

der Sport
sport
Introduced in Chapter 129.

der Staat
a state
Introduced in Chapter 208.

der Stadtplan
a city map
Introduced in Chapter 194.

der Stau
a traffic jam
Introduced in Chapter 155.

der Staubsauger
a vacuum cleaner
Introduced in Chapter 202.

der Stein
a stone
Introduced in Chapter 83.

der Stern
a star
Introduced in Chapter 84.

der Stift
a pen, a pencil
Introduced in Chapter 80.

der Stoff
material, fabric
Introduced in Chapter 203.

der Strand
a beach
Introduced in Chapter 196.

der Streit
an argument
Introduced in Chapter 239.

der Stuhl
a chair
Introduced in Chapter 76.

der Süden
the south
Introduced in Chapter 108.

der Supermarkt
a supermarket
Introduced in Chapter 106.

der Tee
tea — a word that looks like its English cousin and is not said like it, and travelled to Europe by sea rather than overland
Introduced in Chapter 41.

der Teich
a pond
Introduced in Chapter 84.

der Teller
a plate
Introduced in Chapter 79.

der Teppich
a rug, a carpet
Introduced in Chapter 112.

der Termin
an appointment
Introduced in Chapter 143.

der Tisch
a table
Introduced in Chapter 76.

der Topf
a pot
Introduced in Chapter 201.

der Traum
a dream
Introduced in Chapter 240.

der Turm
a tower
Introduced in Chapter 195.

der Unfall
an accident
Introduced in Chapter 155.

der Unterricht
lessons, teaching
Introduced in Chapter 241.

der Unterschied
a difference
Introduced in Chapter 241.

der Urlaub
a holiday
Introduced in Chapter 103.

der Vater
father — spelled with a V and said with an f, which is the whole chapter in one letter
Introduced in Chapter 16.

der Verein
a club, an association
Introduced in Chapter 242.

der Verkäufer
a shop assistant
Introduced in Chapter 124.

der Verkehr
traffic
Introduced in Chapter 242.

der Vogel
a bird
Introduced in Chapter 86.

der Vorhang
a curtain
Introduced in Chapter 113.

der Vorteil
an advantage
Introduced in Chapter 242.

der Wald
a forest
Introduced in Chapter 83.

der Wecker
an alarm clock
Introduced in Chapter 116.

der Wein
wine — a der-word, and the one thing on this table Rome supplied
Introduced in Chapter 17.

der Westen
the west
Introduced in Chapter 108.

der Wettbewerb
a competition
Introduced in Chapter 243.

der Wind
the wind
Introduced in Chapter 162.

der Winter
winter — spelled exactly as in English, and the fourth of the four
Introduced in Chapter 15.

der Wunsch
a wish
Introduced in Chapter 136.

der Zahn
a tooth
Introduced in Chapter 56.

der Zahnarzt
a dentist
Introduced in Chapter 205.

der Zucker
sugar
Introduced in Chapter 73.

deshalb
therefore
Introduced in Chapter 250.

Deutsch
German, the language — and it means "of the people"
Introduced in Chapter 5.

dich
you, as the one it happens to — the partner of mich, and English *thee* one more time
Introduced in Chapter 50.

dick
thick; fat
Introduced in Chapter 92.

die (plural)
the — the one plural article German uses for every gender
Introduced in Chapter 1.

die Abfahrt
a departure
Introduced in Chapter 192.

die Adresse
an address
Introduced in Chapter 159.

die Ahnung
an idea, a notion (keine Ahnung: no idea)
Introduced in Chapter 225.

die Ameise
an ant
Introduced in Chapter 88.

die Ampel
traffic lights
Introduced in Chapter 107.

die Angst
fear
Introduced in Chapter 61.

die Ankunft
an arrival
Introduced in Chapter 192.

die Antwort
an answer
Introduced in Chapter 102.

die Anzeige
an advert
Introduced in Chapter 143.

die Apotheke
a pharmacy
Introduced in Chapter 97.

die Arbeit
work
Introduced in Chapter 102.

die Ärztin
a doctor (a woman)
Introduced in Chapter 59.

die Aufgabe
a task, an exercise
Introduced in Chapter 160.

die Ausbildung
training, an apprenticeship
Introduced in Chapter 225.

die Aussprache
pronunciation
Introduced in Chapter 226.

die Ausstellung
an exhibition
Introduced in Chapter 225.

die Bäckerei
a bakery
Introduced in Chapter 105.

die Badewanne
a bathtub
Introduced in Chapter 113.

die Banane
a banana
Introduced in Chapter 70.

die Bedeutung
a meaning
Introduced in Chapter 226.

die Begrüßung
a greeting, a welcome
Introduced in Chapter 226.

die Beschreibung
a description
Introduced in Chapter 226.

die Bestellung
an order
Introduced in Chapter 200.

die Bevölkerung
the population
Introduced in Chapter 208.

die Bewerbung
an application
Introduced in Chapter 227.

die Beziehung
a relationship
Introduced in Chapter 227.

die Bibliothek
a library
Introduced in Chapter 98.

die Biene
a bee
Introduced in Chapter 88.

die Birne
a pear
Introduced in Chapter 72.

die Blume
a flower
Introduced in Chapter 82.

die Bluse
a blouse
Introduced in Chapter 120.

die Bohnen
beans
Introduced in Chapter 121.

die Briefmarke
a stamp
Introduced in Chapter 158.

die Brille
glasses
Introduced in Chapter 116.

die Brücke
a bridge
Introduced in Chapter 97.

die Burg
a castle
Introduced in Chapter 195.

die Bürste
a brush
Introduced in Chapter 202.

die Butter
butter
Introduced in Chapter 123.

die Cousine
a cousin (woman)
Introduced in Chapter 164.

die Decke
a blanket; a ceiling
Introduced in Chapter 114.

die Dose
a tin, a can
Introduced in Chapter 201.

die Dusche
a shower
Introduced in Chapter 113.

die E-Mail
an email
Introduced in Chapter 159.

die Ecke
a corner
Introduced in Chapter 107.

die Einladung
an invitation
Introduced in Chapter 163.

die Eintrittskarte
an admission ticket
Introduced in Chapter 227.

die Eltern
parents — a plural with no singular, and underneath it a comparative meaning "the older ones"
Introduced in Chapter 16.

die Enkelin
a granddaughter
Introduced in Chapter 164.

die Ente
a duck
Introduced in Chapter 87.

die Entscheidung
a decision
Introduced in Chapter 228.

die Erdbeere
a strawberry
Introduced in Chapter 121.

die Erfahrung
experience
Introduced in Chapter 166.

die Erinnerung
a memory, a reminder
Introduced in Chapter 228.

die Erkältung
a cold
Introduced in Chapter 156.

die Erklärung
an explanation
Introduced in Chapter 228.

die Erlaubnis
permission
Introduced in Chapter 228.

die Fabrik
a factory
Introduced in Chapter 106.

die Fahrkarte
a ticket
Introduced in Chapter 111.

die Familie
family — the whole group the Eltern and Geschwister already named the members of, and this chapter's one Latin loan beside two native words
Introduced in Chapter 42.

die Farbe
a colour
Introduced in Chapter 103.

die Feuerwehr
the fire brigade
Introduced in Chapter 207.

die Firma
a company
Introduced in Chapter 154.

die Flasche
a bottle
Introduced in Chapter 80.

die Fliege
a fly
Introduced in Chapter 198.

die Frau
a woman; a wife
Introduced in Chapter 62.

die Freude
joy
Introduced in Chapter 61.

die Freundin
friend (female) — built on Freund with the native feminine suffix -in, the same suffix English kept in exactly one fossil word, vixen
Introduced in Chapter 42.

die Frucht
a fruit
Introduced in Chapter 199.

die Führung
a guided tour, leadership
Introduced in Chapter 229.

die Fußgängerzone
a pedestrian zone
Introduced in Chapter 195.

die Gabel
a fork
Introduced in Chapter 79.

die Gebühr
a fee
Introduced in Chapter 229.

die Gegend
an area, a region
Introduced in Chapter 229.

die Geldbörse
a purse, a wallet
Introduced in Chapter 117.

die Geschichte
a story, history
Introduced in Chapter 230.

die Geschwister
siblings — one word for brothers and sisters together, which English has to say in three
Introduced in Chapter 16.

die Gewohnheit
a habit
Introduced in Chapter 230.

die Grenze
a border
Introduced in Chapter 100.

die Grippe
the flu
Introduced in Chapter 156.

die Größe
a size
Introduced in Chapter 203.

die Großmutter
a grandmother
Introduced in Chapter 62.

die Gurke
a cucumber
Introduced in Chapter 121.

die Haltestelle
a bus or tram stop
Introduced in Chapter 98.

die Hand
the hand — the same word as English, and unrelated to Romance manus
Introduced in Chapter 30.

die Handschuhe
gloves
Introduced in Chapter 118.

die Hausaufgabe
homework
Introduced in Chapter 128.

die Haut
skin
Introduced in Chapter 57.

die Hitze
heat
Introduced in Chapter 197.

die Hochzeit
a wedding
Introduced in Chapter 163.

die Hoffnung
hope
Introduced in Chapter 231.

die Hose
trousers
Introduced in Chapter 99.

die Idee
an idea
Introduced in Chapter 128.

die Industrie
industry
Introduced in Chapter 210.

die Insel
an island
Introduced in Chapter 83.

die Jacke
a jacket
Introduced in Chapter 100.

die Jahre
the plural of das Jahr, which is the form the age sentence needs and the only form it uses
Introduced in Chapter 27.

die Jahreszeit
season — literally year-time, a compound you can now read without being told
Introduced in Chapter 15.

die Jugend
youth
Introduced in Chapter 231.

die Jugendherberge
a youth hostel
Introduced in Chapter 193.

die Kälte
cold
Introduced in Chapter 197.

die Kamera
a camera
Introduced in Chapter 116.

die Karotte
a carrot
Introduced in Chapter 199.

die Karte
a card; a map; a ticket
Introduced in Chapter 81.

die Kartoffel
a potato
Introduced in Chapter 70.

die Kasse
a till, a checkout
Introduced in Chapter 126.

die Kellnerin
a waitress
Introduced in Chapter 200.

die Kenntnis
knowledge (of something)
Introduced in Chapter 232.

die Kerze
a candle
Introduced in Chapter 118.

die Kette
a chain; a necklace
Introduced in Chapter 117.

die Kindheit
childhood
Introduced in Chapter 232.

die Kirche
a church
Introduced in Chapter 97.

die Kirsche
a cherry
Introduced in Chapter 121.

die Klasse
a class
Introduced in Chapter 127.

die Kleidung
clothes
Introduced in Chapter 98.

die Kollegin
a colleague (woman)
Introduced in Chapter 154.

die Krankenschwester
a nurse
Introduced in Chapter 124.

die Krawatte
a tie
Introduced in Chapter 118.

die Kreditkarte
a credit card
Introduced in Chapter 157.

die Kreuzung
a crossroads
Introduced in Chapter 107.

die Kuh
a cow
Introduced in Chapter 85.

die Kultur
culture
Introduced in Chapter 232.

die Kunst
art
Introduced in Chapter 232.

die Küste
a coast
Introduced in Chapter 197.

die Lampe
a lamp
Introduced in Chapter 77.

die Landschaft
a landscape
Introduced in Chapter 232.

die Laune
a mood
Introduced in Chapter 233.

die Leistung
an achievement, performance
Introduced in Chapter 233.

die Lektion
a lesson (in a textbook)
Introduced in Chapter 233.

die Leute
people
Introduced in Chapter 165.

die Lippe
a lip
Introduced in Chapter 58.

die Lösung
a solution
Introduced in Chapter 166.

die Lust
desire (Lust haben: to feel like)
Introduced in Chapter 165.

die Mahlzeit
a meal
Introduced in Chapter 123.

die Mannschaft
a team
Introduced in Chapter 234.

die Marmelade
jam
Introduced in Chapter 73.

die Maus
a mouse
Introduced in Chapter 86.

die Mehrheit
a majority
Introduced in Chapter 234.

die Meinung
an opinion
Introduced in Chapter 165.

die Melone
a melon
Introduced in Chapter 121.

die Metzgerei
a butcher's
Introduced in Chapter 210.

die Miete
the rent
Introduced in Chapter 143.

die Milch
milk — the native Germanic word that closes this trio, standing beside two loanwords the way Wasser once stood beside the loanword Wein
Introduced in Chapter 41.

die Million
a million
Introduced in Chapter 138.

die Mitte
the middle — the native piece both of the day's pivots are built from
Introduced in Chapter 12.

die Mitternacht
midnight — the second pivot, and the -cht/-ght pair paying off again
Introduced in Chapter 12.

die Mode
fashion
Introduced in Chapter 234.

die Möglichkeit
a possibility
Introduced in Chapter 166.

die Möhre
a carrot
Introduced in Chapter 70.

die Musik
music
Introduced in Chapter 102.

die Mutter
mother — a die-word, and the one family word whose first sound nothing ever touched
Introduced in Chapter 16.

die Mütze
a cap, a woollen hat
Introduced in Chapter 99.

die Nachbarin
a neighbour (woman)
Introduced in Chapter 164.

die Nachricht
a message, the news
Introduced in Chapter 159.

die Nase
nose — the fourth face-part, cousin of English nose and of Latin nasus, and the payoff that completes the face *Kopf* only started
Introduced in Chapter 43.

die Neuigkeit
a piece of news
Introduced in Chapter 235.

die Nudeln
noodles, pasta
Introduced in Chapter 74.

die Nummer
a number
Introduced in Chapter 235.

die Nuss
a nut
Introduced in Chapter 75.

die Öffentlichkeit
the public
Introduced in Chapter 235.

die Öffnungszeiten
opening hours
Introduced in Chapter 143.

die Ordnung
order, tidiness
Introduced in Chapter 235.

die Partei
a party (political)
Introduced in Chapter 209.

die Party
a party
Introduced in Chapter 163.

die Pfanne
a frying pan
Introduced in Chapter 201.

die Pflanze
a plant
Introduced in Chapter 198.

die Pflicht
a duty
Introduced in Chapter 236.

die Politik
politics
Introduced in Chapter 209.

die Polizei
the police
Introduced in Chapter 97.

die Post
the post office; the post
Introduced in Chapter 104.

die Prüfung
an exam
Introduced in Chapter 127.

die Qualität
quality
Introduced in Chapter 236.

die Quittung
a receipt
Introduced in Chapter 143.

die Rechnung
a bill
Introduced in Chapter 158.

die Rede
a speech
Introduced in Chapter 236.

die Regierung
the government
Introduced in Chapter 208.

die Reihe
a row, a turn
Introduced in Chapter 236.

die Reise
a journey
Introduced in Chapter 103.

die Religion
religion
Introduced in Chapter 236.

die Rolle
a role
Introduced in Chapter 237.

die Rückfahrt
a return journey
Introduced in Chapter 193.

die Ruhe
quiet, calm
Introduced in Chapter 237.

die Rundfahrt
a round trip, a tour
Introduced in Chapter 194.

die Sache
a thing, a matter
Introduced in Chapter 237.

die Sahne
cream
Introduced in Chapter 75.

die Salbe
an ointment
Introduced in Chapter 206.

die Schlange
a snake; a queue
Introduced in Chapter 86.

die Schokolade
chocolate
Introduced in Chapter 122.

die Schuhe
shoes
Introduced in Chapter 119.

die Schule
a school
Introduced in Chapter 81.

die Schülerin
a pupil (a girl)
Introduced in Chapter 63.

die Schulter
a shoulder
Introduced in Chapter 56.

die Schwester
sister — and once you strip the sch back to an s it is the English word
Introduced in Chapter 16.

die Schwierigkeit
a difficulty
Introduced in Chapter 238.

die Sehenswürdigkeit
a sight (worth seeing)
Introduced in Chapter 194.

die Seide
silk
Introduced in Chapter 203.

die Seife
soap
Introduced in Chapter 114.

die Seite
a page; a side
Introduced in Chapter 128.

die Sekunde
a second (of time)
Introduced in Chapter 94.

die Sicherheit
safety, security
Introduced in Chapter 238.

die Socke
a sock
Introduced in Chapter 99.

die Socken
socks
Introduced in Chapter 120.

die Sonne
the sun — the noun behind Sunday, and a die-word where English has no gender at all
Introduced in Chapter 11.

die Sorge
a worry
Introduced in Chapter 238.

die Soße
a sauce
Introduced in Chapter 123.

die Speisekarte
a menu
Introduced in Chapter 200.

die Sprache
a language
Introduced in Chapter 100.

die Sprechstunde
surgery hours, office hours
Introduced in Chapter 205.

die Spritze
an injection
Introduced in Chapter 206.

die Spülmaschine
a dishwasher
Introduced in Chapter 201.

die Stelle
a job, a position
Introduced in Chapter 154.

die Stiefel
boots
Introduced in Chapter 119.

die Stimme
a voice, a vote
Introduced in Chapter 238.

die Stimmung
an atmosphere, a mood
Introduced in Chapter 239.

die Strafe
a punishment, a fine
Introduced in Chapter 208.

die Straßenbahn
a tram
Introduced in Chapter 110.

die Stufe
a step, a level
Introduced in Chapter 239.

die Stunde
an hour's span — the native word that survived beside the borrowed one, with the jobs divided
Introduced in Chapter 12.

die Suppe
a soup
Introduced in Chapter 71.

die Tablette
a tablet
Introduced in Chapter 157.

die Tafel
a board
Introduced in Chapter 127.

die Tankstelle
a petrol station
Introduced in Chapter 106.

die Tante
an aunt
Introduced in Chapter 62.

die Tasche
a bag; a pocket
Introduced in Chapter 81.

die Tasse
a cup
Introduced in Chapter 79.

die Tatsache
a fact
Introduced in Chapter 239.

die Telefonnummer
a phone number
Introduced in Chapter 159.

die Temperatur
the temperature
Introduced in Chapter 163.

die Tochter
a daughter
Introduced in Chapter 61.

die Tomate
a tomato
Introduced in Chapter 70.

die Torte
a gateau, a layer cake
Introduced in Chapter 199.

die Tradition
a tradition
Introduced in Chapter 240.

die Traube
a grape
Introduced in Chapter 73.

die Treppe
the stairs
Introduced in Chapter 78.

die Tüte
a bag (paper or plastic)
Introduced in Chapter 158.

die U-Bahn
the underground
Introduced in Chapter 110.

die Überraschung
a surprise
Introduced in Chapter 240.

die Uhr
the clock, and o'clock — the first everyday German word in this book that Rome supplied
Introduced in Chapter 12.

die Umgebung
the surroundings
Introduced in Chapter 240.

die Umwelt
the environment
Introduced in Chapter 241.

die Universität
a university
Introduced in Chapter 160.

die Unterkunft
accommodation
Introduced in Chapter 193.

die Untersuchung
an examination
Introduced in Chapter 205.

die Ursache
a cause
Introduced in Chapter 241.

die Verletzung
an injury
Introduced in Chapter 205.

die Versicherung
insurance
Introduced in Chapter 157.

die Verspätung
a delay
Introduced in Chapter 192.

die Vorsicht
caution
Introduced in Chapter 242.

die Wahl
an election, a choice
Introduced in Chapter 209.

die Wahrheit
the truth
Introduced in Chapter 243.

die Wand
a wall
Introduced in Chapter 76.

die Waschmaschine
a washing machine
Introduced in Chapter 115.

die Welt
the world
Introduced in Chapter 100.

die Werbung
advertising
Introduced in Chapter 243.

die Werkstatt
a workshop, a garage
Introduced in Chapter 210.

die Wiese
a meadow
Introduced in Chapter 196.

die Wirtschaft
the economy
Introduced in Chapter 209.

die Wohnung
a flat, an apartment
Introduced in Chapter 78.

die Wolke
a cloud
Introduced in Chapter 84.

die Wolle
wool
Introduced in Chapter 203.

die Wunde
a wound
Introduced in Chapter 206.

die Wurst
a sausage
Introduced in Chapter 74.

die Wüste
a desert
Introduced in Chapter 85.

die Zahnbürste
a toothbrush
Introduced in Chapter 114.

die Zahnpasta
toothpaste
Introduced in Chapter 114.

die Zehe
a toe
Introduced in Chapter 58.

die Zeichnung
a drawing
Introduced in Chapter 128.

die Zeit
time — a Germanic word with no Latin in it at all, and the second half of the word for season
Introduced in Chapter 15.

die Ziege
a goat
Introduced in Chapter 87.

die Zitrone
a lemon
Introduced in Chapter 72.

die Zukunft
the future
Introduced in Chapter 142.

die Zunge
the tongue
Introduced in Chapter 58.

die Zwiebel
an onion
Introduced in Chapter 70.

Dienstag
Tuesday — named for a war-god both languages kept, under two different names
Introduced in Chapter 10.

dir
to you — the informal partner of mir
Introduced in Chapter 3.

diskutieren
to discuss
Introduced in Chapter 247.

Donnerstag
Thursday — the thunder-god's day, and the same god-slot under three names
Introduced in Chapter 10.

dort
there
Introduced in Chapter 95.

drei
three — the same word, with th worn down to d
Introduced in Chapter 6.

dreizehn
thirteen — the rule's first run, and it is exactly what you would predict
Introduced in Chapter 19.

dreißig
thirty
Introduced in Chapter 101.

drucken
to print
Introduced in Chapter 177.

du / Sie
you (familiar / formal)
Introduced in Chapter 2.

du bist
you are — bin plus the -st ending you already know, and the one place sein behaves
Introduced in Chapter 26.

du hast
you have — the first form where the b falls out and the rule stops working
Introduced in Chapter 22.

du hast gesagt
you said — the second slot, where haben drops its b exactly as English have does
Introduced in Chapter 24.

du warst
you were — the familiar -st ending again, now on the past stem
Introduced in Chapter 28.

dunkel
dark
Introduced in Chapter 168.

dünn
thin
Introduced in Chapter 92.

duschen
to shower
Introduced in Chapter 178.

ehrlich
honest
Introduced in Chapter 212.

eifersüchtig
jealous
Introduced in Chapter 213.

eigentlich
actually
Introduced in Chapter 250.

eilig
urgent, in a hurry
Introduced in Chapter 212.

einen
a, an — the form the word takes for a masculine thing you have, and the first sighting of a system taught later
Introduced in Chapter 22.

einfach
simple
Introduced in Chapter 93.

einkaufen
to go shopping
Introduced in Chapter 145.

einladen
to invite
Introduced in Chapter 145.

einpacken
to pack
Introduced in Chapter 247.

einrichten
to furnish, to set up
Introduced in Chapter 248.

eins
one — and the ei that is always the English word “eye”
Introduced in Chapter 6.

einsam
lonely
Introduced in Chapter 212.

einschlafen
to fall asleep
Introduced in Chapter 178.

einsteigen
to get on (a vehicle)
Introduced in Chapter 178.

elf
eleven — and it is not irregular, it is a different rule
Introduced in Chapter 18.

empfangen
to receive, to welcome
Introduced in Chapter 179.

empfehlen
to recommend
Introduced in Chapter 145.

enden
to end
Introduced in Chapter 248.

endlich
finally
Introduced in Chapter 170.

eng
narrow; tight
Introduced in Chapter 131.

entdecken
to discover
Introduced in Chapter 248.

entscheiden
to decide
Introduced in Chapter 145.

entschuldigen
to excuse (sich entschuldigen: to apologise)
Introduced in Chapter 248.

Entschuldigung
sorry / excuse me (literally "un-guilting," from Schuld "guilt/fault")
Introduced in Chapter 33.

er hat
he has — the second and last form where the b falls out
Introduced in Chapter 22.

er hat das gemacht
he did that — the third slot, and the first Perfekt sentence with something in the middle
Introduced in Chapter 24.

er ist
he is — the form that also serves sie, es and das, and the one that matches Latin est
Introduced in Chapter 26.

er war
he was — the same word as ich war, because the German simple past gives its third person no ending
Introduced in Chapter 28.

er · sie · es
he, she, it — the three third-person pronouns, and the -t they share
Introduced in Chapter 5.

erfahren
to find out, to experience
Introduced in Chapter 248.

erfolgreich
successful
Introduced in Chapter 213.

ergänzen
to complete, to add
Introduced in Chapter 249.

erinnern
to remind (sich erinnern: to remember)
Introduced in Chapter 179.

erkältet
having a cold
Introduced in Chapter 213.

erklären
to explain
Introduced in Chapter 146.

erlauben
to allow
Introduced in Chapter 179.

erledigen
to get done
Introduced in Chapter 249.

ernähren
to feed, to nourish
Introduced in Chapter 179.

ernst
serious
Introduced in Chapter 133.

erreichen
to reach
Introduced in Chapter 179.

erscheinen
to appear
Introduced in Chapter 249.

erst
only (so far), not until
Introduced in Chapter 171.

erwarten
to expect
Introduced in Chapter 180.

erzählen
to tell (a story)
Introduced in Chapter 140.

erzeugen
to produce
Introduced in Chapter 249.

es
it — the placeholder German puts in front of a state
Introduced in Chapter 3.

es geht
"it goes" — the German shrug, and what saying nothing extra means
Introduced in Chapter 3.

es gibt
there is, there are — literally "it gives", and it takes the done-to form this chapter has taught
Introduced in Chapter 47.

Es ist zwei Uhr
telling the time — es ist, a number you own, and Uhr
Introduced in Chapter 12.

euch
you all, as the ones it happens to — and the word English quietly promoted to be its only "you"
Introduced in Chapter 50.

fahren
to travel, to drive — motion with a vehicle under it, and English fare hiding inside
Introduced in Chapter 29.

fallen
to fall
Introduced in Chapter 140.

falsch
wrong
Introduced in Chapter 93.

fangen
to catch
Introduced in Chapter 180.

fantastisch
fantastic
Introduced in Chapter 213.

faul
lazy
Introduced in Chapter 132.

fehlen
to be missing
Introduced in Chapter 146.

feiern
to celebrate
Introduced in Chapter 146.

fernsehen
to watch television
Introduced in Chapter 180.

fertig
finished, ready
Introduced in Chapter 134.

festhalten
to hold on to
Introduced in Chapter 180.

feucht
damp
Introduced in Chapter 213.

finden
to find
Introduced in Chapter 64.

fleißig
hard-working
Introduced in Chapter 132.

fliegen
to fly
Introduced in Chapter 111.

flüstern
to whisper
Introduced in Chapter 180.

fordern
to demand
Introduced in Chapter 249.

fotografieren
to photograph
Introduced in Chapter 181.

fragen
to ask — a weak verb whose vowel stays put, and whose closest English relatives came in from Latin as pray and precarious
Introduced in Chapter 38.

frei
free
Introduced in Chapter 131.

Freitag
Friday — the one day named for a goddess, and the Roman she replaced
Introduced in Chapter 10.

fremd
foreign, strange
Introduced in Chapter 169.

freundlich
friendly
Introduced in Chapter 132.

freut mich
pleased to meet you (literally "it gladdens me")
Introduced in Chapter 2.

fröhlich
cheerful
Introduced in Chapter 214.

früh
early — the word the first season is built out of, though not a cousin of English early
Introduced in Chapter 15.

frühstücken
to have breakfast
Introduced in Chapter 181.

fühlen
to feel
Introduced in Chapter 140.

füllen
to fill
Introduced in Chapter 146.

fünf
five — and the p-to-f law caught in one word
Introduced in Chapter 7.

fünfzehn
fifteen — the rule's third run, and where English clipped and German did not
Introduced in Chapter 19.

fünfzig
fifty
Introduced in Chapter 101.

furchtbar
terrible
Introduced in Chapter 214.

geduldig
patient
Introduced in Chapter 214.

gefährlich
dangerous
Introduced in Chapter 135.

gefallen
to please, to be liked
Introduced in Chapter 146.

gegenüber
opposite
Introduced in Chapter 109.

gehen
to go — and the verb German uses for "how are you?"
Introduced in Chapter 3.

gehen
to go, and to walk — because German has no separate word for walking, and English's walk turns out to be a word about cloth
Introduced in Chapter 40.

geizig
stingy
Introduced in Chapter 214.

gelernt
learned — the wrap on lernen, and the sentence you can finally say about yourself
Introduced in Chapter 23.

gemacht
made, done — the wrap applied to machen, and the one spelling surprise in it
Introduced in Chapter 23.

gemütlich
cosy
Introduced in Chapter 214.

genau
exactly
Introduced in Chapter 172.

geradeaus
straight on
Introduced in Chapter 108.

gerecht
fair, even-handed
Introduced in Chapter 215.

gesagt
said — the first past participle, and the first time a German ending arrives with a beginning attached
Introduced in Chapter 23.

geschieden
divorced
Introduced in Chapter 215.

geschlossen
closed
Introduced in Chapter 131.

gestern
yesterday — the word that fills the middle of a Perfekt sentence, and morgen's opposite number
Introduced in Chapter 24.

gesund
healthy
Introduced in Chapter 60.

gewinnen
to win
Introduced in Chapter 147.

gewohnt
lived, dwelt — the wrap on wohnen, and the English fossil that still means "accustomed"
Introduced in Chapter 23.

gießen
to pour, to water
Introduced in Chapter 181.

glauben
to believe
Introduced in Chapter 67.

gleich
right away, in a moment
Introduced in Chapter 170.

gleichzeitig
at the same time
Introduced in Chapter 215.

glücklich
happy
Introduced in Chapter 60.

grau
grey
Introduced in Chapter 94.

großzügig
generous
Introduced in Chapter 215.

grün, gelb
green and yellow — grün is native Germanic, the direct cousin of English's OWN "green" (a different root entirely from Latin's viridis); gelb is native too, and is usually said to share its ultimate PIE root with French's jaune, though that particular link is less secure than it first appears
Introduced in Chapter 36.

gründlich
thorough
Introduced in Chapter 216.

grüßen
to greet
Introduced in Chapter 181.

günstig
good value, favourable
Introduced in Chapter 215.

gut
good; well
Introduced in Chapter 1.

Gute Nacht
good night
Introduced in Chapter 1.

Guten Abend
good evening
Introduced in Chapter 1.

Guten Morgen
good morning
Introduced in Chapter 1.

Guten Tag
hello / good day (polite)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

haben
to have — the twin of English have, and the workhorse the rest of the book leans on
Introduced in Chapter 22.

hallo
hello (informal)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

hängen
to hang
Introduced in Chapter 147.

hässlich
ugly
Introduced in Chapter 91.

häufig
frequent
Introduced in Chapter 216.

heiraten
to marry
Introduced in Chapter 147.

heißen
to be called / to be named
Introduced in Chapter 2.

helfen
to help — the same word as English help, separated by one sound law, and still strong in German the way English's help once was
Introduced in Chapter 38.

hell
bright, light
Introduced in Chapter 168.

herrlich
wonderful
Introduced in Chapter 216.

heute
today
Introduced in Chapter 95.

hilfsbereit
helpful
Introduced in Chapter 216.

hinten
at the back
Introduced in Chapter 109.

hinter
behind
Introduced in Chapter 110.

hoch
high, tall
Introduced in Chapter 90.

höchstens
at most
Introduced in Chapter 251.

hoffen
to hope
Introduced in Chapter 136.

höflich
polite
Introduced in Chapter 167.

holen
to fetch
Introduced in Chapter 88.

hören
to hear — the same verb as English hear, and the closing of a chapter of four things you do without going anywhere
Introduced in Chapter 39.

hübsch
pretty
Introduced in Chapter 130.

Hund, Katze
dog and cat — Hund is native Germanic, cognate with English's OWN discarded word "hound"; Katze, surprisingly, is NOT native — it's the same borrowed Latin word behind French chat and Spanish gato (though not every European language shares it)
Introduced in Chapter 35.

hundert
a hundred
Introduced in Chapter 101.

ich
I
Introduced in Chapter 2.

ich bin
I am — the first form of sein, and it comes from a different verb than the infinitive does
Introduced in Chapter 26.

ich bin zwanzig Jahre alt
I am twenty years old — the answer, word for word the English sentence
Introduced in Chapter 27.

ich habe gesagt
I said — the first filled slot of the Perfekt, and a sentence you can use whole
Introduced in Chapter 24.

ich hatte
I had — haben's own Präteritum, and one of the handful that everybody says out loud
Introduced in Chapter 25.

ich heiße / du heißt / Sie heißen
one verb, three endings — the ending machine every German verb runs
Introduced in Chapter 2.

ich heiße...
my name is… (literally "I am called…")
Introduced in Chapter 2.

ich konnte
I could — a Präteritum that survives in ordinary speech everywhere, north and south alike
Introduced in Chapter 25.

Ich lerne Deutsch
your first sentence built from parts, not handed to you whole
Introduced in Chapter 5.

ich machte
I made, I did — the second verb through the -te ending
Introduced in Chapter 25.

ich sagte
I said, in one word — the Präteritum of sagen, beside the Perfekt that means exactly the same
Introduced in Chapter 25.

ich war
I was — the past of sein, and a third stem that shares nothing with the other two
Introduced in Chapter 28.

ihn
him — the pronoun that moves on the same row as den, einen, keinen and meinen
Introduced in Chapter 50.

Ihnen
to you, formally — the capitalised to-whom that goes with Sie
Introduced in Chapter 3.

ihr
her — the fourth of the six, and a word that now does three separate jobs in this book
Introduced in Chapter 49.

ihr
you all — the plural you English gave up
Introduced in Chapter 5.

ihr seid
you are, to more than one person — the form English lost when it dropped its plural you
Introduced in Chapter 26.

immer
always
Introduced in Chapter 94.

in
in — the same word as English in, and it needs no learning at all
Introduced in Chapter 5.

informieren
to inform
Introduced in Chapter 181.

intelligent
intelligent
Introduced in Chapter 216.

interessant
interesting
Introduced in Chapter 133.

ja
yes
Introduced in Chapter 31.

jedenfalls
in any case
Introduced in Chapter 250.

kämpfen
to fight
Introduced in Chapter 182.

kaputt
broken
Introduced in Chapter 217.

kaufen
to buy
Introduced in Chapter 64.

kein
no, not a — the word German builds out of "not" and "one", exactly as English built *none*
Introduced in Chapter 45.

keine
no, not a — in front of a die-word, and in front of every plural, wearing the same -e that eine wears
Introduced in Chapter 45.

keinen
no, not a — for a der-word that is the thing you have, the negative twin of einen
Introduced in Chapter 45.

kennen
to know (a person or place)
Introduced in Chapter 147.

klein
small
Introduced in Chapter 89.

klettern
to climb
Introduced in Chapter 182.

klingeln
to ring
Introduced in Chapter 147.

klug
clever
Introduced in Chapter 217.

kochen
to cook
Introduced in Chapter 65.

kommen
to come — English come with one consonant shifted, and the second verb of the sein family
Introduced in Chapter 29.

können
can, to be able — English *can*, and a verb that once meant *to know*
Introduced in Chapter 51.

kosten
to cost
Introduced in Chapter 148.

kostenlos
free of charge
Introduced in Chapter 217.

kräftig
strong, hearty
Introduced in Chapter 217.

krank
ill, sick
Introduced in Chapter 59.

kühl
cool
Introduced in Chapter 135.

kümmern
to take care (sich kümmern um)
Introduced in Chapter 182.

kurz
short
Introduced in Chapter 89.

lächeln
to smile
Introduced in Chapter 182.

lachen
to laugh
Introduced in Chapter 65.

landen
to land
Introduced in Chapter 182.

langsam
slow
Introduced in Chapter 89.

langweilig
boring
Introduced in Chapter 134.

laufen
to run — and to walk, because German draws the line in a different place from English, with rennen at the fast end
Introduced in Chapter 40.

leben
to live
Introduced in Chapter 67.

lecker
tasty
Introduced in Chapter 218.

ledig
single (unmarried)
Introduced in Chapter 217.

leer
empty
Introduced in Chapter 90.

legen
to lay, to put (flat)
Introduced in Chapter 139.

leicht
light; easy
Introduced in Chapter 89.

leiden
to suffer
Introduced in Chapter 183.

leider
unfortunately
Introduced in Chapter 172.

leihen
to lend, to borrow
Introduced in Chapter 148.

leise
quiet
Introduced in Chapter 92.

lernen
to learn — and its noun is English lore
Introduced in Chapter 5.

lesen
to read — a verb that first meant "to gather", and the first one in this book whose vowel changes in the du and er forms
Introduced in Chapter 37.

lieb
kind, dear
Introduced in Chapter 218.

lieben
to love
Introduced in Chapter 148.

lieber
rather, preferably
Introduced in Chapter 136.

liegen
to lie (be lying)
Introduced in Chapter 140.

lila
purple
Introduced in Chapter 94.

locker
relaxed, loose
Introduced in Chapter 218.

lustig
funny
Introduced in Chapter 133.

machen
to make, to do — and it is just English make
Introduced in Chapter 5.

mager
thin, lean
Introduced in Chapter 218.

malen
to paint
Introduced in Chapter 68.

manchmal
sometimes
Introduced in Chapter 95.

mein
my — pulled out of the phrase it has been hiding in since you first gave your name, and the head of a family of six words that share one set of endings
Introduced in Chapter 49.

meistens
mostly, usually
Introduced in Chapter 170.

messen
to measure
Introduced in Chapter 183.

mich
me — the object form of ich
Introduced in Chapter 2.

mieten
to rent
Introduced in Chapter 141.

mindestens
at least
Introduced in Chapter 251.

mir
to me, for me — the form German uses for the person a thing happens to
Introduced in Chapter 3.

mischen
to mix
Introduced in Chapter 183.

mitbringen
to bring along
Introduced in Chapter 148.

mitnehmen
to take along
Introduced in Chapter 148.

Mittwoch
Wednesday — the first day that breaks the pattern, because the Church would not name one for Wodan
Introduced in Chapter 10.

möchten
would like — the politest thing in German, and a bent form of the mögen you already own
Introduced in Chapter 51.

mögen, lieben
to like and to love — plus gern, the adverb that lets any verb say "I like doing this" and has no English shape at all
Introduced in Chapter 38.

möglich
possible
Introduced in Chapter 167.

Montag
Monday — the pattern's first instance, and the one weekday English and German name identically
Introduced in Chapter 10.

Morgen
morning (der Morgen — masculine)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

morgen
tomorrow — the second job of the Morgen you already know
Introduced in Chapter 4.

müde
tired — the first adjective that says something about a person, and it needs no ending here
Introduced in Chapter 26.

müssen
must, to have to — English *must*, one of the very few English verbs with no *-s* in the third person, for the same reason
Introduced in Chapter 51.

mutig
brave
Introduced in Chapter 218.

nachher
later, afterwards
Introduced in Chapter 171.

nächste Woche
next week
Introduced in Chapter 142.

nächstes Jahr
next year
Introduced in Chapter 142.

Nacht
night (die Nacht — feminine)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

nähen
to sew
Introduced in Chapter 183.

nass
wet
Introduced in Chapter 135.

natürlich
of course
Introduced in Chapter 172.

neben
next to
Introduced in Chapter 110.

nehmen
to take — the verb English lost, though it left numb and nimble behind as fossils
Introduced in Chapter 38.

nein
no
Introduced in Chapter 31.

nennen
to name, to call
Introduced in Chapter 149.

nervös
nervous
Introduced in Chapter 169.

nett
nice, kind
Introduced in Chapter 132.

neugierig
curious
Introduced in Chapter 219.

neun
nine — the oy vowel from Deutsch, twice in one word
Introduced in Chapter 9.

neunzehn
nineteen — the last of the -zehn numbers, and the rule's eighth clean run
Introduced in Chapter 19.

neunzig
ninety
Introduced in Chapter 138.

nicht
not — German's plain negator
Introduced in Chapter 3.

nie
never
Introduced in Chapter 137.

niedrig
low
Introduced in Chapter 90.

niesen
to sneeze
Introduced in Chapter 183.

noch
still, yet
Introduced in Chapter 170.

null
zero
Introduced in Chapter 102.

nützlich
useful
Introduced in Chapter 219.

oben
up, upstairs
Introduced in Chapter 109.

oder
or — the second joining word, on the same Germanic root as English *or*, and the tag question every German speaker ends a sentence with
Introduced in Chapter 48.

öffentlich
public
Introduced in Chapter 219.

öffnen
to open — built on offen, which is English open, which is really the word up; and the doorway into German's separable verbs
Introduced in Chapter 40.

oft
often
Introduced in Chapter 137.

orange
orange (the colour)
Introduced in Chapter 130.

ordentlich
tidy, proper
Introduced in Chapter 219.

packen
to pack
Introduced in Chapter 141.

parken
to park
Introduced in Chapter 184.

persönlich
personal
Introduced in Chapter 219.

pflegen
to look after, to nurse
Introduced in Chapter 184.

pflücken
to pick (flowers, fruit)
Introduced in Chapter 184.

prüfen
to test, to check
Introduced in Chapter 184.

pünktlich
punctual
Introduced in Chapter 220.

putzen
to clean
Introduced in Chapter 68.

rechts
on the right
Introduced in Chapter 95.

regnerisch
rainy
Introduced in Chapter 220.

reich
rich
Introduced in Chapter 91.

reinigen
to clean
Introduced in Chapter 184.

reisen
to travel
Introduced in Chapter 66.

reparieren
to repair
Introduced in Chapter 141.

retten
to rescue
Introduced in Chapter 185.

richtig
right, correct
Introduced in Chapter 93.

riechen
to smell
Introduced in Chapter 149.

roh
raw
Introduced in Chapter 220.

rosa
pink
Introduced in Chapter 130.

rot
red — the third colour, and the one humans name first after black and white
Introduced in Chapter 21.

rudern
to row
Introduced in Chapter 185.

rufen
to call
Introduced in Chapter 67.

ruhig
quiet, calm
Introduced in Chapter 131.

rund
round
Introduced in Chapter 130.

sagen
to say — the verb this chapter builds its past tense on
Introduced in Chapter 23.

salzig
salty
Introduced in Chapter 220.

sammeln
to collect
Introduced in Chapter 149.

Samstag
Saturday — the second day that breaks the pattern, and the only one German bought rather than inherited
Introduced in Chapter 11.

sauber
clean
Introduced in Chapter 92.

sauer
sour, annoyed
Introduced in Chapter 220.

schenken
to give (as a present)
Introduced in Chapter 149.

schicken
to send
Introduced in Chapter 68.

schieben
to push
Introduced in Chapter 185.

schlafen
to sleep — the same word as English sleep under two coats of German paint, and a second way for a strong verb to break
Introduced in Chapter 39.

schlagen
to hit, to beat
Introduced in Chapter 185.

schlank
slim
Introduced in Chapter 221.

schließen
to close — the second verb in these chapters that German kept and English lost, and the one that locked up Schloss, Schlüssel and Schluss
Introduced in Chapter 40.

schmecken
to taste
Introduced in Chapter 185.

schmutzig
dirty
Introduced in Chapter 92.

schneiden
to cut
Introduced in Chapter 75.

schneien
to snow
Introduced in Chapter 186.

schnell
fast
Introduced in Chapter 89.

schön
beautiful, nice — and the word that upgrades a thank-you
Introduced in Chapter 3.

schrecklich
dreadful
Introduced in Chapter 221.

schreiben
to write — the one verb in this chapter German did not inherit but borrowed, from Latin scribere
Introduced in Chapter 37.

schreien
to shout, to scream
Introduced in Chapter 149.

schüchtern
shy
Introduced in Chapter 221.

schützen
to protect
Introduced in Chapter 186.

schwach
weak
Introduced in Chapter 91.

schwarz
black — the first of four colours, all of them home-grown Germanic
Introduced in Chapter 20.

schwer
heavy; difficult
Introduced in Chapter 90.

schwierig
difficult
Introduced in Chapter 134.

sechs
six — where chs is simply an x
Introduced in Chapter 8.

sechzehn
sixteen — sechs without its s, because the s and the ts would collide
Introduced in Chapter 19.

sechzig
sixty
Introduced in Chapter 138.

segeln
to sail
Introduced in Chapter 186.

sehen
to see — a straight cognate of English see
Introduced in Chapter 4.

sehr
very — the intensifier that turns gut into a real answer
Introduced in Chapter 3.

sein
his — spelled exactly like the verb *to be*, and the collision is worth meeting head-on
Introduced in Chapter 49.

sein
to be — the partner of haben, and the most irregular verb German has
Introduced in Chapter 26.

selbstständig
independent, self-employed
Introduced in Chapter 221.

selten
rarely
Introduced in Chapter 170.

senden
to send, to broadcast
Introduced in Chapter 186.

sich
himself, herself, itself, themselves — one German word where English needs four, and the pronoun that bends a verb back onto its own subject
Introduced in Chapter 50.

sich anziehen
to get dressed
Introduced in Chapter 140.

sicher
safe; sure
Introduced in Chapter 134.

sie sind / Sie sind
they are, and the polite you are — one form, and the capital letter is the only difference
Introduced in Chapter 26.

sieben
seven — and the s that buzzes at the front of a word
Introduced in Chapter 8.

siebzehn
seventeen — sieben without its -en, one syllable saved
Introduced in Chapter 19.

siebzig
seventy
Introduced in Chapter 138.

singen
to sing
Introduced in Chapter 66.

sitzen
to sit — the same inherited word as English sit, respelt by the other branch of the shift that separated helfen from help
Introduced in Chapter 39.

so lala
so-so — the sing-song middle of the answer ladder
Introduced in Chapter 3.

sofort
immediately
Introduced in Chapter 94.

sondern
but rather — the second "but", reserved for correcting a negative, which is the same job doch does for a question
Introduced in Chapter 48.

Sonnabend
Saturday in the north — Sun-eve, built from two words you already own
Introduced in Chapter 11.

sonnig
sunny
Introduced in Chapter 221.

Sonntag
Sunday — the one day the Church left alone, where Romance renamed it entirely
Introduced in Chapter 11.

sowieso
anyway
Introduced in Chapter 251.

spannend
exciting
Introduced in Chapter 167.

sparen
to save (money)
Introduced in Chapter 150.

sparsam
thrifty
Introduced in Chapter 222.

spät
late — and später, "later," your first comparative
Introduced in Chapter 4.

spazieren
to stroll (spazieren gehen)
Introduced in Chapter 186.

spielen
to play
Introduced in Chapter 64.

sportlich
sporty
Introduced in Chapter 222.

springen
to jump
Introduced in Chapter 150.

spülen
to rinse, to wash up
Introduced in Chapter 187.

stark
strong
Introduced in Chapter 91.

starten
to start, to take off
Introduced in Chapter 187.

stecken
to put, to stick
Introduced in Chapter 187.

stehen
to stand — the verb hiding inside verstehen, and the one place German keeps a letter English put in the wrong tense
Introduced in Chapter 39.

stehlen
to steal
Introduced in Chapter 187.

steigen
to climb, to rise
Introduced in Chapter 187.

stellen
to put (upright)
Introduced in Chapter 139.

sterben
to die
Introduced in Chapter 150.

stolz
proud
Introduced in Chapter 169.

stören
to disturb
Introduced in Chapter 150.

streichen
to paint, to spread
Introduced in Chapter 188.

streiten
to argue
Introduced in Chapter 150.

streng
strict
Introduced in Chapter 222.

suchen
to look for
Introduced in Chapter 64.

süß
sweet
Introduced in Chapter 91.

sympathisch
likeable
Introduced in Chapter 222.

Tag
day (der Tag — masculine)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

tausend
a thousand
Introduced in Chapter 101.

teilen
to share, to divide
Introduced in Chapter 188.

telefonieren
to talk on the phone
Introduced in Chapter 188.

tot
dead
Introduced in Chapter 222.

tragen
to carry; to wear
Introduced in Chapter 68.

träumen
to dream
Introduced in Chapter 151.

traurig
sad
Introduced in Chapter 60.

treffen
to meet
Introduced in Chapter 151.

trennen
to separate
Introduced in Chapter 188.

treu
faithful, loyal
Introduced in Chapter 223.

trocken
dry
Introduced in Chapter 135.

trotzdem
nevertheless
Introduced in Chapter 250.

tschüss
bye, casually — and secretly the same blessing as adiós
Introduced in Chapter 4.

typisch
typical
Introduced in Chapter 223.

üben
to practise
Introduced in Chapter 151.

überlegen
to think over
Introduced in Chapter 151.

übermorgen
the day after tomorrow
Introduced in Chapter 142.

überqueren
to cross
Introduced in Chapter 188.

übersetzen
to translate
Introduced in Chapter 189.

übrigens
by the way
Introduced in Chapter 251.

umarmen
to hug
Introduced in Chapter 189.

umsteigen
to change (trains or buses)
Introduced in Chapter 178.

umziehen
to move (house)
Introduced in Chapter 151.

und
and — and the two-word move that returns a question
Introduced in Chapter 3.

unfreundlich
unfriendly
Introduced in Chapter 167.

ungeduldig
impatient
Introduced in Chapter 223.

ungefähr
about, roughly
Introduced in Chapter 173.

unglücklich
unhappy
Introduced in Chapter 223.

unmöglich
impossible
Introduced in Chapter 168.

uns
us — the same word as English *us*, doing both German jobs at once, which is the one place German is simpler
Introduced in Chapter 50.

unten
down, downstairs
Introduced in Chapter 109.

unterschreiben
to sign
Introduced in Chapter 152.

verabreden
to arrange (sich verabreden: to make a date)
Introduced in Chapter 189.

verbieten
to forbid
Introduced in Chapter 189.

verbinden
to connect, to bandage
Introduced in Chapter 189.

verdienen
to earn
Introduced in Chapter 152.

vergessen
to forget
Introduced in Chapter 66.

vergleichen
to compare
Introduced in Chapter 190.

verheiratet
married
Introduced in Chapter 223.

verkaufen
to sell
Introduced in Chapter 152.

verletzen
to injure
Introduced in Chapter 190.

verliebt
in love
Introduced in Chapter 224.

verlieren
to lose
Introduced in Chapter 67.

verpassen
to miss (a train, a chance)
Introduced in Chapter 190.

verschieben
to postpone
Introduced in Chapter 190.

verschieden
different, various
Introduced in Chapter 224.

versprechen
to promise
Introduced in Chapter 152.

verstehen
to understand — literally "to stand around a thing", the same picture English built independently in understand
Introduced in Chapter 37.

verwenden
to use
Introduced in Chapter 190.

vielen Dank
many thanks — the noun behind danke, and the warmest everyday thank-you
Introduced in Chapter 3.

vielleicht
perhaps
Introduced in Chapter 172.

vier
four — spelt with a v, said with an f
Introduced in Chapter 7.

vierzehn
fourteen — the rule's second run, with the V that is an f
Introduced in Chapter 19.

vierzig
forty
Introduced in Chapter 101.

voll
full
Introduced in Chapter 168.

vorbereiten
to prepare
Introduced in Chapter 191.

vorhaben
to plan, to intend
Introduced in Chapter 142.

vorher
before, beforehand
Introduced in Chapter 171.

vorne
at the front
Introduced in Chapter 109.

vorsichtig
careful
Introduced in Chapter 224.

vorstellen
to introduce
Introduced in Chapter 152.

wach
awake
Introduced in Chapter 132.

wählen
to choose, to vote, to dial
Introduced in Chapter 191.

während
during, while
Introduced in Chapter 251.

wahrscheinlich
probably
Introduced in Chapter 172.

wandern
to hike
Introduced in Chapter 153.

wann
when — the fourth W, and the first question this book can ask about the clock and the calendar it already owns
Introduced in Chapter 46.

warten
to wait
Introduced in Chapter 65.

warum
why — two old words fused into one, “about what”, the same build as English *wherefore*
Introduced in Chapter 46.

was
what — the fourth w-question, and the one you will use most
Introduced in Chapter 5.

wechseln
to change (money), to switch
Introduced in Chapter 153.

wecken
to wake (someone)
Introduced in Chapter 191.

weich
soft
Introduced in Chapter 135.

weil
because — the reason word that sends the verb to the end, built out of *die Weile*, which is English *while*
Introduced in Chapter 48.

weinen
to cry
Introduced in Chapter 65.

weit
far
Introduced in Chapter 95.

weiß
white — and the first everyday word that needs the ß you were given in chapter four
Introduced in Chapter 20.

welcher
which — built as "what-like", the identical two pieces English welded into *which*
Introduced in Chapter 47.

wer
who — and the W that every German question word begins with, against the WH that every English one begins with
Introduced in Chapter 46.

werden
to become — the change-of-state half of the rule, in one word
Introduced in Chapter 29.

werfen
to throw
Introduced in Chapter 153.

wichtig
important
Introduced in Chapter 93.

wie
how
Introduced in Chapter 2.

Wie alt bist du?
how old are you — word for word the English question, built from four words you own
Introduced in Chapter 27.

Wie geht es dir?
how are you? — informal, and every piece already yours
Introduced in Chapter 3.

wie heißen Sie?
what's your name? (literally "how are you called?")
Introduced in Chapter 2.

wie viel · wie viele
how much and how many — one distinction German marks and English marks too, on a word that is English *full*
Introduced in Chapter 47.

wieder
again — the "back" hiding inside withdraw
Introduced in Chapter 4.

wiederholen
to repeat
Introduced in Chapter 153.

wiegen
to weigh
Introduced in Chapter 191.

windig
windy
Introduced in Chapter 224.

wir
we — and the ending that is the dictionary form again
Introduced in Chapter 5.

wir haben gesagt
we said — the fourth slot, where the helper is the infinitive itself
Introduced in Chapter 24.

wir sind
we are — the plural form, and the first one that looks like the infinitive
Introduced in Chapter 26.

wir waren
we were — the plural past, and the last form of sein you need
Introduced in Chapter 28.

wissen
to know (a fact)
Introduced in Chapter 64.

witzig
funny, witty
Introduced in Chapter 224.

wo
where — the third of German's w-questions
Introduced in Chapter 5.

wohnen
to live, to dwell — your first regular German verb
Introduced in Chapter 5.

wollen
to want
Introduced in Chapter 136.

wünschen
to wish
Introduced in Chapter 88.

wütend
angry
Introduced in Chapter 169.

zahlen
to pay
Introduced in Chapter 141.

zählen
to count
Introduced in Chapter 68.

zehn
ten — one consonant photographed three times
Introduced in Chapter 9.

zeichnen
to draw
Introduced in Chapter 191.

zeigen
to show
Introduced in Chapter 66.

ziehen
to pull
Introduced in Chapter 153.

ziemlich
quite, fairly
Introduced in Chapter 173.

zuerst
first
Introduced in Chapter 171.

zusammen
together
Introduced in Chapter 173.

zwanzig
twenty — where the ending changes from zehn to -zig
Introduced in Chapter 19.

zwei
two — English two with its t turned into the ts of z
Introduced in Chapter 6.

zwischen
between
Introduced in Chapter 110.

zwölf
twelve — the second and last number to refuse the pattern
Introduced in Chapter 18.

Review Questions

Try these without looking ahead. Every prompt comes from the same canonical lesson data as its chapter. Answers begin in the next section.

Chapter 30

30.1 *Kopf / Haupt — two head-words*
Which inherited German head-word survives in compounds such as Hauptstadt?

Chapter 52

52.1 *(reading) — six nouns, and a capital letter doing real work*
Which of the six would you drink?

52.2 *(reading) — six sentences, and a wait at the end*
Which line says something is necessary?

52.3 *(reading) — the first paragraph*
Which word sends the verb to the end?

Answer Key

The first response is the canonical display answer. When a question accepts other authored forms, they appear underneath.

Chapter 30

30.1 *Kopf / Haupt — two head-words*
Answer: Haupt

Chapter 52

52.1 *(reading) — six nouns, and a capital letter doing real work*
Answer: coffee
Also accepted: Kaffee

52.2 *(reading) — six sentences, and a wait at the end*
Answer: ich muss arbeiten
Also accepted: Ich muss arbeiten.; muss

52.3 *(reading) — the first paragraph*
Answer: weil
Also accepted: because

Index

Look up an English meaning, a dedicated language topic, or a chapter topic. Each linked reference opens the chapter where the material is introduced; the focus labels name only explicitly typed lesson sections.

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explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1193
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a bag (paper or plastic) *die Tüte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1155
a baker *der Bäcker*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 957
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explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1065
a relationship *die Beziehung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1573
a restaurant *das Restaurant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 833
a result *das Ergebnis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1579
a return journey *die Rückfahrt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1369
a ring *der Ring*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 907
a role *die Rolle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1635
A role, Quiet, A thing, A shadow, A step
chapter topic; Chapter 237, p. 1635
a roof *das Dach*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 655
a room *das Zimmer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 77, p. 661

a round trip, a tour *die Rundfahrt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1375
a row, a turn *die Reihe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1629
a rubber, an eraser *der Radiergummi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 969
a rucksack *der Rucksack*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1375
A rucksack, A sight, A city map, A round trip, A market square
chapter topic; Chapter 194, p. 1375
a rug, a carpet *der Teppich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 875
a salad; lettuce *der Salat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 74, p. 643
a salary *das Gehalt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1137
A salary, An identity card, A visa, A traffic jam, An accident
chapter topic; Chapter 155, p. 1137
a sauce *die Soße*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 943
a sausage *die Wurst*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 74, p. 643
a scarf *der Schal*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 919
a school *die Schule*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 81, p. 687
a second (of time) *die Sekunde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 765
a sentence *der Satz*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 975
a shadow, shade *der Schatten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1635
a sheep *das Schaf*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 87, p. 723
a shelf *das Regal*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 881
a shirt *das Hemd*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 98, p. 789
a shoe *der Schuh*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 795
a shop *der Laden*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 777
a shop, a business *das Geschäft*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1471

a shop assistant *der Verkäufer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 951
a shoulder *die Schulter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 56, p. 535
a shower *die Dusche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 881
a sight (worth seeing) *die Sehenswürdigkeit*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1375
a size *die Größe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1429
a skirt *der Rock*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 919
a snake; a queue *die Schlange*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 86, p. 717
a sock *die Socke*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 795
a sofa *das Sofa*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1181
A sofa, A radio, The weather, The wind, A thunderstorm
chapter topic; Chapter 162, p. 1181
a solution *die Lösung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1205
a son *der Sohn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 565
a song *das Lied*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 103, p. 819
a soup *die Suppe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 625
a speech *die Rede*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1629
a spoon *der Löffel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 681
a square; a seat *der Platz*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 827
a stadium *das Stadion*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 839
a stamp *die Briefmarke*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1155
a star *der Stern*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 84, p. 705
a state *der Staat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1459
a step *der Schritt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1635

a step, a level *die Stufe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1647
a stone *der Stein*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 699
a story, history *die Geschichte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1593
a strawberry *die Erdbeere*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 931
a suit *der Anzug*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1423
a suitcase *der Koffer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 869
a supermarket *der Supermarkt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 839
a surprise *die Überraschung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1653
a swimming pool *das Schwimmbad*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 839
a table *der Tisch*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 655
a tablet *die Tablette*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1149
A tablet, Insurance, A bank account, A credit card, A price
chapter topic; Chapter 157, p. 1149
a take-off, a departure (by air) *der Abflug*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1363
a task, an exercise *die Aufgabe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1167
a taxi *das Taxi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 869
a team *die Mannschaft*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1617
a telephone *das Telefon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 693
a television *der Fernseher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 875
a theatre *das Theater*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 833
a theft *der Diebstahl*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1453
a thief *der Dieb*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1453
a thing, a matter *die Sache*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1635

a thousand *tausend*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 807
a thunderstorm *das Gewitter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1181
a ticket *die Fahrkarte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 869
a tie *die Krawatte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 913
a till, a checkout *die Kasse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 963
a timetable *der Fahrplan*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1369
A timetable, A return journey, Accommodation, A youth hostel, Luggage
chapter topic; Chapter 193, p. 1369
a tin, a can *die Dose*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1417
A tin, A pot, A frying pan, An oven, A dishwasher
chapter topic; Chapter 201, p. 1417
a tip *das Trinkgeld*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1411
a toe *die Zehe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 547
a tomato *die Tomate*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 619
a tooth *der Zahn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 56, p. 535
a toothbrush *die Zahnbürste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 889
a topic *das Thema*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1653
A topic, A tradition, A dream, A surprise, The surroundings
chapter topic; Chapter 240, p. 1653
a towel *das Handtuch*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 889
a tower *der Turm*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1381
a town hall *das Rathaus*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 833
a tradition *die Tradition*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1653
a traffic jam *der Stau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1137
a tram *die Straßenbahn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 863

a tree *der Baum*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 693
a university *die Universität*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1167
A university, A course, A task, A dictionary, A mistake
chapter topic; Chapter 160, p. 1167
a vacuum cleaner *der Staubsauger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1423
A vacuum cleaner, An iron, Shampoo, A brush, A suit
chapter topic; Chapter 202, p. 1423
a valley *das Tal*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1387
a village *das Dorf*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 783
a visa *das Visum*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1137
a visit *der Besuch*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1567
a voice, a vote *die Stimme*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1641
a wage *der Lohn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1617
A wage, A team, A majority, Fashion, Courage
chapter topic; Chapter 234, p. 1617
a waiter *der Kellner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 963
a waitress *die Kellnerin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1411
a wall *die Wand*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 655
a washing machine *die Waschmaschine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 895
a wedding *die Hochzeit*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1187
a window *das Fenster*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 655
a wish *der Wunsch*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 1023
a woman; a wife *die Frau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 571
a word *das Wort*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 813
a workplace *der Arbeitsplatz*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1131

A workplace, A company, A colleague, A colleague, A job
chapter topic; Chapter 154, p. 1131
a workshop, a garage *die Werkstatt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1471
a worry *die Sorge*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1641
a wound *die Wunde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1447
A wound, A plaster, An ointment, An injection, An emergency
chapter topic; Chapter 206, p. 1447
a yoghurt *der Joghurt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 951
a youth hostel *die Jugendherberge*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1369
about, roughly *ungefähr*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1247
accommodation *die Unterkunft*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1369
actually *eigentlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1713
admission, entry *der Eintritt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1573
advertising *die Werbung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1671
afterwards *danach*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1235
again — the "back" hiding inside withdraw *wieder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 4, p. 57
Airport, Square, Museum, Hotel, Post office
chapter topic; Chapter 104, p. 827
Alarm clock, Mobile phone, Camera, Glasses, Umbrella
chapter topic; Chapter 116, p. 901
alone *allein*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1247
always *immer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 765
an accident *der Unfall*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1137
an achievement, performance *die Leistung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1611
an address *die Adresse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1161
An address, A phone number, The internet, An email, A message
chapter topic; Chapter 159, p. 1161

an admission ticket *die Eintrittskarte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1573
an advantage *der Vorteil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1665
an adventure *das Abenteuer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1561
An adventure, An idea, Everyday life, Training, An exhibition
chapter topic; Chapter 225, p. 1561
an advert *die Anzeige*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1065
an aeroplane *das Flugzeug*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 777
an airport *der Flughafen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 827
an alarm clock *der Wecker*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 901
an ambulance *der Krankenwagen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1453
An ambulance, The fire brigade, A thief, A theft, A court
chapter topic; Chapter 207, p. 1453
An Ancient Cousin and a Second Emigrant
chapter topic; Chapter 21, p. 257
an animal *das Tier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1399
An animal, A hare, A fly, A butterfly, A plant
chapter topic; Chapter 198, p. 1399
an answer *die Antwort*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 813
an ant *die Ameise*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 729
an apple *der Apfel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 613
an application *die Bewerbung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1573
An application, A relationship, An impression, Admission, An admission ticket
chapter topic; Chapter 227, p. 1573
an appointment *der Termin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1065
an area, a region *die Gegend*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1587
an argument *der Streit*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1647
an armchair *der Sessel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 895

an arrival *die Ankunft*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1363
an atmosphere, a mood *die Stimmung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1647
An atmosphere, An argument, University studies, A step, A fact
chapter topic; Chapter 239, p. 1647
an aunt *die Tante*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 571
an election, a choice *die Wahl*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1465
an elephant *der Elefant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 729
an email *die E-Mail*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1161
an emergency *der Notfall*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1447
an engineer *der Ingenieur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 957
an exam *die Prüfung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 969
an examination *die Untersuchung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1441
an exercise book *das Heft*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 681
an exhibition *die Ausstellung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1561
An experience, A guided tour, A fee, A feeling, An area
chapter topic; Chapter 229, p. 1587
an experience (something lived) *das Erlebnis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1587
an explanation *die Erklärung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1579
an hour's span — the native word that survived beside the borrowed one, with the jobs divided *die Stunde*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 12, p. 149
an idea *die Idee*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 975
an idea, a notion (keine Ahnung: no idea) *die Ahnung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1561
an identity card *der Ausweis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1137
an impression *der Eindruck*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1573
an injection *die Spritze*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1447

an injury *die Verletzung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1441
an interest *das Interesse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1599
an invitation *die Einladung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1187
an iron *das Bügeleisen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1423
an island *die Insel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 699
an offer *das Angebot*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1155
An offer, A bill, A bag, A parcel, A stamp
chapter topic; Chapter 158, p. 1155
an office *das Büro*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 845
an ointment *die Salbe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1447
an onion *die Zwiebel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 619
an opinion *die Meinung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1199
an order *die Bestellung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1411
an oven *der Ofen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1417
an umbrella *der Regenschirm*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 901
an uncle *der Onkel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 571
and — and the two-word move that returns a question *und*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 33
angry *wütend*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1223
angry; bad *böse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 1005
Angry, Funny, Serious, Famous, Interesting
chapter topic; Chapter 133, p. 1005
anxious, timid *ängstlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1477
Anxious, Tiring, Excited, Excellent, Working
chapter topic; Chapter 211, p. 1477
anyway *sowieso*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1719

April — the one month whose Roman name nobody can be sure about *der April*
explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 13, p. 163
Arm, Finger, Foot, Heart
chapter topic; Chapter 44, p. 447
arm — named on the *Hand* table and now finally taught, a word Grimm's law never had to touch *der Arm*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 44, p. 447
art *die Kunst*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1605
at least *mindestens*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1719
at most *höchstens*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1719
at the back *hinten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 857
at the front *vorne*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 857
at the same time *gleichzeitig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1501
August — the second and last month named for a man, and the last name the calendar ever gave *der August*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 14, p. 175
autumn — and the word is one English still has, doing a different job *der Herbst*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 15, p. 185
awake *wach*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 999

B

Back, Tongue, Lip, Toe, Stomach
chapter topic; Chapter 58, p. 547
Banana, Potato, Tomato, Onion, Carrot
chapter topic; Chapter 70, p. 619
beans *die Bohnen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 931
Beans, Cucumber, Strawberry, Cherry, Melon
chapter topic; Chapter 121, p. 931
beautiful, nice — and the word that upgrades a thank-you *schön*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 33
because — the reason word that sends the verb to the end, built out of *die Weile*, which is English *while* *weil*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 48, p. 485

Bee, Ant, Elephant, To fetch, To wish
chapter topic; Chapter 88, p. 729
beef *das Rindfleisch*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 925
beer *das Bier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 649
before, beforehand *vorher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1235
behaviour *das Verhalten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1659
behind *hinter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 863
Being Your Years
chapter topic; Chapter 27, p. 323
Belt, Jacket, Border, World, Language
chapter topic; Chapter 100, p. 801
besides, moreover *außerdem*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1713
Besides, Therefore, Nevertheless, In any case, Actually
chapter topic; Chapter 250, p. 1713
between *zwischen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 863
bin, ist, war — three verbs under one roof
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 28, p. 333
black — the first of four colours, all of them home-grown Germanic *schwarz*
explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 20, p. 247
Blanket, Towel, Soap, Toothbrush, Toothpaste
chapter topic; Chapter 114, p. 889
blau, taken apart
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 21, p. 257
blond *blond*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1483
blood *das Blut*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 541
blue — the fourth colour, and the second German word the Romance languages took *blau*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 21, p. 257
boots *die Stiefel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 919
boring *langweilig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 1011
Boring, Difficult, Finished, Ready, Safe
chapter topic; Chapter 134, p. 1011

brave *mutig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1519
bread — and the third article, das, which completes the set you were given in chapter one *das Brot*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 215
Bread, Water, Wine
chapter topic; Chapter 17, p. 215
breakfast *das Frühstück*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 631
Bridge, Church, Pharmacy, Village, Police
chapter topic; Chapter 97, p. 783
bright, light *hell*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1217
broken *kaputt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1513
Broken, Clever, Free of charge, Strong, Single
chapter topic; Chapter 217, p. 1513
Brot and bread
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 17, p. 215
brother — the same word as English brother with one vowel of difference *der Bruder*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 16, p. 199
brown *braun*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 759
Bruder and frater
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 16, p. 199
busy *beschäftigt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 993
Busy, Free, Closed, Quiet, Narrow
chapter topic; Chapter 131, p. 993
but rather — the second "but", reserved for correcting a negative, which is the same job doch does for a question *sondern*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 48, p. 485
but — the third joiner, and the first word in the book that sets two thoughts against each other *aber*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 48, p. 485
butter *die Butter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 943
Butter, Sauce, Vinegar, Dessert, Meal
chapter topic; Chapter 123, p. 943
by the way *übrigens*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1719
By the way, Anyway, At most, At least, During
chapter topic; Chapter 251, p. 1719

bye, casually — and secretly the same blessing as adiós *tschüss*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 4, p. 57

C

Cake, Soup, Honey, Oil, Lunch
chapter topic; Chapter 71, p. 625
can, to be able — English *can*, and a verb that once meant *to know* *können*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 51, p. 515
Candle, Calendar, Jumper, Tie, Gloves
chapter topic; Chapter 118, p. 913
careful *vorsichtig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1555
caution *die Vorsicht*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1665
cheap *billig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 741
cheerful *fröhlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1495
Cheerful, Terrible, Patient, Stingy, Cosy
chapter topic; Chapter 214, p. 1495
cheese *der Käse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 637
childhood *die Kindheit*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1605
Childhood, Knowledge, Culture, Art, A landscape
chapter topic; Chapter 232, p. 1605
chocolate *die Schokolade*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 937
clean *sauber*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 753
Clean, Dirty, Thick, Thin, Quiet
chapter topic; Chapter 92, p. 753
clever *klug*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1513
closed *geschlossen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 993
clothes *die Kleidung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 98, p. 789
cloudy *bewölkt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1483
Cloudy, Blond, Honest, Urgent, Lonely
chapter topic; Chapter 212, p. 1483

coffee — a loanword that crossed from Arabic to German by way of Turkish and Italian, and the first word in a new polite request *der Kaffee*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 41, p. 427
Coffee, Tea, and Milk
chapter topic; Chapter 41, p. 427
cold *die Kälte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1393
Comb, Bin, Broom, Washing machine, Armchair
chapter topic; Chapter 115, p. 895
comfortable *bequem*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1211
Comfortable, Unfriendly, Polite, Exciting, Possible
chapter topic; Chapter 167, p. 1211
cool *kühl*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 1017
cosy *gemütlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1495
courage *der Mut*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1617
cream *die Sahne*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 649
Cream, Pepper, Nut, Beer, To cut
chapter topic; Chapter 75, p. 649
culture *die Kultur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1605
Cup, Plate, Glass, Fork, Knife
chapter topic; Chapter 79, p. 673
Cupboard, Floor, Stairs, Mirror, Flat
chapter topic; Chapter 78, p. 667
curious *neugierig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1525
Curious, Useful, Public, Tidy, Personal
chapter topic; Chapter 219, p. 1525
cutlery *das Besteck*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1411

D

damp *feucht*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1489
dangerous *gefährlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 1017

Dangerous, Wet, Dry, Cool, Soft
chapter topic; Chapter 135, p. 1017
dark *dunkel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1217
(das Wetter, es regnet, continued) — es regnet
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 34, p. 377
day (der Tag — masculine) *Tag*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
dead *tot*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1543
December — decem, ten, the last month and the last of the four numbered ones *der Dezember*
explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 14, p. 175
den — the form the book has owed you since einen
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 47, p. 475
der angekommene Zug — where the ending comes back
grammar topic; explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar; Chapter 29, p. 345
(der Kopf, continued) — The old cup
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 30, p. 359
der Stamm — drop the *-en*, and you have the machine
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 5, p. 83
Der Tag ist gut — the adjective that stays still
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 47, p. 475
desire (Lust haben: to feel like) *die Lust*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1199
(die Hand, continued) — Where the family tree stops
etymology topic; explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 30, p. 359
die Verbklammer — the bracket German has been building all along
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, usage and culture; Chapter 51, p. 515
different, various *verschieden*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1555
difficult *schwierig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 1011
dinner *das Abendessen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 631
Dinner, Breakfast, Rice, Pear, Lemon
chapter topic; Chapter 72, p. 631
dirty *schmutzig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 753
divorced *geschieden*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1501
Dog and Cat
chapter topic; Chapter 35, p. 381

dog and cat — Hund is native Germanic, cognate with English's OWN discarded word "hound"; Katze, surprisingly, is NOT native — it's the same borrowed Latin word behind French chat and Spanish gato (though not every European language shares it) *Hund, Katze*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 35, p. 381
down, downstairs *unten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 857
dreadful *schrecklich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1537
Dress, Trousers, Shoe, Cap, Sock
chapter topic; Chapter 99, p. 795
dry *trocken*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 1017
Duck, Sheep, Goat, Lion, Monkey
chapter topic; Chapter 87, p. 723
during, while *während*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1719

E

ear — another direct Germanic cousin of its English translation, and the sense hören already named *das Ohr*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 43, p. 439
early — the word the first season is built out of, though not a cousin of English early *früh*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 15, p. 185
eight — the rasp you already own, on a number you already know *acht*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 8, p. 115
eighteen — the digit whole again, and the -cht you have had since Nacht *achtzehn*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 231
eighty *achtzig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 1035
ein und eine — when "one" becomes "a"
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 7, p. 109
eleven — and it is not irregular, it is a different rule *elf*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 18, p. 225
empty *leer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 741
especially *besonders*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1247

evening (der Abend — masculine) *Abend*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
everyday life *der Alltag*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1561
exactly *genau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1241
excellent *ausgezeichnet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1477
excited, nervous *aufgeregt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1477
exciting *spannend*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1211
experience *die Erfahrung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1205
eye — the third gender back on a body part, and a direct Germanic cousin of English eye *das Auge*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 43, p. 439
Eyes, Ears, Mouth, Nose
chapter topic; Chapter 43, p. 439

F

Face, Blood, Skin, Hair, Belly
chapter topic; Chapter 57, p. 541
Fair, Divorced, At the same time, Generous, Good value
chapter topic; Chapter 215, p. 1501
fair, even-handed *gerecht*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1501
faithful, loyal *treu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1549
Faithful, Typical, Impatient, Unhappy, Married
chapter topic; Chapter 223, p. 1549
family — the whole group the Eltern and Geschwister already named the members of, and this chapter's one Latin loan beside two native words *die Familie*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 42, p. 433
famous *berühmt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 1005
fantastic *fantastisch*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1489
far *weit*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 771
Farewells
chapter topic; Chapter 4, p. 57

Farmer, Baker, Driver, Lawyer, Engineer
chapter topic; Chapter 125, p. 957
fashion *die Mode*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1617
fast *schnell*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 735
father — spelled with a V and said with an f, which is the whole chapter in one letter *der Vater*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 16, p. 199
fear *die Angst*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 565
Fear, Joy, Son, Daughter, Grandfather
chapter topic; Chapter 61, p. 565
February — the one month named for a ritual rather than a person or a god *der Februar*
explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 13, p. 163
Fever, Doctor, Doctor, Hospital, Ill
chapter topic; Chapter 59, p. 553
fifteen — the rule's third run, and where English clipped and German did not *fünfzehn*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 231
fifty *fünfzig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 807
finally *endlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1229
finger — identical to its English cousin, and possibly, though not certainly, built on the word for "five" *der Finger*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 44, p. 447
finished, ready *fertig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 1011
fire *das Feuer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 84, p. 705
first *zuerst*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1235
Fish, Meat, Chicken, Fruit, Apple
chapter topic; Chapter 69, p. 613
five — and the p-to-f law caught in one word *fünf*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 7, p. 109
flour *das Mehl*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 937
fog *der Nebel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1393
foot — the fourth name from the *Hand* table, and the same p-to-f Grimm's law pattern Vater already taught *der Fuß*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 44, p. 447

football *der Fußball*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 981
for, because — the reason word that leaves the sentence alone, and the same word as dann and English *then* *denn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 48, p. 485
foreign, strange *fremd*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1223
Forest, Stone, Island, Field, Sky
chapter topic; Chapter 83, p. 699
forty *vierzig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 807
Four, Five, and the Article Hiding in Eins
chapter topic; Chapter 7, p. 109
Four lines, and the joiner you can see
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 55, p. 533
four — spelt with a v, said with an f *vier*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 7, p. 109
fourteen — the rule's second run, with the V that is an f *vierzehn*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 231
free *frei*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 993
free of charge *kostenlos*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1513
frequent *häufig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1507
Friday — the one day named for a goddess, and the Roman she replaced *Freitag*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 10, p. 127
friend — a Germanic cousin of English friend, both frozen out of the same old verb meaning "to love" *der Freund*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 42, p. 433
Friend and Family
chapter topic; Chapter 42, p. 433
friend (female) — built on Freund with the native feminine suffix -in, the same suffix English kept in exactly one fossil word, vixen *die Freundin*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 42, p. 433
friendly *freundlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 999
fruit *das Obst*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 613
full *voll*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1217

fun *der Spaß*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1199
funny *lustig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 1005
funny, witty *witzig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1555

G

Garden, Lamp, Bath, Room, Bed
chapter topic; Chapter 77, p. 661
garlic *der Knoblauch*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 937
Garlic, Flour, Chocolate, Biscuit, Bread roll
chapter topic; Chapter 122, p. 937
ge-...-t — the wrap that makes a participle
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 23, p. 275
gegangen — the other half of the past
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 51, p. 515
gegangen — the participle that never changes
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, usage and culture; Chapter 29, p. 345
generous *großzügig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1501
German, the language — and it means "of the people" *Deutsch*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 83
glasses *die Brille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 901
gloves *die Handschuhe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 913
Going, Running, Opening, Closing
chapter topic; Chapter 40, p. 417
good evening *Guten Abend*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
good morning *Guten Morgen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
good night *Gute Nacht*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1
good value, favourable *günstig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1501
good; well *gut*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
goodbye, formally — literally "on the seeing-again" *auf Wiedersehen*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 4, p. 57

Gott plus Tag
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 10, p. 127
Grandmother, Woman, Girl, Uncle, Aunt
chapter topic; Chapter 62, p. 571
Grape, Jam, Cheese, Salt, Sugar
chapter topic; Chapter 73, p. 637
grass *das Gras*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1405
Grass, A fruit, A carrot, A chicken, A gateau
chapter topic; Chapter 199, p. 1405
Green and Yellow
chapter topic; Chapter 36, p. 385
green and yellow — grün is native Germanic, the direct cousin of English's OWN "green" (a different root entirely from Latin's viridis); gelb is native too, and is usually said to share its ultimate PIE root with French's jaune, though that particular link is less secure than it first appears *grün, gelb*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 385
Greetings
chapter topic; Chapter 1, p. 1
grey *grau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 765
Grey, Purple, Second, Always, Immediately
chapter topic; Chapter 94, p. 765
Großschreibung — why German capitalises every noun
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing, grammar, usage and culture; Chapter 4, p. 57
(grün, gelb, continued) — gelb
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 385

H

hab- through the machine
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 22, p. 265
haben is not habēre
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 22, p. 265
haben plus a participle — the everyday past
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 24, p. 285
Hallo — copy one greeting with help
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
Hallo — write it from the sound
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
Hallo — write it with the model covered
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

ham *der Schinken*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 74, p. 643
happy *glücklich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 559
hard-working *fleißig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 999
Hard-working, Lazy, Awake, Nice, Friendly
chapter topic; Chapter 132, p. 999
having a cold *erkältet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1489
he did that — the third slot, and the first Perfekt sentence with something in the middle *er hat das gemacht*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 24, p. 285
he has — the second and last form where the b falls out *er hat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 22, p. 265
he is — the form that also serves sie, es and das, and the one that matches Latin est *er ist*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 26, p. 311
he, she, it — the three third-person pronouns, and the -t they share *er · sie · es*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 83
he was — the same word as ich war, because the German simple past gives its third person no ending *er war*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 28, p. 333
Head and Hand
chapter topic; Chapter 30, p. 359
healthy *gesund*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 559
Healthy, Thirst, Hunger, Sad, Happy
chapter topic; Chapter 60, p. 559
heart — the last name from the *Hand* table, closing it with the same k-to-h Grimm's law swap already heard on hören and Hund *das Herz*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 44, p. 447
heat *die Hitze*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1393
Heavy, Cheap, High, Low, Empty
chapter topic; Chapter 90, p. 741
heavy; difficult *schwer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 741
hello / good day (polite) *Guten Tag*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
hello (informal) *hallo*
explicit focus: pronunciation, writing, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1

helpful *hilfsbereit*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1507
her — the fourth of the six, and a word that now does three separate jobs in this book *ihr*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 49, p. 495
Herbst and harvest
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 15, p. 185
high, tall *hoch*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 741
him — the pronoun that moves on the same row as den, einen, keinen and meinen *ihn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 505
himself, herself, itself, themselves — one German word where English needs four, and the pronoun that bends a verb back onto its own subject *sich*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 50, p. 505
his — spelled exactly like the verb *to be*, and the collision is worth meeting head-on *sein*
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 49, p. 495
Homegrown numbers, imported months
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, usage and culture; Chapter 9, p. 119
homework *die Hausaufgabe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 975
Homework, Idea, Sentence, Page, Drawing
chapter topic; Chapter 128, p. 975
honest *ehrlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1483
honey *der Honig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 625
hope *die Hoffnung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1599
how *wie*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
How Are You?
chapter topic; Chapter 3, p. 33
how are you? — informal, and every piece already yours *Wie geht es dir?*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 3, p. 33
how much and how many — one distinction German marks and English marks too, on a word that is English *full* *wie viel · wie viele*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 47, p. 475

how old are you — word for word the English question, built from four words you own *Wie alt bist du?*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 27, p. 323
humour *der Humor*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1599
(Hund, Katze, continued) — Katze
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 35, p. 381
hunger *der Hunger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 559

I

I *ich*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
I am — the first form of sein, and it comes from a different verb than the infinitive does *ich bin*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 26, p. 311
I am twenty years old — the answer, word for word the English sentence *ich bin zwanzig Jahre alt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 27, p. 323
I Am, You Are
chapter topic; Chapter 26, p. 311
I could — a Präteritum that survives in ordinary speech everywhere, north and south alike *ich konnte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 25, p. 297
I had — haben's own Präteritum, and one of the handful that everybody says out loud *ich hatte*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 25, p. 297
I made, I did — the second verb through the -te ending *ich machte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 25, p. 297
I said, in one word — the Präteritum of sagen, beside the Perfekt that means exactly the same *ich sagte*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 25, p. 297
I said — the first filled slot of the Perfekt, and a sentence you can use whole *ich habe gesagt*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 24, p. 285
I was — the past of sein, and a third stem that shares nothing with the other two *ich war*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 28, p. 333
Ice, Hill, Desert, Horse, Cow
chapter topic; Chapter 85, p. 711

ice; ice cream *das Eis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 85, p. 711
ich bin gegangen — the perfect built on sein
grammar topic; explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar; Chapter 29, p. 345
ich bin gewesen — and the rest of the learned list
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 29, p. 345
ill, sick *krank*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 553
immediately *sofort*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 765
impatient *ungeduldig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1549
important *wichtig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 759
impossible *unmöglich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1217
Impossible, Bright, Dark, Full, Old-fashioned
chapter topic; Chapter 168, p. 1217
in any case *jedenfalls*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1713
in love *verliebt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1555
In love, Different, Careful, Windy, Funny
chapter topic; Chapter 224, p. 1555
in — the same word as English in, and it needs no learning at all *in*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 5, p. 83
independent, self-employed *selbstständig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1537
industry *die Industrie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1471
Industry, A workshop, A shop, A butcher's, A department store
chapter topic; Chapter 210, p. 1471
insurance *die Versicherung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1149
intelligent *intelligent*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1507
interesting *interessant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 1005
Introducing Yourself
chapter topic; Chapter 2, p. 21
"it goes" — the German shrug, and what saying nothing extra means *es geht*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 33

It means "I said," not only "I have said"
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 24, p. 285
it — the placeholder German puts in front of a state *es*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 3, p. 33

J

(ja, continued) — A German habit to file away
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 31, p. 367
Jahr and alt, taken apart
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 27, p. 323
jam *die Marmelade*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 637
January — Janus, the god of doorways, which is what a first month is *der Januar*
explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 13, p. 163
jealous *eifersüchtig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1489
Jealous, Successful, Having a cold, Fantastic, Damp
chapter topic; Chapter 213, p. 1489
Job, Class, Exam, Board, Rubber
chapter topic; Chapter 127, p. 969
joy *die Freude*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 565
juice *der Saft*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 74, p. 643
Juice, Sausage, Ham, Salad, Noodles
chapter topic; Chapter 74, p. 643
July — the first month in the year named after a man, and he named it himself *der Juli*
explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 14, p. 175
June — Juno, queen of the gods, and a j that sounds like Januar's *der Juni*
explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 13, p. 163

K

kein oder nicht — picking the right one
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 45, p. 455
kind, dear *lieb*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1519
knowledge (of something) *die Kenntnis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1605

Komm! — the sentence with no subject at all
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 46, p. 465
(Kopf / Haupt, continued) — Two container metaphors
grammar topic; explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 30, p. 359
Kopf / Haupt — two head-words
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 30, p. 359

L

late — and später, "later," your first comparative *spät*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 57
later, afterwards *nachher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1235
lazy *faul*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 999
learned — the wrap on lernen, and the sentence you can finally say about yourself *gelernt*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 23, p. 275
leather *das Leder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1435
Leather, Wood, Metal, Plastic, The body
chapter topic; Chapter 204, p. 1435
Leg, Tooth, Neck, Shoulder, Knee
chapter topic; Chapter 56, p. 535
lessons, teaching *der Unterricht*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1659
Library, Bicycle, Bus or tram stop, Clothes, Shirt
chapter topic; Chapter 98, p. 789
-lif — "left over"
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 18, p. 225
light; easy *leicht*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 735
lightning *der Blitz*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1393
likeable *sympathisch*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1543
lived, dwelt — the wrap on wohnen, and the English fossil that still means "accustomed" *gewohnt*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 23, p. 275
lonely *einsam*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1483
low *niedrig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 741

luck, happiness *das Glück*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1199
luggage *das Gepäck*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1369
lunch *das Mittagessen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 625

M

made, done — the wrap applied to machen, and the one spelling surprise in it *gemacht*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 23, p. 275
many thanks — the noun behind danke, and the warmest everyday thank-you *vielen Dank*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 3, p. 33
March — Mars's month, and once the first month of the whole Roman year *der März*
explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 13, p. 163
married *verheiratet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1549
März and Dienstag
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 13, p. 163
material, fabric *der Stoff*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1429
May — Maia, a goddess of growth, and the shortest month name German has *der Mai*
explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 13, p. 163
me — the object form of ich *mich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
meat *das Fleisch*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 613
metal *das Metall*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1435
midnight — the second pivot, and the -cht/-ght pair paying off again *die Mitternacht*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 12, p. 149
milk — the native Germanic word that closes this trio, standing beside two loanwords the way Wasser once stood beside the loanword Wein *die Milch*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 41, p. 427
Mine, Yours, His, Hers
chapter topic; Chapter 49, p. 495

Mittag and midi
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 12, p. 149
Monday — the pattern's first instance, and the one weekday English and German name identically *Montag*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 10, p. 127
money *das Geld*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 81, p. 687
morning (der Morgen — masculine) *Morgen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
mostly, usually *meistens*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1229
mother — a die-word, and the one family word whose first sound nothing ever touched *die Mutter*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 16, p. 199
mouth — the same inherited word as English mouth, with a root the standard accounts do not agree on past Proto-Germanic *der Mund*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 43, p. 439
music *die Musik*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 813
must, to have to — English *must*, one of the very few English verbs with no *-s* in the third person, for the same reason *müssen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 51, p. 515
Mutter and mater
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 16, p. 199
my name is… (literally "I am called…") *ich heiße…*
explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 2, p. 21
my — pulled out of the phrase it has been hiding in since you first gave your name, and the head of a family of six words that share one set of endings *mein*
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 49, p. 495

N

narrow; tight *eng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 993
Neighbour, Guest, Grandson, Pupil, Pupil
chapter topic; Chapter 63, p. 577
(nein, continued) — One "no" runs across the whole chain
etymology topic; explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 31, p. 367
nervous *nervös*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1223

never *nie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 1029
nevertheless *trotzdem*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1713
next to *neben*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 863
Next to, Between, Behind, Underground, Tram
chapter topic; Chapter 110, p. 863
next week *nächste Woche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1059
next year *nächstes Jahr*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1059
nice, kind *nett*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 999
nicht am Ende — where the "not" goes
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, usage and culture; Chapter 45, p. 455
night (die Nacht — feminine) *Nacht*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
Nine, Ten, and the Months That Are Numbers
chapter topic; Chapter 9, p. 119
nine — the oy vowel from Deutsch, twice in one word *neun*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 9, p. 119
nineteen — the last of the -zehn numbers, and the rule's eighth clean run *neunzehn*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 231
ninety *neunzig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 1035
no *nein*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 31, p. 367
no, not a — for a der-word that is the thing you have, the negative twin of einen *keinen*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 45, p. 455
no, not a — in front of a die-word, and in front of every plural, wearing the same -e that eine wears *keine*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 45, p. 455
no, not a — the word German builds out of "not" and "one", exactly as English built *none* *kein*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 45, p. 455
noise *der Lärm*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1611
Noise, A mood, A CV, An achievement, A lesson
chapter topic; Chapter 233, p. 1611
noodles, pasta *die Nudeln*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 74, p. 643

noon — Mitte plus Tag, a compound you can read before you are told it *der Mittag*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 12, p. 149
North, South, East, West, Straight on
chapter topic; Chapter 108, p. 851
nose — the fourth face-part, cousin of English nose and of Latin nasus, and the payoff that completes the face *Kopf* only started *die Nase*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 43, p. 439
not — German's plain negator *nicht*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 3, p. 33
Not One, Not a Scrap
chapter topic; Chapter 45, p. 455
November — novem, nine, and a word German and English spell identically *der November*
explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 14, p. 175

O

October — octo, eight, and German spells the Latin c as a k because German spells that sound with a k *der Oktober*
explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 14, p. 175
of course *natürlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1241
Office, Corner, Crossroads, Traffic lights, Car park
chapter topic; Chapter 107, p. 845
often *oft*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 1029
oil *das Öl*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 625
old-fashioned *altmodisch*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1217
old — the adjective the German age sentence is built on *alt*
explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 27, p. 323
on the right *rechts*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 771
on, upon — the small word the formal goodbye is built on *auf*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 57
one — and the ei that is always the English word "eye" *eins*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 103
One Left Over
chapter topic; Chapter 18, p. 225

One, Two, Three
chapter topic; Chapter 6, p. 103
one verb, three endings — the ending machine every German verb runs *ich heiße / du heißt / Sie heißen*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
Only, First, Afterwards, Before, Later
chapter topic; Chapter 171, p. 1235
only (so far), not until *erst*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1235
opening hours *die Öffnungszeiten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1065
opposite *gegenüber*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 857
or — the second joining word, on the same Germanic root as English *or*, and the tag question every German speaker ends a sentence with *oder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 48, p. 485
orange (the colour) *orange*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 987
order, tidiness *die Ordnung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1623

P

paper *das Papier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 681
parents — a plural with no singular, and underneath it a comparative meaning "the older ones" *die Eltern*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 16, p. 199
patient *geduldig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1495
people *die Leute*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1199
People, Luck, Fun, Desire, An opinion
chapter topic; Chapter 165, p. 1199
pepper *der Pfeffer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 649
perhaps *vielleicht*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1241
permission *die Erlaubnis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1579
personal *persönlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1525

Pig, Bird, Mouse, Fox, Snake
chapter topic; Chapter 86, p. 717
pink *rosa*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 987
Pink, Orange, Pretty, Round, Wide
chapter topic; Chapter 130, p. 987
plastic *der Kunststoff*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1435
Please
chapter topic; Chapter 32, p. 371
please — and also "you're welcome," "here you go," and "pardon?" *bitte*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 3, p. 33
please — place the familiar courtesy word after a small request *bitte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 32, p. 371
pleased to meet you (literally "it gladdens me") *freut mich*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
polite *höflich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1211
politics *die Politik*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1465
possible *möglich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1211
Postman, Waiter, Customer, Till, Boss
chapter topic; Chapter 126, p. 963
pretty *hübsch*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 987
probably *wahrscheinlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1241
pronunciation *die Aussprache*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1567
Pronunciation, A meaning, A greeting, A description, A visit
chapter topic; Chapter 226, p. 1567
proud *stolz*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1223
public *öffentlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1525
punctual *pünktlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1531
Punctual, Rainy, Raw, Salty, Sour
chapter topic; Chapter 220, p. 1531
purple *lila*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 765

Purse, Ring, Chain, Present, Photo
chapter topic; Chapter 117, p. 907

Q

quality *die Qualität*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1629
quiet *leise*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 753
quiet, calm *die Ruhe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1635
quiet, calm *ruhig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 993
Quite, Especially, About, Together, Alone
chapter topic; Chapter 173, p. 1247
quite, fairly *ziemlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1247

R

rain *der Regen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 84, p. 705
rainy *regnerisch*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1531
rarely *selten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1229
Rarely, Mostly, Right away, Finally, Still
chapter topic; Chapter 170, p. 1229
rather, preferably *lieber*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 1023
raw *roh*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1531
Reading — Nouns, Sentences, and a First Paragraph
chapter topic; Chapter 52, p. 525
ready, willing *bereit*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 1011
red — the third colour, and the one humans name first after black and white *rot*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 21, p. 257
relaxed, loose *locker*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1519
religion *die Religion*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1629

Restaurant, Bakery, Cinema, Theatre, Town hall
chapter topic; Chapter 105, p. 833
rice *der Reis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 631
rich *reich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 747
right away, in a moment *gleich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1229
right, correct *richtig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 759
Right, Wrong, Important, Simple, Brown
chapter topic; Chapter 93, p. 759
rot, taken apart
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 21, p. 257
round *rund*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 987
Rug, Television, Computer, Fridge, Cooker
chapter topic; Chapter 112, p. 875

S

sad *traurig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 559
safe; sure *sicher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 1011
safety, security *die Sicherheit*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1641
said — the first past participle, and the first time a German ending arrives with a beginning attached *gesagt*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 23, p. 275
salt *das Salz*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 637
salty *salzig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1531
Saturday in the north — Sun-eve, built from two words you already own *Sonnabend*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 11, p. 139
Saturday — the second day that breaks the pattern, and the only one German bought rather than inherited *Samstag*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 11, p. 139
Scarf, Boots, Skirt, Coat, Shoes
chapter topic; Chapter 119, p. 919
School, Card, Picture, Bag, Money
chapter topic; Chapter 81, p. 687

schwarz, taken apart
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 20, p. 247
Schwester and soror
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 16, p. 199
season — literally year-time, a compound you can now read without being told *die Jahreszeit*
explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 15, p. 185
see you later — the vaguest of the bis... family *bis später*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 4, p. 57
see you soon — the first of the bis... family *bis bald*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 4, p. 57
see you tomorrow — and the bis... family, complete *bis morgen*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 57
sein, not haben
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, usage and culture; Chapter 27, p. 323
sense, meaning *der Sinn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1641
September — the seventh month, which is now the ninth, and the name never caught up *der September*
explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 14, p. 175
serious *ernst*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 1005
seven — and the s that buzzes at the front of a word *sieben*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 8, p. 115
seventeen — sieben without its -en, one syllable saved *siebzehn*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 231
seventy *siebzig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 1035
shampoo *das Shampoo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1423
shiny, polished, bare — a German word that is not a colour, and became one abroad *blank*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 20, p. 247
shoes *die Schuhe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 919
Shop, Market, Railway station, Aeroplane, Car
chapter topic; Chapter 96, p. 777
short *kurz*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 735
Shower, Bathtub, Shelf, Curtain, Cushion
chapter topic; Chapter 113, p. 881
shy *schüchtern*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1537
Siblings, not borrowings
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, usage and culture; Chapter 6, p. 103

siblings — one word for brothers and sisters together, which English has to say in three *die Geschwister*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 16, p. 199
silk *die Seide*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1429
simple *einfach*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 759
single (unmarried) *ledig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1513
sister — and once you strip the sch back to an s it is the English word *die Schwester*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 16, p. 199
Sitting, Standing, Sleeping, Hearing
chapter topic; Chapter 39, p. 407
Six, Seven, Eight
chapter topic; Chapter 8, p. 115
six — where chs is simply an x *sechs*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 8, p. 115
sixteen — sechs without its s, because the s and the ts would collide *sechzehn*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 231
sixty *sechzig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 1035
Sixty, Seventy, Eighty, Ninety, Million
chapter topic; Chapter 138, p. 1035
skin *die Haut*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 541
slim *schlank*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1537
Slim, Dreadful, Shy, Independent, Sunny
chapter topic; Chapter 221, p. 1537
slow *langsam*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 735
small *klein*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 735
Small, Short, Fast, Slow, Light
chapter topic; Chapter 89, p. 735
so-so — the sing-song middle of the answer ladder *so lala*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 3, p. 33
soap *die Seife*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 889
socks *die Socken*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 925
Socks, Blouse, Beef, Vegetables, Mushroom
chapter topic; Chapter 120, p. 925

soft *weich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 1017
sometimes *manchmal*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 771
Song, Game, Colour, Journey, Holiday
chapter topic; Chapter 103, p. 819
soon — and the same word as English bold *bald*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 4, p. 57
Sorry
chapter topic; Chapter 33, p. 373
sorry / excuse me (literally "un-guilting," from Schuld "guilt/fault") *Entschuldigung*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 33, p. 373
sour, annoyed *sauer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1531
Spoon, Bottle, Exercise book, Pen, Paper
chapter topic; Chapter 80, p. 681
sport *der Sport*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 981
Sport, Film, Football, Concert, Celebration
chapter topic; Chapter 129, p. 981
sporty *sportlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1543
spring — früh plus -ling, "the early one", a season German named rather than borrowed *der Frühling*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 15, p. 185
spring, the old poetic word — worth recognising, not worth saying *der Lenz*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 15, p. 185
Star, Cloud, Rain, Pond, Fire
chapter topic; Chapter 84, p. 705
still, yet *noch*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1229
stingy *geizig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1495
straight on *geradeaus*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 851
strict *streng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1543
strong *stark*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 747
strong, hearty *kräftig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1513
Strong, Weak, Rich, Ugly, Sweet
chapter topic; Chapter 91, p. 747

successful *erfolgreich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1489
sugar *der Zucker*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 637
summer — the season whose German and English names are the same word, barely disguised *der Sommer*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 15, p. 185
Sunday — the one day the Church left alone, where Romance renamed it entirely *Sonntag*
explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 11, p. 139
sunny *sonnig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1537
Supermarket, Petrol station, Swimming pool, Stadium, Factory
chapter topic; Chapter 106, p. 839
Suppletion — filling a verb in from another verb
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 28, p. 333
surgery hours, office hours *die Sprechstunde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1441
sweet *süß*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 747

T

Taking, Asking, Helping, Liking
chapter topic; Chapter 38, p. 397
tasty *lecker*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1519
Tasty, Kind, Relaxed, Thin, Brave
chapter topic; Chapter 218, p. 1519
Taxi, Ticket, Suitcase, Lift, To fly
chapter topic; Chapter 111, p. 869
-te — the one-word past
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 25, p. 297
tea — a word that looks like its English cousin and is not said like it, and travelled to Europe by sea rather than overland *der Tee*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 41, p. 427
Telephone, Tree, Flower, Leaf, Mountain
chapter topic; Chapter 82, p. 693
Telling the Time
chapter topic; Chapter 12, p. 149
telling the time — es ist, a number you own, and Uhr *Es ist zwei Uhr*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 12, p. 149

ten — one consonant photographed three times *zehn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 9, p. 119
terrible *furchtbar*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1495
thank you — which is really "I think of you" *danke*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 33
the afternoon *der Nachmittag*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1205
The b that fell out
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 22, p. 265
the back (of the body) *der Rücken*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 547
the belly *der Bauch*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 541
the body *der Körper*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1435
The Bracket
chapter topic; Chapter 51, p. 515
the clock, and o'clock — the first everyday German word in this book that Rome supplied *die Uhr*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 12, p. 149
The Colour German Lent Away
chapter topic; Chapter 20, p. 247
the day after tomorrow *übermorgen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1059
The dental preterite — a Germanic invention
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 25, p. 297
the east *der Osten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 851
the economy *die Wirtschaft*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1465
The endings you can actually hear
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 5, p. 83
the environment *die Umwelt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1659
The environment, Lessons, A difference, A cause, Behaviour
chapter topic; Chapter 241, p. 1659
the face *das Gesicht*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 541
the fire brigade *die Feuerwehr*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1453
The First Verbs
chapter topic; Chapter 5, p. 83
the floor; the ground *der Boden*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 667

the flu *die Grippe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1143
The forms that stayed spoken
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 25, p. 297
the future *die Zukunft*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1059
The Future, Next Week, the Day after Tomorrow, Next Year, To Plan
chapter topic; Chapter 142, p. 1059
The gathering Ge-
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, usage and culture; Chapter 16, p. 199
The ge- that English lost
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 23, p. 275
The German Weekend
chapter topic; Chapter 11, p. 139
The Gods of the Week
chapter topic; Chapter 10, p. 127
the government *die Regierung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1459
the hand — the same word as English, and unrelated to Romance manus *die Hand*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 30, p. 359
the head — masculine, capitalised, with final pf *der Kopf*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 30, p. 359
the internet *das Internet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1161
the (masculine / feminine / neuter) *der / die / das*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
the middle — the native piece both of the day's pivots are built from *die Mitte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 12, p. 149
the month — and the word itself is the moon, before Rome supplied the names to put in it *der Monat*
explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 13, p. 163
the moon — the noun the first weekday is built on, and English's own word untouched *der Mond*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 10, p. 127
the neck; the throat *der Hals*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 56, p. 535
the north *der Norden*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 851
The One It Happens To
chapter topic; Chapter 50, p. 505

the opposite *das Gegenteil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1593
The opposite, A story, A conversation, Weight, A habit
chapter topic; Chapter 230, p. 1593
The Pair That Proves Grimm's Law
chapter topic; Chapter 16, p. 199
The participle waits at the back
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 24, p. 285
The Past Built From Have
chapter topic; Chapter 24, p. 285
The Past That Takes To Be
chapter topic; Chapter 29, p. 345
The Pattern That Never Breaks
chapter topic; Chapter 19, p. 231
the plural of das Jahr, which is the form the age sentence needs and the only form it uses *die Jahre*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 27, p. 323
the police *die Polizei*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 783
the population *die Bevölkerung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1459
the post office; the post *die Post*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 827
the public *die Öffentlichkeit*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1623
the rent *die Miete*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1065
The Rent, an Advert, an Appointment, Opening Hours, a Receipt
chapter topic; Chapter 143, p. 1065
The Roman Calendar
chapter topic; Chapter 13, p. 163
the Sabbath — the only word in the week that is neither Germanic nor Latin *der Sabbat*
Chapter 11, p. 139
The same retreat, three times over
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 25, p. 297
The same writing, with a clock
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 54, p. 531
The Seasons Go Native
chapter topic; Chapter 15, p. 185
The Simple Past
chapter topic; Chapter 25, p. 297
the sky; heaven *der Himmel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 699

the south *der Süden*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 851
the stairs *die Treppe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 667
the stomach *der Magen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 547
the sun — the noun behind Sunday, and a die-word where English has no gender at all *die Sonne*
explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 11, p. 139
the surroundings *die Umgebung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1653
the temperature *die Temperatur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1187
The temperature, A birthday, A wedding, A party, An invitation
chapter topic; Chapter 163, p. 1187
the — the one plural article German uses for every gender *die (plural)*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
the tongue *die Zunge*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 547
the truth *die Wahrheit*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1671
The two clipped digits
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, usage and culture; Chapter 19, p. 231
the underground *die U-Bahn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 863
the weather *das Wetter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1181
the weekend *das Wochenende*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 1029
the west *der Westen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 851
the wind *der Wind*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1181
The word that emigrated
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 20, p. 247
the world *die Welt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 100, p. 801
The Wrapped Participle
chapter topic; Chapter 23, p. 275
the year — the span the twelve months add up to, and a word German never borrowed *das Jahr*
explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 15, p. 185
there *dort*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 771

there is, there are — literally "it gives", and it takes the done-to form this chapter has taught *es gibt*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 47, p. 475
therefore *deshalb*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1713
they are, and the polite you are — one form, and the capital letter is the only difference *sie sind / Sie sind*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 26, p. 311
thick; fat *dick*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 753
thin *dünn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 753
thin, lean *mager*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1519
thirst *der Durst*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 559
thirteen — the rule's first run, and it is exactly what you would predict *dreizehn*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 231
thirty *dreißig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 807
Thirty, Forty, Fifty, Hundred, Thousand
chapter topic; Chapter 101, p. 807
this is — the phrase that introduces somebody else, using a das that stands for no gender at all *Das ist mein Bruder*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 49, p. 495
thorough *gründlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1507
Thorough, Frequent, Wonderful, Helpful, Intelligent
chapter topic; Chapter 216, p. 1507
three — the same word, with th worn down to d *drei*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 6, p. 103
Three Verbs Under One Roof
chapter topic; Chapter 28, p. 333
thrifty *sparsam*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1543
Thrifty, Sporty, Strict, Likeable, Dead
chapter topic; Chapter 222, p. 1543
thunder — the noun, and the god's name hiding inside it *der Donner*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 10, p. 127
Thursday — the thunder-god's day, and the same god-slot under three names *Donnerstag*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 10, p. 127

tidy, proper *ordentlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1525
time — a Germanic word with no Latin in it at all, and the second half of the word for season *die Zeit*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 15, p. 185
tired — the first adjective that says something about a person, and it needs no ending here *müde*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 26, p. 311
tiring, demanding *anstrengend*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1477
to accept, to assume *annehmen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1677
to accompany *begleiten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1689
To accompany, To notice, To advise, To report, To visit
chapter topic; Chapter 246, p. 1689
to advise *beraten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1689
to allow *erlauben*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1283
to answer *antworten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 1041
to answer (a question) *beantworten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1683
to appear *erscheinen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1707
to apply (sich bewerben) *bewerben*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1271
To apply, To bend, To fry, To spell, To print
chapter topic; Chapter 177, p. 1271
to argue *streiten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1107
to arrange (sich verabreden: to make a date) *verabreden*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1345
to arrive *ankommen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1253
to ask — a weak verb whose vowel stays put, and whose closest English relatives came in from Latin as pray and precarious *fragen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 38, p. 397
to bake *backen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1259
to bathe *baden*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1259

to be called / to be named *heißen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
to be missing *fehlen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1083
to be — the partner of haben, and the most irregular verb German has *sein*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 26, p. 311
to become — the change-of-state half of the rule, in one word *werden*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 29, p. 345
to begin *beginnen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 1041
To begin, To visit, To answer, To lay, To put
chapter topic; Chapter 139, p. 1041
to believe *glauben*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 601
to bend, to turn *biegen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1271
to bloom *blühen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1695
to bring *bringen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 595
to bring along *mitbringen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1095
to build *bauen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1259
to buy *kaufen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 583
To buy, To play, To know, To find, To look for
chapter topic; Chapter 64, p. 583
to call *rufen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 601
To carry, To send, To count, To paint, To clean
chapter topic; Chapter 68, p. 607
to carry; to wear *tragen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 607
to catch *fangen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1289
to celebrate *feiern*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1083
to change *ändern*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1071
to change (money), to switch *wechseln*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1125

To change, To phone, To stop, To go out, To look
chapter topic; Chapter 144, p. 1071
to change (trains or buses) *umsteigen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1277
to choose, to vote, to dial *wählen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1357
to clean *putzen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 607
to clean *reinigen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1315
to climb *klettern*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1301
to climb, to rise *steigen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1333
to close — the second verb in these chapters that German kept and English lost, and the one that locked up Schloss, Schlüssel and Schluss *schließen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 40, p. 417
to collect *sammeln*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1101
to come — English come with one consonant shifted, and the second verb of the sein family *kommen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 29, p. 345
to compare *vergleichen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1351
To compare, To injure, To miss, To postpone, To use
chapter topic; Chapter 190, p. 1351
to complete, to add *ergänzen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1707
To complete, To get done, To appear, To produce, To demand
chapter topic; Chapter 249, p. 1707
to connect, to bandage *verbinden*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1345
to cook *kochen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 589
to cost *kosten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1095
To cost, To lend, To love, To bring along, To take along
chapter topic; Chapter 148, p. 1095
to count *zählen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 607
to cross *überqueren*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1339
to cry *weinen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 589

to cut *schneiden*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 649
to decide *entscheiden*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1077
to demand *fordern*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1707
to depart *abfahren*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1253
to describe *beschreiben*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1265
to die *sterben*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1107
to discover *entdecken*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1701
to discuss *diskutieren*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1695
to disturb *stören*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1107
to draw *zeichnen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1357
to dream *träumen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1113
to earn *verdienen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1119
to end *enden*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1701
to end, to finish *beenden*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1683
to enter, to step on *betreten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1265
to excuse (sich entschuldigen: to apologise) *entschuldigen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1701
to expect *erwarten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1289
To expect, To catch, To watch television, To hold on to, To whisper
chapter topic; Chapter 180, p. 1289
to explain *erklären*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1083
To explain, To be missing, To celebrate, To fill, To please
chapter topic; Chapter 146, p. 1083
to fall *fallen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1047
to fall asleep *einschlafen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1277

to feed, to nourish *ernähren*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1283
to feel *fühlen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1047
to fetch *holen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 729
to fight *kämpfen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1301
To fight, To climb, To take care, To land, To smile
chapter topic; Chapter 182, p. 1301
to fill *füllen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1083
to fill in (a form) *ausfüllen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1259
To fill in, To rest, To bake, To bathe, To build
chapter topic; Chapter 175, p. 1259
to find *finden*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 583
to find out, to experience *erfahren*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1701
to fly *fliegen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 869
to forbid *verbieten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1345
to forget *vergessen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 595
to fry, to roast *braten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1271
To furnish, To end, To discover, To excuse, To find out
chapter topic; Chapter 248, p. 1701
to furnish, to set up *einrichten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1701
to get done *erledigen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1707
to get dressed *sich anziehen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1047
to get off (a vehicle) *aussteigen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1277
to get on (a vehicle) *einsteigen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1277
to give (as a present) *schenken*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1101
to go — and the verb German uses for "how are you?" *gehen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 33

to go, and to walk — because German has no separate word for walking, and English's walk turns out to be a word about cloth *gehen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 40, p. 417
to go out *ausgehen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1071
to go shopping *einkaufen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1077
to greet *grüßen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1295
to hang *hängen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1089
To Have
chapter topic; Chapter 22, p. 265
to have breakfast *frühstücken*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1295
to have — the twin of English have, and the workhorse the rest of the book leans on *haben*
explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 22, p. 265
to hear — the same verb as English hear, and the closing of a chapter of four things you do without going anywhere *hören*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 39, p. 407
to help — the same word as English help, separated by one sound law, and still strong in German the way English's help once was *helfen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 38, p. 397
to hike *wandern*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1125
To hike, To change, To throw, To repeat, To pull
chapter topic; Chapter 153, p. 1125
to hit, to beat *schlagen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1321
to hold on to *festhalten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1289
to hope *hoffen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 1023
to hug *umarmen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1345
to hurry (sich beeilen) *beeilen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1265
to inform *informieren*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1295
to injure *verletzen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1351

to introduce *vorstellen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1119
to invite *einladen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1077
to jump *springen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1107
to keep *behalten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1265
to know (a fact) *wissen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 583
to know (a person or place) *kennen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1089
to land *landen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1301
to laugh *lachen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 589
to lay, to put (flat) *legen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 1041
to learn — and its noun is English lore *lernen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 83
to lend, to borrow *leihen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1095
to lie (be lying) *liegen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1047
To lie, To get dressed, To tell, To feel, To fall
chapter topic; Chapter 140, p. 1047
to like and to love — plus gern, the adverb that lets any verb say "I like doing this" and has no English shape at all *mögen, lieben*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 38, p. 397
to live *leben*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 601
to live, to dwell — your first regular German verb *wohnen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 83
to lock, to complete *abschließen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1677
to look after, to nurse *pflegen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1315
to look for *suchen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 583
to look (like) *aussehen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1071
to lose *verlieren*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 601
To lose, To believe, To need, To live, To call
chapter topic; Chapter 67, p. 601

to love *lieben*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1095
to make, to do — and it is just English make *machen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 83
to marry *heiraten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1089
to me, for me — the form German uses for the person a thing happens to *mir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 3, p. 33
to mean *bedeuten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1265
To mean, To hurry, To keep, To describe, To enter
chapter topic; Chapter 176, p. 1265
to measure *messen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1309
to meet *treffen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1113
To meet, To dream, To practise, To think over, To move
chapter topic; Chapter 151, p. 1113
to miss (a train, a chance) *verpassen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1351
to mix *mischen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1309
to move (house) *umziehen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1113
to name, to call *nennen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1101
To name, To smell, To collect, To give, To shout
chapter topic; Chapter 149, p. 1101
to need *brauchen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 601
to notice *bemerken*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1689
to offer *anbieten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1677
To offer, To accept, To refuse, To lock, To register
chapter topic; Chapter 244, p. 1677
to open — built on offen, which is English open, which is really the word up; and the doorway into German's separable verbs *öffnen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 40, p. 417
to order (food, a taxi) *bestellen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 1023
to pack *einpacken*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1695

to pack *packen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1053
to paint *malen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 607
To paint, To share, To talk on the phone, To separate, To cross
chapter topic; Chapter 188, p. 1339
to paint, to spread *streichen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1339
to park *parken*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1315
To park, To look after, To pick, To test, To clean
chapter topic; Chapter 184, p. 1315
to pass (an exam), to insist *bestehen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1695
To pass, To prove, To bloom, To discuss, To pack
chapter topic; Chapter 247, p. 1695
to pay *bezahlen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 589
to pay *zahlen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1053
to pay attention, to look after *aufpassen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1683
To pay attention, To spend, To pronounce, To answer, To end
chapter topic; Chapter 245, p. 1683
To pay, To rent, To pack, To repair, To start
chapter topic; Chapter 141, p. 1053
to phone *anrufen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1071
to photograph *fotografieren*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1295
To photograph, To have breakfast, To pour, To greet, To inform
chapter topic; Chapter 181, p. 1295
to pick (flowers, fruit) *pflücken*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1315
to pick up, to collect *abholen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1253
To pick up, To depart, To arrive, To take off, To tidy up
chapter topic; Chapter 174, p. 1253
to plan, to intend *vorhaben*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1059
to play *spielen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 583
to please, to be liked *gefallen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1083

to postpone *verschieben*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1351
to pour, to water *gießen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1295
to practise *üben*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1113
to prepare *vorbereiten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1357
To prepare, To choose, To wake, To weigh, To draw
chapter topic; Chapter 191, p. 1357
to print *drucken*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1271
to produce *erzeugen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1707
to promise *versprechen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1119
to pronounce *aussprechen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1683
to protect *schützen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1327
to prove *beweisen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1695
to pull *ziehen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1125
to push *schieben*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1321
to put, to stick *stecken*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1333
to put (upright) *stellen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 1041
to reach *erreichen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1283
to read — a verb that first meant "to gather", and the first one in this book whose vowel changes in the du and er forms *lesen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 37, p. 389
To receive, To remind, To allow, To feed, To reach
chapter topic; Chapter 179, p. 1283
to receive, to welcome *empfangen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1283
to recommend *empfehlen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1077
to refuse, to reject *ablehnen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1677
to register *anmelden*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1677

to remind (sich erinnern: to remember) *erinnern*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1283
to rent *mieten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1053
to repair *reparieren*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1053
to repeat *wiederholen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1125
to report *berichten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1689
to rescue *retten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1321
To rescue, To row, To push, To hit, To taste
chapter topic; Chapter 185, p. 1321
to rest (sich ausruhen) *ausruhen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1259
to ring *klingeln*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1089
To rinse, To start, To put, To steal, To climb
chapter topic; Chapter 187, p. 1333
to rinse, to wash up *spülen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1333
to row *rudern*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1321
to run — and to walk, because German draws the line in a different place from English, with rennen at the fast end *laufen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 40, p. 417
to sail *segeln*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1327
to save (money) *sparen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1107
To save, To jump, To die, To disturb, To argue
chapter topic; Chapter 150, p. 1107
to say — the verb this chapter builds its past tense on *sagen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 23, p. 275
to see — a straight cognate of English see *sehen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 57
to sell *verkaufen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1119
to send *schicken*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 607
to send, to broadcast *senden*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1327
to separate *trennen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1339

to sew *nähen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1309
to share, to divide *teilen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1339
to shout, to scream *schreien*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1101
to show *zeigen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 595
to shower *duschen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1277
To shower, To fall asleep, To get on, To get off, To change
chapter topic; Chapter 178, p. 1277
to sign *unterschreiben*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1119
To sign, To earn, To sell, To promise, To introduce
chapter topic; Chapter 152, p. 1119
to sing *singen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 595
To sing, To travel, To show, To bring, To forget
chapter topic; Chapter 66, p. 595
to sit — the same inherited word as English sit, respelt by the other branch of the shift that separated helfen from help *sitzen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 39, p. 407
to sleep — the same word as English sleep under two coats of German paint, and a second way for a strong verb to break *schlafen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 39, p. 407
to smell *riechen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1101
to smile *lächeln*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1301
to sneeze *niesen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1309
to snow *schneien*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1327
To snow, To protect, To sail, To send, To stroll
chapter topic; Chapter 186, p. 1327
to spell *buchstabieren*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1271
to spend (money) *ausgeben*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1683
to stand — the verb hiding inside verstehen, and the one place German keeps a letter English put in the wrong tense *stehen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 39, p. 407

to start *anfangen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1053
to start, to take off *starten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1333
to stay — a verb that takes sein while meaning the exact opposite of change *bleiben*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 29, p. 345
to steal *stehlen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1333
to stop *aufhören*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1071
to stroll (spazieren gehen) *spazieren*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1327
to suffer *leiden*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1309
To suffer, To measure, To mix, To sew, To sneeze
chapter topic; Chapter 183, p. 1309
to take along *mitnehmen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1095
to take care (sich kümmern um) *kümmern*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1301
to take off (clothes), to move out *ausziehen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1253
to take — the verb English lost, though it left numb and nimble behind as fossils *nehmen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 38, p. 397
to talk on the phone *telefonieren*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1339
to taste *schmecken*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1321
to tell (a story) *erzählen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1047
to test, to check *prüfen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1315
to think over *überlegen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1113
to think — the verb you already met hiding inside danke, and the same inherited word as English think *denken*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 37, p. 389
to throw *werfen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1125
to tidy up *aufräumen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1253

to translate *übersetzen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1345
To translate, To hug, To arrange, To forbid, To connect
chapter topic; Chapter 189, p. 1345
to travel *reisen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 595
to travel, to drive — motion with a vehicle under it, and English fare hiding inside *fahren*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 29, p. 345
to understand — literally "to stand around a thing", the same picture English built independently in understand *verstehen*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 37, p. 389
to use *benutzen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1077
to use *verwenden*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1351
To use, To go shopping, To invite, To recommend, To decide
chapter topic; Chapter 145, p. 1077
to visit *besuchen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 1041
to visit (sights) *besichtigen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1689
to wait *warten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 589
To wait, To pay, To cook, To laugh, To cry
chapter topic; Chapter 65, p. 589
to wake (someone) *wecken*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1357
to want *wollen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 1023
To want, Wish, To hope, To order, Rather
chapter topic; Chapter 136, p. 1023
to watch television *fernsehen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1289
to weigh *wiegen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1357
to whisper *flüstern*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1289
to win *gewinnen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1089
To win, To hang, To marry, To know, To ring
chapter topic; Chapter 147, p. 1089
to wish *wünschen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 729

to write — the one verb in this chapter German did not inherit but borrowed, from Latin scribere *schreiben*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 37, p. 389
to you, formally — the capitalised to-whom that goes with Sie *Ihnen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 3, p. 33
to you — the informal partner of mir *dir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 3, p. 33
today *heute*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 771
Today, Sometimes, There, Far, On the right
chapter topic; Chapter 95, p. 771
together *zusammen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1247
tomorrow — the second job of the Morgen you already know *morgen*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 57
toothpaste *die Zahnpasta*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 889
traffic *der Verkehr*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1665
traffic lights *die Ampel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 845
Traffic, Trust, A club, Caution, An advantage
chapter topic; Chapter 242, p. 1665
training, an apprenticeship *die Ausbildung*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1561
trousers *die Hose*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 795
trust *das Vertrauen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1665
Tuesday — named for a war-god both languages kept, under two different names *Dienstag*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 10, p. 127
twelve — the second and last number to refuse the pattern *zwölf*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 18, p. 225
twenty — where the ending changes from zehn to -zig *zwanzig*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 231
two — English two with its t turned into the ts of z *zwei*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 6, p. 103
Two Thoughts, One Sentence
chapter topic; Chapter 48, p. 485
typical *typisch*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1549

U

ugly *hässlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 747
Uhr, taken apart
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 12, p. 149
unfortunately *leider*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1241
Unfortunately, Perhaps, Probably, Of course, Exactly
chapter topic; Chapter 172, p. 1241
unfriendly *unfreundlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1211
unhappy *unglücklich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1549
university studies *das Studium*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1647
until, up to — the preposition every soft German goodbye is built from *bis*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 57
Up, Down, At the front, At the back, Opposite
chapter topic; Chapter 109, p. 857
up, upstairs *oben*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 857
urgent, in a hurry *eilig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1483
us — the same word as English *us*, doing both German jobs at once, which is the one place German is simpler *uns*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 505
useful *nützlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1525

V

Vater and pater
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 16, p. 199
vegetables *das Gemüse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 925
Verbs of the Mind
chapter topic; Chapter 37, p. 389
very — the intensifier that turns gut into a real answer *sehr*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 3, p. 33
vinegar *der Essig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 943

W

Wasser and water
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 17, p. 215
water — a second das-word, and the w that is said as a v *das Wasser*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 215
we — and the ending that is the dictionary form again *wir*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 83
we are — the plural form, and the first one that looks like the infinitive *wir sind*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 26, p. 311
we said — the fourth slot, where the helper is the infinitive itself *wir haben gesagt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 24, p. 285
we were — the plural past, and the last form of sein you need *wir waren*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 28, p. 333
weak *schwach*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 747
Weather
chapter topic; Chapter 34, p. 377
weather — a NATIVE Germanic word, unlike Romance's shared Latin tempus family; Wetter is the SAME word as English "weather," and regnet is the SAME word as English "rain" *das Wetter, es regnet*
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 34, p. 377
Wednesday — the first day that breaks the pattern, because the Church would not name one for Wodan *Mittwoch*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 10, p. 127
Weekend, Date, Century, Never, Often
chapter topic; Chapter 137, p. 1029
weight *das Gewicht*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1593
Wein and vinum
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 17, p. 215
weiß, taken apart
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 20, p. 247
well known *bekannt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1223
Well known, Foreign, Nervous, Proud, Angry
chapter topic; Chapter 169, p. 1223
wet *nass*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 1017

what's your name? (literally "how are you called?") *wie heißen Sie?*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
what — the fourth w-question, and the one you will use most *was*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 5, p. 83
When the Calendar Stopped Naming
chapter topic; Chapter 14, p. 175
when — the fourth W, and the first question this book can ask about the clock and the calendar it already owns *wann*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 46, p. 465
When the Verb Steps to the Front
chapter topic; Chapter 46, p. 465
where — the third of German's w-questions *wo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 5, p. 83
which — built as "what-like", the identical two pieces English welded into *which* *welcher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 47, p. 475
Which One, and the Form the Book Owed You
chapter topic; Chapter 47, p. 475
Which past, and where
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, usage and culture; Chapter 25, p. 297
white — and the first everyday word that needs the ß you were given in chapter four *weiß*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 20, p. 247
who — and the W that every German question word begins with, against the WH that every English one begins with *wer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 46, p. 465
Why German keeps the pronoun
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 5, p. 83
Why "to be" is the messiest word in every language
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, usage and culture; Chapter 28, p. 333
why — two old words fused into one, "about what", the same build as English *wherefore* *warum*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 46, p. 465
wide *breit*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 987
Wie geht es Ihnen? — the same question, at a distance
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 33
Window, Chair, Table, Wall, Roof
chapter topic; Chapter 76, p. 655
windy *windig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1555
wine — a der-word, and the one thing on this table Rome supplied *der Wein*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 215

winter — spelled exactly as in English, and the fourth of the four *der Winter*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 15, p. 185
Wohnst du in Berlin? — the question that has no question word
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, usage and culture; Chapter 46, p. 465
wonderful *herrlich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1507
wood *das Holz*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1435
wool *die Wolle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1429
work *die Arbeit*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 813
working, employed *berufstätig*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1477
would like — the politest thing in German, and a bent form of the mögen you already own *möchten*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 51, p. 515
Writing — Four Lines, And The Joiner You Can See
chapter topic; Chapter 55, p. 533
Writing — With A Clock
chapter topic; Chapter 54, p. 531
Writing — Your Own Line
chapter topic; Chapter 53, p. 529
wrong *falsch*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 759

Y

yes *ja*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 31, p. 367
Yes and No
chapter topic; Chapter 31, p. 367
yesterday — the word that fills the middle of a Perfekt sentence, and morgen's opposite number *gestern*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 24, p. 285
Yoghurt, Nurse, Cook, Police officer, Shop assistant
chapter topic; Chapter 124, p. 951
you all, as the ones it happens to — and the word English quietly promoted to be its only "you" *euch*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 505
you all — the plural you English gave up *ihr*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 83

you are — bin plus the -st ending you already know, and the one place sein behaves *du bist*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 26, p. 311
you are, to more than one person — the form English lost when it dropped its plural you *ihr seid*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 26, p. 311
you, as the one it happens to — the partner of mich, and English *thee* one more time *dich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 505
you (familiar / formal) *du / Sie*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
you have — the first form where the b falls out and the rule stops working *du hast*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 22, p. 265
you said — the second slot, where haben drops its b exactly as English have does *du hast gesagt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 24, p. 285
you were — the familiar -st ending again, now on the past stem *du warst*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 28, p. 333
your first sentence built from parts, not handed to you whole *Ich lerne Deutsch*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 83
Your own line — the first writing with no model
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 53, p. 529
your — the second of the six, and the same consonant shift that turned *thou* into *du* *dein*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 49, p. 495
youth *die Jugend*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1599

Z

zero *null*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 813
Zero, Word, Answer, Work, Music
chapter topic; Chapter 102, p. 813
Ziffer plus zehn — the rule
grammar topic; explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar; Chapter 19, p. 231
-zig and -ty
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 19, p. 231
zwei Uhr, not zwei Uhren
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 12, p. 149

Other

ß — the letter that is two *s*'s in a coat
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing, grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 4, p. 57